

Dynamic Events & Crisis System

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1. Purpose and scope

This document is the rulebook and first card library for everything the Game Master does to the city: 26 dynamic events, 20 crises and 8 new opportunity templates, all written as structured cards that resolve against whichever companies are active. A run uses about 14 to 16 of the 46 event and crisis cards, so the library supports several runs before a card repeats in the same slot.

What it inherits and does not redesign. The draft's event engine (events change the world, crises force decisions), its 10 event types, the crisis stages (signal, trigger, response window, resolution, aftermath, ledger), the C1 to C4 severity scale, the crisis consequence rules (never eliminate a participant, always a recovery path, never change a stated rule after people act), the announcement templates and the safety rule against anything that could be mistaken for a real emergency. The card IDs E01 to E30 and C01 to C20 are kept, so references in other documents (E05, E20, C16 in the Human Internet design) still point at the right card.

What it builds on. Starting World's uniformity rule (2.1), role slots S1 to S12 (11.1), hidden lever and vulnerability types (10.4) and N-based scaling (12). Core Game Systems' tick settlement order (1.1), evidence classes E1 to E5 (1.3), Reliability Record (1.5), force majeure clause (4.6), shock vocabulary (6.7), credit posture (7.3), talent index (5.6) and crisis-response missions (2.2). The Human Internet's information modes, crisis signals, Stale stamps and the Tick 7 Data Drop. Institution Operating Content's named suppliers (SU-01 to SU-15) and their event hooks, Bank products (BK-01 to BK-13), event-released customer cards (CU-28 to CU-30), Government regulatory instruments (GV-R01 to GV-R06), Investor theses and the eight sector tags: wherever a card here touches a desk, it fires that desk's own event control rather than inventing a new one.

What it adds.

- One card schema for events and crises (section 3), the same fields as the drafts' event trigger format and dynamic-event operations list, so cards move straight into a spreadsheet or the platform.
- A generic targeting rule that picks which company a crisis hits from live play, never from a name (section 4).
- A deck plan for a 6 to 8 hour run that scales with N (section 5).
- The library itself (Appendices A and B) and 8 opportunity templates, O21 to O28, that close the Core Game Systems gap: the opportunity library now holds 28 cards against the 25 a 12-company run needs (Appendix C).
- A generation template for GMs and volunteers to write more cards (section 8).

Library size. This is the first solid batch, not the full set. The target is 50 to 100 event and crisis cards, written in a later content-expansion pass using the template in section 8; the draft sketches not yet filled in are listed there as the first candidates.

Numbers. Every price, capacity, percentage and VB amount is a starting parameter for playtesting, written against the Starting World and Core Game Systems values (Bank base prices Compute 20, Energy 15, Logistics 20, Materials 15, Data 25, Infrastructure 30). Section 12 lists the ones to tune first.

The full library is also exported as a spreadsheet-ready file, event-crisis-library.csv, one row per card with the same columns as section 3.

2. How events plug into the tick

Every event and crisis starts, resolves and ends at a tick boundary, inside the fixed 12-step settlement order of Core Game Systems 1.1, so nothing the GM does lands in the middle of a negotiation.

Words used below. Tick k is the 30-minute trading period; the boundary $k/k+1$ is the settlement that ends it. A card that "fires at Tick k " is announced in step 11 (scheduled releases) of the boundary that opens Tick k and takes effect when the market reopens at step 12.

Moment	Settlement step	What happens
One tick before firing	Step 11 of the previous boundary	Crisis signal (if the card has one) goes to its 2 or 3 holders as a Hidden-to-Personal information record (Human Internet crisis signal)
Firing	Step 11, then step 12	Announcement is published; parameter changes apply from reopen; crisis mission is released outside the board count
During the window	Normal trading	Participants respond with any valid action; desks apply the changed parameters to everyone alike
Resolution	Step 1 (Freeze) of the boundary that ends the window	The crisis outcome is judged on the state at Freeze, never on promises
Posting consequences	The step that kind of entry normally uses	Contract payments and penalties at step 2, resource losses at step 5, extra charges at step 6, seat and staffing effects at step 7; the lifecycle check at step 8 then sees them
Aftermath	Step 9 of the resolving boundary	The card's aftermath opportunity enters the Opportunity Register as

Moment	Settlement step	What happens
		Available
Ending	Step 11 of the boundary at the end of the duration	Parameters revert; an end notice is published; stamped information cards about the changed fact turn Stale (Human Internet 7)

Three rules that follow from Core Game Systems.

1. **Events change parameters, not stocks.** A dynamic event may change prices, capacities, tier rates, credit posture, the talent index, demand indices or desk rules (Core Game Systems 6.7). It never removes cash or units directly. Only a crisis card may destroy units or charge VB, and only as its card states.
2. **Settled contracts keep running.** A recorded contract continues through any event unless it carries a force majeure clause naming that card's ID, in which case the named obligation is suspended for the card's duration (Core Game Systems 4.6). Every card ID is therefore also a force majeure code.
3. **Events apply by tag; crisis targets are picked by rule.** Market events name a resource, sector or cluster, never a company. A company-targeted crisis names the company it hits in its alert, because "who's affected" must be announced, but the company is chosen by the published exposure rule in section 4, never by the GM's preference.

Information modes. Cards behave the same in Dark, Closed-net and Open-net modes, except that in Dark (Human Internet I, before Tick 1) no events or crises fire, because money and resources are still. Signals can travel by whisper in any mode; after the Tick 8 Internet Unlock the announcement also appears in the City Net archive.

3. The event card

Every event and crisis is one record with the same 19 fields, merging the draft's event trigger format (Institutions Handbook 12.3) and per-event operations list (Event Operations 23) with the crisis design rules; a field that does not apply to a card holds a dash, never a blank.

#	Field	What it holds	Rule
1	ID	E01 to E30 for events, C01 to C20 for crises, continuing upward for new cards	Never reused; doubles as the force majeure code
2	Title	Two to four words	Fictional; no real company, brand or emergency service
3	Class and type	Event (one of the 10	Sets which deck slot it

#	Field	What it holds	Rule
		draft event types) or Crisis (local, sector, city, systemic)	can fill
4	Severity	Event: Minor (one parameter, one tick) or Major (several parameters or two or more ticks). Crisis: C1 to C4	Sets response window and consequence cap
5	Stage fit	Early (Ticks 2 to 4), Mid (5 to 7), Late (8 to 9), Final (10)	The GM may move a card one stage either way
6	Tags	Resource, sector, cluster, slot (S1 to S12), vulnerability hook	Used for targeting and for matching dossier vulnerabilities
7	Trigger	Scheduled tick, or a condition the platform can test	Conditions use platform state only
8	Who is affected	A tag rule, or the exposure rule for a crisis target (section 4)	Never a company name
9	Signal	Holders, channel and lead time of the early warning, or "none"	Never sent to a target company's own staff
10	Announcement	The participant-facing text, with slot variables	Uses the CITY NOTICE or CITY ALERT template; states what changed, not what to do
11	What changes	Exact parameter changes, in the Core Game Systems 6.7 vocabulary	Numbers written as formulas of N where quantities scale
12	Duration	Ticks the change lasts	Ends at a stated boundary
13	Immediate	What the change does to the market in the	Describes effects, not

#	Field	What it holds	Rule
	consequences	first tick	intended strategies
14	Response window	Crisis only: when the outcome is judged	Section 6.1
15	Possible responses	Three or more routes with different costs and risks	No obvious single answer
16	Hidden opportunity	Who can profit and how, unannounced	Every card has one
17	GM instructions	Volunteer briefing, sealed instructions, what not to say	Includes which desks get a sealed card
18	Recovery and rollback	How the old state resumes, and the target's recovery path	Every crisis has a recovery path that requires execution
19	Aftermath, scoring and observation	Linked aftermath opportunity, Reliability Record effect, crisis mission, signals for observers	Observers record behaviour, never award points

Slot variables. Card text uses the Human Internet variables so the platform can resolve it for any active set: {res} a resource, {sector} a customer sector, {cluster} Physical, Digital or Regulated, {S1} to {S12} the company or institution currently filling a slot, {target} the company a crisis resolved to, {N} the number of active companies, {k} the firing tick, plus {domain} a role domain, {product} a Product Card's name, {category} a product tag and {product type} a kind of product the GM names in a signal. Announcements show the resolved values; the card keeps the variables.

Resolving {res}, {sector} and {cluster} for market events. Unless a card fixes them, the platform picks the value with the most active companies consuming it at High or Very High tier (for {res}) or with the most active companies selling into it (for {sector}, one of Institution Operating Content's eight sector tags: Retail and Food, Logistics and Mobility, Finance, Health, Skills and Education, Energy and Climate, Technology and Data, Manufacturing); ties go to the value not used by an event in the last 3 ticks, then to a random draw. This keeps every event biting several companies in any active set, which Starting World 4.3's active-set checklist already guarantees is possible.

Visibility. Cards are Hidden (GM) until fired (Starting World 10.2). Announcements become Public. The Who-is-affected rule, hidden opportunity and GM instructions stay Hidden (GM) for the whole run and go into the post-event report.

4. Triggers, targeting and vulnerability hooks

Crises hit whichever active company is most exposed at the moment they fire, measured from platform data, so a crisis is a consequence of how a company has played rather than of which dossier it holds; a company that diversified, hedged or retained its people is less likely to be hit.

4.1 Trigger types

Trigger	How it works	Example
Scheduled	Fires at a tick in the run's deck plan (section 5)	E07 Credit Tightening at Tick 6
Conditional	Fires at the first boundary where a platform condition is true, within its stage window	E01 fires early if Bank Compute stock falls below 50%
Hook	Fires because a dossier's hidden vulnerability names it (4.4)	A Fragile supply vulnerability tied to C01
Aftermath	Fires as the follow-on of another card	C11 Demand Explosion after E28 New Market Signal, if the GM's deck allows

A conditional card that never meets its condition by the end of its stage window either fires at the window's last tick (if marked "fallback: fire") or returns to the reserve unused.

4.2 Picking the target of a company crisis

Local (C1) crises hit one company. The platform resolves the target at the boundary before firing, in four steps.

1. **Eligible companies.** Operating state (not Distressed, Acquired or Failed); not a new venture or spin-out in its first 2 ticks; not already hit by a C1 this run; not hit by any crisis in the last 2 ticks.
2. **Exposure score.** Each card states one exposure measure computed from platform data only, such as lowest runway in ticks, highest share of revenue from one customer, or a critical dependency still served by its institution fallback. Highest exposure is the target.
3. **Ties.** The company that has received the fewest crisis hits this run, then a random draw recorded by the platform.
4. **Operational veto.** The GM may skip a target only for an operational reason (its CEO volunteer is away, its station is mid-dispute, a safety or access need) and must log the reason. The next company in rank becomes the target. Wanting a different storyline is not a reason.

Fairness caps. Each company takes at most one C1 crisis per run and at most three crisis effects in total (counting sector and city crises that touch it). A C1 card may be used at most twice per run, on different companies. If no company is eligible, the card returns to the reserve.

Sector and city crises (C2 to C4) apply to everyone carrying the card's tags, like events, and name tags in their alerts rather than companies.

What participants are told. The Participant Handbook states the principle ("the city hits exposure: thin runway, one big customer, an unhedged supply line, unretained people") but not the formulas. Knowing the principle is a reason to prepare, which is what the Founder Ledger wants to see.

4.3 Generic rules, company flavour

The card is generic; the story is local. When a crisis resolves to {target}, the alert uses that company's public profile (its sector and product names) and the slot variables fill in its actual counterparties. A Platform Outage at a payments company reads as a payments outage and at a hosting company as a data-centre outage, but both run exactly the same rule. Dossiers may add one line of flavour text per crisis type to their CEO persona card; they may never change a card's numbers or rule.

4.4 Vulnerability hooks

Starting World 10.4 lets a dossier's hidden vulnerability fire "if a named event fires". Dossiers name a card ID from this table, so the vulnerability lives in the dossier and the trigger lives in the library.

Vulnerability type (Starting World 10.4)	Cards it may name	What fires
Fragile supply	E01, E02, E03, E04, C01, C03, C04, C21 (C21 is the weather event behind SU-08 and every Materials agreement placed with it)	The dossier's supplier agreement or supply contract fails when the card fires
Regulatory exposure	E17, E31, E32, C08	The dossier's named product is suspended when the card fires, using Government instrument GV-R01 Rule change
Hidden liability	E07, C02, C13, C22, C23	The dossier's liability grows by its stated amount
Concentration	E12, C06, C10	The anchor customer leaves unless the dossier's condition is met
Key person	E13, C07	The named domain loses a person (as an open seat, see C07) unless retained

Deck rule. When building a run, the GM includes every card named by an active company's vulnerability, as long as the card fits a slot in the deck plan. If it cannot fit, the dossier's vulnerability uses its stated-tick fallback instead. A hook adds the dossier's vulnerability effect on top of the card's normal effect, and both count toward the company's crisis cap; the combined worst case still sits inside the vulnerability cap of 10,000 VB plus the card's own cap (section 6.3).

5. Pacing and the deck plan

A default 8-hour run plays 11 ticks between Market Open and the freeze and uses one deck of about 14 to 16 cards: 8 events, $\lceil N \div 2 \rceil$ local crises, one sector crisis at Tick 5 and one final crisis at Tick 10. The draft's stage arc (early: the world changes; mid: trade-offs; late: existential choices; final: commitment before Investor Day) sets which cards go where.

5.1 The default spine

Tick numbers follow the Human Internet spine: Market Open starts Tick 1, Tick 7 is the Data Drop, the Internet Unlock and Capital Market fire as Tick 8 starts, and the freeze falls at the end of Tick 11.

Tick	Fixed moments from other documents	Event slot	Crisis slot	Signals sent
1	Market opens	None: let the base economy show itself	None	Event for Tick 2 (optional)
2		Early, Minor, preferably positive	None	Tick 3 cards
3	Auction session 1	Early	C1 #1	Tick 4 cards
4	Starting supplier agreements expire; salary review	Early, supply-side	C1 #2	Sector crisis (2 or 3 holders)
5	Auction session 2	Optional; skip if the sector crisis is heavy	Sector crisis (C2) , the drafts' Market Shock	Tick 6 cards
6	Anchor contracts reach renewal	Mid, credit or customer	C1 #3	Tick 7 rumour holders
7	Human Internet II, Data Drop; auction session 3	E20 Market Rumour (fixed), E05 optional alongside	None: the Data Drop is the tick's disruption	Tick 8 cards
8	Internet Unlock, Capital Market opens; salary review	Late, capital (E08, E09 or E10)	C1 #4	Tick 9 cards
9	Auction session 4,	Late	C1 #5 ($N \geq 9$)	Final crisis (3

Tick	Fixed moments from other documents	Event slot	Crisis slot	Signals sent
	mystery lot			holders)
10		None	Final crisis (C3 or C4)	None
11	Final build; cap tables locked a tick before the freeze	None	None: aftermath and close	None

When $\lceil N \div 2 \rceil$ is 6 ($N = 11$ or 12), the sixth local crisis shares Tick 6 or Tick 8 with another one, on a different company.

5.2 Pacing rules

- **Two at once, at most.** No more than 2 events are active at the same time, and an event and a crisis may not change the same parameter at the same time. The final crisis is the one deliberate exception, because it is a composite.
- **One new card per tick, plus local crises.** A tick never opens with more than one event and one sector or city crisis. Local crises are added on top because they touch one company each.
- **Silence is a mechanic.** The Human Internet's release budget is a ceiling, not a target. The GM may leave an event slot empty, and should do so at least once in the early or mid game.
- **No repeat on the same resource in consecutive ticks.** A resource squeezed in Tick k is not squeezed again in Tick $k+1$.
- **Positives count.** At least 2 of the 8 events help someone directly (credit window, open capacity, subsidy, new market, fast-track), so players learn that events are opportunities as well as threats.
- **The world must stay readable.** Every active parameter change is shown on the public City Status board with its end tick.

5.3 Building a run deck

The GM builds the deck before the event and seals it; it cannot change during the run except by the GM's emergency ruling protocol (Institutions Handbook 12.4), which is logged.

1. Set N and the active set (Starting World 4.3).
2. Add every card named by an active company's vulnerability hook that fits a slot (4.4).
3. Fill the 8 event slots so the deck touches at least 4 of the 6 resources, and includes at least one capital, one customer, one talent and one regulatory or information event.
4. Pick the sector crisis and the final crisis. The final is C20 Final System Shock by default, or a C3 card for a shorter or gentler run.
5. Load the C1 cards: $\lceil N \div 2 \rceil$ local crises from at least 3 different C1 types.
6. For each card, confirm its aftermath opportunity is loaded in the Opportunity Register and its sealed volunteer cards are printed.

7. Record the deck in the GM state export (Technology backup plan, "at major events").

5.4 Three ready-made decks

Checked on paper against the library, not yet playtested. Each fills the default spine at $N = 7$; add C1 cards for larger N .

Slot	Deck A, Supply squeeze	Deck B, Capital cycle	Deck C, Trust and rules
Tick 2 event	E22 Open Capacity	E29 Resource Subsidy	E26 Procurement Shortcut
Tick 3 event	E01 Compute Crunch	E11 Customer Rush	E15 Media Moment
Tick 4 event	E04 Material Shortage	E02 Energy Spike	E17 Regulatory Review
Tick 5 sector crisis	C01 Critical Supplier Collapse	C10 Demand Collapse	C08 Regulatory Halt
Tick 6 event	E13 Talent Exodus	E07 Credit Tightening	E25 Procurement Tightening
Tick 7 event	E20 Market Rumour	E20 Market Rumour, E05 Data Boom	E20 Market Rumour
Tick 8 event	E09 Investor Frenzy	E10 Investor Freeze	E08 Credit Window
Tick 9 event	E03 Logistics Jam	E24 Demand Fragmentation	E28 New Market Signal
Local crises (4)	C06, C07, C12, C13	C13, C06, C07, C17	C17, C12, C06, C07
Tick 10 final	C20 Final System Shock	C02 Liquidity Freeze	C09 Reputation Shock, played as city-wide

5.5 Shorter and longer runs

A 6-hour run has about 8 ticks. Keep the order (calm open, early events, a sector crisis at the midpoint, the Data Drop, capital, a final crisis on the second-to-last tick) and drop alternate event slots, giving about 5 events, $\lceil N \div 3 \rceil$ local crises and the two big crises. A run longer than 11 ticks adds one event slot per extra tick in the mid game and never adds a third big crisis. The GM Handbook fixes the exact spine for each run length.

6. Responses, recovery, scoring and observation

Every crisis gives at least three routes out with different costs, judges the result on the recorded state at the deadline, caps the damage by severity and leaves a recovery path, so a crisis reveals behaviour and moves advantage rather than ending anyone's day.

6.1 Response windows

Severity	Reach	Draft window	Window in ticks	Resolved at
C1 Local	One company	15 to 30 min	The firing tick	The boundary ending the firing tick
C2 Sector	Companies with one tag	20 to 40 min	The firing tick	The boundary ending the firing tick
C3 City	Most companies and institutions	30 to 45 min	1 tick, or 2 if the card says so	The boundary ending the window
C4 Systemic	The whole economy	30 to 60 min	1 tick in the final slot (2 if fired earlier)	The boundary ending the window

A tick is 30 minutes less a 2-minute freeze, so a one-tick window sits at the top of the draft's C1 range and inside the others. The alert always states the deadline as a tick boundary and a clock time.

6.2 How responses count

- **Any valid action counts.** Cards list likely routes, but the alert says "participants may pursue any valid response" (draft template), and a route nobody listed is judged by the same rule.
- **State at the deadline.** Consequences are computed from the registry at step 1 of the resolving boundary. A deal Proposed but not Accepted by then does not count.
- **Crisis missions.** Each crisis releases one crisis-response mission, outside the board count. Completing it pays the Tier 2 band and exempts the completing company from the crisis effect (Core Game Systems 2.3). Eligibility is "companies affected by the live crisis", plus helpers where the card says a second company takes part.
- **Helping is a response.** A company that is not hit but supplies, lends to or partners with one that is gets the deal's value; several cards add a crisis-mission share for the helper.
- **Force majeure.** A contract whose force majeure clause names a fired card's type (for example "any Supply outage") or ID suspends the named obligation for the card's duration, with no breach recorded. This reads Core Game Systems 4.6's "a GM-declared event named in the clause" as naming either the card or its type, because participants cannot know card IDs in advance.

6.3 Consequence caps

Severity	Worst case per company, VB equivalent
C1	6,000
C2	8,000

Severity	Worst case per company, VB equivalent
C3	10,000
C4	12,000

The cap counts cash charged, units destroyed at Bank base price and revenue forfeited, but not market effects such as paying more for scarce resources. Caps sit under the draft's "no participant eliminated" rule: a crisis may push a company into Distressed, but the 2-tick recovery window always applies. A company made Distressed by the final crisis cannot fail before the freeze; it is reported as Distressed at Investor Day instead.

6.4 Recovery and aftermath

Every crisis card names a recovery path for the company that was hit, and every event and crisis names an aftermath opportunity that enters the register at the resolving boundary (draft rule: "once a crisis is resolved, create at least one aftermath opportunity"). The aftermath card is open to any company, not reserved for the one that was hit, because the drafts want crises to transfer advantage to whoever prepared or moves first. Aftermath opportunities count toward the run's $2N + 1$ selection (Core Game Systems 3.5); with O21 to O28 the library holds 28 opportunities, 3 more than a 12-company run needs.

6.5 Scoring

Events and crises never add or remove points. They act on scoring only through what Core Game Systems already measures.

- **Reliability Record.** A breach caused by an event still counts as a breach unless a force majeure clause covered it. This makes force majeure clauses worth negotiating, which is the lesson.
- **Reference Valuation and Workforce Credit** move with the cash, revenue and staff a crisis changes, at the normal tick recalculation.
- **Crisis timeline.** For each company the platform compiles which cards touched it, what it did inside each window (recorded deals, missions, hires) and the outcome. It goes into the Investor Day pack, so a company can tell the story of a crisis it handled. How much that counts is for the Investor Day and scoring document.

6.6 Observation

Crisis windows are the Founder Ledger's main source of Pressure-family evidence (CL Crisis leader, AD Adaptor), along with RH Resource hacker and RX Relentless executor (Founder Identification, observation moments table).

- **Placement.** When a C1 resolves to {target}, the platform prompts the observer covering that floor zone, and the Ledger Lead may move one observer for the window. Sector and city crises are covered by normal zone rotation.
- **Being hit is not evidence.** Observers record what someone did, never that their company was unlucky. Sector and city crises give every company a pressure moment, which keeps CL evidence available to people whose company escaped a local crisis.
- **Helping counts.** Supplying, lending to or rescuing a hit company is CB Collaborator or DM Deal maker evidence, equal in weight to leading your own response.

- Each card lists the signals most likely to show, as a "look for" prompt. It is not a scoring key.

7. Running a card live

The GM runs each card through the draft's six crisis stages using a fixed checklist, so a volunteer can stand in and the card plays the same way; staffing and rotas belong to the Event Operations Manual.

7.1 Before the event

1. Build and seal the run deck (5.3).
2. For each card, print one sealed volunteer card per desk it touches: what changes at that desk, the exact words to use, and what never to say. A desk opens its card only when the GM announces the firing.
3. Print paper fallbacks: one crisis envelope per crisis (alert text, response sheet, deadline) and one response sheet per company, for use if the platform is down (Technology paper-fallback plan).
4. Load each card's aftermath opportunity in the register as Hidden.
5. Brief the Ledger Lead on the deck, never on C1 targets, which are not known until the boundary.

7.2 Each card, step by step

1. **Signal (one tick ahead).** Send the card's signal to its holders at step 11. Log who received it.
2. **Resolve targets (at the firing boundary).** The platform resolves {res}, {sector} and any C1 target; the GM checks the result and applies an operational veto only for a logged reason (4.2).
3. **Trigger.** Comms publishes the announcement on the City Status board, the portal and the floor screens; the GM hands sealed cards to the named desks; parameter changes go live at reopen.
4. **Response window.** Start the visible timer. Desks apply the change to everyone alike. The GM watches for contradictory desk answers and corrects them at once, in public if a participant was given a wrong answer.
5. **Resolution.** At the deadline's Freeze, apply the stated consequence from the registry. Never change the stated rule after participants have acted (draft consequence rule).
6. **Aftermath.** Release the aftermath opportunity at step 9. Publish a short result line ("Logistics capacity restored. Two companies kept every delivery.") without naming who failed.
7. **Ledger.** Prompt observers on system-flagged actions; log adaptations and failures in the GM log.
8. **End.** At the end of the duration, revert parameters at step 11, publish the end notice, and tell every briefed desk the old state has resumed.

7.3 What the GM and volunteers say

- **Use the templates.** Events: "CITY NOTICE — [EVENT]. Effective now until the end of Tick [k], [rule change]. Affected: [tags]. This is a market condition, not an instruction. The market is open." Crises: "CITY ALERT — [CRISIS]. [What has changed]. Response window: until [boundary and clock time]. Participants may pursue any valid response. Consequences will be based on the recorded state at the deadline."
- **Never suggest a strategy.** Desks answer "what are my options at this desk?", never "what should I do?".
- **Never confirm a signal.** Before a card fires, every desk answers questions about it with "No comment" (Human Internet desk-confirmation rule).

- **Never reveal a target's exposure.** The alert names the affected company and the change; it never says why the company was the most exposed.

7.4 Safety

The drafts' safety rules override every card.

- Every alert carries the word SIMULATION on screen and on paper. No sirens, alarm tones, flashing lights or language borrowed from real emergency services.
- No card creates scarcity of food, water, seating, breaks, exits or accessibility support.
- A real incident pauses the game. Open windows are extended by the length of the pause, and nothing resolves until play restarts.
- Health, security and "outage" cards describe fictional companies and fictional systems only, never a real provider, disease or attack method.

7.5 When something goes wrong

Problem	Ruling
A card fired with a wrong number	Correct it publicly within the window and extend the window by the time lost; never correct it silently after people acted
Two desks gave different answers	The announced card text wins; the GM honours any deal recorded in good faith on the wrong answer
The platform is down during a window	Switch to the paper envelope; the deadline moves to the next boundary after restoration
A target is eliminated in all but name	The GM may apply the restructuring routes early (Core Game Systems 8.6) and log the ruling
Participants find a loophole in a card	It stands for this run if it follows the card's text; fix the card afterwards

8. Writing new cards

New cards are written on the blank below, checked against nine rules, and reviewed by a second person before they enter the library; this is how the library grows from 46 cards to the 50 to 100 target.

8.1 Blank card

[ID] [Title]

Class and type: [Event: type | Crisis: local, sector, city or systemic] · Severity: [Minor/Major | C1-C4] ·

Stage: [Early/Mid/Late/Final] · Tags: [res, sector, cluster, slot, hook]

- Trigger: [scheduled tick, or a platform condition + stage window + fallback]

- Who is affected: [tag rule, or the exposure measure for a C1 target]

- Signal: [holders, channel, lead time | none]

- Announcement: "CITY NOTICE / CITY ALERT — ..." (variables in braces)
- What changes: [parameter changes, written as formulas of N where quantities scale]
- Duration: [ticks]
- Immediate consequences: [what moves in the first tick]
- Response window: [crisis only]
- Possible responses: [3 or more, each with a different cost or risk]
- Hidden opportunity: [who can profit, unannounced]
- GM instructions: [sealed cards for which desks; what never to say]
- Recovery and rollback: [how the old state returns; the target's recovery path]
- Aftermath, scoring and observation: [aftermath opportunity; crisis mission; Reliability effect; look-for signals]

8.2 The nine rules

1. **Generic.** No company name anywhere; tags, slots and exposure measures only (Starting World 2.1 and 2.4).
2. **Parameters, not stocks.** An event changes parameters in the Core Game Systems 6.7 vocabulary. Only a crisis may destroy units or charge VB, inside its severity cap (6.3).
3. **Scales with N.** Any quantity of the city (stock, capacity, card counts) is a formula of N.
4. **Three ways out.** At least three responses with different costs and risks, and no single obvious answer.
5. **Something hidden.** One hidden opportunity that someone not hit by the card can find.
6. **A way back.** A recovery path that needs execution, and an aftermath opportunity that exists in the library.
7. **Says what changed, not what to do.** The announcement uses the template and gives no strategy.
8. **Fictional and safe.** No real brands, people, diseases, attack techniques or emergency language (7.4).
9. **Readable at a desk.** A volunteer can apply the change from the sealed card alone, without a judgement call.

8.3 Review and IDs

A new card takes the next free ID (E33 onward, C24 onward, O29 onward) and stays marked "draft" until it has been read by a second GM or designer against the nine rules and played at least once in a playtest. The CSV keeps a status column for this.

8.4 The expansion pass

The first candidates are the draft sketches this batch did not fill, all already named in the Live Game Mechanics draft:

ID	Draft sketch	Note for the writer
C15	Supply Contamination	First priority: Institution Operating Content already names it as an SU-08 hook. Destroys units of one resource

ID	Draft sketch	Note for the writer
		bought from one channel in the last 2 ticks
E14	Talent Glut	The mirror of E13: one domain's index falls to 80 and the Talent Exchange adds $N \div 2$ specialists
E16	Attention Collapse	Media featured slots fall to zero for one tick; direct sales matter
E19	Competitor Outage	Absorbed into C12 Platform Outage here; keep as an event only if a lighter version is wanted
E23	Viral Product	A consumer sector's demand index jumps; logistics priority capacity becomes the bottleneck
E27	Founder Confidence Shock	Triggered by a public milestone miss; needs care so it never names a person
E30	Black Swan Window	A GM wildcard; write as a template with strict caps rather than a free hand
C14	Founder Departure	The company's CEO volunteer leaves for 2 ticks; signatories run the company (Starting World 5.4)
C18	Capital Flight	Overlaps E10; write as the C3 version with the Investor and Bank both constrained
GV-R06	Spot inspection	Government's once-per-run instrument has no card yet; write one that re-checks $[N \div 3]$ licence holders

After those, the pass should add cards in the families the library is thinnest in: institution-side crises (a desk closing, as the drafts' institution closure mechanic), positive crises (more like C11), cross-company cards that need two companies to cooperate, and late-game cards that interact with mergers and spin-outs. A rough target for the full library: 40 to 50 events, 25 to 35 crises and 15 or more event-linked opportunities.

Appendix A. Event library

Twenty-six market events, each a parameter change that applies by tag to every company alike; where a card touches a desk it fires that desk's own event control from Institution Operating Content. IDs follow the Live Game Mechanics draft; the draft's other sketches are listed for the expansion pass in section 8.4.

ID	Title	Type	Severity	Stage
E01	Compute Crunch	Supply outage + price shock	Major	Early to Mid (Ticks 3-6)
E02	Energy Spike	Price shock	Minor	Early to Mid (Ticks 3-6)
E03	Logistics Jam	Supply outage	Minor	Any (Ticks 3-9)
E04	Material Shortage	Emerging shortage	Major	Early (Ticks 3-4)
E05	Data Boom	Demand spike (information)	Minor	Mid (Tick 7, alongside the Data Drop)
E06	Infrastructure Sale	Supply opening	Minor	Early to Mid (Ticks 3-6)
E07	Credit Tightening	Credit tightening	Major	Mid (Tick 6)
E08	Credit Window	Credit loosening	Minor	Late (Tick 8) or Mid
E09	Investor Frenzy	Capital rush	Major	Late (Tick 8)
E10	Investor Freeze	Capital freeze	Major	Late (Tick 8 or 9)
E11	Customer Rush	Demand spike	Major	Early to Mid (Ticks 3-6)
E12	Customer Freeze	Demand freeze	Major	Mid (Ticks 5-7)
E13	Talent Exodus	Talent shortage	Major	Mid (Ticks 5-6)
E15	Media Moment	Media surge	Minor	Early to Mid
E17	Regulatory Review	Regulatory change	Major	Mid (Ticks 4-6)
E18	Fast-Track Licence	Regulatory opening	Minor	Early to Mid
E20	Market Rumour	Information event	Minor	Mid (Tick 7, fixed)

ID	Title	Type	Severity	Stage
		(rumour)		
E21	Supplier Consolidation	Market structure change	Minor	Mid (Ticks 5-7)
E22	Open Capacity	Supply opening	Minor	Early (Tick 2)
E24	Demand Fragmentation	Market structure change	Minor	Late (Ticks 8-9)
E25	Procurement Tightening	Trust shock	Major	Mid (Ticks 5-7)
E26	Procurement Shortcut	Procurement opening	Minor	Early (Tick 2) or Mid
E28	New Market Signal	New segment	Major	Late (Ticks 8-9)
E29	Resource Subsidy	Subsidy	Minor	Early (Tick 2)
E31	Energy Subsidy Change	Regulatory change (subsidy)	Major	Mid to Late (default Tick 7)
E32	Road Rule Change	Regulatory change (transport)	Major	Late (default Tick 8)

E01 Compute Crunch

Event: Supply outage + price shock • Severity Major • Stage Early to Mid (Ticks 3-6) • Tags res:Compute; cluster:Digital; slot:S3; hook:Fragile supply

- **Trigger:** Scheduled in an early slot, or conditional: fires at the first boundary from Tick 3 where Bank Compute stock is below 50% of its Tick 1 level. Fallback: fire at Tick 6.
- **Who is affected:** Every company; hardest on companies consuming Compute at High or Very High tier and on anyone using the S3 Supplier Market fallback.
- **Signal:** Whisper at the Supplier Market desk to 2 holders one tick ahead: the compute supplier has a maintenance window coming.
- **Announcement:** “CITY NOTICE — COMPUTE CRUNCH. Effective now until the end of Tick {k+1}, the standard Compute supplier cuts capacity 40%, the spot Compute supplier is closed, and the Bank's Compute base price rises from 20 to 25 VB. Affected: all Compute buyers. This is a market condition, not an instruction. The market is open.”
- **What changes:** Supplier Market (Institution Operating Content 5.3): SU-01 CoreCompute Wholesale capacity $12 \times N$ to $\lfloor 7.2 \times N \rfloor$; SU-02 Brightwave Spot Compute closed. Total Supplier Market Compute falls from $20 \times N$ to about $7 \times N$ per tick. Bank Compute base price 20 to 25 VB; dynamic price steps (+20% / +50%) apply on top. The S3 fallback is capped at the reduced capacity.

- **Duration:** 2 ticks
- **Immediate consequences:** Compute buyers queue at the Supplier Market; Bank Compute stock falls faster and hits its price steps sooner; the company filling S3 gains pricing power.
- **Possible responses:** Buy surplus Compute from Low and Medium tier holders through the Market Board; sign a supply contract with the S3 filler; run an efficiency project on Compute; defer compute-heavy deliveries by contract amendment; buy at the Bank now before the price steps.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Low-tier Compute consumers still hold about 90 units at Tick 3 and can sell at a premium; the S3 filler can sell multi-tick hosting at a fixed price.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed cards to Supplier Market (new capacity) and Bank (new base price; platform applies the steps). Never tell anyone who holds surplus. Release O02 Unused Compute in the same tick if it is in the run selection.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Capacity and base price revert at step 11 of the end boundary. Bank stock recovers by normal restock ($10 \times N$ per tick).
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O02 Unused Compute or O26 The Price Lock. Reliability: missed compute-dependent deliveries are breaches unless force majeure covers Supply outage. Look for: RH, DM, CA.

E02 Energy Spike

Event: Price shock · Severity Minor · Stage Early to Mid (Ticks 3-6) · Tags res:Energy; cluster:Physical; slot:S4; hook:Fragile supply

- **Trigger:** Scheduled.
- **Who is affected:** Every Energy buyer; hardest on Very High Energy consumers and on the S4 Bank or Supplier Market fallback.
- **Signal:** None.
- **Announcement:** “CITY NOTICE — ENERGY SPIKE. Effective now until the end of Tick {k}, the Bank’s Energy base price doubles from 15 to 30 VB. Affected: all Energy buyers. This is a market condition, not an instruction. The market is open.”
- **What changes:** Bank Energy base price 15 to 30 VB. Supplier Market Energy list prices (SU-03, SU-04) rise in proportion, staying below the Bank. Bank buy-back for Energy follows the new base (60%, so 18 VB).
- **Duration:** 1 tick
- **Immediate consequences:** Production orders that use Energy cost twice as much this tick; sellers of Energy earn double at the Bank buy-back.
- **Possible responses:** Pause Energy-heavy production for one tick; buy from the S4 filler under an existing contract; sell surplus Energy to the Bank buy-back at 18 VB; barter Energy for something you are short of.
- **Hidden opportunity:** The S4 filler’s production output is worth twice as much this tick; Low-tier Energy holders can sell to the Bank at 18 VB, above the normal base.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Bank and Supplier Market. Do not announce the end early.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Price reverts at the end of the tick. Settled supply contracts keep their agreed price throughout.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O26 The Price Lock. Look for: CA, RH, AD.

E03 Logistics Jam

Event: Supply outage · Severity Minor · Stage Any (Ticks 3-9) · Tags res:Logistics; cluster:Physical; slot:S1, S2; hook:Fragile supply

- **Trigger:** Scheduled, or conditional: fires when more than 80% of standard Logistics capacity was booked in each of the last 2 ticks.
- **Who is affected:** Physical companies and anyone delivering through the Logistics Provider, including S1 and S2 fallbacks.
- **Signal:** Crisis-style whisper at Logistics to 1 holder one tick ahead: congestion is building.
- **Announcement:** "CITY NOTICE — LOGISTICS JAM. Effective now until the end of Tick {k}, standard Logistics capacity is halved, surge pricing starts at 50% booked and Supplier Market logistics capacity is cut. Priority capacity is unchanged. This is a market condition, not an instruction. The market is open."
- **What changes:** Logistics Provider standard capacity $15 \times N$ to $\lfloor 7.5 \times N \rfloor$ units per tick; surge (+25%) from 50% booked instead of 80%. Priority capacity stays $7 \times N$ at $1.5 \times$ base. Supplier Market: SU-05 CityFreight Pool halved, SU-06 Night Owl Couriers to zero (its hidden constraint).
- **Duration:** 1 tick
- **Immediate consequences:** Standard slots sell out early in the tick; priority capacity becomes the only way to move urgent orders.
- **Possible responses:** Book priority capacity early; buy delivery capacity directly from the S1 or S2 filler; use your own Logistics stock; renegotiate a delivery date before it is missed; prioritise the highest-value contract.
- **Hidden opportunity:** S1 and S2 fillers can sell spare fleet capacity above the Logistics Provider's price; holders of Logistics units can sell them to companies that missed out.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Logistics. The platform shows remaining standard capacity live only to the Logistics desk; the public sees the headline.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Capacity reverts at the end of the tick.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O23 The Shared Warehouse. Look for: RH, OP, DM.

E04 Material Shortage

Event: Emerging shortage · Severity Major · Stage Early (Ticks 3-4) · Tags res:Materials; cluster:Physical; slot:S5, S6; hook:Fragile supply

- **Trigger:** Scheduled; best at Tick 4, when starting supplier agreements expire.
- **Who is affected:** Companies consuming Materials at High or Very High tier; S5 and S6 fallbacks.
- **Signal:** Personal card to 2 holders one tick ahead: Materials restocks are slowing.
- **Announcement:** "CITY NOTICE — MATERIAL SHORTAGE. Effective now until the end of Tick {k+1}, Bank Materials restocks are halved, Bank purchases are limited to 15 Materials per company per tick and the standard Materials supplier's capacity is cut. This is a market condition, not an instruction. The market is open."
- **What changes:** Bank Materials restock $10 \times N$ to $5 \times N$ per tick. Bank Materials purchase limit 30 to 15 per company per tick (a declared shortage cap, Core Game Systems 6.6). Supplier Market: SU-07 Allied Materials Depot capacity $12 \times N$ to $7 \times N$; SU-08 unchanged.
- **Duration:** 2 ticks

- **Immediate consequences:** Bank Materials price climbs its steps over two ticks; companies that did not renew their Tick 4 supplier agreement find the Supplier Market crowded.
- **Possible responses:** Renew or sign a supply contract with the S6 filler; buy from Low-tier holders; substitute through a licence or a partner's product; run an efficiency project; ration deliveries to the best-paying contracts.
- **Hidden opportunity:** The S6 raw-materials filler and any company with a Materials supply product can lock in multi-tick contracts at good prices.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed cards to Bank (restock, limit) and Supplier Market (capacity). The shortage cap applies to every company alike.
- **Recovery and rollback:** All three parameters revert at the end boundary; Bank stock refills at the normal restock rate.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O27 The Second Source or O26 The Price Lock. Look for: RH, CA, DM.

E05 Data Boom

Event: Demand spike (information) · Severity Minor · Stage Mid (Tick 7, alongside the Data Drop) · Tags res:Data; slot:S11; info

- **Trigger:** Scheduled; designed to run in Tick 7 with E20 and the Data Drop (Human Internet 5.3).
- **Who is affected:** Everyone who buys, sells or relies on information; Data buyers.
- **Signal:** None: the Data Drop is the signal.
- **Announcement:** "CITY NOTICE — DATA BOOM. Effective now until the end of Tick {k}, the Customer and Investor desks give extra weight to proposals backed by Verified information, and the Bank's Data base price rises 20%. This is a market condition, not an instruction. The market is open."
- **What changes:** In competitive evaluations at the Customer and Investor desks, a proposal citing a Verified card or an E1 record moves up one place against an otherwise equal proposal. Bank Data base price 25 to 30 VB. Demand at SU-09 OpenData Exchange rises (its event hook); its units remain unverified for S11 purposes.
- **Duration:** 1 tick
- **Immediate consequences:** Verified cards rise in value; demand for Media fact checks peaks; Data units cost more.
- **Possible responses:** Get your key claims verified (corroboration, owning-desk confirmation or a Media fact check); buy Verified cards from brokers; sell Verified cards you hold; ignore it and rely on recorded deals.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Registered brokers and the S11 dataset filler earn most this tick; corroborating two independent cards is free and beats paying for a fact check.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed cards to Customer, Investor, Bank and Media. Media runs rush-only fact checks in Tick 7 (Human Internet 13).
- **Recovery and rollback:** Ends at the end of Tick 7; the Internet Unlock at Tick 8 changes the information market anyway.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O28 The Fact-Check Contract. Look for: SP, CT, DM.

E06 Infrastructure Sale

Event: Supply opening · Severity Minor · Stage Early to Mid (Ticks 3-6) · Tags res:Infrastructure; institution:Supplier Market; positive

- **Trigger:** Scheduled; works well in the tick of auction session 1 or 2, as a cheaper alternative to the A04 Warehouse Access lot.
- **Who is affected:** Any company that can use Infrastructure: production upgrades (10 per upgrade), efficiency projects (30) or High and Very High Infrastructure consumers.
- **Signal:** Whisper at the Supplier Market to 1 holder one tick ahead.
- **Announcement:** “CITY NOTICE — INFRASTRUCTURE SALE. For Tick {k} only, the standard Infrastructure supplier sells an extra block at 30% below base, minimum order 30 units, paid up front. This is a market condition, not an instruction. The market is open.”
- **What changes:** SU-11 Civic Build Supplies (its event hook, Institution Operating Content 5.3) adds $10 \times N$ Infrastructure for the tick at 30% below Bank base (21 VB), minimum order 30, up front. Storage cap (200) applies.
- **Duration:** 1 tick
- **Immediate consequences:** Cash-rich companies can buy capacity cheaply; cash-poor ones watch it go.
- **Possible responses:** Buy for a production upgrade or efficiency project now; buy jointly with a partner to meet the 30-unit minimum; resell later; ignore it to protect runway.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Two companies splitting one 30-unit order both get the discount; a supply-product company that upgrades now out-produces rivals for the rest of the run.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Supplier Market.
- **Recovery and rollback:** The extra block ends at the end of the tick; unsold units vanish.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O12 The Strategic Asset. Look for: CA, IN, BU.

E07 Credit Tightening

Event: Credit tightening · Severity Major · Stage Mid (Tick 6) · Tags institution:Bank; hook:Hidden liability

- **Trigger:** Scheduled at Tick 6, matching the Human Internet card IC-INS-01.
- **Who is affected:** Every company seeking new Bank credit; companies with loans falling due.
- **Signal:** Crisis signal to 3 holders at Tick 4 (IC-INS-01: working-capital loans will need two qualifying items).
- **Announcement:** “CITY NOTICE — CREDIT TIGHTENING. Effective now until the end of Tick {k+1}, the Bank’s credit posture is Tight: new loans carry 5 more points of interest and need one more qualifying item. Existing loans are unchanged. This is a market condition, not an instruction. The market is open.”
- **What changes:** Bank posture Tight (Core Game Systems 7.3): +5 points flat interest on new loans and each band’s evidence bar one step higher. New lending in the period capped at 50% of the pool remaining at firing.
- **Duration:** 2 ticks
- **Immediate consequences:** Companies that planned to borrow after anchor renewal face higher cost and a higher bar; loans already drawn are unaffected.

- **Possible responses:** Borrow before Tick 6 if you were warned; borrow from another company or an angel (flat interest capped at 40%); sell surplus or a Notable Asset; collect receivables early; cut burn.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Cash-rich companies can lend to others at better rates than the Tight Bank and earn interest; the S7 payments filler can offer merchant finance against recurring contracts.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Bank with the exact Tight table. The Bank applies it to everyone; the desk script is the Bank refusal script ('If you can give us X, Y or Z, you may qualify').
- **Recovery and rollback:** Posture returns to Standard at the end boundary.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O06 The Broken Contract. Look for: CA, SP, DM.

E08 Credit Window

Event: Credit loosening · Severity Minor · Stage Late (Tick 8) or Mid · Tags institution:Bank; positive

- **Trigger:** Scheduled; pairs well with the Capital Market at Tick 8.
- **Who is affected:** Any company with credit grade A or B.
- **Signal:** Whisper at the Bank to 2 holders one tick ahead.
- **Announcement:** "CITY NOTICE — CREDIT WINDOW. For Tick {k} only, the Bank opens its Credit Window facility: up to 5,000 VB per company at 8% flat over 4 ticks, for companies with credit grade A or B, first come, while it lasts. This is a market condition, not an instruction. The market is open."
- **What changes:** Bank product BK-12 Credit Window facility opens (Institution Operating Content 2.2): up to 5,000 VB per company, total facility 2,500 × N VB, credit grade A or B, 8% flat, 4 equal instalments. Open for 1 tick or until used up. Counts toward the 30,000 VB Bank debt cap and the pool.
- **Duration:** 1 tick
- **Immediate consequences:** A queue at the Bank; fast movers fund expansion cheaply.
- **Possible responses:** Draw the facility and invest it; draw it and lend it on to a partner; ignore it to avoid debt; use it to repay a dearer loan early.
- **Hidden opportunity:** A company that draws the facility can relend to a company that cannot qualify and keep the spread.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Bank. The platform closes BK-12 when the facility is used up.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Facility closes at the end of the tick; loans drawn run to term.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O15 The Emergency Factory. Look for: IN, CA.

E09 Investor Frenzy

Event: Capital rush · Severity Major · Stage Late (Tick 8) · Tags institution:Investor; sector:{sector}

- **Trigger:** Scheduled at Tick 8 with the Capital Market, or the tick after.
- **Who is affected:** Companies selling into {sector}; every company indirectly, through competition for the fund.
- **Signal:** The Data Drop rumour (E20) may point at it; otherwise none.
- **Announcement:** "CITY NOTICE — INVESTOR FRENZY. Effective now until the end of Tick {k+1}, the Venture City Fund has strategic appetite for {sector}: deals in that sector count as fitting the fund's lead thesis. This is a market condition, not an instruction. The market is open."

- **What changes:** Investor event control (Institution Operating Content 3.7): for the duration, deals in {sector} count as fitting the lead thesis, so they can reach the thesis ceiling inside the 0.5 to $2 \times RV$ band. Ticket, concentration (30%) and dilution (40%) caps unchanged.
- **Duration:** 2 ticks
- **Immediate consequences:** {sector} companies raise on better terms; others compete for what is left of the fund.
- **Possible responses:** Raise now while terms are good; partner with a {sector} company on a joint product to qualify; take an angel or strategic stake in a {sector} company before it raises; stay out and avoid dilution.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Angels and companies that buy stakes before the round get the uplift; a spin-out into {sector} raises on frenzy terms.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Investor. {sector} is resolved by the platform rule in section 3, never picked by the Investor volunteer.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Normal thesis fit resumes at the end boundary. Term sheets signed in the window keep their terms.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O19 The Information Premium. Look for: CA, SP, SE.

E10 Investor Freeze

Event: Capital freeze · Severity Major · Stage Late (Tick 8 or 9) · Tags institution:Investor

- **Trigger:** Scheduled; an alternative to E09 in the Tick 8 slot.
- **Who is affected:** Every company planning equity funding.
- **Signal:** Whisper at the Investor desk to 2 holders one tick ahead.
- **Announcement:** “CITY NOTICE — INVESTOR FREEZE. For Tick {k}, the Venture City Fund issues no new term sheets while it reviews evidence. Meetings and diligence continue, and agreed second tranches still release on their milestones. This is a market condition, not an instruction. The market is open.”
- **What changes:** Investor event control (Institution Operating Content 3.7): no new term sheets for the stated tick; agreed second tranches still release. Meetings and diligence continue, so evidence keeps moving.
- **Duration:** 1 tick
- **Immediate consequences:** Companies relying on equity must bootstrap, borrow or wait a tick; those with diligence ready close first when the fund reopens.
- **Possible responses:** Use the pause to finish diligence; borrow from the Bank or other companies; sell angel stakes to participants; win customer revenue to strengthen the pitch; merge with a revenue-generating company.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Cash-rich companies and individual angels can buy stakes cheaply while the fund is closed.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Investor. The Investor keeps meetings running so evidence still moves.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Term sheets resume at the end boundary.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O19 The Information Premium. Look for: CA, RX, AD.

E11 Customer Rush

Event: Demand spike · Severity Major · Stage Early to Mid (Ticks 3-6) · Tags institution:Customer; sector:{sector}; segment:Enterprise; positive

- **Trigger:** Scheduled.
- **Who is affected:** Companies that can sell into {sector}.
- **Signal:** Personal card to 2 holders one tick ahead: a big buyer is about to double its order.
- **Announcement:** "CITY NOTICE — CUSTOMER RUSH. Effective now until the end of Tick {k+1}, Enterprise demand in {sector} doubles and a rapid-response buyer is at the Customer desk. This is a market condition, not an instruction. The market is open."
- **What changes:** {sector} demand index 100 to 200 (Enterprise card budgets × 2, fixed at signing). Release held-back card CU-28 Rapid Response Buyer (2,000 VB per tick for 2 ticks, delivery inside the event tick, first commitment) with {sector} as its sector.
- **Duration:** 2 ticks
- **Immediate consequences:** Sales and delivery capacity become the bottleneck; missed delivery penalties apply as usual.
- **Possible responses:** Bid only what you can deliver; subcontract or licence to a partner to add capacity; buy resources ahead; raise prices; bundle with another company for larger cards.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Companies with spare capacity but no {sector} capability can supply the winners; the S1 and S2 fillers sell delivery capacity.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Customer desk with CU-28. Desk volunteers still reject weak proposals.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Index returns to 100 at the end boundary; contracts signed in the window run to their terms.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O09 Two-Sided Bundle. Look for: SE, OP, DM.

E12 Customer Freeze

Event: Demand freeze · Severity Major · Stage Mid (Ticks 5-7) · Tags institution:Customer; sector:{sector}; hook:Concentration

- **Trigger:** Scheduled.
- **Who is affected:** Companies selling to Enterprise buyers in {sector}.
- **Signal:** Whisper at the Customer desk to 1 holder one tick ahead.
- **Announcement:** "CITY NOTICE — CUSTOMER FREEZE. For Tick {k}, Enterprise buyers in {sector} sign no new contracts. In Tick {k+1} their budgets are 30% lower. Contracts already signed continue. This is a market condition, not an instruction. The market is open."
- **What changes:** Tick k: Customer desk signs no new Enterprise contracts in {sector}. Tick k+1: {sector} Enterprise demand index 70.
- **Duration:** 2 ticks
- **Immediate consequences:** Sales pipelines in {sector} stall; companies with one big buyer feel it most.
- **Possible responses:** Sell to Consumer cards or other sectors; sell to other companies; use the pause to prepare a stronger proposal for Tick k+1; cut capacity costs.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Company-to-company sales become relatively more valuable; Consumer-segment cards in {sector} are untouched.

- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Customer desk. Renewals of existing contracts that fall due in Tick k are delayed one tick, not cancelled.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Index returns to 100 after Tick k+1.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O04 The Quiet Enterprise. Look for: AD, SE, CT.

E13 Talent Exodus

Event: Talent shortage · Severity Major · Stage Mid (Ticks 5-6) · Tags institution:Talent Exchange; domain:{domain}; slot:S10; hook:Key person

- **Trigger:** Scheduled. {domain} is the domain with the most unfilled required seats city-wide at the firing boundary.
- **Who is affected:** Every company with an open seat or a planned hire in {domain}.
- **Signal:** Personal card to 2 holders one tick ahead: specialists in {domain} are being headhunted out of the city.
- **Announcement:** "CITY NOTICE — TALENT EXODUS. Effective now until the end of Tick {k+1}, outside specialists in {domain} are unavailable at the Talent Exchange and the {domain} talent index rises by 40. This is a market condition, not an instruction. The market is open."
- **What changes:** Talent index for {domain} +40 (bounded at 200). Talent Exchange withdraws all {domain} specialist contracts not already signed. Specialist fees in other domains unchanged.
- **Duration:** 2 ticks
- **Immediate consequences:** Deficit charges in {domain} can no longer be covered by outside specialists; participants in {domain} become the scarce resource.
- **Possible responses:** Hire participants in {domain} from other companies with better offers or equity; retain your own with a bonus or option grant; train someone across (domain change halves level); freelance contracts; buy from the S10 talent filler.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Participants in {domain} can negotiate raises or equity; the S10 filler can sell trained talent; free agents in {domain} are in demand.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Talent Exchange. Never move a participant; the exodus is of outside specialists only.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Specialists return and the index falls back by its normal rules after the end boundary.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O17 The Scarce Developer. Look for: TM, OW, CA.

E15 Media Moment

Event: Media surge · Severity Minor · Stage Early to Mid · Tags institution:Media; slot:S12; positive

- **Trigger:** Scheduled.
- **Who is affected:** Any company with a credible story to tell.
- **Signal:** None.
- **Announcement:** "CITY NOTICE — MEDIA MOMENT. For Tick {k}, Media has two extra featured-story slots at half price, and stories backed by recorded revenue or a Verified card earn the company one warm customer lead. This is a market condition, not an instruction. The market is open."

- **What changes:** Media featured slots this tick +2, price halved. A featured story backed by an E1 revenue record or a Verified card unlocks one open customer card for that company at the Customer desk.
- **Duration:** 1 tick
- **Immediate consequences:** A race for the slots; evidence-backed stories turn into customer leads.
- **Possible responses:** Pitch a story backed by evidence; buy a slot for a partner's joint story; skip Media and sell directly; use the S12 audience filler's channel instead.
- **Hidden opportunity:** The S12 audience filler can resell reach; a company with verified traction gets a lead almost free.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed cards to Media and Customer desk. Media rejects unbacked claims as usual.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Slots and price revert at the end of the tick.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O08 Audience Spike. Look for: SE, IN, SP.

E17 Regulatory Review

Event: Regulatory change · Severity Major · Stage Mid (Ticks 4-6) · Tags institution:Government; cluster:Regulated; slot:S8; hook:Regulatory exposure

- **Trigger:** Scheduled.
- **Who is affected:** Every licence holder in {sector}; regulated sellers most.
- **Signal:** Whisper at Government to 2 holders one tick ahead.
- **Announcement:** "CITY NOTICE — REGULATORY REVIEW. Government has opened a review of {sector}. Every licence holder in {sector} must show one extra evidence item within 2 ticks, or the licence is suspended until it does. This is a market condition, not an instruction. The market is open."
- **What changes:** Government instrument GV-R02 Sector review (Institution Operating Content 6.5): every licence holder in {sector} submits one extra evidence item within 2 ticks; otherwise the licence is suspended until the item is submitted. An attestation from the S8 filler (an Approved Auditor) counts as the item.
- **Duration:** 2 ticks
- **Immediate consequences:** A queue at Government; licence holders without spare evidence risk suspension of a gated product.
- **Possible responses:** Submit the item at once; buy an S8 attestation; partner with a company whose licence is safe and deliver under a licence deal; let the licence lapse and sell ungated products for two ticks.
- **Hidden opportunity:** The S8 filler can sell attestations to every licence holder in the sector; companies outside {sector} face no review.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Government. Checks are applied identically to every applicant.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Suspensions lift as soon as the item is in; the review closes at the end boundary.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O16 The Grant Match. Look for: OP, DM, IN.

E18 Fast-Track Licence

Event: Regulatory opening · Severity Minor · Stage Early to Mid · Tags institution:Government; cluster:Regulated; positive

- **Trigger:** Scheduled.
- **Who is affected:** Any company with a gate held by Government.
- **Signal:** Whisper at Government to 1 holder one tick ahead.
- **Announcement:** "CITY NOTICE — FAST-TRACK LICENCE. For Tick {k}, Government will decide licence applications the same tick and adds two extra decisions this tick. This is a market condition, not an instruction. The market is open."
- **What changes:** Government instrument GV-R03 Fast-track window (Institution Operating Content 6.5): licence decisions in the same tick, +2 decisions this tick. Normal fees and requirements apply.
- **Duration:** 1 tick
- **Immediate consequences:** Prepared companies unlock a gated product or buyer type early.
- **Possible responses:** Apply with a complete file; buy the file's evidence from the S8 filler; partner with a company that wins a licence; wait for the normal route.
- **Hidden opportunity:** A newly licensed company can licence its product to unlicensed companies for a royalty.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Government. A missing requirement means refusal; the desk does not coach.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Ends at the end of the tick.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O07 Regulatory Window. Look for: IN, OP.

E20 Market Rumour

Event: Information event (rumour) · Severity Minor · Stage Mid (Tick 7, fixed) · Tags info; institution:Investor; Data Drop

- **Trigger:** Fixed at Tick 7 as the Data Drop's market-moving rumour (Human Internet 5.3).
- **Who is affected:** Everyone heading into the Capital Market at Tick 8.
- **Signal:** The rumour is itself the signal; it is handed out as one of the Data Drop cards (for example IC-RUM-01).
- **Announcement:** No public announcement. The rumour circulates as a Rumour-grade card.
- **What changes:** None by itself. Its truth is fixed before T0 by the Investor's lead thesis: IC-RUM-01 is true exactly when the Platform Partner leads (Institution Operating Content 3.2). The GM records this in the Rumour Register.
- **Duration:** 1 tick (expires when the Capital Market opens or as its card states)
- **Immediate consequences:** Companies decide whether to restructure their pitch, partnerships or cap table around an unverified claim.
- **Possible responses:** Verify it (corroboration, owning-desk confirm or deny, Media rush fact check); act on it unverified; sell it; ignore it.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Whoever verifies first can sell the answer or act before the Capital Market opens.
- **GM instructions:** The Investor desk answers 'No comment' until Tick 8. Never confirm or deny on the floor.

- **Recovery and rollback:** At Tick 8 the Investor's actual criteria are published with the Internet Unlock; the card turns Verified or Debunked.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O28 The Fact-Check Contract. Look for: CT, SP, CA.

E21 Supplier Consolidation

Event: Market structure change · Severity Minor · Stage Mid (Ticks 5-7) · Tags res:Materials, Infrastructure; institution:Supplier Market; slot:S5, S6

- **Trigger:** Scheduled.
- **Who is affected:** Buyers of Materials and Infrastructure from the Supplier Market.
- **Signal:** Personal card to 2 holders one tick ahead: two suppliers' owners have been seen together.
- **Announcement:** "CITY NOTICE — SUPPLIER CONSOLIDATION. Effective now until the end of Tick {k+1}, the standard Materials supplier and the prefabricated Infrastructure supplier have merged. Their prices rise 10% and the merged group no longer negotiates. This is a market condition, not an instruction. The market is open."
- **What changes:** SU-07 Allied Materials Depot and SU-12 Ironside Modular merge (their shared hidden constraint, Institution Operating Content 5.3): both list prices +10%, SU-12's negotiation band removed, minimum order 30 at both. Capacities unchanged.
- **Duration:** 2 ticks
- **Immediate consequences:** Supplier Market Materials and Infrastructure cost more; buyers look for other channels.
- **Possible responses:** Buy from the alternative Materials supplier (SU-08), the S5 or S6 filler, or companies with surplus; form a buying group to reach volume terms; delay non-urgent purchases; sign a supply deal with a company producer.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Company producers of Materials and Infrastructure can undercut the merged group by up to 10% and still earn more than before.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Supplier Market.
- **Recovery and rollback:** The merger 'unwinds' at the end boundary; prices and terms return to normal.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O26 The Price Lock. Look for: RH, DM, CB.

E22 Open Capacity

Event: Supply opening · Severity Minor · Stage Early (Tick 2) · Tags institution:Supplier Market; res:Materials, Infrastructure; positive

- **Trigger:** Scheduled; a good first event.
- **Who is affected:** Buyers of Materials and Infrastructure.
- **Signal:** Whisper at the Supplier Market to 2 holders one tick ahead: a reclaim yard is reopening.
- **Announcement:** "CITY NOTICE — OPEN CAPACITY. Effective now until the end of Tick {k+1}, a reopened reclaim supplier sells Materials and Infrastructure at the Supplier Market at 25% below base. This is a market condition, not an instruction. The market is open."

- **What changes:** Loads SU-14 Phoenix Reclaim (Institution Operating Content 5.2): $10 \times N$ Materials and $5 \times N$ Infrastructure per tick at 25% below base, minimum order 20, for 2 ticks. The first company to discover it gets 1 tick of exclusive access.
- **Duration:** 2 ticks
- **Immediate consequences:** Cheap Materials and Infrastructure for whoever finds it first; the rest of the city gets the second tick.
- **Possible responses:** Find it first and buy for production or upgrades; buy and resell later when Materials get scarce; use it to fund an efficiency project (30 Infrastructure); ignore it if you are long.
- **Hidden opportunity:** A company that buys Infrastructure here can run production upgrades or an efficiency project at a 25% discount.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Supplier Market. The desk reveals SU-14 only to someone who asks about Materials or Infrastructure supply.
- **Recovery and rollback:** SU-14 unloads at the end boundary.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O03 The Expiring Supplier. Look for: IN, SP, CA.

E24 Demand Fragmentation

Event: Market structure change · Severity Minor · Stage Late (Ticks 8-9) · Tags institution:Customer; sector:{sector}; segment:Enterprise

- **Trigger:** Scheduled.
- **Who is affected:** Companies bidding for Enterprise cards in {sector}.
- **Signal:** None.
- **Announcement:** "CITY NOTICE — DEMAND FRAGMENTATION. Effective now until the end of Tick {k+1}, Enterprise buyers in {sector} split large requirements into smaller specialist contracts. This is a market condition, not an instruction. The market is open."
- **What changes:** Each open Enterprise card in {sector} is replaced by 2 cards at 55% of its budget, each needing one fewer delivery unit per tick (minimum 1). Consortium bids are accepted.
- **Duration:** 2 ticks
- **Immediate consequences:** Smaller and newer companies can compete; large bids lose their advantage.
- **Possible responses:** Bid for one part; team up to win both parts; specialise; leave the sector to the smaller players.
- **Hidden opportunity:** New ventures and spin-outs can win their first customer here; two companies that win both halves earn 10% more than the original card.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Customer desk with the split cards prepared in advance.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Cards signed run to term; unsigned split cards expire at the end boundary.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O09 Two-Sided Bundle. Look for: SP, DM, AD.

E25 Procurement Tightening

Event: Trust shock · Severity Major · Stage Mid (Ticks 5-7) · Tags institution:Customer; segment:Enterprise

- **Trigger:** Scheduled.

- **Who is affected:** Companies seeking new Enterprise contracts.
- **Signal:** Whisper at the Customer desk to 2 holders one tick ahead.
- **Announcement:** "CITY NOTICE — PROCUREMENT TIGHTENING. Effective now until the end of Tick {k+1}, new Enterprise contracts need one reference from a different company or customer and written acceptance criteria. Companies with two fulfilled contracts and no breach on their Reliability Record are exempt. This is a market condition, not an instruction. The market is open."
- **What changes:** New Enterprise contracts require one E2 confirmation of a delivered outcome from an independent party, plus acceptance criteria on the Deal Sheet. Exemption: 2 or more fulfilled contracts and no breach.
- **Duration:** 2 ticks
- **Immediate consequences:** Weak sellers lose deals; companies with a clean delivery record sell freely.
- **Possible responses:** Deliver something to another company quickly to earn a reference; use a partner as a reference; sell to Consumer cards; wait out the window.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Companies with a clean record can sell references-by-delivery: a small real delivery to a company that needs a reference.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Customer desk. Independence rules apply (Core Game Systems 1.3): no reference from your own staff.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Requirement ends at the end boundary.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O20 The Competitor's Weak Spot. Look for: OP, SE, CB.

E26 Procurement Shortcut

Event: Procurement opening · Severity Minor · Stage Early (Tick 2) or Mid · Tags institution:Customer; segment:Enterprise; positive

- **Trigger:** Scheduled.
- **Who is affected:** Any company with a deliverable product.
- **Signal:** None.
- **Announcement:** "CITY NOTICE — PROCUREMENT SHORTCUT. For Tick {k}, a buyer at the Customer desk will skip procurement for a proven same-tick pilot. A successful pilot becomes a 3-tick contract. This is a market condition, not an instruction. The market is open."
- **What changes:** Release held-back card CU-30 Fast-Track Pilot Buyer (Institution Operating Content 4.3): 1,000 VB pilot plus 2,000 VB per tick for 3 ticks, needs a same-tick pilot; first complete proposal wins.
- **Duration:** 1 tick for the pilot; the follow-on contract runs as signed
- **Immediate consequences:** A race to the Customer desk; the prepared company closes in one tick.
- **Possible responses:** Submit a complete proposal fast; pair with a company that has the capability you lack; skip the pilot to focus on bigger cards.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Losing bidders now know the buyer's need and can sell to it later; a pilot is a cheap way to earn a reference for E25.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Customer desk with CU-30. 'Complete' means every acceptance field filled.

- **Recovery and rollback:** CU-30 expires at the end of the tick if unclaimed.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O04 The Quiet Enterprise. Look for: IN, SE, BU.

E28 New Market Signal

Event: New segment · Severity Major · Stage Late (Ticks 8-9) · Tags institution:Government, Media, Customer; positive

- **Trigger:** Scheduled. May be followed by C11 Demand Explosion if the deck allows.
- **Who is affected:** Companies that can make the named product type, or partner to make it.
- **Signal:** Personal card to 2 holders one tick ahead.
- **Announcement:** "CITY NOTICE — NEW MARKET SIGNAL. Government and Media report a new group of buyers for {product type}. Ask at the Customer desk. This is a market condition, not an instruction. The market is open."
- **What changes:** Release held-back card CU-29 New Segment Buyers (Institution Operating Content 4.3): Consumer, 800 VB per tick for 4 ticks, 4 units per tick, open claim, for the product type the GM names in the signal (a type at least two active companies can make or combine to make).
- **Duration:** 2 ticks
- **Immediate consequences:** Companies that can make the product type, or partner to make it, enter a new market early.
- **Possible responses:** Sell into it directly; partner with a company that has the missing capability; licence a product; spin out a team to serve it.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Partners who combine to make the product type can also bid for O24 if it is released later.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Customer desk with CU-29; Government and Media publish only the headline.
- **Recovery and rollback:** CU-29 runs its 4 ticks once claimed.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O24 The Resilience Tender. Look for: SP, DM, CB.

E29 Resource Subsidy

Event: Subsidy · Severity Minor · Stage Early (Tick 2) · Tags institution:Government, Bank; res:{res}; positive

- **Trigger:** Scheduled. {res} is Energy by default (SU-04's event hook); the GM may name another at deck-building.
- **Who is affected:** Buyers of {res}.
- **Signal:** None.
- **Announcement:** "CITY NOTICE — RESOURCE SUBSIDY. Effective now until the end of Tick {k+1}, Government subsidises {res}: the Bank's base price is 25% lower. This is a market condition, not an instruction. The market is open."
- **What changes:** Government instrument GV-R04 Resource subsidy (Institution Operating Content 6.5): Bank {res} base price -25% for 2 ticks, a Core Game Systems 6.7 price shock. No eligibility condition. Bank purchase limit (30 per company per tick) unchanged.
- **Duration:** 2 ticks

- **Immediate consequences:** Bank {res} stock depletes faster, so the price steps arrive sooner after the subsidy.
- **Possible responses:** Buy for production now; run a production upgrade; resell to companies that missed it (the storage cap applies); ignore it.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Producers whose recipes use {res} make supply products more profitably for two ticks.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed cards to Bank and Government.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Subsidy ends at the end boundary; Bank stock refills at the normal rate.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O10 Price Gap. Look for: CA, RH.

E31 Energy Subsidy Change

Event: Regulatory change (subsidy) · Severity Major · Stage Mid to Late (default Tick 7) · Tags institution:Government; instrument:GV-R01; res:Energy; slot:S4; hook:Regulatory exposure; event-tag:energy subsidy change

- **Trigger:** Scheduled, default Tick 7. Also by hook: the event that every Regulatory-exposure vulnerability on an energy-efficiency or retrofit product names (in the dossiers, GreenGrid's retrofit).
- **Who is affected:** Every company selling a product tagged energy efficiency or retrofit; buyers of those products; holders and applicants of green certification (GV-L09).
- **Signal:** Rumour-grade card to 2 holders one tick ahead: 'Government is about to change the energy subsidies.' The direction is not stated.
- **Announcement:** "CITY NOTICE — ENERGY SUBSIDY CHANGE. From now on, the city pays its energy-efficiency subsidy only on certified work. Efficiency and retrofit products may be sold only by holders of green certification, and every certified sale earns a 15% city top-up. This is a market condition, not an instruction. The market is open."
- **What changes:** Government applies GV-R01 Rule change to the product tag 'energy efficiency / retrofit': sales by companies without GV-L09 green certification are suspended until certified (an amended licence: 300 VB plus the GV-L09 evidence, decided in 1 tick). For the rest of the run, Government pays the seller a 15% top-up on each verified certified sale, capped at 2,000 VB per company per tick. A Regulatory-exposure vulnerability naming E31 fires. Recorded contracts in progress are suspended, not breached, while the seller certifies.
- **Duration:** Until the freeze (the suspension ends per company when certified)
- **Immediate consequences:** Uncertified sellers lose efficiency revenue until they certify; certified sellers gain margin; the Government desk queue lengthens.
- **Possible responses:** Apply for GV-L09 at once with an accepted S4 delivery or retrofit as evidence; partner with a certified seller and deliver under its licence; pivot capacity to energy supply, which is not suspended; buy efficiency work from a certified company and resell; pre-sell the certified product to buyers now.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Certified sellers can subcontract for uncertified ones and keep the top-up; the S4 filler's accepted deliveries become the evidence everyone needs, so it can sell them.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Government with the list of products the tag covers. Government decides amended licences in 1 tick in the order received. If no product in the active set carries the tag, play the top-up alone and say so in the notice.

- **Recovery and rollback:** No rollback: the new rule runs to the freeze. Each company's suspension ends the tick its GV-L09 is granted; suspended contracts resume.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O16 The Grant Match. Look for: IN, AD, CB.

E32 Road Rule Change

Event: Regulatory change (transport) · Severity Major · Stage Late (default Tick 8) · Tags

institution:Government; instrument:GV-R01; res:Logistics; slot:S1, S2; hook:Regulatory exposure; event-tag:road rule change

- **Trigger:** Scheduled, default Tick 8. Also by hook: the event that every Regulatory-exposure vulnerability on a consumer transport or ride product names (in the dossiers, Voltway's rides).
- **Who is affected:** Every company selling a product tagged consumer transport or ride; holders of the transport operating permit (GV-L05); every company using standard Logistics for one tick.
- **Signal:** Personal card to 2 holders one tick ahead: 'Inspectors are counting vehicles on the ring road.'
- **Announcement:** "CITY NOTICE — ROAD RULE CHANGE. New city road rules start now. Consumer ride and transport permits must be re-issued on fresh evidence before rides can run, and standard Logistics capacity is 10% lower this tick while fleets adjust. This is a market condition, not an instruction. The market is open."
- **What changes:** Government applies GV-R01 Rule change to the product tag 'consumer transport / ride': every GV-L05 permit is suspended until re-issued (300 VB plus fresh evidence: one tick of verified fleet deliveries and an E5 safety plan, decided in 1 tick). Fleet capacity sold to businesses is not suspended. Logistics Provider standard capacity $\times 0.9$ for Tick k. A Regulatory-exposure vulnerability naming E32 fires. Ride contracts in progress are suspended, not breached, until re-issue.
- **Duration:** Until re-issued (Logistics effect 1 tick)
- **Immediate consequences:** Ride revenue stops for at least the firing tick; fleet capacity is still sellable, so fleet holders turn to business buyers.
- **Possible responses:** Apply for re-issue at once with the evidence ready; sell the idle fleet to businesses as S1 capacity; partner with another company that can carry consumers; offer ride customers a credit to keep them; buy priority Logistics before the cut.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Companies needing fleet capacity can rent idle ride vehicles cheaply for a tick; whoever holds a verified fleet delivery record can sell it as evidence.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Government and Logistics. Rules are fictional and generic (no real traffic law). If no product in the active set carries the tag, play the Logistics cut alone and say so in the notice.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Each permit returns the tick it is re-issued; Logistics returns to full at the end of Tick k.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O24 The Resilience Tender (fleet plus energy variant). Look for: AD, OP, CL.

Appendix B. Crisis library

Twenty crises: seven local (C1) cards that resolve to one company by the exposure rule in section 4.2, eight sector cards, four city cards and the systemic final shock. C21 Storm Front is the weather event

that Institution Operating Content names behind SU-08 Riverbend Growers Co-op and behind every Fragile-supply vulnerability on a Materials agreement. Every crisis carries its crisis-response mission (CR-xx), paid at the Tier 2 band from the City Reserve unless the card says otherwise.

ID	Title	Type	Severity	Stage
C01	Critical Supplier Collapse	Sector	C2	Mid (Tick 5)
C02	Liquidity Freeze	City	C3	Mid or Final (Tick 5 or 10)
C03	Logistics Shutdown	Sector	C2	Mid (Ticks 5-6)
C04	Energy Emergency	City	C3	Late or Final (Ticks 9-10)
C05	Data Integrity Incident	Sector	C2	Mid (Ticks 5-6)
C06	Enterprise Procurement Audit	Local	C1	Early to Late (Ticks 3-9)
C07	Talent Walkout	Local	C1	Mid (Ticks 4-8)
C08	Regulatory Halt	Sector	C2	Mid (Ticks 5-6)
C09	Reputation Shock	Sector (city variant)	C2 (C3 as city variant)	Mid, or Final as the city variant
C10	Demand Collapse	Sector	C2	Mid (Ticks 5-6)
C11	Demand Explosion	Sector (positive)	C2	Mid to Late (Ticks 6-9)
C12	Platform Outage	Local	C1	Early to Late (Ticks 3-9)
C13	Cash Burn Crisis	Local	C1	Mid to Late (Ticks 5-9)
C16	Market Manipulation Rumour	City (information)	C3	Early to Mid (Ticks 3-6)
C17	Cyber and Trust Incident	Local	C1	Early to Late (Ticks 3-9)
C19	City Capacity	City	C3	Late or Final (Ticks

ID	Title	Type	Severity	Stage
	Crisis			8-10)
C20	Final System Shock	Systemic	C4	Final (Tick 10)
C21	Storm Front	Sector (weather)	C2	Early to Mid (Ticks 3-6)
C22	Merchant Fraud	Local	C1	Early to Late (Ticks 3-9)
C23	Data Breach	Local	C1	Early to Late (Ticks 3-9)

C01 Critical Supplier Collapse

Crisis: Sector · Severity C2 · Stage Mid (Tick 5) · Tags res:{res}; institution:Supplier Market; hook:Fragile supply

- **Trigger:** Sector-crisis slot at Tick 5. {res} is the resource with the most High or Very High consumers among active companies.
- **Who is affected:** Companies consuming {res} at High or Very High tier, and any company holding a supply contract with the Supplier Market for {res}.
- **Signal:** Crisis signal to 2 holders at Tick 4 (one outsider, one desk whisper at the Supplier Market): the {res} supplier has stopped paying its own suppliers.
- **Announcement:** “CITY ALERT (SIMULATION) — CRITICAL SUPPLIER COLLAPSE. The Supplier Market's {res} suppliers have stopped trading. {res} supply contracts with them are suspended and the Bank will not sell {res} this tick. Response window: until the end of Tick {k}. Participants may pursue any valid response. Consequences will be based on the recorded state at the deadline.”
- **What changes:** Both Supplier Market suppliers of {res} stop: the standard line (B reliability) closes, and the alternative line (C reliability) closes with any outage on its resource (Institution Operating Content 5.3). Capacity 0 for 2 ticks; supply contracts with them suspended with no breach on either side. Bank {res} stock freeze for Tick k (Core Game Systems 6.7). Bank purchase limit for {res} 30 to 15 in Tick k+1.
- **Duration:** 2 ticks (supplier closed); Bank freeze 1 tick
- **Immediate consequences:** Affected companies draw down stock; those near the 30-unit warning or 15-unit surcharge threshold hit it within the tick. No VB is charged by the card itself.
- **Response window:** The firing tick.
- **Possible responses:** Buy {res} from companies holding it at Low or Medium tier; buy from a company with a {res} supply product; bid for the supplier's stranded stock (O21); ration deliveries to the highest-value contracts and amend the rest; run an efficiency project on {res}.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Low-tier holders and producers of {res} can sell at a premium; whoever wins O21 buys $10 \times N$ units below base.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed cards to Supplier Market and Bank. Release O21 at step 9 of the firing boundary, not before. Never say which companies hold surplus.

- **Recovery and rollback:** The standard-line supplier reopens at the end of Tick k+1 at 70% capacity for one tick, then full; the alternative line reopens with it. Suspended supply contracts resume automatically.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O21 The Stranded Inventory. Crisis mission CR-C01 Crisis Supplier (the M47 pattern): record a delivery of at least 15 units of {res} to an affected company this tick; both companies earn the Tier 2 band and the buyer's {res}-related delivery penalties are waived this tick. Look for: RH, DM, CB, CL.

C02 Liquidity Freeze

Crisis: City · Severity C3 · Stage Mid or Final (Tick 5 or 10) · Tags institution:Bank; hook:Hidden liability

- **Trigger:** Final-crisis slot at Tick 10 (Deck B), or the Tick 5 sector slot in a capital-focused run. Never within 2 ticks of E07, since both restrict credit.
- **Who is affected:** Every company; hardest on companies that planned new Bank credit or hold a loan instalment due.
- **Signal:** Crisis signal to 3 holders one tick ahead: the Bank is reviewing its own reserves.
- **Announcement:** "CITY ALERT (SIMULATION) — LIQUIDITY FREEZE. The Bank has paused normal lending this tick. Resource purchases, buy-back, the emergency loan and proof-of-funds certificates stay open, and loan instalments still fall due. Response window: until the end of Tick {k}. Participants may pursue any valid response. Consequences will be based on the recorded state at the deadline."
- **What changes:** Bank event control (Institution Operating Content 2.5): BK-03 to BK-07, BK-09 and BK-10 closed for 1 tick; BK-01, BK-02, BK-08 and BK-11 stay open; instalments still fall due. No other Bank parameter changes.
- **Duration:** 1 tick
- **Immediate consequences:** Companies that needed credit this tick must find cash elsewhere; resource credit (BK-09) is unavailable, so short companies must pay cash for stock.
- **Response window:** 1 tick
- **Possible responses:** Borrow from another company or an angel (revenue-based or flat, capped at 40%); sell a recurring contract's future payments to another company as a revenue-share deal; sell assets or surplus to other companies; raise equity if the capital window is open; cut production and burn.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Cash-rich companies become the city's lenders; the S7 payments filler is the only working-capital provider besides player loans.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Bank. The emergency loan rules are unchanged.
- **Recovery and rollback:** All Bank products reopen at the end boundary.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O06 The Broken Contract. Crisis mission CR-C02 Bridge: one company lends at least 3,000 VB to another under a recorded Loan deal at 20% flat or less; both earn the Tier 2 band and the borrower's late fees this tick are waived. Look for: CA, CB, DM, CL.

C03 Logistics Shutdown

Crisis: Sector · Severity C2 · Stage Mid (Ticks 5-6) · Tags res:Logistics; cluster:Physical; slot:S1, S2; hook:Fragile supply

- **Trigger:** Sector-crisis slot.
- **Who is affected:** Physical companies and any company with deliveries through the Logistics Provider.
- **Signal:** Crisis signal to 2 holders one tick ahead: a warning from the Logistics Provider about a depot closure.
- **Announcement:** "CITY ALERT (SIMULATION) — LOGISTICS SHUTDOWN. Standard Logistics capacity is closed this tick and priority capacity is halved at double price. Response window: until the end of Tick {k}. Participants may pursue any valid response. Consequences will be based on the recorded state at the deadline."
- **What changes:** Logistics standard capacity 0 for Tick k; priority capacity $\lfloor 3.5 \times N \rfloor$ units at $2 \times$ base. S1 and S2 institution fallbacks use the same limits.
- **Duration:** 1 tick
- **Immediate consequences:** Deliveries that needed standard Logistics are missed unless rerouted; default late-delivery penalties apply (10% of that tick's contract value).
- **Response window:** The firing tick.
- **Possible responses:** Form a consortium to buy priority capacity and share it; buy delivery capacity from the S1 or S2 filler; use your own Logistics stock; agree a one-tick delay with the customer as a contract amendment; prioritise the highest-value delivery.
- **Hidden opportunity:** S1 and S2 fillers can sell their own fleet capacity at a premium; holders of Logistics units can sell them.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Logistics. Delivery penalties follow each contract's own clauses.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Full capacity returns at the end of the tick.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O23 The Shared Warehouse. Crisis mission CR-C03 Last Mile: a company or consortium delivers another company's due order this tick under a recorded deal; both earn the Tier 2 band and the owner's penalty is waived. Look for: OP, RH, CB, CL.

C04 Energy Emergency

Crisis: City · Severity C3 · Stage Late or Final (Ticks 9-10) · Tags res:Energy; slot:S4; hook:Fragile supply

- **Trigger:** Final-crisis slot, or the sector slot in a physical-heavy active set.
- **Who is affected:** Every company; hardest on Very High Energy consumers and producers whose recipes use Energy.
- **Signal:** Crisis signal to 3 holders one tick ahead: the grid operator has asked large users to cut demand.
- **Announcement:** "CITY ALERT (SIMULATION) — ENERGY EMERGENCY. Energy supply has dropped sharply. The Bank's Energy price doubles, the Bank will not sell Energy this tick and Supplier Market Energy capacity falls 60% for two ticks. Response window: until the end of Tick {k}. Participants may pursue any valid response. Consequences will be based on the recorded state at the deadline."
- **What changes:** Bank Energy base 15 to 30 VB for 2 ticks; Bank Energy stock freeze for Tick k. Supplier Market: SU-04 SunField Energy Cooperative closed (its event hook) and SU-03 Metro Power Wholesale cut from $12 \times N$ to $8 \times N$, so Supplier Market Energy falls from $20 \times N$ to $8 \times N$ for 2 ticks.
- **Duration:** 2 ticks

- **Immediate consequences:** Energy stocks drain; production that uses Energy becomes expensive; companies near zero Energy risk Distressed after 2 ticks at zero.
- **Response window:** 1 tick
- **Possible responses:** Sign a supply contract with the S4 energy filler; pause Energy-heavy production; run an efficiency project; barter for Energy from Low-tier holders; partner so one company produces for both.
- **Hidden opportunity:** The S4 filler's production capacity upgrade pays for itself in one tick; Low-tier Energy holders hold the city's spare supply.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed cards to Bank and Supplier Market. No real-world energy language: the grid is the city's fictional grid.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Price steps back 30, then 22, then 15 VB over the two boundaries after the duration; capacity returns at the end boundary.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O24 The Resilience Tender. Crisis mission CR-C04 Shared Grid: supply at least 15 Energy to another company at or below 20 VB per unit; both earn the Tier 2 band and the buyer is exempt from the Bank Energy freeze for one purchase. Look for: RH, CL, CB.

C05 Data Integrity Incident

Crisis: Sector · Severity C2 · Stage Mid (Ticks 5-6) · Tags res:Data; sector:{sector}; slot:S11; info

- **Trigger:** Sector-crisis slot.
- **Who is affected:** Companies selling into {sector} and anyone holding information cards about {sector} demand.
- **Signal:** Crisis signal to 2 holders one tick ahead: an analyst has doubts about the city's {sector} figures.
- **Announcement:** "CITY ALERT (SIMULATION) — DATA INTEGRITY INCIDENT. A city dataset behind {sector} demand figures has been found unreliable. Information about {sector} demand is now marked Stale, Data bought from the scraped-data supplier in the last two ticks is void, and {sector} competitive evaluations pause this tick. Response window: until the end of Tick {k}. Participants may pursue any valid response. Consequences will be based on the recorded state at the deadline."
- **What changes:** Every information card whose statement cites {sector} demand or budgets turns Stale. Data units bought from SU-10 Quarry Analytics in the previous 2 ticks are void and removed from stock (its hidden constraint, Institution Operating Content 5.3). Customer desk pauses competitive evaluations in {sector} for Tick k.
- **Duration:** 1 tick
- **Immediate consequences:** Pitches built on {sector} numbers lose their footing; companies that bought cheap scraped data lose those units.
- **Response window:** The firing tick.
- **Possible responses:** Validate independently (two independent cards, owning-desk confirmation); replace lost units from SU-09, the Bank or the S11 filler; pause decisions until evaluations reopen; reprice proposals.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Holders of Verified cards from independent roots become the only trusted sources; the S11 filler sells validation.

- **GM instructions:** Sealed cards to Customer, Media and Supplier Market. The platform flips the Stale stamps; the GM never edits a card's truth silently (Human Internet 7).
- **Recovery and rollback:** Evaluations reopen next tick; void units are not restored.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O14 Data Nobody Owns. Crisis mission CR-C05 Clean Data: submit an E5 artefact that correctly re-establishes the {sector} demand figure, backed by two independent sources; Tier 2 band to the submitter's company. Look for: CT, SP, RH.

C06 Enterprise Procurement Audit

Crisis: Local · Severity C1 · Stage Early to Late (Ticks 3-9) · Tags institution:Customer; segment:Enterprise; hook:Concentration

- **Trigger:** Local-crisis slot.
- **Who is affected:** {target}: the eligible company with the highest share of verified revenue over the last 2 ticks from one institution customer contract (must have at least one active institution contract).
- **Signal:** Crisis signal to 2 outsiders one tick ahead: the buyer's procurement team is asking questions about one of its suppliers.
- **Announcement:** "CITY ALERT (SIMULATION) — PROCUREMENT AUDIT. A major buyer has opened an audit of {target}. This tick's payment under that contract is held until {target} shows an independent reference and a delivery record. Response window: until the end of Tick {k}. Participants may pursue any valid response. Consequences will be based on the recorded state at the deadline."
- **What changes:** The Tick k payment on {target}'s largest institution contract goes to platform escrow. Release needs two items by the deadline: an E2 confirmation of a delivered outcome from a different company or institution, and an E5 delivery record or E3 Customer desk acceptance.
- **Duration:** 1 tick
- **Immediate consequences:** If both items are in, the payment is released. If not, the payment is forfeited (capped at 6,000 VB) and the contract's renewal goes to competitive evaluation, with {target} allowed to bid.
- **Response window:** The firing tick.
- **Possible responses:** Get a reference from a company you have delivered to; deliver something small to a partner this tick to earn one; bring in the S8 filler to prepare the audit file; offer the buyer a price concession; accept the loss and redeploy sales.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Any company can become a reference by having received a real delivery; if the contract goes to evaluation, rivals can bid for it (O22).
- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Customer desk. The desk never tells {target} who might be a reference.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Passing restores the contract; failing still leaves {target} free to win the renewal.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O22 The Orphaned Customer (only if the audit fails); a company that passes has the buyer's next need revealed (Core Game Systems 3.3, execution). Crisis mission CR-C06 Reference Run: another company provides the E2 reference; both earn 750 VB. Look for: OW, SE, CB, CL.

C07 Talent Walkout

Crisis: Local · Severity C1 · Stage Mid (Ticks 4-8) · Tags institution:Talent Exchange; domain:{domain}; slot:S10; hook:Key person

- **Trigger:** Local-crisis slot.
- **Who is affected:** {target}; the eligible company with the most employees in one domain who have no retention bonus, no option grant and salary at the ladder floor. {domain} is that domain.
- **Signal:** Crisis signal to 2 outsiders one tick ahead: contractors at one company are unhappy.
- **Announcement:** “CITY ALERT (SIMULATION) — TALENT WALKOUT. Contractors in {domain} have walked out of {target}. {target} needs two more {domain} seats filled for the next two ticks, and the {domain} talent index rises by 25. Response window: until the end of Tick {k}. Participants may pursue any valid response. Consequences will be based on the recorded state at the deadline.”
- **What changes:** {target}'s required seats in {domain} +2 for 2 ticks (deficit charge 225 VB per empty seat per tick, so at most 900 VB). Any outside specialist {target} holds leaves at once, with no refund. City-wide {domain} talent index +25 for 2 ticks. No participant is moved: employees stay unless they choose to leave.
- **Duration:** 2 ticks
- **Immediate consequences:** Deficit charges start at the next settlement; rivals see that {domain} talent is in demand.
- **Response window:** The firing tick (for the crisis mission); seats stay open for 2 ticks.
- **Possible responses:** Hire into {domain} from the Talent Exchange or other companies; offer retention bonuses or option grants to keep current staff; take freelancers; move someone across domains (their level halves); buy from the S10 filler; accept the charge and restructure.
- **Hidden opportunity:** The walked-out specialists become available to other companies as a package (O25); {target}'s own {domain} staff can negotiate better terms.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Talent Exchange. Volunteers never pressure a participant to move.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Extra seats close after 2 ticks; the index falls back by its normal rules.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O25 The Released Specialists. Crisis mission CR-C07 Hold the Line: fill both seats by recorded hire or freelance contract by the deadline; Tier 2 band and both seats' charges waived. Look for: TM, OW, CL.

C08 Regulatory Halt

Crisis: Sector · Severity C2 · Stage Mid (Ticks 5-6) · Tags institution:Government; cluster:Regulated; slot:S8; hook:Regulatory exposure

- **Trigger:** Sector-crisis slot. Needs at least one Regulated company active (guaranteed by Starting World 4.3).
- **Who is affected:** Companies with a Product Card in {category}.
- **Signal:** Crisis signal to 2 holders one tick ahead (one is a whisper at Government).
- **Announcement:** “CITY ALERT (SIMULATION) — REGULATORY HALT. Government has halted sales of {category} until each seller obtains a halt clearance. Clearances are decided within one

tick. Response window: until the end of Tick {k}. Participants may pursue any valid response. Consequences will be based on the recorded state at the deadline.”

- **What changes:** Government instrument GV-R05 Regulatory halt (Institution Operating Content 6.5): sales of one product category stop until the seller holds a halt clearance (500 VB plus safety or security evidence, decided in 1 tick). {category} is a product tag carried by at least two active companies' Product Cards, a regulated one where possible. An S8 attestation counts as the security evidence. Deliveries due under existing contracts are breaches unless force majeure covers Regulatory change, but the Customer desk waives penalties for sellers who applied for clearance within the window.
- **Duration:** Until cleared, at most 2 ticks
- **Immediate consequences:** Revenue from {category} pauses; a queue forms at Government.
- **Response window:** The firing tick.
- **Possible responses:** Apply for clearance at once; buy an S8 attestation as the evidence; licence a cleared company's product to deliver meanwhile; pivot to products outside {category}; let the halt run and absorb the penalty.
- **Hidden opportunity:** The first cleared company can serve every buyer of {category} the others cannot; the S8 filler's attestation becomes the most valuable product in the city for a tick.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed cards to Government and Customer desk. A clearance needs only the GV-R05 items; the desk does not coach.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Each company's halt lifts when cleared; any still halted are cleared automatically after 2 ticks.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O07 Regulatory Window. Crisis mission CR-C08 Cleared Partner: a cleared company delivers for a halted one under a licence deal this tick; both earn the Tier 2 band. Look for: OP, DM, AD.

C09 Reputation Shock

Crisis: Sector (city variant) · Severity C2 (C3 as city variant) · Stage Mid, or Final as the city variant · Tags institution:Media, Customer; sector:{sector}

- **Trigger:** Sector-crisis slot; the city variant can fill the final slot.
- **Who is affected:** Companies selling into {sector} (city variant: every company).
- **Signal:** A rumour seeded through Media one tick ahead; its truth status is set by the GM in the Rumour Register.
- **Announcement:** “CITY ALERT (SIMULATION) — REPUTATION SHOCK. A widely shared claim has shaken customer trust in {sector}. For two ticks, Consumer budgets in {sector} fall 30% and Enterprise buyers in {sector} ask for verified proof. Response window: until the end of Tick {k}. Participants may pursue any valid response. Consequences will be based on the recorded state at the deadline.”
- **What changes:** {sector} Consumer demand index 70 for 2 ticks; new {sector} Enterprise contracts need one Verified proof (a Media fact check or an E3 validation). City variant: every sector's Consumer index 80, same proof rule. A company that runs a featured Media story backed by a Verified card is exempt. If the claim is false and someone has it Debunked, the effect ends at the next boundary for everyone.
- **Duration:** 2 ticks, or until debunked
- **Immediate consequences:** Weak claims stop selling; evidence and transparency start to pay.

- **Response window:** The firing tick.
- **Possible responses:** Publish verified proof through Media; buy third-party validation from the S8 or S11 filler; reposition to another sector; work to debunk the claim if it is false; wait it out.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Whoever debunks a false claim frees the whole sector and can sell that service; companies outside {sector} pick up its customers.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed cards to Media and Customer desk. The claim must be about a fictional product category, never a real health or safety issue.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Indices return to 100 at the end boundary or after a public Debunk.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O20 The Competitor's Weak Spot. Crisis mission CR-C09 Set the Record: submit two independent verifications establishing the claim's truth status; Tier 2 band to the submitter. Look for: CT, SE, CB.

C10 Demand Collapse

Crisis: Sector · Severity C2 · Stage Mid (Ticks 5-6) · Tags institution:Customer; sector:{sector}; hook:Concentration

- **Trigger:** Sector-crisis slot.
- **Who is affected:** Companies whose verified revenue over the last 2 ticks comes mostly from {sector}.
- **Signal:** Crisis signal to 2 holders one tick ahead: buyers in {sector} are cutting forecasts.
- **Announcement:** "CITY ALERT (SIMULATION) — DEMAND COLLAPSE. Demand in {sector} has fallen 60%. For two ticks, open {sector} customer cards are worth 40% of their budgets and renewals in {sector} are offered at 60% of their current price. Existing contracts continue. Response window: until the end of Tick {k}. Participants may pursue any valid response. Consequences will be based on the recorded state at the deadline."
- **What changes:** {sector} demand index 40 for 2 ticks (open card budgets $\times 0.4$). Renewals falling due in {sector} are offered at 60% of current price. Recorded contracts run on their terms.
- **Duration:** 2 ticks
- **Immediate consequences:** Pipelines in {sector} shrink; companies reliant on one sector face a revenue gap.
- **Response window:** The firing tick.
- **Possible responses:** Sell into another sector or to other companies; renegotiate renewals with added scope; develop or licence a new product; cut capacity and costs; acquire customers elsewhere through a partner.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Buyers of distressed assets and talent get good prices; a product line orphaned by the collapse can be spun out (O11).
- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Customer desk with the reduced budgets precomputed.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Index returns to 100 at the end boundary.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O11 Founderless Product. Crisis mission CR-C10 New Buyer: sign a customer contract outside {sector} this tick; Tier 2 band. Look for: AD, SE, CT.

C11 Demand Explosion

Crisis: Sector (positive) · Severity C2 · Stage Mid to Late (Ticks 6-9) · Tags institution:Customer; sector:{sector}; positive

- **Trigger:** Sector-crisis slot, or as the follow-on to E28 New Market Signal.
- **Who is affected:** Companies that can sell into {sector}; their suppliers.
- **Signal:** Crisis signal to 2 holders one tick ahead: a buyer is about to place an unprecedented order.
- **Announcement:** "CITY ALERT (SIMULATION) — DEMAND EXPLOSION. Demand in {sector} has tripled. Open {sector} customer cards now pay three times their budgets and accept up to three times their delivery units. Late-delivery penalties apply as normal. Response window: until the end of Tick {k}. Participants may pursue any valid response. Consequences will be based on the recorded state at the deadline."
- **What changes:** {sector} demand index 300 for 2 ticks (budgets $\times$ 3, fixed at signing). Open {sector} cards accept up to $3 \times$ their delivery units per tick at the same unit price. Penalty clauses unchanged.
- **Duration:** 2 ticks
- **Immediate consequences:** Capacity, resources and delivery become the bottleneck; overcommitting creates breaches.
- **Response window:** The firing tick (to claim cards); delivery over the duration.
- **Possible responses:** Scale (production upgrade, buy resources ahead); subcontract or licence to partners; take only what you can deliver; raise prices; raise capital against the backlog.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Suppliers to {sector} companies and holders of priority logistics capacity profit as much as the sellers.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Customer desk. The desk applies normal acceptance; a breach is a breach.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Index returns to 100 at the end boundary; contracts run to their terms.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O01 The 500-Unit Buyer. Crisis mission CR-C11 Scale Partner: deliver part of another company's {sector} order under a recorded subcontract; both earn the Tier 2 band. Look for: OP, SE, DM, CA.

C12 Platform Outage

Crisis: Local · Severity C1 · Stage Early to Late (Ticks 3-9) · Tags cluster:Digital; slot:S3, S8

- **Trigger:** Local-crisis slot.
- **Who is affected:** {target}: among eligible companies whose critical dependency is still served by its institution fallback (no recorded deal with a company filling that slot), the one whose highest-revenue Product Card earned the largest share of its verified revenue over the last 2 ticks.
- **Signal:** Crisis signal to 2 outsiders one tick ahead: engineers at one company are working through the night.
- **Announcement:** "CITY ALERT (SIMULATION) — PLATFORM OUTAGE. A core system behind {target}'s {product} has failed. {product} cannot be delivered normally this tick. Response window: until the end of Tick {k}. Participants may pursue any valid response. Consequences will be based on the recorded state at the deadline."
- **What changes:** {target}'s highest-revenue Product Card cannot be delivered through normal means in Tick k. A manual workaround allows delivery at $2 \times$ the card's resource cost per unit. Recurring deliveries not covered are breaches unless force majeure covers it. For Tick k, {target}'s institution customers may take a one-tick substitute delivery from another company.
- **Duration:** 1 tick

- **Immediate consequences:** Revenue at risk on {target}'s main product; customers are briefly open to rivals.
- **Response window:** The firing tick.
- **Possible responses:** Pay for the manual workaround; licence a compatible capability from another company to deliver; sign a hosting or resilience deal with the slot filler; agree a delay with the customer; let the delivery miss and protect cash.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Rivals with a compatible product can win a substitute delivery and a relationship with {target}'s customer; the S3 and S8 fillers can sell resilience to every company watching.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Customer desk. The alert uses {target}'s own product name for flavour; the rule is the same for every company.
- **Recovery and rollback:** The product works again from Tick k+1. Any company that signs a deal with its dependency filler is no longer on institution fallback.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O27 The Second Source. Crisis mission CR-C12 Backup Route: a company delivers for {target} under a licence deal this tick; both earn the Tier 2 band and {target}'s breach is waived. Look for: RH, CL, CB, BU.

C13 Cash Burn Crisis

Crisis: Local · Severity C1 · Stage Mid to Late (Ticks 5-9) · Tags finance; hook:Hidden liability

- **Trigger:** Local-crisis slot; only fires if some eligible company has a runway under 4 ticks.
- **Who is affected:** {target}: the eligible company with the shortest runway (cash divided by average net outflow over the last 2 ticks), among those under 4 ticks.
- **Signal:** Crisis signal to 2 outsiders one tick ahead: a supplier has been asking whether one company can pay.
- **Announcement:** "CITY ALERT (SIMULATION) — CASH BURN CRISIS. Suppliers have lost confidence in {target}'s cash position. For two ticks {target} pays 20% more at the Bank and the Supplier Market, cash up front, and its next loan instalment is brought forward a tick. Response window: until the end of Tick {k}. Participants may pursue any valid response. Consequences will be based on the recorded state at the deadline."
- **What changes:** For 2 ticks, {target}'s purchases from the Bank and Supplier Market cost +20%. If {target} has a Bank loan, its next instalment is debited one tick early (at the Tick k boundary). Total extra cost is capped at 6,000 VB.
- **Duration:** 2 ticks
- **Immediate consequences:** Runway shortens further unless {target} acts; Distressed becomes likely if cash goes negative.
- **Response window:** The firing tick.
- **Possible responses:** Cut burn (pause production, sell surplus to other companies or the buy-back); collect receivables early in exchange for a discount; raise money from angels or a strategic stake; take a revenue-based loan from another company; open merger or rescue talks.
- **Hidden opportunity:** A cash-rich company can buy a strategic stake or a Product Card cheaply; free agents and angels get unusually good terms.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed cards to Bank and Supplier Market. The surcharge appears automatically on {target}'s purchases.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Premium ends after 2 ticks, or at once if the crisis mission is completed.

- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O12 The Strategic Asset. Crisis mission CR-C13 Runway Plan: submit an E5 runway plan to the Bank and record one cash-raising deal of at least 3,000 VB by the deadline; the premium lifts and {target} earns the Tier 2 band. Look for: CA, OW, CL, AD.

C16 Market Manipulation Rumour

Crisis: City (information) · Severity C3 · Stage Early to Mid (Ticks 3-6) · Tags info; res:{res}; institution:Media

- **Trigger:** Optional extra card in Ticks 3 to 6, using an event slot; seeded one tick before as a Rumour-grade card (the IC-RUM-02 pattern).
- **Who is affected:** Everyone who reacts to the rumour.
- **Signal:** The rumour itself, seeded through a volunteer or the Media desk one tick ahead: '{res} supply will be cut next tick'.
- **Announcement:** No alert. The rumour spreads as a card; the GM publishes nothing until resolution.
- **What changes:** None unless the GM's Rumour Register says the rumour is true (then the card is played as C01 instead). Bank dynamic pricing reacts to real buying, so a panic moves the price on its own.
- **Duration:** 1 tick
- **Immediate consequences:** Panic buying can push the Bank's {res} price through its steps with no real shortage.
- **Response window:** 1 tick (resolved when the truth is published).
- **Possible responses:** Verify before acting (corroboration, Supplier Market confirm or deny, Media fact check); hedge with a small purchase; sell {res} into the panic; do nothing.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Disciplined holders sell {res} to panicking buyers at stepped prices; whoever verifies first can sell the answer.
- **GM instructions:** The Supplier Market answers 'No comment' until resolution. At resolution, Media publishes the correction and the card turns Debunked.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Bank stock and price recover by normal restock once buying stops.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O28 The Fact-Check Contract. No crisis mission. Look for: CT, CA, SP.

C17 Cyber and Trust Incident

Crisis: Local · Severity C1 · Stage Early to Late (Ticks 3-9) · Tags cluster:Digital, Regulated; res:Data; slot:S8

- **Trigger:** Local-crisis slot.
- **Who is affected:** {target}: among eligible Digital or Regulated companies that consume Data at High or Very High tier and have no recorded deal with the S8 filler (or no Government licence when S8 falls back), the one with the highest verified revenue over the last 2 ticks.
- **Signal:** Crisis signal to 2 outsiders one tick ahead: unusual activity has been seen on one company's systems.
- **Announcement:** "CITY ALERT (SIMULATION) — TRUST INCIDENT. {target} has reported a fictional security incident. Until it is contained, the Customer desk signs no new contracts with

{target} and Consumer buyers pay {target} 20% less. Response window: until the end of Tick {k}. Participants may pursue any valid response. Consequences will be based on the recorded state at the deadline."

- **What changes:** Until contained: no new Customer desk contracts with {target}; Consumer-segment payments to {target} -20%. Containment is an E3 Government validation (300 VB) or an E2 security audit confirmation from the S8 filler. Uncontained at the deadline: the effect runs one more tick, then ends. Total effect capped at 6,000 VB.
- **Duration:** 1 tick if contained, 2 ticks if not
- **Immediate consequences:** New sales stop and consumer revenue drops; Media runs the headline.
- **Response window:** The firing tick.
- **Possible responses:** Buy an audit from the S8 filler; get a Government validation; offer customers credits to keep them; publish the facts through a Media story; deliver through a trusted partner under a licence deal.
- **Hidden opportunity:** The S8 filler can sell audits to every Digital company now worried it is next; rivals can win {target}'s new business for a tick.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed cards to Customer desk, Government and Media. The incident is fictional and described only in the game's own terms; no real attack methods.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Effects end on containment; {target} keeps its existing contracts throughout.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O20 The Competitor's Weak Spot. Crisis mission CR-C17 Contain: complete containment by the deadline; Tier 2 band and the Consumer discount is refunded for Tick k. Look for: CL, OW, CB.

C19 City Capacity Crisis

Crisis: City · Severity C3 · Stage Late or Final (Ticks 8-10) · Tags res:Logistics, Infrastructure; institution:Logistics, Talent Exchange, Bank

- **Trigger:** Final-crisis slot, or conditional: fires when standard Logistics, Talent Exchange specialists and Bank Infrastructure stock were all above 80% used in the same tick.
- **Who is affected:** Every company.
- **Signal:** Crisis signal to 3 holders one tick ahead.
- **Announcement:** "CITY ALERT (SIMULATION) — CITY CAPACITY CRISIS. The city has run out of room. For two ticks, standard Logistics capacity falls 30%, no new outside specialists are available, and the Bank sells at most 10 Infrastructure per company per tick. The remaining scarce capacity will be auctioned at the start of each tick. Response window: until the end of Tick {k+1}. Participants may pursue any valid response. Consequences will be based on the recorded state at the deadline."
- **What changes:** Logistics standard capacity $\times 0.7$; Talent Exchange signs no new specialist contracts; Bank Infrastructure purchase limit 30 to 10. Each tick, an ad hoc multi-unit auction sells the priority Logistics capacity ($7 \times N$), the last unsigned specialists and a $10 \times N$ Infrastructure block.
- **Duration:** 2 ticks
- **Immediate consequences:** Companies compete for capacity in the open; cooperation becomes cheaper than outbidding.

- **Response window:** 2 ticks
- **Possible responses:** Bid in the auctions; form a consortium to bid jointly and share; prioritise the deliveries that matter most; trade capacity you hold; pause expansion.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Consortia buy capacity cheaper than single bidders; companies holding Logistics or Infrastructure units can sell at auction-level prices.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed cards to Logistics, Talent Exchange and Bank. Run the auctions with the visible bid record (Event Operations 25).
- **Recovery and rollback:** All limits lift at the end boundary.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O23 The Shared Warehouse. Crisis mission CR-C19 Coordinate: three or more companies record a capacity-sharing deal; each earns the Tier 1 band. Look for: CB, OP, DM, CL.

C20 Final System Shock

Crisis: Systemic · Severity C4 · Stage Final (Tick 10) · Tags res:Energy, Logistics, Compute; institution:Bank, Customer, auction

- **Trigger:** Final-crisis slot, Tick 10, by default.
- **Who is affected:** Every company and institution.
- **Signal:** Crisis signal to 3 holders at Tick 9, plus the Tick 9 mystery lot hinting at a rare resource.
- **Announcement:** “CITY ALERT (SIMULATION) — FINAL SYSTEM SHOCK. Several things have changed at once: Energy is scarce, Logistics is congested, Compute demand is up, credit is tight, a major city contract is open for bids, and a rare resource block is up for auction now. Response window: until the end of Tick {k}. Participants may pursue any valid response. Consequences will be based on the recorded state at the deadline.”
- **What changes:** Until the freeze: Bank Energy base +50% (15 to 23 VB) and Supplier Market Energy capacity -40%; Logistics surge pricing from 50% booked; Digital companies consume Compute at one tier step higher; Bank posture Tight. Opens O24 The Resilience Tender as the city contract (value up to 12,000 VB, decided at the end of Tick 10, delivered in Tick 11). An ad hoc auction at the start of Tick 10 sells a $15 \times N$ block of the scarcest resource by Bank stock.
- **Duration:** Until the freeze
- **Immediate consequences:** Every company faces a different mix of pressure; no company can optimise every dimension at once (the draft's design intent).
- **Response window:** Tick 10 (1 tick).
- **Possible responses:** Buy, sell or hold resources; raise money; bid for the city contract with a partner; acquire or merge (agreed and validated in Tick 10 so it settles before the cap table lock); pivot strategy; bid for the rare block; secure supply for the final tick.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Companies that hedged earlier sell into the shock; the best-prepared consortium wins the city contract; the rare block is worth most to whoever needs it for the tender.
- **GM instructions:** Sealed cards to every desk. Run the auction first, then open the tender. No company can fail before the freeze as a result of this card (section 6.3).
- **Recovery and rollback:** No rollback: the freeze ends the run. Tick 11 is the aftermath and final build.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O24 The Resilience Tender (built in). Reliability and RV recalculate at the last settlement as normal; the platform's crisis timeline goes into the

Investor Day pack. Crisis mission CR-C20 Last Push: deliver every contract due in Tick 10 and Tick 11 in full; Tier 2 band. Look for: CL, AD, CA, DM, OP.

C21 Storm Front

Crisis: Sector (weather) · Severity C2 · Stage Early to Mid (Ticks 3-6) · Tags res:Materials; supplier:SU-08; slot:S6; cluster:Physical; hook:Fragile supply; event-tag:weather (crop)

- **Trigger:** Sector-crisis slot or a local-crisis slot, or by hook: the weather event Institution Operating Content names behind SU-08's hidden constraint and behind every Fragile-supply vulnerability on a Materials agreement. Best at Tick 3 to 6, while produce-based supply still matters.
- **Who is affected:** Buyers from SU-08 Riverbend Growers Co-op; companies whose Fragile-supply vulnerability names C21 (their supplier agreement sits with SU-08, Institution Operating Content, Supplier Market section); Materials buyers using the S6 fallback; physical deliveries for one tick.
- **Signal:** Crisis signal to 2 holders one tick ahead (one is a whisper at the Supplier Market): the growing district's forecast has turned.
- **Announcement:** "CITY ALERT (SIMULATION) — STORM FRONT. Heavy rain in the city's fictional growing district has closed Riverbend Growers Co-op for two ticks. Supply contracts with Riverbend are suspended, and standard Logistics capacity is 20% lower this tick. Response window: until the end of Tick {k}. Participants may pursue any valid response. Consequences will be based on the recorded state at the deadline."
- **What changes:** SU-08 Riverbend Growers Co-op closed for 2 ticks (Ticks k and k+1); its supply contracts and starting supplier agreements suspended with no breach on either side; a Fragile-supply vulnerability naming C21 fires (its agreement fails rather than resuming). The S6 fallback falls to SU-07 alone ($12 \times N$ Materials). Logistics Provider standard capacity $\times 0.8$ for Tick k. No units are destroyed.
- **Duration:** 2 ticks (Riverbend closed); 1 tick (Logistics)
- **Immediate consequences:** Materials buyers crowd onto SU-07 and the Bank; companies whose agreement sat with Riverbend lose their discounted supply.
- **Response window:** The firing tick.
- **Possible responses:** Switch to SU-07 or the Bank and pay more; buy from the S6 filler or a company with a Materials supply product; buy from Low and Medium tier Materials holders; ask the Supplier Market about other channels (the grey market from Tick 5, a reclaim supplier if E22 is live); ration deliveries and amend the rest.
- **Hidden opportunity:** The S6 raw-materials filler can sell multi-tick contracts to every former Riverbend buyer; holders of surplus Materials sell at a premium; Riverbend's harvested stock left in its yard goes to auction (O21).
- **GM instructions:** Sealed card to Supplier Market and Logistics. Keep the weather fictional and mild in tone: no evacuation, flood-warning or emergency-service language (section 7.4). The desk confirms Riverbend's closure but never names its buyers. This card is the weather (crop) event the Company Dossiers name: in the dossiers both Mango & Co.'s and HarvestLoop's supplier agreements sit with Riverbend, so one firing hits both.

- **Recovery and rollback:** Riverbend reopens at the end of Tick k+1 at full capacity; suspended contracts resume, except an agreement whose Fragile-supply vulnerability fired, which must be renegotiated. Logistics returns to full at the end of Tick k.
- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O21 The Stranded Inventory (Riverbend's yard stock, $10 \times N$ Materials). Crisis mission CR-C21 Harvest Relief: record a delivery of at least 15 Materials to a company that lost its Riverbend supply; both earn the Tier 2 band and the buyer's Materials-related penalties are waived this tick. Look for: RH, CB, AD.

C22 Merchant Fraud

Crisis: Local · Severity C1 · Stage Early to Late (Ticks 3-9) · Tags cluster:Regulated; slot:S7, S8; hook:Hidden liability; event-tag:merchant fraud

- **Trigger:** Local-crisis slot; only fires if some eligible company sold a payment or merchant-finance product (S7) to at least 2 other companies or customers in the last 2 ticks.
- **Who is affected:** {target}: among those eligible companies, the one with the highest fraud exposure score: the number of companies and customers it processed payments for in the last 2 ticks, doubled for each tick it had no S8 cover (a recorded S8 deal, an Approved Auditor attestation or a GV-L10 pass). Ties go to the higher processing revenue.
- **Signal:** Crisis signal to 2 outsiders one tick ahead: a merchant is complaining that payments it never made are leaving its account.
- **Announcement:** "CITY ALERT (SIMULATION) — MERCHANT FRAUD. Fictional fraudulent transactions have gone through {target}'s payment rails. {target} must refund the affected merchants, and its merchants may pause processing with it until the rails are secured. Response window: until the end of Tick {k}. Participants may pursue any valid response. Consequences will be based on the recorded state at the deadline."
- **What changes:** {target} owes chargebacks of 10% of its processing revenue over the last 2 ticks (at least 1,000 VB), payable at the Tick k boundary. A Hidden-liability vulnerability naming C22 fires and adds its own amount (in the dossiers, Ledgerly's refund obligation grows by 4,000 VB). Until {target} shows security evidence (an S8 audit confirmation, an attestation or a GV-L10 pass), any merchant may suspend its processing contract with {target} for Tick k without breach. Total effect capped at 6,000 VB.
- **Duration:** 1 tick (merchant pause ends on security evidence)
- **Immediate consequences:** Cash leaves {target} at once; merchants look for a backup processor; the S8 filler's phone rings.
- **Response window:** The firing tick.
- **Possible responses:** Buy an S8 audit or attestation and show it to merchants; offer merchants fee credits to stay; settle chargebacks from a loan or a merchant advance; licence a fraud-scoring tool from another company; pause new merchants until secured.
- **Hidden opportunity:** The S8 filler and any company with a fraud-detection product can sell to every payments business in the city; a rival processor can win paused merchants for a tick (O22).
- **GM instructions:** Sealed cards to Customer desk, Government and Bank. The fraud is fictional and described only in game terms; no real fraud methods. The desk never names the merchants affected.
- **Recovery and rollback:** Merchant pauses end the tick security evidence is shown; chargebacks are not refunded.

- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O22 The Orphaned Customer (a paused merchant seeking a backup processor). Crisis mission CR-C22 Secure the Rails: show security evidence by the deadline; Tier 2 band and the chargebacks for Tick k are halved. Look for: CL, RX, OW, CB.

C23 Data Breach

Crisis: Local · Severity C1 · Stage Early to Late (Ticks 3-9) · Tags cluster:Digital, Regulated; res:Data; slot:S8, S11; hook:Hidden liability; event-tag:data breach

- **Trigger:** Local-crisis slot; only fires if some eligible company sold or shared Data or a dataset product with another company in the last 2 ticks.
- **Who is affected:** {target}: among those eligible companies, the one with the highest breach exposure score: Data units (or dataset deliveries, each counting as 10 units) sold or shared in the last 2 ticks, doubled for each tick it had no S8 cover. Ties go to the higher verified revenue. Different from C17: C17 targets heavy Data consumers, C23 targets companies that move data out.
- **Signal:** Crisis signal to 2 outsiders one tick ahead: 'A major breach is coming; someone in the city has already been hit.'
- **Announcement:** "CITY ALERT (SIMULATION) — DATA BREACH. A fictional breach has exposed data {target} sold or shared. Government is reviewing it, and regulated buyers will not take new data from {target} until it shows security evidence. Response window: until the end of Tick {k}. Participants may pursue any valid response. Consequences will be based on the recorded state at the deadline."
- **What changes:** Until {target} shows security evidence (an S8 audit confirmation, an attestation or a GV-L10 pass), regulated buyers sign no new data or dataset contracts with {target}. Without evidence by the deadline, Government fines {target} 1,500 VB. A Hidden-liability vulnerability naming C23 fires and adds its own amount (in the dossiers, MediLink's compliance gap becomes a 6,000 VB fine if it shared data without cover). If {target} was monitored by a company selling security monitoring that tick, that company's warranty terms apply (in the dossiers, TrustLayer's 5,000 VB payout). Total effect on {target} capped at 6,000 VB; a warranty payout is the monitoring company's own capped C1 effect.
- **Duration:** 1 tick (data sales pause ends on security evidence)
- **Immediate consequences:** Data revenue to regulated buyers stops; Media runs the headline; every company that bought the data wants reassurance.
- **Response window:** The firing tick.
- **Possible responses:** Buy an S8 audit or attestation; apply for the relevant data licence on the new evidence; tell buyers what was exposed through a Media story; offer affected buyers credits; sell data only to unregulated buyers this tick.
- **Hidden opportunity:** Security sellers and Approved Auditors find every data seller in the city wants cover now; a company with a clean record can sell the same data at a premium (O20).
- **GM instructions:** Sealed cards to Government, Customer desk and Media. The breach is fictional and described only in game terms; no real attack methods. A monitoring company's clean-audit record (in the dossiers, TrustLayer's) counts an audit as clean only if no C23 or C17 hits that client within 2 ticks.
- **Recovery and rollback:** The sales pause ends the tick evidence is shown; fines are not refunded.

- **Aftermath, scoring and observation:** Aftermath: O20 The Competitor's Weak Spot. Crisis mission CR-C23 Disclose and Secure: show security evidence and record an E5 disclosure to every buyer of the data by the deadline; Tier 2 band and the 1,500 VB Government fine is waived. Look for: CL, OW, IN, CB.

Appendix C. Opportunity templates O21 to O28

Core Game Systems loads $2N + 1$ opportunities per run: 25 at $N = 12$. The draft library holds O01 to O20, so a 12-company run was five short. These eight generic templates close the gap with three to spare (28 against 25), and each one is written to be released as the aftermath of a card in Appendices A and B, so a crisis always leaves something on the table. They use the same fields as O01 to O20 and the same claim methods (first commitment, competitive evaluation, auction). {res} is the resource the linked card touched. The same data is in opportunity-templates-O21-O28.csv.

O21 The Stranded Inventory

Opportunity: Broken company / resource arbitrage

- **Signal:** A closed supplier's warehouse still holds stock nobody has claimed.
- **Detail:** $10 \times N$ units of {res} (the closed supplier's resource, or a failed company's largest stock) are sold by descending auction: opening at 80% of Bank base, falling 10% of the opening price each minute to a floor of 40%. The buyer takes the storage cap (200 per resource) and the 10% decay above it.
- **Discovery paths:** Supplier Market desk when asked about the closure; the grey-market volunteer; the crisis signal holders (person-to-person); the auction announcement headline.
- **Claim method:** Auction (descending).
- **Trade-off:** Cash now for stock that may exceed the storage cap and decay; a big win can tie up runway.
- **Value cap:** About 4,000 VB of value below base at $N = 12$ (120 units of a 25 VB resource bought at 40%); always under 15,000.
- **Window:** 1 tick, from the crisis's resolving boundary.
- **Decay rule:** Price falls during the auction; unsold units return to Bank stock.
- **Institutions involved:** Supplier Market, GM auctioneer, Logistics (to move physical stock).
- **Visibility:** Hidden at load; headline Public when released.
- **Linked cards:** C01, C21; any company failure (Core Game Systems 8.6).

O22 The Orphaned Customer

Opportunity: Customer demand

- **Signal:** A buyer is quietly looking for a backup supplier after a delivery scare.
- **Detail:** The institution customer of a company that failed an audit or missed a delivery opens a 3-tick contract for the same deliverable at the original price plus 10%. Awarded by competitive evaluation at the end of the tick on Reliability Record, delivery plan and price. The original supplier may bid.
- **Discovery paths:** Customer desk when a visitor names the sector and need; execution (a company delivering to this buyer learns it); a whisper to the original supplier's partners.

- **Claim method:** Competitive evaluation.
- **Trade-off:** Commits capacity for 3 ticks; a breach here hurts your Reliability Record; winning may cost a relationship with the original supplier.
- **Value cap:** $3 \times \text{the original per-tick payment} \times 1.1$, at most 9,000 VB.
- **Window:** 1 tick.
- **Decay rule:** None.
- **Institutions involved:** Customer desk; Logistics for physical delivery.
- **Visibility:** Hidden at load; Available at the Customer desk only.
- **Linked cards:** C06, C12, C17, C22, any recorded breach on an institution contract.

O23 The Shared Warehouse

Opportunity: Cross-company bundle / idle capacity

- **Signal:** The Logistics Provider has an empty warehouse it will only lease to a group.
- **Detail:** A 3-tick warehouse contract for a consortium of 2 or 3 companies, 2,500 VB in total: storage cap raised to 400 for 3 named resources for each member, plus $5 \times N$ priority Logistics units per tick at the standard price, shared as the consortium's Deal Sheet records.
- **Discovery paths:** Logistics desk when asked about storage or capacity; person-to-person through the S1 and S2 fillers; Market Board posts by companies looking for partners.
- **Claim method:** First commitment: the first consortium to record its sharing deal and deposit.
- **Trade-off:** Needs a sharing rule; members depend on each other's discipline; ties capital for 3 ticks.
- **Value cap:** About 6,000 VB of avoided surge, priority and decay costs across the consortium.
- **Window:** 2 ticks.
- **Decay rule:** None.
- **Institutions involved:** Logistics Provider.
- **Visibility:** Hidden at load; Available at Logistics.
- **Linked cards:** E03, C03, C19.

O24 The Resilience Tender

Opportunity: Regulatory opening

- **Signal:** After the disruption, the city wants a backup plan it can buy.
- **Detail:** A Government tender for a resilience package: two capabilities from different role slots (for example fleet plus energy, or hosting plus security) delivered jointly, one delivery per tick for 2 ticks. Value $3,000 \times [N \div 4]$ VB (12,000 at the C20 final shock). Applicants need a recorded partnership deal and an E5 plan; evaluation on coverage, price and Reliability Record.
- **Discovery paths:** Broadcast headline; Government desk for the detail; crisis signal holders; the Customer desk refers enquiries about resilience to Government.
- **Claim method:** Competitive evaluation by the end of the window.
- **Trade-off:** Revenue is split with a partner; capacity is committed late in the game when it is scarcest.
- **Value cap:** Up to 12,000 VB.
- **Window:** 2 ticks (1 tick when built into C20).
- **Decay rule:** None.

- **Institutions involved:** Government, plus whichever desks the capabilities need.
- **Visibility:** Headline Public; detail at Government.
- **Linked cards:** C04, C19, C20, E28, E32.

O25 The Released Specialists

Opportunity: Talent mismatch

- **Signal:** Three specialists who just walked out of a team want to land somewhere together.
- **Detail:** Three outside specialists in the walkout's domain join the Talent Exchange as a package for up to 3 companies, one specialist each (the one-specialist-per-company rule still applies), at 300 VB per tick for 2 ticks, below the going rate during a shortage. The package goes only if all three are placed in one recorded consortium hiring deal.
- **Discovery paths:** Talent Exchange when asked about the domain; staff of the company the specialists left (they know who walked out); a whisper at the Talent Exchange.
- **Claim method:** First commitment by a consortium of 1 to 3 companies placing all three.
- **Trade-off:** Coordination with rivals; uses each member's one specialist slot for 2 ticks.
- **Value cap:** About 2,000 VB per member in avoided deficit charges and fees.
- **Window:** 1 tick.
- **Decay rule:** If unclaimed, the specialists join the normal roster at the going rate.
- **Institutions involved:** Talent Exchange.
- **Visibility:** Hidden at load; Available at the Talent Exchange.
- **Linked cards:** C07, E13, any company failure.

O26 The Price Lock

Opportunity: Resource arbitrage / emerging shortage

- **Signal:** A supplier will fix today's price for anyone who commits now.
- **Detail:** The Supplier Market offers $[N \div 3]$ forward contracts for {res}: 15 units per tick for 3 ticks at 10% below today's Bank base, paid per tick. The contract is unconditional: if prices fall, the buyer still pays, and it carries no force majeure clause.
- **Discovery paths:** Supplier Market desk when asked about forward prices; crisis signal holders; information trade with anyone who saw the signal.
- **Claim method:** First commitment.
- **Trade-off:** Committed spend for 3 ticks; storage and decay if the units are not needed; the price may fall instead of rise.
- **Value cap:** Up to about 3,000 VB if {res} doubles in price during the contract.
- **Window:** 1 tick.
- **Decay rule:** Contracts are limited in number; once they are gone the card closes.
- **Institutions involved:** Supplier Market.
- **Visibility:** Hidden at load; Available at the Supplier Market.
- **Linked cards:** E01, E02, E04, C04; may also be released with no event following, which is the risk.

O27 The Second Source

Opportunity: Unserved segment

- **Signal:** A buyer will pay just to have a backup supplier on standby.
- **Detail:** The Customer desk offers $[N \div 4]$ standby retainers: 600 VB per tick for 3 ticks to keep capacity for one delivery unit per tick of a named product type available. The GM may call the standby at most once; the holder must then deliver at list price within the tick. Failing a call is a breach and the retainers paid are refunded.
- **Discovery paths:** Customer desk; execution (a company that delivered a substitute during an outage is told); person-to-person from the affected buyer's other suppliers.
- **Claim method:** Competitive evaluation at the end of the tick.
- **Trade-off:** Reserved capacity earns little unless called; a failed call costs more than the retainer.
- **Value cap:** 1,800 VB in retainers plus the called delivery's value.
- **Window:** 1 tick.
- **Decay rule:** None.
- **Institutions involved:** Customer desk.
- **Visibility:** Hidden at load; Available at the Customer desk.
- **Linked cards:** C12, E04, E12.

O28 The Fact-Check Contract

Opportunity: Information asymmetry / market rumour

- **Signal:** Someone with money needs to know whether a story is true before they act.
- **Detail:** The Investor desk (or Media, before Tick 8) pays 1,000 VB for an E5 artefact establishing the truth status of a named live rumour, backed by two independent verifications under the Human Internet corroboration rules. The first valid artefact wins. The claimant must disclose the finding to the buyer at once. Personal-eligible: a participant or free agent can claim it into their wallet.
- **Discovery paths:** Media desk; Investor desk; registered brokers; anyone holding a copy of the rumour.
- **Claim method:** First commitment (first valid submission).
- **Trade-off:** Time spent verifying; the finding could be worth more traded or acted on than sold, and the contract forces disclosure.
- **Value cap:** 1,000 VB plus the information advantage.
- **Window:** 1 tick.
- **Decay rule:** Closes when the rumour is publicly Verified or Debunked.
- **Institutions involved:** Investor or Media.
- **Visibility:** Hidden at load; Available at Media and Investor.
- **Linked cards:** E05, E20, C05, C09, C16.

12. Defaults chosen and open questions

Where the earlier documents left a fork, this document picked a default so the library is playable now. Each one is a parameter, not a redesign, and can be changed without touching the cards.

Defaults chosen

- **Run spine.** Eleven ticks, events at Ticks 2 to 9, one sector crisis at Tick 5, one final crisis at Tick 10, Tick 11 for aftermath and the final build. The three decks (Supply squeeze, Capital cycle, Trust and rules) are presets, not rules; the GM may mix cards from any deck.
- **Local crises scale with the city.** $\lceil N \div 2 \rceil$ local (C1) crises per run, and no company receives more than one. At $N = 12$ that is six, so half the companies face a crisis aimed at them and the rest feel it second-hand.
- **Targeting is by exposure, not by choice.** Local crises pick their target from platform data by the rule printed on each card. The GM may veto a target only for operational reasons (the team is mid-pitch, a desk is overloaded, a safety concern), never to help or punish a company, and every veto is logged.
- **Consequence caps.** C1 6,000 VB, C2 8,000, C3 10,000, C4 12,000 per company, and no company can fail before the freeze because of the final crisis.
- **Force majeure** may name a card type (for example 'supply disruption'), so contract terms written in play can anticipate crises. Without such a clause, a breach during an event still counts on the Reliability Record.
- **IDs.** The draft's card numbers are kept where the drafts used them. C21 Storm Front was added at the request of the Institution Operating Content thread to give SU-08 Riverbend Growers Co-op its weather closure; E06 Infrastructure Sale and E21 Supplier Consolidation were written because that document's supplier event hooks already referenced them. E31 Energy Subsidy Change, E32 Road Rule Change, C22 Merchant Fraud and C23 Data Breach were added at the request of the Company Dossiers thread, whose vulnerabilities name them; the dossiers' fifth event, weather (crop), is C21 Storm Front, which already closes Riverbend for both Mango & Co. and HarvestLoop. Where a dossier balance lever says to fire one of these cards on a particular company, the GM chooses only the tick: the target still comes from the card's exposure rule. E31 and E32 keep the dossiers' default ticks (7 and 8) when GreenGrid or Voltway is in the active set. New cards start at E33, C24 and O29.
- **Opportunity count.** Aftermath opportunities released by a card count toward the $2N + 1$ loaded per run, so the GM does not load them twice.
- **Disclosure to participants.** The Participant Handbook should say that crises fall on companies by their exposure (concentration, fragile supply, thin runway) and that every company is subject to the same rules. The exact scoring formulas stay with the GM so participants respond to the market, not to the algorithm.

Parameters to tune first in playtest

- The number of local crises ($\lceil N \div 2 \rceil$ may be too many for a 7-company run).
- The consequence caps against starting cash, once Company Dossiers fix each company's opening balance.
- Signal lead time (one tick ahead, two to three holders): too few holders and nobody acts on the signal; too many and the crisis is priced in before it lands.
- Response window length for C3 and C4 crises, which may need more than one tick for 80 or more participants.

Open questions for the owner

1. Should participants be told in the Handbook that the final crisis is coming at Tick 10, or should only the existence of a final crisis be disclosed? Default: disclose that one is coming, not its tick or contents.
2. Is a GM veto on targeting acceptable as written (operational reasons only, logged), or should targeting be fully automatic with no veto? Default: keep the logged veto.

Investor Day Playbook, Final Scoring & Post-Event Reports

Oct 5, 2026 · @Nero Kami

Venture City ends with three separate results that never merge into one number: how each company performed economically, which outcomes each company achieved, and which individuals showed founder potential. This document runs the last 110 minutes of the day (freeze to closing line), defines exactly how each result is decided and tie-broken, and specifies the two reports that follow the event. It reuses the rules of the earlier documents and links to them rather than restating them: [Core Game Systems](#) (CGS), [Founder Identification System](#) (FID), [Institution Operating Content](#) (IOC), [GM Handbook](#) (GMH), [Event Operations Manual](#) (EOM), [Company Dossiers](#) and [Starting World](#) (SW).

0. Run parameters: what plugs in on Wednesday

The document works for any company set, any lead thesis and either truth of the Tick 7 rumour. Three values are filled in on the sealed run card at the Wednesday 7 October lock (GMH section 2); every rule below reads them, and nothing else in this document changes when they do.

Parameter	Options	Default until the owner answers	What it changes in this document
P1 Company set and N	Core 7 (N = 7), Supply-chain 7 (N = 7), City 10 (N = 10), Full 12 (N = 12)	City 10, N = 10 (confirmed by the owner on 5 October)	Room split and clock (1.3), fund size 14,000 × N and investment cap [0.7N] shown in the snapshot (IOC 3.1), observer count (FID 2.2), the median used by the Unexpected standout cut (2.6)
P2 Lead thesis	Operating, Platform or Impact partner (IOC 3.2)	Stays a random draw at the pre-event training (confirmed by the owner; GMH 2)	The fit test printed on every snapshot, each company's valuation ceiling (2.0 / 1.5 / 1.0 × RV), the lead partner's opening question in both rooms (1.4)
P3 Tick 7 rumour (E20, IC-RUM-01, "the fund favours companies with two or more partnerships")	True or False	Follows the thesis draw: true exactly when the Platform partner leads (IOC 3.2; confirmed, no separate decision)	Whether "Active or Completed deals with 2 or more other companies" counts as lead-thesis fit at Investor Day (1.4)

Run card for this event (fill on Wednesday).

Field	Value
Company set	City 10: SwiftCart, Ledgerly, Mango & Co., SkillForge, PulseAI, GreenGrid, MediLink, StackHouse, Voltway, TrustLayer (confirmed)
N	10
Room A / room B companies	5 / 5 if all 10 pitch ($P = 10$); recompute from 1.3 if failures, mergers or new ventures change P
Lead thesis	Drawn at the pre-event training: _____
Tick 7 rumour true?	Yes if Platform is drawn, otherwise No
Pitches end / results start / results end ($P = 10$)	17:13 / 17:23 / about 17:43
Fund size and investment cap	140,000 VB / 7 deals (IOC 3.1)
Observers and Ledger Lead	One per 25 participants (FID 2.2): 4 at 100, so 3 observers plus the Ledger Lead

Notes on combinations. Supply-chain 7 has only one Regulated company (Ledgerly, per the Catalogue), so an Impact lead leaves most of that set fitting no thesis: their ceiling is $1.0 \times RV$. That is legal and consistent, but the GM may prefer to redraw the thesis between Operating and Platform for that set; decide it Wednesday, not on the day. If the owner sets the rumour's truth separately from the thesis (overriding IOC 3.2), use 1.4's rule; no other part of scoring reads the rumour.

Part 1. Investor Day Playbook

Investor Day turns the frozen city into three announcements: what the fund decides, which company is Best Venture, and which individuals the Founder Ledger recognises. The pitch matters, but only inside limits set by frozen data: no panel can value a company above its thesis ceiling, and no pitch can change a frozen number.

1.1 Rules that hold all the way through

1. **Frozen state decides.** Everything is read from the state locked at 16:10 (GMH 11). Nothing said or done after the freeze changes cash, ownership, contracts or any score input (EOM 10.3).
2. **Two pipelines, one stage.** Company scoring (Tech Lead, panels) and the Founder Ledger roll-up (Ledger Lead) run in parallel and share only participant and company IDs until the ceremony (FID 5.4). Panels never see Ledger data; the Ledger Lead never sees company scores before proposing awards.
3. **Observers are not panellists** (FID 5.4). They sit in the rooms only to record Q&A evidence, capped at grade B, significance 2 (FID 3.3), and at no more than half of that company's existing entries (GMH 12).
4. **Same rules in both rooms.** Both panels use the same decision card (1.4), so the room a company draws cannot help or hurt it.

5. **Every surviving company pitches.** "Surviving" means any company not Failed, Dissolved or Acquired-and-integrated at the freeze. Distressed companies pitch; new ventures and spin-outs pitch; a merged company pitches once; a held subsidiary is presented inside its parent's slot. Call the number of pitching companies **P**. Room timing uses P, not N.

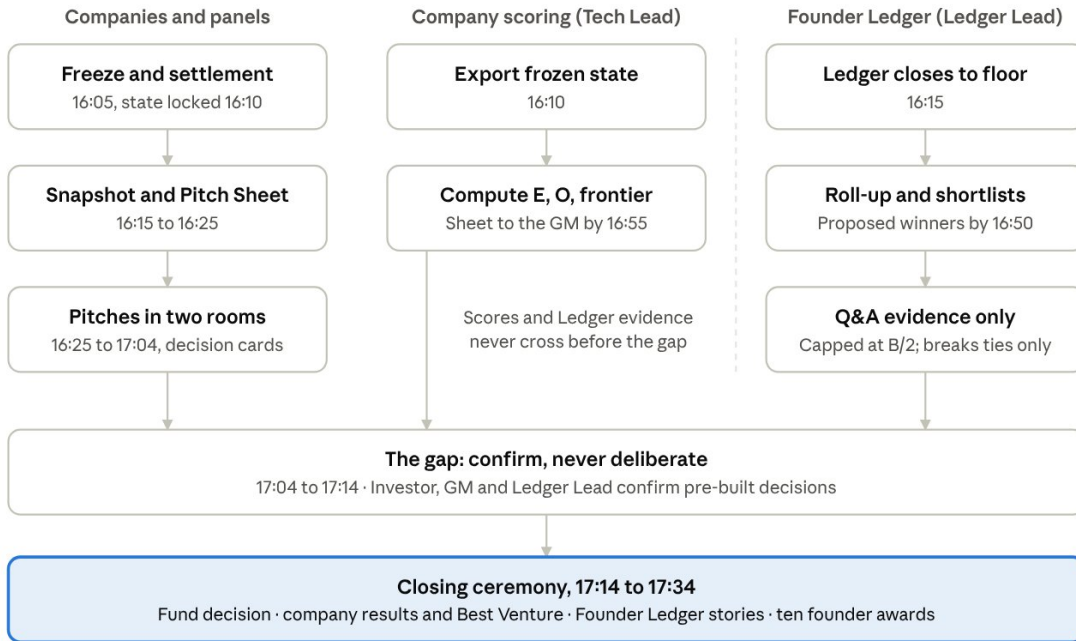
1.2 Run of show, freeze to close

Times are for the standard day (GMH 3) with P = 7. Rows marked "by P" shift by the table in 1.3. For this run (City 10, all ten pitching): room B finishes 17:13 and is back at 17:23, room A ends 17:13, the gap runs 17:13 to 17:23, and the ceremony runs 17:23 to about 17:43.

Clock	What happens	Owner
15:55	Transaction cutoff; only recorded deals settle	MC, Deal Desk
16:05	Final market freeze; final settlement steps 1 to 10 for Tick 10	GM, Tech Lead
16:05 to 16:25	Preparation window. Companies write their Pitch Sheet (1.5); room B companies move to the second hall after collecting their snapshot	Companies, Floor runner
16:10	State locked; options vest; Tech Lead starts the scoring export (2.3, 2.4)	Tech Lead
16:10 to 16:20	Paper evidence (observation cards, any failsafe forms used) handed to GM Control; nothing else is collected, because Founder Dossiers stay on the platform and there are no physical assets	CEO volunteers, desks
16:15	Pitch order drawn; rooms assigned (1.3); each company handed its Frozen Snapshot and crisis timeline	Boundary GM
16:15	Ledger closes for floor play (freeze + 15 min, FID 6.1); roll-up starts	Ledger Lead
16:20 to 16:25	Pitch Sheets handed in at the room door by 16:25, one copy	Companies

Clock	What happens	Owner
	per panellist	
16:25	Investor Day opens in both rooms: 3-minute opening by the room chair	MC (room A), Floor GM (room B)
16:28 onward	9-minute slots: 5:00 pitch, 3:00 questions, 1:00 changeover, during which the panel fills the decision card	Panels
16:50	Ledger Lead freezes award shortlists and proposed winners from floor evidence (1.8)	Ledger Lead
16:55 (by P)	Room B finishes and walks back to the main hall (10 minutes)	Floor runner
17:04 (by P)	Room A finishes. Gap: 10 minutes to confirm fund decisions, Best Venture and awards (1.8)	GM, Investor, Ledger Lead
17:14 (by P)	Closing ceremony , 20 minutes (1.9)	MC, Investor, Ledger Lead, Event Lead
17:34 (by P)	Closing line, survey link, departure	MC

Company scores and founder evidence run apart and meet only on stage



freeze to ceremony at $P = 7$ · two pipelines meeting in the gap

The company and founder pipelines run side by side from the freeze and meet for the first time in the 10-minute gap, where every decision is confirmed rather than made.

1.3 Rooms and clock by number of pitching companies

Room A is the main-hall stage with an Investor partner, the Lead GM and an optional guest investor. Room B is the second hall, chaired by the Floor GM with the Bank lead and the Government volunteer (EOM 10.4). Pitch order is drawn at random; the first $\lceil P \div 2 \rceil$ draws go to room A, so at odd P the larger half stays on the stage and the smaller half has time to walk back.

P	Room A / room B	Pitch block (room A)	Room A ends	Room B back in main hall	Results start	Results end
6	3 / 3	30 min	16:55	17:05	17:05	about 17:25
7	4 / 3	39 min	17:04	17:05	17:14	about 17:34
8	4 / 4	39 min	17:04	17:14	17:14	about 17:34
9	5 / 4	48 min	17:13	17:14	17:23	about 17:43
10	5 / 5	48 min	17:13	17:23	17:23	about 17:43
11	6 / 5	57 min	17:22	17:23	17:32	about 17:52

P	Room A / room B	Pitch block (room A)	Room A ends	Room B back in main hall	Results start	Results end
12	6 / 6	57 min	17:22	17:32	17:32	about 17:52

Results start 10 minutes after room A ends, which is also when room B is back for every P. These rows match EOM 10.4 and GMH 12 at P = 7, 10 and 12; the other rows follow the same arithmetic (3-minute opening plus 9 minutes per company). Every row closes before 18:00.

1.4 How the panel evaluates, by the active thesis

Each panel fills one decision card per company. The card has three parts, and only the third involves judgement.

Part A, thesis fit (from the snapshot, not the panel). The Tech Lead runs IOC 3.2's fit tests on the frozen registry and prints the result on each snapshot: fits the lead thesis, fits another partner's thesis, or fits none. That sets the company's **ceiling**: 2.0, 1.5 or $1.0 \times RV$ (IOC 3.2), with the floor at $0.5 \times RV$ (CGS 7.4). Fit tests are IOC's, unchanged: Operating (verified customer revenue in each of the last 2 ticks and at least 1 Completed contract), Platform (Active or Completed deals with 2 or more other companies), Impact (a Government licence or certification, or a grant or tender won).

Rumour rule (P3). When the Platform partner leads, the rumour is true by construction and nothing extra applies. If the owner has made the rumour true while another partner leads, a company passing the Platform test also counts as fitting the lead thesis for its ceiling, the same mechanism IOC 3.7 uses for E09 Investor Frenzy. If the rumour is false, it has no effect. Event effects that expired before the freeze (E09, E10) do not apply at Investor Day.

Part B, the lead partner's question (from the thesis). The room chair opens every Q&A with the lead partner's question from IOC 3.2, so all companies face the same first question whatever room they are in:

Lead thesis	Opening question in both rooms
Operating	"What does one more unit cost you, and what do you sell it for?"
Platform	"Who would be hurt if you disappeared tomorrow?"
Impact	"What did you have to prove to be allowed to do this?"

The other two minutes and a half are open questions, but every question must be answerable from the snapshot or the Pitch Sheet.

Part C, conviction (three yes or no checks). The panel agrees each check together during the changeover minute; the chair records it.

1. **Evidence match.** Every number the team stated matches the snapshot. One contradicted claim fails the check.
2. **Thesis answer.** The team answered the opening question with registry evidence (a named contract, deal, licence or delivery), not only with a story. Claims resting on Rumour-grade information cards carry no weight (IOC 3.6).
3. **Next step.** The Pitch Sheet names a use of funds tied to a milestone the fund could verify, written the way a tranche condition is written (IOC 3.5).

With k checks passed, the decision is:

$$\text{indicative multiple } m = 0.5 + (\text{ceiling} - 0.5) \times \frac{k}{3}, \text{ } \forall k = 1, 2, 3$$

Checks passed (k)	Decision	m at ceiling 2.0	m at ceiling 1.5	m at ceiling 1.0
3	Back	2.0	1.5	1.0
2	Back	1.5	1.17	0.83
1	Back	1.0	0.83	0.67
0	Pass	none	none	none

The company's **Investor Day Valuation** is $m \times$ its final RV. It always sits inside the CGS 7.4 band of 0.5 to $2 \times$ RV and below the IOC thesis ceiling, so no panel can invent a valuation. Founder quality is not on the card: IOC 3.6 already forbids the fund from reading the Founder Ledger, and this keeps the two pipelines apart.

Room B has no Investor volunteer. Its panel fills the same card, and the Investor reviews room B's cards in the gap (1.8); the Investor may correct a check only where the snapshot shows it was recorded wrongly, and logs the change.

1.5 The data package each company has

Every company receives one auto-generated **Frozen Snapshot** and hands in one **Pitch Sheet**. Panels hold the same two documents for every company. Both follow the source draft's Investor Day Data Package (Technology draft section 67) and the submission list in the original concept.

Frozen Snapshot (platform-generated at 16:10, printed by 16:15; identical copy for the company and both panels):

Block	Contents	Source rule
Status	Lifecycle state at freeze (Operating, High Growth, Distressed), merger or acquisition history	CGS 8.1
Valuation	Baseline RV, final RV, NAV, average verified customer revenue over Ticks 9 and 10	CGS 7.2

Block	Contents	Source rule
Cap table	Holders and shares at the lock, Founding Holder percentage, investor rights held, liquidation preferences	CGS 7.1, 7.4, 7.5
Finance	Cash, debt outstanding by lender, arrears, capital raised and equity given away (amount, price, %)	CGS 7.3, 7.4
Commercial	Customer contracts (live, Completed, breached), new revenue since T0, Enterprise cards signed	CGS 4, IOC 4
People	Headcount, required seats filled and empty, Workforce Credit, hires and departures by tick	CGS 5.3
Resources	Stock of each of the six resources against its consumption tier; ticks at zero	SW 6.4
Reliability Record	Contracts fulfilled, contracts breached, payments missed	CGS 1.5
Strategic moves	Partnerships, stakes, M&A, spin-outs, licences held, grants and tenders	CGS 8, IOC 6
Objectives	Each of the five objective layers marked Met or Not met (2.4); the Hidden layer is shown to the company and the Tech Lead only, never printed on panel copies	Dossiers shared conventions
Crisis timeline	Every event and crisis that touched the company and the response recorded	GMH 12
Thesis fit	Fit result and ceiling (1.4)	IOC 3.2

Pitch Sheet (one page, written by the company in the preparation window, handed in at the room door by 16:25):

1. The seven beats of the pitch arc in one line each (1.6).

2. Up to three claims the team will defend, each with the snapshot line or registry ID that proves it.
3. The ask: amount, use of funds and the milestone it buys, by when.
4. The names of the people who will present and answer (any staff member may; presenters earn nothing extra).

A company that hands in no Pitch Sheet still pitches; it simply cannot pass conviction check 3.

1.6 The pitch arc

Companies receive this arc with their snapshot. It is EOM 10.4's seven-beat structure, which itself comes from the source draft's Investor Day Operations section, and each beat points at the snapshot block that backs it, so the story is told against evidence.

Beat	What the team says	Backed by
1. What we started with	The T0 position: product, anchor customer, constraint	Baseline RV, dossier public facts
2. What changed	The event, crisis or market move that mattered most	Crisis timeline
3. What we built	Products delivered, capacity added, licences won	Commercial, Strategic moves
4. What customers valued	Who paid, for what, and who renewed	Commercial, verified revenue
5. How we survived	The hardest moment and the decision that got through it	Finance, Reliability Record
6. Where the opportunity is now	The next market and why this company can reach it	Thesis fit, Growth layer
7. Why this team should continue	What the team has proved it can do together	Pitch Sheet claims

The MC cuts at 5:00 and 3:00 without exception (EOM 10.4). Slides are optional and never required; a printed snapshot is enough.

1.7 During the pitches: the two pipelines

Tech Lead (company pipeline). From 16:10 the Tech Lead computes, for every company, the Economic and Outcome results (2.3, 2.4) and the Best Venture frontier (2.5), and hands them to the GM on one sheet by 16:55. The panels do not see this sheet while pitching.

Ledger Lead (founder pipeline). From 16:15 the Ledger Lead runs the completeness check, banding and profile reads (FID 5.1 to 5.3), builds each award's shortlist (FID 6.2) and runs the six evidence checks on every shortlisted case. At 16:50 the Ledger Lead fixes one proposed winner per award, applying FID 6.4's one-award-per-person rule and decision order. Q&A entries recorded after 16:50 can only break a tie the Ledger Lead has already flagged; they never create a shortlist on their own, because of the FID 3.3 cap.

1.8 The 10-minute gap: confirming decisions

The gap between room A's last pitch and the ceremony is too short to deliberate from scratch, so every decision arrives pre-built and is only confirmed (GMH 12).

Decision	Arrives as	Confirmed by	Can change it when
Fund decisions	Both rooms' decision cards	Investor	A check was recorded against what the snapshot shows (logged)
Fund allocation	Computed from the cards (below)	Investor	Never by judgement; only a computation error
Best Venture	The frontier and the rule in 2.5	GM and Investor	Only at the last tie-breaker in 2.5
Founder awards	The Ledger Lead's proposed winners with each story moment	GM and Ledger Lead (FID 6.2's panel, with any observer back from the rooms)	A FID 6.2 check fails, or a flagged tie is settled by Q&A evidence
Unexpected standout flags	The Tech Lead's bottom-half company list (2.6), handed over only now	Ledger Lead	Never changes a read or an award (FID 5.3)

Fund allocation ("the fund decides"). The fund cannot move shares after the cap table lock (CGS 7.5), so its Investor Day decision is a published commitment, not a transaction: it is announced on stage and recorded in both post-event reports, and it changes no frozen result. The Investor allocates whatever the fund has not committed during the capital window, in this order:

1. List the Back companies by indicative multiple m , highest first; break ties by final RV, higher first.
2. Give each, in order, up to 25,000 VB (the IOC ticket maximum), never taking any company above 30% of the fund in total (CGS 7.4 concentration, counting capital-window money already invested).
3. Stop when the remaining fund or the remaining investment count ($[0.7N]$ minus deals already done) runs out.

The Investor reads each commitment on stage with its valuation: "The fund backs [company] at $[m]$ times RV, an Investor Day valuation of $[VB]$, with a commitment of $[VB]$."

1.9 The closing ceremony (20 minutes)

Order follows the source draft: the company results first, then the Founder Ledger stories, then the founder awards, so the room has seen that the day was not only about money before any person is named (FID 6.5).

Min	Segment	Who	Content
0 to 2	The city at freeze	MC	Number of companies still standing, deals made, people hired, money raised (read from the snapshot totals)
2 to 6	The fund decides	Investor	Each Back company's commitment and valuation (1.8). Pass decisions are not read aloud
6 to 9	Company results and Best Venture	GM	The company results board (2.7) on screen, then Best Venture with the one-line reason from 2.5
9 to 14	The Founder Ledger	Ledger Lead	5 to 7 anonymous timed stories from different companies and signals (FID 6.5)
14 to 19	Founder awards	Event Lead and Ledger Lead	The ten individual awards in FID 6.3 order, each read with its moment, then the person named. An award nobody earned is said to be not given today
19 to 20	Close	MC	Thanks, the 7-day personal summary promise, the survey link, "Now imagine doing this for real."

What is never shown publicly: any person's band, read, entry count or rank (FID 6.5); any company's Hidden objective; any combined company-and-founder figure.

1.10 Edge cases

- **A company is Distressed at the freeze.** It pitches and can receive a Back decision (the fund may like a rescue), but it is not eligible for Best Venture (2.5). Nobody is failed or liquidated at the freeze (GMH 11).
- **A company failed during the day.** It does not pitch. The MC names it in the opening as part of the city's story, never as a loser. Its former staff are in other companies or free agents and remain fully eligible for founder awards (FID 5.5).
- **Free agents at the freeze.** They attend the room of their choice; they are observed in Q&A like anyone else if they speak.
- **A team member is absent.** Any staff member present may pitch; there is no penalty.
- **A pitch overruns or the clock slips.** The MC cuts at 5:00 and 3:00. If a room falls more than 5 minutes behind, the chair shortens changeovers, never pitches. If the ceremony start slips, cut the city recap first, never the Founder Ledger stories.
- **Platform down at the freeze.** The Boundary GM's paper ledger is the record (EOM 13.3); the Tech Lead computes Part 2 from it by hand using 2.3 and 2.4, which need only registry totals.

Part 2. Final Scoring

Winning has three separate meanings, decided by three separate rules, and no rule adds one dimension to another. This is the source draft's design choice (Economic, Founder and Outcome performance as separate dimensions, because "a team can fail financially but contain an exceptional founder") and FID's law that people are never reduced to one score.

2.1 The three dimensions

Dimension	Who it is about	Measure	Decided by	Announced as
Economic performance	Each company	E, the Founder-Held Value multiple (2.3), built on CGS RV and cap-table math	Tech Lead, from frozen data	A line on the company results board
Outcome performance	Each company	O, the number of the dossier's five objective layers met (2.4)	Tech Lead, GM signs off	A line on the company results board
Founder performance	Each participant	Founder Ledger bands, reads and awards, unchanged from FID	Ledger Lead and FID 6.2's panel	The ten individual awards

Best Venture is the only award that reads two dimensions, and it does so without adding them: it looks for companies that no other company beats on both E and O, then lets the fund's decision choose among those (2.5). It never reads the Founder Ledger, and no founder award reads E or O (FID 6.3).

Not scored anywhere: personal wallet balances (VB is money, not score), Personal Objective rewards (they reach the Ledger only as grade-B draft entries, FID 2.4), presentation polish, and anything that happened after the freeze.

2.2 Baselines: comparing against where each company started

Every company is measured against its own start, so an inherited position earns nothing by itself (the draft's "a team can make enormous money because it inherited a great starting position").

- **Baseline RV** is the RV the platform publishes at Market Open, before Tick 1 settles, using the real T0 cash the platform recomputes at registration close (GMH 5.3). With no revenue history it equals $\max(\text{NAV}, 0)$ (CGS 7.2).
- **Baseline Founder-Held Value** is $800 \div 1,000$ of Baseline RV, because the Founding Holder owns 800 of 1,000 shares at T0 (CGS 7.1).
- **Final RV** is the RV after the freeze settlement, at 16:10 (GMH 11): $\max(\text{NAV}, 0)$ plus $6 \times$ average verified customer revenue over Ticks 9 and 10 (CGS 7.2).

2.3 Economic performance: the Founder-Held Value multiple

$$\text{FHV} = \frac{\text{Founding Holder shares}}{\text{shares outstanding at the lock}} \times \text{Final RV}$$

$$E = \frac{\text{FHV}}{\text{Final RV}} \times 0.8 \times \text{Baseline RV}$$
 Shares outstanding include the option pool, the investor's shares and any strategic or angel stakes, exactly as the CGS 7.4 worked example counts them.

Why this measure. Raising money lifts RV by the cash raised, so RV alone would reward any raise. FHV counts the equity given away for it. A raise improves E only when it was priced well (the thesis ceilings in IOC 3.2 are what make a good price possible) or when the money turned into verified revenue, which the multiple of 6 rewards. Debt does not dilute, but it is already netted out of NAV. This is the cap-table math CGS 10.3 left to this document.

Worked example (illustrative). The CGS 7.2 example company starts at Baseline RV 44,550 VB, so its baseline FHV is 35,640 VB. At Tick 8 its RV is 50,000 VB; it fits the lead thesis and raises 20,000 VB at a 75,000 VB pre-money ($1.5 \times \text{RV}$): 75 VB a share, 267 new shares (rounded), 1,267 outstanding, Founding Holder 63.1%. At the freeze its NAV is 50,000 VB and its revenue averaged 3,000 VB over Ticks 9 and 10, so Final RV is 68,000 VB, FHV is 42,935 VB and **E = 1.20**. Without the raise (NAV 38,000, revenue 2,000) it would have had Final RV 50,000, FHV 40,000 and **E = 1.12**. Values of E below 1.0 are normal, because salaries leave the company for personal wallets every tick.

Scoring conventions (computed by the Tech Lead; none of them changes a CGS rule during play):

Situation	How E is computed
Merged company	FHV adds both original Founding Holders' shares in the survivor; the baseline adds both

Situation	How E is computed
	companies' baselines
Acquired and integrated target	No E of its own. The board shows an exit line: consideration received ÷ its baseline FHV. Its result lives on inside the buyer
Held subsidiary	Reported inside the parent. For scoring only, the parent's NAV includes its stake: percentage held × the subsidiary's Final RV
Strategic stakes under 50%	Same convention: percentage held × the target's Final RV, added to the holder's NAV for scoring only
Debt-for-equity restructuring	Bank shares count as outstanding (CGS 8.6)
Liquidation preferences	Ignored, because there is no exit at Investor Day; shown on the snapshot
New venture or spin-out	E is shown against the founders' share of NAV at the founding tick, marked "founded at Tick X" (see 2.5 for eligibility)

Workforce Credit appears on the snapshot for diligence but is not a separate input: empty seats already reduce NAV through deficit charges (CGS 5.3), so counting WC again would double-count it.

2.4 Outcome performance: the five objective layers

Every dossier carries the same five objective layers, the first two identical for every company (Company Dossiers, shared conventions). O is how many are met at the freeze, from 0 to 5.

Layer	Met when	Evidence
Survival	Never Distressed for 2 ticks running, and solvent at freeze	Platform lifecycle log (E1)
Revenue	18,000 VB of new revenue by freeze, excluding the T0 anchor's Ticks 1 to 6	Registry revenue (E1)
Growth	The dossier's Growth Opportunity is unlocked	The unlock condition's evidence class
Strategic (public objective)	The dossier's public objective is achieved	As written in the dossier, usually E1 or E3
Hidden (private objective)	The dossier's private objective type is achieved (Vertical move, Partner web, Customer base,	E1, or E3 for licences

Layer	Met when	Evidence
	Enterprise reach, Independence, Licence first, Consolidator)	

The Tech Lead marks each layer from the registry; any layer resting on E3 or E4 evidence needs the GM's initials. Layers are never part-met.

Merged companies (the question CGS 8.3 left open): each layer counts as met if either predecessor's version of it is met, and is counted once, so O still runs 0 to 5. Merging costs money and staff consent, and one hidden type (Consolidator) already rewards it, so this keeps a merger neutral rather than a shortcut.

2.5 Best Venture

Best Venture is "the strongest company outcome" (FID 6.3), decided in four steps from company data only.

1. **Eligibility.** The company played from T0 (including a reserve company activated before T0) and is Operating or High Growth at the freeze. Merged survivors are eligible. Distressed companies, acquired targets, failed or dissolved companies, and new ventures and spin-outs are not.
2. **The frontier.** A company is *beaten* if another eligible company has an E at least as high and an O at least as high, and is strictly higher on one of them. The **frontier** is every eligible company that is not beaten. No weights are set between E and O.
3. **Pick.** If one company is on the frontier, it is Best Venture. If several are, Best Venture is the frontier company with the highest Investor Day multiple m from 1.4 (Pass counts as zero).
4. **Ties, in order:** higher O; then higher E; then the cleaner Reliability Record (fewest contracts breached plus payments missed, CGS 1.5); then a decision by the GM and the Investor, with the reason written in the post-event report.

The GM reads Best Venture with its reason in one line: "No company beat [name] on both value created and objectives met, and the fund backed it at [m] times RV."

Why this shape. A company cannot win by money alone if another matched its money and achieved more, or by objectives alone if another achieved as much and created more value. The panel's view only chooses among companies the numbers cannot separate, which is what the Participant Handbook already promises ("company results and the panel's view"). The active thesis matters only through m, so a run's thesis tilts Best Venture exactly as far as it tilts the fund.

Why new ventures are not eligible (a default the owner can change). They exist for 2 to 3 ticks (Founder Window Ticks 7 to 8, GMH 13.1) and start from about 10,000 VB of committed capital instead of a full dossier, so their E is measured over a different time and base and would routinely top the city. Their founders are recognised by the founder awards, where founding is strong Initiator, Talent magnet and Owner evidence (FID 5.5). They appear on the results board with their numbers and are named by the MC.

Illustrative frontier (made-up numbers, P = 7):

Company	E	O	Beaten by	On frontier?	m
A	1.31	3	none	Yes	1.5
B	1.12	5	none	Yes	1.17
C	1.18	4	none	Yes	2.0
D	1.05	3	A, C	No	1.5
E	0.94	4	B, C	No	1.0
F	0.88	2	A, B, C, D, E	No	Pass
G	Distressed	1	not eligible	No	0.83

A, B and C are on the frontier; C has the highest m, so C is Best Venture, even though A created the most value and B met the most objectives.

2.6 Founder performance

Founder results are entirely FID's, reused without change: signal bands from each participant's best three independent entries (FID 5.1), profile reads (FID 5.3), shortlists and the six evidence checks (FID 6.2), the ten individual awards (FID 6.3) and the award rules (FID 6.4): one individual award per person, a minimum of Clear or better in the award's signal with at least one grade A entry (otherwise the award is not given), and the decision order Founder of the Day, Most Promising Founder, The Invisible Force, then the rest.

The one input this document supplies: "bottom half of the company results" for FID 5.3's Unexpected standout flag. A company is in the bottom half if, at the freeze, it was ineligible for Best Venture for any reason other than being a new venture or spin-out, or it was eligible but below the median on both E and O among eligible companies. A participant is matched to the company they belonged to at the freeze (free agents to their last company). The Tech Lead hands the Ledger Lead only the list of bottom-half company IDs, and only after proposed winners are fixed (1.8), so the flag can colour the reveal stories but cannot touch a read or an award.

2.7 What the company results board shows

One screen, companies in alphabetical order, with no overall rank column and no combined figure.

Company	Status at freeze	Fund decision	Economic: E (Final RV)	Outcome: layers met
Name	Operating, High Growth, Distressed, Merged, or Founded at Tick X	Back at $m \times RV$, or blank for Pass	1.18 (61,200 VB)	4 of 5

Acquired targets and failed companies are listed beneath in a "Stories of the day" strip with their exit line or the tick they closed. Best Venture is highlighted after the GM announces it. The board shows only the count of layers met, never which layers, so no Hidden objective is spelled out on screen.

2.8 Tie-breakers, one dimension at a time

Dimension	Used for	Tie-breakers in order
Economic	Sorting E in the post-event report; the median in 2.6	Higher Final RV; then higher average verified customer revenue over Ticks 9 and 10; then shared position
Outcome	Sorting O in the post-event report; the median in 2.6	Cleaner Reliability Record; then the earlier tick at which the last met layer was completed; then shared position
Best Venture	The single company award	Highest m among the frontier; then higher O; then higher E; then cleaner Reliability Record; then GM and Investor decision, logged
Fund allocation	Order of commitments (1.8)	Higher m; then higher Final RV
Founder awards	Each individual award	Seen by more observers; then more significance-3 entries; then a panel decision recorded in the post-event report (FID 6.4)

No tie-breaker in one dimension ever uses a measure from another, except that Best Venture uses E and O, which are both company measures.

Part 3. Post-Event Founder Report

The Venture Labs team receives the Founder Report within 7 days of the event (by Saturday 17 October for this run), the same deadline FID 6.5 sets for participant summaries and invitations, because Venture Labs needs the candidate pages to send those invitations. The report holds one page per participant and a cohort summary. It never contains a total, rank, composite index or anything else that reduces a person to one number (FID 5, source draft "Do not reduce people to one score").

Owner and inputs. The Ledger Lead writes it, with the Tech Lead supplying registry extracts. Inputs: the closed Founder Ledger and profiles (FID 5), the collaboration map (FID 5.5), award evidence (FID 6.2), the frozen registry, and the post-event data package (EOM 14.4). Calibration notes and coverage-gap analysis, which FID 6.5 also lists for Venture Labs, go in Part 4's founder-identification section by day 14, so the 14-day commitment in FID still holds in full.

Access. Venture Labs staff only (FID 6.7). Participants never see it; each receives only their personal summary (FID 6.5), and any participant may ask to see that summary.

3.1 Cohort summary (one page)

Item	Content
Run facts	Date, company set, N, lead thesis, participants observed, observers
Profile reads	How many participants received each of the five reads (FID 5.3), and the Unexpected standout flags
Awards	Each award with winner, its story moment, and any award not given and why
Invitation list	Founder candidates and standouts invited to the founder session (FID 6.6), with date sent
Proposed teams	Anchor and complement suggestions from 3.3, for the founder session
Coverage	Participants with no entries, listed as unobserved, never as weak (FID 6.1)

3.2 Participant page (template)

One page per participant, in this order. Sections A to D are founder evidence; section E is company context and is visually separated, labelled "Context only: never used in the profile".

VENTURE CITY FOUNDER REPORT · PARTICIPANT PAGE · VENTURE LABS ONLY

Participant: _____ ID: ____ Consent on file: Yes / No

Profile read: Founder candidate / Operator standout / Commercial standout /
Specialist standout / Developing Unexpected standout: Yes / No

Award(s): _____ Invited to founder session: Yes / No

A. SIGNATURE STRENGTHS (up to 3 signals at Clear or Exceptional, strongest first)

1. _____ (band) · 2. _____ (band) · 3. _____ (band)

Family spread: Drive / Value creation / Market sense / Exchange / Pressure

B. FOUNDER SIGNALS OBSERVED (story moments, timed, one line each)

1. hh:mm · _____

2. hh:mm · _____

3. hh:mm · _____

Pressure record (every CL, AD, RX entry): _____

C. KEY DECISIONS (from the registry, where this person is the recorded negotiator or signatory, and from ledger entries)

Tick · Decision · Counterparty · What changed

D. HOW THE DAY WENT

Trajectory: entries in Act I / II / III / IV

Path: company and role, with times (incl. moves, founding, free agency)

Caveats: counter-entries; single-observer warning if it applies

Coverage: entries ____ from ____ observers

E. COMPANY CONTEXT (context only, never used in the profile)

Company at freeze: _____ Status: _____

Economic E: ____ Outcome: __ of 5 Fund decision: _____

Best Venture: Yes / No

F. POTENTIAL FOUNDER MATCHES

Complements (cover families this person lacks): _____

Proven chemistry (collaboration map, cross-company first): _____

G. OBSERVED STRENGTHS, IN WORDS (3 to 5 sentences, evidence-based, no adjectives about the person, no comparison with others)

Rules for filling it:

- Bands appear only for Clear and Exceptional signals. Emerging and Not seen are never listed, so the page shows strengths, not gaps.
- Every sentence in section G must point at an entry in B, C or D. "Confident" or "natural leader" are not evidence (FID 3.3).
- Section C lists decisions, not outcomes for the company: "Tick 6, signed a 4-tick supply contract with a rival to secure Logistics" is a decision; the company's VB is not.
- Section E is printed for Venture Labs' convenience only. The FID separation law applies: nothing in E may be used to choose who is invited (FID 5.4).

3.3 How potential founder matches are made

Matches follow FID 6.6 and are proposals for the founder session, never assignments.

1. **Anchors.** Every Founder candidate is a possible anchor.
2. **Complements.** For each anchor, list invited standouts whose signature strengths cover the families the anchor lacks; a Drive-heavy anchor needs Value creation and Market sense.
3. **Proven chemistry.** Prefer people the collaboration map shows already created an outcome together, cross-company pairs first.
4. **Choice.** Venture Labs proposes; participants decide (FID 6.6).

Write each proposed team as: anchor, two or three complements, the families covered, and the shared moment that shows chemistry (if any).

Part 4. Post-Event Learning and Analytics Report

This report improves the next run. It is a template to fill in from the actual event, due within 14 days (by Saturday 24 October for this run), owned by the Event Lead with the GM (economy and mechanics), the Ledger Lead (founder identification) and the Tech Lead (data). Its sources are the post-event data package (EOM 14.4), the volunteer debrief and participant survey (EOM 14.3), and the platform export. Every cell below is filled from the event; nothing is estimated in advance.

4.1 Run facts

Field	Value
Date, venue, hours actually run	
Company set, N, P (companies pitching)	
Lead thesis; Tick 7 rumour true or false	
Participants registered / attended / observed	
Volunteers by role; observers	
Deviations from the GMH run sheet (time, what, why)	

4.2 What worked and where people got stuck

Question	Finding	Evidence (debrief note, queue log, survey %)
Which mechanic produced the strongest behaviour?		
Which mechanic was ignored or misunderstood?		
Where did participants get stuck, and at which tick?		
Which desk became an unintended bottleneck (average and peak queue time)?		
Which rule was unclear (disputes needing the GM, by rule)?		
Which event or crisis felt artificial?		

Question	Finding	Evidence (debrief note, queue log, survey %)
Which opportunities were found without prompting?		
Which systems failed or slowed play (downtime minutes)?		

4.3 Economic balance

Measure	Result	Target or expectation	Read
Money supply by tick (City Reserve view, CGS 1.4)		Stable, no runaway inflation	
Mission payouts vs customer revenue		Missions should not out-earn customers (CGS 10.2)	
Spread of E across companies (lowest, median, highest)			
Starting position vs result: rank correlation between T0 SPV and E		Near zero; a strong link means starting positions decided the day	
Bank debt used vs 30,000 ceiling; defaults			
Investor fund committed in the window; deals vs [0.7N] cap			
Valuation multiples agreed in the window vs thesis ceilings			

4.4 Resource scarcity

Resource	Ticks any company sat at zero	Bank dynamic price steps reached (+20%, +50%)	Price index at freeze	Read

Resource	Ticks any company sat at zero	Bank dynamic price steps reached (+20%, +50%)	Price index at freeze	Read
Compute				
Energy				
Logistics				
Materials				
Data				
Infrastructure				

4.5 Activity counts

Activity	Count	By tick (peak tick)
Deals recorded (all types)		
Customer contracts signed / completed / breached		
Hires, poaches, counteroffers		
Equity investments (fund, strategic, angel)		
Loans (Bank, between players)		
Acquisitions, mergers, spin-outs, new ventures		
Auction lots offered / sold		
Information cards traded; verifications		

4.6 Company survival and outcomes

Company	Status at freeze	Ticks Distressed	Layers met (of 5)	E	Fund decision	Best Venture?

Also record: which objective layers were met most and least often across companies, and whether any company's public objective proved much easier or harder than the rest (the dossiers aim for equal difficulty).

4.7 Mission completion

Measure	Result	Target
Missions claimed / completed, by tier		
Personal Objective completion rate		40 to 60% (Personal Objective System)
Personal Objectives swapped		
Opportunities discovered / claimed / expired		

4.8 Crisis response

Card	Tick	Companies hit	Responses recorded	Consequence paid vs cap	Did it create the intended decision?

4.9 Founder-identification accuracy

Measure	Result	Target or check
Entries per participant (median, lowest)		Several per participant (EOM 14.5)
Participants unobserved		Zero (FID 6.1)
Entries by observer; share of profiles resting on one observer		
Founder candidates as a share of participants		Not above 10% (FID 6.2 calibration signal)
Halo check triggered? Which company, and the result		FID 5.4
Loudness check changes		FID 6.2
Awards not given, and why		
Agreement check: shortlist overlap between observers on a sample of 10 profiles		
Calibration notes and coverage gaps (the FID 6.5 items for		

Measure	Result	Target or check
Venture Labs)		
Follow-up accuracy (fill at 3 and 6 months): invited participants who joined a Venture Labs programme; who founded or joined a venture; any standout later missed by the ledger		

4.10 Investor Day

Measure	Result
Planned vs actual pitch end and results end	
Overruns and cuts	
Back / Pass decisions by room; average m by room (a room bias check)	
Best Venture decided at which step of 2.5	
Fund allocation announced vs remaining fund	

4.11 Changes for the next run

One row per proposed change. Parameters come first from CGS 10.2's tuning table, then anything else the findings above support.

Parameter or rule	Current value	Proposed value	Evidence from this run	Owner

5. Consistency check

This document was checked against every earlier document it touches. It redefines none of their rules; the table lists what it reuses, and the second table lists the places where documents disagreed or left a question to this one, with the call made. Each call is a default the owner can change.

5.1 What is reused, unchanged

Source	Reused here
Core Game Systems	RV and NAV formulas (7.2), share and price formula and dilution cap (7.4), cap table lock one tick before freeze (7.5), lifecycle states and

Source	Reused here
	Distressed triggers (8.1, 8.6), Reliability Record (1.5), evidence classes E1 to E5 (1.3)
Founder Identification System	The 15 signals, bands, reads, Unexpected standout flag, award list and award rules, six evidence checks, Q&A cap at B/2, roll-up during Investor Day, separation law, 7-day participant summaries and invitations, team formation and consent
Institution Operating Content	Fund size and investment cap, ticket range, thesis fit tests, ceilings $2.0 / 1.5 / 1.0 \times RV$, the lead partners' questions, IC-RUM-01 truth rule, the fund never reading the Ledger
GM Handbook	10-tick clock, freeze at 16:05 with final settlement and lock at 16:10, pitch order drawn at 16:15, Investor Day at 16:25, panels per room, Ledger Lead bringing proposed winners, Q&A volume cap
Event Operations Manual	Two rooms at every N, 9-minute slots with hard cuts, the seven-beat pitch arc, results timing by N, 10-minute move from room B, data package and debrief questions feeding Part 4
Company Dossiers	The five objective layers and the shared private objective types; the 18,000 VB new-revenue target
Starting World	Company sets, reserve activation before T0, Starting Position Value band used in Part 4's balance check

5.2 Calls this document made

#	Question or conflict	Sources	Call made here
1	Weights of RV, Workforce Credit, Reliability Record, cap-table ownership and liquidation preferences in final scoring	CGS 5.3, 7.2, 10.3	No weights anywhere. E uses RV and cap-table ownership through FHV; WC is diligence context only (already inside NAV via deficit charges); Reliability is a tie-breaker; liquidation

#	Question or conflict	Sources	Call made here
			preferences are ignored at a going-concern Investor Day
2	How a merged company is judged against two sets of objectives	CGS 8.3, 10.3	Each layer is met if either predecessor's version is met, counted once (2.4)
3	"The fund decides" at Investor Day, but cap tables lock before the freeze	Source draft 25; CGS 7.5	The decision is a published, non-binding commitment computed from the decision cards; it changes no frozen result (1.8)
4	FID 6.1 puts the GM on banding and the review panel during Investor Day, but the GM chairs room A	FID 6.1; EOM 10.4; GMH 12	Ledger Lead does the roll-up and proposed winners alone during pitches; GM and Ledger Lead confirm in the gap, as GMH 12 already set (1.7, 1.8)
5	Founder Report timing: brief asked for 7 days; FID 6.5 gives Venture Labs' report 14 days	FID 6.5	Founder Report with candidate pages by day 7 (needed for the 7-day invitations); calibration notes and coverage gaps by day 14 in Part 4, so FID's list is still delivered in full on time
6	Pitch arc length: six beats in the brief, seven in EOM 10.4	EOM 10.4; source draft 38	Seven beats, keeping "why this team should continue"
7	FID 5.3 needs "bottom half of the company results" but no ranking existed	FID 5.3	Defined in 2.6, handed over only after proposed winners are fixed
8	Room B has no Investor volunteer	EOM 10.4	Both rooms use the same decision card; the

#	Question or conflict	Sources	Call made here
			Investor reviews room B's cards in the gap and can correct only a recording error (1.4)
9	Odd number of companies: which room gets the larger half	EOM 10.4	Room A (the stage), so room B is back before results at every P (1.3)
10	Pitching companies may differ from N after failures, mergers and new ventures	SW 4.5; CGS 8	Timing and room split use P, the number of companies pitching (1.1, 1.3)
11	New ventures founded at Ticks 7 to 8 measured against a much smaller base	CGS 8.5; GMH 13.1	Shown on the board, not eligible for Best Venture; founders covered by the founder awards (2.5)
12	Equity stakes in other companies are not part of CGS NAV	CGS 7.2, 7.4	For scoring only, a stake counts at percentage held × the target's Final RV (2.3)
13	Two Q&A caps exist (grade and volume)	FID 3.3; GMH 12	Both apply (1.1)
14	Owner decisions after the complexity audit, 2026-10-05: five GM lanes, and the Founder Dossier replacing the passport	EOM 4.1, 10.4; GMH	Room A: an Investor partner, the Lead GM and an optional guest. Room B: chaired by the Floor GM with the Bank lead and Government volunteer. The Boundary GM hands out snapshots and keeps the paper ledger. Nothing is collected at the freeze except paper evidence; the 16:10 to 16:15 steps are unchanged (1.2, 1.3, 2.7)

5.3 Amendments other documents should pick up

- **Participant Handbook:** where it says Best Venture uses "company results and the panel's view", add one line: Best Venture goes to a company no other company beats on both value created and objectives met, and the fund's Investor Day decision chooses among those. Add that the pitch arc has seven beats and that each company receives a Frozen Snapshot and writes a one-page Pitch Sheet in the 16:05 to 16:25 window.
- **GM Handbook section 12:** point "scoring and awards" to this document; add that room A takes the larger half at odd P; add the Tech Lead's 16:55 results sheet.
- **Event Operations Manual 10.4:** same room-split note; print the decision cards (one per company per room) and the Pitch Sheet template in the Investor Day kit (EOM 15.6).
- **Founder Identification System 6.5:** note that the Venture Labs report is split: Founder Report by day 7 (Part 3) and calibration and coverage by day 14 (Part 4 section 4.9).
- **Platform (Tech Lead):** compute Baseline RV at Market Open and store it; generate the Frozen Snapshot at 16:10 with the thesis fit result; produce the E, O and frontier sheet by 16:55.

card_id	personal_ki	card_type	statement	resolves_to	teaser	kind	grade_at_is	verifiable_b	expiry	copies_per	truth_statu	truth_note	variant	claim_id	source	active_set	rvalue_band
IC-MKT-11	market	Market info	The Bank st	one card (f	What make	fact	Reported	Bank from T	Tick 6	2	TRUE	True as written (Bank pr		CLM-BANK-IO	IOC 2.1, 8.1;	always	100-200
IC-MKT-12	market	Market info	No compan	one card	The Bank's	fact	Reported	Bank from T	Tick 8	2	TRUE	True as written (BK-01, E		CLM-BANK-IO	IOC 2 (BK-01)	always	50-150
IC-MKT-13	market	Customer ir	The Custom	one card pe	A buyer mo	fact	Reported	Customer d	Tick {cu.dec	5	TRUE	True as written; values c		CLM-CU-{cu	IOC 4.2-4.3	issue only fr	200-400
IC-MKT-14	market	Customer ir	Customer d	one card	How to get	fact	Reported	Customer d	Tick 8	2	TRUE	True as written (standar		CLM-PILOT	IOC 4.1	always	100-200
IC-MKT-15	market	Customer ir	The Custom	one card	More buyer	fact	Reported	Customer d	Tick 8	2	TRUE	True: 2 open cards per a		CLM-CU-CO	IOC 4.2	always	100-250
IC-MKT-16	market	Market info	A Media sto	one card	How a story	fact	Reported	Media from	Tick 9	2	TRUE	True as written (viral me		CLM-VIRAL	IOC 7.4	always	100-200
IC-MKT-17	market	Customer ir	In {sector},	one card pe	Room abov	fact	Reported	Customer d	Tick 7	5	partly_true	Partial. The partial		CLM-STRET	(IOC 4.1, 4.5	sectors with	50-150
IC-MKT-18	market	Market info	{sector} der	one card pe	Will {sector}	fact	Reported	Media from	Tick 6	4	FALSE	False. A car	FALSE	CLM-INDEX	IOC 1.2, 7.4	sectors with	0-100
IC-CO-11	company	Company in	If {Sx} buys	each active	When {Sx}'s	fact	Reported	Media from	Tick {Sx.first	10	TRUE	True: copied from the st		CLM-RUNO	(Passport pa	every subje	150-300
IC-CO-12	company	Company in	{Sx} draws	{ each active	What {Sx} h	fact	Reported	Media from	Tick 6	3	TRUE	True: the subject has {S}		CLM-SURPL	(Passport pa	only if the s	150-300
IC-CO-13	company	Company in	{Sx} is one	peach active	{Sx}'s miss	fact	Reported	Media from	Tick 5	4	TRUE	True: the subject's defic		CLM-DEFIC	(Passport pa	every subje	100-250
IC-CO-14	company	Company in	{Sx}'s ancho	each active	{Sx}'s ancho	fact	Reported	Media from	Tick 7	4	TRUE	True: the anchor contra		CLM-ANCH	(Passport pa	every subje	150-300
IC-CO-15	company	Company in	{Sx} depende	each active	What {Sx} c	fact	Reported	Media from	Tick 6	3	TRUE	True: critical dependenc		CLM-DEP-{\$	(Passport pa	every subje	150-300
IC-CO-16	company	Company in	{Sx} has on	each active	How long {S	fact	Reported	Media from	Tick 5	4	partly_true	Inflated. Dir	inflated	CLM-RUNW	(Passport pa	every subje	50-150
IC-CO-17	company	Company in	{Sx} can bor	each active	Cash hider	fact	Reported	Bank (BK-06	Tick 6	3	partly_true	Partial. BK-C	partial	CLM-ASSET	(Passport pa	every subje	100-200
IC-CO-18	company	Company in	{Sx} cannot	each active	Who {Sx} is	fact	Reported	Media from	Tick 6	3	partly_true	Misattribut	misattribut	CLM-DEP-{\$	(Passport pa	every subje	50-150
IC-CO-19	company	Company in	The Venture	each active	{Sx} and the	fact	Reported	Investor de	Tick 8	3	FALSE	False. The F	FALSE	CLM-FUND-	IOC 3.1	every subje	0-100
IC-CO-20	company	Company in	{Sx} has alr	each active	{Sx}'s gate	fact	Reported	Media from	Tick 3	3	FALSE	False at T0: F	FALSE	CLM-GATE-{\$	(Passport pa	every subje	0-100
IC-SUP-11	institution	Supplier inf	For {res}, {s	one card pe	A cheaper {r	fact	Reported	Supplier de	Tick 6	4	TRUE	True: list prices and neg		CLM-SUPBA	IOC 5.2	always	100-250
IC-SUP-12	institution	Supplier inf	Quarry Anal	one card	The cheape	fact	Reported	Supplier de	Tick 7	2	partly_true	Partial. The partial		CLM-SU10	IOC 5.2-5.3	always	50-150
IC-INS-11	institution	Institution i	Governmen	one card	The licence	fact	Reported	Governmen	Tick 8	2	TRUE	True as written (6.1, GV-		CLM-GOVQ	IOC 6.1-6.2	always	100-250
IC-INS-12	institution	Institution i	The Venture	one card	How many t	fact	Reported	Investor de	Tick 9	3	TRUE	True as written (fund pa		CLM-FUND	IOC 3.1	always	100-250
IC-INS-13	institution	Institution i	Governmen	one card	Free money	fact	Reported	Governmen	Tick 7	2	TRUE	True as written (6.3).		CLM-GRANT	IOC 6.3	always	150-300
IC-INS-14	institution	Institution i	Without a s	one card	Proving you	fact	Reported	Governmen	Tick 8	2	partly_true	Inflated. GV	inflated	CLM-GVL10	IOC 6.2	always	50-150
IC-INS-15	institution	Institution i	Media gives	one card	A discount	fact	Reported	Media desk	Tick 9	1	partly_true	Inflated. Thi	inflated	CLM-BRANC	IOC 7.2	always	50-150
IC-INS-16	institution	Institution i	Lock cash at	one card	Parking cas	fact	Reported	Bank from T	Tick 6	2	FALSE	False. BK-11	FALSE	CLM-BK11	IOC 2.2	always	0-50
IC-RUM-11	rumour	Rumour	Heard at th	one card	What buyer	rumour	Rumour	Customer d	Tick 8	3	TRUE	True: every open card h		CLM-STRET	(IOC 4.1, 4.5	always	50-150
IC-RUM-12	rumour	Rumour	Someone s	one card	A seller nob	rumour	Rumour	Supplier de	Tick 9	3	TRUE	True: SU-15 The Back Lo		CLM-SU15	IOC 5.2-5.3	issue only if	50-150
IC-RUM-13	rumour	Rumour	Allied Mater	one card	Two supplier	rumour	Rumour	Supplier de	Tick 8	2	partly_true	Inflated. SU	inflated	CLM-E21	IOC 5.3	always	0-100
IC-RUM-14	rumour	Rumour	They say th	one card	Cheap credi	rumour	Rumour	Bank (once	Tick 9	2	partly_true	Partial. BK-1	partial	CLM-BK12	IOC 2.2, 2.5	issue only if	0-100
IC-RUM-15	rumour	Rumour	The Bank is	one card	Bank lendin	rumour	Rumour	Bank from T	Tick 3	3	FALSE	False. Bank	FALSE	CLM-BANKC	IOC 2.2, 2.5	always	0-50
IC-RUM-16	rumour	Rumour	Someone s	one card	Bad data in	rumour	Rumour	Corroborati	Tick 8	2	TRUE	True: about a third of S		CLM-SU10	IOC 5.3	always	50-150
IC-RUM-17	rumour	Rumour	Word at the	one card	A discount	rumour	Rumour	Media desk	Tick 9	3	TRUE	True: 25% off MD-P02, P		CLM-BRANC	IOC 7.2	always	50-150

Company Passport Packs + Participant Role Cards

Venture City · Oct 5, 2026 · @Nero Kami

Every participant gets two things at orientation: their company's Passport Pack (section 3) and the Role Card for their assigned domain (section 4). Passports carry only what a company's staff may know at T0; role cards work unchanged in any of the 12 companies.

1. How to use this document

This is the print master. The passport bodies and role cards are participant-safe; the bracketed [Print: ...] notes and the sealed inserts at the end of each passport are for whoever prints the packs.

What	Who receives it	Visibility class (Starting World 10.2)
Passport Pack body	Every member of that company's staff	Company
Leadership envelope	The CEO volunteer only; the CEO may share it with the two signatories	Company leadership
Role insert	Every staff member in the one domain the dossier names, never the CEO	Company role
Role Card	Every participant, by domain	Public (the rules of a role are no secret)

What a passport leaves out of the dossier. Everything tagged [GM] (the Unknown risk row, the GM information part, names behind the slots, memoranda by set, the vulnerability itself, balance levers, cards to load, gate evidence), the truth column on private facts, the Failure states part beyond the likely failure trigger, the Founder observation map and the Founder-mode variant. The vulnerability clue stays, unlabelled, as "Something you overheard".

What a passport keeps. Every [Public] and [Company] row of the dossier, word for word, so the two documents cannot drift apart. Where the dossier text depends on the active set (the memorandum and the market fact), the passport carries a [Print: ...] note telling the printer which line to keep.

Sources: [Company Dossiers](#) (authority for every company row), [Starting World Master Design](#) (sections 5, 6, 10 and 11), [Starting Companies Master Catalogue](#) and [Core Game Systems](#) (authority, talent, missions). If a dossier changes, its passport changes with it; this document never overrides a dossier.

Names. Like the dossiers, passports name slots ("the S1 fleet provider"), not other companies. Finding out which company fills a slot is part of Human Internet I. The only company name a printer adds is the memorandum counterparty, because both sides of a memorandum know each other.

Numbers are shown for the 9-person reference company. The event runs entirely on the web platform (local server at the venue): there are no physical VB notes, resource tokens or counts. Every company's cash and resource units, and every participant's wallet, are platform balances issued at setup, and the platform journal is the only record of them. The platform recomputes cash and runway from real headcount at registration close and shows the live figures on the Company Station and Participant Portal; the printed passport is a briefing, not a balance.

2. The passport template

All 12 passports use the same 13 parts in the same order, so a participant who moves company reads the new passport in the place they expect.

#	Part	What it holds	Dossier source
1	Lead	One sentence: the company's situation	Dossier lead line
2	Who you are	Sector, story, history, mission, business model, products, customers, market position, technology, reputation	Identity; Starting state
3	Team	CEO persona card, workforce mix, deficit domain, signatory election	Identity; Starting state
4	Capital and resources	Cash, Notable Asset, resource tiers, runway, first run-out, personal wallet	Starting state; at-a-glance table
5	Products	The Product Cards, in full	Product Cards [Public]
6	Obligations	Anchor contract, supplier agreement, liability, memorandum	Starting state; mechanics
7	Customers and leads	Anchor customer, Leads 1 to 3	Starting state
8	Suppliers and dependencies	Critical dependency, slots needed and filled, relationships, gate	Starting state; mechanics; Starting World 11.2

#	Part	What it holds	Dossier source
9	Immediate challenges	Bottleneck, weakness, known risks, economics in brief	Starting problems (GM row removed); Economics
10	Objectives	Survival, revenue, growth, strategic	Company objectives (hidden layer removed)
11	Options on the table	Obvious, discoverable and opportunistic openings; bigger moves	Opportunities (Hidden row removed); Founder opportunities
12	What only you know	Vantage point, inside fact, market fact, rumour, overheard clue	Mechanics; Private information (truth removed)
13	Rules that matter most	Likely failure trigger, distress, thresholds, signing authority, expiry ticks, pre-market rules	Shared conventions; Core Game Systems 1.2

Two sealed inserts follow each passport and are printed on separate slips: the Leadership envelope (private objective) and the Role insert (hidden lever, for the one named domain).

Printing. Passports are briefings; balances live on the platform. One passport is about 4 A4 pages. Print one per participant, plus one for the CEO volunteer, and staple the role card for the participant's domain to the front.

3. Company Passport Packs

One passport per company, in pool order. Print only the companies in this run's active set; reserve passports go to founders who draw that dossier for a new venture, with the Founder-mode changes the GM applies from the dossier.

3.1 SwiftCart

The busiest operation in the city with the thinnest margin: SwiftCart owns the only ready consumer delivery channel, but it runs short of Logistics first and owes its cold-room builder 7,000 VB at Tick 4.

Who you are

Field	Entry
Archetype and sector	Quick-commerce and logistics; Physical cluster
Headline story	"Anything your kitchen needs, at your door in 30 minutes." Six dark stores, a van fleet and a reputation for speed.

Field	Entry
History	Started as two friends delivering groceries by scooter. Grew to six dark stores by promising 30 minutes and never pricing for it. Every new neighbourhood added orders and cost in equal measure.
Mission	Make 30-minute delivery the city's default, for households and for any business shipping to a home.
Business model	Small margin on each basket plus a delivery fee; sells spare van runs to other companies.
Products	30-minute basket batch; van run (last mile or spare fleet capacity).
Target customer	Consumer households; businesses that ship to homes (S2); businesses that need fleet capacity (S1).
Market position	The only ready consumer distribution channel in the city. Competes with a fleet-capacity provider for S1 buyers while also buying from it.
Technology	A route-planning app built in-house; no demand forecasting
Reputation	Known for speed; one bad week of late baskets would undo it

Team

Your CEO is a volunteer who plays this persona card: Growth Maximiser. Belief: customers first, profit later. Red line: won't cut acquisition spend. Bias: overspends on growth.

Your staff: Ops-led mix. Deficit domain: Finance / Capital, one person short. Strong in Operations; nobody models unit economics. Everyone starts at L0 on 100 VB per tick. Elect 2 Authorised Signatories before Market Open.

Capital and resources

Item	At the start
Cash (platform balance, issued at setup)	30,050 VB (Strategic Adjustment -2,000)
Notable Asset	Distribution channel: six dark stores, book value 6,000 VB

Item	At the start
Resources	Platform balance of 100 units of each, issued at setup. Tiers: Compute Low, Energy Medium, Logistics Very High, Materials Medium, Data Medium, Infrastructure High
Runway with no new revenue	8 ticks
First resource to run out (no purchases)	Logistics, Tick 7
Personal wallet	1,000 VB each in your platform wallet, yours, not the company's

Products

Field	30-minute basket batch	Van run
Buyer gets	A batch of grocery baskets delivered to a Consumer customer within the tick	Either last-mile delivery of up to 5 of the buyer's product units to its customers within the tick (S2), or 5 Logistics units of van capacity (S1)
Delivery unit	1 batch	1 van run
Resource cost per unit	1 Logistics, 1 Materials	1 Logistics, 1 Energy
Units per tick	5	3
List / floor (VB)	650 / 500	85 / 70
Eligible buyers	Consumer cards	Companies (S1, S2); institution customer cards
Licence	None; chilled baskets need the cold-chain permit	None; the chilled variant (list 120, floor 95) needs the cold-chain permit
Beats the fallback by	n/a	Price: 17 VB per Logistics unit against the Bank's 20; speed: delivered within the tick at the buyer's table

Obligations you start with

Obligation	Terms
Anchor contract	Consumer card "Hillcrest Households": 2 basket batches per tick at 650 VB, 1,300 VB per tick for Ticks 1 to 6 (7,800 VB), then renewal on the

Obligation	Terms
	Customer desk's standard terms
Supplier agreement	Civic Build Supplies (SU-11), Infrastructure (cold rooms and racking): 25.5 VB per unit (15% below base), up to 12 units per tick; expires at Tick 4 unless renewed with a volume commitment of 3 ticks at the cap
Liability	Deferred supplier payment: 7,000 VB to Civic Build Supplies (SU-11) for the cold-room fit-out, due Tick 4; the supplier agreement suspends if missed
Memorandum (non-binding)	With the S1 fleet provider: "Peak-hour vans and drivers for grocery runs, from Tick 1." It records a need, not an obligation. [Print: name the counterparty company. If it is not active this run, print the fallback partner and need line from the dossier.]

Customers and leads

Anchor customer: see the anchor contract above. Open customer cards sit with the Customer desk; visit it to see them.

Leads: Lead 1: "Riverside Pharmacy Group", an Enterprise card on the Customer desk (CU-02) that needs chilled medicines delivered every tick (requires the cold-chain permit, GV-L01). Lead 2: health sector, a business needs medicines carried to patients' homes within the hour. Lead 3: agriculture sector, a grower network has more stock than it has buyers.

Suppliers and dependencies

Item	Entry
Critical dependency	S1 Fleet capacity. Fallback: Logistics Provider at standard terms
Other slots you need	S6 raw materials and produce, S7 payments, S9 analytics
Slots you fill (others need you)	S1 Fleet and delivery capacity (secondary filler), S2 Consumer fulfilment and last mile
Who you deal with	Buys S1 from a fleet-capacity provider while competing with it to sell S1 to others. Sells S2 to a consumer brand and a health marketplace. When no primary fleet provider is active, SwiftCart becomes the S1 filler for the produce supplier

Item	Entry
	and the manufacturer.
Memoranda you may receive as supplier	S2 fallback memoranda from a consumer brand or a health marketplace whose critical filler is inactive; S1 memoranda from the produce supplier or the manufacturer when no primary fleet provider is active.
Gate	Cold-chain delivery permit, held by Government; opens the chilled variant of the van run and pharmacy Consumer cards

Every slot has an institution fallback that always works at standard terms. A company filling the slot is usually cheaper or faster; finding out which company fills it is part of the game.

Immediate challenges

Kind	Challenge
Bottleneck	Logistics at Very High; each van run it sells to others spends one more unit of it
Weakness	Nobody in the company models unit economics (Finance / Capital deficit)
Known risk	Tick 4 deferred payment and supplier-agreement expiry at the same tick
Known risk	Anchor renewal after Tick 6 on the desk's standard terms

Economics, in brief:

- Revenue model. Basket batches to Consumer cards carry the business; van runs to companies are small per sale but recurring per tick.
- Cost structure. Payroll rises from 900 VB at Tick 1 to 5,400 VB per tick from Tick 6. Baseline resource draw is worth 1,045 VB per tick at Bank prices, almost half of it Logistics.
- Unit economics. A basket batch costs 35 VB of resources at Bank prices against a 650 VB price; a van run costs 35 VB against 85. The margin problem is not the unit: it is that every unit spends Logistics, the resource SwiftCart runs out of first.
- Fixed versus variable. Fixed: payroll and baseline draw, about 6,445 VB per tick from Tick 6. Variable: 1 Logistics per basket batch and per van run.
- Resource consumption. Logistics draws 16 units per tick with the anchor running (14 baseline + 2 deliveries), so it hits the 30-unit warning after Tick 5 and is empty during Tick 7 without purchases. Infrastructure lasts to Tick 10; Compute is a surplus to sell.
- Talent costs. Filling the Finance / Capital gap means a hire from the Talent Exchange, a trained hire (\$10) or poaching.

- Working capital. The Tick 4 payment of 7,000 VB lands on the same tick as the supplier agreement's expiry. Runway is 8 ticks.

Objectives

Layer	Your target
Survival	Never Distressed for 2 ticks running; solvent at the freeze
Revenue	18,000 VB of new revenue by the freeze, not counting the anchor's Ticks 1 to 6
Growth	Hold the cold-chain permit and deliver to at least one pharmacy card.
Strategic (public objective)	Run per-tick delivery contracts with 3 other companies and renew the anchor at or above its T0 rate.

Your CEO also holds one private objective in a sealed envelope. Each of you holds a personal objective: see the Personal Objective System.

Options on the table

Kind	Opportunity
Obvious	Renew the anchor after Tick 6 on better terms; sell van runs to companies that need last mile (S2) or fleet (S1)
Discoverable	Lead 1 needs chilled delivery, which the cold-chain permit opens; the fleet provider's idle vans (your market fact) make S1 cheap
Opportunistic	Logistics surge-pricing events make van runs worth more; a distressed producer or consumer brand becomes a cheap acquisition

Bigger moves your team could make:

- Pivot: stop selling baskets and become the city's logistics-as-a-service business, selling S1 and S2 to everyone.
- New product: chilled medicine delivery once permitted.
- Spin-outs: a last-mile unit selling S2 to the whole city; a dark-store data product sold to analytics (S9) or community (S12) holders.
- Acquisitions: buy the produce supplier (S6) to secure stock, or a consumer brand for own-brand goods; merge with the fleet provider to run one fleet for two customer bases.

What only you know

Item	What you know
Your vantage point	Sees what every household orders; holds the city's only consumer distribution channel.
Inside fact	"Our dark stores turn stock over every two ticks; one could be fitted for chilled medicine if we held the permit."
Market fact	If an S1 company other than SwiftCart is active: "The city's fleet operator has vans standing idle half of every day and wants steady buyers." Otherwise: "The Logistics Provider's priority lane rarely sells out before Tick 5." [Print: keep only the line that matches this run.]
Rumour you heard	"The Bank is tightening credit for delivery businesses after a bad quarter."
Something you overheard	"Our anchor's buyer mentioned their last delivery partner was dropped after two late weeks."

None of these is labelled true or false. You may share, sell or trade any of them under the Human Internet rules.

Rules that matter most to you

- Same rulebook for every company; only your story and numbers differ.
- Your most likely failure: Logistics at 0 for 2 ticks (likely Ticks 7 to 8 without purchases); missing payroll after Tick 8.
- Distressed is triggered by any High or Very High resource at 0 for 2 ticks, unpaid payroll, a missed liability payment past its tick, or fewer than 3 staff.
- Stock thresholds: warning at 30 units; at 15, deliveries using that resource cost 25% more of it; at 0, deliveries stop.
- Any employee may negotiate and propose deals. One signatory or the CEO approves up to 5,000 VB; above that needs the CEO or both signatories.
- Your supplier agreement expires at Tick 4 unless renewed with a volume commitment; your anchor comes up for renewal after Tick 6.
- Before Market Open you may talk, trade information, spend your platform wallet through Trade Slips and agree deals as Proposed. Nothing settles until Tick 1, when the desks enter Trade Slips on the platform.

Sealed inserts (print and hand out separately)

Leadership envelope, to the CEO only (may be shared with the signatories): Vertical move. Bring one needed slot in-house, ideally fleet capacity or produce supply.

Role insert, to every Operations member of staff (not the CEO): Signing an S1 contract of 3 or more ticks at 2 or more blocks per tick, with any S1 filler or the Logistics Provider, drops Logistics from Very High to High (14 to 10 units per tick) from the next tick, for as long as the contract runs.

3.2 Ledgerly

Ledgerly touches every company's money but holds little of its own: most of the city needs its payment rails, yet it cannot lend until licensed and its trust rests on security it does not own.

Who you are

Field	Entry
Archetype and sector	Fintech, small-business payments; Digital and Regulated clusters
Headline story	"Get paid today, grow tomorrow." Payment rails for the city's merchants, with working capital coming soon.
History	Built by two former bank engineers who thought small merchants were badly served. The rails work; the sales team never got hired, so growth came only from word of mouth.
Mission	Every small business in the city takes payments and gets credit on fair terms.
Business model	A fee per tick of payment processing; interest on short merchant advances once licensed; sales of anonymised transaction datasets.
Products	Payment processing; verified transaction dataset. Merchant advances after licensing.
Target customer	Every other company as a merchant (S7); Enterprise and Consumer merchants on the Customer desk; analytics and security firms that buy data (S11).
Market position	Sees transaction flows across the city, so it learns who is healthy before anyone else. Competes with the Bank for payments and credit, and with a health marketplace for data buyers.
Technology	Working payment rails and a fraud-scoring prototype that nobody has had time to finish
Reputation	Trusted by its merchants; unknown to everyone

Field	Entry
	else

Team

Your CEO is a volunteer who plays this persona card: Dealmaker. Belief: every problem is a deal. Red line: won't walk away from a table. Bias: overcommits.

Your staff: Tech-led mix. Deficit domain: Growth / Sales, one person short. Strong engineering; nobody selling. Everyone starts at L0 on 100 VB per tick. Elect 2 Authorised Signatories before Market Open.

Capital and resources

Item	At the start
Cash (platform balance, issued at setup)	32,050 VB (Strategic Adjustment 0)
Notable Asset	Dataset: merchant transaction history, book value 5,000 VB
Resources	Platform balance of 100 units of each, issued at setup. Tiers: Compute High, Energy Low, Logistics Low, Materials Low, Data Very High, Infrastructure High
Runway with no new revenue	9 ticks
First resource to run out (no purchases)	Data, Tick 7
Personal wallet	1,000 VB each in your platform wallet, yours, not the company's

Products

Field	Payment processing	Verified transaction dataset
Buyer gets	One tick of payment processing for its customer receipts; meets any customer card that names digital payments as a must-have	5 Data units of verified quality
Delivery unit	1 processing block: one tick of processing for up to 4 company merchants, or for one Enterprise merchant network	1 dataset
Resource cost per unit	1 Compute, 1 Data	1 Compute, 2 Data
Units per tick	4	2
List / floor (VB)	2.5% / 1.5% of the receipts	100 / 85

Field	Payment processing	Verified transaction dataset
	processed (Enterprise anchor at its contracted rate)	
Eligible buyers	Companies (S7); Enterprise and Consumer merchant cards	Companies (S11); Enterprise cards
Licence	None	None
Beats the fallback by	Price: below the Bank merchant service's 3% of receipts	Price: 20 VB per Data unit against the Supplier Market's 22.5

Obligations you start with

Obligation	Terms
Anchor contract	Enterprise card "Metro Retail Federation": 2 processing blocks per tick at the Enterprise rate of 500 VB, 1,000 VB per tick for Ticks 1 to 6 (6,000 VB), then renewal
Supplier agreement	OpenData Exchange (SU-09), Data: 22 VB per unit (12% below base), up to 12 units per tick; expires at Tick 4 unless renewed with a volume commitment of 3 ticks at the cap
Liability	Refund obligation (chargebacks): 1,000 VB owed to the anchor customer for each tick in which processing is not delivered, up to 5,000 VB
Memorandum (non-binding)	With the S8 security provider: "Security monitoring and an audit that counts toward the payments licence." It records a need, not an obligation. [Print: name the counterparty company. If it is not active this run, print the fallback partner and need line from the dossier.]

Customers and leads

Anchor customer: see the anchor contract above. Open customer cards sit with the Customer desk; visit it to see them.

Leads: Lead 1: "Market Street Traders Association", an Enterprise card on the Customer desk that wants processing for its member shops plus short working capital (needs the gate). Lead 2: AI sector, a business wants verified transaction data to train its models. Lead 3: security sector, a firm sells monitoring that regulators accept.

Suppliers and dependencies

Item	Entry
Critical dependency	S8 Security and compliance. Fallback: Government licence route
Other slots you need	S3 compute hosting, S9 analytics, S10 trained talent
Slots you fill (others need you)	S7 Payments and merchant finance, S11 Verified datasets
Who you deal with	Supplier to most of the city on S7 and to analytics and security firms on S11. Buys S8, S3, S9 and S10. Competes with the Bank on S7 and with a health marketplace on S11.
Memoranda you may receive as supplier	S7 fallback memoranda from any company whose critical filler is inactive; an S11 fallback memorandum from a security provider with no active S3 or S10 filler (a health marketplace, if active, takes it first).
Gate	Payments licence, held by Government; opens merchant advances

Every slot has an institution fallback that always works at standard terms. A company filling the slot is usually cheaper or faster; finding out which company fills it is part of the game.

Immediate challenges

Kind	Challenge
Bottleneck	Data at Very High; every processing block and dataset spends it
Weakness	A strong product with nobody selling it (Growth / Sales deficit)
Known risk	Cannot lend until licensed; licence needs security evidence it cannot produce alone
Known risk	Chargebacks on any tick the anchor is not served

Economics, in brief:

- Revenue model. Recurring processing fees from many small buyers, plus dataset sales and, once licensed, advance fees.
- Cost structure. Payroll from 900 to 5,400 VB per tick; baseline resource draw worth 1,050 VB per tick, mostly Data, Compute and Infrastructure.

- Unit economics. A processing block costs 45 VB of resources at Bank prices; at 1.5 to 2.5% of receipts it pays once the merchants it covers take about 3,000 VB a tick between them. A dataset costs 70 VB against 85 to 100 VB, and spends Data the company is already short of.
- Fixed versus variable. Fixed: about 6,450 VB per tick from Tick 6. Variable: 1 Data and 1 Compute per processing block.
- Resource consumption. Data draws 16 units per tick with the anchor (14 + 2), so it is empty during Tick 7 without purchases. Compute lasts to Tick 9; Energy, Logistics and Materials are surplus to sell.
- Talent costs. The Growth / Sales gap is the one that limits revenue; filling it is worth more here than anywhere else in the company.
- Working capital. No cash liability falls due, so runway is 9 ticks; the risk is contingent (chargebacks) and grows with every merchant added without security cover.

Objectives

Layer	Your target
Survival	Never Distressed for 2 ticks running; solvent at the freeze
Revenue	18,000 VB of new revenue by the freeze, not counting the anchor's Ticks 1 to 6
Growth	Hold the payments licence and complete one merchant advance.
Strategic (public objective)	Process payments for at least half of the other active companies by freeze, with security cover in place.

Your CEO also holds one private objective in a sealed envelope. Each of you holds a personal objective: see the Personal Objective System.

Options on the table

Kind	Opportunity
Obvious	Sign other companies up for processing (S7): most of the city needs it
Discoverable	Lead 1 wants credit as well as processing; the security firm behind S8 has no regulated client yet (your market fact) and may deal on price
Opportunistic	A credit-tightening event makes merchant advances valuable; a failed company's customer list can be bought cheaply

Bigger moves your team could make:

- Pivot: from payments to credit, using transaction data to underwrite advances the Bank will not make.
- New product: merchant advances; a fraud-scoring service built on the unfinished prototype.
- Spin-outs: a credit-scoring and data unit selling S11; a fraud tool that competes with the security provider.
- Acquisitions: merge with the security provider (S8) to clear the critical dependency for good; buy a failed company's customer list; be the captive tenant a compute host (S3) or the Investor fund wants to own.

What only you know

Item	What you know
Your vantage point	Sees payment flows, so it can tell which companies are running out of cash. Selling or sharing that is a deal like any other.
Inside fact	"Our transaction data shows which businesses are short of cash about two ticks before anyone else notices."
Market fact	If an S8 company is active: "The city's security firm has a credible product but has not signed a regulated client this quarter." Otherwise: "Government's licence route for security reviews is open but slow; applicants queue." [Print: keep only the line that matches this run.]
Rumour you heard	"The Bank plans to launch its own merchant advances at a cheaper rate."
Something you overheard	"A merchant on our rails had an unusual spike in refunds last week."

None of these is labelled true or false. You may share, sell or trade any of them under the Human Internet rules.

Rules that matter most to you

- Same rulebook for every company; only your story and numbers differ.
- Your most likely failure: Data at 0 for 2 ticks (likely Ticks 7 to 8 without purchases); missing payroll after Tick 9.
- Distressed is triggered by any High or Very High resource at 0 for 2 ticks, unpaid payroll, a missed liability payment past its tick, or fewer than 3 staff.
- Stock thresholds: warning at 30 units; at 15, deliveries using that resource cost 25% more of it; at 0, deliveries stop.
- Any employee may negotiate and propose deals. One signatory or the CEO approves up to 5,000 VB; above that needs the CEO or both signatories.

- Your supplier agreement expires at Tick 4 unless renewed with a volume commitment; your anchor comes up for renewal after Tick 6.
- Before Market Open you may talk, trade information, spend your platform wallet through Trade Slips and agree deals as Proposed. Nothing settles until Tick 1, when the desks enter Trade Slips on the platform.

Sealed inserts (print and hand out separately)

Leadership envelope, to the CEO only (may be shared with the signatories): Partner web. Live contracts with 3 different counterparties on a slot it fills.

Role insert, to every Finance / Capital member of staff (not the CEO): Each company with a live S7 contract adds 150 VB per tick to Ledgerly's revenue, credited by the platform at settlement; capped at 6 companies (900 VB per tick) and 15,000 VB over the run.

3.3 Mango & Co.

Mango & Co. is a loved brand with no factory: it owes its anchor two boxes every tick from Tick 1 but cannot make them, and its fruit supply depends on the weather.

Who you are

Field	Entry
Archetype and sector	Direct-to-consumer brand of mango-based foods, drinks and lifestyle goods; Physical cluster
Headline story	"Sunshine in a box." The city's favourite mango brand and its fan community.
History	Began as a weekend stall selling mango pulp. A viral recipe turned the stall into a subscription box and a community of fans. The founders outsourced everything except the brand.
Mission	Bring the taste of a mango summer to every home, all year.
Business model	High gross margin on branded boxes; high marketing spend; sells access to its community to other brands.
Products	Mango product box; community feature for other brands.
Target customer	Consumer households; Enterprise retail chains once certified; companies that need a consumer audience (S12).
Market position	The only consumer brand and community in the city. Cannot make its own product (needs S5) or

Field	Entry
	ship it efficiently (needs S2).
Technology	A community app and mailing list; no production systems
Reputation	The most liked brand in the city; Media covers it readily

Team

Your CEO is a volunteer who plays this persona card: Brand Purist. Belief: the brand is the asset. Red line: won't discount. Bias: undervalues partnerships.

Your staff: Market-led mix. Deficit domain: Operations, one person short. Marketers and community builders; nobody runs a supply chain. Everyone starts at L0 on 100 VB per tick. Elect 2 Authorised Signatories before Market Open.

Capital and resources

Item	At the start
Cash (platform balance, issued at setup)	29,550 VB (Strategic Adjustment -2,500)
Notable Asset	Brand, book value 7,000 VB
Resources	Platform balance of 100 units of each, issued at setup. Tiers: Compute Medium, Energy Medium, Logistics High, Materials High, Data High, Infrastructure Medium
Runway with no new revenue	9 ticks
First resource to run out (no purchases)	Materials Tick 8, Logistics Tick 9
Personal wallet	1,000 VB each in your platform wallet, yours, not the company's

Products

Field	Mango product box	Community feature
Buyer gets	One branded box of mango foods, drinks or lifestyle goods, delivered	A featured spot in the brand's community channel and one Consumer lead: a named open Consumer card in the buyer's sector, confirmed by the Customer desk
Delivery unit	1 box	1 feature

Field	Mango product box	Community feature
Resource cost per unit	Hand-packed: 2 Materials, 1 Logistics. With an S5 deal on record: 1 finished unit plus 1 Logistics	1 Data
Units per tick	2 hand-packed; 4 with an S5 deal on record	2
List / floor (VB)	550 / 450	300 / 220
Eligible buyers	Consumer cards; Enterprise retail-chain cards with the gate	Companies (S12)
Licence	Food Safety Certificate for Enterprise retail buyers	None
Beats the fallback by	n/a	A named Consumer lead, which a Media story does not give, at 300 VB list against 600 VB for a Media featured story (MD-P05)

Obligations you start with

Obligation	Terms
Anchor contract	Consumer card "Mango Club Subscribers": 2 boxes per tick at 550 VB, 1,100 VB per tick for Ticks 1 to 6 (6,600 VB), then renewal
Supplier agreement	Riverbend Growers Co-op (SU-08), Materials (fruit pulp and packaging): 13 VB per unit (about 13% below base), up to 12 units per tick, paid 1 tick after delivery; expires at Tick 4 unless renewed with a volume commitment of 3 ticks at the cap
Liability	Refund obligation: 1,500 VB owed to the anchor customer for each tick in which a box delivery is missed, up to 6,000 VB
Memorandum (non-binding)	With the S5 manufacturer: "Manufacturing runs for our product boxes, every tick from Tick 1." It records a need, not an obligation. [Print: name the counterparty company. If it is not active this run, print the fallback partner and need line from the dossier.]

Customers and leads

Anchor customer: see the anchor contract above. Open customer cards sit with the Customer desk; visit it to see them.

Leads: Lead 1: "FreshWay Supermarkets", an Enterprise retail-chain card on the Customer desk that wants 3 boxes per tick for its stores (needs the gate). Lead 2: manufacturing sector, a factory has idle line time and wants a steady client. Lead 3: education sector, a training business needs to reach young consumers.

Suppliers and dependencies

Item	Entry
Critical dependency	S5 Manufacturing. Fallback: Outsourced Assembly Partners (SU-13), 1,200 VB per batch plus 30 of the buyer's Materials, delivered next tick
Other slots you need	S2 last mile, S6 raw materials and produce, S7 payments
Slots you fill (others need you)	S12 Consumer audience and community
Who you deal with	Buys S5, S2, S6 and S7. Sells S12 to a training business and a produce supplier. Shares one Food Safety Certificate queue at Government with the produce supplier when both are active.
Memoranda you may receive as supplier	The S12 memorandum from a training business (its critical dependency: "Featured access to the consumer community to sign up learners."); an S12 fallback memorandum from a produce supplier with no active S7 or S9 filler.
Gate	Food Safety Certificate, held by Government; opens the Enterprise retail-chain buyer

Every slot has an institution fallback that always works at standard terms. A company filling the slot is usually cheaper or faster; finding out which company fills it is part of the game.

Immediate challenges

Kind	Challenge
Bottleneck	No factory: hand-packing caps output at 2 boxes per tick, exactly the anchor's demand
Weakness	No supply-chain people (Operations deficit)

Kind	Challenge
Known risk	Refunds from Tick 1 if the first boxes are not made and delivered
Known risk	Brand Purist persona resists discounting and partnering

Economics, in brief:

- Revenue model. Branded boxes to Consumer and, once certified, retail-chain cards; community features sold to companies that need an audience.
- Cost structure. Payroll from 900 to 5,400 VB per tick; baseline resource draw worth 1,055 VB per tick, spread across Logistics, Materials and Data.
- Unit economics. A hand-packed box costs 50 VB of resources against 450 to 550 VB, but only 2 can be packed per tick, which just covers the anchor. A factory box costs one finished unit (about 65 VB from a manufacturing run) plus 20 VB of Logistics and doubles capacity. The problem is scale, not margin.
- Fixed versus variable. Fixed: about 6,455 VB per tick from Tick 6. Variable: 2 Materials and 1 Logistics per hand-packed box, or a finished unit and 1 Logistics per factory box.
- Resource consumption. With the anchor hand-packed, Materials draws 14 units per tick (empty during Tick 8) and Logistics 12 (empty during Tick 9) without purchases; Data lasts to about Tick 10. The binding constraint is manufacturing, not stock.
- Talent costs. The Operations gap is why nobody has set up a supply chain; one good hire changes the company.
- Working capital. No cash liability falls due; runway is 9 ticks. Missed boxes cost 1,500 VB each in refunds.

Objectives

Layer	Your target
Survival	Never Distressed for 2 ticks running; solvent at the freeze
Revenue	18,000 VB of new revenue by the freeze, not counting the anchor's Ticks 1 to 6
Growth	Hold the Food Safety Certificate and sign one Enterprise retail-chain contract.
Strategic (public objective)	Deliver every anchor box on time and hold a standing manufacturing contract by Tick 4.

Your CEO also holds one private objective in a sealed envelope. Each of you holds a personal objective: see the Personal Objective System.

Options on the table

Kind	Opportunity
Obvious	Sign a manufacturing contract (S5) and last-mile delivery (S2) before Tick 1 settles
Discoverable	The contract factory has an idle line (your market fact); a training business wants the community's audience (Lead 3, your inside fact)
Opportunistic	A weather event that hurts a rival's supply raises the value of a secured supply chain; Media coverage is cheapest for this brand

Bigger moves your team could make:

- Pivot: from direct-to-consumer to wholesale and private label, where the brand sells through other people's channels.
- New products: a private-label food line; community events sold to other brands.
- Spin-out: a community and media unit selling S12 on its own.
- Acquisitions: acquire or merge with the produce supplier (farm to brand) or the manufacturer (own the factory); be the own-brand goods a delivery company wants to buy.

What only you know

Item	What you know
Your vantage point	Knows what its community members want; a list worth selling, carefully.
Inside fact	"Our community has thousands of active members, and a quarter of them told us they want to learn new skills."
Market fact	If an S5 company is active: "The city's contract factory has one big customer and an idle line most of the day." Otherwise: "The Supplier Market sells finished goods, but at a premium and only in its minimum order size." [Print: keep only the line that matches this run.]
Rumour you heard	"A rival brand is about to launch a cheaper mango drink."
Something you overheard	"Our pulp supplier mentioned the orchards had a dry spring."

None of these is labelled true or false. You may share, sell or trade any of them under the Human Internet rules.

Rules that matter most to you

- Same rulebook for every company; only your story and numbers differ.
- Your most likely failure: missing payroll after Tick 9; Logistics or Materials at 0 for 2 ticks from about Tick 9.
- Distressed is triggered by any High or Very High resource at 0 for 2 ticks, unpaid payroll, a missed liability payment past its tick, or fewer than 3 staff.
- Stock thresholds: warning at 30 units; at 15, deliveries using that resource cost 25% more of it; at 0, deliveries stop.
- Any employee may negotiate and propose deals. One signatory or the CEO approves up to 5,000 VB; above that needs the CEO or both signatories.
- Your supplier agreement expires at Tick 4 unless renewed with a volume commitment; your anchor comes up for renewal after Tick 6.
- Before Market Open you may talk, trade information, spend your platform wallet through Trade Slips and agree deals as Proposed. Nothing settles until Tick 1, when the desks enter Trade Slips on the platform.

Sealed inserts (print and hand out separately)

Leadership envelope, to the CEO only (may be shared with the signatories): Customer base. Four or more paying contracts live at freeze.

Role insert, to every Brand / Community member of staff (not the CEO): Once Mango & Co. signs a manufacturing contract of 3 or more ticks (with an S5 company, or a batch deal with Outsourced Assembly Partners, SU-13), the GM releases "Maison Verde Department Stores" (CU-25), an Enterprise card wanting an exclusive premium gift range for 4 ticks, budget 10,000 VB. It needs no certificate, because sealed goods from a certified factory are accepted.

3.4 SkillForge

SkillForge is a two-sided talent marketplace with too few employers and too few learners: every company in the city is short of someone, but SkillForge has to prove its hires work before its one corporate client loses patience.

Who you are

Field	Entry
Archetype and sector	Edtech and talent marketplace; Digital cluster
Headline story	"Skills in weeks, jobs in days." Bootcamps that place trained people straight into the city's companies.
History	Founded by a teacher and a recruiter who were tired of graduates nobody would hire. The bootcamps fill when the marketing works; employers sign up only when they see results.

Field	Entry
Mission	Every person in the city can learn a skill that gets them hired.
Business model	Learners or their employers pay for course cohorts; companies pay a placement fee per hire.
Products	Placement of a trained hire; course cohort.
Target customer	Companies with an understaffed domain (\$10); Enterprise and Consumer learners; Government skilling programmes once accredited.
Market position	Every company starts short in one domain, so every company is a potential customer. Competes with the Talent Exchange, which is always open.
Technology	A half-built course platform; assessments run on spreadsheets
Reputation	Loved by learners; unproven with employers

Team

Your CEO is a volunteer who plays this persona card: Mission Idealist. Belief: impact is the point. Red line: won't take "dirty" money. Bias: ignores unit economics.

Your staff: Market-led mix. Deficit domain: Product / Build, one person short. Strong on sales and community; the course platform is half-built. Everyone starts at L0 on 100 VB per tick. Elect 2 Authorised Signatories before Market Open.

Capital and resources

Item	At the start
Cash (platform balance, issued at setup)	32,050 VB (Strategic Adjustment 0)
Notable Asset	Customer list: learners and alumni, book value 4,000 VB
Resources	Platform balance of 100 units of each, issued at setup. Tiers: Compute High, Energy Low, Logistics Low, Materials Low, Data High, Infrastructure Medium
Runway with no new revenue	9 ticks
First resource to run out (no purchases)	Compute and Data, Tick 10

Item	At the start
Personal wallet	1,000 VB each in your platform wallet, yours, not the company's

Products

Field	Placement	Course cohort
Buyer gets	One trained hire placed into a named domain: an outside specialist on the Talent Exchange's standard specialist terms, counting toward the buyer's headcount in that domain for the rest of the run	One tick of training for a cohort of learners or staff
Delivery unit	1 placement	1 cohort-tick
Resource cost per unit	1 Compute, 1 Data	1 Compute, 1 Data
Units per tick	2 (6 per run)	3
List / floor (VB)	450 / 300	900 / 600
Eligible buyers	Companies (\$10, or any company's deficit domain)	Enterprise and Consumer cards; Government after accreditation
Licence	None	Course accreditation for Government buyers
Beats the fallback by	Capacity and speed: placed within the tick in the domain the buyer names, while the Talent Exchange holds only one specialist per active company across all domains	n/a

Obligations you start with

Obligation	Terms
Anchor contract	Enterprise card "Allied Services Corp": 1 cohort-tick of corporate training per tick at 900 VB, 900 VB per tick for Ticks 1 to 6 (5,400 VB), then renewal
Supplier agreement	CoreCompute (SU-01), Compute: 17 VB per unit (15% below base), up to 10 units per tick; expires at Tick 4 unless renewed with a volume

Obligation	Terms
	commitment of 3 ticks at the cap
Liability	Key-person risk: the lead instructor (Operations) leaves at Tick 5 unless a retention deal (a salary step or a new role) is recorded first
Memorandum (non-binding)	With the S12 community holder: "Featured access to the consumer community to sign up learners." It records a need, not an obligation. [Print: name the counterparty company. If it is not active this run, print the fallback partner and need line from the dossier.]

Customers and leads

Anchor customer: see the anchor contract above. Open customer cards sit with the Customer desk; visit it to see them.

Leads: Lead 1: "City Skilling Programme", a Government tender the Regulator will announce in its tender window; it will need accredited providers. Lead 2: consumer sector, a brand's community is full of people who want to learn. Lead 3: fintech sector, a payments firm cannot find salespeople.

Suppliers and dependencies

Item	Entry
Critical dependency	S12 Consumer audience. Fallback: Media
Other slots you need	S3 compute hosting, S7 payments, S9 analytics
Slots you fill (others need you)	S10 Trained talent and hiring
Who you deal with	Buys S12, S3, S7 and S9. Sells S10 to a payments firm, an analytics firm and a security firm, and to any company with a gap. Competes with the Talent Exchange, and with a climate company for places in Government's tender pipeline.
Memoranda you may receive as supplier	S10 fallback memoranda from a payments firm, an analytics firm or a security firm whose earlier slots have no active filler.
Gate	Course accreditation, held by Government; opens the Government skilling tender

Every slot has an institution fallback that always works at standard terms. A company filling the slot is usually cheaper or faster; finding out which company fills it is part of the game.

Immediate challenges

Kind	Challenge
Bottleneck	Liquidity: needs learners (an audience) and employers at the same time
Weakness	Half-built platform (Product / Build deficit)
Known risk	Lead instructor leaves at Tick 5 without a retention deal
Known risk	The Talent Exchange is a free alternative for every buyer

Economics, in brief:

- Revenue model. Cohort-ticks to Enterprise, Consumer and later Government buyers; placement fees from companies.
- Cost structure. Payroll from 900 to 5,400 VB per tick; baseline resource draw worth 860 VB per tick, the lightest in the city.
- Unit economics. Both products cost 45 VB of resources at Bank prices; a cohort-tick earns 600 to 900 VB and a placement 300 to 450 VB.
- Fixed versus variable. Fixed: about 6,260 VB per tick from Tick 6. Variable: 1 Compute and 1 Data per unit.
- Resource consumption. Compute and Data draw 11 units per tick each with the anchor, empty during Tick 10 without purchases. Energy, Logistics and Materials are surplus to sell.
- Talent costs. The Product / Build gap keeps the platform half-built; the retention deal for the lead instructor is a second talent cost due by Tick 5.
- Working capital. No cash liability falls due; runway is 9 ticks. The risk is losing revenue, not paying a bill.

Objectives

Layer	Your target
Survival	Never Distressed for 2 ticks running; solvent at the freeze
Revenue	18,000 VB of new revenue by the freeze, not counting the anchor's Ticks 1 to 6
Growth	Hold course accreditation and win the skilling tender.
Strategic (public objective)	Place trained hires into 3 different companies by freeze.

Your CEO also holds one private objective in a sealed envelope. Each of you holds a personal objective: see the Personal Objective System.

Options on the table

Kind	Opportunity
Obvious	Sell placements into every company's understaffed domain
Discoverable	The consumer brand's community wants to learn (your market fact); a Government skilling tender is coming (Lead 1)
Opportunistic	A company that fails releases staff who need retraining; a talent-shortage event raises the value of every placement

Bigger moves your team could make:

- Pivot: from open bootcamps to corporate training for one sector, where one buyer pays for whole cohorts.
- New products: an assessment and credentialing service; security or AI courses built with a partner.
- Spin-outs: a corporate training unit; an assessment service.
- Acquisitions: merge with the analytics provider (AI-led training) or the security provider (security training); take on a failed company's staff as a ready-made cohort.

What only you know

Item	What you know
Your vantage point	Knows which companies are short of which skills, because they ask.
Inside fact	"Half our alumni are still looking for work; we could place them tomorrow if employers came to us."
Market fact	If an S12 company is active: "The city's best-loved consumer brand has a community full of people who want to learn new skills." Otherwise: "Media sells featured stories, but a story brings attention, not sign-ups." [Print: keep only the line that matches this run.]
Rumour you heard	"The Talent Exchange is about to run out of specialists in every domain."
Something you overheard	"Our anchor's HR head asked twice whether any of our learners have actually been hired yet."

None of these is labelled true or false. You may share, sell or trade any of them under the Human Internet rules.

Rules that matter most to you

- Same rulebook for every company; only your story and numbers differ.
- Your most likely failure: missing payroll after Tick 9; Compute or Data at 0 for 2 ticks from about Tick 10.
- Distressed is triggered by any High or Very High resource at 0 for 2 ticks, unpaid payroll, a missed liability payment past its tick, or fewer than 3 staff.
- Stock thresholds: warning at 30 units; at 15, deliveries using that resource cost 25% more of it; at 0, deliveries stop.
- Any employee may negotiate and propose deals. One signatory or the CEO approves up to 5,000 VB; above that needs the CEO or both signatories.
- Your supplier agreement expires at Tick 4 unless renewed with a volume commitment; your anchor comes up for renewal after Tick 6.
- Before Market Open you may talk, trade information, spend your platform wallet through Trade Slips and agree deals as Proposed. Nothing settles until Tick 1, when the desks enter Trade Slips on the platform.
- A placement is a Talent Exchange specialist contract supplied by a company instead of the desk.

Sealed inserts (print and hand out separately)

Leadership envelope, to the CEO only (may be shared with the signatories): Independence. No institution loan outstanding and 3 or more ticks of runway at freeze.

Role insert, to every Growth / Sales member of staff (not the CEO): Each company with a live placement through SkillForge adds 120 VB per tick to its revenue, credited at settlement; capped at 6 companies (720 VB per tick) and 15,000 VB over the run.

3.5 PulseAI

PulseAI has the best technology in the city and almost no paying customers: its model is in demand everywhere, but it burns Compute faster than anyone and runs dry first, around Tick 6.

Who you are

Field	Entry
Archetype and sector	B2B AI software; Digital cluster
Headline story	"See the next tick before it happens." Forecasting and analytics models for any business.
History	Spun out of a university lab with a forecasting model that beat everything it was tested against. Two years of building later, it has one pilot and a backlog of features.

Field	Entry
Mission	Every decision in the city made with a forecast, not a guess.
Business model	Per-run fees from companies; per-tick subscriptions from Enterprise buyers, which pay more once pilots prove the model.
Products	Model run; analytics subscription.
Target customer	Companies that need a sharper decision (S9), which is most of the city; Enterprise analytics buyers.
Market position	The most demanded supplier slot in the city: every conversation is a sales lead. The hungriest resource consumer in the city.
Technology	The best model in the city, running on aging code that wastes Compute
Reputation	Admired by engineers; unknown to buyers

Team

Your CEO is a volunteer who plays this persona card: Product Perfectionist. Belief: build it right, then sell. Red line: won't sell vapourware. Bias: ships late.

Your staff: Tech-led mix. Deficit domain: Growth / Sales, one person short. Engineers who cannot sell. Everyone starts at L0 on 100 VB per tick. Elect 2 Authorised Signatories before Market Open.

Capital and resources

Item	At the start
Cash (platform balance, issued at setup)	30,050 VB (Strategic Adjustment -2,000)
Notable Asset	Prototype: a working forecasting model, book value 7,500 VB
Resources	Platform balance of 100 units of each, issued at setup. Tiers: Compute Very High, Energy High, Logistics Low, Materials Low, Data Very High, Infrastructure High
Runway with no new revenue	9 ticks
First resource to run out (no purchases)	Compute, Tick 6
Personal wallet	1,000 VB each in your platform wallet, yours, not

Item	At the start
	the company's

Products

Field	Model run	Analytics subscription
Buyer gets	A model run that sharpens one recurring decision: the buyer's baseline draw of one resource it names falls by 4 units per tick for the next 2 ticks; also meets any customer card that names analytics as a must-have	One tick of forecasting for an Enterprise buyer's operations
Delivery unit	1 run	1 subscription-tick
Resource cost per unit	1 Compute, 1 Data	1 Compute, 1 Data
Units per tick	4	3
List / floor (VB)	150 / 110	1,000 / 700
Eligible buyers	Companies (S9)	Enterprise cards: pilots (1 to 2 ticks, up to 25% of the card's per-tick budget) at once; full contracts after the gate
Licence	None	Gate for full contracts
Beats the fallback by	Price: one run instead of hiring a Talent Exchange specialist for a tick; 8 resource units saved per run	n/a

Obligations you start with

Obligation	Terms
Anchor contract	Enterprise card "Quayside Distribution": a pilot of 1 subscription-tick per tick at the pilot rate of 700 VB, 700 VB per tick for Ticks 1 to 6 (4,200 VB), then renewal
Supplier agreement	CoreCompute (SU-01), Compute: 17 VB per unit (15% below base), up to 15 units per tick; expires at Tick 4 unless renewed with a volume commitment of 3 ticks at the cap

Obligation	Terms
Liability	Technical debt: Compute consumed at +3 units per tick until fixed by a fix mission or a fix bought from another company (SPV burden 4,000 VB)
Memorandum (non-binding)	With the S3 compute host: "Hosted compute for model runs, below the market price." It records a need, not an obligation. [Print: name the counterparty company. If it is not active this run, print the fallback partner and need line from the dossier.]

Customers and leads

Anchor customer: see the anchor contract above. Open customer cards sit with the Customer desk; visit it to see them.

Leads: Lead 1: "Atlas Retail Group", an Enterprise card on the Customer desk that wants demand forecasting for its 30 stores (needs the gate for a full contract). Lead 2: logistics sector, a delivery business is losing money on badly planned routes. Lead 3: health sector, a marketplace holds clean patient-outcome data it cannot yet sell; with data like that, health forecasts would be worth far more.

Suppliers and dependencies

Item	Entry
Critical dependency	S3 Compute hosting. Fallback: Supplier Market (Compute)
Other slots you need	S4 energy, S8 security, S10 trained talent, S11 verified datasets
Slots you fill (others need you)	S9 AI and analytics
Who you deal with	Sells S9 to most of the city. Buys S3 (critical), S4, S8, S10 and S11. Competes for scarce Data with three other Very High users.
Memoranda you may receive as supplier	S9 fallback memoranda from any company whose earlier slots have no active filler.
Gate	2 completed pilots, recorded by the Customer desk; opens full Enterprise contracts

Every slot has an institution fallback that always works at standard terms. A company filling the slot is usually cheaper or faster; finding out which company fills it is part of the game.

Immediate challenges

Kind	Challenge
Bottleneck	Compute and Data both Very High; technical debt adds 3 Compute per tick
Weakness	Engineers who cannot sell (Growth / Sales deficit)
Known risk	Enterprise contracts locked until 2 pilots are completed
Known risk	Persona keeps perfecting instead of selling

Economics, in brief:

- Revenue model. Many small run fees from companies now; few large Enterprise subscriptions after the gate.
- Cost structure. Payroll from 900 to 5,400 VB per tick; baseline resource draw worth 1,220 VB per tick, plus 60 VB of technical debt.
- Unit economics. Each run or subscription-tick costs 45 VB of resources at Bank prices; a run earns 110 to 150 VB and a subscription-tick 700 to 1,000 VB.
- Fixed versus variable. Fixed: about 6,680 VB per tick from Tick 6. Variable: 1 Compute and 1 Data per unit.
- Resource consumption. Compute draws 18 units per tick (14 + 3 technical debt + 1 anchor), empty during Tick 6 without purchases, the earliest run-out in the city. Data draws 15, empty during Tick 7. Energy and Infrastructure last to Tick 10.
- Talent costs. The Growth / Sales gap is the reason the model is unsold.
- Working capital. No cash liability falls due, so runway is 9 ticks, but Compute purchases will eat into it from Tick 5.

Objectives

Layer	Your target
Survival	Never Distressed for 2 ticks running; solvent at the freeze
Revenue	18,000 VB of new revenue by the freeze, not counting the anchor's Ticks 1 to 6
Growth	Complete 2 pilots and sign one full Enterprise contract.
Strategic (public objective)	Sell model runs to 3 companies and complete 2 pilots by Tick 6.

Your CEO also holds one private objective in a sealed envelope. Each of you holds a personal objective: see the Personal Objective System.

Options on the table

Kind	Opportunity
Obvious	Sell model runs to the many companies that need S9; complete a second pilot
Discoverable	The compute host has idle halls (your market fact); a health marketplace's data would make health forecasts worth far more (Lead 3)
Opportunistic	A Compute shortage event makes owning compute strategic; a failing company's engineers are a cheap team to hire

Bigger moves your team could make:

- Pivot: narrow to one vertical (health, logistics or energy forecasting) around one paying customer.
- New products: route optimisation for physical companies; credit scoring with a payments partner.
- Spin-out: a vertical AI unit built around one buyer.
- Acquisitions: merge with the compute host (an AI company that owns its compute) or the health marketplace (health AI on its data); acquire a small team for talent; be the in-house AI a health or payments company wants.

What only you know

Item	What you know
Your vantage point	Its runs for other companies show it their weak spots; what it does with that is a deal like any other.
Inside fact	"Our model is good enough to sell today; the team keeps adding features instead."
Market fact	If an S3 company is active: "The city's compute host has half its halls empty and would rather sell cheap than sit idle." Otherwise: "The Supplier Market's Compute line sells out fast once heavy users start buying around Tick 5." [Print: keep only the line that matches this run.]
Rumour you heard	"Enterprise buyers are about to freeze AI budgets."
Something you overheard	"Our lead ML engineer was seen having coffee with a recruiter."

None of these is labelled true or false. You may share, sell or trade any of them under the Human Internet rules.

Rules that matter most to you

- Same rulebook for every company; only your story and numbers differ.
- Your most likely failure: Compute at 0 for 2 ticks (as early as Ticks 6 to 7 without purchases); missing payroll after Tick 9.
- Distressed is triggered by any High or Very High resource at 0 for 2 ticks, unpaid payroll, a missed liability payment past its tick, or fewer than 3 staff.
- Stock thresholds: warning at 30 units; at 15, deliveries using that resource cost 25% more of it; at 0, deliveries stop.
- Any employee may negotiate and propose deals. One signatory or the CEO approves up to 5,000 VB; above that needs the CEO or both signatories.
- Your supplier agreement expires at Tick 4 unless renewed with a volume commitment; your anchor comes up for renewal after Tick 6.
- Before Market Open you may talk, trade information, spend your platform wallet through Trade Slips and agree deals as Proposed. Nothing settles until Tick 1, when the desks enter Trade Slips on the platform.
- How your gate is judged. A pilot is 1 to 2 ticks at no more than 25% of the card's per-tick budget, and is completed when the Customer desk accepts the delivery. The T0 anchor does not count, so both pilots come from cards worked during play.

Sealed inserts (print and hand out separately)

Leadership envelope, to the CEO only (may be shared with the signatories): Enterprise reach. Two new Enterprise customer cards signed.

Role insert, to every Research / Intelligence member of staff (not the CEO): Every Enterprise subscription contract pays a 40% premium, credited by the platform at settlement; capped at 15,000 VB over the run.

3.6 GreenGrid

GreenGrid is asset-rich and cash-poor: it holds the city's only grid connection and a strong energy buyer, but it is the heaviest resource consumer in the city and owes the Bank 10,000 VB at Tick 7.

Who you are

Field	Entry
Archetype and sector	Climate and energy: solar-plus-battery supply and efficiency retrofits; Physical and Regulated clusters
Headline story	"Clean power, by the tick." Solar and battery energy for the city's businesses, and retrofits that cut what they use.

Field	Entry
History	Founded by two engineers who won the city's only grid connection licence and borrowed to build the first solar field. Demand is real; the capital to build more is not.
Mission	Run the city on clean energy that costs less than the dirty kind.
Business model	Per-tick energy supply contracts; one-off efficiency retrofits; capacity built first and paid for later.
Products	Energy supply block; efficiency retrofit.
Target customer	Energy-heavy companies (S4); Enterprise and Government energy buyers.
Market position	The only energy supplier among the companies. Needs panels and batteries made by someone else (S5).
Technology	A solar field and battery bank; no demand forecasting
Reputation	Respected by engineers; the Bank watches it closely

Team

Your CEO is a volunteer who plays this persona card: Operator. Belief: systems beat heroics. Red line: won't take orders it can't fulfil. Bias: avoids bold bets.

Your staff: Ops-led mix. Deficit domain: Finance / Capital, one person short. Strong engineers and site crews; nobody to raise money. Everyone starts at L0 on 100 VB per tick. Elect 2 Authorised Signatories before Market Open.

Capital and resources

Item	At the start
Cash (platform balance, issued at setup)	32,050 VB (Strategic Adjustment 0)
Notable Asset	Licence: the city's grid connection, book value 8,000 VB
Resources	Platform balance of 100 units of each, issued at setup. Tiers: Compute Medium, Energy Very High, Logistics High, Materials Very High, Data Medium,

Item	At the start
	Infrastructure Very High
Runway with no new revenue	8 ticks
First resource to run out (no purchases)	Materials and Infrastructure, Tick 7
Personal wallet	1,000 VB each in your platform wallet, yours, not the company's

Products

Field	Energy supply block	Efficiency retrofit
Buyer gets	10 Energy units	The buyer's baseline Energy draw falls by 4 units per tick for the rest of the run
Delivery unit	1 block	1 retrofit
Resource cost per unit	1 Materials, 1 Infrastructure	2 Materials, 1 Infrastructure, plus 1 finished product unit (panels and batteries)
Units per tick	5 (8 after the Grid Expansion)	1
List / floor (VB)	120 / 100	650 / 450
Eligible buyers	Companies (S4); Enterprise and Government cards	Companies (S4); Enterprise and Government cards
Licence	None	None
Beats the fallback by	Price: 12 VB per Energy unit against the Bank's 15 and the Supplier Market's 13.5	Capacity: no institution sells a permanent cut in use

Obligations you start with

Obligation	Terms
Anchor contract	Enterprise card "Eastgate Industrial Park": 2 energy blocks per tick at the Enterprise rate of 650 VB, 1,300 VB per tick for Ticks 1 to 6 (7,800 VB), then renewal
Supplier agreement	Allied Materials Depot (SU-07), Materials: 12 VB per unit (20% below base), up to 20 units per tick; expires at Tick 4 unless renewed with a volume commitment of 3 ticks at the cap

Obligation	Terms
Liability	Bank loan: 10,000 VB repayment due at Tick 7, the largest in the city
Memorandum (non-binding)	With the S5 manufacturer: "Panels and battery units made for the grid build-out." It records a need, not an obligation. [Print: name the counterparty company. If it is not active this run, print the fallback partner and need line from the dossier.]

Customers and leads

Anchor customer: see the anchor contract above. Open customer cards sit with the Customer desk; visit it to see them.

Leads: Lead 1: "Eastport Cold Storage", an Enterprise card on the Customer desk that wants site power every tick and a retrofit. Lead 2: manufacturing sector, a factory can make panels and battery units. Lead 3: transport sector, an operator's depot sits on land with a grid connection point; as a charging site it would be worth far more to an energy business than to its owner.

Suppliers and dependencies

Item	Entry
Critical dependency	S5 Manufacturing. Fallback: Outsourced Assembly Partners (SU-13), 1,200 VB per batch plus 30 of the buyer's Materials, delivered next tick
Other slots you need	S7 payments, S9 analytics
Slots you fill (others need you)	S4 Energy supply and efficiency
Who you deal with	Sole S4 supplier: a compute host and a fleet operator depend on it critically, and an analytics firm and a manufacturer also buy. Buys S5 (critical), S7 and S9. Competes with a training business for places in Government's tender pipeline, and with two other Very High users for scarce Energy.
Memoranda you may receive as supplier	S4 memoranda from a compute host ("Energy for the server halls at contract price.") and a fleet operator ("Energy to charge the van fleet each tick."); S4 fallback memoranda from an analytics firm or a manufacturer whose earlier slots have no active filler.

Item	Entry
Gate	2 signed offtake contracts, recorded by the Bank; open project finance for the Grid Expansion

Every slot has an institution fallback that always works at standard terms. A company filling the slot is usually cheaper or faster; finding out which company fills it is part of the game.

Immediate challenges

Kind	Challenge
Bottleneck	Materials and Infrastructure Very High, and every block spends both
Weakness	Nobody to raise or manage capital (Finance / Capital deficit)
Known risk	The 10,000 VB loan due at Tick 7
Known risk	Retrofits need panels and batteries it cannot make

Economics, in brief:

- Revenue model. Long per-tick supply contracts, plus one-off retrofits.
- Cost structure. Payroll from 900 to 5,400 VB per tick; baseline resource draw worth 1,355 VB per tick, the highest in the city.
- Unit economics. A block costs 45 VB of resources at Bank prices against 100 to 120 VB. A retrofit costs 60 VB plus a finished unit against 450 to 650 VB.
- Fixed versus variable. Fixed: about 6,755 VB per tick from Tick 6. Variable: 1 Materials and 1 Infrastructure per block.
- Resource consumption. Materials and Infrastructure draw 16 units per tick each with the anchor, empty during Tick 7 without purchases; Energy draws 14, empty during Tick 8. Three Very High resources: the heaviest consumer in the city.

Objectives

Layer	Your target
Survival	Never Distressed for 2 ticks running; solvent at the freeze
Revenue	18,000 VB of new revenue by the freeze, not counting the anchor's Ticks 1 to 6
Growth	Complete the Grid Expansion.
Strategic (public objective)	Sign 2 offtake contracts and repay the Tick 7 loan on time.

Your CEO also holds one private objective in a sealed envelope. Each of you holds a personal objective: see the Personal Objective System.

Options on the table

Kind	Opportunity
Obvious	Sign energy supply contracts with energy-heavy companies; two offtakes open project finance
Discoverable	A transport depot would make an ideal charging site (Lead 3); the contract factory has an idle line (your market fact)
Opportunistic	An energy shortage event makes every block worth more; a distressed fleet or hosting company is a natural merger

Bigger moves your team could make:

- Pivot: from building generation to selling efficiency, which needs less capital.
- New products: EV charging for a fleet operator.
- Spin-outs: an EV charging unit; an efficiency consulting unit.
- Acquisitions: merge with the fleet operator (energy plus fleet) or the compute host (a green data centre); acquire the manufacturer to own its supply.

What only you know

Item	What you know
Your vantage point	Holds the city's only grid connection: any new generator needs it or a deal.
Inside fact	"Our grid connection licence is the only one in the city; any new generator needs it or a deal with us."
Market fact	If an S5 company is active: "The city's contract factory has one big customer and an idle line most of the day." Otherwise: "The Supplier Market sells finished goods, but at a premium and only in its minimum order size." [Print: keep only the line that matches this run.]
Rumour you heard	"Government is about to raise energy subsidies."
Something you overheard	"A regulator at the Government desk asked how much of our retrofit margin depends on the subsidy."

None of these is labelled true or false. You may share, sell or trade any of them under the Human Internet rules.

Rules that matter most to you

- Same rulebook for every company; only your story and numbers differ.
- Your most likely failure: missing the Tick 7 repayment; Materials or Infrastructure at 0 for 2 ticks (Ticks 7 to 8 without purchases).
- Distressed is triggered by any High or Very High resource at 0 for 2 ticks, unpaid payroll, a missed liability payment past its tick, or fewer than 3 staff.
- Stock thresholds: warning at 30 units; at 15, deliveries using that resource cost 25% more of it; at 0, deliveries stop.
- Any employee may negotiate and propose deals. One signatory or the CEO approves up to 5,000 VB; above that needs the CEO or both signatories.
- Your supplier agreement expires at Tick 4 unless renewed with a volume commitment; your anchor comes up for renewal after Tick 6.
- Before Market Open you may talk, trade information, spend your platform wallet through Trade Slips and agree deals as Proposed. Nothing settles until Tick 1, when the desks enter Trade Slips on the platform.
- How your gate is judged. An offtake contract is an energy supply contract of 3 or more ticks with any buyer, company or institution, signed from Market Open onward; the T0 anchor does not count.

Sealed inserts (print and hand out separately)

Leadership envelope, to the CEO only (may be shared with the signatories): Independence. No institution loan outstanding and 3 or more ticks of runway at freeze.

Role insert, to every Operations member of staff (not the CEO): With green certification from Government (GV-L09; evidence: an accepted S4 delivery or retrofit), the GM releases the "Municipal Green Energy" tender (GV-T02), worth 12,500 VB over 5 ticks for 20 Energy units per tick to city buildings.

3.7 MediLink

MediLink is trusted by patients and distrusted by regulators: it holds the cleanest dataset in the city, but cannot sell it to regulated buyers or reach hospitals until it fixes its security and compliance.

Who you are

Field	Entry
Archetype and sector	Health marketplace: telehealth and pharmacy; Digital and Regulated clusters
Headline story	"A doctor in your pocket, medicine at your door." Telehealth consultations and pharmacy orders for the whole city.

Field	Entry
History	Started during a winter flu wave by a doctor and a software engineer. Patients loved it; the regulator noticed it was storing outcome data faster than it was securing it.
Mission	Good care for everyone in the city, without a waiting room.
Business model	A fee per consultation and pharmacy order; sales of anonymised outcome data once compliant.
Products	Telehealth consultation and pharmacy order; verified health dataset.
Target customer	Consumer patients; Enterprise hospital networks after the gate; analytics and security firms buying data (\$11).
Market position	Owns the cleanest dataset in the city, worth more to an analytics business than on its books. Competes with a payments firm for data buyers.
Technology	A telehealth app and a large outcome database with weak access controls
Reputation	Patients trust it; regulators and hospitals do not yet

Team

Your CEO is a volunteer who plays this persona card: Risk Guardian. Belief: evidence before money. Red line: no credit without proof. Bias: misses fast opportunities.

Your staff: Tech-led mix. Deficit domain: Brand / Community, one person short. Clinicians and engineers; nobody to earn patient and hospital trust. Everyone starts at L0 on 100 VB per tick. Elect 2 Authorised Signatories before Market Open.

Capital and resources

Item	At the start
Cash (platform balance, issued at setup)	30,050 VB (Strategic Adjustment -2,000)
Notable Asset	Dataset: verified provider and patient-outcome data, book value 6,000 VB
Resources	Platform balance of 100 units of each, issued at setup. Tiers: Compute High, Energy Medium, Logistics Medium, Materials Medium, Data Very

Item	At the start
	High, Infrastructure High
Runway with no new revenue	9 ticks
First resource to run out (no purchases)	Data, Tick 7
Personal wallet	1,000 VB each in your platform wallet, yours, not the company's

Products

Field	Consultation and pharmacy order	Verified health dataset
Buyer gets	One telehealth consultation, with any pharmacy order prepared for delivery	5 Data units of verified quality
Delivery unit	1 consultation	1 dataset
Resource cost per unit	1 Data, 1 Compute (home delivery of the pharmacy order through S2 or the Logistics Provider)	1 Compute, 2 Data
Units per tick	4	2
List / floor (VB)	500 / 380	105 / 90
Eligible buyers	Consumer cards; Enterprise hospital cards after the gate	Companies (S11); regulated buyers only after the health data compliance licence (GV-L07)
Licence	None	Health data compliance licence (GV-L07) for regulated buyers
Beats the fallback by	n/a	Price: 21 VB per Data unit against the Supplier Market's 22.5

Obligations you start with

Obligation	Terms
Anchor contract	Consumer card "CityCare Patients": 2 consultations per tick at 500 VB, 1,000 VB per tick for Ticks 1 to 6 (6,000 VB), then renewal

Obligation	Terms
Supplier agreement	OpenData Exchange (SU-09), Data: 22 VB per unit (12% below base), up to 12 units per tick; expires at Tick 4 unless renewed with a volume commitment of 3 ticks at the cap
Liability	Compliance gap: the health dataset cannot be sold to regulated buyers until Government grants a health data compliance licence (GV-L07) (SPV burden 5,000 VB)
Memorandum (non-binding)	With the S8 security provider: "Security cover and an attestation to close the data compliance gap." It records a need, not an obligation. [Print: name the counterparty company. If it is not active this run, print the fallback partner and need line from the dossier.]

Customers and leads

Anchor customer: see the anchor contract above. Open customer cards sit with the Customer desk; visit it to see them.

Leads: Lead 1: "Northbridge Hospital Network", an Enterprise card on the Customer desk that wants follow-up care for discharged patients (needs the gate). Lead 2: AI sector, an analytics business wants clean health data for its models. Lead 3: security sector, a firm sells audits that regulators accept.

Suppliers and dependencies

Item	Entry
Critical dependency	S8 Security and compliance. Fallback: Government licence route
Other slots you need	S2 last mile, S7 payments, S9 analytics
Slots you fill (others need you)	S11 Verified datasets
Who you deal with	Buys S8 (critical), S2, S7 and S9. Sells S11 to an analytics firm and a security firm. Competes with a payments firm for S11 buyers.
Memoranda you may receive as supplier	S11 fallback memoranda from an analytics firm or a security firm whose earlier slots have no active filler (MediLink takes the security firm's ahead of the payments firm).
Gate	3 verified deliveries, recorded by the Customer desk; open the Enterprise hospital buyer

Every slot has an institution fallback that always works at standard terms. A company filling the slot is usually cheaper or faster; finding out which company fills it is part of the game.

Immediate challenges

Kind	Challenge
Bottleneck	Data at Very High, and the dataset product spends more of it
Weakness	Nobody to build trust (Brand / Community deficit)
Known risk	Dataset blocked for regulated buyers until licensed
Known risk	Hospital buyer locked until 3 verified deliveries

Economics, in brief:

- Revenue model. Consultation fees now; data sales and hospital contracts once compliant and gated.
- Cost structure. Payroll from 900 to 5,400 VB per tick; baseline resource draw worth 1,200 VB per tick, led by Data.
- Unit economics. A consultation costs 45 VB of resources at Bank prices against 380 to 500 VB; a dataset costs 70 VB against 90 to 105 VB and spends scarce Data.
- Fixed versus variable. Fixed: about 6,600 VB per tick from Tick 6. Variable: 1 Data and 1 Compute per consultation, plus delivery of pharmacy orders.
- Resource consumption. Data draws 16 units per tick with the anchor, empty during Tick 7 without purchases; Compute lasts to Tick 9.
- Talent costs. The Brand / Community gap is why hospitals and regulators have not been won over.
- Working capital. No cash liability falls due; runway is 9 ticks. The big money (data and hospitals) is locked behind compliance.

Objectives

Layer	Your target
Survival	Never Distressed for 2 ticks running; solvent at the freeze
Revenue	18,000 VB of new revenue by the freeze, not counting the anchor's Ticks 1 to 6
Growth	Complete 3 verified deliveries and sign the hospital buyer.
Strategic (public objective)	Clear the compliance gap, and sell data only with security cover in place.

Your CEO also holds one private objective in a sealed envelope. Each of you holds a personal objective: see the Personal Objective System.

Options on the table

Kind	Opportunity
Obvious	Ship pharmacy orders through a last-mile provider to reach 3 verified deliveries; sell data to unregulated buyers
Discoverable	An analytics business wants clean health data (Lead 2); the security firm will become an approved auditor (your market fact)
Opportunistic	A data-breach event at a rival raises the value of being compliant; a health-scare event lifts Consumer demand

Bigger moves your team could make:

- Pivot: from a care marketplace to a health data business.
- New products: chilled medicine delivery with a delivery partner; a diagnostics model built on the dataset.
- Spin-outs: a diagnostics AI unit; a pharmacy delivery unit.
- Acquisitions: merge with the analytics provider (health AI) or the security provider (compliant data); be the most valuable acquisition target in the city for an AI company.

What only you know

Item	What you know
Your vantage point	Sees the city's health; knows which neighbourhoods are getting sick before anyone else.
Inside fact	"Our outcome data is the cleanest in the city; an analytics business could build a whole product on it."
Market fact	If an S8 company is active: "The city's security firm can audit us now, but its attestations only count once Government approves it as an auditor." Otherwise: "Government's licence route for data handling is open but slow; applicants queue." [Print: keep only the line that matches this run.]
Rumour you heard	"Government plans to fine any health business

Item	What you know
	that sells data this quarter."
Something you overheard	"Our engineers found an old database backup on a shared drive and never traced who copied it."

None of these is labelled true or false. You may share, sell or trade any of them under the Human Internet rules.

Rules that matter most to you

- Same rulebook for every company; only your story and numbers differ.
- Your most likely failure: Data at 0 for 2 ticks (Ticks 7 to 8 without purchases); missing payroll after Tick 9.
- Distressed is triggered by any High or Very High resource at 0 for 2 ticks, unpaid payroll, a missed liability payment past its tick, or fewer than 3 staff.
- Stock thresholds: warning at 30 units; at 15, deliveries using that resource cost 25% more of it; at 0, deliveries stop.
- Any employee may negotiate and propose deals. One signatory or the CEO approves up to 5,000 VB; above that needs the CEO or both signatories.
- Your supplier agreement expires at Tick 4 unless renewed with a volume commitment; your anchor comes up for renewal after Tick 6.
- Before Market Open you may talk, trade information, spend your platform wallet through Trade Slips and agree deals as Proposed. Nothing settles until Tick 1, when the desks enter Trade Slips on the platform.
- How your gate is judged. A verified delivery is a pharmacy order delivered to a Consumer customer through a recorded last-mile contract (an S2 provider or the Logistics Provider) and confirmed by the Customer desk. Anchor orders count only when shipped that way.

Sealed inserts (print and hand out separately)

Leadership envelope, to the CEO only (may be shared with the signatories): Licence first. Hold the gate's key (3 verified deliveries) by the end of Tick 6.

Role insert, to every Research / Intelligence member of staff (not the CEO): The dataset is worth 2.5 times book (15,000 VB) to the S9 analytics provider: the platform and Investor value it at that figure when the S9 provider owns it or holds an exclusive licence to it, by acquisition, merger or a sale.

3.8 HarvestLoop

HarvestLoop has plenty of stock and little time to sell it: it is the city's only produce and bio-materials supplier, but it owes its seed supplier 6,000 VB at Tick 3 and cannot move a crate without someone else's vans.

Who you are

Field	Entry
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Field	Entry
Archetype and sector	Agritech, farm-to-business supply; Physical cluster
Headline story	"From the field to your floor by the next tick." Fresh produce and bio-materials from a network of local growers.
History	Built by a grower's daughter who organised forty small farms into one supply network. The farms trust her; buyers come and go, and the stock does not wait.
Mission	Fair prices for growers and fresh supply for the city's businesses.
Business model	Buys from its grower network and sells produce and bio-material batches to businesses; earns on volume and freshness.
Products	Produce or bio-material batch; farm box for consumers once certified.
Target customer	Manufacturers, food brands and grocery businesses (S6); Enterprise food buyers; Consumer households after the gate.
Market position	The only produce and materials supplier among the companies; a manufacturer cannot run without it.
Technology	Paper ledgers at the collection points; a group chat with the growers
Reputation	Growers trust it; city buyers barely know it exists

Team

Your CEO is a volunteer who plays this persona card: Mission Idealist. Belief: impact is the point. Red line: won't take "dirty" money. Bias: ignores unit economics.

Your staff: Ops-led mix. Deficit domain: Research / Intelligence, one person short. Strong field operations; no demand forecasting. Everyone starts at LO on 100 VB per tick. Elect 2 Authorised Signatories before Market Open.

Capital and resources

Item	At the start
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Item	At the start
Cash (platform balance, issued at setup)	32,550 VB (Strategic Adjustment +500)
Notable Asset	Distribution channel: the grower collection network, book value 5,000 VB
Resources	Platform balance of 100 units of each, issued at setup. Tiers: Compute Low, Energy Medium, Logistics High, Materials Very High, Data Medium, Infrastructure Medium
Runway with no new revenue	8 ticks
First resource to run out (no purchases)	Materials, Tick 7
Personal wallet	1,000 VB each in your platform wallet, yours, not the company's

Products

Field	Produce or bio-material batch	Farm box
Buyer gets	8 Materials units, as fresh produce or bio-material	A box of fresh produce delivered to a Consumer household
Delivery unit	1 batch	1 box
Resource cost per unit	1 Materials, 1 Logistics	1 Materials, 1 Logistics
Units per tick	6	3
List / floor (VB)	95 / 70	400 / 300
Eligible buyers	Companies (S6); Enterprise cards	Consumer cards
Licence	None	Food Safety Certificate
Beats the fallback by	Price: about 12 VB per Materials unit against the Supplier Market's 13.5	n/a

Obligations you start with

Obligation	Terms
Anchor contract	Enterprise card "Central Kitchens Ltd": 2 produce batches per tick at the Enterprise rate of 500 VB, 1,000 VB per tick for Ticks 1 to 6 (6,000 VB), then

Obligation	Terms
	renewal
Supplier agreement	Riverbend Growers Co-op (SU-08), Materials (seed, feed and crates): 13 VB per unit (about 13% below base), up to 15 units per tick, paid 1 tick after delivery; expires at Tick 4 unless renewed with a volume commitment of 3 ticks at the cap
Liability	Deferred supplier payment: 6,000 VB to Riverbend Growers Co-op (SU-08) for seed and fertiliser, due Tick 3; the supplier agreement suspends if missed
Memorandum (non-binding)	With the S1 fleet provider: "Vans for perishable runs from the grower network." It records a need, not an obligation. [Print: name the counterparty company. If it is not active this run, print the fallback partner and need line from the dossier.]

Customers and leads

Anchor customer: see the anchor contract above. Open customer cards sit with the Customer desk; visit it to see them.

Leads: Lead 1: "Farm-Box Subscribers", a Consumer card on the Customer desk that wants weekly farm boxes for its members (needs the gate). Lead 2: manufacturing sector, a factory needs bio-materials every tick to keep its line running. Lead 3: transport sector, a fleet operator has vans standing idle.

Suppliers and dependencies

Item	Entry
Critical dependency	S1 Fleet capacity. Fallback: Logistics Provider at standard terms
Other slots you need	S7 payments, S9 analytics, S12 consumer audience
Slots you fill (others need you)	S6 Raw materials and produce
Who you deal with	Sole S6 supplier: the manufacturer depends on it critically, and a consumer brand and a delivery business also buy. Buys S1 (critical), S7, S9 and S12. Shares a certificate queue with the consumer brand.

Item	Entry
Memoranda you may receive as supplier	The S6 memorandum from a manufacturer ("Bio-material batches to keep the line running."); S6 fallback memoranda from a consumer brand or a delivery business whose earlier slots have no active filler.
Gate	Food Safety Certificate, held by Government; opens direct Consumer sales

Every slot has an institution fallback that always works at standard terms. A company filling the slot is usually cheaper or faster; finding out which company fills it is part of the game.

Immediate challenges

Kind	Challenge
Bottleneck	No vans of its own: every batch to a business needs fleet capacity or the Logistics Provider
Weakness	No demand forecasting (Research / Intelligence deficit)
Known risk	6,000 VB due at Tick 3
Known risk	Shares the Food Safety Certificate queue with a consumer brand

Economics, in brief:

- Revenue model. Standing per-tick batch deals with businesses; farm boxes once certified.
- Cost structure. Payroll from 900 to 5,400 VB per tick; baseline resource draw worth 980 VB per tick.
- Unit economics. A batch costs 35 VB of resources at Bank prices against 70 to 95 VB; a farm box costs the same against 300 to 400 VB.
- Fixed versus variable. Fixed: about 6,380 VB per tick from Tick 6. Variable: 1 Materials and 1 Logistics per unit.
- Resource consumption. Materials draws 16 units per tick with the anchor, empty during Tick 7 without purchases; Logistics draws 12, empty during Tick 9. Compute is surplus to sell.
- Talent costs. The Research / Intelligence gap is why it over-harvests.
- Working capital. The 6,000 VB payment at Tick 3 is the earliest cash liability in the city; runway is 8 ticks.

Objectives

Layer	Your target
Survival	Never Distressed for 2 ticks running; solvent at the freeze

Layer	Your target
Revenue	18,000 VB of new revenue by the freeze, not counting the anchor's Ticks 1 to 6
Growth	Hold the Food Safety Certificate and sell farm boxes to a Consumer card.
Strategic (public objective)	Pay the Tick 3 bill on time and sell standing batches to 2 companies.

Your CEO also holds one private objective in a sealed envelope. Each of you holds a personal objective: see the Personal Objective System.

Options on the table

Kind	Opportunity
Obvious	Standing batch deals with the manufacturer and food businesses (S6)
Discoverable	A fleet operator has idle vans (Lead 3, your market fact); a merchant advance against produce contracts could fund the Tick 3 bill
Opportunistic	A weather event that hits other suppliers raises the price of every batch it still holds

Bigger moves your team could make:

- Pivot: from wholesale to farm-to-door, selling straight to households.
- New products: a farm-yield data product for analytics (S9) or dataset (S11) buyers.
- Spin-outs: a cold-chain logistics unit; the farm-yield data product.
- Acquisitions: be acquired by a consumer brand or a delivery company for vertical integration; merge with the manufacturer (materials to finished goods).

What only you know

Item	What you know
Your vantage point	Knows the harvest before anyone else: what will be scarce next tick.
Inside fact	"We over-harvest every week because nobody forecasts demand, and half the surplus is wasted."
Market fact	If the primary S1 fleet operator is active: "The city's fleet operator has vans idle half the day and wants steady buyers." If only the delivery business fills S1: "The city's grocery delivery

Item	What you know
	business sells spare van runs, but needs every van at peak." Otherwise: "The Logistics Provider's priority lane rarely sells out before Tick 5." [Print: keep only the line that matches this run.]
Rumour you heard	"A big supermarket chain is about to sign up every grower in the region."
Something you overheard	"Our growers say the reservoirs are lower than any year they remember."

None of these is labelled true or false. You may share, sell or trade any of them under the Human Internet rules.

Rules that matter most to you

- Same rulebook for every company; only your story and numbers differ.
- Your most likely failure: missing the Tick 3 payment and then payroll; Materials at 0 for 2 ticks (Ticks 7 to 8 without purchases).
- Distressed is triggered by any High or Very High resource at 0 for 2 ticks, unpaid payroll, a missed liability payment past its tick, or fewer than 3 staff.
- Stock thresholds: warning at 30 units; at 15, deliveries using that resource cost 25% more of it; at 0, deliveries stop.
- Any employee may negotiate and propose deals. One signatory or the CEO approves up to 5,000 VB; above that needs the CEO or both signatories.
- Your supplier agreement expires at Tick 4 unless renewed with a volume commitment; your anchor comes up for renewal after Tick 6.
- Before Market Open you may talk, trade information, spend your platform wallet through Trade Slips and agree deals as Proposed. Nothing settles until Tick 1, when the desks enter Trade Slips on the platform.

Sealed inserts (print and hand out separately)

Leadership envelope, to the CEO only (may be shared with the signatories): Partner web. Live contracts with 3 different counterparties on a slot it fills.

Role insert, to every Operations member of staff (not the CEO): Once HarvestLoop holds an S1 contract of 3 or more ticks (with any S1 filler or the Logistics Provider) and the Food Safety Certificate, the GM releases "Portside Export Processors" (CU-26), an Enterprise card wanting 3 produce units per tick with cold delivery for 4 ticks, budget 11,200 VB.

3.9 StackHouse

StackHouse has built its halls and filled half of them: it is the only compute host among the companies, but empty halls still draw power, and it runs short of Energy and Infrastructure around Tick 7.

Who you are

Field	Entry
Archetype and sector	Cloud and data-centre hosting; Digital cluster
Headline story	"Your compute, next door." Local hosting from the city's own data centre.
History	Two infrastructure engineers bet that local businesses would rather rent compute nearby than from a distant giant. The halls were built on a loan that has been repaid; the tenants have been slower to arrive.
Mission	Every business in the city runs on fast, local, affordable compute.
Business model	Sells compute capacity by the tick; profit depends on how full the halls are.
Products	Hosted compute block; dedicated regulated server once licensed.
Target customer	Compute-hungry companies (S3); Enterprise hosting buyers; regulated buyers after licensing.
Market position	The only compute host among the companies; two companies depend on it critically. Competes with the Supplier Market's Compute line.
Technology	Modern racks, an old cooling plant that wastes power
Reputation	Reliable so far; untested at scale

Team

Your CEO is a volunteer who plays this persona card: Dealmaker. Belief: every problem is a deal. Red line: won't walk away from a table. Bias: overcommits.

Your staff: Tech-led mix. Deficit domain: Operations, one person short. Strong engineers; too few people to run the halls. Everyone starts at L0 on 100 VB per tick. Elect 2 Authorised Signatories before Market Open.

Capital and resources

Item	At the start
Cash (platform balance, issued at setup)	29,550 VB (Strategic Adjustment –2,500)

Item	At the start
Notable Asset	Equipment: server halls, book value 8,000 VB
Resources	Platform balance of 100 units of each, issued at setup. Tiers: Compute High, Energy Very High, Logistics Low, Materials Low, Data Medium, Infrastructure Very High
Runway with no new revenue	9 ticks
First resource to run out (no purchases)	Energy and Infrastructure, Tick 7
Personal wallet	1,000 VB each in your platform wallet, yours, not the company's

Products

Field	Hosted compute block	Dedicated regulated server
Buyer gets	10 Compute units	10 Compute units on a dedicated server that counts as compliant hosting in licence evidence
Delivery unit	1 block	1 server-tick
Resource cost per unit	1 Energy, 1 Infrastructure	2 Energy, 1 Infrastructure
Units per tick	6	2
List / floor (VB)	160 / 130	300 / 230
Eligible buyers	Companies (S3); Enterprise cards	Regulated companies (S3); Enterprise cards
Licence	None	Hosting licence for regulated buyers
Beats the fallback by	Price: 16 VB per Compute unit against the Supplier Market's 18 and the Bank's 20	Capacity: no institution sells compliant hosting

Obligations you start with

Obligation	Terms
Anchor contract	Enterprise card "Westbrook Media Group": 2 compute blocks per tick at the Enterprise rate of 400 VB, 800 VB per tick for Ticks 1 to 6 (4,800 VB), then renewal

Obligation	Terms
Supplier agreement	Metro Power (SU-03), Energy: 12 VB per unit (20% below base), up to 20 units per tick; expires at Tick 4 unless renewed with a volume commitment of 3 ticks at the cap
Liability	Compliance gap: the dedicated server cannot be sold to regulated buyers until Government grants a hosting licence (SPV burden 4,500 VB)
Memorandum (non-binding)	With the S4 energy supplier: "Energy for the server halls at contract price." It records a need, not an obligation. [Print: name the counterparty company. If it is not active this run, print the fallback partner and need line from the dossier.]

Customers and leads

Anchor customer: see the anchor contract above. Open customer cards sit with the Customer desk; visit it to see them.

Leads: Lead 1: "Orbit Broadcasting", an Enterprise hosting card on the Customer desk that wants several compute blocks every tick (needs the gate). Lead 2: AI sector, an analytics business burns compute faster than anyone in the city. Lead 3: energy sector, a solar-and-battery firm sells energy by the tick below the market price.

Suppliers and dependencies

Item	Entry
Critical dependency	S4 Energy. Fallback: Bank or Supplier Market (Energy)
Other slots you need	S7 payments, S8 security
Slots you fill (others need you)	S3 Compute hosting
Who you deal with	Sole S3 supplier: an analytics firm and a security firm depend on it critically, and a payments firm and a training business also buy. Buys S4 (critical), S7 and S8. Competes with two other Very High users for scarce Energy.
Memoranda you may receive as supplier	S3 memoranda from an analytics firm ("Hosted compute for model runs, below the market price.") and a security firm ("Hosted compute for the threat-detection engine."); S3 fallback memoranda from a payments firm or a training

Item	Entry
	business whose earlier slots have no active filler.
Gate	3 ticks of unbroken delivery, recorded by the Customer desk; open the Enterprise hosting buyer

Every slot has an institution fallback that always works at standard terms. A company filling the slot is usually cheaper or faster; finding out which company fills it is part of the game.

Immediate challenges

Kind	Challenge
Bottleneck	Energy and Infrastructure both Very High; empty halls still draw them
Weakness	Too few people to run the halls (Operations deficit)
Known risk	Regulated tenants blocked until the hosting licence
Known risk	Discounting to fill halls below its own energy cost

Economics, in brief:

- Revenue model. Per-tick hosting contracts; utilisation is everything.
- Cost structure. Payroll from 900 to 5,400 VB per tick; baseline resource draw worth 1,145 VB per tick, mostly Energy and Infrastructure, whether the halls are full or not.
- Unit economics. A block costs 45 VB of resources at Bank prices against 130 to 160 VB; a server-tick costs 60 VB against 230 to 300 VB.
- Fixed versus variable. Fixed: about 6,545 VB per tick from Tick 6. Variable: 1 Energy and 1 Infrastructure per block.
- Resource consumption. Energy and Infrastructure draw 16 units per tick each with the anchor, empty during Tick 7 without purchases. Logistics and Materials are surplus to sell.
- Talent costs. The Operations gap is the one that breaks delivery; losing another Operations person would hurt twice.
- Working capital. No cash liability falls due; runway is 9 ticks. Energy purchases are the cost that grows.

Objectives

Layer	Your target
Survival	Never Distressed for 2 ticks running; solvent at the freeze
Revenue	18,000 VB of new revenue by the freeze, not

Layer	Your target
	counting the anchor's Ticks 1 to 6
Growth	Reach 3 ticks of unbroken delivery and sign the Enterprise hosting buyer.
Strategic (public objective)	Host 3 tenants at once by Tick 6.

Your CEO also holds one private objective in a sealed envelope. Each of you holds a personal objective: see the Personal Objective System.

Options on the table

Kind	Opportunity
Obvious	Host the compute-hungry companies (S3); clean delivery to the anchor starts the unbroken-delivery count
Discoverable	The energy company needs contracts to show its Bank (your market fact), so it may sell cheap
Opportunistic	A Compute shortage event fills halls at higher prices; a security breach elsewhere sells hosting plus security

Bigger moves your team could make:

- Pivot: from raw capacity to managed hosting bundled with security.
- New products: edge hosting for physical companies.
- Spin-outs: a managed-security unit (bundled with the security provider); an edge-hosting unit.
- Acquisitions: merge with the analytics firm (an AI cloud) or the energy company (a green data centre); acquire the payments firm as a captive tenant.

What only you know

Item	What you know
Your vantage point	Sees how much compute every tenant uses, a fair proxy for how busy they are.
Inside fact	"Half our halls are empty, and every empty hall still draws power."
Market fact	If an S4 company is active: "The city's energy company has a big loan repayment coming and needs contracts it can show its Bank." Otherwise: "The Supplier Market's Energy line gets scarce once heavy users start buying." [Print: keep only

Item	What you know
	the line that matches this run.]
Rumour you heard	"A national cloud giant is opening a data centre in the city next quarter."
Something you overheard	"Our site reliability lead has turned down two promotions and keeps mentioning burnout."

None of these is labelled true or false. You may share, sell or trade any of them under the Human Internet rules.

Rules that matter most to you

- Same rulebook for every company; only your story and numbers differ.
- Your most likely failure: Energy or Infrastructure at 0 for 2 ticks (Ticks 7 to 8 without purchases); missing payroll after Tick 9.
- Distressed is triggered by any High or Very High resource at 0 for 2 ticks, unpaid payroll, a missed liability payment past its tick, or fewer than 3 staff.
- Stock thresholds: warning at 30 units; at 15, deliveries using that resource cost 25% more of it; at 0, deliveries stop.
- Any employee may negotiate and propose deals. One signatory or the CEO approves up to 5,000 VB; above that needs the CEO or both signatories.
- Your supplier agreement expires at Tick 4 unless renewed with a volume commitment; your anchor comes up for renewal after Tick 6.
- Before Market Open you may talk, trade information, spend your platform wallet through Trade Slips and agree deals as Proposed. Nothing settles until Tick 1, when the desks enter Trade Slips on the platform.
- How your gate is judged. Three consecutive ticks with every hosting commitment delivered in full; the anchor counts.

Sealed inserts (print and hand out separately)

Leadership envelope, to the CEO only (may be shared with the signatories): Consolidator. Complete one acquisition or merger, or take a recorded stake in another company.

Role insert, to every Finance / Capital member of staff (not the CEO): Signing an S4 contract of 3 or more ticks at 10 or more Energy units per tick, with any S4 filler or the Supplier Market's Energy line (renewing the T0 agreement with a volume commitment counts), drops Energy from Very High to High (14 to 10 units per tick) for as long as the contract runs.

3.10 Voltway

Voltway has a large electric fleet that sits idle half the day: it is the city's main source of vans and drivers, but its fleet runs on someone else's power and it owes the Bank 8,000 VB at Tick 6.

Who you are

Field	Entry
Archetype and sector	Electric fleet and mobility; Physical cluster
Headline story	"Electric vans and drivers, by the tick." Fleet capacity for any business, and rides for the city once permitted.
History	A former logistics manager bought forty electric vans on a Bank loan, betting businesses would rather rent than own. The morning rush proved her right; the afternoons have not.
Mission	Clean, shared transport so no business in the city needs its own fleet.
Business model	Rents vans with drivers by the tick to businesses; runs consumer rides once permitted.
Products	Fleet capacity block; consumer ride once permitted.
Target customer	Businesses that move goods (S1); Enterprise freight buyers; Consumer riders after the gate.
Market position	The primary fleet supplier: two companies depend on it critically. Competes with a grocery delivery business that also sells spare vans, and buys from it in return.
Technology	Telematics on every van; nobody analyses the data
Reputation	Dependable at peak; invisible the rest of the day

Team

Your CEO is a volunteer who plays this persona card: Growth Maximiser. Belief: customers first, profit later. Red line: won't cut acquisition spend. Bias: overspends on growth.

Your staff: Ops-led mix. Deficit domain: Research / Intelligence, one person short. Drivers and dispatchers; no route or demand intelligence. Everyone starts at L0 on 100 VB per tick. Elect 2 Authorised Signatories before Market Open.

Capital and resources

Item	At the start
Cash (platform balance, issued at setup)	32,050 VB (Strategic Adjustment 0)

Item	At the start
Notable Asset	Equipment: the electric van fleet and its depot, book value 7,000 VB
Resources	Platform balance of 100 units of each, issued at setup. Tiers: Compute Medium, Energy Very High, Logistics High, Materials Medium, Data Medium, Infrastructure Medium
Runway with no new revenue	8 ticks
First resource to run out (no purchases)	Energy, Tick 7
Personal wallet	1,000 VB each in your platform wallet, yours, not the company's

Products

Field	Fleet capacity block	Consumer ride
Buyer gets	6 Logistics units of vans and drivers	A batch of rides for a Consumer customer within the tick
Delivery unit	1 block	1 ride batch
Resource cost per unit	1 Energy, 1 Logistics	1 Energy
Units per tick	5	4
List / floor (VB)	100 / 80	350 / 250
Eligible buyers	Companies (S1); Enterprise cards	Consumer cards
Licence	None	Transport operating permit
Beats the fallback by	Price: about 17 VB per Logistics unit against the Bank's 20; capacity: 5 blocks a tick	n/a

Obligations you start with

Obligation	Terms
Anchor contract	Enterprise card "Dockside Wholesale": 2 fleet blocks per tick at the Enterprise rate of 600 VB, 1,200 VB per tick for Ticks 1 to 6 (7,200 VB), then renewal
Supplier agreement	Metro Power (SU-03), Energy: 13 VB per unit (about 13% below base), up to 15 units per tick;

Obligation	Terms
	expires at Tick 4 unless renewed with a volume commitment of 3 ticks at the cap
Liability	Bank loan: 8,000 VB repayment due at Tick 6 (the vehicle loan)
Memorandum (non-binding)	With the S4 energy supplier: "Energy to charge the van fleet each tick." It records a need, not an obligation. [Print: name the counterparty company. If it is not active this run, print the fallback partner and need line from the dossier.]

Customers and leads

Anchor customer: see the anchor contract above. Open customer cards sit with the Customer desk; visit it to see them.

Leads: Lead 1: "Late-Night Commuters", a Consumer card on the Customer desk that wants rides for its members every tick (needs the gate). Lead 2: agriculture sector, a grower network needs vans for perishable runs. Lead 3: energy sector, a solar-and-battery firm sells energy by the tick below the market price.

Suppliers and dependencies

Item	Entry
Critical dependency	S4 Energy. Fallback: Bank or Supplier Market (Energy)
Other slots you need	S7 payments, S9 analytics
Slots you fill (others need you)	S1 Fleet and delivery capacity (primary filler)
Who you deal with	Primary S1 supplier: a grocery delivery business and a produce supplier depend on it critically, and a manufacturer also buys. Buys S4 (critical), S7 and S9. Rivals the grocery delivery business for S1 buyers while selling to it; competes for scarce Energy with two other Very High users.
Memoranda you may receive as supplier	S1 memoranda from a grocery delivery business ("Peak-hour vans and drivers for grocery runs, from Tick 1.") and a produce supplier ("Vans for perishable runs from the grower network."); an S1 fallback memorandum from a manufacturer with no active S6 filler.
Gate	Transport operating permit, held by Government;

Item	Entry
	opens the consumer ride product

Every slot has an institution fallback that always works at standard terms. A company filling the slot is usually cheaper or faster; finding out which company fills it is part of the game.

Immediate challenges

Kind	Challenge
Bottleneck	Energy at Very High, and every block and ride spends it
Weakness	No route or demand intelligence (Research / Intelligence deficit)
Known risk	The 8,000 VB vehicle loan due at Tick 6
Known risk	A rival sells spare van runs to the same buyers

Economics, in brief:

- Revenue model. Per-tick fleet contracts with businesses; consumer rides after the permit.
- Cost structure. Payroll from 900 to 5,400 VB per tick; baseline resource draw worth 1,040 VB per tick, led by Energy.
- Unit economics. A block costs 35 VB of resources at Bank prices against 80 to 100 VB; a ride batch costs 15 VB against 250 to 350 VB.
- Fixed versus variable. Fixed: about 6,440 VB per tick from Tick 6. Variable: 1 Energy per unit, plus 1 Logistics per block.
- Resource consumption. Energy draws 16 units per tick with the anchor, empty during Tick 7 without purchases; Logistics draws 12, empty during Tick 9.
- Talent costs. The Research / Intelligence gap is why vans sit idle: nobody matches routes to demand.
- Working capital. The 8,000 VB repayment at Tick 6 leaves a runway of 8 ticks.

Objectives

Layer	Your target
Survival	Never Distressed for 2 ticks running; solvent at the freeze
Revenue	18,000 VB of new revenue by the freeze, not counting the anchor's Ticks 1 to 6
Growth	Hold the transport operating permit and sell rides to a Consumer card.
Strategic (public objective)	Sell fleet capacity to 3 companies and repay the

Layer	Your target
	Tick 6 loan on time.

Your CEO also holds one private objective in a sealed envelope. Each of you holds a personal objective: see the Personal Objective System.

Options on the table

Kind	Opportunity
Obvious	Sell fleet blocks to the businesses that move goods (\$1)
Discoverable	The energy company needs contracts to show its Bank (your market fact), so it may sell cheap
Opportunistic	A Logistics surge-pricing event lifts block prices; a distressed physical company's routes can be taken over

Bigger moves your team could make:

- Pivot: from renting vans to selling charging and fleet management.
- New products: fleet-management software built on its telematics.
- Spin-outs: a charging network unit (with the energy supplier); a fleet-management software unit.
- Acquisitions: merge with the energy supplier (energy plus fleet) or the grocery delivery business (one fleet, two customer bases); acquire a distressed physical company's routes.

What only you know

Item	What you know
Your vantage point	Its telematics show where goods move in the city and when.
Inside fact	"Our vans sit idle half the day, and at peak we turn work away."
Market fact	If an S4 company is active: "The city's energy company has a big loan repayment coming and needs contracts it can show its Bank." Otherwise: "The Supplier Market's Energy line gets scarce once heavy users start buying." [Print: keep only the line that matches this run.]
Rumour you heard	"The grocery delivery business is about to buy its own electric fleet."

Item	What you know
Something you overheard	"Our permit officer said Government is reviewing the rules for vans on residential streets."

None of these is labelled true or false. You may share, sell or trade any of them under the Human Internet rules.

Rules that matter most to you

- Same rulebook for every company; only your story and numbers differ.
- Your most likely failure: missing the Tick 6 repayment; Energy at 0 for 2 ticks (Ticks 7 to 8 without purchases).
- Distressed is triggered by any High or Very High resource at 0 for 2 ticks, unpaid payroll, a missed liability payment past its tick, or fewer than 3 staff.
- Stock thresholds: warning at 30 units; at 15, deliveries using that resource cost 25% more of it; at 0, deliveries stop.
- Any employee may negotiate and propose deals. One signatory or the CEO approves up to 5,000 VB; above that needs the CEO or both signatories.
- Your supplier agreement expires at Tick 4 unless renewed with a volume commitment; your anchor comes up for renewal after Tick 6.
- Before Market Open you may talk, trade information, spend your platform wallet through Trade Slips and agree deals as Proposed. Nothing settles until Tick 1, when the desks enter Trade Slips on the platform.

Sealed inserts (print and hand out separately)

Leadership envelope, to the CEO only (may be shared with the signatories): Customer base. Four or more paying contracts live at freeze.

Role insert, to every Operations member of staff (not the CEO): The depot is worth 2 times the fleet-and-depot book value (14,000 VB) to the S4 energy supplier as a charging site: the platform and Investor value it at that figure when the S4 supplier owns it or holds a lease of 3 or more ticks on it, by acquisition, merger or a deal.

3.11 Forgeline

Forgeline is an idle factory with one customer: it is the only manufacturer among the companies and two companies depend on it critically, but its single client is watching to see whether it will survive.

Who you are

Field	Entry
Archetype and sector	Contract manufacturing; Physical cluster
Headline story	"Your product, made here." Manufacturing runs for any business that sells something physical.
History	Took over an old factory when its previous owner

Field	Entry
	left the city. The line works, the machines are old, and the order book has one name in it.
Mission	Bring making back to the city, so local businesses do not ship their ideas away to be built.
Business model	Makes other companies' products by the run; needs steady volume to cover the fixed cost of the line.
Products	Manufacturing run; spare line time.
Target customer	Businesses with physical products (\$5); Enterprise bulk buyers after the gate; new ventures that need prototypes.
Market position	The only manufacturer among the companies. Its two company buyers both name manufacturing as their critical need, which makes it the most exposed supplier in the city if it fails.
Technology	A working line from another era; quality checks by eye
Reputation	Known for solid work by the few who know it exists

Team

Your CEO is a volunteer who plays this persona card: Operator. Belief: systems beat heroics. Red line: won't take orders it can't fulfil. Bias: avoids bold bets.

Your staff: Ops-led mix. Deficit domain: Product / Build, one person short. Skilled line operators; no engineers to adapt the line. Everyone starts at L0 on 100 VB per tick. Elect 2 Authorised Signatories before Market Open.

Capital and resources

Item	At the start
Cash (platform balance, issued at setup)	28,050 VB (Strategic Adjustment -4,000)
Notable Asset	Equipment: the factory line, book value 7,500 VB
Resources	Platform balance of 100 units of each, issued at setup. Tiers: Compute Low, Energy High, Logistics Medium, Materials Very High, Data Low, Infrastructure Medium

Item	At the start
Runway with no new revenue	9 ticks
First resource to run out (no purchases)	Materials, Tick 7
Personal wallet	1,000 VB each in your platform wallet, yours, not the company's

Products

Field	Manufacturing run	Spare line time
Buyer gets	4 finished product units	1 tick of line time: a prototype or a small batch of 2 finished units
Delivery unit	1 run	1 line-tick
Resource cost per unit	2 Materials, 1 Energy (if the buyer supplies the 2 Materials, the price falls by 30 VB)	1 Materials, 1 Energy
Units per tick	3	2
List / floor (VB)	260 / 200	150 / 110
Eligible buyers	Companies (S5); Enterprise bulk-order cards after the gate	Companies, including new ventures
Licence	None	None
Beats the fallback by	Price and speed: about 65 VB per finished unit, made within the tick, against Outsourced Assembly Partners (SU-13): 1,200 VB per batch plus the buyer's own 30 Materials, delivered a tick later	n/a

Obligations you start with

Obligation	Terms
Anchor contract	Enterprise card "Homeware Direct": 1 manufacturing run per tick at the Enterprise rate of 1,100 VB, 1,100 VB per tick for Ticks 1 to 6 (6,600 VB), then renewal
Supplier agreement	Allied Materials Depot (SU-07), Materials: 13 VB per unit (about 13% below base), up to 18 units

Obligation	Terms
	per tick; expires at Tick 4 unless renewed with a volume commitment of 3 ticks at the cap
Liability	Technical debt: old machines consume Energy at +3 units per tick until fixed by a fix mission or a fix bought from another company (SPV burden 4,500 VB)
Memorandum (non-binding)	With the S6 produce supplier: "Bio-material batches to keep the line running." It records a need, not an obligation. [Print: name the counterparty company. If it is not active this run, print the fallback partner and need line from the dossier.]

Customers and leads

Anchor customer: see the anchor contract above. Open customer cards sit with the Customer desk; visit it to see them.

Leads: Lead 1: "Brightline Appliances", an Enterprise card on the Customer desk that wants bulk manufacturing runs every tick (needs the gate). Lead 2: consumer sector, a brand has orders and no factory. Lead 3: agriculture sector, a grower network sells bio-materials by the batch.

Suppliers and dependencies

Item	Entry
Critical dependency	S6 Raw materials and produce. Fallback: Supplier Market (Materials)
Other slots you need	S1 fleet capacity, S4 energy
Slots you fill (others need you)	S5 Manufacturing
Who you deal with	Sole S5 supplier: a consumer brand and an energy company both depend on it critically. Buys S6 (critical), S1 and S4. Competes for Enterprise cards with the compute host, the analytics firm, the security firm and the training business.
Memoranda you may receive as supplier	S5 memoranda from a consumer brand ("Manufacturing runs for our product boxes, every tick from Tick 1.") and an energy company ("Panels and battery units made for the grid build-out.").
Gate	First batch passes inspection, recorded by the

Item	Entry
	Customer desk; opens Enterprise bulk orders

Every slot has an institution fallback that always works at standard terms. A company filling the slot is usually cheaper or faster; finding out which company fills it is part of the game.

Immediate challenges

Kind	Challenge
Bottleneck	Materials at Very High; every run spends it
Weakness	No engineers to adapt the line (Product / Build deficit)
Known risk	One customer: losing it halves the order book
Known risk	Technical debt burns 3 extra Energy every tick

Economics, in brief:

- Revenue model. Runs for company buyers and, after the gate, Enterprise bulk orders; spare line time fills the gaps.
- Cost structure. Payroll from 900 to 5,400 VB per tick; baseline resource draw worth 890 VB per tick, plus 45 VB of technical debt.
- Unit economics. A run costs 45 VB of resources at Bank prices against 200 to 260 VB; line time costs 30 VB against 110 to 150 VB.
- Fixed versus variable. Fixed: about 6,335 VB per tick from Tick 6. Variable: 2 Materials and 1 Energy per run.
- Resource consumption. Materials draws 16 units per tick with the anchor, empty during Tick 7 without purchases; Energy draws 14 (10 + 3 technical debt + 1 anchor), empty during Tick 8. Compute and Data are surplus to sell, the only Low-tier Data in the city.
- Talent costs. The Product / Build gap stops it adapting the line to new products.
- Working capital. No cash liability falls due; runway is 9 ticks, but a lost anchor halves revenue overnight.

Objectives

Layer	Your target
Survival	Never Distressed for 2 ticks running; solvent at the freeze
Revenue	18,000 VB of new revenue by the freeze, not counting the anchor's Ticks 1 to 6
Growth	Pass inspection and sign an Enterprise bulk order.
Strategic (public objective)	Sign 2 company manufacturing contracts by Tick

Layer	Your target
	4.

Your CEO also holds one private objective in a sealed envelope. Each of you holds a personal objective: see the Personal Objective System.

Options on the table

Kind	Opportunity
Obvious	Sell runs to the businesses that cannot make their own products (\$5)
Discoverable	The produce supplier has more bio-material than buyers (your market fact); its Low-tier Data is the scarcest surplus in the city
Opportunistic	New ventures need prototypes; a supply shock elsewhere makes owning a factory strategic

Bigger moves your team could make:

- Pivot: from contract runs to a prototyping studio for the city's new ventures.
- New products: an own-brand product line.
- Spin-outs: a prototyping studio; an own-brand product line.
- Acquisitions: be acquired by the consumer brand or the energy company that depends on it; merge with the produce supplier (materials to finished goods).

What only you know

Item	What you know
Your vantage point	Sees what everyone is planning to make before it reaches the market.
Inside fact	"Our line runs at a third of its capacity, and the machines cost the same to keep warm either way."
Market fact	If an S6 company is active: "The city's produce supplier over-harvests and has more bio-material than buyers." Otherwise: "The Supplier Market's Materials line is among the first to tighten once heavy users start buying." [Print: keep only the line that matches this run.]
Rumour you heard	"An overseas factory is undercutting every contract manufacturer in the region."

Item	What you know
Something you overheard	"Our anchor's buyer keeps asking whether we have any other clients, as if checking we'll survive."

None of these is labelled true or false. You may share, sell or trade any of them under the Human Internet rules.

Rules that matter most to you

- Same rulebook for every company; only your story and numbers differ.
- Your most likely failure: Materials at 0 for 2 ticks (Ticks 7 to 8 without purchases); payroll after Tick 9 with the line idle.
- Distressed is triggered by any High or Very High resource at 0 for 2 ticks, unpaid payroll, a missed liability payment past its tick, or fewer than 3 staff.
- Stock thresholds: warning at 30 units; at 15, deliveries using that resource cost 25% more of it; at 0, deliveries stop.
- Any employee may negotiate and propose deals. One signatory or the CEO approves up to 5,000 VB; above that needs the CEO or both signatories.
- Your supplier agreement expires at Tick 4 unless renewed with a volume commitment; your anchor comes up for renewal after Tick 6.
- Before Market Open you may talk, trade information, spend your platform wallet through Trade Slips and agree deals as Proposed. Nothing settles until Tick 1, when the desks enter Trade Slips on the platform.
- How your gate is judged. A batch passes inspection when a manufacturing run for any buyer other than the anchor is delivered in full, on the tick promised, and checked by the Customer desk.

Sealed inserts (print and hand out separately)

Leadership envelope, to the CEO only (may be shared with the signatories): Enterprise reach. Two new Enterprise customer cards signed.

Role insert, to every Growth / Sales member of staff (not the CEO): Every contract with another company pays a 25% premium, credited by the platform at settlement; capped at 15,000 VB over the run.

3.12 TrustLayer

TrustLayer sells prevention before anyone has been hit: it is the only security provider among the companies and two regulated companies depend on it, but its attestations count for nothing until Government approves it as an auditor.

Who you are

Field	Entry
Archetype and sector	Cybersecurity and compliance software; Digital

Field	Entry
	and Regulated clusters
Headline story	"The breach that never happened." Security monitoring, audits and compliance attestations for the city's businesses.
History	Founded by two former incident responders who were tired of arriving after the damage. The engine is good; selling a loss that has not happened yet is slow.
Mission	Every business in the city secure enough to be trusted with other people's money and data.
Business model	Monitoring sold by the tick; one-off audits; compliance attestations once approved as an auditor.
Products	Security monitoring; compliance audit and attestation.
Target customer	Regulated and data-heavy companies (S8); regulated Enterprise buyers.
Market position	The only security provider among the companies; a payments firm and a health marketplace depend on it critically. Competes with Government's own licence route.
Technology	A threat-detection engine that is better than anything else in the city
Reputation	Respected by engineers; seen by buyers as a cost

Team

Your CEO is a volunteer who plays this persona card: Risk Guardian. Belief: evidence before money. Red line: no credit without proof. Bias: misses fast opportunities.

Your staff: Tech-led mix. Deficit domain: Brand / Community, one person short. Strong analysts; no one to make the case for prevention. Everyone starts at L0 on 100 VB per tick. Elect 2 Authorised Signatories before Market Open.

Capital and resources

Item	At the start
Cash (platform balance, issued at setup)	31,050 VB (Strategic Adjustment –1,000)

Item	At the start
Notable Asset	IP: the threat-detection engine, book value 6,000 VB
Resources	Platform balance of 100 units of each, issued at setup. Tiers: Compute High, Energy Low, Logistics Low, Materials Low, Data Very High, Infrastructure Medium
Runway with no new revenue	9 ticks
First resource to run out (no purchases)	Data, Tick 7
Personal wallet	1,000 VB each in your platform wallet, yours, not the company's

Products

Field	Security monitoring	Compliance audit and attestation
Buyer gets	One tick of monitoring: counts as S8 cover for that tick, and meets any customer card that names security as a must-have	One audit of the buyer's systems; once TrustLayer is an Approved Auditor, it comes with an attestation that counts as the security evidence in a Government licence application
Delivery unit	1 monitoring unit (one client, one tick)	1 audit
Resource cost per unit	1 Data, 1 Compute	2 Data, 1 Compute
Units per tick	5	1
List / floor (VB)	200 / 150	800 / 600
Eligible buyers	Companies (S8); Enterprise cards	Companies (S8); Enterprise cards
Licence	None	Approved Auditor status for the attestation
Beats the fallback by	Capacity: Government's route grants licences but gives no cover	Speed: an attestation skips Government's own security review (GV-L10: 1,500 VB and 2 ticks); Government still issues the licence

Obligations you start with

Obligation	Terms
Anchor contract	Enterprise card "Civic Insurance Mutual": 1 monitoring unit per tick at the Enterprise rate of 900 VB, 900 VB per tick for Ticks 1 to 6 (5,400 VB), then renewal
Supplier agreement	OpenData Exchange (SU-09), Data: 22 VB per unit (12% below base), up to 12 units per tick; expires at Tick 4 unless renewed with a volume commitment of 3 ticks at the cap
Liability	Key-person risk: the lead auditor (Product / Build) leaves at Tick 6 unless a retention deal is recorded first (SPV burden 5,000 VB)
Memorandum (non-binding)	With the S3 compute host: "Hosted compute for the threat-detection engine." It records a need, not an obligation. [Print: name the counterparty company. If it is not active this run, print the fallback partner and need line from the dossier.]

Customers and leads

Anchor customer: see the anchor contract above. Open customer cards sit with the Customer desk; visit it to see them.

Leads: Lead 1: "Pinecrest Clinics", an Enterprise card on the Customer desk that wants monitoring and a compliance attestation (needs the gate). Lead 2: fintech sector, a payments firm needs security cover before it can be licensed. Lead 3: hosting sector, the city's data centre has idle capacity.

Suppliers and dependencies

Item	Entry
Critical dependency	S3 Compute hosting. Fallback: Supplier Market (Compute)
Other slots you need	S10 trained talent, S11 verified datasets
Slots you fill (others need you)	S8 Security and compliance
Who you deal with	Sole S8 supplier: a payments firm and a health marketplace depend on it critically, and an analytics firm and a compute host also buy. Buys S3 (critical), S10 and S11. Competes with Government's own route, and for scarce Data with three other Very High users.

Item	Entry
Memoranda you may receive as supplier	S8 memoranda from a payments firm ("Security monitoring and an audit that counts toward the payments licence.") and a health marketplace ("Security cover and an attestation to close the data compliance gap."); S8 fallback memoranda from a compute host or an analytics firm whose earlier slots have no active filler.
Gate	Approved Auditor status, held by Government; lets its attestations count in licence applications

Every slot has an institution fallback that always works at standard terms. A company filling the slot is usually cheaper or faster; finding out which company fills it is part of the game.

Immediate challenges

Kind	Challenge
Bottleneck	Data at Very High, and audits spend twice as much of it
Weakness	Nobody to sell prevention (Brand / Community deficit)
Known risk	Attestations do not count until it is an Approved Auditor
Known risk	Lead auditor leaves at Tick 6 without a retention deal

Economics, in brief:

- Revenue model. Monitoring by the tick, the recurring base; audits and attestations, the high-value one-offs.
- Cost structure. Payroll from 900 to 5,400 VB per tick; baseline resource draw worth 960 VB per tick, led by Data.
- Unit economics. A monitoring unit costs 45 VB of resources at Bank prices against 150 to 200 VB; an audit costs 70 VB against 600 to 800 VB.
- Fixed versus variable. Fixed: about 6,360 VB per tick from Tick 6. Variable: Data and Compute per unit.
- Resource consumption. Data draws 15 units per tick with the anchor, empty during Tick 7 without purchases; Compute draws 11, empty during Tick 10. Energy, Logistics and Materials are surplus to sell.
- Talent costs. The Brand / Community gap is why prevention does not sell; the lead auditor's retention deal is due by Tick 6.
- Working capital. No cash liability falls due; runway is 9 ticks.

Objectives

Layer	Your target
Survival	Never Distressed for 2 ticks running; solvent at the freeze
Revenue	18,000 VB of new revenue by the freeze, not counting the anchor's Ticks 1 to 6
Growth	Become an Approved Auditor and issue one attestation.
Strategic (public objective)	Provide security cover to 2 regulated companies by Tick 6.

Your CEO also holds one private objective in a sealed envelope. Each of you holds a personal objective: see the Personal Objective System.

Options on the table

Kind	Opportunity
Obvious	Monitoring for the regulated companies that need cover before they can be licensed
Discoverable	The data centre has idle halls (your market fact, Lead 3); a payments firm cannot be licensed without security (Lead 2)
Opportunistic	Any breach event in the city turns prevention into an urgent purchase

Bigger moves your team could make:

- Pivot: from security tools to compliance-as-a-service, where the attestation is the product.
- New products: a fraud-detection service for payment businesses.
- Spin-outs: a security training unit (with the training business); a fraud-detection unit sold to the payments firm.
- Acquisitions: merge with the payments firm (secure payments) or the compute host (secure hosting); take on the health marketplace's compliance team if it fails.

What only you know

Item	What you know
Your vantage point	Sees attacks against its clients before anyone else, and which companies are exposed.
Inside fact	"Our engine caught three intrusions at our anchor client last quarter, and nobody outside

Item	What you know
	knows."
Market fact	If an S3 company is active: "The city's compute host has half its halls empty and would rather sell cheap than sit idle." Otherwise: "The Supplier Market's Compute line sells out fast once heavy users start buying." [Print: keep only the line that matches this run.]
Rumour you heard	"A major breach is coming; someone in the city has already been hit."
Something you overheard	"One of our monitored clients ignored our last three patch warnings."

None of these is labelled true or false. You may share, sell or trade any of them under the Human Internet rules.

Rules that matter most to you

- Same rulebook for every company; only your story and numbers differ.
- Your most likely failure: Data at 0 for 2 ticks (Ticks 7 to 8 without purchases); missing payroll after Tick 9.
- Distressed is triggered by any High or Very High resource at 0 for 2 ticks, unpaid payroll, a missed liability payment past its tick, or fewer than 3 staff.
- Stock thresholds: warning at 30 units; at 15, deliveries using that resource cost 25% more of it; at 0, deliveries stop.
- Any employee may negotiate and propose deals. One signatory or the CEO approves up to 5,000 VB; above that needs the CEO or both signatories.
- Your supplier agreement expires at Tick 4 unless renewed with a volume commitment; your anchor comes up for renewal after Tick 6.
- Before Market Open you may talk, trade information, spend your platform wallet through Trade Slips and agree deals as Proposed. Nothing settles until Tick 1, when the desks enter Trade Slips on the platform.
- Attestations use Government's standard licence process; Approved Auditor status only changes whose evidence Government accepts.

Sealed inserts (print and hand out separately)

Leadership envelope, to the CEO only (may be shared with the signatories): Licence first. Hold Approved Auditor status by the end of Tick 6.

Role insert, to every Research / Intelligence member of staff (not the CEO): After 2 clean audits (audits of clients that suffer no data-breach event within 2 ticks), the GM releases "Northgate Savings Bank" (CU-27), a regulated Enterprise card worth 12,000 VB over 4 ticks for monitoring and attestations.

4. Participant Role Cards

There are 9 cards: one for each of the 7 role domains every dossier staffs, plus the CEO card (for the volunteer) and the Authorised Signatory card (an add-on two participants hold on top of their domain card). The same card is used in all 12 companies; the passport supplies the company-specific facts.

The brief's role list maps onto the dossiers' domains as follows. The dossiers, Starting World 5.3 and the talent rules all count seats by domain, so a separate Engineering or Marketing card would have no seat, salary track or Workforce Credit of its own.

Role named in the draft	Card	Domain as the platform records it
CEO	CEO	Volunteer, not a domain
Product, Engineering	Product / Build	Product / Build
Sales, Partnerships	Growth / Sales	Growth / Sales
Marketing, Communications	Brand / Community	Brand / Community
Operations	Operations	Operations
Finance	Finance / Capital	Finance / Capital
Research	Research / Intelligence	Research / Intelligence
Generalist, coordinator	Generalist / Founder	Generalist / Founder
Signatory	Authorised Signatory (add-on)	Kept in the participant's own domain

4.0 What every participant's card has in common

Authority on the platform is the same for every employee, whatever the card. The card says what your team looks to you for; it never stops you acting outside it.

- Anyone can discover, negotiate, propose a deal and claim a mission for the company. Deals settle once a signatory (or the CEO) approves; you get registry credit for deals you negotiate whether or not you sign.
- You start at L0 on 100 VB per tick and gain one level per tick in your domain from Tick 1. A Tier 2 or 3 mission tagged with your domain adds one extra level, at most once every 2 ticks. Moving to another domain halves your level.
- You hold a 1,000 VB personal wallet (a platform balance, shown in your Participant Portal), one personal information card and one personal objective. They are yours and leave with you.
- You may take an offer from any company. The move happens at the next tick boundary, your employer may counteroffer first, and a 2-tick cooldown follows. Nobody can be fired; you may resign into Free Agent status.
- Product floors bind: nothing may be sold below a Product Card's floor price.

- If your company's dossier gives a hidden lever to your domain, you receive a sealed Role insert at orientation, and the platform shows it to your domain's staff only. It is yours to use or share.

4.1 CEO

Field	Entry
Who holds it	One volunteer per active company. Not a participant: cannot be hired away and does not join the Talent Exchange.
What you know	The whole passport, your persona card and the sealed Leadership envelope (the private objective).
What you can do	Set strategy; make hiring decisions; own the company's relationships. Approve any commitment alone, including those over 5,000 VB. Vote the Founding Holder's 800 shares with the two signatories, by majority of the three.
What you control	Direction and the persona: one belief, one red line, one bias, played consistently. The persona belongs to the company; a replacement volunteer picks up the same card.
What you're responsible for	Keeping the company coherent while leaving staff room to lead: the Founder Ledger watches participants, not you. Never giving rules rulings; send rule questions to the GM.
Information you have	Company and Company leadership classes. You may show the Leadership envelope to the signatories.
What you do not get	A Role insert (it goes to staff in the named domain, by design), a salary track or a personal objective.
Personal objectives	None for the volunteer; the persona card and private objective take their place.

4.2 Authorised Signatory (add-on)

Field	Entry
Who holds it	Two participants, elected by their company's staff during orientation. If one leaves, staff elect a replacement at the next tick. Keep your domain

Field	Entry
	card as well.
What you know	Everything on your domain card. The Leadership envelope, if the CEO shows it to you.
What you can do	Approve commitments up to 5,000 VB alone; approve larger ones together with the other signatory. Bid at auction, or give an employee a bid mandate (named lots, a maximum, one session). Vote the Founding Holder's shares with the CEO. Approve option grants and retention bonuses at the same thresholds as cash.
What you control	Whether the company's proposed deals settle.
What you're responsible for	Approving quickly so deals do not stall; checking each commitment against cash and runway; refusing self-dealing unless both signatories (or the CEO and one signatory) agree. If the CEO leaves the city, the two signatories run the company jointly.
Information you have	Company class, plus Company leadership if shared.
Personal objectives	See the Personal Objective System.

4.3 Product / Build

Covers product, engineering, prototyping and implementation.

Field	Entry
What you know	Your Product Cards line by line: what the buyer gets, resource cost per unit, units per tick, list and floor, licence. Your technology, any technical debt, and how your gate is judged.
What you can do	Plan production and deliveries each tick. Propose capacity upgrades (+5 units per tick for 1,500 VB and 10 Infrastructure, at most 2 per product). Claim fix missions or buy a fix to clear technical debt. Propose an efficiency project (a Tier 3 efficiency mission, or 3,000 VB and 30 Infrastructure) to drop one resource a tier, once per run. Design new products or variants and apply to the GM for a new Product Card. Build

Field	Entry
	the prototype a pilot, inspection or new venture needs.
What you control	The delivery plan: what gets made, for whom, and which resource units it spends.
What you're responsible for	Every contracted delivery made in full and on the tick promised, starting with the anchor. Your company's Reliability Record (contracts fulfilled and breached) is mostly your work.
Information you have	Product Cards, resource stock on the dashboard, the delivery log and the Reliability Record.
Watch for	At 15 units of a resource, deliveries using it cost 25% more of it; at 0, they stop.
Personal objectives	See the Personal Objective System.

4.4 Growth / Sales

Covers sales, partnerships, growth and customer acquisition.

Field	Entry
What you know	The anchor contract and when it renews, Leads 1 to 3, your list and floor prices, which buyers each product can serve, and which slots your company fills for others.
What you can do	Visit the Customer desk to see open customer cards. Negotiate and propose sales on Deal Sheets, at or above floor. Sign other companies up on the slots you fill. Post asks on the Market Board. Renew the anchor after Tick 6. Claim Company and Cross-company missions.
What you control	The pipeline: which buyers you chase and what you offer them, inside the list and floor.
What you're responsible for	New revenue: the shared target is 18,000 VB by the freeze, not counting the anchor's first 6 ticks. Customer count and Enterprise cards matter for several private objectives.
Information you have	Leads, open cards you have seen at the desk, the Market Board and the published sector demand

Field	Entry
	indices.
Personal objectives	See the Personal Objective System.

4.5 Brand / Community

Covers marketing, content, community and communications.

Field	Entry
What you know	The company's headline story, mission and reputation, and its public Reliability Record.
What you can do	Buy featured stories and coverage from Media. Plant a labelled rumour through Media, and answer corrections if one is debunked. Pitch the company to Consumer cards and to the community holders. Write the company's role postings on the Talent Exchange board. Build the story the company tells at Investor Day.
What you control	The company's public voice: what it announces and how it answers what others say about it.
What you're responsible for	Reputation and attention; recruiting and keeping people; making sure a public claim never outruns what the company can deliver.
Information you have	Media's public channel, other companies' public profiles and Reliability Records, and whatever your community or audience tells you.
Personal objectives	See the Personal Objective System.

4.6 Operations

Covers supply, logistics, fulfilment and process.

Field	Entry
What you know	Your six resource tiers, what you draw each tick, when each resource runs out, the supplier agreement's terms and Tick 4 expiry, and your critical dependency with its institution fallback.
What you can do	Buy from the Bank (up to 30 units of a resource per tick; its price rises as its stock falls), the Supplier Market (minimum 20 units, paid up

Field	Entry
	front) and the Logistics Provider (standard next tick, or priority now at 1.5 times base). Renew the supplier agreement with a volume commitment before Tick 4. Sign supply contracts with the companies that fill your slots. Sell surplus: Bank buy-back at 60% of base, or the Market Board.
What you control	Stock levels and the purchasing plan, within the 200-unit storage cap per resource.
What you're responsible for	No High or Very High resource at 0 for 2 ticks, the most common way a company becomes Distressed. Keeping deliveries supplied.
Information you have	Dashboard stock and warnings at 30 units, the Bank price table, Supplier Market capacity and Logistics surge notices.
Personal objectives	See the Personal Objective System.

4.7 Finance / Capital

Covers finance, pricing, fundraising and unit economics.

Field	Entry
What you know	Cash, runway, the liability and its due tick, the payroll ladder (about 900 VB at Tick 1 rising to 5,400 VB per tick for 9 staff), and the unit economics on your passport.
What you can do	Arrange Bank loans and refinancing, merchant advances and Government grants in their window. Prepare the case for the Investor fund when the capital window opens. Price deals against cost. Propose option grants from the 200-share pool and retention bonuses. Advise the signatories on every commitment over 5,000 VB.
What you control	The cash plan: what the company can afford, and when.
What you're responsible for	Payroll every tick and every liability paid on its tick, so the company never builds arrears. The numbers behind the company's valuation at Investor Day.

Field	Entry
Information you have	The company cash ledger, Reference Valuation, Workforce Credit, the cap table, and Bank and Investor terms.
Personal objectives	See the Personal Objective System.

4.8 Research / Intelligence

Covers market research, competitive intelligence and customer discovery.

Field	Entry
What you know	The passport's vantage point, inside fact, market fact, rumour and overheard clue, and your personal information card. None is labelled true or false.
What you can do	Run the company's Human Internet: buy, sell, swap and verify information cards (corroborate with a second independent card, ask the owning desk, or pay Media 250 VB for a fact check). Register as a broker. Find out which companies fill the slots you need. Claim Research missions that take an artefact as evidence. Hunt opportunities at the desks.
What you control	The company's information book: what it buys, shares and sells, and how sure it is of each item.
What you're responsible for	Naming the company that fills your critical dependency before Market Open; grading what the team hears before it acts on it.
Information you have	Your cards and the company's, the Tick 7 Data Drop, and open-net search once the Internet Unlocks at Tick 8.
Personal objectives	See the Personal Objective System.

4.9 Generalist / Founder

Covers cross-functional execution, coordination and problem solving.

Field	Entry
What you know	The whole passport, with an eye on dates: the Tick 3 to 7 payments, the Tick 4 supplier expiry

Field	Entry
	and the post-Tick 6 anchor renewal.
What you can do	Step into any gap, including the deficit domain's work, while recruiting fills it. Run the team's tick routine. Lead a Crisis-response mission. Take Founder missions once the Founder Window opens, and form or join a new venture (3 or more participants and 10,000 VB on the shared charter).
What you control	The team's to-do list for each tick.
What you're responsible for	Nothing falling between domains: deadlines met, deals recorded, approvals obtained.
Information you have	Company class, plus Founder Window notices when the GM opens it.
Personal objectives	See the Personal Objective System.

5. Handing out cards, and open items

Role cards follow the domain each participant is assigned at registration (Starting World 5.2); passports and inserts are handed out at the company station during orientation, in this order.

1. Each participant gets the company passport with their domain's role card on top.
2. The CEO volunteer gets a passport, the CEO card and the sealed Leadership envelope.
3. Staff elect two Authorised Signatories; each gets the add-on card.
4. Every participant in the domain the dossier names gets the sealed Role insert.

Which domain receives the Role insert, by company:

Domain	Companies whose Role insert goes to it
Operations	SwiftCart, GreenGrid, HarvestLoop, Voltway
Research / Intelligence	PulseAI, MediLink, TrustLayer
Finance / Capital	Ledgerly, StackHouse
Growth / Sales	SkillForge, Forgeline
Brand / Community	Mango & Co.
Product / Build, Generalist / Founder	None

Default I picked: if nobody holds the named domain at registration close (possible in a very small company), the GM keeps the insert and hands it to the first person to join that domain. That turns the gap into one more reason to recruit, and never gives the insert to the CEO.

Open items and hand-offs:

- ☐ Personal Objective System: fill the "Personal objectives" field on every role card.
- ☐ Company Dossiers: TrustLayer's economics line "The hidden risk is a warranty payout, not a bill" points at its GM-only vulnerability while tagged [Company]. The passport drops the sentence; the dossier should too.
- ☐ Company Dossiers: PulseAI's pilot rule names "Coastline Freight (CU-09, Lead 2)", which turns a signal-only lead into a named one. The passport drops the name.
- ☐ Event Operations Manual or GM Handbook: add the print step that resolves each [Print: ...] note from the active set and prints recomputed cash and runway after registration closes.

Venture City — Core Game Systems

Oct 5, 2026 · @Nero Kami

1. Purpose, scope and shared conventions

This document is the rulebook for Venture City's economy: eight systems (missions, opportunities, deals, talent, resources, capital, M&A and auctions) specified so that the platform can enforce them and a volunteer can run them without inventing a rule. Every rule here applies identically to every company in every run (Starting World, section 2.1). Company content (stories, products, numbers inside bands) belongs in the dossiers; it plugs into these rules as parameters and never changes them.

What this document inherits and does not redesign. The six resources, Venture Bucks as money rather than score, the 30-minute tick, the salary ladder, the institution roster and behaviour, the core player loop, Bank base prices, loan bands, the Investor fund formula, the spin-out charter, the mission, opportunity and auction libraries (M01–M50, O01–O20, A01–A10) and every T0 quantity in Starting World sections 6 to 12. The Technology draft's state machines are adopted as the canonical states for each object.

What this document adds. Concrete operating rules for each system, the settlement order inside a tick, one evidence standard used by every system, a reference valuation formula, equity and cap tables, a free-agent rule, and the money sources and sinks that keep the economy from inflating.

Numbers. Every VB amount, rate, cap and window below is a proposed starting parameter for playtesting. Section 10.2 lists the ones to tune first. The structure is meant to be fixed; the numbers are meant to move.

The platform is the record. The event runs entirely on the venue-hosted web platform. There are no physical VB notes or resource tokens: every balance, transfer, Bank purchase or buy-back, mission payout and auction payment exists only as a platform journal entry, and paper forms are used only as a fallback if the platform is down, reconciled into the journal afterwards.

1.1 The tick: settlement order

At each 30-minute tick the platform freezes new transactions for about two minutes and settles in this fixed order. The order matters: revenue lands before costs, so a company that sells in a tick can pay for it.

1. **Freeze.** New deals, bids and claims are queued, not lost.
2. **Recurring contracts.** Per-tick deliveries and payments under Active contracts settle (section 4.4).
3. **Production.** Supply products convert inputs into resource units (section 6.2).
4. **Salaries.** Each employee's agreed salary moves from company cash to their personal wallet.
5. **Baseline consumption.** Each company is charged its tier rate for all six resources (Starting World 6.4).
6. **Debt service.** Loan instalments and interest are debited (section 7.3).
7. **Workforce.** Levels rise, deficit charges post, Workforce Credit recalculates (section 5).
8. **Lifecycle check.** Distress, recovery and failure conditions are tested (section 8.6).

9. **Missions and opportunities.** Deadlines resolve, expired items close, boards refill (sections 2 and 3).
10. **Market update.** Bank restocks, price indices and talent indices update (sections 5.6 and 6.5).
11. **Scheduled releases.** GM events, information and auctions due this tick are published.
12. **Reopen.** Queued actions process in the order they arrived.

If a step cannot be paid in full, the shortfall is recorded as arrears against that company and the next steps still run. Section 8.6 says what arrears trigger.

1.2 Who can commit a company

The authority rules from Starting World 5.4 apply to every system in this document.

Action	Who can do it
Discover, negotiate, propose a deal, claim a mission	Any employee
Approve a commitment up to 5,000 VB (cash or equivalent value)	One Authorised Signatory or the CEO
Approve a commitment over 5,000 VB	The CEO, or both signatories
Bid at auction	A signatory, or an employee holding a bid mandate (section 9.3)
Sell the company, merge, issue new shares, spin out a product line	Shareholder approval (section 7.5)

An employee who negotiates a deal gets credit for it in the registry and the Founder Ledger whether or not they hold signing authority.

1.3 One evidence standard

Missions, contracts, opportunities, loans and investments all accept the same five classes of evidence, so a volunteer judges proof the same way at every desk.

Class	What counts	Who confirms	Typical use
E1 Registry record	A deal, transfer or contract already recorded on the platform	Platform, automatically	Sales, supplier deals, hires
E2 Counterparty confirmation	The other party confirms on the platform (scan or code)	The counterparty	Introductions, commitments, interviews
E3 Institution validation	An institution desk approves the outcome	The desk volunteer	Licences, pilots, credit reviews

Class	What counts	Who confirms	Typical use
E4 Observer or GM validation	A GM or observer witnessed the outcome	GM or observer	Demonstrations, Founder Test
E5 Artefact	A submitted document or record (map, comparison, feedback summary)	The desk named on the item	Research missions, diligence

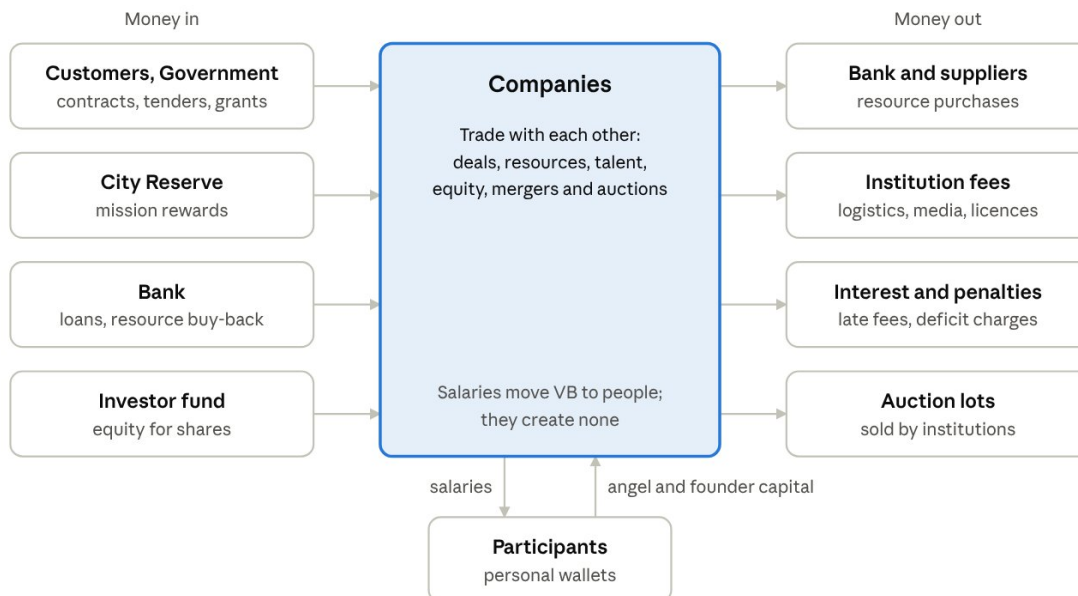
Three rules apply to all evidence:

- **Independence.** A counterparty must be a different company, an institution or an unaffiliated participant. Staff of the same company cannot confirm each other.
- **Freshness.** Evidence must be created after the claim, deal or application it supports.
- **Single use.** One piece of evidence satisfies one mission or condition per company. A single counterparty can confirm at most two items for the same company per tick.

1.4 Where money comes from and where it goes

VB enters companies through customers, missions, loans, investment and asset sales, and leaves through the Bank, institutions, interest and penalties. Salaries move VB from companies to people; they do not create or destroy it.

Customers, missions and capital bring VB in; resources and fees take it out



VB sources and sinks - 4 in, 4 out

The **City Reserve** is a GM-held ledger account that pays mission rewards and receives institution income, so the GM can see the net money supply at every tick. Its mission budget is set in section 2.5.

1.5 The Reliability Record

Every company carries one public statistic on its profile: contracts fulfilled, contracts breached and payments missed, counted by the platform. It is the only reputation mechanic in the game. It is a record of what happened, never a score someone awards, and the Bank, Investor and Customer desks are expected to read it.

1.6 Settling the free-agent question

Starting World 13.3 left one conflict open: the 26-phase draft forbids resigning into unemployment and firing, while the Game Engine allows a free-agent state. This document settles it as follows.

- **Companies cannot fire anyone.** They can only agree a mutual release, recorded like any deal.
- **Participants can resign into Free Agent status.** A free agent earns no salary, keeps their personal wallet, and has their level frozen. They can freelance, join any company, or join a founding team.
- **Failure, release and acquisition refusals also produce free agents** (sections 7 and 8).

This keeps the 26-phase draft's intent (nobody is pushed out, and leaving has a cost) while allowing the Game Engine's freelance and founder routes, which the spin-out mechanics depend on.

2. Missions

A mission is a defined challenge with a defined reward: it turns an action that creates evidence into access, resources or money. Missions come from one shared library (M01 to M50), carry tags instead of company names, and are activated by formula, so the same library works for any active set.

2.1 The mission card

Every mission is stored as a card with the same fields.

Field	Meaning
ID and title	Library reference (M01–M50, plus any added later)
Category	One of the eight categories in 2.2
Tier	1, 2 or 3, which sets the reward band and deadlines (2.3)
Objective	What must be true at the end, in one sentence
Constraints	What is not allowed (for example, "not with your own supplier")
Evidence required	One or more evidence classes from section 1.3
Completion mode	Exclusive, Race (first k) or Open (2.4)
Eligibility	Who may claim: any participant, any company, a

Field	Meaning
	tag, a state (for example, Distressed only)
Tags	Sector, resource, constraint and dependency-slot tags used to match missions to companies
Window and deadline	How long it stays Available; how long a claimant has to finish
Reward and recipient	What is released on verification and to whom (company or personal wallet)
Human Internet flag	Whether it can only be completed without internet
Visibility	Public board, company, personal or hidden (Starting World 10.2)

2.2 Categories

Category	Who claims	Reward goes to	Example from the library
Individual	One participant	Personal wallet, or a personal access token	M17 Five Conversations
Company	Any employee, for their company	Company	M03 Energy Deal
Cross-company	One company, needing a second company's participation	Split as recorded at claim; default 50/50	M35 Cross-Company Product
Institution	A company, validated at a named desk	Company	M39 Debt Readiness
Market	Anyone; the first to complete wins	Claimant's company, or wallet if a free agent	M28 Arbitrage
Hidden	Whoever unlocks it through a card, desk or opportunity	As stated on the card	M46 Scarcity Scout
Crisis-response	Companies affected by a live crisis	Company, plus protection from the crisis effect	M47 Crisis Supplier
Founder	Individual participants during the Founder	Personal, usually an opportunity card	M50 Founder Test

Category	Who claims	Reward goes to	Example from the library
	Window		

2.3 Difficulty tiers and rewards

Tier sets the effort expected, the reward band and the deadlines. Rewards unlock something useful rather than adding points.

Tier	What it takes	Reward band (one of)	Available for	Deadline after claim
1 Quick	One action with one counterparty	5–10 resource units; 250–500 VB; a minor access token	2 ticks	1 tick
2 Standard	Two steps or two parties	15–25 units; 750–1,500 VB; an introduction, discount or priority slot	2 ticks	2 ticks
3 Strategic	Several parties or an institution decision	25–50 units; 2,000–3,000 VB; a strategic unlock (credit eligibility, tender access, opportunity card)	3 ticks	2 ticks
Crisis	Defined by the crisis	Tier 2 band plus exemption from that crisis's effect	Until the crisis deadline	Crisis deadline

Rescaling the library. Several library rewards are written in single or double-digit VB (M07 "5 VB", M16 "10 VB", M28 "15 VB profit cap", M35 "20 VB"). Against a 100 VB salary these are too small to notice. Each library mission takes the band of its tier instead: M07 becomes 10 Logistics plus 250 VB, M28's cap becomes 750 VB, and so on. The mission content does not change.

Access tokens (priority slots, discounts, introductions) are platform records with an expiry, default 2 ticks. They are not transferable unless the card says so.

Level acceleration. Completing a Tier 2 or 3 mission whose tags match your role domain adds one extra level at the next tick, at most once every 2 ticks per participant (section 5.2).

2.4 Completion modes

Mode	How it works	Default for
Exclusive	One claimant holds it; nobody else can claim while it is active	Company first missions; Hidden missions
Race (first k)	Anyone eligible can claim; the first k verified completions are rewarded; the rest are told it closed	Public board missions, k = 2
Open	Every eligible claimant can complete it once	Individual and Founder missions

2.5 Lifecycle and claiming

Missions use the Technology draft's state machine, with a Locked state added in front from the 26-phase draft.

State	Meaning	Moves to
Locked	Loaded but not yet activated	Available
Available	Visible to eligible players and open to claim	Claimed, Expired
Claimed / In progress	A claimant is working on it; the deadline clock runs	Submitted, Failed (deadline passed), Abandoned
Submitted	Evidence lodged	Verified, Returned (evidence insufficient; once only)
Verified	Desk, GM or platform accepted the evidence	Completed (reward released)
Expired	Window closed with no completion	Back to the library reserve

Claiming rules:

- A participant may hold at most **2 active claims**. A company may hold at most **3 active company or cross-company claims**.
- Abandoning releases the mission to others. The abandoner cannot reclaim the same mission, and a participant who abandons twice cannot claim for 1 tick.
- Failing a mission costs nothing except for Crisis missions, whose cost is the crisis effect itself.
- E1 evidence verifies automatically. Other submissions are verified within 10 minutes or escalate to the GM, so desks do not become queues.
- A deal created only to satisfy a mission and reversed within the next tick voids the reward, and the platform reclaims it.

Reward budget. Mission rewards are paid from the City Reserve, not from the Bank's stock. The Reserve holds $15 \times N$ units of each resource at T0, and its mission budget is $600 \times N$ VB-equivalent per tick (4,200 VB at $N = 7$), with unspent budget carried forward. If a tick's budget runs out, newly verified rewards queue to the next tick.

2.6 Generation: which missions are live

The GM selects about $3 \times N$ missions from the library for a run (21 at $N = 7$, 36 at $N = 12$) and keeps the rest in reserve. Within that selection, the platform keeps the board full by rule.

1. **At T0** the GM activates $N + 1$ public board missions and one first mission per company, matched to that company's gate or critical-dependency tags (Starting World 8.2).
2. **Each tick** the public board refills to $N + 1$ live missions, adding at most $\lceil N \div 2 \rceil$ new ones.
3. **Refill priority.** Missions tagged to a live event or shortage come first; then categories missing from the board (it should always show at least one Individual, one Cross-company, one Institution and one Market mission); then missions tagged to the companies with the fewest completions over the last 2 ticks, as a quiet catch-up.
4. **Company missions.** When a company completes, fails or lets expire its current company mission, it receives the next matching one at the following tick. It holds one at a time.
5. **Hidden missions.** Up to $\lceil N \div 2 \rceil$ are live at once. They are unlocked only by an information card, an institution desk or an opportunity, never by the board.
6. **Crisis and Founder missions** are released with their crisis or with the Founder Window, outside the board count.
7. **Human Internet.** At least 3 live missions carry the Human Internet flag while internet is off (inherited rule).

3. Opportunities

An opportunity is an open situation with no prescribed method: it shows only a signal, and the value goes to whoever discovers the detail, commits first or makes the best case before it expires. Missions say what to do; opportunities only say that something is there.

3.1 The opportunity card

Each card has a public half (the signal) and a hidden half (the detail), so the platform can show one without the other.

Field	Meaning
ID and type	Library reference (O01–O20) and one of the 14 inherited types (customer demand, resource arbitrage, idle capacity, talent mismatch, information asymmetry, regulatory opening, technology capability, audience access, broken company, emerging shortage, unserved segment, cross-company bundle, founder gap, market rumour)

Field	Meaning
Signal	One or two lines, enough to make someone act and no more
Detail	Who, how much, by when and on what terms; revealed only on discovery
Discovery paths	At least two, one of which must be person-to-person (3.3)
Claim method	First commitment, competitive evaluation, auction or open (3.4)
Trade-off	What a claimant gives up or risks; every card needs one
Value cap	Best-case value, at most 15,000 VB equivalent, matching the hidden-lever cap
Window	When it becomes Available and when it expires
Decay rule	What happens as more players find it: none, price rises, or value falls at a stated tick
Institutions involved	The desks a claimant will need; the best cards need two or more
Visibility	Hidden at load; the signal's class once released

3.2 Lifecycle

State	Meaning
Hidden	Loaded and held by the GM
Available	The signal is in the world (on a card, at a desk, in a rumour or a broadcast) but nobody has the detail
Discovered	At least one participant has reached a discovery path and registered the opportunity's code; each discoverer sees the detail personally, timestamped
Claimed	A company has made the claim commitment the card requires
Active	The claimant is executing (delivering, building, closing)

State	Meaning
Resolved	The outcome is recorded in the Opportunity Register
Expired	The window closed without a claim, or the claimant failed to execute

Discovery is recorded per person, not per company. The discoverer chooses whether to tell their company, sell the detail, or act alone as a free agent, because the detail is a Personal information record with the Tradable flag set (Starting World 10.1).

3.3 How opportunities are discovered

Path	How it works	Typical use
Personal information card	A participant starts with or acquires a card carrying the signal and code	Human Internet I
Institution desk	The desk reveals the detail when a visitor names the right sector or need; it never volunteers it	Customer, supplier and government openings
Mission reward	Tier 3 and Founder missions can pay out an opportunity card	Hidden and strategic cards
Information trade	Bought, bartered or given by another participant	Any card already discovered
Execution	Completing a contract or mission with a party reveals that party's next need	Follow-on sales, broken company
Broadcast	A time-released public signal; everyone has the signal, nobody has the detail	Regulatory openings, shortages
Grey market	From about Tick 5, one designated volunteer holds unofficial opportunities and reveals them only when asked directly	Failed-company assets, unlisted inventory, introductions

3.4 How opportunities are claimed

Claim method	Rule	Example
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Claim method	Rule	Example
First commitment	The first company to record the required deal, deposit or application wins it	O02 Unused Compute, O03 The Expiring Supplier
Competitive evaluation	The holding desk evaluates all proposals received by a stated deadline on published criteria	O04 The Quiet Enterprise, O07 Regulatory Window
Auction	Converted to a sealed-bid auction when two or more companies commit in the same tick	O12 The Strategic Asset, O17 The Scarce Developer
Open	Anyone can benefit until the situation closes	O10 Price Gap, which closes when the price gap does

Two commitments arriving in the same tick for a First-commitment card are settled by a sealed-bid auction between those two only, run by the GM before the next tick.

3.5 Release, expiry and the register

- **Run selection.** The GM selects about $2N + 1$ opportunities for a run (15 at $N = 7$, 25 at $N = 12$). The library of 20 is too small above $N = 9$; see section 10.3.
- **Live at T0.** $\lceil N \div 2 \rceil + 1$ city opportunities (Starting World 12.2), mostly in the Available state with signals on personal cards.
- **Each tick** the GM tops the live count back up to that floor and releases anything scheduled. No more than twice the floor are live at once, so players are not flooded.
- **Expiry.** Default 2 ticks after becoming Available; urgent cards 1 tick. The GM may extend a card once, by 1 tick, and logs it.
- **The Opportunity Register** records every opportunity's state, discoverers, claimant and outcome, so the same opportunity is never awarded twice.
- **Growth Opportunities** (one per company, Starting World 8.1) are Exclusive to their company. When the unlock condition is met they move straight to Discovered for that company and expire 3 ticks later.
- **Hidden-lever triggers** are opportunities tied to a company's hidden lever. The GM releases them only when the dossier's condition is met.

Players also create value nobody planted: bundles, arbitrage, introductions. Those are ordinary deals under section 4 and are never registered as opportunities. A company that wants to advertise a need or a surplus posts it on the Market Board (section 6.4).

4. Deals and contracts

A deal becomes official only when both sides' authorised signers accept it on the platform; from then on its recorded terms, and nothing said in conversation, are what the city enforces. Negotiation is free and in person. Recording is quick and standard.

4.1 Deal types

All deal types share one Deal Sheet (4.2) and one lifecycle (4.3). Types differ only in their extra fields and how they settle.

Type	Extra fields beyond the Deal Sheet	Usual settlement	Rules in
Cash sale	Item or service, quantity, acceptance criteria	Spot or milestone	4.4
Resource trade or barter	Resource, quantity on each side	Spot	6.4
Supply contract	Units per tick, price per unit, duration, volume commitment	Recurring	4.6
Customer contract (institution)	Desk's standard terms: deliverable, quantity, price, deadline, acceptance, payment timing, penalty or bonus	Recurring or milestone	4.6
Revenue share	Named revenue stream, percentage, duration	Recurring	4.6
Licence	Product Card licensed, scope (exclusive or not), royalty, duration	Recurring	4.6
Partnership or joint product	Contribution of each side, ownership split of anything created, cost and revenue split	Per its terms	4.6
Information sale	Description, permitted use, optional warranty	Spot	4.6
Employment, freelance	Role or deliverable, pay, duration	Recurring or escrow	5
Loan, investment	Principal or amount, terms, rights	Per its terms	7
Acquisition, merger,	Assets, staff, liabilities,	At a tick boundary	8

Type	Extra fields beyond the Deal Sheet	Usual settlement	Rules in
spin-out	ownership		

4.2 The Deal Sheet

Every deal records these fields; the platform will not accept a deal with one missing.

Field	Notes
Parties	Companies, institutions or participants (personal wallet)
What changes hands	VB, resource units, Product Card rights, assets, shares, information, labour
Consideration	Price or the other side's leg; zero is allowed but flagged (4.5)
Timing	When each leg transfers: now, per tick, at a milestone, or at a stated tick
Duration	For recurring deals, in ticks; never beyond the final freeze
Conditions	Anything that must be true first (a licence held, a delivery accepted)
Penalties	Default clauses from 4.6 apply unless the sheet says otherwise
Acceptance and evidence	How completion is shown, using the classes in section 1.3
Negotiator credit	Who on each side negotiated; feeds the registry and Founder Ledger
Signatures	Each side's authorised signer under section 1.2

4.3 Lifecycle

State	Meaning
Draft	Being written by one side
Proposed	Sent to the other side; lapses if not accepted within 1 tick. Before Market Open, deals stop here (Starting World 3.3)

State	Meaning
Accepted	Both signers confirmed; legs due now transfer atomically
Active	Recurring or milestone obligations running
Delivered	The seller has recorded delivery; the buyer has 1 tick to accept or dispute, after which it is deemed accepted
Completed	All obligations met; counted as fulfilled on both Reliability Records
Disputed	Either side has raised a dispute (4.7)
Failed or Terminated	Ended by breach, by agreement or by a termination clause

4.4 Settlement

- **Spot.** Both legs move at the same instant on acceptance. If either side lacks the cash or units, the deal is refused, not half-settled.
- **Recurring.** Each tick at step 2 of the settlement order (section 1.1), the platform moves that tick's units and payment. A side that cannot pay or deliver is in breach for that tick.
- **Milestone.** A leg transfers when a stated deliverable is accepted.
- **Deferred.** Payment falls due at a stated tick and appears as a receivable for one side and a liability for the other.
- **Escrow.** Any deal may put a payment in platform escrow, released on acceptance or deemed acceptance. Escrow is required for freelance fees, opportunity deposits and auction settlements.

4.5 Pricing and integrity

Prices between players are free. Institutions trade only at their published prices or inside their published bands. Four integrity rules stop the economy being gamed:

- **Product floors bind.** A Product Card's floor price is the lowest price at which that product may be sold to anyone (Starting World 6.5).
- **Nominal deals are flagged.** A deal with zero consideration, or consideration below 25% of the Bank base value of what moves, is allowed but flagged to the GM. This catches cash or stock being drained from a failing company to a friendly one.
- **Self-dealing needs both signatories.** A deal between a company and one of its own staff personally needs both signatories (or the CEO and one signatory) and is flagged.
- **Bluffing is allowed; impersonation is not.** Players may bluff in negotiation, and information sold without a warranty is buyer-beware. Only recorded terms bind. Claiming to act for the GM or an institution is cheating (Game Engine, section 25).

4.6 Default clauses and specific contracts

Unless the Deal Sheet says otherwise, these clauses apply.

Clause	Default	Limits
Late or missed delivery	Seller pays 10% of that tick's contract value per missed tick	Can be written anywhere from 0% to 50%
Late payment	Overdue amount grows 10% per tick; seller may suspend delivery after one missed payment	Cannot exceed 30% per tick
Termination	Either side may end the deal after 2 consecutive breaches by the other	A termination-for-convenience fee may be added
Exclusivity	None	Must name its scope; at most 3 ticks
Non-solicitation of staff	None	Binds the companies only, never a participant's freedom to move; at most 3 ticks
Force majeure	None	If written, a GM-declared event named in the clause suspends the affected obligation for that event's duration
Information warranty	None	If written, the seller refunds the price if the GM rules the information false

Specific contract rules:

- **Institution customer contracts** use the Customer desk's standard terms (Institutions Handbook 6.5). The anchor contract's renewal at Tick 6 is a new negotiation on those terms.
- **Supply contracts** state a per-tick cap. Units not taken in a tick are lost unless the contract says they roll over.
- **Licences** let the licensee deliver the licensor's Product Card using its own resources and capacity, paying a royalty per unit delivered. The licensor keeps ownership.
- **Joint products** created by a partnership (for example, through M35) are owned as the Deal Sheet says; the default is 50/50. Either owner may deliver them, sharing revenue as recorded.
- **Revenue shares** are calculated by the platform from registry revenue and paid at the tick. They end at the stated tick or the final freeze, whichever is first.

4.7 Disputes

Disputes go up a three-step ladder, and every step defaults to the recorded terms rather than reconstructing private conversations.

1. **The parties** have 10 minutes to settle it themselves and record an amendment.
2. **The relevant desk** decides if an institution is a party; otherwise the Deal Desk (the GM's operations team) decides, within one tick.
3. **The GM** decides when the dispute changes company ownership, affects several institutions, exposes a hidden mechanic or has no precedent.

Remedies are always ledger entries: a compensating transfer, a penalty under the clause, termination, or a breach on the Reliability Record. Settled transactions are never silently edited (Technology draft, VB engine).

5. Talent market and employment

People are the scarcest input in the city: every participant is free to move, every company opens one seat short, and a move takes effect only at the next tick, so the current employer always gets a chance to counteroffer. The salary ladder is fixed for everyone; scarcity shows up in premiums, equity and the talent index, never in a different ladder.

5.1 Employment states

State	Salary	Can do	Cannot do
Employee	Agreed salary each tick	Act and negotiate for the company; one freelance contract with employer approval	Hold two full-time roles
Free Agent	None	Freelance (up to 2 contracts), claim Individual and Market missions, join a company or a founding team	See any company's Company-class information
Founder	Salary from the new venture, as its founders decide	Everything an employee can, inside their own venture	Draw a second reserve dossier
Outside specialist	Paid by the tick to the Talent Exchange	Fill one required seat	Sign, claim missions, hold information, count toward minimum team size

5.2 Levels and salary

- **The ladder is a floor.** An employee's salary is whatever was agreed, but never below the ladder rate for their level (Starting World 6.1). When a level rise lifts the floor above the agreed salary, pay rises to the floor automatically.

- **Progression.** Each tick from Tick 1, an employee gains one level in their current domain. A Tier 2 or 3 mission in their domain adds one extra level at most once every 2 ticks. Salary stops rising at L5.
- **Changing domain.** Moving to the same domain keeps the level. Moving to a different domain halves it, rounded down (an L4 developer who moves into sales starts at L2). This softens the 26-phase draft's full reset, as the Game Engine draft allows.
- **Free agents** keep their level but do not progress, except that each completed freelance contract in their domain counts as one tick of progression.
- **Raises and cuts.** A company may raise pay at any time. Pay cuts need the employee's consent. At two GM-scheduled salary review windows (default Tick 4 and Tick 8) every employee may formally request a raise, and the company must accept, reject or counter before the window closes.

5.3 Workforce requirements, deficits and Workforce Credit

Each company's required seats per domain are fixed at registration close from its workforce mix, T0 headcount and deficit gap (Starting World 5.3). They change only through a merger or acquisition (requirements add together) or a GM ruling. Losing staff therefore opens real gaps.

Deficit charge. Each unfilled required seat costs 225 VB per tick (the L2 rate, standing for contractors the company has to buy in). Surplus staff in a domain cost nothing extra but do not cover another domain's gap.

Workforce Credit (WC) is the measure of a company's talent strength, shown on its dashboard and read by the Bank and Investor.

$WC = \text{sum over employees of } (1 + \text{level} \div 2) \times (\text{talent index of their domain} \div 100), \text{ plus } 2.5 \times \text{outside specialists}$

A 9-person company at L0 has a WC of 9; the same team at L4 in a normal market has a WC of 27. WC is a metric, not cash. Its weight in final scoring is for the Investor Day and scoring document to set.

5.4 Hiring, offers and counteroffers

1. **Posting.** A company may post a role on the Talent Exchange board: role, domain, salary, any equity or bonus, number of seats, expected outcome and application window (Game Engine, section 12).
2. **Offer.** Any company may make an offer to any participant, posted or not. An offer records role, domain, salary, equity grant, any retention bonus, start tick, and an expiry of at most 1 tick.
3. **Acceptance.** When the participant accepts, the move is pending until the next tick boundary. Their current employer is notified at once.
4. **Counteroffer.** Until the tick boundary, the current employer may counteroffer. The participant chooses freely between all offers on the table. If they stay, the outside offer lapses and the counteroffer is recorded as a pay or role change.
5. **Move.** At the tick boundary the participant changes company. The old company's Company-class information disappears from their view, and their personal records go with them.

Cooldown. After a move, a participant cannot move again for 2 ticks. The cooldown does not apply when their company fails, is acquired, or misses paying them.

Unpaid salary. If a company cannot pay an employee at the tick, the shortfall is recorded as salary arrears. That employee may then leave immediately, with no counteroffer window and no cooldown.

5.5 Poaching, retention and minimum team size

- **Poaching is always allowed.** Companies may approach anyone. A non-solicitation clause between two companies binds only those companies (section 4.6); nothing stops a participant moving on their own initiative.
- **Retention bonus.** A company may pay a lump-sum bonus with a lock-in of up to 2 ticks. Leaving inside the lock-in means repaying the bonus from the personal wallet, down to zero.
- **Equity grants** come from the Employee Option Pool (section 7.5). They vest at the final freeze for anyone still employed there, and are forfeited on leaving. This is the main non-cash retention tool.
- **Minimum team size.** A company with fewer than 3 participants is Distressed (section 8.6). Poaching may push a company below 3; that is a legal and visible consequence, not a foul.
- **Signatories** who leave are replaced by staff election at the next tick. CEO volunteers cannot be hired away.

5.6 Scarcity and the talent index

Each of the seven domains has a talent index that starts at 100 (Starting World 8.3) and moves at each tick.

Trigger	Change
Two or more recorded hires into the domain this tick	+10
No hires into the domain for 2 ticks	-5
GM-declared shortage (a Dynamic Event)	+25 to +50 for the event's duration
Bounds	Never below 80 or above 200

The index sets three things: outside specialist fees, Workforce Credit, and a published "going rate" ($\text{ladder rate} \times \text{index} \div 100$). The going rate is information only; it tells players what scarce talent is commanding without changing the uniform ladder.

5.7 Freelancing and outside specialists

Freelance contracts record client, freelancer, deliverable, fee, deadline (at most 2 ticks) and acceptance. The fee is held in escrow and released on the client's confirmation, or deemed released 1 tick after delivery if the client is silent. Free agents may hold 2 contracts at once. Employees may hold 1, with a signatory's approval from their employer; the fee goes to the employee unless the approval records a split. Freelancers never receive the client's Company-class information.

Outside specialists are the Talent Exchange's N contracts (Starting World 9). The fee is $400 \text{ VB} \times \text{the domain's talent index} \div 100$ per tick, with a minimum term of 2 ticks. A company may hold one specialist at a time. Specialists whom several companies want at once go to auction (A03, section 9).

6. Resource economy and production

Every company burns resources every tick and is short on some and long on others, so resources move through four channels (Bank, Supplier Market, Logistics Provider and other companies), and the Bank is always available but never the best deal. A typical consumption profile costs about 1,000 VB per tick at Bank prices once starting stock runs out (SwiftCart's profile is 1,045 VB).

6.1 Holding and consuming

The T0 stock (100 units of each), tier rates (Low 4, Medium 7, High 10, Very High 14 units per tick) and thresholds (warning at 30, 25% delivery surcharge at 15, deliveries stop at 0, Distressed after 2 ticks at 0 on a High or Very High resource) are fixed by Starting World 6.4 and not repeated here. Two kinds of use draw on stock:

- **Baseline consumption** at tick step 5, by tier, whether or not the company sells anything.
- **Delivery consumption** whenever a product is delivered, at the rate on its Product Card.

Shortfalls are never bought automatically. A company at zero simply cannot deliver products that need that resource, and the consequence follows.

6.2 Production

Some Product Cards are **supply products**: they turn inputs into units of a resource the company can use or sell. This is how a company that fills a supply slot (for example, S4 Energy supply) actually supplies.

Field on a supply product	Rule
Recipe	Input units (zero or more resources) for a stated number of output units of one resource
Efficiency band	Output's Bank value must be 1.5 to 2.5 times the inputs' Bank value, so production pays but cannot print money
Capacity	10 to 25 output units per tick, set by the dossier inside this band
Production order	The company sets a standing quantity up to capacity; production runs at tick step 3 if inputs are in stock
Upgrade	+5 units per tick of capacity for 1,500 VB plus 10 Infrastructure; at most 2 upgrades per product

Output goes into the producer's stock and is subject to the same storage cap as everything else (6.6).

Efficiency projects. Any company may permanently lower one resource's tier by one step, once per run, by completing a Tier 3 mission tagged "efficiency" or by spending 3,000 VB plus 30 Infrastructure. A Cost-lever hidden mechanic (Starting World 10.4) is separate and can stack with it. No tier falls below Low.

6.3 Institutional supply

Channel	Price	Capacity	Rules
Bank: buy	Base price, adjusted by Bank stock (below)	$40 \times N$ per resource at Tick 1, restocked by $10 \times N$ per tick	At most 30 units of each resource per company per tick
Bank: buy-back	60% of base price, cash on settlement	Up to 20 units per resource per company per tick	Units bought back return to Bank stock
Supplier Market	10% below base; 15% below for orders of 50 units or more	$20 \times N$ units per resource per tick, shared by all buyers, less what starting agreements reserve	Minimum order 20 units; paid up front; can be disrupted by events
Logistics Provider: standard	Base price for Logistics units	$15 \times N$ units per tick	Delivered at the next tick's step 2; surge pricing of +25% once 80% of a tick's standard capacity is booked
Logistics Provider: priority	$1.5 \times$ base	$7 \times N$ units per tick	Delivered immediately; not subject to surge

Bank dynamic pricing. The Bank's price for each resource follows its own remaining stock, measured against its Tick 1 stock.

Bank stock remaining	Bank sell price
50% or more	Base
25% to 50%	Base + 20%
Under 25%	Base + 50%
Zero	Not available until restock

The Bank volunteer never sets prices; the platform applies this table, and only the GM can override it through a Dynamic Event.

6.4 Trading between companies

Companies can trade resources in any form the Deal Sheet allows: spot sales, barter, recurring supply contracts and resource loans (units now, more units back at a stated tick, recorded as deferred barter). Transfers settle atomically: both legs move or neither does.

The Market Board is a public listing where any company can post a bid or an ask: resource, quantity, price and expiry. Accepting a listing creates a Proposed deal for the poster's signer to confirm. The board makes surpluses and shortages visible, and the negotiation still happens between people.

6.5 The price index

Each resource has a published index, starting at 100 and updated at tick step 10.

$$\text{Index} = 100 \times (0.5 \times \text{volume-weighted price of last tick's company trades} \div \text{base price} + 0.5 \times \text{current Bank price} \div \text{base price})$$

In a tick with no company trades in a resource, the index uses the Bank ratio alone. The index is information that tells the city where prices are heading. It does not set any price.

6.6 Storage and hoarding

- **Storage cap.** A company may hold up to 200 units of each resource. Above that, the excess loses 10% per tick (rounded up), standing for spoilage and holding costs.
- **Warehousing.** A warehouse contract with the Logistics Provider (or the A04 auction lot) raises the cap for the resources it names.
- **Purchase limits** at the Bank stop any company buying out a resource in one tick.
- **Shortage caps.** During a declared shortage the GM may lower the Bank purchase limit for that resource for every company alike.

6.7 Scarcity and shocks

Shocks change parameters, never stocks, unless a crisis card says it destroys units. They are announced at tick step 11 and apply by tag (resource, sector, cluster), never by company name. The Dynamic Events and Crisis document holds the library; this document fixes what a shock can change.

Shock	Parameter it changes	Typical size and duration
Price shock	Bank base price for one resource	±20-50%, 1-3 ticks
Supply outage	Supplier Market or Logistics capacity	-50% to closed, 1-2 ticks
Bank stock freeze	Bank stops selling one resource	1 tick
Demand surge	Tier rate for companies carrying a tag	+1 tier step, 1-2 ticks
Technology leap	Tier rate or recipe input for a tag	-1 tier step, 2 ticks
Restock change	Bank restock rate	±50%, 2 ticks

Settled contracts keep running through a shock unless they contain a force majeure clause naming it (section 4.6).

7. Capital, debt and investment

Companies can fund themselves three ways (revenue, debt from the Bank or other players, and equity from the Investor, other companies or individuals), and each costs something different: debt must be repaid on schedule, equity gives away ownership and votes. Every company has 1,000 shares at T0 and a reference valuation recalculated every tick, so all negotiations start from the same public numbers.

7.1 Shares and the T0 cap table

Holder	Shares at T0	Who exercises the votes
Founding Holder	800 (80%)	The CEO and the two signatories, by majority of the three
Employee Option Pool	200 (20%), unallocated	No votes until granted and vested
Total	1,000	

The Founding Holder stands for the company's original owners. It cannot sell its shares except in an approved acquisition, merger or restructuring.

Later holders can be the Investor fund, other companies (strategic stakes), participants personally (angels) and employees with vested options. The Bank never holds equity except through a debt-for-equity restructuring (section 8.6). New ventures split their 1,000 shares by their founder agreement and may reserve a pool. Spin-outs split theirs as the spin-out agreement records (section 8.4).

There are no dividends. Shareholder value is realised only through acquisition, liquidation or final valuation.

7.2 Reference valuation

Every company's Reference Valuation (RV) is recalculated at each tick and shown on its public profile, so valuations start from evidence rather than rhetoric.

NAV = cash + resources at current Bank price + asset book values + receivables – debt outstanding – other liabilities due

$RV = \max(NAV, 0) + 6 \times \text{average verified customer revenue per tick over the last 2 ticks}$

Verified customer revenue means registry revenue from customer contracts and product sales only.

Loans, investment, mission rewards and asset sales do not count. The multiple of 6 is the main tuning lever.

Worked example (illustrative). The Starting World example company (34,050 VB cash, 12,500 VB of resources, a 5,000 VB asset, a 7,000 VB loan) has a NAV of 44,550 VB. Once its anchor contract has paid 1,000 VB a tick for 2 ticks, its RV is $44,550 + 6,000 = 50,550$ VB, or about 50.5 VB per share.

RV is used as the Investor's starting point (7.4), the default merger ratio (8.3), a collateral reference for the Bank and the liquidation reference (8.6). Its weight in final scoring is left to the scoring document.

7.3 Debt

The Bank's inherited loan bands are kept. Their "10% / 15% / 20% / 25%+ repayment" is read as a flat total interest charge over the loan's term.

Product	Amount	Eligibility	Flat interest	Term	Repayment	Security
Working capital S	5,000	Any recorded customer contract, including the anchor	10%	4 ticks	Equal instalments	None
Working capital M	10,000	2,000 VB verified revenue, or 5,000 VB contract backlog	15%	5 ticks	Equal instalments	None
Working capital L	20,000	10,000 VB backlog, or a pledged asset	20%	6 ticks	Equal instalments	Contract or asset assigned
Asset-backed	Up to 60% of an asset's book value	An eligible asset	12%	4 ticks	Single payment at term	The asset
Strategic facility	Up to 15,000	M39 completed or an institution unlock	12%	6 ticks	Single payment at term	Use of funds recorded and restricted
Emergency	Up to 5,000	Distressed companies only; once per run	25%	3 ticks	Equal instalments	First claim on all assets

Rules for every Bank loan:

- **Limits.** A company may owe the Bank at most 30,000 VB outside an emergency loan. The Bank cannot lend beyond its pool ($8,000 \times N$); repayments refill it.
- **Instalments** are debited at tick step 6, starting the tick after disbursement. Interest is spread evenly across them.
- **Early repayment** is allowed at any time. The company pays the remaining principal plus interest only for the ticks elapsed.

- **Missed instalment.** A 10% late fee is added and a missed payment goes on the Reliability Record.
- **Default** follows a second consecutive miss. The Bank takes any pledged security, the unsecured balance grows 10% per tick, the company becomes Distressed, and it gets no new Bank credit until the default is cured.
- **Credit posture.** The GM sets the Bank's posture through Dynamic Events. "Tight" adds 5 points of interest and raises each band's evidence bar one step; "Loose" removes 3 points. The Bank volunteer applies the current posture to everyone alike.
- **Starting liabilities** of the Bank loan type (Starting World 7.3) are recorded at T0 as existing loans under these rules.

Debt between players. Companies and participants may lend to companies through Loan deals, including revenue-based repayment (a percentage of revenue until a cap is repaid). Flat interest is capped at 40%. The default rules above apply only if the Deal Sheet adopts them. Participants cannot borrow from the Bank personally.

7.4 Equity investment

The Investor fund holds $14,000 \times N$ VB and makes at most $\lceil N \times 0.7 \rceil$ investments (Starting World 9). It opens only at the GM-scheduled capital window.

Rule	Default
Ticket size	5,000 to 25,000 VB per investment
Concentration	No company may receive more than 30% of the fund in total
Valuation	Negotiated between 0.5 and 2 times the company's RV; outside that range only with GM approval
Dilution cap	One round may not give new investors more than 40% of post-money shares
Tranches	Up to 2. The second is released only when a named milestone is verified by a stated tick
Process	Meeting, diligence, term sheet, approval, funding, milestone (Technology draft state machine)

Shares issued are calculated the same way for every deal:

Price per share = pre-money valuation $\div$ shares outstanding; New shares = investment $\div$ price per share

For example, 20,000 VB at a 50,000 VB pre-money valuation buys 400 new shares at 50 VB each. The investor then holds 400 of 1,400 shares (28.6%) and the Founding Holder 800 (57.1%).

Investor rights. Each investment may carry up to two of these, recorded on the Deal Sheet and enforced by the platform: board observer (sees Company Leadership information); information rights (sees the company's financial data); pro-rata right in later rounds; 1× non-participating liquidation preference; veto over a sale of the company; restriction on use of funds.

Other equity. Companies may take strategic stakes in other companies of up to 49%, by new issue or by buying existing shares; 50% or more is an acquisition (section 8). Participants may invest personal VB in any company as angels, from 250 VB, on the same share formula.

Grants from the Government pool ($3,000 \times N$ VB) are non-dilutive and come by application in their window. Their criteria belong to the Institution Operating Content document.

7.5 Shareholder decisions and the option pool

- **Votes.** Each issued, vested share has one vote. A simple majority decides a sale of the company, a merger, a spin-out of a product line, or any new share issue above 10% of shares outstanding. A veto right, if an investor holds one, applies on top.
- **Option grants** come out of the pool and need the same signing authority as a cash commitment of equal value at the current RV share price (section 1.2).
- **Vesting.** Grants vest at the final freeze for holders still employed by the company, and vest immediately if the company is acquired or merged. Unvested grants are forfeited on leaving and return to the pool.
- **Share transfers** between holders are recorded as Share Transfer deals and need no company approval, except that the Founding Holder's shares cannot be sold this way.
- **Cap table lock.** All cap tables lock one tick before the final freeze, so Investor Day sees a fixed ownership picture.

8. M&A, spin-outs, founder independence and failure

Companies can be bought, merged, split or closed, and people can leave to found something new, but every change of ownership needs a shareholder vote, each affected employee's consent and GM validation at a tick boundary. Failure is never a dead end: it releases staff, customers and assets back into the city.

8.1 Company lifecycle states

State	Entered when	Effect
Operating	Default	All actions available
High Growth	Verified revenue rose in each of the last 2 ticks and RV is at least 1.5 times its Tick 2 value	Public flag only; desks may prioritise it
Distressed	Any trigger in 8.6	Public flag; emergency loan eligible; 2-tick recovery window
Acquired	An acquisition settles	Integrated into the buyer, or

State	Entered when	Effect
		run as a subsidiary
Merged	A merger settles	Two companies become one
Spun out	A spin-out settles (applies to the new company)	Independent, founder-run
Failed	Recovery window ends without recovery (8.6)	Liquidation
Dissolved	Shareholders close a solvent company	Voluntary liquidation

8.2 Acquisitions

An acquisition transfers control (50% or more of shares) or a defined set of assets for agreed consideration. Three forms exist.

Form	What moves	Liabilities	Staff
Share acquisition	Control of the whole company	All of them, with the company	Each employee chooses to stay or become a free agent
Asset purchase	Named assets: Product Cards, Notable Asset, resources, contracts (with the counterparty's consent), customer relationships	Only those named	Nobody moves unless separately hired
Acqui-hire	A group of staff, under new offers	None	Only those who accept, under section 5.4

Rules for every acquisition:

- **Approval.** The target's shareholders approve by majority (section 7.5). The buyer approves under normal signing authority. Founding Holder shares can be sold only this way.
- **Consideration** may be cash, buyer shares, resources, assumed liabilities or an earn-out (a share of the target's revenue, paid each tick until the final freeze).
- **Solvency.** The buyer must hold the consideration at settlement, and the target's own cash cannot pay its own price. Bank and player loans may fund it.
- **Integrate or hold.** A share acquisition either integrates (cash, resources, contracts, liabilities, assets, Product Cards, staff and required seats all combine, and the target's station closes) or holds the target as a subsidiary (it keeps its station, books and staff; the buyer appoints its signatories).

- **Hidden mechanics travel with the company.** The target's lever and vulnerability both pass to the buyer, and its Company-class information becomes visible to the buyer's leadership. The buyer acquires the risks it did not diligence.
- **Staff consent.** No participant can be transferred against their will. Anyone who declines becomes a free agent with no cooldown. Unvested options vest on acquisition (section 7.5).
- **Volunteers.** An integrated target's CEO volunteer returns to the GM for redeployment; a subsidiary keeps its CEO.
- **Settlement and limits.** Acquisitions settle at the next tick boundary after GM validation. A company may complete at most one share acquisition per 3 ticks. The GM may block one that would leave fewer than $\lceil N \times 0.6 \rceil$ independent companies (5 at $N = 7$), so there is always a market to play in. None settle after the cap table lock.

There are no hostile takeovers. Because the Founding Holder's 80% can only be sold with the leadership's vote, control changes only by agreement.

8.3 Mergers

A merger combines two companies into one and needs a majority vote of each company's shareholders.

- **Ownership.** The surviving company issues new shares to the other company's holders at an agreed ratio. The default ratio is the two companies' RVs.
- **Leadership.** One CEO volunteer stays, by agreement or GM decision; the other returns to the GM. The merged staff elect two signatories at the next tick.
- **Combination.** Cash, resources, contracts, liabilities, Product Cards, required seats and both companies' hidden mechanics all combine. Consumption is charged for both original profiles until an efficiency project or merger integration mission reduces it.
- **Objectives.** Both companies' public objectives stay on record. How a merged company is scored against two sets of objectives is left to the Investor Day and scoring document.

8.4 Spin-outs

A spin-out lets a group take a product line out of their company with the company's agreement. It uses the inherited charter and does not draw a reserve dossier (Starting World 4.5).

Requirement	Rule
Team	3 or more participants, at least 2 of them from the parent
Capital	10,000 VB committed from personal wallets, angels, player loans or transferred resources at Bank value
Customer	One credible customer or letter of intent, shown with E1 or E2 evidence (M42 Spin-Out Proof qualifies)
Capability	One Product Card transferred or licensed from the parent, or a new card approved by the GM

Requirement	Rule
	(8.5)
Founder agreement	Named leaders, the split of 1,000 shares, and two signatories
Parent agreement	Parent shareholders approve the transfer of anything the spin-out takes. The default consideration is a 20% stake for the parent (negotiable from 0% to 49%) or cash
Window	Only once the GM has opened the Founder Window

The spin-out starts with only what was committed and transferred, with no anchor contract and no volunteer CEO. Like a new venture, it must record a delivered sale or a signed customer contract within 2 ticks or become Distressed.

8.5 Founder independence and new ventures

Participants who want to found something without taking anything from their employer use the new-venture route in Starting World 4.5: the same charter (3+ participants, 10,000 VB, a founder agreement, a resource agreement), then a random reserve dossier drawn after the charter is confirmed. No employer consent is needed, because nothing of the employer's leaves.

- **Leaving.** Founders leave at the next tick boundary and their employer may counteroffer each of them as usual (section 5.4). Unvested options are forfeited and any retention bonus inside its lock-in is repaid.
- **Capacity.** At most $\lceil N \div 3 \rceil$ new ventures and spin-outs combined may start in a run (3 at $N = 7$), limited further by reserve dossiers left ($12 - N$) and the blank template. This protects desk capacity and keeps the starting companies viable.
- **One each.** A participant may be a founder of at most one new venture or spin-out per run.

Ownership and IP. Companies own their Product Cards, Notable Assets, datasets, contracts and Company-class information records. Participants own their personal wallets, personal information records, personal objectives, level and history. A departing participant takes only what is theirs. What they remember cannot be policed, but the platform removes their access to the company's records. New Product Cards can be created in play: a company with a demonstrated capability and customer evidence may apply to the GM, who issues a card on the shared schema with parameters inside the dossier bands. Ownership goes to the company that applied, or as a partnership's Deal Sheet records.

8.6 Distress, failure and liquidation

A company becomes **Distressed** when any of these is true after tick settlement:

- its cash is below zero (it has arrears);
- it is in default on a loan;
- it has fewer than 3 participants;

- a High or Very High resource has been at zero for 2 ticks (Starting World 6.4);
- as a new venture or spin-out, it has missed its first-customer deadline.

Recovery window. A Distressed company has 2 ticks to clear every trigger. It may take the emergency loan, sell assets, raise money or agree a rescue. Clearing all triggers returns it to Operating.

Restructuring. Before declaring failure, the GM offers three routes, any of which can be agreed in the last tick of the window: a debt-for-equity swap (creditors take shares instead of repayment), a rescue acquisition at any price including zero with liabilities assumed, or an orderly asset sale.

Failure is declared at the end of the window if the company still has negative cash or no viable staff, immediately if it has no participants at all, or by GM ruling in a systemic crisis. Then:

1. Its assets (Product Cards, Notable Asset, resources, transferable contracts, customer relationships) go to a Liquidation auction within 1 tick (section 9).
2. Proceeds are paid out in order: emergency loan, salary arrears to staff, secured Bank debt, other creditors pro rata, liquidation preferences, then shareholders pro rata.
3. Staff become free agents with their personal wallets intact and no cooldown.
4. Its customer cards return to the Customer desk as open cards, creating Customer Rescue openings (M48, O13).
5. Its dossier is never returned to the reserve, and its CEO volunteer returns to the GM.

Dissolution is a voluntary closure by a shareholder majority while solvent. It follows the same steps.

9. Auctions

Auctions are short, public contests for things that are genuinely scarce. They run in four scheduled sessions plus ad hoc sales of failed companies' assets and contested opportunities, and a company can win at most one lot per session, so no single cash pile buys the city. Every lot should change what a company can do, not add points (Game Engine, section 16).

9.1 What gets auctioned

Category	Library lots and other sources	Who sells	Proceeds go to
Resource capacity	A01 Compute Block, A02 Prime Logistics Slot, A04 Warehouse Access	GM / institutions	City Reserve
Talent	A03 Specialist Talent; talent auctions during a declared shortage	Talent Exchange	City Reserve
Access	A05 Enterprise Introduction, A06 Media Burst, A07 Supplier Priority;	Institutions	City Reserve

Category	Library lots and other sources	Who sells	Proceeds go to
	limited licences and tender slots from Government		
Assets and M&A	A08 M&A Asset	GM	City Reserve
Information	A09 Data Package	GM	City Reserve
Mystery	A10 Mystery Lot	GM	City Reserve
Liquidation	A failed company's assets (section 8.6)	GM, for the creditors	Liquidation waterfall
Contested opportunity	An opportunity two companies committed to in the same tick (section 3.4)	Opportunity holder	As the card states
Company sale	Any asset a company chooses to sell through the auctioneer	The company	The seller, less a 5% fee to the City Reserve

Scaling. Resource lot quantities and opening prices in the library are written for $N = 7$. For other N , both scale by $N \div 7$, rounded to the nearest 5 units and 50 VB.

9.2 Formats

Format	How it runs	Default use
Open ascending	Public bids; minimum increment 10% of the current bid or 500 VB, whichever is lower (inherited)	Most lots
Timed	Open ascending with a 5-minute clock; a bid in the last 30 seconds adds 30 seconds, at most twice	High-energy stage lots
Sealed bid	One bid per company, first price; ties go to the earlier bid	Contested opportunities; information lots
Limited access	Any format, restricted to bidders meeting a stated condition (a licence, a state, a tag)	Licences, tender slots, distressed-only rescues

Format	How it runs	Default use
Mystery	A partial description before bidding; full reveal on winning	A10
Descending (Dutch)	The price starts high and drops by 10% of the opening price each minute until someone accepts or a floor is reached	Liquidation lots; perishable stock
Multi-unit	Several identical lots in one sealed round; every winner pays the lowest winning bid	Resource blocks when N is 10 or more

9.3 Bidding

- **Who bids.** Companies bid through a signatory, or through an employee holding a bid mandate: a platform record naming the lots and a maximum amount, valid for one session. Participants and free agents may bid personally only on lots marked personal-eligible (usually information, introductions and mystery lots).
- **Covered bids only.** The platform reserves a bidder's cash while they are the top bidder (and on submission, for sealed bids). A bid that available cash cannot cover is refused. A company can lead on several lots at once only if its cash covers all of them.
- **Consortium bids.** Two or more companies may bid jointly if they record the split before the lot opens. Collusion is legitimate strategy; shill bidding (bidding up your own lot) is cheating.
- **One win per session.** A company may win at most one lot per scheduled session. Liquidation and contested-opportunity auctions are outside this limit.
- **Use statement.** Strategic lots (A03, A05, A08, licences) need a one-line statement of intended use as E5 evidence. If the asset is not used within 2 ticks, it returns to the seller without refund.

9.4 Lifecycle, settlement and default

Auctions follow the Technology draft's states: Draft, Announced, Open, Closed, Settlement Pending, then Settled or Defaulted.

- **Announcement.** Scheduled lots are announced at least one tick ahead with asset, opening price, format, close time, eligibility and payment terms (inherited rule). Mystery lots show only their partial description.
- **Reserve price.** The GM may set a hidden reserve. A lot that misses it stays unsold and returns to the GM.
- **Settlement.** Because winning bids are already reserved, settlement on the platform is immediate when the lot closes, and the asset transfers at once.
- **Default** can only happen in paper fallback mode. A defaulting winner forfeits the lot and pays 10% of their bid to the City Reserve, and the lot is offered to the next-highest bidder at their own bid.

9.5 Schedule

Session	Default tick	Lots	Character
1	Tick 3	$\lceil N \div 3 \rceil + 1$ (4 at $N = 7$)	Resources and access, as Very High resources start to bind
2	Tick 5	$\lceil N \div 3 \rceil + 1$	Talent and supplier priority, as capital and talent competition rises
3	Tick 7	$\lceil N \div 3 \rceil + 1$	M&A assets and data, one tick before the capital window opens at Tick 8
4	Tick 9	$\lceil N \div 3 \rceil + 1$	Final strategic lots and the mystery lot before the last shock
Ad hoc	Within 1 tick of the trigger	As needed	Liquidations, contested opportunities, shortage talent auctions

This gives the drafts' 4 to 6 major auctions. The GM may move a session by one tick to protect pacing, and logs the change.

10. How the systems connect, tuning and open questions

The eight systems share one ledger, one evidence standard and one tick, so an outcome in one system is an input to the next: a mission unlocks credit, a missed delivery lowers what the Bank will lend, a failure stocks the next auction.

10.1 Cross-system triggers

When this happens	It triggers
M39 Debt Readiness or another unlock mission completes	Strategic facility eligibility (7.3)
M42 Spin-Out Proof completes	Spin-out customer evidence (8.4)
A Tier 2 or 3 mission in a participant's domain completes	One extra level (5.2)
Two companies commit to the same opportunity in one tick	A sealed-bid auction between them (3.4, 9)

When this happens	It triggers
A contract is breached or a payment missed	The Reliability Record, which the Bank, Investor and Customer desks read (1.5)
A required seat is empty	A 225 VB deficit charge each tick, and lower Workforce Credit (5.3)
A High or Very High resource sits at zero for 2 ticks	Distressed, which opens the emergency loan and rescue routes (8.6)
Verified customer revenue rises	Higher Reference Valuation, which sets investment and merger terms (7.2)
A company fails	A liquidation auction, free agents, and open customer cards (8.6)
A GM shock fires	Parameter changes only: prices, capacity, tiers, credit posture, talent index (6.7, 7.3, 5.6)

10.2 Parameters to tune first

These numbers are new in this document. Each was chosen against the Starting World formulas (payroll of about 5,450 VB per person over 12 ticks, and starting cash of about 34,000 VB at 9 staff), but none has been playtested.

Parameter	Proposed value	Section	Raise it if	Lower it if
RV revenue multiple	6	7.2	Selling feels less rewarding than hoarding cash	Valuations run away from cash reality
Mission budget	$600 \times N$ VB per tick	2.5	Missions are ignored	Missions out-earn customers
Tier reward bands	250–3,000 VB or 5–50 units	2.3	Claims are rare	Players farm missions
Deficit charge	225 VB per empty seat per tick	5.3	Nobody recruits	Poaching becomes a weapon
Domain-change level penalty	Halve the level	5.2	Players switch domains too freely	Nobody changes role
Move cooldown	2 ticks	5.4	Musical chairs	People feel trapped
Bank purchase	30 units per	6.3	Company trading	Shortages kill

Parameter	Proposed value	Section	Raise it if	Lower it if
limit	resource per tick		stays thin	companies
Bank dynamic price steps	+20% / +50%	6.3	Bank remains the easy answer	Prices feel punitive
Storage cap and decay	200 units; 10% per tick above	6.6	Hoarding appears	Producers cannot sell surplus
Supply recipe efficiency	1.5–2.5× input value	6.2	Producers struggle	Producers flood the market
Bank debt ceiling	30,000 VB	7.3	Debt is too scarce to matter	Debt becomes free money
Investor valuation band	0.5–2× RV	7.4	Negotiation feels fixed	Valuations detach from evidence
Dilution cap per round	40%	7.4	Investors walk away	Founders lose control too easily
New ventures per run	$[N \div 3]$	8.5	Founder energy is stifled	Starting companies collapse
Independence floor	$[N \times 0.6]$ companies	8.2	Consolidation is impossible	The market empties
Auction lots per session	$[N \div 3] + 1$	9.5	Auctions feel cramped	Lots go unsold

10.3 Open questions and handoffs

These are not blockers for this document, but later documents or the event owner need to settle them.

1. **Opportunity library size.** A run needs about $2N + 1$ opportunities (25 at $N = 12$) but the library has 20. The Dynamic Events or Institution Operating Content document should add about 10.
2. **Final scoring weights.** How Reference Valuation, Workforce Credit, the Reliability Record, cap-table ownership and liquidation preferences count at Investor Day, and how a merged company is judged against two sets of objectives, belong to the Investor Day and scoring document.
3. **Window timing.** The capital window and Founder Window are GM-scheduled. The capital window opens at Tick 8, matching the Event Operations Manual and Institution Operating Content; the GM Handbook should fix the Founder Window.
4. **Library rescaling.** The mission library's VB rewards need rewriting to the tier bands in 2.3 when the library is next edited.
5. **Dossier fields.** Dossiers must write supply products with a recipe inside the 1.5–2.5× band, record starting Bank-loan liabilities as loans under 7.3, and set a floor price on every Product Card.

Defaults chosen here that the event owner may want to change: free agents are allowed and firing is not (1.6); changing domain halves your level (5.2); 1,000 shares split 80/20 between the Founding Holder and an option pool (7.1); no dividends (7.1); no hostile takeovers (8.2); at most $\lceil N \div 3 \rceil$ new ventures and spin-outs per run (8.5).

Venture City — Event Operations Manual

Oct 5, 2026 · @Nero Kami

This run: Saturday 10 October 2026

The first run is on Saturday 10 October 2026 at RR Campus, 9:00 to 18:00, in two halls on different floors. The 9-hour window fits the 10-tick day with about an hour to spare, and that hour pays for a shared lunch and the move between floors. The tighter constraint is time to prepare: the event is five days away, so section 5's eight-week timeline is replaced by the countdown below.

Fact	Detail
Date	Saturday 10 October 2026
Venue	Seminar Halls on the 9th and 11th floors, Be Block, RR Campus
Hours	Doors 9:00; participants out by 18:00. Building open 07:00 for setup and until 18:45 for teardown
Entry	Free; no payment step at registration
Food	Lunch and snacks provided; lunch is served on the 13th floor
Participants bring	ID card (checked at registration) and a charged phone (the game runs on it)

How the 9-hour window is used

The tick count stays at 10 as confirmed. The extra hour goes to three things:

- **City lunch, 12:35 to 13:05:** the tick clock pauses and everyone eats at once, because lunch is provided for all and served on the 13th floor. This replaces the staggered lunch.
- **Moving between floors:** 10 minutes for Investor Day room B to rejoin the main hall for results.
- **Buffer:** about 10 to 25 minutes at the end, depending on N.

The full timetable is in section 10.1. The last company finishes pitching between 17:04 (N = 7) and 17:22 (N = 12), and results end by 17:52 at the latest.

Two floors, one market

The market must stay on one floor: stations, Institution Row, GM Control, the stage and the Human Internet zone all go in the **larger hall (the main hall)**. Splitting the market across floors would double queues and runners and break the rule that nobody has to ask where an institution is. The other hall becomes the **second hall**.

Main hall (larger)	Second hall
N company stations, Institution Row (7 desks)	Investor Day room B
GM Control, stage (Investor Day room A, results)	Snacks (lunch is on the 13th floor)
Human Internet zone, Investor Room (screened corner)	Staff base and kit storage
Registration at its entrance, first-aid point	Second first-aid point

What changes because of the two floors:

- **Signage:** "Venture City: [9th or 11th] floor" signs at the building entrance, in every lift and at both stairwell landings.
- **Runners:** one Floor runner leads the group to the 13th floor for lunch, and works the second hall during Investor Day and teardown.
- **Safety:** one safety person per floor whenever people are in both halls (the Floater covers the second). The building's evacuation procedure for high floors applies, and lifts are not used in a fire.
- **Staff channel:** radios or a phone group are required, because the halls are out of sight of each other.
- **Movement:** stairs are the default between floors, and lifts are kept for accessibility. Lunch is on the 13th floor, so allow 5 minutes each way and sign the route. Allow 10 minutes for room B to return after Investor Day. If both halls are big enough, make the 11th-floor hall the main hall, because it is closer to lunch.

Countdown

Day	Must be done	Owner
Mon 5 Oct	Confirm volunteers against section 4, with a backup for each; ask the venue for hall capacities, building access times and the catering location	Event Lead
Tue 6 Oct	Walk both halls with the building contact (power, Wi-Fi, PA, lifts and stairs, fire procedure); choose the main hall; draw the floor plan	Event Lead, Tech Lead
Wed 7 Oct	Freeze: GM sets N and the active set from registrations; rules, content and roster versioned. Participant email: 9:00 arrival, bring your ID card, lunch provided, no preparation	GM, Event Lead

Day	Must be done	Owner
	needed. Print order placed	
Thu 8 Oct	Volunteer training, 3 hours (Appendix A.6); tabletop of one tick; platform loaded and paper fallback tested	GM, Tech Lead
Fri 9 Oct	Print collected; N + 1 company kits and desk kits packed; devices charged; signage ready; T-1 checklist (15.2)	Floor runners, Tech Lead
Sat 10 Oct	Build from 07:00 (section 6), briefing 08:30, doors 09:00	All

Venue logistics (resolved)

- **Building hours:** confirmed. The building opens at 07:00 for setup and stays open until 18:45 for teardown.
- **Lunch:** confirmed for the 13th floor. A runner and a safety person go up with the group, and the market halls stay locked or staffed while they are empty.
- **Content, hall capacity and volunteers:** Nero confirmed on 5 October that these are handled.

1. Purpose and how to use this manual

This manual is how a Venture City day gets run on the floor: who is where, when, with what, and what they do when something goes wrong. It is the master execution layer for the Event Lead, the Game Master (GM), and every volunteer. Game rules live in the Starting World and Core Game Systems documents; this manual covers how they are delivered.

Operating principle (inherited): the event should feel spontaneous to participants and controlled to the team. Participants see a living city. The team sees a clock, an inventory, a ledger and an escalation path.

Who reads what

Reader	Read	Skim
Event Lead	Everything	None
The five GMs (Lead, Boundary, Crisis, Market, Floor)	2, 4, 9 to 13, 15, Appendix A	3, 5 to 8
Institution volunteers	9, 11 to 13, Appendix A (own role card), Appendix B (own desk)	2, 10
Company CEO volunteers	9.1, 10, 13, Appendix A,	2, 11

Reader	Read	Skim
	Appendix B section B.10	
Floor, registration, safety, tech	3, 6 to 8, 11 to 14, Appendix A	10
Founder Ledger observers	10, 13, Appendix A role card, B.12	2

Decisions this manual inherits and does not reopen: the 12-company pool with a GM-chosen active set of N companies (7, 10 or 12) and random participant assignment; the 30-minute economic tick; the institution roster; the Human Internet mechanic; the evidence-only Founder Ledger; Investor Day at 5 minutes of pitch plus 3 minutes of questions per company; 50 to 100 participants over a 6 to 8 hour day; digital-first card libraries with paper fallback.

Reconciled in this manual

Conflict in the drafts	Resolution
"10 volunteers" (first draft) versus the ~20+ role staffing table (Event Operations draft)	The ~20+ role model is canonical. Headcount now scales with N (section 4). The 10-volunteer number is retired.
"7 company stations" and "7 Company CEOs" hardcoded	One station and one CEO volunteer per active company, N = 7 to 12.
Volunteer briefing is 70 minutes but volunteers arrive at T-45	Full 70-minute training moves to T-14 days; the day-of briefing is a 30-minute refresh (section 5).
Investor Day sized for 45 minutes, which cannot hold N companies at 8 minutes each	Investor Day runs in two parallel pitch rooms at every N (section 10.4).
Observer count 5 to 6 versus 2 to 4	One observer per 25 participants (Starting World), so 2 to 4.
Deputy GM "optional"	Required at every N. A GM without a deputy becomes the bottleneck the drafts warn against. The role is now the Boundary GM (2026-10-05).
Owner decisions after the complexity audit (2026-10-05)	City Opens runs 09:30 to 10:05 and Human Internet I 10:05 to 10:35 (30 min); during Human Internet I phones stay out but the platform is read-only (own Founder Dossier, role card and objective). The Founder Dossier replaces the passport and is published to Portals at City Opens. Five GMs in lanes (Lead, Boundary, Crisis, Market, Floor) with a shared ruling log; the Lead GM has the final word. At N = 10 Government and Media are separate volunteers and the Investor has two partners, so staff is 38. Investor

Conflict in the drafts	Resolution
	booking in the app from Tick 7. Desk console shows cross-desk history; Media gets an automatic inbox; whispers and signals are delivered by the platform.

All times below use **T0 = City Opens** (dossier reveal). The example clock assumes doors at 09:00.

2. Event at a glance

One number drives the whole operation: **N, the number of active companies**, set by the GM from confirmed registrations at T-7 days. Stations, staff, kits, Investor Day length and inventory all read off N. Nothing in this manual assumes N = 7.

	Small run	Standard run	Large run
Participants (P)	50 to 60	61 to 90	91 to 110
Active companies (N)	7	8 to 10	10 to 12
Staff per company	7 to 9	8 to 10	8 to 10
Company stations	7	8 to 10	10 to 12
Institution desks	8	8	8 (Bank, Customer and Supplier desks doubled)
Total staff (section 4)	about 27	about 33 to 38	about 38 to 42
Observers (1 per 25 P)	2 to 3	3 to 4	4
Investor Day rooms	2	2	2
Floor area, guide only	400 to 500 m ²	500 to 650 m ²	650 to 800 m ²

The N bands come from Starting World section 12.1. Hard limits: never fewer than 6 or more than 12 participants per company at T0. The floor-area figures are a planning assumption (about 6 to 7 m² per person including stations and walkways), not a sourced standard; confirm against the actual venue.

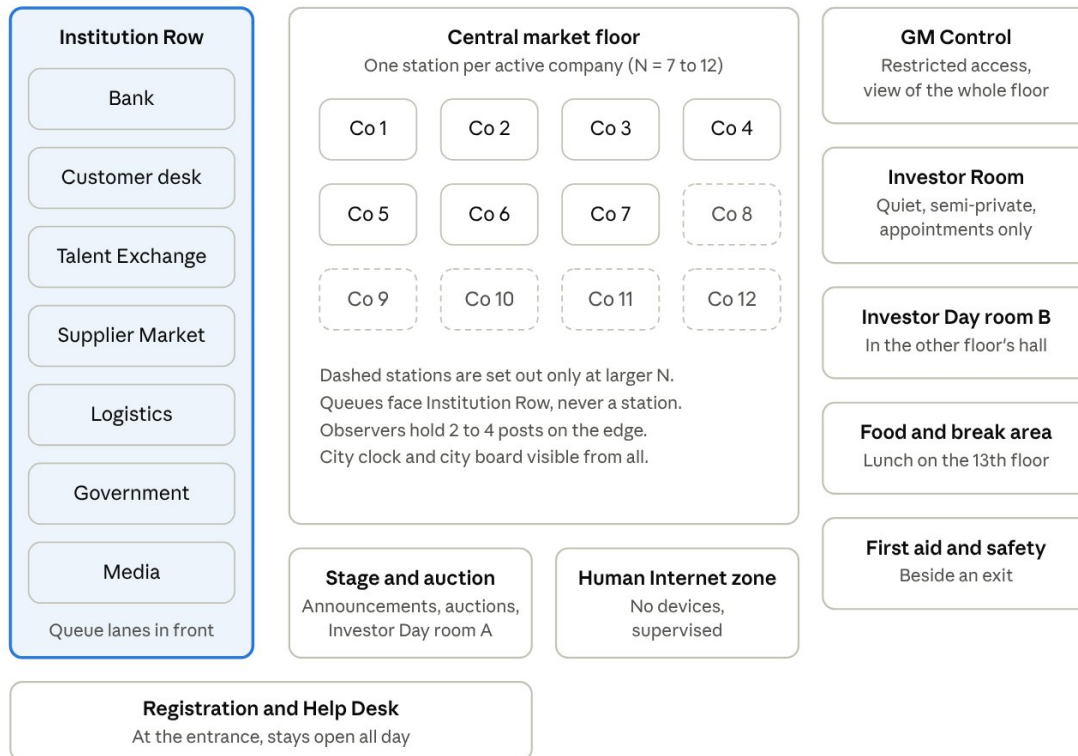
Day shapes. The standard day (section 10, set to 9:00 to 18:00 for 10 October) runs 10 economic ticks between Market Open and the freeze, with a 30-minute paused lunch. A 6-hour compact day runs 7 ticks; see section 10.5 and the open items for what that changes in the economy.

3. Venue and floor layout

The floor must make the market legible: a participant should see where money, talent, customers and resources live without asking. For 10 October the market occupies the larger hall and the other floor's hall takes room B, lunch and storage (see This run). Adapt the plan below to the room, but keep its three

rules: institutions together on one wall, GM Control apart with a view of everything, and quiet rooms off the main floor.

Institutions line one wall so nobody has to ask where they are



Reference floor plan · zones, not to scale

Only N company stations are set out; positions for inactive companies are removed, not left empty.

3.1 Zone requirements

Zone	Contents	Furniture and power	Rule
Central market floor	N company stations	Per station: 2 tables, 4 chairs (most people stand), 1 power point, station sign	Open sightlines; stations visible but private enough to talk
Institution Row	7 desks: Bank, Customer, Talent Exchange, Supplier, Logistics, Government, Media	Per desk: 1 table, 2 chairs behind, 1 power point, price or status board, queue marker	Every desk shows name, one-line purpose and Open / Limited / Closed state
Investor Room	Investor desk and	1 table, 4 chairs, door	Booking board in the app opens at Tick 7;

Zone	Contents	Furniture and power	Rule
	meetings	or screen	meetings from the capital window
GM Control	The five GMs, Tech Lead, master board	3 tables, 7 chairs, 4 power points, wall or screen for the city board	Restricted; no participant strategy talk inside
Stage and auction	Announcements, auctions, Investor Day room A	PA, mic, screen for clock and bids, seating or standing for all P at Investor Day	Audible and visible from every station
Human Internet zone	Conversation area	Open floor, no screens, clear signage	Supervised during Human Internet phases
Investor Day room B	Second pitch room	Screen, 6 chairs for panel and timer, seating for half of P	Set up at every N
Registration and Help Desk	Check-in, badges, help	2 tables, 3 check-in lanes, printer nearby	Near the entrance, open all day
Food and break area	Water all day, meals	Tables, bins	Off the floor; never a scarce resource
First aid and safety	First-aid kit, contacts	Chair, kit, phone	Beside an exit; accessible without crossing play

3.2 Physical principles (inherited, kept)

- Participants never need to ask where an institution is.
- GM Control is physically separated from participant strategy.
- High-value conversations get privacy without becoming inaccessible silos.
- Announcements are audible and visible across the floor.
- Queues never block company stations.
- Money and resources exist only on the platform: there are no physical VB notes or resource tokens. Printed cards are used for information and missions where they help immersion.
- Exits, corridors and accessible routes stay clear at all times.

3.3 Venue selection checklist

- ☐ One main room that holds all P plus staff standing, with space for N stations and 7 desks
- ☐ At least one quiet side room (Investor Room); a second room for Investor Day
- ☐ PA system and a screen visible from the whole floor
- ☐ Power points reachable from every station and desk, or enough extension leads

- ☐ Wi-Fi that carries about 130 devices (participants' phones plus staff devices) to the local platform server, plus a mobile hotspot as backup
- ☐ Step-free access, accessible toilets, and seating available throughout
- ☐ Venue emergency procedures, fire exits and first-aid contact documented
- ☐ Access from T-150 minutes for setup and until T+60 minutes after close for teardown

4. Staffing model

The canonical model is the Event Operations draft's ~20+ role team, scaled by N and by participant count P: about **27 people at N = 7, 38 at N = 10 and 42 at N = 12**. The "10 volunteers" model from the first draft is retired. Role cards, shifts and the reporting tree are in Appendix A.

4.1 Headcount by N

Role	Group	N = 7	N = 10	N = 12	Scales with
Event Lead	Command	1	1	1	Fixed
Lead GM	Command	1	1	1	Fixed; stage, announcements, story, final rulings, Investor Day room A panel
Boundary GM (was Deputy GM / State Controller)	Command	1	1	1	Fixed, required; presses Settle with the Tech Lead, 10-point watch list, company clocks, Distressed recovery
Crisis GM	Command	1	1	1	Fixed; events, crises, exposure ranking, signals and whispers, aftermath opportunities
Market GM	Command	1	1	1	Fixed; missions, opportunities,

Role	Group	N = 7	N = 10	N = 12	Scales with
					held-back customer cards, auctions, Founder Window
Floor GM	Command	1	1	1	Fixed; desk queues, disputes, objective and mission escalations, volunteer cover; chairs Investor Day room B
Company CEO volunteer	Companies	7	10	12	N
Bank	Institutions	1	2	2	Lending pool $8,000 \times N$ VB
Investor	Institutions	1	2	2	Fund is finite; a second partner from $N = 10$ so every company can get a 10-minute appointment
Customer desk (Enterprise and Consumer)	Institutions	1	2	2	$3N$ customer cards
Talent Exchange	Institutions	1	1	2	N specialist contracts
Supplier Market and Logistics	Institutions	1	2	2	$20N$ and $15N$ units per tick

Role	Group	N = 7	N = 10	N = 12	Scales with
Government and Media	Institutions	1	2	2	One shared volunteer at N = 7; separate Government and Media volunteers from N = 10
Tech Lead	Operations	1	1	1	Fixed
Tech support	Operations	0	1	1	Devices on the floor
Founder Ledger observers	Evaluation	2	3	4	1 per 25 P
Comms / MC	Operations	1	1	1	Fixed
Registration and Help Desk	Operations	1	1	1	Fixed; floor staff join at doors
Floor runner	Operations	1	2	2	Floor area
Safety and venue	Operations	1	1	1	Venue rules; 2 if P is over 100
Floater / backup	Operations	1	1	1	Covers breaks and absences
Total		27	38	42	

Five GMs is the plan for this run (10 October, N = 10; owner decision 2026-10-05). Each GM rules in their own lane and writes every ruling to the shared ruling log on the platform; the Lead GM has the final word (section 13.1). The Boundary GM is the role earlier drafts called the Deputy GM / State Controller. Desk queues, disputes, objective and mission escalations and volunteer cover belong to the Floor GM. Where it says the GM without a lane, the GM whose lane covers the task acts, and the Lead GM decides anything that crosses lanes.

Observer counts assume P = 55, 80 and 100. Set the actual number as $P \div 25$, rounded up, capped at 4. Because the whole event runs on the web platform, add one developer on call at GM Control all day. Participants are told about them at Market Open, and the Help Desk is their first stop for app problems.

4.2 Lean floor at N = 7

If fewer than 27 people can be recruited for a 7-company run, combine in this order and no further: Market GM into Crisis GM; Floor GM into Boundary GM; Comms / MC into Boundary GM; Floater into

Floor runner; Registration into Floor runner after doors close. That gives a floor of 22, with three GMs (Lead, Boundary, Crisis). Below 22, do not run: 7 is the smallest active set, and a desk left unstaffed breaks the economy for every company. At larger N the same rule applies: if staffing falls short of the table, drop to the next smaller active set (12 to 10, 10 to 7) before thinning desks. The two GM merges may be used at any N before that; for 10 October the plan is all five GMs and both Investor partners.

4.3 Shared-desk rules

- One volunteer may run two desks, but the rules, records and inventories stay separate.
- Never combine the Bank with the Investor, or the Government with a desk it regulates; the participant must face two independent decisions.
- Never give an institution volunteer a company CEO role.
- Observers never staff a desk; observation and play are kept apart.

4.4 Who can be a volunteer

CEO and institution volunteers are best drawn from people who have done the real job: bankers for the Bank, founders and angels for the Investor, buyers for the Customer desk. They need roleplay confidence more than expertise. Observers need training in behavioural note-taking (section 5, T-14 days) and should not know participants personally; if they do, they declare it and the Evaluation lead reassigns coverage.

5. Pre-event timeline

The event is locked one week out: at T-7 days the GM fixes N and the active set, and rules, content and the staff roster are frozen with a version number. Everything before that builds toward the freeze; everything after it is packing and rehearsal.

When	Milestone	Owner	Done when
T-8 weeks	Date, venue shortlist, budget; start volunteer recruitment against the N = 10 column of section 4	Event Lead	Venue held; recruitment open
T-6 weeks	Venue confirmed and walked; floor plan drafted (section 3); participant registration opens	Event Lead, Venue lead	Signed venue; plan v1
T-4 weeks	Volunteer roles provisionally assigned, each with a named backup; tech architecture and paper fallbacks agreed; print	Event Lead, GM, Tech Lead	Roster v1; tech plan

When	Milestone	Owner	Done when
	list drafted		
T-3 weeks	Accessibility and dietary needs collected from registrations; catering ordered with a provisional headcount	Event Lead	Catering booked
T-14 days	Full volunteer training (3 hours): the 70-minute briefing protocol (Appendix A.6), role-specific desk drills, scriptbook rehearsal (Appendix B), observer calibration on sample evidence	GM, Event Lead	Every volunteer trained or scheduled for catch-up
T-10 days	Registration closes or waitlists; participant pre-event email (arrival time, bring an ID card, no prep needed)	Participant Ops	Email sent
T-7 days	Freeze. GM sets P estimate, N and the active set; rules, content and roster versioned (for example VC-2026.1, EVENT-01); 60 to 90 minute tabletop simulation with the core team; starting money and inventory reconciled at the chosen N	GM, Event Lead	Version tags recorded; tabletop done
T-5 days	Print order placed: N company kits plus 1 reserve kit, 7 desk kits, GM pack, signage, forms (section 8)	Event Lead	Order confirmed
T-3 days	Platform loaded with active set, roster and	Tech Lead, Boundary GM	Test log signed off

When	Milestone	Owner	Done when
	inventory; full paper-fallback test; staff call sheet and radio or messaging channel sent		
T-1 day	Kits packed and labelled; devices charged; dashboards loaded; emergency contact sheet printed; Investor Day slides template ready	Floor runners, Tech Lead	T-1 checklist (section 15) complete
T-150 min	Command team, tech and floor crew arrive; venue safety walk; build starts (section 6)	Event Lead	Build under way
T-90 min	All volunteers arrive; desks and stations set; starting state reconciled	All	Every station signs its setup sheet
T-60 min	Day-of briefing, 30 minutes (Appendix A.6)	GM	Briefing done
T-30 min	Doors open; registration (section 7)	Registration	Check-in running
T0	City opens	GM	Clock running

Setting N at T-7 days. Take confirmed registrations, expect some no-shows (assume 10 to 15% until the first run gives a real figure), and read N off the section 2 table. Pack one reserve company kit drawn from the pool so the GM can add a company on the day if turnout is high. If turnout is low, the GM can drop a company only before T0 (dossier reveal); after that, companies stay and a small one is handled by in-game mechanics.

6. Setup and build

The build runs from T-150 to T-30 minutes in a fixed order: safety, power and network first, furniture second, kits third, reconciliation last. Nothing hidden goes on the floor until the reconciliation is signed.

Time (example clock)	Task	Owner
T-150 (07:00)	Venue safety walk: exits, first aid, accessible routes, fire	Event Lead, Safety

Time (example clock)	Task	Owner
	procedure confirmed with venue	
T-150	Local platform server and network up; hotspot tested; developer on call at GM Control; GM Control powered; city clock and board on screen	Tech Lead
T-140	Furniture placed to plan: N stations, 7 desks, Investor Room, stage, Human Internet zone signage, registration lanes	Floor runners
T-120	Signage up: every station and desk named with its one-line purpose; directional signs from the entrance	Floor runners
T-110	Devices placed and logged in at every desk, station and registration lane	Tech Lead, Tech support
T-100	Desk kits placed (sealed); company kits held at GM Control until the CEO volunteer collects	Boundary GM
T-90 (08:00)	Volunteers arrive, sign in at GM Control, collect role card, radio or channel access, and kit	Floor GM
T-80	Each desk checks its opening inventory, lending pool and price board on the platform against the GM's starting-state sheet; each CEO checks the company kit against its manifest	Every volunteer
T-70	Test every transaction path once end to end, digital and paper (one loan, one resource sale, one hire, one contract)	Tech Lead, desks
T-65	Boundary GM signs the reconciliation: starting VB,	Boundary GM

Time (example clock)	Task	Owner
	resources and capacities equal the approved state for this N	
T-60 (08:30)	Day-of briefing (Appendix A.6)	GM
T-35	PA, mic and announcement test; Investor Day screen test	Comms / MC
T-30 (09:00)	Doors open	Registration

Rules for the build

- Public material only on the floor. Event cards, crisis envelopes, hidden-mechanic triggers and unreleased opportunities stay in GM custody.
- Founder Dossiers stay unpublished until the GM opens the city at T0.
- VB and resources exist only on the platform; no notes or tokens are printed. Paper forms are numbered so any used during an outage can be keyed in and traced.
- A desk is not open until its volunteer has signed the setup sheet. An unsigned desk stays dark at T0 and the Floor GM is told.

7. Registration and check-in

Check-in takes 30 minutes for up to 110 people through 3 lanes, about 40 seconds per person. Each participant leaves the desk with a badge, a random company assignment and directions to their station, and nothing else: the dossier is revealed at the station at T0.

7.1 Lanes and staffing

Lane	Staffed by	Handles
Lane 1 and Lane 2	Registration lead, Floor runner	Pre-registered participants: identity check, badge, assignment
Lane 3	Floor runner 2 or Floater	Walk-ins, name changes, accessibility needs, problems

7.2 Check-in steps

1. Check the participant's ID card against the roster. If they have no ID card, Lane 3 verifies them by their registration email and notes it.
2. Record any accessibility or dietary need not already on file, and tell the Safety lead if it affects the floor.
3. Assign a company at random (section 7.3) and print or hand over the badge: participant name, participant ID, company name and colour.
4. Hand over the personal starter card: participant ID, the 1,000 VB personal wallet, and a portal login or QR code.

5. Point to the company station on the floor map. Say the arrival line (Appendix B.11).
6. Do not explain rules, hidden mechanics or strategy. "Your CEO will brief you at your station" covers every question.

7.3 Random assignment

Assignment is always random within the active set, with company sizes kept within one person of each other. Participants do not choose, swap or request companies.

- **Platform method (default):** the platform assigns each participant at check-in to a random company among those with the fewest people so far.
- **Paper fallback:** before doors, build a shuffled deck of assignment cards with exactly the planned count per company ($P \div N$, remainders spread one each). Each participant draws the top card. At doors-close, the Floor GM rebalances any company more than one person off by moving the most recent arrivals only.
- Groups who arrive together are not kept together.
- The Founder Ledger opens empty for everyone, whatever company they draw.

7.4 Late arrivals and no-shows

- **Before T0:** check in normally.
- **T0 to Market Open:** assign to the smallest company; the CEO volunteer gives a 2-minute catch-up.
- **After Market Open:** the participant joins the city at its current state with the standard personal starter card. They get no missed salary, resources or advantages unless the GM has published a catch-up rule.
- **Leaving early:** the participant tells their CEO volunteer and the Help Desk. Their employment ends at the next tick, under the Core Game Systems rule for departures.
- **No-shows:** at T-5 minutes the Floor GM confirms final company sizes. If any company is below 6 (the hard minimum), the GM rebalances before dossier reveal.

7.5 Registration records

The roster at doors-close records name, participant ID, company, arrival time, and any needs flagged. Two printed copies go to the GM and the Help Desk; the digital roster is the master.

8. Materials and technology kit

Card libraries and game state are digital first; paper exists so the event never stops. Every quantity below is a formula of N (active companies), P (participants) and S (staff), so the print order is read off the T-7 freeze.

8.1 Kits

Kit	How many	Contents	Owner
Company kit	$N + 1$ reserve	No printed dossier or passport (the Founder Dossier is published to	CEO volunteer (Mohnish, hotseat)

Kit	How many	Contents	Owner
		Portals at City Opens; one printed copy per company sits only in the paper failsafe kit at GM Control), product cards, starting-package contracts, signatory form, paper ledger sheets, station sign, 10 blank deal forms	
Desk kit	7 (Bank, Customer, Talent, Supplier, Logistics, Government, Media) + Investor	Desk rules card, price or status board, opening inventory sheet, transaction forms (30 per desk), queue marker, Open / Limited / Closed sign, desk script card (Appendix B)	Desk volunteer (Anamitra)
GM pack	1	Starting-state sheet for this N, event and crisis envelopes, opportunity and mission registers, auction register, rumour register, master run sheet, ruling log	GM
Boundary GM pack	1	Incident log, reconciliation sheets, roster copy, call sheet, version tags	Boundary GM
Observer pack	1 per observer + 1 spare	Founder Ledger sheets (40 per observer), coverage map, clipboard	Observers
Registration kit	1	Printed roster x2, badges for P + 10%, starter cards, assignment card deck,	Registration

Kit	How many	Contents	Owner
		floor maps	
Investor Day kit	1 per room	Pitch order, timer, slide template; decision cards, one per company per room (Playbook 1.4); a Pitch Sheet template, one per company plus spares (Playbook 1.5); a Frozen Snapshot per company, three copies (one for the company, one per panel)	Comms / MC

8.2 Consumables

Item	Quantity	Notes
Name badges	P + 10%	Company colour applied at check-in
Staff badges	S, by role colour	Command, Institution, Company, Ops, Observer
Platform join posters (QR code and local address)	1 per station and desk, plus 4 at registration	Points phones at the local server
Deal, loan, hire, investment forms	30 per desk, 10 per station, 50 spare	Numbered pads, used only if the platform or a module is down; keyed in afterwards
Mission and opportunity cards	Active library for this run, printed once	Platform first; paper copies held by GM
Signage	1 per station and desk, plus 6 directional	Name plus one-line purpose

No VB notes or resource tokens are produced. Money and resources exist only on the platform.

8.3 Technology kit

Item	Quantity	Fallback
Local platform server	1, at GM Control, with a restore snapshot	Paper forms plus the last tick export

Item	Quantity	Fallback
Venue Wi-Fi to the local server	About 130 devices (about 100 phones plus about 30 staff devices)	Mobile hotspot first, then paper
Participant phones	1 per participant, brought charged	Spare device at the Help Desk; paper forms
Tablet or laptop	1 per desk, 1 per station, 2 at registration, 3 at GM Control (N + 13 total)	Paper forms and the Founder Dossier copy in the paper failsafe kit at GM Control
Developer on call	1, at GM Control all day	Tech Lead
Big screen for city clock and board	1 on the floor, 1 per Investor Day room	Wall clock and printed bulletin board (Projector)
Power strips and extension leads	1 per station and desk, plus phone charging at the Help Desk	Charged spares
Spare charged devices	3	Paper
Printer	1, at GM Control	Pre-printed forms
PA with 2 microphones	1	Megaphone and runner
Staff radios or a staff messaging channel	1 per staff member	Runner

Technology rule: the web platform, hosted on a local server at the venue, is the only record of money, resources, deals and missions. Participants use it on their own phones. If the platform fails, desks switch to the numbered paper forms. The Boundary GM restarts from the last tick export, and the Tech Lead keys the backlog in time order when the platform returns (section 13.3, and the [Technology Platform Specification](#)).

8.4 Paper and record control

- Unused mission, opportunity, event and crisis cards stay with the GM.
- Any paper form used during an outage carries its form number, time and tick, and is keyed into the platform before the freeze.
- Avoided document is marked VOID and kept, never thrown away.
- Sensitive material is kept physically apart from public material at every desk.
- There is no physical currency. Anything that looks like a VB note has no value in the city.

9. Stations and institution desks

The floor runs N company stations and 8 institution desks. Stations are a company's home; desks are the city. Both facilitate action and never do the participant's work for them.

9.1 Company stations

Each station is run by its CEO volunteer, who plays the company's persona card (the persona belongs to the company, so a replacement volunteer picks up the same card). The station keeps the minimum state a team needs to decide.

Company record	Track
People	Employees, roles, levels, signatories
Cash	VB balance, receivables, payables, liability due tick
Resources	Stock, committed units, per-tick consumption
Customers	Anchor contract, leads, pilots, contracts
Suppliers	Supplier agreement (expires at Tick 4 unless renewed), dependencies
Capital	Debt, equity, milestones
Products	Product cards and delivery capacity
Deals and opportunities	Pending and closed; claimed opportunities

Station rule (inherited): if a team needs someone outside the company, the CEO volunteer points them to the right institution or person rather than doing it for them. The CEO volunteer opens the dossier at T0, runs the signatory election, and then steps back; the two signatories run the company jointly if the CEO volunteer "leaves the city."

9.2 Institution desks

Desk	Opens	What it controls	Capacity at N (Starting World s.9)
Bank	Market Open	Base resources, loans, deposits	Stock 40N per resource, restock 10N per tick; lending pool 8,000N VB
Investor	Capital window (GM schedules; default Tick 8); booking opens in the app at Tick 7	Equity capital, by appointment with one of two partners at N = 10; the platform shows each company's valuation ceiling (RV x thesis fit) to the partner	Fund 14,000N VB; at most $N \times 0.7$ deals, rounded up

Desk	Opens	What it controls	Capacity at N (Starting World s.9)
Customer desk	Market Open	Anchor contracts, open customer cards, held-back cards	N anchor cards, 2N open cards
Talent Exchange	Market Open	Job board, specialist contracts, poaching records	N specialist contracts
Supplier Market	Market Open	Discounted resources by contract	20N units per resource per tick
Logistics	Market Open	Delivery capacity	Standard 15N, priority 7N units per tick
Government	Market Open; grant window later	Licences, tenders, grants	Grant pool 3,000N VB
Media	Market Open	Featured stories, campaigns	1 featured slot per tick, 2 when N is 10 or more

All desks take enquiries from T0 but trade only from Market Open. Prices and capacities come from the GM's starting-state sheet; a desk never changes them on its own.

9.3 The desk protocol (inherited)

Participant arrives → ask what they want → identify what they offer → check eligibility → negotiate within rules → confirm → record → release resource or access → next.

- Routine transactions take under 2 minutes. Anything longer moves to the side of the desk or to GM review.
- Every desk shows its name, purpose, public rules and current state (Open, Limited, Closed).
- When a queue passes 5 people, the desk starts a numbered queue and the Floor runner tells the Floor GM.
- The record for every transaction: time, desk, party, counterparty, type, amount, terms, approver, status.

Desk console. The platform desk console shows the asker's history across all desks and flags the Earned items they already qualify for. The volunteer still logs each item by hand, and every desk can see the other desks' records. The Media desk also gets an automatic inbox copy of fact-check requests, rumour plants, debunks (with a draft correction), objective lodges that name Media, and amplification counts.

9.4 Throughput targets

Measure	Target	Action if missed
Routine transaction	Under 2 minutes	Simplify the form or add the

Measure	Target	Action if missed
		Floater
Queue length	5 or fewer	Numbered queue; Floor GM considers a second volunteer
Queue wait	Under 5 minutes, repeatedly	GM reviews whether the desk has become the only path (section 13.6)
Investor meeting	10-minute slots	In-app booking board (opens Tick 7, meetings from Tick 8); two partners at N = 10 cover every company; no walk-ins

9.5 Desk closures

Closure is a deliberate scarcity mechanic, never a punishment, and always has a city reason. Only the GM orders one. The desk turns its sign to Closed or Limited, states until when, keeps honouring settled contracts, and points people to alternatives. A real volunteer absence is handled as an operations problem first (Floater covers) and only becomes a game closure if the GM chooses to announce it.

10. Run of show

The standard day runs from doors at 9:00 to departure by 18:00. It has 10 economic ticks of 30 minutes from Market Open at 10:35 to the freeze at 16:05, with the tick clock paused for a city lunch from 12:35 to 13:05. Investor Day runs in two parallel rooms on different floors. The GM may move any event within its tick; the tick clock itself never moves.

10.1 Standard day (9:00 to 18:00)

Clock	From T0	Tick	Phase (Event Foundation)	What happens on the floor	Ops cues
09:00	-0:30		Arrival and identity	Registration with ID card check, random assignment, badges (section 7)	Registration lanes open; CEOs at stations
09:30	0:00	T0	The city opens	35 minutes: GM welcome from the stage; company reveal at	Observers begin; first Founder Ledger point is the signatory election; Tech

Clock	From T0	Tick	Phase (Event Foundation)	What happens on the floor	Ops cues
				stations; meet the team; GM publishes each company's Founder Dossier to Portals and teams read it; envelopes and personal items; signatory election	Lead loads each company's inbox release schedule (Company Dossiers N.16) so inbox messages drip-feed by tick
10:05	0:35		Human Internet I (30 min)	Information moves by talking. Phones may stay out, but the GM locks the platform to read-only: each participant can read only their own Founder Dossier, role card and objective. No deals, chat, card trading or wallet actions on the platform; personal wallets buy facts on paper Trade Slips; company deals recorded as Proposed only	GM announces start and sets the platform to HI read-only; HI zone supervised

Clock	From T0	Tick	Phase (Event Foundation)	What happens on the floor	Ops cues
10:35	1:05	1	The market opens	All desks trade; first salaries and consumption at tick end; first public missions live (N + 1)	GM announces Market Open; city clock starts
11:05	1:35	2		Discovery and first deals	15-minute GM pacing check
11:35	2:05	3	First value checkpoint	Companies show a first outcome by the end of Tick 3 (12:05)	Boundary GM logs which companies have one
12:05	2:35	4	Market Event I	First controlled shock; supplier agreements expire at the end of Tick 4 unless renewed	Brief affected desks 10 min before; aftermath opportunity ready
12:35	3:05	Paused	City lunch	Tick clock paused; all desks closed; lunch on the 13th floor; talking allowed, nothing recorded or settled	GM announces the pause; runner leads the way to the 13th floor; safety goes with the group
13:05	3:35	5	Talent and opportunity market	Market reopens; hiring, poaching, missions	GM announces restart

Clock	From T0	Tick	Phase (Event Foundation)	What happens on the floor	Ops cues
13:35	4:05	6	Talent and opportunity market	Anchor contracts lapse after Tick 6 (14:05)	Customer desk ready for renewals
14:05	4:35	7	Company evolution; Human Internet II	M&A, partnerships, spin-outs open; second information layer for 30 minutes	GM announces HI II; desks briefed on evolution rules; Investor booking board opens in the app
14:35	5:05	8	Capital market	Investor fund opens; booked meetings start; first major auction	Investor Room opens; auction on stage
15:05	5:35	9	Major crisis	Systemic event; response window ends at Tick 9 close	Sealed crisis instructions to desks; all observers on the floor
15:35	6:05	10	Final build and survival window	Final deals, final auction; "final phase" announced at 15:35	T-30 announcement; final opportunities only
15:55	6:25		Transaction cutoff	No new deals	T-10 announcement
16:05	6:35		Final market freeze	State locked (section 10.3)	Exports and reconciliation start
16:05	6:35		Investor Day preparation	Companies prepare 5-minute	Both rooms set; snacks out

Clock	From T0	Tick	Phase (Event Foundation)	What happens on the floor	Ops cues
				pitches; room B companies move to the second hall	
16:25	6:55		Investor Day	Two parallel rooms: 3-minute opening, then 9 minutes per company (5 pitch, 3 questions, 1 changeover)	Section 10.4
17:04 to 17:22			Pitches end (by N)	Room B returns to the main hall (10 minutes)	Runner leads room B down or up the stairs
17:14 to 17:52			Results and awards	Founder Ledger reveal, company results, awards (20 minutes)	Plenary on the stage
By 18:00			Close	Survey link, thanks, departure	Teardown begins (section 14)

10.2 At every tick boundary

The tick runs automatically on the platform; the Boundary GM runs the paper version if it is down.

1. Charge baseline resource consumption by tier and pay salaries (Starting World section 6).
2. Raise levels for participants who worked the tick in the same domain.
3. Restock Bank (10N per resource) and reset per-tick capacities (Supplier, Logistics, Media slots).
4. Check scheduled due items: liabilities, contract deliveries, expiries.
5. Update the city board; Boundary GM notes cash or resource anomalies.
6. The platform exports the journal and every company's balances; the Boundary GM keeps the latest export ready to print as the paper restart point.

GM rhythm (inherited): continuously watch queues, disputes and energy; every 15 minutes check pacing and desk load; every 30 minutes reconcile the tick; every 60 minutes review the opportunity pipeline, Founder Ledger coverage and crisis readiness; brief affected volunteers before every major event and record consequences after it. In the final hour add no new complexity; in the final 30 minutes protect the freeze.

10.3 Final hour and freeze

1. From Tick 9, open only high-impact final opportunities; stop low-value missions.
2. At 15:35 (T-30): "The market is entering its final phase."
3. At 15:55 (T-10): transaction cutoff. Only already-recorded deals may settle.
4. At 16:05: GM announces FINAL MARKET FREEZE. No new deals, purchases, hires or transfers.
5. Lock company cash, resources, contracts, ownership and employment.
6. Collect paper evidence and any failsafe forms used; Tech Lead exports the state; any paper forms used are keyed in and handed to GM Control.
7. Each company receives its frozen snapshot for Investor Day. Nothing done after the freeze changes a result.

10.4 Investor Day operations

Format is fixed: 5 minutes of pitch and 3 minutes of questions per company, plus 1 minute of changeover. Two parallel rooms run at every N, so the pitch block stays under an hour; both rooms then reconvene on the stage for results.

N	Companies per room	Pitch block	Pitches end (from 16:25)	Results and awards end
7	4 and 3	3 + 36 = 39 min	17:04	about 17:34
8	4 and 4	39 min	17:04	about 17:34
9 to 10	5 and 4, or 5 and 5	48 min	17:13	about 17:43
12	6 and 6	57 min	17:22	about 17:52

Results and awards take about 20 minutes on the stage, after a 10-minute move back from the second hall. Room A is the main hall's stage; room B is the hall on the other floor.

- **Room A** (stage): an Investor partner, the Lead GM, and an optional guest investor form the panel. **Room B:** Floor GM (chair), Bank lead and Government volunteer. Pitch order is drawn at random at the freeze; companies are split between rooms by that draw. The first $\lceil P \div 2 \rceil$ draws go to room A, so the larger half stays on the stage. P is the number of companies pitching.
- Comms / MC times every slot with a visible countdown and cuts at 5:00 and 3:00 without exception.
- Observers split across rooms and record evidence, not impressions.
- Pitch structure handed to companies: what we started with, what changed, what we built, what customers valued, how we survived, where the opportunity is now, why this team should continue.

- Scoring and award decisions follow the [Investor Day Playbook](#); this manual only runs the room.

10.5 Six-hour compact day

Use only when the venue or audience cannot take a full day. It runs 7 ticks and always uses two Investor Day rooms.

Clock	Block
09:00	Doors and registration (20 min, 4 lanes)
09:20	City opens, orientation (15 min)
09:35	Human Internet I (30 min)
10:05 to 13:35	Ticks 1 to 7; Market Event I at Tick 3; staggered lunch Ticks 3 to 4; Human Internet II and capital window at Tick 5; crisis at Tick 6
13:35	Freeze, then 15 minutes of preparation
13:50	Investor Day, two rooms (about 40 min at N = 7)
14:35 to 15:00	Results, awards, close

The Starting World economy was tuned for about 10 to 12 ticks (a 7 to 9 tick runway, a Tick 4 supplier expiry, a Tick 6 anchor lapse). At 7 ticks those pressure points arrive too late to matter, so the compact day needs a compact parameter set from the Core Game Systems document before it is used.

11. Movement, flow and breaks

The market stops once, for a 30-minute city lunch with the tick clock paused. At every other time people rotate, desks stay covered, and only the clock decides when the city changes. Food, water and rest are never scarce resources.

11.1 Flow on the floor

- Participants move freely between stations, desks and zones at all times except Investor Day.
- Queues form in marked lanes in front of Institution Row, facing away from stations.
- The Investor Room is by appointment, booked on the in-app board, which opens at Tick 7 and shows free slots.
- GM Control is staff only. A participant who needs the GM goes through any desk or the Help Desk.
- Floor runners walk the floor continuously, move materials, and report crowding to the Floor GM.
- For stage moments (City Opens, Market Open, auctions, crisis alerts, freeze), the MC calls people to face the stage; nobody is asked to leave a negotiation to walk there.

11.2 Breaks for participants

Window	Pattern	Rule
Ticks 1 to 4	Short individual breaks whenever needed	Water and snacks available all day
City lunch, 12:35 to 13:05	Tick clock paused; everyone eats on the 13th floor	All desks closed; talking allowed, nothing recorded or settled
Ticks 5 to 10	Short individual breaks	No scheduled long interruption
Freeze to Investor Day	20-minute preparation with snacks	

An 8-hour simulation causes cognitive fatigue. Peaks need valleys: the lunch window is deliberately quiet so people can think.

11.3 Breaks for staff

Every volunteer gets a 30-minute meal break and two 10-minute breaks. The Floater and the Floor GM schedule them (Appendix A.4) so no desk is ever left unstaffed without a Closed sign. All volunteers, CEOs included, take their meal during the paused city lunch; the five GMs eat in turn.

11.4 Accessibility

- Seating is available at every station, desk and zone.
- Investor Day rooms keep step-free seating at the front.
- Participants who need quiet can use the Investor Room outside appointment slots or the break area.
- Needs recorded at check-in reach the Safety lead and the participant's CEO volunteer, and nobody else.

12. Announcements and communications

Announce what participants need to know, never what they should do; silence is part of the game. Staff talk on a separate channel that participants never hear, and anything real-world is said in words no game announcement ever uses.

12.1 Channels

Channel	Audience	Used for	Owner
PA and stage	Everyone	City Opens, Market Open, events, crises, auctions, freeze	Comms / MC, GM
City board and clock (screen)	Everyone	Tick, time left, prices, desk states, public	Tech Lead, GM

Channel	Audience	Used for	Owner
		notices	
Participant portal	One participant or company	Private updates, balances, missions	Tech Lead, GM
Printed bulletin	Everyone	Public notices if screens fail	Comms / MC
Desk or station	Whoever visits	Local information	That volunteer
Staff channel (radio or messaging)	Staff only	Coordination, escalation	Floor GM
Runner	One person	Urgent physical delivery, sealed instructions	Floor runner
Whispers and signals (platform)	The holders the platform picks	The Crisis GM picks the card and a holder rule (for example "2 outsiders lowest on exposure"); the platform picks holders from the exposure ranking and delivers. No hand-routing	Crisis GM

12.2 Staff channel discipline

- **Command channel:** Event Lead, the five GMs, Tech Lead, Safety. **Floor channel:** all staff.
- Messages start with who and where: "Bank to Floor GM, queue at eight."
- Game secrets never go on the floor channel; sealed instructions go by runner or private message.
- The code word "**REAL WORLD**" means a real incident (safety, medical, conduct). It is never used in play, and it overrides every game task.

12.3 Announcement templates (inherited, extended)

- **Market event:** "CITY NOTICE: [EVENT NAME]. Effective now until [TICK], [RULE CHANGE]. Affected: [WHO]. This is a market condition, not an instruction. The market is open."
- **Crisis:** "CITY ALERT: [CRISIS]. [WHAT CHANGED]. Response window: until the end of Tick [X]. Any valid response is allowed. Consequences are based on the state at [DEADLINE]."
- **Auction:** "AUCTION OPEN: [ASSET]. Opening bid: [VB]. Eligibility: [RULE]. Bidding closes at [TIME]. Settlement required by [TIME]."
- **Desk closure:** "CITY NOTICE: [DESK] is [closed / limited] until [TIME]. Recorded commitments keep their terms unless the GM announces otherwise."

- **City Opens (T0):** "Welcome to Venture City. Every one of you works for a company that is solvent today. What happens next is up to you. Your CEO has your company file. The city is open."
- **Human Internet start:** "For the next [30] minutes the internet is down. Your phone shows only your own Founder Dossier: no deals, chat or wallet on the platform. Everything else you need to know is in someone's head. Go and find it."
- **Human Internet end:** "The internet is back. Anything learned from a search now does not count toward Human Internet missions."
- **Market Open:** "The market is open. The Bank, Customer desk, Talent Exchange, Suppliers, Logistics, Government and Media are trading. Tick 1 has started."
- **Final phase (T-30):** "Thirty minutes to the freeze. Close what matters."
- **Cutoff (T-10):** "Ten minutes. No new deals from now. Only recorded deals may settle."
- **Freeze:** "FINAL MARKET FREEZE. The city is closed. Nothing done from this moment changes a result."
- **Real incident:** "This is a REAL WORLD announcement, not part of the game. [INSTRUCTION]."

12.4 What never gets announced

Hidden mechanics, another company's private state, the event schedule, Founder Ledger content or how it is scored, and any hint at the best strategy. Fictional alarms are never worded so they could be mistaken for a real emergency.

13. Incidents and emergencies

Safety beats the game, every time: any real incident stops the affected part of the city at once and the Event Lead takes over. Game problems go the other way, from the volunteer up to the GM, and the GM fixes them with the smallest ruling that works.

13.1 Decision hierarchy (inherited)

1. Safety and venue rules
2. Published game rules
3. Recorded transactions and contracts
4. Explicit event or crisis rules
5. Fairness and consistency across participants
6. Pacing and experience
7. GM judgement where the rules genuinely do not cover a case

Who rules. Five GMs each rule in their own lane (section 4.1) and write every ruling to the shared ruling log on the platform, which all five can see. The Lead GM has the final word; item 7 means the Lead GM's judgement when lanes disagree.

13.2 Emergency scenarios

Scenario	Immediate action	Game action	Lead
Medical	Call first aid or emergency services;	GM pauses the	Safety

Scenario	Immediate action	Game action	Lead
	clear space	affected area	
Fire or evacuation	Follow the venue procedure; staff sweep their zones	Game stops; Tech Lead snapshots state if safe	Event Lead
Power failure	Safety check; switch to paper	Paper mode; ticks run on the wall clock	Tech Lead
Internet or platform failure	Tech failure procedure (13.3)	Paper ledger	Tech Lead
Device failure	Swap a spare device	Paper record meanwhile	Tech support
Volunteer absent	Floater covers; Floor GM reassigns	Reduced desk capacity if needed	Floor GM
Major rule bug	Pause the affected mechanic	GM temporary ruling, announced if public	GM
Crowding	Redirect; open a numbered queue or second desk	None	Floor runner
Conduct or safeguarding concern	Separate people calmly; take the person reporting to a quiet space	Participant removed from play if needed	Event Lead
Participant distressed by a game event	Step them out of play; offer a break	GM reviews whether the event was fair	Safety, GM

13.3 Technology failure procedure (inherited)

1. Tech Lead tells the GM the system is unavailable.
2. GM decides whether it is local or citywide and announces paper mode if citywide.
3. Affected desks switch to paper forms; every paper record gets a time and tick.
4. Play continues.
5. When the system is back, the Tech Lead enters paper records in time order.
6. Balances are reconciled with affected companies; the incident is logged.

13.4 Disputes

Step	Action	Owner
1	Pause the disputed transaction	Volunteer

Step	Action	Owner
2	Ask each party for the recorded terms	Volunteer
3	Check the published rule	Volunteer
4	If still unresolved, escalate	Volunteer to Floor GM
5	The GM whose lane it is issues a narrow ruling; the Lead GM decides if lanes disagree	GM
6	Record it in the shared ruling log; announce it as precedent if it affects others	Floor GM, in the shared ruling log

Never decide a dispute on who sounds more convincing; decide on records and rules. Escalate whenever the issue touches more than one desk, changes a major outcome, would reveal a hidden mechanic, or has no precedent.

13.5 Incident log

Every incident, game or real, is logged by the Boundary GM: time, area, what happened, immediate action, GM ruling, who was affected, permanent fix, follow-up owner, and severity.

Severity	Meaning	Example
Low	No effect on outcomes	A form filled wrongly and corrected
Medium	One company or desk affected	A mispriced sale, a 10-minute desk outage
High	Several companies, or a result at risk	Platform down citywide, a disputed acquisition
Critical	Safety, conduct, or the event cannot continue	Medical emergency, evacuation

13.6 Red flags and recovery (inherited)

Red flag	Immediate response
Routine waits of more than 5 minutes, repeatedly	Add capacity or simplify the record
Too little activity	Release customer demand, a mission or an opportunity
Everyone follows the same strategy	Release a counter-opportunity

Red flag	Immediate response
One desk is the only path to progress	Release an opportunity tied to another desk
Cash hoarding	Open attractive capital or resource opportunities
One company dominates	Do not punish it; create counter-opportunities for others
Participants ask volunteers what to do	Volunteers redirect with the B.1 scripts; GM releases a visible opportunity
A crisis eliminates a company without a choice	Open a recovery path; review the trigger after the event
Volunteers improvising hidden advantages	Floor GM corrects at once; Lead GM reviews affected deals
GM resolving basic rule questions all day	Lane GMs take routine rulings and log them in the shared ruling log; publish the common answer

14. Teardown and close-out

The event is not over until the state is exported, every paper form used has been keyed into the platform, and the volunteer debrief is written down. Settlement starts at the freeze; the venue is cleared by 18:45, when the building closes.

14.1 Settlement

Item	Owner	When
VB settlement and loan book	Bank, GM	At the freeze
Resource reconciliation	Supplier, GM	At the freeze
Company records and paper evidence	CEO volunteers	Before Investor Day
Investment records and cap tables	Investor	Before results
Founder Ledger sheets collected and entered	Evaluation lead	During the day and by the freeze
Platform state export, audit log, database backup	Tech Lead	Before teardown
Incident log closed	Boundary GM	End of day
Physical inventory: forms,	Floor runners	During teardown

Item	Owner	When
devices, kits		

14.2 Teardown order

1. Collect all sensitive material first (event cards, Founder Ledger sheets, rosters) into the GM pack.
2. Count and log devices; charge and pack.
3. Strike desks and stations; bag VOID and completed forms for the archive.
4. Remove signage; restore furniture to the venue's layout.
5. Final walk with the venue; Event Lead signs off.

14.3 Debriefs

Participants (end of day, plus a survey within 24 hours): what was the first thing you tried to create value from; which assumption turned out wrong; which relationship became unexpectedly valuable; when did the market change your strategy; what would you do with four more hours.

Volunteers (30 minutes after teardown, notes taken by the Floor GM): where participants got stuck; which desk became an unintended bottleneck; which rule was unclear; which mechanic produced the strongest behaviour; which event felt artificial; which opportunities were found without prompting; which systems failed or slowed play.

14.4 Post-event data package

Within 7 days the Event Lead assembles: participant activity, company performance, market events and outcomes, Founder Ledger records, desk load and queue times, incidents, feedback, and final results, tagged with the version numbers set at T-7. It feeds the Post-Event Reports in the Investor Day Playbook.

14.5 Operational KPIs

Transactions per hour; unique participant interactions; mission completion rate; opportunity discovery rate; desk utilisation and average queue time; crisis response participation; Founder Ledger evidence points per person (target: several per participant); technical downtime; disputes needing the GM; participant satisfaction; volunteer workload.

15. Master checklists

These are the gates the Event Lead signs. Copy them per run; a gate with an open box does not pass.

15.1 T-7 days (freeze)

- ☐ P estimate, N and the active set fixed; reserve company chosen
- ☐ Rules, content, company pack and event configuration versioned
- ☐ Every role in section 4 filled with a named backup
- ☐ Tabletop simulation run with the core team
- ☐ Starting money, resources and desk inventories reconciled at this N
- ☐ Active mission, opportunity, event and crisis cards selected

- ☐ Tech fallback procedures confirmed and tested on paper
- ☐ Emergency, accessibility and venue procedures confirmed

15.2 T-1 day

- ☐ N + 1 company kits, 8 desk kits, GM, Boundary GM, observer, registration and Investor Day kits packed and labelled
- ☐ Devices charged; dashboards loaded with the active set and roster
- ☐ Local server, Wi-Fi under load of about 130 devices, and hotspot tested at the venue; paper fallback tested
- ☐ Signage, floor map and station labels printed
- ☐ Emergency contact sheet printed, one per desk and station
- ☐ Investor Day pitch template and timer ready

15.3 Before doors (T-30)

- ☐ Venue safety walk done; exits and accessible routes clear
- ☐ Every station and desk staffed and its setup sheet signed
- ☐ Starting state reconciled and signed by the Boundary GM
- ☐ Every transaction path tested once
- ☐ Hidden material secured at GM Control
- ☐ GM holds all event and crisis envelopes
- ☐ Day-of briefing done
- ☐ PA and city clock working; registration lanes ready

15.4 During play

- ☐ City clock visible and running
- ☐ Every desk staffed or showing its state
- ☐ Transactions recorded; tick reconciliation each 30 minutes
- ☐ Queues watched; balance export saved at every tick boundary
- ☐ Events fired on schedule or deliberately moved
- ☐ Founder Ledger evidence captured continuously
- ☐ Incidents logged; staff breaks taken

15.5 Close

- ☐ Final freeze complete; state exported and backed up
- ☐ Paper forms used during any outage keyed in and reconciled on the platform
- ☐ Founder Ledger collected
- ☐ Investor Day and awards delivered
- ☐ Venue restored and signed off
- ☐ Volunteer debrief recorded; participant survey sent

15.6 Documents to print

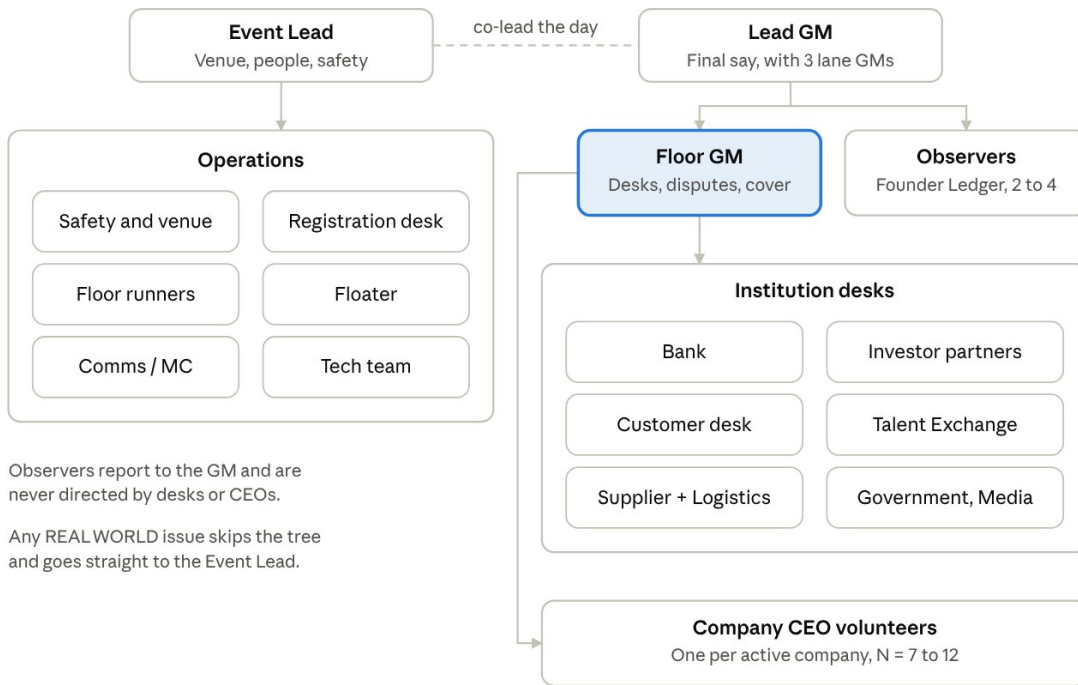
Document	Copies	Holder
Master run sheet (section 10.1)	6	Event Lead and the five GMs
GM control board and starting-state sheet	1	GM
Role card and desk script card	1 per volunteer	Each volunteer
Floor map	1 per volunteer, plus 20 for participants	All
Participant roster	2	Registration, GM
Mission, opportunity, event, crisis and auction registers	1 each	GM
Incident log and ruling log	1 each	Boundary GM
Founder Ledger sheets	40 per observer, plus spares	Evaluation
Emergency contacts	1 per desk and station	All
Investor Day kit: decision cards (Playbook 1.4)	1 per company per room	Panels, rooms A and B
Investor Day kit: Pitch Sheet template (Playbook 1.5)	1 per company, plus spares	Companies, via Comms / MC
Investor Day kit: Frozen Snapshot	3 per company (company, panel A, panel B)	Boundary GM prints at the freeze

Appendix A. Volunteer Roles and Shift Manual

Every volunteer has one lead, one role card, one backup and one rule: roleplay freely, rules stay fixed. This appendix is what each volunteer reads before training and keeps on them on the day.

A.1 Hierarchy

Game questions climb through the Floor GM; real-world issues go to the Event Lead



Reporting tree • all roles at any N

The Event Lead and the Lead GM co-lead: the Event Lead owns the venue, people and safety; the Lead GM owns the game. The Floor GM is the first stop for every desk and CEO, and the Boundary, Crisis and Market GMs run their own lanes (section 4.1), so the Lead GM stays free for the city.

A.2 Role cards

Role	Reports to	Owns	Must never	Station
Event Lead	(top)	Delivery, venue, safety, people, final escalation for anything real-world	Change game rules alone	Floating, GM Control
Lead GM	(top)	Game state, stage, announcements, story, pacing, the freeze, final rulings, Investor Day room A panel	Favour a participant or company	GM Control, stage

Role	Reports to	Owns	Must never	Station
Boundary GM (was Deputy GM / State Controller)	Lead GM	Presses Settle with the Tech Lead, tick reconciliation, 10- point watch list, company clocks, Distressed recovery, incident log	Overrule the Lead GM	GM Control
Crisis GM	Lead GM	Events, crises, exposure ranking, signals and whispers (sent through the platform), aftermath opportunities	Hand-route a whisper or reveal a crisis early	GM Control
Market GM	Lead GM	Missions, opportunities, held-back customer cards, auctions, Founder Window	Release an opportunity to favour one company	GM Control, stage for auctions
Floor GM	Lead GM	Desk queues, disputes, objective and mission escalations, volunteer cover and break rota, rebalancing at check-in; chairs Investor Day room B	Overrule the Lead GM	Floor, GM Control
Company CEO volunteer	Floor GM	Dossier reveal, persona, signatory election, station records	Create unofficial mechanics; play the game for the team	Company station
Bank	Floor GM	Resource sales, loans, deposits,	Invent credit	Institution Row

Role	Reports to	Owns	Must never	Station
		Bank inventory	terms or prices	
Investor partner (two at N = 10)	Floor GM (Lead GM for fund policy)	Investment decisions, cap-table records, in-app booking board (opens Tick 7), Investor Day panel	Fund everyone; reveal fund size or remaining deals	Investor Room
Customer desk	Floor GM	Anchor and open customer cards, contracts, acceptance	Accept vague pitches; reveal other bids	Institution Row
Talent Exchange	Floor GM	Job board, specialist contracts, hires and moves	Allow two jobs at once; guarantee a hire	Institution Row
Supplier + Logistics	Floor GM	Supplier stock, delivery capacity, contracts	Sell beyond recorded capacity	Institution Row
Government (separate volunteer from N = 10; shared with Media at N = 7)	Floor GM	Licences, tenders, grants; Investor Day room B panel	Reveal hidden information	Institution Row
Media (separate volunteer from N = 10)	Floor GM	Featured stories, fact-checks, rumour plants and debunks (automatic inbox on the platform)	Reveal hidden information; sell attention for cash alone	Institution Row
Tech Lead and support	Event Lead	Platform, devices, network, exports, paper fallback	Alter game data without a logged GM ruling	GM Control
Observers	Lead GM	Founder Ledger evidence	Score personality; talk strategy with participants	Floor edge posts
Comms / MC	Event Lead	PA,	Ad-lib game	Stage

Role	Reports to	Owns	Must never	Station
		announcements, stage, Investor Day timing	content	
Registration and Help Desk	Event Lead	Check-in, assignment, roster, procedural help	Explain strategy or hidden rules	Entrance
Floor runner	Event Lead	Materials, queues, sealed deliveries, crowd flow	Resolve rule disputes	Floor
Safety and venue	Event Lead	First aid, exits, accessibility, venue liaison	Change gameplay for convenience	First aid point
Floater	Event Lead (break rota from the Floor GM)	Break cover, absent volunteers, second desk at peaks	Run a desk without its desk card	Wherever sent

A.3 Shifts and call times

All volunteers work the whole day. Shifts are about arrival and breaks, not handovers between people.

Group	Call time	Released
Event Lead, the five GMs, Tech, Floor runners, Safety	T-150 (07:00)	After teardown sign-off
All other volunteers	T-90 (08:00)	After the volunteer debrief
Observers	T-90 (08:00); calibration huddle at T-45	After Founder Ledger handover

A.4 Break rotation

Each volunteer gets a 30-minute meal and two 10-minute breaks. The Floor GM issues the rota at the briefing; the Floater covers.

Window	Who breaks	Cover
Ticks 1 to 4	10-minute breaks, one desk at a time	Floater

Window	Who breaks	Cover
City lunch, 12:35 to 13:05	Everyone eats; desks closed	None needed; the five GMs eat in turn
Ticks 5 to 7	Second 10-minute breaks, one desk at a time	Floater
Ticks 8 to 10	10-minute breaks only if needed; none during the crisis tick	Floater
Freeze to close	Observers and desks during Investor Day prep	None needed

No desk is left without either a person or a Closed sign with a return time. No two GMs break in the same tick.

A.5 Handoffs

When anyone covers a desk, even for 10 minutes, they do a 60-second handoff:

1. Current state: Open, Limited or Closed, and until when.
2. Prices, capacity and inventory left this tick.
3. Anything pending: a deal mid-negotiation, a promised callback, a dispute.
4. Any GM instruction in force.
5. The cover signs the desk log with the time.

A cover never makes a discretionary decision the regular volunteer started; it waits or goes to the Floor GM.

A.6 Training and briefing

Full training, T-14 days, 3 hours. The inherited 70-minute protocol, then drills.

Block	Minutes	Content
Purpose	10	Event purpose and participant experience
Roles	10	Institution roles and boundaries
Protocol	10	The desk protocol and records
Escalation	10	Escalation and disputes
Mechanics	10	Live mechanic examples
Crisis drill	10	Crisis and closure drill
Safety	5	Safety and REAL WORLD protocol

Block	Minutes	Content
Questions	5	Questions
Desk drills	60	Each volunteer runs their desk against role-played participants using Appendix B
Observer calibration	30, in parallel	Observers code the same sample scenes and compare
Tabletop	30	One tick of play end to end

Day-of briefing, T-60, 30 minutes: changes since training; N and the active set; today's desk prices and capacities; break rota; staff channel check; REAL WORLD protocol; one quick crisis drill; station checks.

Briefing script (inherited): "You are not here to tell participants what to do. You operate a real institution inside the city. Ask what they are trying to achieve, identify the mechanism that applies, enforce the published rules, record important transactions, and escalate anything outside your authority. Roleplay freely. Rules stay fixed."

A.7 Escalation ladder

Level	Who decides	Use for	Response time
0	The volunteer	Anything the desk rules cover	Immediately
1	Floor GM (Boundary GM for settlement and company clocks)	Unclear rule, record mismatch, queue overload, cover requests	Within 5 minutes
2	Lead GM, or the GM whose lane it is	Touches several desks, changes a major outcome, would expose a hidden mechanic, no precedent	Within one tick
R	Event Lead	Any REAL WORLD issue: safety, health, conduct, distress	Immediately

While waiting for a ruling, the volunteer pauses only the disputed item and keeps serving the queue.

A.8 What volunteers do and don't do

Do	Don't
Ask what the participant is trying to achieve	Tell them what to do
Say "What can you offer?" more than "Here is what you need"	Solve the problem for them
Reward evidence and preparation	Reward confidence or charm
Apply prices and policies exactly as published	Improvise discounts, prices or penalties
Record every important transaction	Let a deal settle unrecorded
Keep the queue moving	Let one person hold the desk for ten minutes
Stay in character, firm but friendly	Be hostile or sarcastic
Escalate when unsure	Invent a rule
Keep other companies' information private	Leak hidden mechanics, events or the schedule
Report notable behaviour to an observer	Tell participants how founders are evaluated or rank them aloud

A.9 When a volunteer "leaves the city"

A desk closure or a CEO volunteer's departure can be a deliberate game event. Only the GM triggers one, with a sealed instruction stating the city reason, the duration and what the volunteer says. The volunteer turns the sign, says the closure line (Appendix B.1), and goes to GM Control; they remain staff and must not take part in the game while away. If the CEO volunteer leaves, the two signatories run the company jointly. A real absence is handled by the Floater first, and is announced as a game closure only if the GM decides to.

Appendix B. Volunteer Scriptbook

These are lines volunteers can say word for word, built on the drafts' scripts and voices. Each desk's scripts follow the same moments (open, discover, decide, close), so a Floater covering any desk can pick them up. Numbers in brackets come from the live price board or GM instruction, never from memory.

B.1 Lines every volunteer uses

Situation	Say
"What should I do?"	"I can tell you what this desk offers. I can't tell you what your company should do."
"Can you make an exception?"	"I can only make exceptions this desk's rules allow. If you have a better proposal, make it."

Situation	Say
"I have no money."	"Then bring me something else of value: an asset, a contract, evidence, a partner, or a way to reduce my risk."
Participant is stalling	"This offer closes in five minutes. What decision are you making?"
Participant is holding the desk	"Deal confirmed. Next." or "Let's pause there. Come back when you've decided; I need to serve the queue."
"Is this rumour true?"	"I can't confirm that. You might ask whoever would know first-hand."
"What is that other company doing?"	"That's their business. If you want to know, ask them."
"How are we being judged?"	"By what you do. That's all I can say."
"Is this a good deal?"	"That's your call. I can tell you the terms; you decide if they work for you."
Closing the desk (GM instruction)	"The [desk] is closed until [time]. Deals already recorded keep their terms. You may want to look for another route."
Limited service	"We're running limited service until [time]: [what is still available]. Everything else waits."
Escalating	"That's outside what I can decide. I'm asking City Control; carry on and I'll call you back."
Recording	"Let's write it down so it's real. Both of you confirm the terms here."

B.2 Bank

Voice: "We can finance this, but not on those terms." Prudent, polite, evidence-led.

Moment	Say
Open	"Welcome to the Bank. Are you buying resources, borrowing, or depositing?"
Resource sale	"[Resource] is [price] VB a unit today. I have [stock] left this tick. How many?"
Out of stock	"We're out of [resource] until the restock at the end of this tick. The Supplier Market or another

Moment	Say
	company may have some."
Loan discovery	"How much do you need? What is it for? What evidence says it pays back? What can you offer as security? What happens if the plan fails?"
Eligible	"On that evidence you qualify for [amount] at [rate], repayable by Tick [X]. Your signatories confirm here."
Not eligible (inherited)	"We can't approve that under the current credit policy. If you can give us [a signed contract, revenue this tick, or an asset as collateral], you may qualify."
Asking for more	"That's above what your evidence supports. I can do [lower amount] now, and we can talk again once the contract pays."
Emergency loan	"This facility exists for companies in a declared crisis. It's expensive: [rate]. Are you sure it's your best option?"
Repayment due	"You have [amount] due at the end of this tick. How would you like to settle?"
Policy change (GM)	"Credit policy changed at [time]: [new rule]. It applies to everyone from now on."
Persuasive but weak	"I like the story. The Bank lends on evidence. Show me the contract."

B.3 Investor

Voice: "Show me why this changes if I put 20,000 VB into it." Scarce capital, sharp questions, happy to say no.

Moment	Say
Before the window	"The fund isn't investing yet. You can book a meeting in the app from Tick 7, for when it opens."
Booking	"Ten-minute slots. Which one? Bring your numbers and whoever will do the work."
Open (inherited)	"What have you achieved that makes you worth

Moment	Say
	funding today?"
Traction	"Who has paid you? How much, and would they pay again?"
Bottleneck	"What exactly is stopping you, and why does money fix it?"
Pressure (inherited)	"If I give you [amount] VB, what changes by the next checkpoint?"
Team	"Who owns delivery? What have they already shown they can do?"
Risk	"What kills this company? What's your plan if it happens?"
Close (inherited)	"Here is what we're willing to invest, and here are the conditions: [amount] for [share], with [milestone] by Tick [X]."
Decline	"Not today. You'd need [specific evidence] for me to look again."
Strong pitch, thin evidence	"Great presentation. I fund results. What's actually happened?"
Fund status probe	"We're selective. I won't discuss what we've done with others."

B.4 Customer desk

Voice: "Why should I buy this instead of solving it internally?" A real buyer with a budget and better things to do.

Moment	Say
Open	"Who are you with, and what do you think you can do for us?"
Vague pitch	"I don't buy ideas. What exactly would we receive, when, and for how much?"
Discovery reward	"Good question. Our biggest problem right now is [card problem]. Our budget is limited."
Qualification	"Who'd deliver this? Have you done it for anyone else?"

Moment	Say
Refusal (inherited)	"That's interesting, but it doesn't solve our most important problem. Can you change the proposal?"
Price push	"Others are bidding too. What's your best price for that scope?"
Pilot first	"We'll start with a pilot: [units] by Tick [X]. If it's accepted, we'll talk about the full contract."
Close	"Agreed: [deliverable], [quantity], [price], due Tick [X], accepted if [criteria]. Sign here."
Delivery check	"Show me what you delivered. Does it meet what we signed?"
Missed delivery	"You missed the deadline. Under the contract that's [penalty or refund]. Do you want to keep working with us?"
Anchor renewal (after Tick 6)	"Our contract with you has ended. We're open to renewing on our standard terms. Make your case."
Competitor probe	"I won't share other suppliers' bids."

B.5 Supplier Market

Voice: a trader who negotiates on volume, timing and payment, never just reads a price list.

Moment	Say
Open	"What do you need, how much, and when?"
Quote	"[Resource] at [price] per unit, minimum order 20 units. Bigger orders get a better rate."
Negotiate	"Commit to [volume] over the next [ticks] and I can do [discount]. Pay half up front."
Capacity	"I can supply [units] this tick. After that you'll be waiting until the next one."
Agreement expiring (Tick 4)	"Your supply agreement ends at the end of this tick. Renew with a volume commitment, or buy at list."
Disruption (GM)	"We've had a disruption: no new orders until

Moment	Say
	[time]. Contracts already settled still stand."
Exclusivity ask	"Exclusive supply has a price. What are you offering for it?"

B.6 Logistics

Voice: capacity is finite; companies decide who goes first.

Moment	Say
Open	"What are you moving, how many units, and by which tick?"
Standard	"Standard delivery: [price] per unit, [units] left this tick."
Priority	"Priority costs [price] and jumps the queue. [Units] left."
Full	"We're full for this tick. I can book you for next tick, or you can find another route."
Surge (GM)	"Demand is high: surge pricing is on at [price] until [time]."
Prioritise	"You've booked more than I can carry. Which orders matter most to you?"

B.7 Talent Exchange

Voice: "You are not the only company trying to hire me." The desk speaks for scarce people, both to companies and to candidates.

Moment	Say
Open, to a company (inherited)	"What outcome do you need this person to produce?"
Open, to a candidate (inherited)	"What can you prove you can do, and what are you willing to trade for the opportunity?"
Posting a job	"Role, level, pay per tick, and how long. I'll put it on the board."
Specialist available	"I have one [domain] specialist on contract at [rate] per tick. Two other companies have asked."

Moment	Say
Scarcity (GM)	"[Domain] is scarce from now: [premium or auction rule]."
Poaching	"You can make them an offer. They decide. Their current employer may counter."
Double booking	"They're already committed until Tick [X]. They can't take a second full role."
Recording a move	"New employer, role, pay, start tick. Both sides confirm here and I'll update the register."
Freelance	"Short assignment: [task], [pay], done by Tick [X]. They can hold other freelance work if time allows."
Company failed	"Their people are back on the market from next tick."

B.8 Government

Voice: "You can apply, but you don't currently meet the requirement." Fair, procedural, unhurried.

Moment	Say
Open	"Licence, tender, grant, or a compliance question?"
Licence requirement	"For a [licence] you need [documents, a qualified person, a mission completed]. Come back when you have them."
Not yet eligible	"You can apply, but you don't currently meet the requirement. Here's what's missing."
Approved	"Licence granted from Tick [X]. It's recorded; you don't need to carry anything."
Grant window closed	"The grant programme isn't open yet. Watch for a city notice."
Grant application	"What's the money for, what's the public benefit, and what proves you can deliver?"
Tender	"Requirements are on the notice. Bids close at [time]. We decide on the published criteria only."
Regulation (GM)	"A new rule applies from [time]: [rule]. Here's the

Moment	Say
	compliance path. How you meet it is up to you."
Pressure to bend	"The rule is the same for everyone. I can't waive it."

B.9 Media

Voice: "Why should our audience care?" Attention is earned by a story and proof, not just cash.

Moment	Say
Open	"What's the story?"
Weak story	"That's an advert, not a story. What's surprising? Who did it help?"
Proof	"Can you show me a customer, a result or a number?"
Slot status	"One featured slot per tick [two when N is 10 or more]. This one is [open, taken]."
Paid campaign	"A campaign costs [price]. It buys reach, not customers. Still interested?"
Accepted	"We'll run it at [time]. Here's exactly what we'll say: [line]. Agreed?"
Viral event (GM)	"There's a buzz around [sector]. People are talking about it. What you do with that is up to you."
Request to attack a rival	"We report what's true and interesting. Bring evidence, not a grudge."

B.10 Company CEO volunteer

Voice: the company persona card. The CEO opens the company, then lets the team lead it.

Moment	Say
T0 welcome	"Welcome to [company]. Our Founder Dossier is on the platform: it is everything we know about ourselves. Read it together. Some of what we need to know isn't in it."
Signatory election	"Two of you will sign for this company. Decide who, and how. You have ten minutes."

Moment	Say
Team asks the CEO to decide	"What would you decide if I weren't here? Choose, and I'll back it."
Team asks for outside help	"The Bank and the Customer desk are on Institution Row. Go and ask them."
Before Human Internet	"For the next 30 minutes, information moves by talking. What do we need to find out, and who might know?"
Late arrival	"Quick catch-up: we're [company], our biggest problem is [public problem], and the signatories are [names]. Find them."
Leaving the city (GM instruction)	"I've been called away. [Signatory 1] and [Signatory 2] run the company jointly from now."
Before Investor Day	"You have 20 minutes and a 5-minute slot. Who's speaking, and what's the evidence?"

B.11 Registration and Help Desk

Moment	Say
Arrival line	"Welcome to Venture City. You're with [company]. Your station is [location]; your CEO is waiting. Scan this code to join the city on your phone. The city opens at [time]."
"Can I switch company?"	"Everyone's company is drawn at random, and it stays that way. You'll find plenty to do."
"How does the game work?"	"Your CEO will brief you at your station. The basic rules are on your starter card."
"The app isn't working"	"Show me. If I can't fix it in a minute, our developer on call will. Meanwhile any desk can record your deal on paper."
Phone battery dead	"You can charge it here. Use this spare device in the meantime; your account is the same."
Procedural help, mid-game	"The Bank is on Institution Row, third from the end. Deals are recorded at the desk that makes them."
Strategic question	"I can't help with that one. Who in the city might

Moment	Say
	know?"
Needs a break or feels unwell	"Of course. The break area is through there. Would you like someone from first aid?"

B.12 Founder Ledger observers

Observers stay out of the play. Their script is mostly what they write, plus a few lines when a participant notices them.

Moment	Say
"What are you writing?"	"Notes on how the city is working today."
"Are you scoring us?"	"I'm watching the city. Carry on."
Asked for advice	"I'm not part of the game. Ask someone in the city."
Writing evidence (example)	"Approached three suppliers, compared terms, secured alternate supply before the outage." Not "great entrepreneur."

Each note records action, context, initiative, outcome, evidence, quality, confidence (Low, Medium, High), observer and time.

B.13 Game Master and MC

The GM is barely visible in normal play and becomes visible when the city changes: opening, events, crises, auctions, disputes, the final phase and the freeze. Stage lines are in section 12.3; these are the GM's floor lines.

Moment	Say
Ruling, narrow	"Here's the ruling: [ruling]. It applies to this deal only."
Ruling, precedent	"This applies to everyone from now: [ruling]. It'll be on the city board."
Refusing a new mechanic	"That's not something the city allows today. Find a way within the rules."
Approving a new venture	"Your venture is registered as [name]. You have two ticks to record a customer or letter of intent."
Participant complains of unfairness	"Tell me what was recorded and what you

Moment	Say
	expected. I'll check the records, not the story."
Briefing a desk before an event (private)	"At [time], [change] for [duration]. You say [line]. Settled deals stand. Send anything odd to me."
Auction close	"Bidding is closed. The winning bid is [amount] from [company]. Settlement by [time], or it goes to the next bidder."
Ending an event	"The [event] is over. Normal conditions are back from [time]."

Decisions and open items

Confirmed by Nero Kami on 5 October 2026: a 10-tick standard day, two Investor Day rooms at every N, and the six-hour version kept as a separate option. The rest run on the defaults below until changed.

Item	Status	Setting
Ticks in the standard day	Confirmed	10 ticks, Market Open 10:35 to freeze 16:05 (clock paused 12:35 to 13:05 for lunch)
Investor Day rooms	Confirmed	2 parallel rooms at every N; results end 17:34 to 17:52 by N, inside the 9:00 to 18:00 window
Six-hour compact day	Confirmed as a separate option	7 ticks (section 10.5); needs a compact parameter set from Core Game Systems before use
Lunch	Default	City lunch with the tick clock paused, 12:35 to 13:05 (fits the 9-hour window; lunch is provided for everyone)
Investor desk	Default	Dedicated partner volunteers (two at N = 10, one at N = 7), so the GM is not a bottleneck; booking in the app from Tick 7 (updated 2026-10-05)
Volunteer recruitment	Default	27 / 38 / 42 people at N = 7 / 10 / 12 (lean floor 22 at N = 7); updated 2026-10-05 for five GMs and the City 10 desk split

Item	Status	Setting
No-show allowance	Default	10 to 15% until a first run gives a real figure
Complexity audit amendments	Confirmed 2026-10-05	30-minute Human Internet I after a 35-minute City Opens; five GMs; 38 staff at N = 10; see the last row of the reconciliation table in section 1

The date, venue and hours are set (see This run). Building hours (07:00 to 18:45) and the lunch location (13th floor) are confirmed. Nothing is outstanding for the venue.

Venture City — GM Handbook

Oct 5, 2026 · @Nero Kami

The Game Master's bible for Saturday 10 October 2026: 10 ticks, Market Open 10:35, freeze 16:05, two ;Investor Day rooms on two floors. It pulls together what the other documents decided; where they disagree for this run, this handbook says which way to go.

1. How to use this handbook

Run the day from section 3 (the run sheet) and section 6 (the GM-only digest); everything else is a reference you open when something goes wrong. Where this handbook and a source document differ for the 10 October run, this handbook wins and section 13 says why. For card text, prices and full rules, open the source.

Source document	Open it for
Starting World — Master Design	Uniformity rule, T0 state, N-scaling (12.2), visibility classes, new-venture charter (4.5)
Starting Companies — Master Catalogue	Active sets, slot map, memoranda by set (6.3, 8), rivals and M&A pairs (7)
Company Dossiers (all 12)	Every company number; the [GM] parts summarised in section 6 here
Passport Packs + Role Cards	GM reference copy only (the Founder Dossier replaces the passport for participants); sealed insert routing; print notes
Personal Objective System	PO-01 to PO-20, the deal, swaps, rewards
Core Game Systems	Tick settlement order (1.1), evidence E1–E5, deals, talent, resources, capital, M&A, auctions
Dynamic Events & Crisis System	Full card text (E01–E32, C01–C23, O21–O28), targeting rule, caps, live-firing checklist
Human Internet & Information Economy	Info modes, grades, verification, Data Drop, Internet Unlock
Institution Operating Content	Every desk catalogue: BK, IN, CU, SU, GV, MD
Event Operations Manual	Venue, staffing, registration, announcements, incidents, teardown

Source document	Open it for
Founder Identification System	Observers, Founder Ledger, awards

Card data also lives as spreadsheets in the project folder: `dynamic-events/event-crisis-library.csv` and `dynamic-events/opportunity-templates-O21-O28.csv`.

What the GMs own on the day. Five GMs split the game into lanes (section 7.1). The Lead GM owns the stage, announcements, final rulings, pacing and the freeze (Event Ops A.2). The Boundary GM (the Deputy GM role) owns tick reconciliation, the boundary watch list and company clocks. The Crisis GM owns the event and crisis deck, signals and whispers. The Market GM owns missions, auctions and releases of held-back cards and opportunities. The Floor GM owns desk queues, disputes and volunteer cover. All five write to the shared ruling log on the platform. The Event Lead owns everything real-world.

What the GM never does.

- Favours or punishes a company, or picks a crisis target by preference. Targets come from the exposure rule (Dynamic Events 4.2).
- Changes a stated rule after people have acted, or edits a settled transaction silently. Corrections are public ledger entries.
- Confirms whether a card is true, reveals another company's state, or hints at a strategy.
- Writes Founder Ledger entries. The GM forwards system-flagged moments to observers and sits on the award panel.
- Moves the tick clock. Events may move within their tick; the clock does not.

2. Decisions to lock at the Wednesday 7 October freeze

Every hidden choice below is made once, before play, written into the sealed GM pack and never changed live except by a logged emergency ruling. **The owner has set this run to City 10 (N = 10).** Every count, deck and table in this handbook is locked to it.

Decision	Setting for this run	Source rule	Owner
N and the active set	City 10, decided by the owner: SwiftCart, Ledgerly, Mango & Co., SkillForge, PulseAI, GreenGrid, MediLink, StackHouse, Voltway, TrustLayer. 6 to 12 staff per company, so 60 to 120 participants. Staffing 38 (33 in Event Ops, plus a second Investor partner, a separate Media volunteer and three more GMs; owner, 5	Starting World 4.3, 4.4, 12.1; owner, 5 Oct	Owner (set)

Decision	Setting for this run	Source rule	Owner
	Oct). Safety net only: if fewer than 60 people are present at registration close, deactivate Voltway, then StackHouse, then TrustLayer (reverse reserve order) until every company has 6, and use the Core 7 notes in section 4.2		
Reserve dossiers	HarvestLoop and Forgeline stay in the box for mid-game new ventures (Founder Window, section 3)	Catalogue 8; CGS 8	GM
Event and crisis deck	The City 10 deck in section 4.1. Built and sealed; changes only by logged emergency ruling	Dynamic Events 5.3	Crisis GM
Investor lead thesis	Drawn at random on the day , by the Lead GM at the 08:30 staff briefing with the Boundary GM as witness, from Operating, Platform and Impact; sealed until the capital window opens at Tick 8 (owner, 5 Oct)	IOC 3.2	Lead GM
Truth of the Data Drop rumour (E20, IC-RUM-01 "the fund favours companies with two or more partnerships")	Follows the draw automatically: true exactly when the Platform Partner leads. Prepare both versions of the E20 card; the GM keeps the matching one at 08:30	IOC 3.2; Human Internet 5.3	Lead GM

Decision	Setting for this run	Source rule	Owner
Mission selection	About $3 \times N$ from M01–M50 (30 at $N = 10$). At T0: $N + 1 = 11$ public board missions, one first mission per company matched to its gate or critical dependency, and at least 3 Human Internet missions (M19, M45, and M17 or M18)	Core Game Systems 2.6; Human Internet 5.2	Market GM
Opportunity selection	$2N + 1 = 21$ in total including this deck's aftermath cards (section 4.1): the 14 aftermath cards plus 7 others; $\lceil N/2 \rceil + 1 = 6$ live at T0	Core Game Systems 3.5; Dynamic Events 6.4	Market GM
Tender order	$\lceil N/2 \rceil = 5$ tenders: GV-T06 School Meals at Tick 3, GV-T05 Smart City Data Platform at Tick 4, GV-T01 City Skilling at Tick 5, GV-T03 Public Health Outreach at Tick 7; GV-T02 Municipal Green Energy only when GreenGrid's lever fires. GV-T04 held in reserve	IOC 6.4	GM
Planted double-false card (corroboration trap)	Not used on this first run; kept in reserve	Human Internet 10.2	Crisis GM
Personal Objective deal	Run on the platform for City 10, printed into T0 envelopes on Friday, re-run for no-shows at registration close	Personal Objectives 2.2	Tech Lead, GM reviews
Founder Dossier and	Each company's Founder Dossier,	Passports 1	GM, CEO volunteers

Decision	Setting for this run	Source rule	Owner
cash line	published to Portals at City Opens, replaces the passport as the one start-of-day read; Passport Packs are a GM reference copy only and carry the 9-staff reference figure only. Nothing is handed out or collected on paper; one printed Founder Dossier per company sits only in the paper failsafe kit at GM Control, used if the platform is down; the platform is the only record of cash and units, and it recomputes each company's real cash at registration close (section 5.2). No physical VB notes or resource tokens (owner, 5 Oct)		
Other owner defaults	Disclose that a final crisis exists but not its tick; keep the logged GM targeting veto; keep participant-planted rumours with the correction rule; Internet Unlock at Tick 8; Human Internet I with phones out but the platform locked to read-only (own Founder Dossier, role card and objective; owner, 5 Oct)	Dynamic Events 12; Human Internet 13.4	Owner (defaults stand)

Print for the GM pack: this run sheet (3 copies), the sealed deck, one sealed volunteer card per desk per card, one paper crisis envelope per crisis plus one response sheet per company, both E20 versions, the opportunity, mission, auction and rumour registers, the ruling log and the City 10 starting-state sheet (Event Ops 15.6, Dynamic Events 7.1). One printed Founder Dossier per active company goes into the paper failsafe kit only; it is never handed out. **Brief the Ledger Lead on the deck, never on local crisis targets,** which nobody knows until the boundary resolves them (Dynamic Events 7.1).

3. Master run sheet: Saturday 10 October (City 10)

Ten 30-minute ticks run from Market Open at 10:35 to the freeze at 16:05, with the tick clock paused for lunch from 12:35 to 13:05. A card that "fires at Tick k" is announced at step 11 of the boundary that opens Tick k and takes effect at reopen; its signal goes out one tick earlier through the platform's signal feature (Dynamic Events 2; section 4.3). The deck column is the City 10 deck in section 4.1.

3.1 The day, tick by tick

Clock	Tick and info mode	Cards that fire	Windows, deadlines, auctions	Signals to send now via the platform (for next tick)	GM cues
07:00	Build	—	Setup from 07:00 (building open 07:00 to 18:45, confirmed). Local server and venue network up and tested with staff devices; developer on call at the helpdesk	—	GM Control set, including the GM Console feature toggles for each phase; sealed deck and envelopes in hand (Event Ops 15.3)
08:30	Staff briefing	—	Day-of refresher, 30 minutes	—	Draw the investor thesis with the Boundary GM as witness; seal it with the matching E20 card. Starting state signed by the Boundary

Clock	Tick and info mode	Cards that fire	Windows, deadlines, auctions	Signals to send now via the platform (for next tick)	GM cues
					GM
09:00	Doors	—	Registration with ID check, random balanced assignment to 10 companies	—	09:25: Boundary GM confirms company sizes; rebalance any company under 6 (safety net in section 2 if under 60 people)
09:30	T0, City Opens (Closed-net)	None	35 minutes, to 10:05: welcome, company reveal, meet the team, publish the Founder Dossier to Portals and read it; load the company inbox schedule (Company Dossiers N.16) so inbox messages release by tick; envelopes (Leadership, Role insert, Personal Objective, personal card); signatory	—	City Opens line, including the platform helpdesk and its developer on call; Tech Lead confirms each company's real cash in the platform at registration close; 11 public missions, first missions and 6 opportunities go live

Clock	Tick and info mode	Cards that fire	Windows, deadlines, auctions	Signals to send now via the platform (for next tick)	GM cues
			election; Founder Ledger opens		
10:05	Human Internet I (Dark preset, Founder Dossier read only)	None: nothing fires in Dark	30 minutes; phones may stay out, but the platform is locked so each participant can only read their own Founder Dossier, role card and objective (no deals, chat, card trading or wallet actions); no printed dossiers; Trade Slips for wallet purchases; company deals stop at Proposed; desks take enquiries only	—	Human Internet start line; GM Console toggles set to the HI I preset (Founder Dossier read only); HI zone supervised
10:35	Tick 1 (Closed-net)	None: let the base economy show	Market Open; Trade Slips entered; Proposed deals settle; per-tick release budget starts (1 bulletin, 5 whispers, 1	None (E29 has no signal)	Market Open line; toggles to the Closed-net preset; city clock starts; tell participants that if the platform ever stops, desks

Clock	Tick and info mode	Cards that fire	Windows, deadlines, auctions	Signals to send now via the platform (for next tick)	GM cues
			rumour)		switch to numbered paper forms and nothing is lost
11:05	Tick 2	E29 Resource Subsidy: Energy Bank base -25% (GV-R04), Ticks 2-3	—	E01: whisper at Supplier Market, 2 holders. C12: 2 outsiders	15-minute pacing check
11:35	Tick 3	E01 Compute Crunch , Ticks 3-4. C12 Platform Outage (local crisis 1), 1 tick	Auction session 1 (5 lots); tender GV-T06 announced, 1-tick window; first value checkpoint by 12:05	E11: personal card, 2 holders. C07: 2 outsiders	Boundary GM logs which companies have a first outcome
12:05	Tick 4	E11 Customer Rush , Ticks 4-5, loads CU-28. C07 Talent Walkout (local crisis 2), 2 ticks	Salary review window 1; tender GV-T05 announced. End of tick: every T0 supplier agreement lapses unless renewed; SwiftCart 7,000 VB due; SkillForge anchor check (CU-34)	C21 sector crisis: 2 holders, one a whisper at Supplier Market	Brief affected desks 10 minutes ahead; Tech Lead checks the boundary export before lunch
12:35	Lunch, clock paused	Held: Tick 5 releases wait	Boundary 4/5 settles steps	—	Pause line; runner and

Clock	Tick and info mode	Cards that fire	Windows, deadlines, auctions	Signals to send now via the platform (for next tick)	GM cues
		until 13:05	1-10 at 12:35; desks closed; talking allowed, nothing recorded		safety lead the group to the 13th floor (5 min each way); market halls locked or staffed
13:05	Tick 5	C21 Storm Front (sector crisis): SU-08 Riverbend closed Ticks 5-6, Logistics effect 1 tick. No event: planned silence	Auction session 2 (5 lots); grant window opens (Ticks 5-6); grey market opens (SU-15); tender GV-T01 announced; SkillForge instructor and StackHouse reliability lead leave unless retained. End of tick: SwiftCart anchor check (CU-31)	E31: rumour-grade card, 2 holders. C22 and C23: 2 outsiders each	Restart line; check Personal Objective completion rate
13:35	Tick 6	E31 Energy Subsidy Change (GreenGrid hook), until freeze. C22 Merchant Fraud (local crisis 3) and C23 Data Breach (local crisis 4, moved	Anchor contracts' last scheduled tick; renewals for Ticks 7-10 at the Customer desk; PulseAI ML engineer and TrustLayer auditor leave unless retained;	Data Drop cards prepared ($2 \times N = 20$); no other signal	Customer desk double-staffed for 10 renewals; note dead objective templates

Clock	Tick and info mode	Cards that fire	Windows, deadlines, auctions	Signals to send now via the platform (for next tick)	GM cues
		from Tick 8; fallback C06 Enterprise Procurement Audit if C23 is ineligible, C13 Cash Burn if C06 is used or ineligible), on different companies	Voltway 8,000 VB due; SU-04 closes unless committed; grant window closes at end		
14:05	Tick 7, Human Internet II (Closed-net)	E20 Market Rumour (in the Data Drop) and E05 Data Boom	Data Drop of 20 cards, handed out at random; Media fact desk rush-only; Founder Window opens (up to 4 new ventures); auction session 3 (5 lots); grant awards announced at boundary 6/7; tender GV-T03 announced; investor booking board opens in the app (meetings from Tick 8); GreenGrid 10,000 VB Bank repayment. End of tick:	E32: personal card, 2 holders	HI II line; desks briefed on evolution rules

Clock	Tick and info mode	Cards that fire	Windows, deadlines, auctions	Signals to send now via the platform (for next tick)	GM cues
			Human Internet mission claims close; Personal Objective swaps close		
14:35	Tick 8, Internet Unlock (Open-net)	E32 Road Rule Change (Voltway hook; GV-R01, Logistics effect 1 tick). No crisis (C23 moved to Tick 6)	Capital window opens (at most 70,000 VB of the 140,000 fund this tick); Unlock release of Earned items; auction session 4 (5 lots) with A10 mystery lot hinting at the final crisis resource; salary review window 2 (optional: each company holds it or skips it). End of tick: Founder Window closes	C20 final crisis: 3 holders. E08: whisper at Bank, 2 holders	Unlock line; toggles to the Open-net preset; Investor Room open; Tech Lead checks the boundary export
15:05	Tick 9	C20 Final System Shock (systemic), window = Tick 9, effects until freeze. E08 Credit Window (BK-	No new or swapped objectives from now; only high-impact final opportunities; stop low-value	None	Sealed crisis cards to every desk; all observers on the floor

Clock	Tick and info mode	Cards that fire	Windows, deadlines, auctions	Signals to send now via the platform (for next tick)	GM cues
		12 for 1 tick)	missions. Boundary 9/10 at 15:35: cap tables lock, capital window closes, last M&A settles, C20 resolves, O24 released		
15:35	Tick 10	None: aftermath and final build	T-30 line at 15:35; ad hoc auctions only (liquidation, contested); 15:55 transaction cutoff	—	Add no new complexity; protect the freeze
16:05	Freeze	—	Final settlement (steps 1–10), then lock (section 11)	—	FINAL MARKET FREEZE line
16:05	Investor Day prep	—	20 minutes; pitch order drawn; 5 companies move to room B	—	Snapshots out; both rooms set
16:25	Investor Day	—	Two rooms, 5 companies each: 3-minute opening, then 9 minutes per company. Pitches end	—	Section 12

Clock	Tick and info mode	Cards that fire	Windows, deadlines, auctions	Signals to send now via the platform (for next tick)	GM cues
			17:13		
17:13–17:43	Move back, results and awards	—	10-minute move back from room B, then Founder Ledger reveal, company results, awards, 20 minutes	—	Out by 18:00

3.2 Company clocks: what falls due, by tick

Automatic or GM-executed triggers from the dossiers, for the 10 active companies.

Tick	Company	What happens	GM action
4	SwiftCart	7,000 VB to SU-11 Civic Build due; Infrastructure agreement suspends if missed	Supplier desk records
4 (end)	SkillForge	Anchor CU-34 Allied Services leaves unless one placement is completed with any company	Check registry; if not met, close CU-34 for Ticks 5–6, no renewal
4 (end)	Every company	T0 supplier agreement lapses unless renewed with a 3-tick volume commitment	Supplier desk
5	SkillForge	Lead instructor leaves unless a retention deal is recorded first	Open one extra required seat (225 VB per tick deficit charge)
5	StackHouse	Site reliability lead (Operations) leaves unless retained	Same: one extra required seat

Tick	Company	What happens	GM action
5 (end)	SwiftCart	Anchor CU-31 Hillcrest leaves unless every delivery in Ticks 1-5 was made in full	Check registry; if missed, forfeit Tick 6 payment and renewal
6	PulseAI	Lead ML engineer (Product / Build) leaves unless retained	One extra required Product / Build seat
6	TrustLayer	Lead auditor leaves unless retained	One extra required seat
6	Voltway	8,000 VB Bank repayment	Bank debits at step 6
6	All 10 anchors	Last scheduled payment; renewal for Ticks 7-10 at the T0 rate as ceiling, +10% if every delivery was made	Customer desk
7	GreenGrid	10,000 VB Bank repayment, the city's largest	Bank debits at step 6
8	Voltway	E32 suspends consumer rides until GV-L05 is re-issued on fresh evidence	Government desk ready for re-issue requests

A person "leaving" is executed as an open required seat, never by moving a participant (Dynamic Events 4.4, C07 pattern). The participant stays where they are.

3.3 At every tick boundary

The Boundary GM and the Tech Lead press Settle tick in the GM Console, and the platform settles in the fixed order from Core Game Systems 1.1: freeze, recurring contracts, production, salaries, baseline consumption, debt service, workforce, lifecycle check, missions and opportunities, market update, scheduled releases, reopen. At every boundary the platform exports the journal and every company's balances; the Boundary GM runs the boundary on paper from that export only if the platform is down (Platform spec 5.5). The GM steps, each with its lane owner (section 7.1):

1. **Step 1, freeze:** the Crisis GM resolves any crisis whose window ends here, from the registry only.
2. **Step 8, lifecycle:** the Boundary GM reads the Distressed flags and offers restructuring routes to any company in its last recovery tick (BK-13, rescue sale, asset sale).

3. **Step 9, missions and opportunities:** the Crisis GM releases aftermath opportunities; the Market GM tops live opportunities back to 6, never above 12, and releases any held-back card whose lever condition is now met (section 6.1).
4. **Step 11, releases:** the Crisis GM publishes the next tick's cards, signals and whispers through the platform, the Market GM the auction notices and the Lead GM the bulletin; revert expired event parameters and publish end notices.
5. **After reopen:** the Boundary GM checks the company clocks (3.2) and logs anything executed.

Every 15 minutes the Lead GM checks pacing and the Floor GM desk queues; every 30 minutes the Boundary GM reconciles the tick; every 60 minutes review the opportunity pipeline, Founder Ledger coverage and crisis readiness (Event Ops 10.2).

3.4 The lunch pause

Boundary 4/5 runs steps 1 to 10 at 12:35, so supplier agreements lapse and Tick 4 obligations post before lunch. Step 11 is held: the C21 alert and every Tick 5 release are published at 13:05 as the market reopens. This gives the sector crisis a full 30-minute response window and keeps lunch free of game decisions. Nothing is recorded or settled while desks are closed.

4. The event and crisis deck for this run

The card text, windows, consequences and caps live in Dynamic Events (cards) and in /mnt/project-files/dynamic-events/event-crisis-library.csv. This section fixes **which cards fire when** on the 10-tick spine for City 10 and how the Crisis GM fires them. Local crisis count for City 10 is 4 by owner decision on 5 Oct (the $\lceil N/2 \rceil$ formula would give 5), with at most one per company; caps C1 6,000 / C2 8,000 / C3 10,000 / C4 12,000 VB (DE framework).

4.1 The City 10 deck (N = 10)

Tick	Event	Crisis	Signal goes out	Aftermath opportunity
1	none (Market Open)	none	E29 has no signal	—
2	E29 Resource Subsidy (Energy, 2 ticks)	none	—	O10
3	E01 Compute Crunch (2 ticks)	C12 Platform Outage (C1, local 1)	Tick 2: E01 whisper at Supplier desk to 2 holders; C12 signal to 2 outsiders	O02, O26; O27
4	E11 Customer Rush (loads CU-	C07 Talent Walkout (C1, local	Tick 3: E11 personal card to 2	O09; O25

Tick	Event	Crisis	Signal goes out	Aftermath opportunity
	28, 2 ticks)	2)	holders; C07 signal to 2 outsiders	
5	none	C21 Storm Front (C2 sector; SU-08 closed 2 ticks; hits Mango & Co.'s Riverbend agreement)	Tick 4: 2 holders, one a Supplier-desk whisper	O21
6	E31 Energy Subsidy Change (moved from T7, see 13)	C22 Merchant Fraud (C1, local 3) and C23 Data Breach (C1, local 4; moved from T8; fallback C06 Enterprise Procurement Audit if C23 is ineligible, C13 Cash Burn if C06 is used or ineligible), on different companies	Tick 5: E31 rumour card to 2 holders; each crisis signal to 2 outsiders	O16; O22; O20 (O22 if C06 fires, O12 if C13)
7	E20 Market Rumour + E05 Data Boom (Data Drop, HI II)	none	Data Drop is the signal	O28
8	E32 Road Rule Change (Voltway hook)	none (C23 moved to T6)	Tick 7: E32 personal card to 2 holders	O24
9	E08 Credit Window (moved from T8, see 13)	C20 Final System Shock (C4, until freeze)	Tick 8: C20 signal to 3 holders + A10 mystery lot; E08 Bank whisper to 2 holders	O15; O24
10	none (aftermath and final build)	none	—	—

Checks this deck passes. Every active company's vulnerability card is in the deck or handled by its anchor or key-person rule (E31 GreenGrid, E32 Voltway, C21 Mango & Co., C22 Ledgerly, C23 MediLink and TrustLayer). Positives: E29, E11, E08 (three of eight events). Resources touched before the final shock: Energy (E29, E31), Compute (E01), Materials (C21), Data (E05, C23), Logistics (E32); Logistics and Compute again in C20. Four local crises (owner decision, 5 Oct), no company hit twice, no local crisis in the same tick as the sector or final crisis. Ticks 1 and 10 stay quiet so the day starts and ends on player decisions, and Tick 8 has no crisis so Internet Unlock and the capital window have room. Aftermath cards: 14 instances (O24 twice), counted inside the 21 opportunities in section 2; C23's O20 is released at the Tick 6/7 boundary.

Why E08 moved to Tick 9. In City 10, E32 needs the Tick 8 event slot. E08 at Tick 9 keeps three positive events and gives every company with credit grade A or B a relief valve during the final shock, which supports the rule that no company fails before the freeze because of the final crisis.

4.2 If the safety net drops the city to Core 7

Only if fewer than 60 people are present (section 2): remove E32 and put **E08 back at Tick 8**; the four local crises stay as they are (C23 at Tick 6, fallback C06, else C13); auctions go back to 4 lots per session; Tick 9 has C20 only. Everything else stays.

A conditional card (C22, C23, C13) only fires if its eligibility condition is met at the boundary before; if not, fire the listed fallback and log why.

4.3 How to fire a card (DE 7.2, in order)

1. **Signal (one tick ahead).** The Crisis GM picks the card and a holder rule in the platform's signal feature (for example "2 outsiders lowest on exposure"); the platform picks the holders from the exposure ranking and delivers them at the boundary step 11 release. No hand-routing. For C1 cards, the rule is always the 2 outsiders ranking **lowest** on the card's exposure measure, so a holder can never be the target.
2. **Resolve the target** from the exposure rule at the boundary before the firing tick (Tech Lead prints the ranking). For two local crises in one tick (Tick 6), resolve C22 first, then take the top-ranked company for C23 (or its fallback) that C22 did not hit. The Crisis GM may veto only for an operational reason (company mid-move, key player injured) and logs it; the next-ranked company takes the card.
3. **Trigger.** The Lead GM reads the CITY NOTICE (event) or CITY ALERT (crisis) from the Event Ops scriptbook template at the start of the tick; platform posts the card.
4. **Window.** The response window is the firing tick unless the card says otherwise. Responses are recorded on the platform as they happen.
5. **Resolution** at the crisis-resolution step of the next boundary; apply consequences up to the cap.
6. **Aftermath** opportunity released at step 9 of the same settlement.
7. **Ledger.** Ledger Lead logs responses as Founder Ledger evidence (crises are the strongest signal source, Founder ID).
8. **End** at step 11 when the duration runs out; post the all-clear.

Events change **parameters** (prices, rates, stock, demand), never a company's cash or resources directly. Only crisis consequences touch stocks, and only within the cap.

4.4 Auction sessions for this run

Lots per scheduled session: $\lceil N/3 \rceil + 1 = 5$. Library and formats in CGS 9.1–9.4; resource lot sizes and opening prices are written for $N = 7$ and scale by $10/7$ (rounded to the nearest 5 units and 50 VB). At $N = 10$, run resource blocks as multi-unit sealed rounds (CGS 9.2).

Session	Tick	Lots ($N = 10$)	Why
1	3	A01 Compute Block, A02 Prime Logistics Slot, A04 Warehouse Access, A07 Supplier Priority, A06 Media Burst	Lands in E01 Compute Crunch
2	5	A03 Specialist Talent (C07 walkout package if unsold), A07 Supplier Priority (Materials, during C21), A05 Enterprise Introduction, A06 Media Burst, A04 Warehouse Access	Talent and supply bind
3	7	A08 M&A Asset, A09 Data Package, A05, A03, one Government limited-access licence or tender slot	Rides the Data Drop and Founder Window
4	8 (moved from 9)	A10 Mystery Lot (hints at C20), A01, A02, A08, A03	Last chance to hedge before the Tick 9 shock

The Market GM runs every session. Session 4 moves one tick earlier under CGS 9.5 so the mystery lot is the C20 signal; log the move. Tick 10 has ad hoc auctions only (liquidations, contested opportunities). One win per company per session.

5. World state at T0 (cross-reference)

This section tells the GM **where** each T0 number lives and gives the few figures needed on the floor. Do not re-key numbers from here into the platform; load them from the source.

5.1 Institution stocks by N

Parameter	Formula	N = 7	N = 10	N = 12	Source
Bank stock per resource	40N	280	400	480	SW 12.2
Bank restock per tick	10N	70	100	120	SW 12.2
Bank lending pool	8,000N	56,000	80,000	96,000	SW 12.2
Investor fund / max deals	14,000N / [0.7N]	98,000 / 5	140,000 / 7	168,000 / 9	IOC 3.1
Open customer cards	2N	14	20	24	IOC 4
Talent Exchange specialists	N	7	10	12	SW 12.2
Supplier Market capacity per resource	20N (12N standard + 8N alternative)	140	200	240	IOC 5
Logistics Provider standard / priority	15N / 7N	105 / 49	150 / 70	180 / 84	SW 12.2
Grant pool	3,000N	21,000	30,000	36,000	IOC 6
Opportunities live at once	[N/2] + 1	5	6	7	CGS 3
Missions on the board	N + 1	8	11	13	CGS 2
Tenders	[N/2]	4	5	6	IOC 6
Licence decisions per tick	2 (3 at N ≥ 10)	2	3	3	IOC 6
City Reserve mission budget per	600N VB, 15N units	4,200	6,000	7,200	CGS 2

Parameter	Formula	N = 7	N = 10	N = 12	Source
tick					

Bank base prices (VB/unit): Compute 20, Energy 15, Logistics 20, Materials 15, Data 25, Infrastructure 30. Dynamic steps +20% / +50% as stock falls (CGS 6). Storage cap 200 per resource; Bank debt cap 30,000.

5.2 Companies at T0

Every company starts with 100 units of each resource and the shared salary ladder. Cash = headcount × 2,450 + 10,000 + Strategic Adjustment; the platform recomputes at registration close (Dossiers, reference headcount).

Company	Adj.	Cash at 9 staff	Anchor (CU, T1-6 value)	Liability (value, due)	Runway	First run-out	Named supplier
SwiftCart	-2,000	30,050	CU-31 Hillcrest Households, 7,800	Deferred payment to SU-11, 7,000 at T4	8	Logistics T7	SU-11
Ledgerly	0	32,050	CU-32 Metro Retail Federation, 6,000	Chargebacks 1,000/mis sed tick, to 5,000	9	Data T7	SU-09
Mango & Co.	-2,500	29,550	CU-33 Mango Club Subscribers, 6,600	Refund 1,500/mis sed box, to 6,000	9	Materials T8	SU-08
SkillForge	0	32,050	CU-34 Allied Services Corp, 5,400	Lead instructor leaves T5	9	Compute, Data T10	SU-01
PulseAI	-2,000	30,050	CU-35 Quayside Distribution, 4,200	Tech debt +3 Compute/tick	9	Compute T6	SU-01
GreenGrid	0	32,050	CU-36 Eastgate	Bank loan 10,000 at	8	Materials,	SU-07

Company	Adj.	Cash at 9 staff	Anchor (CU, T1-6 value)	Liability (value, due)	Runway	First run-out	Named supplier
			Industrial Park, 7,800	T7		Infra T7	
MediLink	-2,000	30,050	CU-37 CityCare Patients, 6,000	Compliance gap (cleared by GV-L07)	9	Data T7	SU-09
HarvestLoop	+500	32,550	CU-38 Central Kitchens Ltd, 6,000	Deferred payment to SU-08, 6,000 at T3	8	Materials T7	SU-08
StackHouse	-2,500	29,550	CU-39 Westbrook Media Group, 4,800	Compliance gap (cleared by GV-L08)	9	Energy, Infra T7	SU-03
Voltway	0	32,050	CU-40 Dockside Wholesale, 7,200	Bank loan 8,000 at T6	8	Energy T7	SU-03
Forgeline	-4,000	28,050	CU-41 Homeware Direct, 6,600	Tech debt +3 Energy/tick	9	Materials T7	SU-07
TrustLayer	-1,000	31,050	CU-42 Civic Insurance Mutual, 5,400	Lead auditor leaves T6	9	Data T7	SU-09

Cash base by headcount: 6 → 24,700; 7 → 27,150; 8 → 29,600; 9 → 32,050; 10 → 34,500; 11 → 36,950; 12 → 39,400 (before adjustment). Payroll at 9 staff as levels rise: 900, 1,350, 2,025, 2,925, 4,050, 5,400 VB per tick. Supplier agreements soften every run-out until Tick 4. Full per-company T0 sheets: Dossiers x.1-x.9 and Passport Packs.

Anchor renewal. Anchors run Ticks 1–6, then renew for Ticks 7–10 as a new negotiation with the T0 rate as the ceiling, +10% if every delivery was made (IOC 4.4). A Concentration anchor that left does not renew.

5.3 What to load for City 10

HarvestLoop and Forgeline rows in 5.2 are reserve dossiers this run; ignore them unless a new venture draws one.

Item	Load at T0	Hold back
Open customer cards (2N = 20)	CU-01 to CU-14, CU-17 and CU-18 (StackHouse), CU-19 and CU-20 (Voltway), CU-23 and CU-24 (TrustLayer)	CU-25 (Mango lever), CU-27 (TrustLayer lever), CU-28 (enters with E11 at Tick 4)
Anchors	CU-31 to CU-37, CU-39 Westbrook Media Group, CU-40 Dockside Wholesale, CU-42 Civic Insurance Mutual	—
Licences	GV-L01 to GV-L10 (every one has an active applicant); 3 decisions per tick	—
Tenders (5)	GV-T06 (T3), GV-T05 (T4), GV-T01 (T5), GV-T03 (T7)	GV-T02 (GreenGrid lever, released by GV-L09); GV-T04 in reserve
Grants	GV-G01 to G05, window Ticks 5–6, pool 30,000 VB	—
Suppliers	SU-01 to SU-13; SU-14 only with E22; SU-15 only when asked directly	—

City 10 memoranda (Catalogue 8; Dossiers x.12): 8 of 10 critical dependencies are filled by another active company: Ledgerly ← TrustLayer (S8), MediLink ← TrustLayer (S8), PulseAI ← StackHouse (S3), TrustLayer ← StackHouse (S3), StackHouse ← GreenGrid (S4), Voltway ← GreenGrid (S4), SwiftCart ← Voltway (S1), SkillForge ← Mango & Co. (S12). The other two move to the next needed slot: Mango & Co. ← SwiftCart (S2) and GreenGrid ← Ledgerly (S7). Unfilled slots in City 10: **S5 and S6** (manufacturing and raw materials). These are the openings a new venture drawing HarvestLoop or Forgeline can fill; SU-13 and SU-07 / SU-08 cover them meanwhile (Dossiers 13.4).

6. GM-only digest: every hidden mechanic in one place

Print this section for the five GMs only. Nothing here is said at a desk or on the floor until it fires or a GM releases it. Sources: Dossiers x.10–x.12, IOC best-fit and hidden-constraint columns, Dynamic Events

4, Human Internet, Personal Objectives. All levers are capped at 15,000 VB over the run and all vulnerabilities at 10,000 VB.

6.1 Hidden levers (who holds the clue, what triggers it, what the GM does)

Company	Lever type, holder	Trigger	Effect and value	GM action
SwiftCart	Cost lever, Operations	S1 contract ≥ 3 ticks at ≥ 2 blocks/tick (any S1 filler or Logistics Provider)	Logistics tier Very High $\rightarrow$ High (14 $\rightarrow$ 10/tick) from next tick while it runs; about 80 VB/tick saved and 2 extra ticks	Tech Lead flips the tier at step 1 of the next settlement
Ledgerly	Network effect, Finance / Capital	Each company with a live S7 contract	+150 VB/tick per company, max 6 (900/tick), 15,000 total	Platform credits at settlement; check the count
Mango & Co.	Hidden buyer, Brand / Community	Manufacturing contract ≥ 3 ticks (S5 company or SU-13 batch deal)	Release CU-25 Maison Verde Department Stores : exclusive gift range, 4 ticks, 10,000 VB, no certificate needed	Hand CU-25 to the Customer desk at step 9
SkillForge	Network effect, Growth / Sales	Each company with a live placement through it	+120 VB/tick per company, max 6 (720/tick), 15,000 total	Platform credits at settlement
PulseAI	Multiplier, Research / Intelligence	Any Enterprise subscription contract	+40% premium, 15,000 total	Platform credits at settlement
GreenGrid	Unlock, Operations	Green certification GV-L09 (evidence: an accepted S4 delivery or retrofit)	Release GV-T02 Municipal Green Energy tender: 12,500 VB over 5 ticks, 20 Energy/tick	Government announces GV-T02 next tender slot; competes with GV-T01 for places
MediLink	Latent asset, Research / Intelligence	S9 provider owns or holds an exclusive licence	Dataset valued at 15,000 ($2.5 \times 6,000$ book) by platform and	Dormant if no S9 company; confirm valuation at the

Company	Lever type, holder	Trigger	Effect and value	GM action
		to the dataset	Investor	deal
HarvestLoop	Hidden buyer, Operations	S1 contract ≥ 3 ticks and Food Safety Certificate GV-L03	Release CU-26 Portside Export Processors : 3 produce/tick, cold delivery, 4 ticks, 11,200 VB	Customer desk at step 9
StackHouse	Cost lever, Finance / Capital	S4 contract ≥ 3 ticks at ≥ 10 Energy/tick (renewing the T0 agreement with a volume commitment counts)	Energy Very High $\rightarrow$ High (14 $\rightarrow$ 10); about 60 VB/tick and 2 extra ticks	Tech Lead flips the tier
Voltway	Latent asset, Operations	S4 supplier owns the depot or leases it ≥ 3 ticks	Depot valued at 14,000 (2 $\times$ 7,000 book)	Dormant if no S4 company
Forgeline	Multiplier, Growth / Sales	Any contract with another company	+25% premium, 15,000 total	Platform credits at settlement
TrustLayer	Unlock, Research / Intelligence	2 clean audits (client has no data breach within 2 ticks)	Release CU-27 Northgate Savings Bank : regulated, 12,000 VB over 4 ticks	Customer desk at step 9

6.2 Vulnerabilities (fire only through the deck and the exposure rule)

Company	Type	Trigger and tick	Worst case	Card in this run
SwiftCart	Concentration	CU-31 leaves at end of T5 unless every delivery T1-T5 was made in full	about 9,100	Anchor rule (no card)
Ledgerly	Hidden liability	Merchant fraud fires while it processes for ≥ 3 companies without S8 cover:	9,000 total	C22 at T6

Company	Type	Trigger and tick	Worst case	Card in this run
		refund obligation +4,000		
Mango & Co.	Fragile supply	Weather closes SU-08 Riverbend for 2 ticks	a few thousand	C21 at T5
SkillForge	Concentration	CU-34 leaves at end of T4 unless one placement is complete	about 7,200	Anchor rule
PulseAI	Key person	Lead ML engineer (Product / Build) leaves at T6 unless retained first	one open seat	Key-person rule
GreenGrid	Regulatory exposure	Energy subsidy change suspends the retrofit until GV-L09	lost retrofit sales	E31 at T6
MediLink	Hidden liability	Data breach after it sold or shared data without S8 cover: 6,000 fine to Government	6,000	C23 at T6
HarvestLoop	Fragile supply	Weather closes SU-08 for 2 ticks (shared shock with Mango & Co.)	lost supply	C21 at T5
StackHouse	Key person	Site reliability lead (Operations) leaves at T5 unless retained	one open seat	Key-person rule
Voltway	Regulatory exposure	Road rule change suspends rides until GV-L05 is re- issued	lost ride revenue	E32 at T8 if active
Forgeline	Concentration	CU-41 leaves at	about 8,800	Anchor rule

Company	Type	Trigger and tick	Worst case	Card in this run
		end of T4 unless a second paying customer exists		
TrustLayer	Hidden liability	Data breach hits a client it monitored that tick: 5,000 warranty	5,000	C23 at T6

Key-person loss is executed as an **open required seat**: the deficit charge of 225 VB per tick applies until filled (CGS 5). Concentration departures happen at the boundary step for contract renewal and are announced as ordinary customer news, never as a "vulnerability".

6.3 Liabilities, private facts and gate evidence

Starting liabilities are in the 5.2 table. Cash due dates to watch in City 10: SwiftCart 7,000 to SU-11 at **T4**, Voltway's 8,000 Bank loan at **T6** and GreenGrid's 10,000 at **T7**. (HarvestLoop's 6,000 at T3 applies only if it enters as a new venture.) PulseAI burns +3 Compute per tick until a fix mission clears it. MediLink and StackHouse compliance gaps clear on GV-L07 / GV-L08.

Private fact 3 (the rumour). False for every company **except** SkillForge ("Talent Exchange running out of specialists"), MediLink ("Government fining health data sellers") and TrustLayer ("a major breach is coming"), which are **partly true**. TrustLayer's is the C23 signal in disguise. Desks must not confirm any of them.

Gate evidence (desk rules the GM briefs at 08:30). SwiftCart GV-L01: one S1 contract or 2 ticks of Logistics Provider priority booked. Ledgerly GV-L02: auditor attestation or GV-L10 pass, BK-11 proof of funds for 5,000, Finance L2+, 1,000 fee. Mango & Co. and HarvestLoop GV-L03: one unit inspected, hygiene plan, Operations L1+, **one shared queue**. SkillForge GV-L04: one accepted cohort, Product or Research L2+. PulseAI: 2 accepted pilots (T0 pilot CU-35 does not count). GreenGrid project finance: 2 offtakes (CU-36 does not count). MediLink: 3 verified deliveries; GV-L07 attestation. StackHouse: 3 ticks unbroken delivery; GV-L08 needs 20 Infrastructure + attestation. Voltway GV-L05: 10 Infrastructure and driver vetting. Forgeline: first batch accepted. TrustLayer GV-L06: one accepted audit, lead auditor L2+, 800 fee.

6.4 Institution secrets

Supplier hidden constraints (IOC 5). SU-02 halves if the S3 filler contracts most of its idle capacity. SU-04 closes at T6 unless one buyer signs a 3-tick volume commitment (whisper to 2 holders once released). SU-06 delivers a tick late and drops to zero in E03/C03. SU-07 and SU-12 share an owner (E21 merges them, +10%). SU-08 fails for 2 ticks on weather (C21). SU-10: a third of its data is stale (C05 voids units bought in the prior 2 ticks). SU-14 loads only with E22. SU-15 is the grey market, revealed only when asked directly; sells whatever is shortest, no limit.

Investor. The lead thesis is drawn before T0 (section 2). **IC-RUM-01** ("the fund favours companies with two or more partnerships"), released as E20 in the Tick 7 Data Drop, is **true only if the Platform Partner leads**. Valuation ceiling $2.0 / 1.5 / 1.0 \times RV$ by fit.

Customer cards. Best-fit company and hidden need columns are GM only; a hidden need met pays +10% stretch. Hidden buyers (CU-25, CU-26, CU-27) appear only on their lever trigger.

"Never" tiers. No desk ever reveals another company's orders, terms, pipeline, diligence, credit grade or balances; unreleased hidden constraints; a crisis target's exposure reason. A desk asked a Never question says "That's not something we share" and logs the ask (it is Founder Ledger evidence).

6.5 Information economy secrets (Human Internet)

Personal information cards are about 60% true, 25% partly true, 15% false. Modes are presets of the GM Console feature toggles (Founder Dossier read, deals, wallet, cards, missions, chat, search, investor booking and the rest), which the GMs set per phase and can change live: DARK during HI I (phones out, platform read-only for each participant's own Founder Dossier, role card and objective), CLOSED Ticks 1–7 (Earned tiers need the right question or relationship), OPEN from the Tick 8 Internet Unlock. Signals for C1 cards go to outsiders with the **lowest** exposure on that card. Do not plant two false items on one company in one tick (decision in section 2). Forgery and impersonation are void and logged (section 9). The relationship tier stays: the platform desk console shows each asker's history across all desks and flags the Earned items they already qualify for; volunteers still log manually, and every desk can see the other desks' records. The Media desk gets an automatic inbox copy of fact-check requests, rumour plants, debunks (with a draft correction), objective lodges that name Media, and amplification counts.

6.6 Personal Objectives (GM rules)

Platform deals one objective per participant at T0 (PO-01 to PO-20; tokens resolve automatically). Rewards 500 VB first, 250 follow-on, to the personal wallet from the City Reserve outside the mission budget; max 3 completions. One free swap until end of Tick 7; none dealt from Tick 9. Target completion 40–60%: if under 25% by Tick 6, use the PO levers in section 8. Completion writes a grade-B draft Founder Ledger entry. Signal codes are never shown on cards.

7. Company monitoring

7.1 Who watches what

Role	Watches	Reports to
Tech Lead	Platform dashboard: cash, runway, resource stocks, Distressed flags, settlement exceptions; prints the exposure ranking for the next crisis	Boundary GM at each boundary, before step 1; the ranking to the Crisis GM
Ledger Lead	Founder Ledger entries, nominal deals, self-dealing, PO completions	Boundary GM each boundary; flags at once

Role	Watches	Reports to
CEO volunteers (one per 1–2 companies)	Company mood, stuck teams, missed deliveries, retention talks	Floor GM, by radio or note when a company is stuck for a tick
Desk leads	Queues, Never-tier requests, odd patterns (one company buying everything)	Floor GM within 5 minutes
Boundary, Crisis, Market and Floor GMs	Their lanes (below)	Lead GM at each boundary

Five GMs, one lane each

Five GMs run the game, each in one lane (owner, 5 Oct). All five write to the shared ruling log on the platform, and the Lead GM has the final word. The Boundary GM is the role older documents call the Deputy GM.

GM	Lane	Investor Day
Lead GM	Stage, announcements, story, pacing, final rulings, the freeze	Room A panel
Boundary GM	Presses Settle with the Tech Lead; the boundary watch list (7.2); company clocks (3.2); Distressed recovery	Draws pitch order and issues snapshots
Crisis GM	Events, crises, exposure ranking, signals and whispers through the platform, aftermath opportunities	—
Market GM	Missions, opportunities, held-back customer cards, auctions, Founder Window	—
Floor GM	Desk queues, disputes, objective and mission escalations, volunteer cover	Chairs room B with the Bank lead and the Government volunteer

7.2 The boundary watch list (two minutes, every boundary)

1. **Cash and runway.** Any company with runway under 4 ticks (C13 eligibility) or cash heading negative.
2. **Resources against thresholds.** Stocks at 30 (warning), 15 (critical), 0 (two ticks at 0 kills a company, Dossiers x.11). Check each company's first run-out tick in 5.2; seven of the ten first run short around Tick 7.

3. **Distressed flags** and their 2-tick recovery clocks.
4. **Liabilities due this boundary** (SwiftCart T4, Voltway T6, GreenGrid T7; key-person departures T5 SkillForge instructor and StackHouse reliability lead, T6 PulseAI engineer and TrustLayer auditor).
5. **Lever conditions met** (6.1). Release the held card at step 9; flip tiers at the next step 1.
6. **Concentration checks** (SkillForge at end of T4, SwiftCart at end of T5).
7. **Nominal-deal and self-dealing flags** from the Ledger Lead: a deal between companies sharing a signatory, a round-trip of VB, or a price outside 0.5–2× market. Floor GM rules under section 9.
8. **Reliability Record** breaches logged this tick.
9. **Queues** over 5 minutes at any desk (section 8.4). Government carries 10 licence applicants this run.
10. **Crisis eligibility** for the next conditional card (C22, C23, C13) and the targets from the exposure ranking (two at Tick 6, C22 and C23; none at Tick 8).

7.3 The company clock

Section 3.2 lists each company's clocks by tick. The Boundary GM keeps a printed copy on the clipboard and ticks each one off as it passes. Most companies first run short of a resource around Tick 7 and lose their supplier agreements' softening at Tick 4, so Ticks 4 and 7 are where most interventions happen.

8. Balance levers

The GM balances the **city**, never a winner. Every lever is a public or desk-level release that any company could use; none hands a specific company cash or units outside the rules. Every use is logged with the reason.

8.1 City-wide red flags (Event Ops 13.6)

Red flag	Lever
Too little activity	Release customer demand, a mission or an opportunity
Everyone follows the same strategy	Release a counter-opportunity
One desk is the only path	Release an opportunity tied to another desk
Cash hoarding	Open attractive capital or resource opportunities
One company dominates	Do not punish it; create counter-opportunities for others
A crisis eliminates a company without a choice	Open a recovery path; review the trigger after
Participants ask volunteers what to do	Volunteers use B.1 scripts; GM releases a visible opportunity

8.2 Per-company levers (Dossiers x.12)

Dossier wording such as "fire X on this company" sets **timing only**. The target is always the exposure rule (DE 4).

Company	Cruising by Tick 5	Struggling
SwiftCart	Logistics surge-pricing event	Held-back Consumer basket card; open Logistics Provider priority
Ledgerly	Bring merchant fraud forward if processing without cover	Held-back Enterprise merchant card; announce Bank credit tightening
Mango & Co.	Fire the weather event	Release CU-25 on a weaker condition; free Media featured story
SkillForge	Talent-surplus event (cheaper specialists)	Held-back Consumer learner card; open tender window early
PulseAI	Compute shortage event	Held-back Enterprise pilot card; public fix mission for its tech debt
GreenGrid	Bring the subsidy change forward	Bank refinances the loan into T9 on standard terms; held-back Enterprise energy card
MediLink	Data-breach event	Held-back Consumer health card; Government fast-tracks GV-L07 on an attestation
HarvestLoop	Fire the weather event	Supplier Market accepts part-payment at T3; held-back Enterprise food card
StackHouse	Heatwave or Energy shortage	Held-back Enterprise tenant card; one-off Supplier Market Energy lot
Voltway	Bring the road rule change forward	Refinance the loan into T8; held-back Enterprise freight card
Forgeline	Materials shortage event	Held-back Enterprise buyer before T4; public fix mission for its tech debt

Company	Cruising by Tick 5	Struggling
TrustLayer	Data breach on a monitored client	Data breach on an unmonitored company (sends buyers to TrustLayer); fast-track GV-L06

A "bring forward" or extra event must fit an open deck slot (section 4) or replace a card of the same stage; never add a second crisis to one company.

8.3 Emergency menu (any company, Dossiers 1.12)

Bank emergency loan band; one held-back customer card; a Talent Exchange specialist in Finance / Capital; a GM-seeded rumour that points a buyer to the company. Use one at a time, at a boundary, and only when a company has no available choice left.

8.4 Institution overload

The Floor GM owns desk queues. Queue over 5 minutes twice: send the Floater, open a second desk or a numbered queue, or take routine rulings to the Floor GM. Government overload: E18 or GV-R03 (fast-track instrument) per IOC 6. At N = 10 Government makes 3 licence decisions per tick and every licence GV-L01 to L10 has an applicant, so expect the Government desk to be the first queue; the Customer desk is second at the Tick 6 renewals. At City 10 Government and Media are two separate volunteers, and the Investor desk has two partners on 10-minute appointments, booked in the app from Tick 7, enough for all 10 companies (owner, 5 Oct).

8.5 Personal Objective levers

Under 25% completion by Tick 6: announce the free swap closing at end of Tick 7; release a mission that fits common objectives. Over 70%: deal no follow-ons. Never change a dealt objective's target.

8.6 What the GM never does

Pay a company directly; reveal a hidden mechanic to rescue a team; retarget a crisis for any reason except a logged operational veto; change prices outside an event card; undo a settled transaction (remedies are new ledger entries).

9. Disputes and rulings

Priority when rules collide (Event Ops 13.1): safety and venue rules → published game rules → recorded transactions and contracts → explicit event or crisis rules → fairness and consistency → pacing → GM judgement.

Ladder (CGS 4.7 and Event Ops A.7).

Level	Who	For	Time
Parties	The two sides	Settle and record an amendment	10 minutes
0	Volunteer at the desk	Anything desk rules	Immediately

Level	Who	For	Time
		cover	
1	Floor GM (Deal Desk)	Unclear rule, record mismatch, queue overload	5 minutes
2	Lead GM (the Floor GM brings it)	Several desks, ownership change, major outcome, would expose a hidden mechanic, no precedent	Within one tick
R	Event Lead	Anything REAL WORLD	Immediately

While waiting, the volunteer pauses **only the disputed item** and keeps serving the queue (Event Ops 13.4 steps 1–6). Decide on records and rules, never on who sounds more convincing.

Remedies are ledger entries only: compensating transfer, the contract's penalty clause, termination, or a Reliability Record breach. Settled transactions are never silently edited.

Standard rulings to reuse.

Case	Ruling	Source
Spoken deal never recorded	Not a deal; nothing owed	CGS 4
Crisis response submitted late	Counts only if inside the window; pausing the city extends the window by the pause	DE 7.5
"The crisis targeted us unfairly"	Show the published principle; never reveal the exposure reason; Crisis GM checks the log privately	DE 4
Forged or altered information card	Void; Media desk logs; Reliability Record breach for the forger's company	HI
Impersonating a desk or another participant	Void every resulting deal; breach	HI
Nominal deal or round-trip	Void at Floor GM ruling; Founder Ledger notes it; no other penalty unless it moved	CGS 7, Founder ID

Case	Ruling	Source
	RV	
PO completed by a deal made only for the objective	Counts if the deal is real and recorded; Ledger Lead may grade it down	PO edge cases
Two companies commit to one opportunity in one tick	Sealed-bid contested auction within 1 tick	CGS 3.4, 9
Hidden lever claimed without the trigger	Not released; no hint why	Dossiers x.10

Ruling log. Every GM records each ruling in the shared ruling log on the platform (time, parties, ruling, precedent yes/no); the Lead GM has the final word. Rulings that affect others are announced at the next boundary as precedent.

10. Emergency procedures

Safety beats the game every time. The code word **REAL WORLD** means a real incident; it is never used in play and overrides every game task. The Event Lead takes over; the Lead GM handles only the game consequences. Full scenario table: Event Ops 13.2; tech procedure: 13.3; script: Appendix B.

Scenario	First 60 seconds	Game action (GM)
Medical or injury	Volunteer calls Safety; clear space; "This is a REAL WORLD announcement" if the area must stop	Pause the affected area only. If a key player is out, their company keeps acting through its other signatories; no deficit charge for that seat while they are out
Fire or evacuation	Venue procedure; staff sweep zones; both floors use their own exits	Whole city stops. Tech Lead snapshots state if safe. On return, resume at the start of the interrupted tick
Power or platform failure (citywide)	Tech Lead confirms; GM announces paper mode	Desks switch to the numbered paper forms with time and tick; the Boundary GM runs boundaries on paper from the last boundary export; ticks run on the wall clock ; crisis cards come from the sealed paper envelopes; the Tech Lead keys the backlog in time order when the platform returns. The local

Scenario	First 60 seconds	Game action (GM)
		server means an internet outage alone does not trigger this
Device failure	Swap a spare	A participant whose phone fails goes to the platform helpdesk for a spare or shares a teammate's device; desks keep serving meanwhile
Major rule bug	Pause the mechanic, not the city	Narrow temporary ruling; announce if public; log High
Participant distressed by a game event	Step them out; offer a break	GM reviews whether the event was fair; may open a recovery path (8.1)
Conduct or safeguarding	Separate calmly; Event Lead	Remove from play if needed; company continues
Lead GM incapacitated	Boundary GM becomes Lead GM at once; the Floor GM covers the boundary lane	Every GM holds a printed copy of sections 3, 4 and 6

Pausing the city. A pause stops the tick clock (as at lunch). Any open crisis response window is extended by the length of the pause. Settlement never runs during a pause.

Three floors. The market runs in the main hall; room B and storage are in the other seminar hall; lunch is on the 13th floor. Each floor has a named volunteer who knows its exits and first-aid point; the radio or phone channel is checked at the T-60 briefing. During lunch the market halls are locked or staffed (Event Ops, venue logistics).

Paper kit (packed Wednesday). There is no physical money or resource tokens; this kit exists only for a platform outage. Numbered paper forms per desk, one sealed envelope per deck card with signal slips and alert text, the printed exposure ranking sheet, blank Reliability breach slips, a wall-clock tick chart, and the latest boundary export (printed by the Boundary GM at each boundary).

11. Final hour and the freeze

Clock	Action	Owner
From Tick 9 (15:05)	C20 fires. Open only high-impact final opportunities; stop low-value missions; no new Personal Objectives	Crisis GM, Market GM
Tick 10 (15:35)	"The market is entering its final	MC

Clock	Action	Owner
	phase." Aftermath (O24) and final build only	
15:55 (T-10)	Transaction cutoff: only already-recorded deals may settle. Auctioneer closes ad hoc lots	MC, Deal Desk
16:05	FINAL MARKET FREEZE announced	Lead GM
16:05–16:10	Final settlement runs steps 1–10 for Tick 10 (payroll, deliveries, crisis resolution, aftermath), then locks	Tech Lead
16:10	Lock cash, resources, contracts, ownership and employment. Options vest. Nothing after this changes a result	Tech Lead
16:10–16:20	Collect paper evidence (observation cards, any failsafe forms used); nothing else is collected, as Founder Dossiers stay on the platform; Tech Lead runs the final lock in the GM Console and exports the journal. The platform record is the result; there is no physical count	CEO volunteers, desks
16:15	Draw pitch order; assign rooms; issue each company its frozen snapshot plus its crisis timeline	Boundary GM
16:25	Investor Day starts	MC

Distressed or broke at the freeze. Report it in the snapshot; do not fail or liquidate a company at the freeze. No company fails because of the final crisis before the freeze (DE framework). C20 consequences are capped at 12,000 VB per company.

Running a final settlement at the freeze (steps 1–10, not step 11 releases) is this handbook's default so that Tick 10's deliveries and payroll count. Flagged in section 13.

12. Investor Day transition

Room operations are Event Ops 10.4; scoring and awards follow the Investor Day Playbook (#14): <https://claude.ai/code/artifact/de6d6987-ac7f-4e65-afd1-f322e3121a07>, Parts 1 and 2. This section is the GM's part, for City 10.

Item	City 10
Rooms	5 companies in room A, 5 in room B, split by the pitch-order draw at the freeze
Pitch block	3-minute opening + 5×9 minutes = 48 minutes, 16:25 to 17:13
Move back	17:13 to 17:23 (room B returns to the main hall)
Results and awards	17:23 to about 17:43, on the main-hall stage
Out	By 18:00; building closes 18:45

Room split uses P, the number of companies pitching, not N. Room A (the stage) takes the larger half, $\lceil P \div 2 \rceil$ of the draws, so at odd P room B is back before results.

Format: 5 min pitch, 3 min questions, 1 min changeover; hard cuts at 5:00 and 3:00.

Panels. Room A (main-hall stage): Investor, Lead GM, optional guest investor. Room B (other seminar hall): Floor GM (chair), Bank lead, Government volunteer. Observers split across rooms and record evidence, not impressions.

What each company gets. Its frozen snapshot (cash, resources, contracts, cap table, RV, Reliability Record) and its crisis timeline (which events and crises touched it and what it did). Panels see the same pack.

While pitches run. The Ledger Lead rolls up the Founder Ledger and pre-builds award shortlists from the evidence; Tech Lead computes final RV for every company. Q&A entries the panel adds to the Ledger are capped at half of the company's existing entries so the room does not outweigh the day.

Tech Lead hands the Lead GM one sheet by 16:55 with each company's E (Founder-Held Value multiple), O (objective layers met, out of 5) and the Best Venture frontier (#14 sections 2.3 to 2.5). Both panels fill one decision card per company (#14 section 1.4).

Between pitches and results there are only the 10 minutes of the move back (17:13–17:23), and the two panels are on different floors until then. Default: the **Ledger Lead brings proposed winners** with evidence; the Lead GM and Floor GM confirm or change them in the main hall as room B arrives. One award per person. Best Venture and company rankings follow #14.

13. Reconciliations and open items

The source documents were written in parallel and disagree in a few places. This handbook settles each one as below. **Each line is a default the owner can change before Wednesday.**

13.1 Calls this handbook made

#	Conflict	Sources	This handbook's call
1	Dynamic Events assumes an 11-tick spine with the final crisis at Tick 10; this run has 10 ticks	DE, Event Ops	C20 fires at Tick 9 (window Tick 9, effects to freeze); Tick 10 is aftermath and final build
2	Event Ops decisions table said Market Open 10:35 to freeze 15:35	Event Ops	Freeze is 16:05 because of the paused 30-minute lunch (Event Ops being corrected to match)
3	Auction sessions: CGS says T3/T5/T7/T9; Event Ops says first major auction T8 and final T10	CGS 9.5, Event Ops	Sessions at T3, T5, T7, T8 (session 4 moved under CGS 9.5 so its A10 mystery lot is the C20 signal); T10 ad hoc only
4	E31 default Tick 7 collides with E20 and the Data Drop	DE, Dossiers	E31 moves to Tick 6
5	E32 (Voltway is active in City 10) needs the Tick 8 slot that E08 held	DE	E32 at Tick 8 ; E08 moves to Tick 9 alongside C20, as a relief valve during the final shock
6	Local crisis count and slots at N = 10	DE 5.3; owner, 5 Oct	Four local crises, not $\lceil N/2 \rceil = 5$ (owner, 5 Oct). C23 Data Breach moves from Tick 8 to Tick 6 , on a different company from C22; C06 only as C23's fallback (C13 if C06 is used or ineligible); Tick 8 has no crisis
7	Windows left to the GM	CGS 10.3, IOC	Founder Window T7 to end of T8 (up to 4 ventures); capital window T8 to cap-table

#	Conflict	Sources	This handbook's call
			lock at boundary 9/10, at most 70,000 VB in T8; salary reviews T4 and T8 (T8 optional for each company, owner 5 Oct); grant window T5–6, awards at boundary 6/7
8	Lunch falls on a boundary	Event Ops 11	Boundary 4/5 steps 1–10 run at 12:35; step 11 releases wait until 13:05
9	What happens at the freeze	CGS, Event Ops 10.3	Final settlement steps 1–10, then lock (section 11)
10	Dossier balance levers name a company	Dossiers x.12 vs DE 4	Wording sets timing only; target always from the exposure rule
11	Talent event slot missing on a 10-tick deck	DE	C07 Talent Walkout covers talent at T4
12	Signal holders could be the target	DE 7.2	C1 signals go to the lowest-exposure companies
13	Investor Day has only the 10-minute move between pitches and results	Event Ops 10.4	Ledger Lead brings proposed winners
14	Thesis draw timing: this handbook first said the Thursday training	IOC 3.2; owner, 5 Oct	Drawn at random on the day at the 08:30 briefing; E20's truth follows the draw
15	Complexity audit: owner decisions of 2026-10-05	Owner, 5 Oct	T0 09:30–10:05 and Human Internet I 10:05–10:35 (30 min); HI I with phones out and the platform read-only through GM

#	Conflict	Sources	This handbook's call
			Console feature toggles (info modes become toggle presets); C23 at Tick 6, Tick 8 with no crisis, four local crises; salary window 2 optional; Government and Media split and a second Investor partner, booking from Tick 7; desk console shows cross-desk history, Media inbox; signals and whispers through the platform; five GM lanes (7.1); staffing 38

13.2 Amendments other documents should pick up

- **Event Ops:** freeze 16:05 (in progress); auction ticks T3/T5/T7/T8; C20 at T9; City 10 staffing (38 after the owner's 5 Oct additions: two desk volunteers and three GMs, with five GM lanes) and Investor Day timings (pitches end 17:13, results about 17:43).
- **Dynamic Events:** note the City 10 deck in this handbook as the run deck: C23 at Tick 6 with its signal at Tick 5, no crisis at Tick 8, four local crises (owner, 5 Oct).
- **Founder ID 2.4:** a verified PO completion writes a grade-B draft entry (from Personal Objectives).
- **Participant Handbook (#12):** use the clock and ticks in section 3; say a final crisis is coming but not when; 10 companies; T0 09:30 to 10:05 and Human Internet I 10:05 to 10:35 with phones out and the platform read-only (owner, 5 Oct).

13.3 Still open (needs the owner)

Venue items are settled in Event Ops (building 07:00 to 18:45, lunch on the 13th floor, hall capacity handled), the company set is City 10 and the thesis is drawn on the day.

Item	Status
Investor Day Playbook (#14), which blocked Best Venture and company scoring	Resolved. Written: https://claude.ai/code/artifact/de6d6987-ac7f-4e65-afd1-f322e3121a07 (section 12 links it)

Nothing in this handbook is waiting on the owner.

Human Internet & Information Economy — Full Design

Oct 5, 2026 · @Nero Kami

1. Purpose and scope

Venture City runs without the normal internet from City Open until Tick 8, and this document fixes how information is held, found, traded, checked, faked and finally searched during that time. It is the full mechanical specification of the Human Internet, which the drafts already decided as a concept ("the internet is down; the people around you are now the internet").

What it inherits and does not change. From the Starting World Master Design: the information record and its fields (10.1), the nine visibility classes (10.2), who knows what at T0 (10.3), the starting information distribution and the 60/25/15 truth mix on personal cards (10.5), the 1,000 VB personal wallet, the rule that money and resources stay still before Market Open, and the 12 role slots S1 to S12. From the drafts: the two Human Internet phases on the 8-hour timeline, the Rumour Register, the information-release mechanisms, missions M17 to M21 and M44 to M46, events E05 and E20, crisis C16, and the operations rule that no retroactive internet research earns credit.

What it adds.

- Three information modes across the day, with an exact allowed and not-allowed list for each.
- A grade on every card (Rumour, Reported, Corroborated, Verified) that holders can see, kept separate from the GM-only truth status.
- Verification routes, prices and outcomes.
- Rules for telling, sharing, selling and escrowing information, and for who keeps the money.
- Information brokers as an open behaviour with an optional registered status.
- Misdirection as a deliberate, bounded mechanic.
- What the Internet Unlock at Tick 8 opens, and what it never opens.
- An information-card schema and a starter library of 15 example cards across seven types, plus a personal card pool of 33 templates that the platform deals at T0 (12.5).

Company-agnostic rule. Every rule here applies to every company in the same way. Company names appear only inside card content, and even there they are written against role slots (for example "the company filling S3") so the platform resolves them to whichever companies are active. The full card library (dozens of entries) is a separate content pass; section 12 gives the schema and the pattern.

Numbers. Every VB price, Data cost and count below is an illustrative starting parameter in the same bands as the Starting World document, meant to be tuned in playtesting.

2. Information modes across the day

The city runs in three information modes: Dark for Human Internet I, Closed-net from Market Open to the end of Human Internet II, and Open-net from Tick 8 to the freeze. The Human Internet is therefore not one 30-minute stunt but the default condition for the first five hours, with Human Internet I as its hardest form and the Internet Unlock as a scheduled turning point. The platform holds the mode as one

field (info_mode: DARK, CLOSED, OPEN), as the Technology doc requires. Each mode is a preset of the GM Console's per-feature toggles (Founder Dossier read, deals, wallet, cards, missions, chat and messaging, search, investor booking and the rest), which the GM sets per phase and can change live (13.1).

Clock (8-hour timeline)	Phase	Ticks	Mode
00:30–01:05	City Opens: welcome, company reveal, meet the team, read the Founder Dossier on the platform, envelopes, signatory election	before Tick 1	Closed-net
01:05–01:35	Human Internet I	before Tick 1	Dark
01:35–04:45	Market Open to Company Evolution	Ticks 1–6	Closed-net
04:45–05:15	Human Internet II: the Data Drop (section 5.3)	Tick 7	Closed-net
05:15–07:15	Internet Unlock, Capital Market, Major Crisis, Final Build	Tick 8 to the freeze	Open-net
07:15–08:00	Investor Day and City Close	frozen	Open-net

Clock times are the drafts' indicative 8-hour spine. The GM aligns each phase to the nearest tick boundary, so Human Internet II always covers Tick 7 and the Unlock always fires as Tick 8 starts, whatever the venue clock says. On the event day 00:00 is 09:00, so City Opens runs 09:30–10:05 (35 minutes), Human Internet I runs 10:05–10:35 (30 minutes) and Market Open is 10:35.

2.1 What is allowed in each mode

Channel	Dark	Closed-net	Open-net
Talking in person, anywhere in the venue	Yes	Yes	Yes
Paper notes, physical cards, the paper Trade Slip	Yes	Yes	Yes
Public screens and boards (Venture City Live, mission board, price board)	Yes	Yes	Yes

Channel	Dark	Closed-net	Open-net
Institution desks for enquiries	Yes (enquiries only)	Yes	Yes
Participant platform: own dossier, wallet, cards, deals, missions, public feed	Read-only: own Founder Dossier, role card and objective; every other feature switched off	Yes	Yes
Offline tools on a device (calculator, offline spreadsheet, notes)	No	Yes	Yes
Platform messaging between participants	No	No	Yes
City Net search (section 11)	No	No	Yes
People Directory search (section 11)	No	No	Yes
External web, search engines, maps, news	No	No	Yes
AI assistants and chatbots of any kind	No	No	Yes
Messaging apps, calls and social media	No	No	Yes

Personal emergencies override every mode: anyone may step outside the zone to take a call, and the venue's safety procedures come before game rules.

2.2 What each mode is for

- **Dark** makes people the only channel. Phones may stay out, but the GM's toggles lock the platform to read-only: each person can read only their own company's Founder Dossier, role card and objective. There are no deals, chat, card trading or wallet actions on the platform, so nobody can look up a name, a price or a card list; they have to remember, ask and write things down. Wallet purchases are written on a paper Trade Slip signed by both sides and entered by an operator at Market Open, and company deals stay Proposed. Nothing about the company is printed; only personal cards are on paper.
- **Closed-net** lets the platform do its job as the record of reality while keeping discovery human. The app shows each person only what their visibility classes allow, has no search over other people or companies, and has no chat, so a question still means walking over to someone.

- **Open-net** tests the lesson the drafts set: the internet improves the speed and quality of information but does not supply relationships, access or execution.

2.3 Enforcement

Enforcement follows the Event Operations rule: an announced honour system plus the platform lock during Dark (only the read-only Founder Dossier, role card and objective stay on), not an IT contest. Volunteers give one reminder. A repeat is logged as an observation for the Founder Ledger, not fined. Anything found externally before Tick 8 cannot be used as mission evidence, and because the city's facts are fictional, the real internet holds almost none of them anyway; the main thing the closed modes protect is unaided thinking and talking (no AI-written analysis, no group chats replacing conversation).

3. Information hierarchy: who knows what

The GM alone sees everything; every other actor sees one slice, and the slices are cut so that each company's most useful facts sit with someone else. This section uses the Starting World's nine visibility classes (10.2) and its T0 table (10.3) without change, and adds what each actor may do with what it holds during play.

Actor	Knows by default	May reveal	Never reveals
Game Master / City Control	Everything, including truth status of every card and the Rumour Register	Through a release mechanism (3.2) only	Truth status on request; anything outside a scheduled or triggered release
Observers	Founder Ledger evidence (Observer class)	Nothing during play	All of it until the post-event reports
Institution desk	Its own rules, inventory, detailed criteria, its contracts with named companies, its whisper list (section 6)	Public headline always; detailed criteria and whispers under its desk sheet; confirm or deny claims about its own domain	Any company's cash, objectives, hidden lever or vulnerability; another company's dealings with it
Company leadership (CEO, signatories)	Company class plus Company leadership class: private objective	Anything the company holds, and may authorise the sale of Company-class cards	(no restriction; leaking is a choice)
Company role (one domain)	Company class plus the hidden lever, if the dossier gives it to their domain	Same as any staff member	(no restriction)
Any staff member	Company class: starting	May tell anyone	Cannot transfer a

Actor	Knows by default	May reveal	Never reveals
	state, public objective, dependency, gate, liability, anchor contract, leads, the 3 private facts and the vulnerability clue	anything; may transfer only cards they hold personally	Company-class card without a signatory (section 8.3)
Individual participant	Personal class: personal objective, personal information card, cards bought or earned	Anything they hold	(no restriction)
Everyone	Public class: city map, institution names, base prices, ruleset, company public profiles, public bulletins, mission board	(already public)	(already public)

3.1 Why the slices are cut this way

- A company's own staff never hold cards about their own company (Starting World 10.5), so self-knowledge comes from outsiders.
- The hidden lever sits with one domain, not the CEO, so the company learns its best move only if its own people talk.
- Institutions confirm only their own domain, so no single desk can answer everything and volunteers can never leak company secrets they were never told.

3.2 How information moves between classes

Information changes class only through a named mechanism, and every move is written to the record's Holders and Provenance fields. These are the drafts' seven release mechanisms plus the participant-driven moves this document adds.

Mechanism	Moves information from → to	Started by
Public bulletin	Hidden (GM) → Public	GM
Time release	Time-released → Public at its trigger	Platform
Institution whisper	Institution → Personal (one asker)	Desk, by its whisper rule

Mechanism	Moves information from → to	Started by
Company memo	Hidden (GM) → Company or Company role	GM
Company inbox	Hidden (GM) → Company, drip-fed tick by tick on the platform under each company's inbox schedule (Company Dossiers N.16)	Platform
Mission clue	Hidden (GM) → Personal (the claimant)	Mission completion
Auction reveal	Hidden (GM) → Public, for the auction window	GM
Crisis signal	Hidden (GM) → Personal or Company, before the crisis	GM
Person-to-person rumour	Any holder → a listener, as speech only	Any participant
Share or sale	Personal or Company → another participant's Personal class, with provenance	Holder (section 8)
Publication	Any class → Public, via the Media desk	Holder or GM (sections 8.5 and 10)

4. Information units: cards, grades and truth

Every tradable piece of information is a card: one Starting World information record (10.1) that the platform shows to its holders, carrying a grade everyone can see and a truth status only the GM can see. Keeping those two apart is the core of the mechanic: the grade says how much the city stands behind a card, never whether it is actually true.

4.1 Speech and cards

Anyone can say anything to anyone, and nothing stops it. What speech cannot do is create a record. A fact heard in conversation is, to the listener, a rumour with no provenance until they obtain the card itself through a share, sale, issue or verification. Only a held card can be verified cheaply, used as mission evidence, redeemed at a desk or resold with its provenance. This is what gives cards a price even though the words on them can be repeated for free.

4.2 Grades (visible to every holder)

Grade	Meaning	How a card gets it	Truth behind it
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Grade	Meaning	How a card gets it	Truth behind it
Rumour	No traceable source, or the card's own kind is rumour	Default for rumour cards; any card written up from speech at the Media desk	Any
Reported	A named source, not yet checked	Default for dossier private facts, personal information cards and cards bought from participants	About 60% true, 25% partly true, 15% false across the pool (Starting World 10.5)
Corroborated	Two independent sources agree	Holder presents two cards on the same claim, with the same assertion and different root sources (section 7.1)	Usually true; can still be wrong if both trace to planted misinformation
Verified	The city stands behind it at a stated time	Stamped by an institution about its own domain, the Media fact desk, or issued directly by the GM (bulletins, mission clues, institution whispers)	True, or partly true with the true part stated on the stamp
Debunked	Checked and found false	A verification that returns False	False; kept as evidence

Two extra labels sit beside the grade: **Stale** when a card passes its Expiry, and **Key** when it carries a redeemable benefit (4.4).

4.3 Rumours compared with verified information

	Rumour	Verified
Source	None, or untraceable	Named authority and time stamp
Can be traded	Yes, always labelled Rumour by the platform	Yes
Counts as mission evidence	Only for missions about rumours (M45 Rumour Check)	Yes
Accepted by the Investor or	No	Yes

	Rumour	Verified
Customer desk as proof		
Typical price (section 8.4)	0–150 VB	200–600 VB
Can become the other	Rises by corroboration or verification	Falls to Stale at expiry; never back to Rumour

The drafts' rule holds: rumours may be traded as rumours and never automatically become facts. A rumour changes grade only through section 7.

4.4 Key cards

Some cards are not only knowledge but a door: "the Energy supplier will give 20% off to a company that commits to 60 units" can be presented at the desk to get the discount. A key states where it is redeemed, what it gives, how many times, and until when.

- A key is honoured only if the card's truth status is True or Partly true; a false key fails at the desk with "no such offer", which is how false information costs something.
- Keys are first come, first served across all copies. A card copied to five people still opens a single-use door once, which is why exclusive sales (8.3) exist.
- Redeeming a key from Tick 1 on is a normal institution transaction; before Market Open a key can only be reserved, not used.

5. Discovery: how information enters the game

Information enters through nine sources, and the GM releases a steady per-tick budget through them so that something new is always findable but never broadcast to everyone at once. Every volume below scales with N, the number of active companies, in line with the Starting World rule that nothing assumes 7.

5.1 Sources

Source	What it yields	When	Grade at issue	Volume
Company dossier	3 private facts (own business, market behind a dependency slot, one rumour) and 1 vulnerability clue	T0	Reported (the rumour: Rumour)	4 per company
Personal information card	1 market, company, institution or rumour card	T0	Reported or Rumour	1 per participant

Source	What it yields	When	Grade at issue	Volume
Institution enquiry	Public answers from the desk sheet	From T0	Verified	Unlimited
Institution whisper	A private fact given to an asker who meets the whisper rule (section 6.1)	From T0	Verified	About $[N/2]$ loaded per tick across desks
Mission completion	A clue card and/or Data units (M17–M21, M44–M46 and the Human Internet missions)	From T0	Verified	Per mission
Public bulletin	A city-wide fact on Venture City Live	Each tick	Verified, Public	1 per tick, plus events
Crisis signal	An early warning one tick before a crisis or event, delivered by the platform to holders it picks under the GM's holder rule (13.1)	Before scheduled shocks	Verified, or Reported if deliberately ambiguous	1–3 holders per shock
Auction reveal	The asset, its reserve and its window	At auction open	Verified, Public	Per auction
Data Drop (Human Internet II)	A surge of new cards handed to participants by volunteers	Tick 7	Mixed	$2 \times N$ cards

Two further sources come from play rather than the GM. A participant who changes company keeps their Personal cards and their memory but loses Company-class access the moment the move is recorded. A company that fails leaves its Company-class records (customer list, supplier terms, contracts) as an asset the Core Game Systems document disposes of, typically by auction, which is the drafts' "acquire a failed company's customer list".

5.2 Human Internet missions

The drafts require at least 3 missions that need the Human Internet; this document sets the minimum at 3 active during Dark and Closed-net, drawn from the shared library and all generic:

- **M19 Human Internet.** Locate a named fact only through people and submit the chain of discovery (who told whom, in order). Card holdings are logged automatically; spoken links are written on a slip and spot-checked by a volunteer.
- **M45 Rumour Check.** Take one Rumour card to Corroborated or Debunked before acting on it.
- **M17 Five Conversations** or **M18 Competitor Map**, whichever fits the active set.

M44 Information Broker and M46 Scarcity Scout open from Tick 1, since both depend on a live market.

5.3 The Data Drop: Human Internet II

Human Internet II (Tick 7) is the drafts' "new information layer" made concrete: a second wave of asymmetric information released through people, timed so that whoever verifies and acts on it fastest enters the Capital Market at Tick 8 with an edge.

- $2 \times N$ new cards are handed by volunteers to participants chosen at random, never at desks, so finding them means asking around again.
- The mix: about N market, supplier or customer cards; about $N/2$ company-intel templates resolved to active companies; 1 market-moving rumour tied to the Capital Market (event E20), whose truth status the GM sets before the run.
- The Media fact desk switches to a rush queue for the tick (section 7.2).
- Event E05 Data Boom may run alongside, raising the value of Verified information for the tick.

5.4 Per-tick release budget

The GM releases, every tick from Tick 1: 1 public bulletin, about $\lceil N/2 \rceil$ whispers loaded across desks, 1 rumour seeded through a volunteer or the Media desk, and any scheduled crisis signals. The drafts' "silence is a mechanic" applies: the budget is a ceiling, and some ticks should release less so participants wonder what they are missing.

6. Asking people

Institutions answer from a fixed desk sheet with three tiers (always, earned, never), while participants owe nobody an answer or the truth in conversation. Both rules are the same for every company.

6.1 Asking an institution

Every desk works from a desk sheet that lists what it says to anyone, what it says only when a rule is met, and what it never says. Volunteers do not improvise beyond the sheet.

Tier	What the desk gives	Condition
Always	Its public headline, own rules, prices, how to apply, what it is looking for in general	Anyone asks

Tier	What the desk gives	Condition
Earned	Detailed criteria, exact remaining capacity, and whispers	The asker meets the item's whisper rule (below)
Never	Any company's cash, objectives, lever or vulnerability; another company's dealings with the desk; other desks' business; GM hidden state	Under no condition

Each whisper carries one of four rules, set in its record:

- **Relationship:** the asker's company has at least one recorded transaction with this desk. This rewards the drafts' "institution whisper rewards relationship-building".
- **Right question:** the asker names the specific topic on the record (for example, asking Logistics about spare priority capacity at a named tick). Curiosity is the price.
- **Consultation fee:** the asker pays the desk a stated fee, 100–200 VB, from wallet or company cash, from Market Open only, because desks take enquiries only before then (Starting World 3.3).
- **First K:** the first K askers get it, then it is gone, usually K = 2.

Confirm, deny or no comment. A desk will check a claim about its own domain, free, when shown the card. It answers Confirmed (the card becomes Verified), Denied (Debunked) or No comment. No comment is required whenever the claim touches another company's confidential business or a GM release not yet due, and it is given whether the claim is true or false, so the refusal itself leaks nothing.

Desk	Confirms or denies claims about
Bank	Credit policy, its own prices and stock, buy-back terms
Investor	Fund thesis and criteria, once the fund window is open
Customer desk	Open customer cards and procurement criteria
Talent Exchange	Specialist availability and market rates
Supplier Market	Supplier capacity, discounts and minimum orders
Logistics Provider	Standard and priority capacity, surge pricing
Government	Licences, tenders and rule changes already announced
Media	What has been published, and by whom

Desk time is the bottleneck, as the Starting World notes, so an enquiry is capped at about 2 minutes per person per visit and a fee-based whisper takes priority in the queue.

6.2 Asking another participant

Nobody is obliged to answer, and nobody is obliged to tell the truth in conversation; that is part of the economy (section 10). What is binding is the record: a share, sale, introduction or deal entered on the platform or a Trade Slip says exactly what was transferred and on what terms.

Introductions are tradable like cards. "I will introduce you to the person who knows this for 5% of the contract" is recorded as a deal with a fee or a percentage of a named contract, and settles under the Core Game Systems deal rules.

6.3 Asking a volunteer or the GM

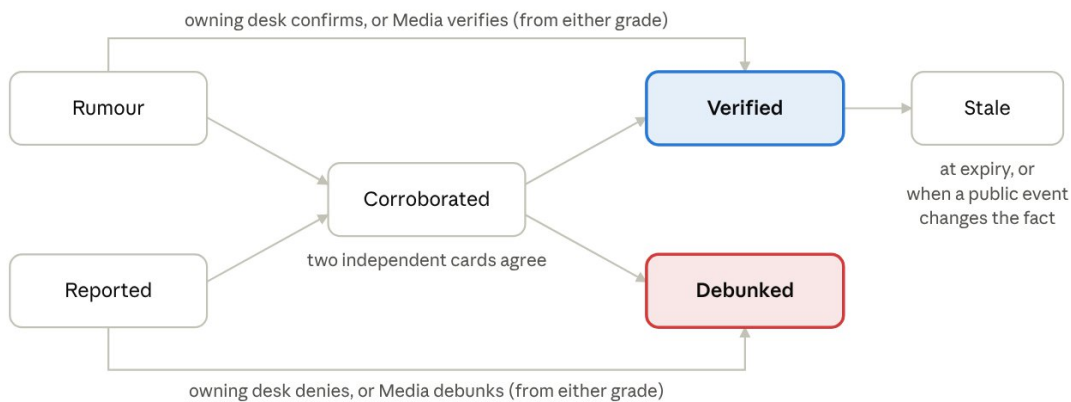
Volunteers and the GM never say whether a card is true. Following the Event Operations script, "Is this rumour true?" gets the answer "here is who can verify it, if anyone", which points to section 7.

7. Verification

A card can be checked three ways: free corroboration between two independent cards, free confirmation by the institution that owns the topic, or a paid Media fact check. Verification upgrades only the copy of the person who did it, so a verified card is worth more than the same words unverified, and verifying is itself a business.

Route	Who can use it	Cost	Result	Turnaround
Corroboration	Any holder of two qualifying cards	Free	Corroborated	Instant (platform), or at Market Open if done during Dark
Institution confirmation	Any holder, on claims in that desk's domain (6.1)	Free	Verified, Debunked or No comment	At the desk
Media fact check	Any holder, on any claim marked verifiable by Media	250 VB, or 10 Data units from Tick 1	Verified, Partly verified, Debunked or Unverifiable now	End of the current tick; rush in about 10 minutes at double price

Only a desk or the Media can make a card Verified



card grades · how a card moves between them

Corroboration is the free middle step participants control; only a desk or the Media can stamp a card Verified or Debunked, and any stamp can later go Stale.

7.1 Corroboration

Two cards corroborate each other when they refer to the same claim, make the same assertion, and trace back to different root cards. Copies of one original never corroborate each other, however many hands they passed through; the platform checks the root, which stops a seller manufacturing agreement by selling two copies. Corroboration is the participant-led route the drafts set in M45 ("two independent sources before acting") and it counts for that mission.

Corroboration is strong evidence, not proof. Once per run the GM may plant two independent false cards on one claim (section 10.2), so that the lesson "corroborated is not verified" can be learned the hard way.

7.2 Media fact check

The Media desk is the city's only general-purpose verifier. Its volunteer sees on the platform only the outcome to stamp for the card shown, never the rest of the register.

- **Verified:** the card is true as at this tick.
- **Partly verified:** the stamp states which part is true and which is not.
- **Debunked:** the card is false.
- **Unverifiable now:** the claim depends on a GM release not yet due (its record names the earliest tick it can be checked). Half the fee is refunded.

Media charges the same to every company, and paying in Data units gives the Data resource a use beyond production. During Dark, when desks take enquiries only, a request is logged, then charged to the wallet and answered at Market Open. During Human Internet II it runs rush-only, because that is when timing matters most.

The Media desk's platform inbox gets an automatic copy of every fact-check request, rumour plant, debunk (with a draft correction ready to publish), objective lodge that names Media, and the amplification counts, so the fact desk never depends on hand-carried notes.

7.3 Rules that apply to every route

- A stamp applies to the presenter's copy only. Other holders of the same card still see their own grade.
- Every stamp carries the tick it was made. If a later public event changes the underlying fact, every stamped card on that claim turns Stale at once; the GM never flips a verified fact silently, matching the crisis rule "do not secretly change the stated rule after participants act".
- Verification never reveals anything beyond what the card already says. Checking "the company filling S3 has under 3 ticks of runway" returns true or false, not the actual runway.
- A Debunked card stays in the holder's list as evidence: it can support a correction (10.3) or a dispute about a sale with a truth warranty (8.3).

8. Trading, buying and selling information

Information is traded like any other asset, with three differences: it can be copied, so most sales sell a copy; its grade travels with it, so the buyer always sees what the city stands behind; and the seller can add an exclusivity promise or a truth warranty that the platform enforces. The drafts' rule stands: information can be shared freely, sold, bartered, bundled into a deal or used as leverage.

8.1 Kinds of transaction

Transaction	What the buyer gets	Seller keeps a copy?	Recorded?
Tell	Words only; to the listener it is a rumour	Yes	No
Share	A copy with provenance, free	Yes	Yes
Sale	A copy with provenance, for VB, resources or Data units	Yes	Yes
Exclusive sale	A copy, and the seller's copy is locked against further shares or sales for the stated ticks	Yes, locked	Yes
Transfer	The original; the seller's copy is removed (the normal way to sell a key card outright)	No	Yes

Transaction	What the buyer gets	Seller keeps a copy?	Recorded?
Barter	A card for a card, or a card for an introduction	Yes	Yes
Deal component	A card bundled as part of a larger deal's consideration	Per the deal	Yes, as part of the deal

Using information as leverage in a negotiation without handing it over is not a transaction and is never recorded.

8.2 Recording a trade

- **Closed-net and Open-net:** the seller picks the card, buyer, price and terms in the app; the buyer accepts; the platform settles and writes the provenance.
- **Dark:** dossier facts and the company's private facts stay on the platform, read-only in the Founder Dossier view with their card ID; only personal cards, printed with their card ID, use the paper and Trade Slip route. Handing over the printed card is a Transfer; writing the card ID on a Trade Slip signed by both sides is a Sale of a copy. Operators enter slips at Market Open, and wallet VB settles then.

8.3 Rules

- **Whose money it is.** A Personal card is sold by its holder and the money goes to their personal wallet. A Company-class card needs a signatory's approval to be shared or sold, and the money goes to company cash. Without approval the platform refuses the transfer; the person can still say it aloud, but the listener only gets a rumour.
- **Before Market Open** only wallet VB moves. A Company-class card sale agreed during Dark is recorded as Proposed and settles at Tick 1, in line with the Starting World pre-market rules.
- **The grade travels.** A copy made from a stamped copy carries the stamp, so verify-then-resell is a legitimate business. A seller cannot misstate a grade, because the platform shows it; spoken sales talk ("this is solid") is the buyer's risk.
- **Truth warranty.** An optional clause: if the card is Debunked within 2 ticks, the price is refunded automatically. Warranties exist so honest sellers of unverified cards can charge more.
- **Exclusivity.** The platform blocks the seller's recorded resale for the stated ticks. A spoken leak cannot be policed, but it only ever reaches the next listener as a rumour.

8.4 Indicative price bands

Prices are free. These bands guide the GM, institution fees and playtest calibration against the 1,000 VB wallet and the 100 VB LO salary per tick.

Grade	Typical price
Rumour	0–150 VB
Reported	100–300 VB

Grade	Typical price
Corroborated	150–400 VB
Verified	200–600 VB
Key card	Up to about 30% of the value it unlocks

8.5 Publishing

A holder may pay the Media desk to publish a card, using one of the featured-story slots (1 per tick, Starting World section 9) at Media's standard price, set in the Institution Operating Content. A published card becomes Public, keeps its grade (a Rumour is printed as "sources say"), and the author is recorded in the register though not printed. Publishing is how a company kills a rival's information edge, signals strength, or answers a rumour about itself.

9. Information brokers

Anyone can broker information, and a limited number of participants can register as brokers for visibility and a few tools; brokering is a behaviour the game rewards, not a job anyone is assigned. Brokers stay employed by their company, in keeping with the Starting World rule that every participant is employed.

9.1 What a broker does

- Collects cards (buys, barter, earns from missions) and resells them, often after verifying them first.
- Assembles bundles: three Reported cards on one supplier are worth more together than apart.
- Arranges introductions for a fee or a share of a contract, recorded as a deal (6.2).
- Corroborates or verifies on behalf of clients, charging a margin over the Media fee.

9.2 Registered broker status

Item	Rule
How to register	Complete M44 Information Broker, or pay the Media desk 200 VB from Tick 1
Slots	At most $\lceil N/2 \rceil$ registered brokers per run (4 at $N = 7$), first come
Broker Board	A board in the information zone showing each broker's name, company and up to three "ask me about" topics, with no card content
Teaser listings	Can list cards on the board by their teaser line (a schema field) so buyers know what is for sale without learning it
Bulk checks	Media fact checks at 3 for 600 VB instead of 750

Item	Rule
Where the money goes	Personal cards to the wallet; Company-class cards to company cash, as in 8.3
Company arrangement	A broker's company may agree a revenue share with them, recorded as an internal deal

Registered status gives no special access to hidden information, desks or the GM. Every broker advantage is about being found and moving faster, not about knowing more by right.

9.3 Brokers in the wider game

- The Research/Intelligence domain is the natural home for brokers but has no exclusive right to it.
- Companies whose business is data (any company filling slot S11 Verified datasets) may trade information at company level under the same rules as everyone else.
- Event E05 Data Boom raises demand for Verified cards for its duration, which is when brokers earn most.
- Brokering, introducing and verifying before acting are recorded actions, so the Founder Ledger can see the drafts' quiet operators, connectors and researchers, not only the loudest pitchers.

10. Misdirection and false information

False information is a deliberate part of the economy, from two sources: the GM, who seeds a fixed share of false and partial cards, and participants, who may lie in conversation and plant labelled rumours. The line is drawn at the record: anyone may say something false, but nobody may falsify what the platform, a desk or a deal says.

10.1 Forms of false information

Form	What it is	Example of the pattern
False	The statement is untrue	A supplier "is about to run out" when it is not
Partial	True but missing the condition that matters	A discount is real but needs a volume nobody can meet
Outdated	Was true; an event has since changed it	Capacity that a later shock has consumed
Misattributed	True fact, wrong subject	The tight runway belongs to a different company
Inflated	Right direction, wrong size	Demand "doubles" when it rises 20%

10.2 GM-seeded misdirection

- Personal cards keep the Starting World mix of about 60% true, 25% partly true and 15% false, and each dossier's third private fact is a rumour that may be false.
- The Data Drop includes one market-moving rumour whose truth the GM fixes before the run (5.3).
- Crisis C16 Market Manipulation Rumour is the city-wide form: a false or uncertain signal that rewards participants who verify before reacting.
- Once per run at most, the GM may plant two independent false cards on one claim, so corroboration fails (7.1).
- No false card may decide the day: its worst consequence stays inside the Starting World cap of 10,000 VB equivalent for a vulnerability.

10.3 Participant misdirection

Allowed:

- Lying or bluffing in conversation, and declining to answer.
- Selling an unverified card without a warranty, as long as the platform shows its true grade.
- Planting a rumour: paying the Media desk to publish a statement as a Rumour (8.5). The author is recorded but not printed.

Not allowed, and voided by the GM if found:

- Forging or altering a printed card, Trade Slip or platform record.
- Impersonating a volunteer, an institution or the GM, or claiming a desk said something it did not.
- Writing false terms into a recorded deal; deal terms are binding facts.
- False safety or venue announcements.
- Rumours about a real person's character, appearance or private life. Rumours may concern companies, institutions, markets and in-game roles only, and the Media desk declines any that do not.

The correction rule. A published rumour that a verification later Debunks triggers a Media correction one tick later naming the author's company. For the next 2 ticks the Customer desk asks that company for one extra piece of evidence on any proposal. This gives misdirection a cost without banning it, and every plant, correction and act of verification is visible to the Founder Ledger as evidence of judgement and ethics.

11. The Internet Unlock at Tick 8

At the start of Tick 8 the city switches to Open-net: the real internet, AI tools, messaging, the City Net archive and the People Directory all open, and a batch of institution information goes public. What does not open is everything private, so the value of information shifts from knowing public facts to holding verified private intelligence and having access to the right people.

The announcement. "The internet is back. You can now search anything that is public. What you cannot search is what people know, what they want, and who they trust."

11.1 What opens

Unlocked	What it gives
External web and AI assistants	Real-world research and analysis, mainly for strengthening Capital Market proposals and Investor Day pitches
City Net	A platform search over everything Public: every bulletin, published card, price and demand index history, company public profiles, missions, auction results, and deal headlines (parties, type and tick, never terms)
People Directory	Search by name, company, domain, level and registered-broker topics; never by what someone holds
Platform messaging	Direct messages between participants
The Unlock release	Every institution Earned-tier item whose record names the Unlock as its release trigger goes Public, typically detailed credit criteria and supplier and logistics capacity notes

11.2 What never opens

Company, Company leadership, Company role, Personal, Institution whispers not yet released, Hidden (GM) and Observer records stay exactly as private as before. Truth status is never searchable, deal terms stay with the parties, and unverified cards keep their grade.

11.3 What changes in the economy

- Anything Public is now free to everyone, so cards that merely repeat City Net lose their price. The ruleset says in advance that much institution information goes public at the Unlock, so holding instead of using is a known risk.
- Private and Verified cards gain relative value, since they are the only edge left to buy.
- Human Internet missions close at the Unlock. Claims must be submitted by the end of Tick 7, and anything found online cannot be used as evidence for them, as the Event Operations reconciliation rule requires.
- From Tick 8 the Investor desk may check pitch claims against City Net and against the presenter's own Verified cards and recorded deals. Claims backed only by rumours carry no weight; the Investor Day Playbook sets the detail.

This is the lesson the drafts wanted at the end of the closed phase: the internet gives information, people give access.

12. Information cards: schema and starter library

Every card uses one schema with the same fields, so the library can move straight into a spreadsheet or the platform; this section fixes that schema, defines seven card types, and gives 15 example cards to show the pattern. The personal card pool is in 12.5; the rest of the library (Data Drop, whispers and signals) is a separate content-generation pass and is not attempted here.

12.1 Card schema

The first eleven fields are the Starting World information record (10.1) under platform names; the rest are added by this document.

Field	Content	Seen by holder?
card_id	Unique reference, e.g. IC-SUP-01	Yes
statement	What the holder reads; may contain slot variables (12.3)	Yes
kind	fact, clue or rumour	Yes
truth_status	true, partly_true or false	No (GM)
visibility_class	One of the nine Starting World classes, at issue	Yes
holders	Who holds a copy now	Own copy only
provenance	Chain of holders back to the root card	Yes
tradable	yes, signatory (Company-class) or no	Yes
release_trigger	Tick or condition at which it becomes Public, if any	No (GM)
expiry	Tick after which it is Stale	Yes
links	Companies, slots, contracts, events, other cards	No (GM)
card_type	One of the seven types (12.2)	Yes
personal_kind	market, company, institution or rumour, for drawing personal cards from the Starting World pool	No (GM)
teaser	One line that says what the card is about without giving it away	Yes

Field	Content	Seen by holder?
	(used on the Broker Board)	
claim_id and assertion	The underlying claim and the value asserted, used for corroboration	No (GM)
grade	Rumour, Reported, Corroborated, Verified or Debunked, plus Stale	Yes
truth_note	For partly true or false cards: what is wrong, and which variant (10.1)	No (GM)
source_channel	dossier, personal, whisper, mission, bulletin, crisis signal or Data Drop	Yes
whisper_rule	relationship, right question, fee or first K (whispers only)	No (GM)
key	Where redeemed, what it gives, uses, until when; or none	Yes
verifiable_by	Routes (corroboration, a named desk, Media) and the earliest tick each works	Yes
value_band	Indicative VB range for calibration	No (GM)
active_set_rule	Issue only if a named slot is filled; otherwise skip or fall back	No (GM)

12.2 Card types

Type	What it is about	Starting World personal kind
Company intelligence	Another company's state, needs, problems or spare assets	company
Market information	Demand indices, prices, shortages, sector trends	market
Supplier information	Supplier and logistics capacity, discounts, terms	institution
Customer intelligence	Buyer needs, procurement	market

Type	What it is about	Starting World personal kind
	criteria, upcoming customer cards	
Institution intelligence	Bank, Government, Investor and Talent policy and timing	institution
Rumour	An unsourced claim about anything above	rumour
Strategic clue	A pointer towards a hidden lever, opportunity or vulnerability, phrased as a lead rather than a fact	company

False and partial cards are a variant, not a type. Any card of any type can be partly true or false; this lives only in the GM-only `truth_status` and `truth_note`, so a holder can never tell from the card's face. Three examples below carry that variant.

12.3 Slot variables

Card statements never name a company directly. `{S1}` to `{S12}` resolve at T0 to the active company filling that role slot; `{own}` is the holder's company; `{sector}`, `{res}` and `{N}` resolve to a sector in the active set, a resource and the number of active companies. If a card's slot is not filled in this run, its `active_set_rule` skips it or substitutes the institution fallback from Starting World 11.1.

12.4 Starter library: 15 example cards

card_id	Type	Statement	Kind / grade at issue	Truth (GM) and note	Source / held by	Key	Verifiable by	Expiry	Value band
IC-CO-01	Company intelligence	<code>{S3}</code> has about 30 units of Compute per tick it is not using.	fact / Reported	true	personal card, an outsider to <code>{S3}</code>	none	Media from T0; corroboration	Tick 4	150–300
IC-CO-02	Company intelligence	<code>{S7}</code> 's supplier agreement lapses	fact / Reported	partly true (partial) : every compa	personal card, an outside	none	Media from T0	Tick 4	50–150

card_id	Type	Statement	Kind / grade at issue	Truth (GM) and note	Source / held by	Key	Verifiable by	Expiry	Value band
		at Tick 4 and has not been renewed.		ny's supplier agreement lapses at Tick 4, so it is no special weakness	r to {S7}				
IC-CO-03	Company intelligence	{S1} will lose its anchor customer next tick.	fact / Reported	false	personal card, an outsider to {S1}	none	Media from T0; Customer desk gives No comment	Tick 6	0-100
IC-MKT-01	Market information	Demand in {sector} rises to 130 at Tick 5.	fact / Reported	true; linked to a scheduled event	crisis signal to 2 holders at Tick 4	none	Media from Tick 4	Tick 7	200-400
IC-MKT-02	Market information	A Data shortage from Tick 6 will push the Bank price up 40%.	fact / Reported	partly true (inflated): the rise is 20%	Data Drop	none	Media from Tick 5; Bank at release	Tick 8	100-250
IC-SUP-	Supplie	The	fact /	true	whisper	Logistic	Logistic	Tick 5	up to

card_id	Type	Statement	Kind / grade at issue	Truth (GM) and note	Source / held by	Key	Verifiable by	Expiry	Value band
01	Supplier information	Logistics Provide r gives 30% off standard capacity to the first company that commits to 15 × {N} units over 3 ticks.	Verified		at Logistics, rule: right question	Supplier desk, 1 use, until Tick 5	Supplier desk		30% of the saving
IC-SUP-02	Supplier information	The Energy supplier has 40 spare units this tick at 20% below Bank base.	fact / Verified	true	M46 Scarcity Scout reward	Supplier Market, 1 use, this tick	Supplier desk	end of tick	100-200
IC-CUS-01	Customer intelligence	At Tick 3 an Enterprise buyer will post a card seeking	fact / Reported	true	personal card	priority first meeting at the Customer desk, 1 use	Media from Tick 2; Customer desk from Tick 3	Tick 5	300-600

card_id	Type	Statement	Kind / grade at issue	Truth (GM) and note	Source / held by	Key	Verifiable by	Expiry	Value band
		an AI analytics vendor; budget 6,000 VB; must-have: a verified dataset .							
IC-CUS-02	Customer intelligence	Anchor renews after Tick 6 will require a delivery record of at least 3 ticks.	fact / Verified	true	whisper at Customer desk, rule: relationship	none	Customer desk	Tick 7	150-300
IC-INS-01	Institution intelligence	From Tick 6 the Bank's working-capital loans will need two qualifying items instead	fact / Reported	true; bulletin at Tick 6	crisis signal to 3 holders at Tick 4	none	Media from Tick 5; Bank gives No comment until then	Tick 6	300-500

card_id	Type	Statement	Kind / grade at issue	Truth (GM) and note	Source / held by	Key	Verifiable by	Expiry	Value band
		of one.							
IC-INS-02	Institution intelligence	Government opens a tender at Tick 5 for the {gate} licence, worth 3,000 VB, favouring applicants who already hold a licence.	fact / Verified	true	whisper at Government, rule: relationship	priority filing slot, 1 use	Government desk	Tick 6	250-500
IC-RUM-01	Rumour	The Investor fund favours companies with recorded partnerships with two or more others.	rumour / Rumour	set by GM per run (event E20)	Data Drop, 1 market-moving rumour	none	Media (rush) from Tick 7; Investor desk from Tick 8	Tick 9	0-150
IC-RUM-	Rumour	The Materials	rumour /	false (crisis C16)	GM seed via a	none	Media from T0;	Tick 5	0-50

card_id	Type	Statement	Kind / grade at issue	Truth (GM) and note	Source / held by	Key	Verifiable by	Expiry	Value band
02		supplier shuts at Tick 5.	Rumour	pattern)	volunteer		Supplier desk		
IC-CLU-01	Strategic clue	Ask {S6}'s Operations team what their spare stock would be worth to a manufacturer.	clue / Reported	true; issued only if {S6} holds a Latent asset lever	personal card, an outsider to {S6}	none	corroboration only	Tick 8	150-350
IC-CLU-02	Strategic clue	Your anchor customer's procurement lead has asked twice about your delivery record.	clue / Reported	true; this is the dossier vulnerability clue for a Concentration vulnerability	dossier, {own} company	none	Customer desk gives No comment; Media from T0	Tick 6	not for sale outside ; signatory only

The pattern for the full library: about two cards per type per active company for the personal pool and dossiers, keeping the 60/25/15 truth mix; 2 × N Data Drop cards; at least one whisper per desk per tick of Closed-net; and every card about a company held by at least three outsiders across at least two companies (Starting World 10.5).

12.5 Personal information card pool

The personal pool is 33 templates that the platform turns into one personal card per participant at T0: about 100 cards at City 10 ($N = 10$), 61% true, 24% partly true and 15% false, so organisers write no cards by hand. The GM reviews the deal on the console before the cards are printed for the City Opens envelopes. The same rows are in `human-internet/personal-card-pool.csv` in the project files for the developer.

Variables beyond 12.3. Every value is read from the same platform record the game runs on, after registration closes, so a true card stays true in any active set.

- $\{Sx\}$ is the subject company, reached through the one slot it is dealt under: SwiftCart S2, Ledgerly S7, Mango & Co. S12, SkillForge S10, PulseAI S9, GreenGrid S4, MediLink S11, HarvestLoop S6, StackHouse S3, Voltway S1, Forgeline S5, TrustLayer S8. No two companies share a slot this way, even though S1 and S11 can have two fillers.
- $\{Sx.field\}$ reads that company's T0 record (Passport Packs parts 3 to 8): `first_res` and `first_tick` (first resource to run out, no purchases), `low_res` (first Low-tier resource), `deficit` (deficit domain), `anchor` and `anchor_pay` (anchor customer, VB per tick), `crit` and `crit_fallback` (critical dependency slot and its fallback), `runway` (ticks, as recomputed at registration close), `asset` and `asset_loan` (Notable Asset and 60% of its book value), `fill` (the subject slot's name), `gate`.
- $\{cu.*\}$ is one loaded open customer card (CU-01 to CU-24): `customer`, `sector`, `budget`, `decide`. $\{su.*\}$ is a supplier pair from IOC 5.2: `alt`, `band`, `std`, `list`. Formulas of $\{N\}$ are worked out before printing.

Mix at City 10 (100 participants).

Kind	True	Partly true	False	Cards
Company	24	10	6	40
Market	15	5	4	24
Institution	11	5	2	18
Rumour	11	4	3	18
Total	61	24	15	100

Dealing rules (platform, at T0).

1. **Size.** One card per registered participant (P), dealt after registration closes. Company cards are $4 \times N$; the other $P - 4N$ cards split market, institution and rumour 24 : 18 : 18, each template scaled from its "Cards per 100" column and rounded so the pool stays within 2 points of 60/25/15.
2. **Four cards about every company.** Slot A is IC-CO-11 (true). Slot B is a true card from IC-CO-12 to IC-CO-15, rotating. Slot C is a partly true card from IC-CO-16 to IC-CO-18, rotating. Slot D is a false card (IC-CO-19 or IC-CO-20) for $\text{round}(0.6 \times N)$ subjects (6 at $N = 10$) and a second, different true card from IC-CO-12 to IC-CO-15 for the rest. No company is the subject of two cards that are not true.

3. **Never to insiders.** A company card never goes to anyone in the resolved company, and the four cards about one subject go to four different companies (above the Starting World minimum of 3 outsiders across 2 companies).
4. **Copies.** One resolved card (same template, same values) goes to at most 3 people, each in a different company. All copies of a resolved card share one root, so they never corroborate each other (7.1). Some templates share a claim with a different assertion (IC-CO-15 and IC-CO-18; IC-INS-15 and IC-RUM-17; IC-SUP-12 and IC-RUM-16; IC-MKT-17 and IC-RUM-11): holders who compare them find a conflict to check.
5. **Spread inside a company.** Each company's staff get roughly the pool's mix: company cards are 30 to 50% of their cards, at least 3 of the 4 kinds appear once a company has 7 or more staff, no two staff hold cards about the same subject, and no company's staff hold more than 2 false cards at $N = 10$.
6. **Active-set rules.** A template whose GM-only rule is not met (for example IC-CO-12 for a company with no Low-tier resource, or IC-RUM-14 when E08 is not in the deck) is replaced by the substitute the CSV names, which has the same truth status. If the substitute is at its copy cap, the platform takes the next template of the same kind and truth status, then one of another kind.
7. **Review and lock.** The deal uses a recorded seed. The GM sees holder, card and truth on the console, may re-deal once, then locks it for printing. Cards appear in each holder's card list on the platform when the cards feature is switched on after Human Internet I.
8. **Late arrivals and movers.** The platform holds about 5% spare cards from true and partly true market and institution templates; a late arrival draws one, never a company card. Anyone who later joins a subject's company keeps their card.

Pool. Columns marked GM only are never shown to participants or desk volunteers; the platform keeps them in the card's truth_status, truth_note and value_band fields (12.1).

card_id	Kind / type	State ment (temp late)	Resol ves to	Tease r	Grade at issue	Verifi able by	Expiry	Cards per 100 (GM only)	Truth (GM only)	What is actual ly true (GM only)	Value band VB (GM only)
IC-MKT-11	mark et / Mark et infor mation	The Bank starts with {40×N } units of each resou rce	one card ({N} filled in)	What make s Bank prices jump	fact / Repor ted	Bank from T0; Medi a from T0	Tick 6	2	true	True as writte n (Bank price steps and stock formu	100-200

card_id	Kind / type	Statement (template)	Resolves to	Teaser	Grade at issue	Verifiable by	Expiry	Cards per 100 (GM only)	Truth (GM only)	What is actually true (GM only)	Value band VB (GM only)
		and restocks {10×N} a tick. Once its stock of a resource drops below half, that resource costs 20% more; below a quarter, 50% more.								la).	
IC-MKT-12	market / Market information	No company can buy more than 30 units	one card	The Bank's hard limits	fact / Reported	Bank from T0	Tick 8	2	true	True as written (BK-01, BK-02).	50-150

card_id	Kind / type	State ment (temp late)	Resol ves to	Tease r	Grade at issue	Verifi able by	Expiry	Cards per 100 (GM only)	Truth (GM only)	What is actual ly true (GM only)	Value band VB (GM only)
		of one resou rce from the Bank in a tick, and the Bank buys back at only 60% of base price, 20 units at most.									
IC-MKT-13	mark et / Custo mer intelli gence	The Custo mer desk holds an open card: {cu.cu stome r} ({cu.s	one card per loade d open custo mer card (CU-01 to CU-24	A buyer most peopl e have not seen	fact / Repor ted	Custo mer desk from T0; Medi a from T0	Tick {cu.de cide}	5	true	True as writte n; value s copie d from the loade d card	200-400

card_id	Kind / type	Statement (template)	Resolves to	Teaser	Grade at issue	Verifiable by	Expiry	Cards per 100 (GM only)	Truth (GM only)	What is actually true (GM only)	Value band VB (GM only)
		ector} , budget {cu.budget} } VB, deciding by Tick {cu.decide}. Only people who visit the desk or hold a lead see it.	in this run's set); never a held-back card							at index 100.	
IC-MKT-14	market / Customer intelligence	Customer desk pilots run 1 or 2 ticks at no more than 25% of the card's per-	one card	How to get a foot in the door	fact / Reported	Customer desk from T0	Tick 8	2	true	True as written (standard terms 4.1).	100-200

card_id	Kind / type	Statement (template)	Resolves to	Teaser	Grade at issue	Verifiable by	Expiry	Cards per 100 (GM only)	Truth (GM only)	What is actually true (GM only)	Value band VB (GM only)
		tick budget, and an accepted pilot counts as a completed pilot toward any gate.									
IC-MKT-15	market / Customer intelligence	The Customer desk opens with {2×N} open buyer cards, and up to 6 more are held back until an event or a	one card	More buyers than the board shows	fact / Reported	Customer desk (open count only) from T0; Media from T0	Tick 8	2	true	True: 2 open cards per active company are loaded; CU-25 to CU-30 are held back for levers and event	100-250

card_id	Kind / type	Statement (template)	Resolves to	Teaser	Grade at issue	Verifiable by	Expiry	Cards per 100 (GM only)	Truth (GM only)	What is actually true (GM only)	Value band VB (GM only)
		company's hidden move releases them.								s.	
IC-MKT-16	market / Market information	A Media story goes viral when people from $\{\text{ceil}(N/3)+1\}$ other companies amplify it before the tick ends; its sector's demand index	one card	How a story moves a market	fact / Reported	Media from Tick 1	Tick 9	2	true	True as written (viral mechanism 7.4).	100-200

card_id	Kind / type	Statement (template)	Resolves to	Teaser	Grade at issue	Verifiable by	Expiry	Cards per 100 (GM only)	Truth (GM only)	What is actually true (GM only)	Value band VB (GM only)
		then rises by 20 for 2 ticks.									
IC-MKT-17	market / Customer intelligence	In {sector}, the Customer desk will pay up to 10% above a card's ceiling to any seller who asks for it.	one card per sector in the active set	Room above the ceiling	fact / Reported	Customer desk from T0; Media from T0	Tick 7	5	partly true (partial)	Partial. The +10% stretch is real but only when the seller meets the card's hidden need, which the desk reveals only on the right question. Asking for more money	50-150

card_id	Kind / type	State ment (temp late)	Resol ves to	Tease r	Grade at issue	Verifi able by	Expiry	Cards per 100 (GM only)	Truth (GM only)	What is actual ly true (GM only)	Value band VB (GM only)
										y gets nothing.	
IC-MKT-18	mark et / Mark et infor mation	{secto r} dema nd is fixed for the day: card budge ts in that sector will not move.	one card per sector in the active set	Will {secto r} budge ts hold?	fact / Repor ted	Medi a from T0; Custo mer desk from T0	Tick 6	4	false	False. A card's live budge t is its listed budge t × the sector index ÷ 100 at signin g; a viral story adds 20 for 2 ticks and event s move indice s.	0-100
IC-CO-11	comp any / Comp any	If {Sx} buys nothing, it	each active comp any,	When {Sx}'s shelv es go	fact / Repor ted	Medi a from T0;	Tick {Sx.fir st_tic k}	10	true	True: copie d from	150-300

card_id	Kind / type	State ment (temp late)	Resol ves to	Tease r	Grade at issue	Verifi able by	Expiry	Cards per 100 (GM only)	Truth (GM only)	What is actual ly true (GM only)	Value band VB (GM only)
	intelli gence	runs out of {Sx.fir st_res } around Tick {Sx.fir st_tic k}.	throu gh its subje ct slot {Sx}	empt y		corro borati on				the subje ct's T0 recor d (first resou rce to run out, no purch ases).	
IC-CO-12	comp any / Comp any intelli gence	{Sx} draws {Sx.lo w_res } at the Low tier and holds more than it needs ; it could sell some.	each active comp any, throu gh its subje ct slot {Sx}	What {Sx} has spare	fact / Repor ted	Medi a from T0; corro borati on	Tick 6	3	true	True: the subje ct has {Sx.lo w_res } at Low tier (100 units at T0, slow draw) .	150-300
IC-CO-13	comp any / Comp	{Sx} is one perso	each active comp	{Sx}'s missi ng	fact / Repor ted	Medi a from	Tick 5	4	true	True: the subje	100-250

card_id	Kind / type	State ment (temp late)	Resol ves to	Tease r	Grade at issue	Verifi able by	Expiry	Cards per 100 (GM only)	Truth (GM only)	What is actual ly true (GM only)	Value band VB (GM only)
	any intelligence	n short in {Sx.deficit} and nobody on the team covers it.	any, through its subject slot {Sx}	seat		T0; corroboration				ct's deficit domain from its T0 record.	
IC-CO-14	comp any / Comp any intelligence	{Sx}'s anchor customer, {Sx.anchor}, pays {Sx.anchor_pay} VB a tick only through Tick 6; after that it renews on the Custo	each active comp any, through its subject slot {Sx}	{Sx}'s anchor after Tick 6	fact / Reported	Media from T0 (Customer desk gives No comment)	Tick 7	4	true	True: the anchor contract runs Ticks 1 to 6, then renews on the Customer desk's standard terms .	150-300

card_id	Kind / type	Statement (template)	Resolves to	Teaser	Grade at issue	Verifiable by	Expiry	Cards per 100 (GM only)	Truth (GM only)	What is actually true (GM only)	Value band VB (GM only)
		mer desk's standard terms or walks.									
IC-CO-15	company / Company intelligence	{Sx} depends on {Sx.crit}. If no company sells it, {Sx} pays {Sx.crit_fall back} at standard terms.	each active company, through its subject slot {Sx}	What {Sx} cannot do without	fact / Reported	Media from T0; corroboration	Tick 6	3	true	True: critical dependency and fallback from the T0 record (SW 11.2).	150-300
IC-CO-16	company / Company intelligence	{Sx} has only {Sx.ru nway - 3} ticks of	each active company, through its subject slot	How long {Sx} can last	fact / Reported	Media from T0; corroboration	Tick 5	4	partly true (inflated)	Inflated. Direction right, size wrong: the	50-150

card_id	Kind / type	Statement (template)	Resolves to	Teaser	Grade at issue	Verifiable by	Expiry	Cards per 100 (GM only)	Truth (GM only)	What is actually true (GM only)	Value band VB (GM only)
		cash left if no new revenue comes in.	{Sx}							real runway with no new revenue is {Sx.runway} ticks (platform value at registration close) .	
IC-CO-17	company / Company intelligence	{Sx} can borrow {Sx.asset_loan} VB from the Bank against its {Sx.asset} and repay	each active company, through its subject slot {Sx}	Cash hidden in {Sx}'s assets	fact / Reported	Bank (BK-06 terms only) from T0; Media from T0	Tick 6	3	partly true (partial)	Partial. BK-06 does lend up to 60% of the Notable Asset's book value ({Sx.asset_loan})	100-200

card_id	Kind / type	State ment (temp late)	Resol ves to	Tease r	Grade at issue	Verifi able by	Expiry	Cards per 100 (GM only)	Truth (GM only)	What is actual ly true (GM only)	Value band VB (GM only)
		nothi ng until the freeze .								VB), but at 12% flat with a single paym ent after 4 ticks, one loan per asset, and the Bank takes the asset on defaul t.	
IC- CO-18	comp any / Comp any intelli gence	{Sx} canno t run witho ut a {Sx.fill } provi der and will pay	each active comp any, throu gh its subje ct slot {Sx}	Who {Sx} is shopp ing for	fact / Repor ted	Medi a from TO; corro borati on	Tick 6	3	partly true (misat tribut ed)	Misat tribut ed. {Sx} sells {Sx.fill }; what it needs and pays	50- 150

card_id	Kind / type	Statement (template)	Resolves to	Teaser	Grade at issue	Verifiable by	Expiry	Cards per 100 (GM only)	Truth (GM only)	What is actually true (GM only)	Value band VB (GM only)
		well for one.								for is {Sx.critical}.	
IC-CO-19	company / Company intelligence	The Venture Fund has already offered {Sx} 20,000 VB, agreed before Market Open.	each active company, through its subject slot {Sx}	{Sx} and the Fund	fact / Reported	Investor desk from T0 (fund not open) ; Media from T0	Tick 8	3	false	False. The Fund is closed until the capital window (Tick 8): no meetings, no terms before it. No company has an offer.	0-100
IC-CO-20	company / Company intelligence	{Sx} has already cleared its	each active company, through its	{Sx}'s gate	fact / Reported	Media from T0; the gate	Tick 3	3	false	False at T0: no company starts	0-100

card_id	Kind / type	State ment (temp late)	Resol ves to	Tease r	Grade at issue	Verifi able by	Expiry	Cards per 100 (GM only)	Truth (GM only)	What is actual ly true (GM only)	Value band VB (GM only)
		gate ({Sx.g ate})) and is keepi ng it quiet.	subje ct slot {Sx}			holde r's desk for its own recor ds				with its gate cleare d. If {Sx} clears it later, the card goes Stale at Tick 3 anyw ay.	
IC-SUP-11	institut ion / Suppli er infor mation	For {res}, {su.alt } will sell inside a band of {su.band} VB a unit, under {su.st d}'s fixed list of {su.lis	one card per resou rce: Comp ute (SU-02 vs SU-01), Logist ics (SU-06 vs SU-05), Mater ials	A cheap er {res} suppli er	fact / Repor ted	Suppli er desk from T0	Tick 6	4	true	True: list prices and negot iation bands from the suppli er catalo gue. Some altern ative suppli ers carry	100-250

card_id	Kind / type	Statement (template)	Resolves to	Teaser	Grade at issue	Verifiable by	Expiry	Cards per 100 (GM only)	Truth (GM only)	What is actually true (GM only)	Value band VB (GM only)
		tj.	(SU-08 vs SU-07), Infrastructure (SU-12 vs SU-11)							hidden constraints, which this card does not claim about .	
IC-SUP-12	institution / Supplier information	Quarry Analytics (SU-10) is the cheapest Data in the city, down to 19 VB a unit.	one card	The cheapest Data	fact / Reported	Supplier desk (price only) from T0; Media from T0	Tick 7	2	partly true (partial)	Partial. The price is right, but about a third of SU-10's data is stale; the C05 card names it and voids units bought in	50-150

card_id	Kind / type	State ment (temp late)	Resol ves to	Tease r	Grade at issue	Verifi able by	Expiry	Cards per 100 (GM only)	Truth (GM only)	What is actual ly true (GM only)	Value band VB (GM only)
										the 2 ticks before. Its units are never Verified grade .	
IC-INS-11	institution / Institution intelligence	Gover nment decides at most {2, or 3 when $N \geq 10$ } licenc e applications a tick, in arriva l order, and runs only 1 Food Safety	one card	The licenc e queue	fact / Reported	Gover nment desk from T0	Tick 8	2	true	True as writte n (6.1, GV-L03).	100-250

card_id	Kind / type	Statement (template)	Resolves to	Teaser	Grade at issue	Verifiable by	Expiry	Cards per 100 (GM only)	Truth (GM only)	What is actually true (GM only)	Value band VB (GM only)
		inspection a tick.									
IC-INS-12	institution / Institution intelligence	The Venture Fund will make at most {ceil(0.7×N)} investments in the whole run and meets nobody before the capital window.	one card	How many the Fund will back	fact / Reported	Investor desk (once open) ; Media from T0	Tick 9	3	true	True as written (fund parameters 3.1). Booking can open earlier; meetings start at the window.	100-250
IC-INS-13	institution / Institution intelligence	Government's grant window runs	one card	Free money, if you partner	fact / Reported	Government desk from T0	Tick 7	2	true	True as written (6.3).	150-300

card_id	Kind / type	Statement (template)	Resolves to	Teaser	Grade at issue	Verifiable by	Expiry	Cards per 100 (GM only)	Truth (GM only)	What is actually true (GM only)	Value band VB (GM only)
		Tick 5 to the end of Tick 6 from a pool of {3,000×N} VB, and two companies with a recorded partnership can share up to 5,000 VB (GV-G04).									
IC-INS-14	institution / Institution intelligence	Without a security firm, Government's security	one card	Proving you are secure	fact / Reported	Government desk from T0; Media from	Tick 8	2	partly true (inflated)	Inflated. GV-L10 costs 1,500 VB and takes	50-150

card_id	Kind / type	Statement (template)	Resolves to	Teaser	Grade at issue	Verifiable by	Expiry	Cards per 100 (GM only)	Truth (GM only)	What is actually true (GM only)	Value band VB (GM only)
		ty review (GV-L10) is the only way to prove security, and it costs 3,000 VB and takes 3 ticks.				T0				2 ticks; an Approved Auditor's attestation (GV-L06 holder) is the other route.	
IC-INS-15	institution / Institution intelligence	Medi a gives a company whose Notable Asset is a brand half price on	one card	A discount at the Medi a desk	fact / Reported	Medi a desk from T0	Tick 9	1	partly true (inflated)	Inflated. The brand discount is 25%, on MD-P02, P03 and P04 only.	50-150

card_id	Kind / type	Statement (template)	Resolves to	Teaser	Grade at issue	Verifiable by	Expiry	Cards per 100 (GM only)	Truth (GM only)	What is actually true (GM only)	Value band VB (GM only)
		featured stories, business features and campaigns.									
IC-INS-16	institution / Institution intelligence	Lock cash at the Bank for a proof-of-funds certificate (BK-11) and it earns 5% a tick.	one card	Parking cash at the Bank	fact / Reported	Bank from T0	Tick 6	2	false	False. BK-11 pays no interest and costs a 50 VB fee; locked cash still counts in NAV and serves as E3 evidence.	0-50
IC-	rumo	Heard	one	What	rumo	Custo	Tick 8	3	true	True:	50-

card_id	Kind / type	State ment (temp late)	Resol ves to	Tease r	Grade at issue	Verifi able by	Expiry	Cards per 100 (GM only)	Truth (GM only)	What is actual ly true (GM only)	Value band VB (GM only)
RUM-11	ur / Rumour	at the Custo mer desk: some buyer s have a secon d need they menti on only if you ask the right questi on, and meeti ng it lifts what they pay.	card	buyer s do not say	ur / Rumour	mer desk (its own cards) from T0; Medi a from T0				every open card has a hidde n need (Earn ed: right questi on) that unloc ks the +10% stretc h.	150
IC-RUM-12	rumour / Rumour	Some one says a grey-mark et seller	one card	A seller nobo dy lists	rumour / Rumour	Suppli er desk from Tick 5	Tick 9	3	true	True: SU-15 The Back Lot sells small	50-150

card_id	Kind / type	Statement (template)	Resolves to	Teaser	Grade at issue	Verifiable by	Expiry	Cards per 100 (GM only)	Truth (GM only)	What is actually true (GM only)	Value band VB (GM only)
		appears from Tick 5, but only if you ask for it directly.								lots of the GM-named resource from Tick 5 and is revealed only when asked directly.	
IC-RUM-13	rumor / Rumor	Allied Materials Depot and Ironside Modular share an owner and are about to merge; both	one card	Two suppliers, one owner	rumor / Rumor	Supplier desk (after GM release); Media from T0	Tick 8	2	partly true (inflated)	Inflated. SU-07 and SU-12 do share an owner, but they merge only if event E21 fires, and prices	0-100

card_id	Kind / type	Statement (template)	Resolves to	Teaser	Grade at issue	Verifiable by	Expiry	Cards per 100 (GM only)	Truth (GM only)	What is actually true (GM only)	Value band VB (GM only)
		will put prices up 20%.								then rise 10%.	
IC-RUM-14	rumor / Rumor	They say the Bank will open a cheap credit window at 8% for every one at some point.	one card	Cheap credit coming?	rumor / Rumor	Bank (once announced); Media from T0	Tick 9	2	partly true (partial)	Partial. BK-12 Credit Window opens only when event E08 fires, for 1 tick, Grade A or B only, first come, 5,000 VB per company from a 2,500 × N facility.	0-100

card_id	Kind / type	Statement (template)	Resolves to	Teaser	Grade at issue	Verifiable by	Expiry	Cards per 100 (GM only)	Truth (GM only)	What is actually true (GM only)	Value band VB (GM only)
IC-RUM-15	rumour / Rumour	The Bank is closing all lending for the first three ticks.	one card	Bank lending frozen?	rumour / Rumour	Bank from T0	Tick 3	3	false	False. Bank lending opens at Market Open; only C02 Liquidity Freeze closes some products, for 1 tick, if the GM fires it.	0-50
IC-RUM-16	rumour / Rumour	Someone says the cheaper Data supplier's stock is	one card	Bad data in the market	rumour / Rumour	Corroboration; Supplier desk after GM release	Tick 8	2	true	True: about a third of SU-10 Quarry Analytics' data	50-150

card_id	Kind / type	State ment (temp late)	Resol ves to	Tease r	Grade at issue	Verifi able by	Expiry	Cards per 100 (GM only)	Truth (GM only)	What is actual ly true (GM only)	Value band VB (GM only)
		partly stale.				(C05)				is stale (hidden constraint).	
IC-RUM-17	rumor / Rumor	Word at the Media desk: a company whose Notable Asset is a brand pays a quarter less for stories.	one card	A discount at the Media desk	rumor / Rumor	Media desk from T0	Tick 9	3	true	True: 25% off MD-P02, P03 and P04 for a Brand Notable Asset.	50-150

13. GM controls, platform data and open questions

The GM runs the information economy from one console over the card register; the platform enforces visibility, grades, exclusivity and warranties so no volunteer has to remember them.

13.1 GM console

- **Mode switch:** DARK, CLOSED, OPEN, with an on-screen countdown to each change. Each mode is a preset of per-feature toggles: the visibility and use of Founder Dossier read, deals, wallet, cards, missions, chat and messaging, search, investor booking and the other platform features. The GM sets them per phase and can change any one live. Dark leaves only the read-only own Founder Dossier, role card and objective on.
- **Release:** public bulletins, whisper loading per desk, crisis signals and whispers through the platform's delivery feature (the GM picks the card and a holder rule, for example "2 outsiders lowest on exposure"; the platform picks the holders from the exposure ranking and delivers, with no hand-routing), the Data Drop, and the Unlock release.
- **Rumour Register:** the drafts' register as a live view over the cards: statement, source, truth status, who holds it, when it becomes public, and whether it is tradable.
- **Corrections:** the only way to change a fact after release is a public bulletin or correction; the console has no silent edit.
- **Disputes:** void a forged record or a trade built on impersonation (10.3), with the reason logged.

13.2 Platform data objects

Object	Key fields
info_mode	DARK, CLOSED or OPEN (a toggle preset); feature_toggles; changed_at; changed_by
card	The schema in 12.1
holding	card_id, holder, grade, stamp_tick, acquired_via, from_holder, exclusive_until, warranty_until
verification	holding, route, outcome, tick, fee, verifier
info_trade	type (8.1), seller, buyer, price, currency (VB or Data), terms, status (Proposed or Settled)
broker	participant, registered_at, topics, listed cards
whisper_log	card, desk, asker, rule met, tick

Every verification, trade, plant and correction also emits an evidence event for the Founder Ledger, which records behaviour (verified before acting, built a chain of discovery, brokered, planted a rumour) without judging it during play.

13.3 Operations notes

- A marked information zone holds the Media desk, the Broker Board and the Venture City Live screen.
- The Media desk needs one volunteer dedicated to fact checks during Tick 7, when it runs rush-only.
- Printed personal cards (with card IDs, handed out in the City Opens envelopes) are needed for Human Internet I only, and Founder Dossiers are read on the platform, not printed (Passport

Packs are a GM reference only); from Tick 1 cards live on the platform, so the library stays digital-first.

13.4 Open questions for the owner

Each has a working default already written into this document.

- ☐ Participant-planted rumours through the Media desk: keep, with the correction rule (default), or drop so only the GM plants false information?
- ☐ Internet Unlock at Tick 8, right before the Capital Market (default), or later, at Investor Day preparation only?
- ☒ Human Internet I fully device-free with printed cards, or the platform allowed for recording only? Decided 2026-10-05: neither. Phones may stay out, but the platform is locked by GM toggles to read-only own Founder Dossier, role card and objective; no deals, chat, card trading or wallet actions; wallet purchases on paper Trade Slips; company deals stay Proposed; nothing about the company is printed.

Decisions, 2026-10-05 (owner decision after the complexity audit). Human Internet I is 30 minutes, 10:05–10:35, after a 35-minute City Opens (09:30–10:05); Market Open stays 10:35. The three info modes are presets of GM Console feature toggles, and Dark locks the platform to read-only own Founder Dossier (which replaces the passport as the start-of-day read), role card and objective. Company inbox messages are drip-fed per tick on the platform (3.2). Crisis signals and whispers go out through a platform delivery feature, not by hand. The Media fact desk gets automatic inbox copies (7.2). The personal information card pool is added as 12.5, with a CSV for the platform.

Parameters to tune first in playtesting: the 250 VB / 10 Data Media fee, the 2-tick warranty window, $\lceil N/2 \rceil$ broker slots, the $2 \times N$ Data Drop, the per-tick release budget and the price bands in 8.4.

Venture City — Institution Operating Content

Oct 5, 2026 · @Nero Kami

1. How to use this document

This is the data each institution desk trades from: 13 Bank products, one Investor fund with 3 partner theses and 6 investment products, 42 customer cards (12 of them T0 anchors), 15 suppliers, 10 licences, 5 grant programmes, 6 tenders, 6 regulatory instruments, and 5 Media outlets with 10 products. How each desk behaves (scripts, refusal lines, conduct) stays in the source draft's Institutions Volunteer Operating Handbook; this document only supplies what they sell, at what price, to whom and on what terms.

What it plugs into. Every price, loan band, valuation rule, deal clause and evidence class comes from [Core Game Systems](#) (CGS) and is cited, not re-derived. Inventories and pools are the N-formulas in [Starting World](#) (SW) section 12.2. Company fit follows the slot map and resource tiers in the [Master Catalogue](#) (MC). Information rules (desk sheets, grades, fact checks, brokers) follow [Human Internet](#) (HI).

Uniform rules. Every catalogue entry is open to any company that meets its stated conditions. Where an entry was written with one company in mind, that company appears only in a GM-only "Best fit" column; desks never say it aloud (SW 2.4). Conditions refer to slots, licences, asset types and evidence, never to company names.

1.1 Shared conventions

Convention	Rule
IDs	BK Bank, IN Investor, CU Customer, SU Supplier, GV Government (L licence, G grant, T tender, R regulatory instrument), MD Media (O outlet, P product). IDs are stable and become spreadsheet keys.
Money	VB. Amounts scaled by an index or by N round to the nearest 50 VB; per-unit prices round to the nearest 0.5 VB. All cash and resource units are balances in the platform journal, which is the only record; there are no physical notes, tokens or counts.
Time	Ticks (30 minutes). "Decide by Tick 4" means before the Tick 4 freeze. Durations never run past the final freeze (CGS 4.2).
Evidence	Classes E1 to E5 from CGS 1.3, with its

Convention	Rule
	independence, freshness and single-use rules.
Visibility	Always, Earned or Never, as on the HI 6.1 desk sheet. Hidden fields are GM-only and never on the desk sheet. Relationship items stay: the platform desk console shows the asker's history across all desks and flags the Earned items they already qualify for; volunteers still log each item, and every desk can read the other desks' records.
Scaling	Every quantity marked $\times N$ or $\div N$ reads off SW 12.2. Section 8 collects them.
Status	Every number new in this document is a playtest starting value; section 8.3 lists the ones to tune first.

1.2 Sector tags

SW 8.3 gives each sector a demand index that scales customer card budgets, but no document has listed the sectors. This document fixes eight, used by customer cards, tenders, Media and shocks.

Sector tag	Companies whose products sell into it (GM reference)
Retail and Food	SwiftCart, Mango & Co., HarvestLoop
Logistics and Mobility	SwiftCart, Voltway
Finance	Ledgerly
Health	MediLink
Skills and Education	SkillForge
Energy and Climate	GreenGrid
Technology and Data	PulseAI, StackHouse, TrustLayer, Ledgerly
Manufacturing	Forgeline

A card's live budget is its listed budget $\times$ the sector index $\div$ 100, fixed at the moment a contract is signed.

2. Bank

The Bank sells 13 products: resource purchase and buy-back, the six CGS 7.3 loans unchanged, three new financing products (resource credit, inventory-backed loan, proof-of-funds certificate) and three

event or restructuring facilities. New here are credit grades, collateral advance rates and the three new products; everything else is CGS.

Pools and limits (CGS 6.3, 7.3; SW 12.2). Lending pool $8,000 \times N$ VB, refilled by repayments. Resource stock $40 \times N$ per resource at Tick 1, restocked by $10 \times N$ per tick. A company may owe the Bank at most 30,000 VB outside an emergency loan, and may buy at most 30 units of each resource per tick. Starting Bank-loan liabilities in dossiers are booked at T0 as loans under these rules and count against the pool.

2.1 Resource price list

The platform applies the price step from the Bank's own remaining stock against its Tick 1 stock (CGS 6.3). The volunteer never sets prices.

Resource	Base, stock 50% or more (VB)	Stock 25–50% (+20%)	Stock under 25% (+50%)	Buy-back, 60% of base
Compute	20	24	30	12
Energy	15	18	22.5	9
Logistics	20	24	30	12
Materials	15	18	22.5	9
Data	25	30	37.5	15
Infrastructure	30	36	45	18

At zero stock the resource is unavailable until restock. Buy-back is capped at 20 units per resource per company per tick. Price shocks (CGS 6.7) move the base column; the steps follow.

2.2 Product catalogue

ID	Product	Amount	Eligibility	Interest or price	Term and repayment	Security	Source
BK-01	Resource purchase	Up to 30 units per resource per tick	Any company, from Market Open	Price list 2.1	Spot	None	CGS 6.3
BK-02	Resource buy-back	Up to 20 units per resource per tick	Any company	60% of base	Spot	None	CGS 6.3
BK-03	Working capital S	5,000	Any recorded customer	10% flat	4 ticks, equal instalmen	None	CGS 7.3

ID	Product	Amount	Eligibility	Interest or price	Term and repayment	Security	Source
			contract, including the anchor		ts		
BK-04	Working capital M	10,000	2,000 VB verified revenue, or 5,000 VB contract backlog	15% flat	5 ticks, equal instalments	None	CGS 7.3
BK-05	Working capital L	20,000	10,000 VB backlog, or a pledged asset	20% flat	6 ticks, equal instalments	Contract or asset assigned	CGS 7.3
BK-06	Asset-backed loan	Up to 60% of the asset's book value	An eligible asset (2.4)	12% flat	4 ticks, single payment at term	The asset	CGS 7.3
BK-07	Strategic facility (includes project finance)	Up to 15,000	M39 completed, or an institution unlock such as 2 signed offtake contracts	12% flat	6 ticks, single payment at term	Use of funds recorded and restricted	CGS 7.3
BK-08	Emergency loan	Up to 5,000	Distressed companies only; once per run	25% flat, never discounted	3 ticks, equal instalments	First claim on all assets	CGS 7.3
BK-09	Resource credit	Up to 1,500 VB	Grade A or B	5% fee on the	Repaid in full at the	None	New

ID	Product	Amount	Eligibility	Interest or price	Term and repayment	Security	Source
		of BK-01 purchases outstanding		purchase	next tick's step 6		
BK-10	Inventory-backed loan	Up to 50% of the current Bank value of pledged units; at least 50 units pledged	Grade A, B or C	10% flat	3 ticks, single payment at term	Pledged units, ring-fenced	New
BK-11	Proof-of-funds certificate	Any sum the company locks at the Bank	Any company	50 VB fee	Locked until a tick boundary the company names; no interest	The locked cash	New
BK-12	Credit Window facility	5,000 per company; facility of $2,500 \times N$ VB	Opens only on event E08; first come, Grade A or B	8% flat	4 ticks, equal instalments	None	New, for E08
BK-13	Debt-for-equity restructuring	The unsecured Bank balance	Offered by the GM in a Distressed company's last recovery tick (CGS 8.6)	Converted at 80% of the RV share price	Replaces repayment	Bank takes new shares, at most 49% of post-conversion shares	New terms for CGS 8.6

Notes on the new products.

- **BK-09 Resource credit** lets a short company buy now and pay at the next tick. An unpaid balance at step 6 becomes a missed instalment under CGS 7.3, with the 10% late fee and a Reliability Record entry.
- **BK-10 Inventory-backed loan** turns surplus stock into cash without selling it at the 60% buy-back. Baseline consumption draws on unpledged units first; if total stock falls below the pledged quantity, the loan falls due at the next step 6.
- **BK-11 Proof-of-funds certificate** is the draft's "deposit or reserve" product. The certificate is E3 evidence of financial standing, which several customer cards and tenders ask for. Locked cash still counts in NAV.
- **BK-12** and **BK-13** exist only through a GM event or a restructuring offer; the Bank never offers them on its own. The Bank is also the S7 payments fallback (SW 11.1): its merchant service processes any company's customer payments for a 3% fee on receipts, with no merchant advances, which is the price CU-03 and every S7 seller must beat.
- All Bank lending (BK-03 to BK-10, BK-12) counts toward the 30,000 VB cap and the pool. Early repayment, missed instalments and default follow CGS 7.3.

2.3 Credit grades

The platform assigns each company a credit grade from its Reliability Record and lifecycle state at every tick, so the volunteer applies terms rather than judging people. The grade sits on the company's Bank page, visible to the company and the Bank.

Grade	Condition (checked at tick settlement)	Interest adjustment	Products available
A Prime	2 or more Completed contracts, and no missed payment or breach this run	-2 points	All, subject to eligibility
B Standard	Default for every company at T0	None	All, subject to eligibility
C Watch	A missed payment or breach in the last 3 ticks, or Bank debt above 20,000 VB	+3 points	BK-01, 02, 03, 04, 06, 10, 11
D Restricted	In default on any loan, or Distressed	No new credit	BK-01, 02, 11, and BK-08 if Distressed

Grade and credit posture stack. "Tight" adds 5 points and raises each band's evidence bar one step; "Loose" removes 3 points (CGS 7.3). No loan's flat rate falls below 5%, and the emergency loan is never adjusted.

Worked example. A Grade A company takes BK-04 under Tight posture: $15 - 2 + 5 = 18\%$ flat, so 10,000 VB costs 11,800 VB over 5 instalments of 2,360.

2.4 Collateral rules

Security	Advance rate	Used by	Rule
Notable Asset	Up to 60% of book value	BK-05, BK-06	One loan per asset at a time. On default the Bank takes the asset and sells it through the liquidation auction format.
Assigned customer contract	Contract backlog of 10,000 VB or more	BK-05	Contract payments go to the Bank first each tick until that tick's instalment is covered.
Pledged resource units	Up to 50% of current Bank value	BK-10	Units ring-fenced; on default the Bank takes them at the current Bank price.
Locked cash	100%	BK-11	Released at the named tick boundary; never lent out.
Restricted use of funds	Not security; a condition	BK-07	Spending outside the recorded purpose is a breach.
Not accepted	None	None	Product Cards, shares, information cards, personal wallets or guarantees (participants cannot borrow from the Bank, CGS 7.3).

On failure, Bank claims are paid in the CGS 8.6 order: the emergency loan first, then salary arrears, then secured Bank debt.

2.5 Event controls

Event	Bank effect
E07 Credit Tightening	Posture set to Tight for the stated ticks
E08 Credit Window	BK-12 opens for 1 tick, or until the facility is used up

Event	Bank effect
C02 Liquidity Freeze	BK-03 to BK-07, BK-09, BK-10 closed for 1 tick; BK-01, BK-02, BK-08, BK-11 stay open; instalments still fall due
Price shock, Bank stock freeze, restock change	Parameter changes from CGS 6.7, applied by the platform

2.6 Desk sheet additions

Tier	Item	Rule
Always	Price list, product table, the current posture, the asker's own credit grade	Anyone
Earned	Which resources are within 10 units of the next price step	Right question: name the resource
Earned	Lending pool remaining	Consultation fee, 150 VB
Earned	Detailed credit criteria for the next tick, when a posture change is scheduled	Relationship: one recorded Bank transaction; released Public at the Internet Unlock if still current
Never	Any other company's loans, grade, repayments or applications	Under no condition

3. Investor / Venture Fund

The Venture City Fund holds $14,000 \times N$ VB, makes at most $\lceil N \times 0.7 \rceil$ investments, and is run by three partners with different theses; the run's lead thesis decides how high a valuation can go inside the CGS 0.5–2× RV band. Ticket size, concentration, dilution, tranches, the share formula and investor rights are CGS 7.4 and 7.5, unchanged.

3.1 Fund parameters

Parameter	Value	Source
Fund size	$14,000 \times N$ VB (98,000 / 140,000 / 168,000 at $N = 7 / 10 / 12$)	SW 12.2
Maximum investments	$\lceil N \times 0.7 \rceil$ (5 / 7 / 9)	SW 12.2
Ticket size	5,000 to 25,000 VB	CGS 7.4

Parameter	Value	Source
Concentration	No company receives more than 30% of the fund in total	CGS 7.4
Valuation	0.5 to 2 × RV; the ceiling for each deal is set by thesis fit (3.2)	CGS 7.4, refined here
Dilution cap	40% of post-money shares per round	CGS 7.4
Tranches	Up to 2; the second only on a verified milestone by a stated tick	CGS 7.4
Window	Opens at the GM's capital window (default the start of Tick 8, with the Internet Unlock) and closes at the cap table lock	CGS 7.5, HI 2
Pacing	At most half the fund may be committed in the window's first tick	New
Before the window	Closed: no meetings, no terms, no thesis disclosed. Desks give "the fund is not open yet". Booking opens earlier: the in-app booking board opens at Tick 7 for 10-minute appointments that start at the capital window	CGS 7.4

3.2 Partners and theses

Every investment needs one sponsoring partner. Fit is tested from platform data, so it never depends on charm. Before T0 the GM picks the run's lead thesis, by choice or by drawing one of the three; event E20's rumour IC-RUM-01 ("the fund favours companies with two or more partnerships") is true exactly when the Platform Partner leads.

Partner	Thesis	Fit test (all from the registry)	Typical questions
Operating Partner	Businesses that already make money and run tight	Verified customer revenue in each of the last 2 ticks, and at least 1 Completed contract	"What does one more unit cost you, and what do you sell it for?"

Partner	Thesis	Fit test (all from the registry)	Typical questions
Platform Partner	Companies other companies depend on	Active or Completed deals with 2 or more other companies	"Who would be hurt if you disappeared tomorrow?"
Impact Partner	Regulated, climate, health and skills ventures that clear barriers	Holds a Government licence or certification, or has won a grant or tender	"What did you have to prove to be allowed to do this?"

Thesis fit	Valuation ceiling
Fits the lead thesis	$2.0 \times RV$
Fits another partner's thesis	$1.5 \times RV$
Fits no thesis	$1.0 \times RV$

The floor is $0.5 \times RV$ in every case. A deal outside the band needs GM approval (CGS 7.4). At N = 10 two partner volunteers share the three partners, each naming which partner is speaking, so every company can get a 10-minute appointment in the window; at N = 7 one volunteer may play all three.

3.3 Investment products

ID	Product	Ticket	Eligibility	Valuation basis	Tranches	Rights (CGS 7.4 list)	Counts toward max deals
IN-01	Seed ticket	5,000–10,000	Any Operating company with a recorded customer contract	Thesis ceiling (3.2)	1	Up to 1	Yes
IN-02	Growth round	10,000–25,000	Fits at least one thesis	Thesis ceiling	1 or 2	Up to 2	Yes
IN-03	Strategic co-investment	Matches a company's strategic stake 1:1, up to	Another company is buying a stake of 10–49% at	The co-investor's agreed price	1	Up to 1	Yes

ID	Product	Ticket	Eligibility	Valuation basis	Tranches	Rights (CGS 7.4 list)	Counts toward max deals
		15,000	the same price				
IN-04	New venture or spin-out ticket	5,000–10,000	Founded this run; first customer or letter of intent shown with E1 or E2	1.0 to 2.0 × NAV (RV has no revenue history yet)	1 or 2	Up to 2	Yes
IN-05	Rescue investment	5,000–15,000	Distressed, with a plan that clears every trigger	0.5 to 1.0 × RV	1	Liquidation preference and use-of-funds restriction	Yes
IN-06	Diligence commission	300–600 VB fee	Any participant or company; at most 2 per tick	Fee, paid from the fund	None	None	No

IN-06 is the source draft's O19 "Information Premium": the fund pays for an independent E5 diligence report on a company in its pipeline. The report goes only to the fund; the subject company is told one was commissioned but not by whom.

3.4 Valuation worksheet

The platform shows the partner each company's valuation ceiling ($RV \times \text{thesis fit}$). The partner fills the rest at every meeting, from public numbers, before anyone names a price.

$$\text{ceiling} = \text{RV} \times \text{fit multiple} \quad \text{price per share} = \frac{\text{pre-money}}{\text{shares outstanding}} \quad \text{new shares} = \frac{\text{investment}}{\text{price per share}}$$

Worked example. The CGS 7.2 example company has RV 50,550 VB and 1,000 shares. It fits the lead thesis, so the ceiling is 101,100 VB. The partner and company agree a 60,000 VB pre-money and a 15,000 VB ticket: price 60 VB per share, 250 new shares, so the fund holds 250 of 1,250 shares (20%), inside the 40% dilution cap.

3.5 Term sheet template

The term sheet is a template in the platform's deal builder, not a paper form. The builder pre-fills what the registry knows (RV, shares outstanding, the thesis ceiling), runs the floor-price and 5,000 VB signatory-limit checks, then sends the draft for signatures and notifies the signatories and the fund.

Field	Notes
Company, sponsoring partner, product ID	IN-01 to IN-05
Amount	Inside the product's ticket range and the 30% concentration cap
RV at signing, pre-money, multiple	Multiple = pre-money ÷ RV; must sit inside the thesis band
Price per share, new shares, post-money ownership	CGS 7.4 formula; ownership ≤ 40% new per round
Tranche 2 (if any)	Amount, milestone, evidence class, deadline tick
Rights	Up to the product's limit from the CGS 7.4 list
Use of funds	One line; restricted if a use-of-funds right is taken
Conditions precedent	Anything that must be true at funding (a licence held, a contract signed)
Approvals	Company signers under CGS 1.2; a shareholder vote when new shares exceed 10% (CGS 7.5)
Expiry	1 tick from issue

3.6 Diligence checklist

Criterion (source draft 5.3)	What the partner checks	Evidence
Market	Sector demand index; customer cards won or bid	Public, E1
Traction	Verified customer revenue, Completed contracts	E1
Team	Workforce Credit; empty required seats	Public dashboard
Economics	Product Card price against resource cost per unit	Company shows it
Resource position	Stock against tier for each High or Very High resource	Company shows it

Criterion (source draft 5.3)	What the partner checks	Evidence
Founder quality	Who negotiated what (registry negotiator credit) and who answers in the room	E1 and the meeting; never the Founder Ledger
Use of funds	What changes by which tick	Term sheet
Defensibility	Licences held, slots filled, exclusivity clauses	E1, E3
Risk	Reliability Record, debt, Distressed history	Public, Bank grade if shown
Upside	Growth Opportunity and gated buyers the company can reach	Company shows it

From Tick 8 the partner may check pitch claims against City Net and the company's Verified cards. Claims backed only by Rumour-grade cards carry no weight (HI 11.3). Red flags are the source draft's list in its section 5.6.

3.7 Event controls and desk sheet

Event or item	Effect
E09 Investor Frenzy	For its duration, deals in the named sector count as fitting the lead thesis
E10 Investor Freeze	No new term sheets for the stated ticks; agreed second tranches still release on their milestones
Always (once open)	Fund size remaining, ticket range, the three theses and which one leads, process steps
Earned	Investments remaining before the cap: Relationship (a meeting held)
Earned	Whether a named sector is attracting several applications: Consultation fee, 200 VB
Never	Any other company's terms, pipeline position or diligence report

4. Customer desk (Enterprise and Consumer)

The Customer desk holds 42 cards: 12 anchor cards already under contract at T0 (4.6), 24 open cards, two written around each of the 12 companies' markets so loading the active companies' cards gives exactly the $2 \times N$ that SW 9 requires, plus 6 held-back cards released by a hidden lever or an event. The anchor cards carry the dossiers' starting contracts as named desk records.

4.1 Standard terms

These are the "Customer desk standard terms" that CGS 4.6 points to. Every customer contract, including each anchor's Tick 6 renewal, uses them unless the card says otherwise.

Term	Rule
Contract forms	Pilot, per-tick supply (recurring) or milestone. A card names which it accepts.
Pilot	1 or 2 ticks, 1 delivery unit per tick, priced at no more than 25% of the card's per-tick budget. Desk acceptance is E3 evidence and counts as one "completed pilot" toward any gate.
Budget	The card's published budget $\times$ sector index $\div$ 100 is the ceiling. The desk opens at its opening offer and never pays above the ceiling, except the +10% stretch when a hidden need is met.
Payment	Per delivered unit at tick step 2 (CGS 1.1), or on milestone acceptance. Cards marked "pays in arrears" pay 1 tick late as a deferred leg.
Penalties	CGS 4.6 defaults (10% of the tick's value per missed tick; termination after 2 consecutive breaches) unless the card sets a higher rate.
Competitive cards	The desk collects proposals until the decide-by tick, drops any that miss a must-have, then picks the lowest price per unit; ties go to the better Reliability Record, then the earlier proposal.
First-commitment cards	The first proposal that meets every must-have at or under the ceiling wins (CGS 3.4).
Reliability Record	The desk reads it on every proposal. A card may refuse sellers with more than a stated number of breaches.
Media correction	A company named in a Media correction gives one extra piece of evidence on any proposal for 2 ticks (HI 10.3).
Failed seller	The card returns to the desk as an open card and is offered as a Customer Rescue (CGS 8.6).

4.2 Loading cards for a run

- At T0 the GM loads the two open cards whose best fit is each active company: 14, 20 or 24 cards at N = 7, 10 or 12. Cards are written as needs, so most can also be won by other companies (the "Also fits" column).
- A gated card's must-have is a licence or evidence threshold, so only a company that clears it can win. These are the buyers behind each company's Growth Opportunity or gate in MC 3.
- Anchor cards CU-31 to CU-42 load with their company. Held-back cards CU-25 to CU-27 load only when the company holding the matching lever is active; CU-28 to CU-30 load with their events.
- Open cards are visible only to someone who visits the desk or holds a lead (SW 7.2). The desk sheet is in 4.6.

4.3 Card catalogue: who, what and when

Budgets are at sector index 100. "Decide by" is the last tick the desk accepts proposals; the contract runs over the ticks shown.

ID	Customer	Segment	Sector	Problem	Budget (VB)	Decision-maker	Decide by; contract
CU-01	Northside Households	Consumer	Retail and Food	No time to shop; want groceries the same hour	900/tick × 4 = 3,600 (3 units/tick)	Household panel lead	T3; T4-T7
CU-02	Riverside Pharmacy Group	Enterprise	Health	Chilled medicines spoil in transit; 2 failed deliveries last month	1,500/tick × 5 = 7,500	Head of pharmacy operations	T5; T6-T10
CU-03	Market Street Traders Association	Enterprise	Finance	40 cash-only shops losing sales; card fees too high	1,000/tick × 5 = 5,000	Association treasurer	T4; T5-T9
CU-04	Metro Credit Bureau	Enterprise	Technology and Data	Needs fresh, verified small-	1,200/tick × 4 = 4,800	Head of risk analytics	T6; T7-T10

ID	Customer	Segment	Sector	Problem	Budget (VB)	Decision-maker	Decide by; contract
				business data to score loans			
CU-05	Weekend Wellness Crowd	Consumer	Retail and Food	Want healthy treats that taste good, delivered	800/tick × 4 = 3,200 (4 units/tick)	Community organiser	T3; T4-T7
CU-06	FreshWay Supermarkets	Enterprise	Retail and Food	Own-label range is stale; wants a local branded line in 12 stores	2,500/tick × 5 = 12,500	Category buyer	T7; T8-T12
CU-07	Harbour Insurance	Enterprise	Skills and Education	30 staff cannot use data tools; must upskill now	1,400/tick × 4 = 5,600	HR director	T4; T5-T8
CU-08	Career Switchers	Consumer	Skills and Education	Want a job-ready skill in weeks	600/tick × 5 = 3,000 (3 seats/tick)	Learner panel	T5; T6-T10
CU-09	Coastline Freight	Enterprise	Logistics and Mobility	Vans run half empty; routes planned by hand	700/tick × 3 = 2,100	Operations manager	T3; T4-T6
CU-10	Atlas Retail Group	Enterprise	Technology and Data	Stockouts and waste across 30	3,000/tick × 5 = 15,000	Chief data officer and	T7; T8-T12

ID	Customer	Segment	Sector	Problem	Budget (VB)	Decision-maker	Decide by; contract
				stores; needs demand forecasting		procurement committee	
CU-11	Eastport Cold Storage	Enterprise	Energy and Climate	Power bill doubled; cooling halls run all day	1,600/tick × 5 = 8,000	Site director	T5; T6-T10
CU-12	Lakeview Office Parks	Enterprise	Energy and Climate	Tenants demand lower energy use in 3 buildings	6,000 milestone (50% at signing, 50% on verification)	Property manager	T6; deliver by T9
CU-13	Old Town Seniors	Consumer	Health	Hard to see a doctor and collect prescriptions	900/tick × 5 = 4,500 (3 units/tick)	Residents' association	T4; T5-T9
CU-14	Northbridge Hospital Network	Enterprise	Health	Discharged patients readmitted; no follow-up	3,000/tick × 4 = 12,000	Chief medical officer	T7; T8-T11
CU-15	Canteen Collective	Enterprise	Retail and Food	Unreliable produce for 12 office canteens	1,300/tick × 5 = 6,500	Head chef and buyer	T4; T5-T9
CU-16	Farm-Box Subscribers	Consumer	Retail and Food	Want a weekly box straight	700/tick × 5 = 3,500 (4 units/tick)	Subscriber panel	T6; T7-T11

ID	Customer	Segment	Sector	Problem	Budget (VB)	Decision-maker	Decide by; contract
				from growers			
CU-17	Nimbus Games Studio	Enterprise	Technology and Data	Game launch next tick; needs burst compute	1,200/tick × 3 = 3,600	Studio CTO	T3; T4-T6
CU-18	Orbit Broadcasting	Enterprise	Technology and Data	Ten years of video archive needs dedicated hosting	2,500/tick × 5 = 12,500	Head of infrastructure	T7; T8-T12
CU-19	BuildRight Construction	Enterprise	Logistics and Mobility	Site deliveries arrive late	1,400/tick × 5 = 7,000	Site logistics lead	T4; T5-T9
CU-20	Late-Night Commuters	Consumer	Logistics and Mobility	No transport after 10 pm	600/tick × 5 = 3,000 (4 rides/tick)	Commuter group	T6; T7-T11
CU-21	Kettle & Co. Homewares	Enterprise	Manufacturing	Needs a short run of one product line for the season	4,000 milestone, 2 batches (T5, T7)	Product director	T4; T5-T7
CU-22	Brightline Appliances	Enterprise	Manufacturing	Needs a second source for battery housings	2,800/tick × 4 = 11,200	Supply chain director	T7; T8-T11
CU-23	ShopNow Marketplace	Enterprise	Technology and Data	Account takeovers after a breach;	1,100/tick × 5 = 5,500	Head of trust and safety	T4; T5-T9

ID	Customer	Segment	Sector	Problem	Budget (VB)	Decision-maker	Decide by; contract
				shoppers leaving			
CU-24	Pinecrest Clinics	Enterprise	Health	Cannot sign insurer contracts without a compliance attestation	3,500 milestone + 600/tick × 4 = 5,900	Practice manager	T6; T7-T10
CU-25	Maison Verde Department Stores	Enterprise	Retail and Food	Wants an exclusive premium gift range	2,500/tick × 4 = 10,000	Head buyer	Held back; 2 ticks after release
CU-26	Portside Export Processors	Enterprise	Retail and Food	Short of certified produce for export	2,800/tick × 4 = 11,200	Export manager	Held back; 2 ticks after release
CU-27	Northgate Savings Bank	Enterprise	Finance	Regulator demands continuous monitoring and attestations	3,000/tick × 4 = 12,000	Chief risk officer	Held back; 2 ticks after release
CU-28	Rapid Response Buyer	Enterprise	Set by the GM with E11	Demand for one outcome has doubled overnight	2,000/tick × 2 = 4,000	Emergency procurement lead	Event tick; next 2 ticks
CU-29	New Segment Buyers	Consumer	Set by the GM with E28	A new customer group has appeared	800/tick × 4 = 3,200 (4 units/tick)	Segment panel	1 tick after release; next 4 ticks

ID	Customer	Segment	Sector	Problem	Budget (VB)	Decision-maker	Decide by; contract
CU-30	Fast-Track Pilot Buyer	Enterprise	Set by the GM with E26	Will skip procurement for a proven pilot	1,000 pilot + 2,000/tick × 3 = 7,000	Innovation lead	Event tick; next 3 ticks

4.4 Card catalogue: requirements and procurement

ID	Must-have	Nice-to-have	Procurement constraints	Alternatives the buyer will name
CU-01	Basket delivered within the tick	A fresh-produce share	Competitive; 1-tick trial at half volume	Keep using the old supermarket; walks above 300/unit
CU-02	Cold-chain delivery permit (GV-L01); delivery every tick	Order tracking data	Permit holders only; 1-tick pilot; no delivery breach on the Reliability Record	Logistics Provider priority with its own ice packs
CU-03	Payment processing live within 1 tick; fees below the Bank merchant service	Same-day settlement	Competitive	The Bank's merchant service on standard terms
CU-04	A dataset product delivering 1 unit per tick, Verified grade (desk confirm or Media fact check)	A model run showing predictive value	Seller must show security evidence (S8 contract, attestation or GV-L10)	40 Data units a tick from the Supplier Market, unverified
CU-05	Branded product box with ingredients listed	Community events	Open; may split between 2 sellers	Generic snacks; walks above 200/unit
CU-06	Food Safety Certificate (GV-L03); 3 units per tick	In-store promotion	1-tick sample pilot; manufacturing capacity on record (E1: S5 deal or	An imported brand

ID	Must-have	Nice-to-have	Procurement constraints	Alternatives the buyer will name
			own production)	
CU-07	1 certified cohort unit per tick	Placement of 1 trained hire into Research or Product	Competitive; 1-tick pilot; trainer at L2 or above	Talent Exchange specialist workshops
CU-08	Course seats with a placement promise	Accreditation (GV-L04): accredited sellers get a +15% ceiling	Open	Free online videos; walks above 200/seat
CU-09	Route plan that cuts van runs by 10% or more (E5, desk-validated E3)	Fleet capacity on peak days	Pilot first; no references needed	Talent Exchange analyst (the S9 fallback)
CU-10	2 completed pilots on record; security evidence (S8 contract, attestation or GV-L10)	Dedicated hosted compute	Committee: 2 meetings; 2 pilot references (E2); 20% penalty per missed tick	Buy a packaged tool from outside the city
CU-11	20 Energy units per tick under contract, or a retrofit cutting its use by 25% (E3)	Price fixed for the whole term	Competitive; proof-of-funds certificate (BK-11) for 3,000 VB	Bank-price energy
CU-12	Measured energy saving, verified by the desk (E3)	Green certification (GV-L09)	Competitive; 30 Materials or an S5 deal on record at signing	Do nothing this year
CU-13	Telehealth consult with home medicine delivery	Chilled medicines	Open; no Media correction or Debunked rumour about the seller in the last 2 ticks	The city clinic queue
CU-14	3 verified deliveries to Consumer health buyers; Health	A readmission-risk model	Committee; security evidence; pays in arrears	Hire nurses through the Talent Exchange

ID	Must-have	Nice-to-have	Procurement constraints	Alternatives the buyer will name
	data compliance licence (GV-L07) or attestation			
CU-15	2 produce units per tick, delivered within the tick	Food Safety Certificate	Competitive; 15% penalty per missed tick	The wholesale market (Supplier Market Materials)
CU-16	Food Safety Certificate; home delivery	A grower story in the press	Open	The supermarket
CU-17	25 Compute units per tick, as hosting or as delivered units; no missed tick	Security monitoring	First commitment	Supplier Market Compute on its own servers
CU-18	3 ticks of unbroken delivery on the Reliability Record; a dedicated hosting product	Security monitoring	Committee; proof-of-funds certificate for 5,000 VB	A cloud outside the city
CU-19	2 fleet capacity units per tick	Electric vehicles	Competitive; 15% penalty per missed tick	Logistics Provider standard (arrives next tick)
CU-20	Transport operating permit (GV-L05)	App booking	Open	Walking and taxis
CU-21	A manufacturing batch at each milestone, materials sourced	Packaging design	Sample batch first (pilot)	Import, 3 ticks slower
CU-22	A first batch accepted by the Customer desk on record; Materials secured for 4 ticks (E1 supply	An energy cost hedge	Committee; proof-of-funds certificate for 3,000 VB; 20% penalty	Its single current source

ID	Must-have	Nice-to-have	Procurement constraints	Alternatives the buyer will name
	contract)			
CU-23	Security monitoring each tick	Payment fraud scoring	Competitive; 1 reference (E2)	Talent Exchange security specialist
CU-24	Approved Auditor status (GV-L06) to issue the attestation	Staff training	Approved Auditors only	Government compliance review (GV-L10): 2 ticks and 1,500 VB
CU-25	Premium gift box; a manufacturing deal on record	Food Safety Certificate	Exclusive negotiation with the first company told	No range this season
CU-26	3 produce units per tick with cold delivery; Food Safety Certificate	A grower traceability record	Exclusive negotiation with the first company told	Import from outside the city
CU-27	Approved Auditor status; monitoring each tick plus one attestation	Fraud scoring	Exclusive negotiation with the first company told	The Government review route
CU-28	Delivery inside the event tick	None	First commitment	Goes without
CU-29	The product type named by the GM's E28 signal	Media visibility	Open	Status quo
CU-30	A same-tick pilot	Prior completed pilot	First commitment; skips the committee	Waits for the normal process

4.5 Card catalogue: negotiation and contract

ID	Negotiation position (opening offer, ceiling, what it values)	Hidden need (Earned: right question)	Contract opportunity	Best fit (GM only)	Also fits
CU-01	Opens 240/unit, ceiling 300; values reliability; adds a tick for 5% off	A weekly healthy box option: +1 unit/tick	4 ticks; renews 4 more with no missed delivery	SwiftCart	Mango & Co., HarvestLoop (with certificate)
CU-02	Opens 1,200, ceiling 1,500; pays on acceptance	Pharmacy order integration with a health platform: +10% stretch on a joint bid	5 ticks; +500/tick for 2 more stores if the pilot passes	SwiftCart	Voltway (with permit); MediLink as partner
CU-03	Opens 800, ceiling 1,000; values low fees; 2 extra ticks for 5% off	The treasurer was hit by fraud: any S8 security evidence unlocks the stretch and an E2 reference	5 ticks; completion reveals a follow-on card	Ledgerly	None; competes with the Bank fallback
CU-04	Opens 900, ceiling 1,200; +10% for 3-tick exclusivity	Really wants merchant transaction data, not health data	4 ticks	Ledgerly	MediLink (with GV-L07), PulseAI as a bundle
CU-05	Opens 160/unit, ceiling 200; responds to Media campaigns	A fruit-based seasonal box: +1 unit/tick	4 ticks	Mango & Co.	HarvestLoop (with certificate), SwiftCart as reseller
CU-06	Opens 2,000,	3 ticks of city	5 ticks	Mango & Co.	HarvestLoop

ID	Negotiation position (opening offer, ceiling, what it values)	Hidden need (Earned: right question)	Contract opportunity	Best fit (GM only)	Also fits
	ceiling 2,500; asks to pay 2 ticks late, or pays now for 5% off	exclusivity unlocks the stretch			
CU-07	Opens 1,100, ceiling 1,400; wants pass rates as acceptance criteria	Needs security-awareness training after a phishing incident: +10%	4 ticks	SkillForge	PulseAI, TrustLayer
CU-08	Opens 160/seat, ceiling 200	A consumer community deal (\$12 or MD-P05): +2 seats/tick	5 ticks	SkillForge	Any company or spin-out with a training product
CU-09	Opens 500, ceiling 700; trades a public reference for 10% off	Peak-day fleet top-up, 600/tick for 3 ticks, if asked about peak days	3 ticks; counts as a completed pilot	PulseAI	Voltway, SwiftCart
CU-10	Opens 2,400, ceiling 3,000; pays more for a named account team	The board wants a waste-reduction story: a joint MD-P03 feature unlocks +10%	5 ticks	PulseAI	StackHouse and TrustLayer as bundle partners
CU-11	Opens 1,300, ceiling 1,600; values a fixed price; accepts a longer term	Also needs chilled delivery: an introduction to a cold-chain carrier earns	5 ticks	GreenGrid	PulseAI (efficiency analytics)

ID	Negotiation position (opening offer, ceiling, what it values)	Hidden need (Earned: right question)	Contract opportunity	Best fit (GM only)	Also fits
		+10%			
CU-12	Opens 4,500, ceiling 6,000	Wants to co-apply for GV-G02: a seller who co-applies earns +10%	Milestone; repeat for 2 more buildings at T10	GreenGrid	PulseAI, Forgeline
CU-13	Opens 250/unit, ceiling 300; loyal if no delivery is missed	Families pay for a weekly check-in report: +1 unit/tick	5 ticks	MediLink	SwiftCart (delivery-only scope)
CU-14	Opens 2,400, ceiling 3,000; pays in arrears unless the seller takes 5% off	Wants anonymised outcome data back: a data-sharing clause unlocks +10%	4 ticks	MediLink	PulseAI as partner
CU-15	Opens 1,000, ceiling 1,300; pays promptly	Branded snacks for meetings: +1 unit/tick of a branded product	5 ticks	HarvestLoop	SwiftCart, Mango & Co.
CU-16	Opens 140/unit, ceiling 175	A community channel doubles sign-ups: S12 deal or MD-P05 adds +2 units	5 ticks	HarvestLoop	Mango & Co., SwiftCart
CU-17	Opens 1,000, ceiling 1,200; +10% if delivery starts	Launch slips without press: a co-marketing MD-P02 earns	3 ticks, +2 on the hidden need	StackHouse	Any company with surplus Compute (SwiftCart,

ID	Negotiation position (opening offer, ceiling, what it values)	Hidden need (Earned: right question)	Contract opportunity	Best fit (GM only)	Also fits
	this tick	a 2-tick extension			HarvestLoop, Forgeline)
CU-18	Opens 2,000, ceiling 2,500; +2 ticks if the price is fixed	Needs a green power claim: an S4 contract or GV-L09 unlocks +10%	5 ticks	StackHouse	GreenGrid as partner
CU-19	Opens 1,100, ceiling 1,400	Knows a diesel restriction is coming: electric fleet earns +10% and 2 more ticks	5 ticks	Voltway	SwiftCart
CU-20	Opens 120/ride, ceiling 150	Wants vetted drivers (a security check or trained drivers): +1 unit/tick	5 ticks	Voltway	SwiftCart (with permit)
CU-21	Opens 3,200, ceiling 4,000; pays 30% up front	A fixed-price third batch adds 3,000	Milestone; repeat order on the hidden need	Forgeline	None; competes with the Supplier Market's finished goods premium
CU-22	Opens 2,200, ceiling 2,800	Wants an energy-efficient line (S4 retrofit): +10%	4 ticks	Forgeline	None
CU-23	Opens 850, ceiling 1,100	Also needs payment fraud screening: a bundle with a	5 ticks	TrustLayer	Ledgerly, PulseAI

ID	Negotiation position (opening offer, ceiling, what it values)	Hidden need (Earned: right question)	Contract opportunity	Best fit (GM only)	Also fits
		payments provider earns +10%			
CU-24	Opens 4,500 total, ceiling 5,900	The insurer deadline is T8: an attestation by T7 earns +10%	Milestone plus 4 ticks of monitoring	TrustLayer	None
CU-25	Opens 2,000, ceiling 2,500	Exclusivity for the rest of the run	4 ticks	Mango & Co. (Hidden-buyer lever)	None
CU-26	Opens 2,300, ceiling 2,800	Traceability record unlocks +10%	4 ticks	HarvestLoop (Hidden-buyer lever)	None
CU-27	Opens 2,500, ceiling 3,000	Wants staff security training bundled: +10%	4 ticks	TrustLayer (Unlock lever)	None
CU-28	Pays the ceiling for same-tick delivery	None	2 ticks	Any company in the named sector	Any
CU-29	Opens 160/unit, ceiling 200	Set by the GM with the signal	4 ticks	Any	Any
CU-30	Pays the pilot in full on acceptance	None	Pilot plus 3 ticks	Any company with a completed pilot	Any

Release triggers for held-back cards (GM only): CU-25 when the Hidden-buyer lever holder records an S5 manufacturing deal; CU-26 when its lever holder holds an S1 fleet deal and the Food Safety Certificate; CU-27 when its lever holder has 2 audits accepted with no breach; CU-28 to CU-30 with events E11, E28 and E26. Each lever card's best case stays under the 15,000 VB lever cap (SW 10.4).

4.6 Anchor cards (T0 contracts)

These 12 cards are the starting customers named in the [Company Dossiers](#). Each is already contracted at T0, pays per tick for Ticks 1 to 6 (SW 7.1) and then comes up for renewal on the 4.1 standard terms. The dossier is the source of truth for the numbers; if the two ever differ, the dossier wins and this table is corrected. A card loads only when its company is active.

ID	Customer	Segment	Sector	Deliverable per tick	Rate (VB)	Ticks 1–6 value (VB)	Linked liability or vulnerability (GM only)	Best fit (GM only)
CU-31	Hillcrest Households	Consumer	Retail and Food	2 basket batches	650 each; 1,300/tick	7,800	Concentration: leaves at the end of Tick 5 unless every delivery in Ticks 1–5 was made in full	SwiftCart
CU-32	Metro Retail Federation	Enterprise	Finance	2 processing blocks	500 each; 1,000/tick	6,000	Refund obligation: 1,000 VB per tick processing is not delivered, up to 5,000	Ledgerly
CU-33	Mango Club Subscribers	Consumer	Retail and Food	2 boxes	550 each; 1,100/tick	6,600	Refund obligation: 1,500 VB per tick a box is missed, up to	Mango & Co.

ID	Customer	Segment	Sector	Deliverable per tick	Rate (VB)	Ticks 1-6 value (VB)	Linked liability or vulnerability (GM only)	Best fit (GM only)
							6,000	
CU-34	Allied Services Corp	Enterprise	Skills and Education	1 cohort-tick of corporate training	900/tick	5,400	Concentration: leaves at the end of Tick 4 unless the company has completed a placement with any company	SkillForge
CU-35	Quayside Distribution	Enterprise	Technology and Data	1 subscription-tick (pilot rate)	700/tick	4,200	None; this T0 pilot does not count toward the 2-pilot gate	PulseAI
CU-36	Eastgate Industrial Park	Enterprise	Energy and Climate	2 energy blocks	650 each; 1,300/tick	7,800	None; it does not count as an offtake contract for BK-07	GreenGrid
CU-37	CityCare Patients	Consumer	Health	2 consultations	500 each;	6,000	None	MediLink

ID	Customer	Segment	Sector	Deliverable per tick	Rate (VB)	Ticks 1-6 value (VB)	Linked liability or vulnerability (GM only)	Best fit (GM only)
				tions	1,000/tick			
CU-38	Central Kitchens Ltd	Enterprise	Retail and Food	2 produce batches	500 each; 1,000/tick	6,000	None	HarvestLoop
CU-39	Westbrook Media Group	Enterprise	Technology and Data	2 compute blocks	400 each; 800/tick	4,800	None	StackHouse
CU-40	Dockside Wholesale	Enterprise	Logistics and Mobility	2 fleet blocks	600 each; 1,200/tick	7,200	None	Voltway
CU-41	Homeware Direct	Enterprise	Manufacturing	1 manufacturing run	1,100/tick	6,600	Concentration: leaves at the end of Tick 4 unless the company has a second paying customer	ForgeLine
CU-42	Civic Insurance Mutual	Enterprise	Finance	1 monitoring unit	900/tick	5,400	None	TrustLayer

Renewal at Tick 6. Each anchor renews for Ticks 7 to 10 as a new negotiation on the 4.1 terms, with the T0 rate as the ceiling. A company with every anchor delivery made in full gets the +10% stretch, the same as meeting a hidden need. A Concentration anchor that has already left does not renew, and its card does not return to the desk.

4.7 Desk sheet additions

Tier	Item	Rule
Always	For any open card: customer, segment, sector, problem, published budget, must-haves, decide-by tick, contract form	Anyone who visits the desk or names a lead
Earned	A card's hidden need	Right question: the asker names the need's topic
Earned	How many proposals a card has received	Consultation fee, 100 VB
Earned	A card's nice-to-have and procurement detail before the asker holds a lead	Relationship: one recorded transaction with the desk
Never	Opening offer, other sellers' prices or identities, held-back cards, any company's anchor terms	Under no condition

5. Supplier Market

The Supplier Market is the city's outside supply: 12 named suppliers, two per resource, whose capacities add up to exactly the CGS 6.3 line of $20 \times N$ units per resource per tick, plus 3 suppliers that exist only for a fallback slot, an event or the grey market. The companies that supply each other (MC 6) are not here; these suppliers are what a company buys from when no company will sell, and what a slot filler has to beat.

One refinement to CGS 6.3. CGS describes one supplier per resource at 10% below base (15% at 50 units or more). That line is kept exactly as the standard-line supplier for each resource, with $12 \times N$ of the capacity. The other $8 \times N$ sits with an alternative supplier that is cheaper but harder to deal with. Total capacity, and so city scarcity, is unchanged.

5.1 Terms for every supplier

Term	Rule
Price	Each supplier has a list price and a negotiation band; the desk may agree any price inside the band and nothing outside it (CGS 4.5).
Guardrail	No supplier price is ever above the Bank's current price or below the Bank's 60% buy-back, so the Bank stays the fallback and never the best deal.

Term	Rule
Capacity	Per tick, shared by all buyers, first come. Units not taken in a tick are lost. Starting agreements reserve their cap from the named supplier's capacity.
Standing orders	A recurring supply contract of up to 3 ticks at an agreed price, inside the supplier's capacity (CGS 4.6).
Payment	Up front unless the supplier's entry says otherwise. A deferred leg that is missed follows CGS 4.6 late payment, and the supplier suspends delivery.
Exclusivity	At most 3 ticks and at most 50% of an alternative supplier's capacity, at band low + 10%. Standard-line suppliers never sell exclusivity.
Disruption	When a shock closes or cuts a supplier, the desk stops new orders at once, honours settled orders unless a force majeure clause names the event, and points buyers to other channels (source draft 8.4).
Library hooks	M26 Bundle & Save: a joint order by 2 companies earns 10% off the standard line. M37 Supplier Alliance: priority status, served first when capacity is short. A07 Supplier Priority: the auction lot buys first call on one supplier for 1 tick.

Starting supplier agreements (SW 7.1). Each company's T0 agreement sits with the standard-line supplier for its chosen resource, at 10–20% below base and a 10–20 unit cap, and lapses at Tick 4. It renews at the same price with a volume commitment of at least 3 ticks × its cap. A company whose dossier carries a Fragile-supply vulnerability places its agreement with an alternative supplier whose hidden constraint is that vulnerability's named event (SU-08 for a Materials agreement).

Deferred supplier payments (SW 7.3). The creditor is the supplier holding that company's agreement. Before the due tick the desk will accept one renegotiation: a 1-tick extension for a 10% fee, or settlement in resource units at the current Bank price.

5.2 Supplier catalogue: offer

Prices in VB per unit. Capacities per tick (N = 7 / 10 / 12 in brackets).

ID	Supplier	Sells	List price	Negotiation band	Capacity per tick	Minimum order	Payment terms
SU-01	CoreCompute Wholesale	Compute (standard line)	18; 17 at 50+	Fixed	$12 \times N$ (84 / 120 / 144)	20	Up front
SU-02	Brightwave Spot Compute	Compute	17	15–17	$8 \times N$ (56 / 80 / 96)	40	Half up front, half next tick
SU-03	Metro Power Wholesale	Energy (standard line)	13.5; 13 at 50+	Fixed	$12 \times N$	20	Up front
SU-04	SunField Energy Cooperative	Energy	13	11.5–13	$8 \times N$	30	On delivery
SU-05	CityFreight Pool	Logistics (standard line)	18; 17 at 50+	Fixed	$12 \times N$	20	Up front
SU-06	Night Owl Couriers	Logistics, off-peak	17	15–17	$8 \times N$	20	Up front
SU-07	Allied Materials Depot	Materials (standard line)	13.5; 13 at 50+	Fixed	$12 \times N$	20	Up front
SU-08	Riverbend Growers Co-op	Materials, produce-based	13	11.5–13	$8 \times N$	30	1 tick after delivery
SU-09	OpenData Exchange	Data (standard line)	22.5; 21.5 at 50+	Fixed	$12 \times N$	20	Up front
SU-10	Quarry Analytics	Data, scraped and aggregated	21.5	19–21.5	$8 \times N$	20	Up front
SU-11	Civic Build Supplies	Infrastructure (standard	27; 25.5 at 50+	Fixed	$12 \times N$	20	Up front

ID	Supplier	Sells	List price	Negotiation band	Capacity per tick	Minimum order	Payment terms
		line)					
SU-12	Ironside Modular	Infrastructure, prefabricated	25.5	22.5–25.5	$8 \times N$	25	Half up front, half next tick
SU-13	Outsourced Assembly Partners	Contract manufacturing: one finished-goods batch from 30 of the buyer's Materials (S5 fallback)	1,200 per batch	1,100–1,200	$\lceil N \div 3 \rceil$ batches	1 batch	Up front
SU-14	Phoenix Reclaim	Reclaimed Materials and Infrastructure	25% below base	Fixed	$10 \times N$ Materials and $5 \times N$ Infrastructure, for 2 ticks	20	Up front
SU-15	The Back Lot (grey market)	Small lots of the resource the GM names, from Tick 5	Bank base + 10%	Fixed	20 units of one resource	10	Up front

5.3 Supplier catalogue: risk and role

Reliability: **B** suppliers are hit only by shocks tagged to their resource. **C** suppliers are hit first and harder (closed by any outage on their resource) and carry a hidden constraint. Hidden constraints are GM-only; desks may confirm them only once the GM has released them.

ID	Reliability	Hidden constraint (GM only)	Event hooks	Fallback role
SU-01	B	None	E01 Compute Crunch cuts capacity 40%	S3 Compute hosting fallback
SU-02	C	Rents idle capacity from the city's hosting halls; if the S3 filler signs a contract for most of its idle capacity, SU-02 halves	E01 closes it for the event	Part of the S3 fallback
SU-03	B	None	E02 Energy Spike, C04 Energy Emergency	S4 Energy fallback (with the Bank)
SU-04	C	Closes at Tick 6 unless one buyer signs a 3-tick volume commitment (the O03 Expiring Supplier pattern)	C04 closes it; E29 subsidy applies	Part of the S4 fallback
SU-05	B	None	E03 Logistics Jam halves it	None; the Logistics Provider is the S1 and S2 fallback
SU-06	C	Its drivers moonlight for the Logistics Provider: delivers at the next tick's step 2, and drops to zero in E03 or C03	E03, C03	None
SU-07	B	Owned by the same group as SU-12; E21 Supplier Consolidation merges them,	E04 Material Shortage, E21	S5 and S6 fallback

ID	Reliability	Hidden constraint (GM only)	Event hooks	Fallback role
		raising both prices 10%		
SU-08	C	Weather-exposed: fails for 2 ticks when the GM fires a weather event; this is the named event behind Fragile-supply vulnerabilities	Weather event, C15 Supply Contamination	Part of the S6 fallback
SU-09	B	None	E05 Data Boom raises demand	S11 Verified datasets fallback (units are unverified)
SU-10	C	About a third of its data is stale: the C05 Data Integrity Incident card names it, and units bought from it in the previous 2 ticks are void	C05	Part of the S11 fallback
SU-11	B	None	E06 Infrastructure Sale	None
SU-12	B	Merges with SU-07 in E21	E21	None
SU-13	B	Delivers at the next tick's step 3; worse than the S5 filler on price and speed by design	O15 Emergency Factory doubles capacity for 1 tick	S5 Manufacturing fallback
SU-14	B	Loaded only with E22 Open Capacity; the first discoverer gets 1 tick of exclusive	E22	None

ID	Reliability	Hidden constraint (GM only)	Event hooks	Fallback role
		access		
SU-15	C	Revealed only when asked directly (CGS 3.3 grey market); sells the resource the GM is shortest of, with no per-company purchase limit	Shortages	None

Why two Data suppliers matter. MC 6.4 calls Data the tightest market in a Full 12 run (four Very High users, one Low seller). The alternative Data supplier's hidden flaw gives S11 sellers' Verified data a real price premium, which is the point of the slot.

5.4 Desk sheet additions

Tier	Item	Rule
Always	Supplier names, what they sell, list prices, minimum orders, payment terms	Anyone
Earned	Exact remaining capacity this tick for a named supplier	Right question; goes Public at the Internet Unlock
Earned	That an alternative supplier will negotiate inside a band	Relationship: one recorded order with the desk
Earned	SU-04's closure risk, once the GM releases it as a whisper	First K, K = 2
Never	Other buyers' orders, agreements or prices; unreleased hidden constraints	Under no condition

6. Government / Regulator

Government runs 10 licences and certifications, 5 grant programmes from a pool of $3,000 \times N$ VB, 6 public tenders and 6 regulatory instruments the GM fires through events. Every company gate held by Government in MC 3 has a licence here, and every licence is open to any company that meets its requirements.

6.1 How the desk works

Rule	Value
Opens	Market Open for licences; grants only in their window; tenders as announced
Licence decisions	Decided at the next tick boundary after a complete application. Government decides at most 2 applications per tick, 3 when $N \geq 10$, in arrival order.
Loading	The GM loads a licence when a gate, compliance-gap liability or lever in the active set needs it (SW 9), plus GV-L10, which is always loaded.
Validity	For the rest of the run, unless suspended under GV-R02, R05 or R06
Requirements	Built from the source draft's four kinds: documents (E5), resources, a qualified employee (domain and minimum level) and evidence of a completed action
Fees	Paid to the City Reserve (CGS 1.4)
Staffing	Its own volunteer at $N = 10$, separate from Media; one volunteer may cover both desks at $N = 7$

6.2 Licences and certifications

ID	Licence	Unlocks	Requirements	Fee (VB)	Decision	Best fit (GM only)
GV-L01	Cold-chain delivery permit	Chilled and medicine delivery products; CU-02	A delivery Product Card; 10 Energy units; Operations employee at L2+; cold-chain procedure (E5)	600	1 tick	SwiftCart gate
GV-L02	Payments	Lending to other	Security evidence	1,000	1 tick	Ledgerly

ID	Licence	Unlocks	Requirements	Fee (VB)	Decision	Best fit (GM only)
	licence	companies (merchant advances); regulated payment buyers	(attestation from an Approved Auditor, or a GV-L10 pass); proof-of-funds certificate (BK-11) for 5,000 VB; Finance employee at L2+			gate
GV-L03	Food Safety Certificate	Certified food sales; CU-06, CU-16, CU-26; GV-T06	One product unit delivered to the desk on the platform for inspection; hygiene plan (E5); Operations employee at L1+. Only 1 Food Safety inspection per tick, one shared queue	500	1 tick	Mango & Co. and HarvestLoop gates
GV-L04	Course accreditation	GV-T01; +15% ceiling on CU-08	One cohort delivery accepted by a customer (E1 or E3); course author in Product or Research at	500	1 tick	SkillForge gate

ID	Licence	Unlocks	Requirements	Fee (VB)	Decision	Best fit (GM only)
			L2+			
GV-L05	Transport operating permit	Consumer rides; CU-20; GV-T04	A fleet Product Card; 10 Infrastructure for the safety check; driver vetting (E2 from a security or training provider, or an Operations employee at L2+)	600	1 tick	Voltway gate
GV-L06	Approved Auditor status	Attestations that count as security evidence for GV-L02, L07, L08 and customer cards; CU-24, CU-27	One audit accepted by a customer (E1 or E3); lead auditor in Research or Product at L2+; the audit artefact (E5) checked by the desk	800	1 tick	TrustLayer gate
GV-L07	Health data compliance licence	Health data and services to regulated buyers; CU-14; GV-T03	Security evidence; data-handling policy (E5)	800	1 tick	MediLink compliance gap
GV-L08	Regulated hosting licence	Dedicated hosting for regulated buyers; GV-	Security evidence; 20 Infrastructure	800	1 tick	StackHouse compliance gap

ID	Licence	Unlocks	Requirements	Fee (VB)	Decision	Best fit (GM only)
		T05	re units for hardening			
GV-L09	Green certification	GV-T02; hidden needs on CU-12 and CU-18	Verified clean energy delivered or saved (E3: an accepted S4 delivery or retrofit)	500	1 tick	GreenGrid Unlock lever
GV-L10	Security compliance review (S8 fallback)	A "security compliance pass" that counts as security evidence anywhere an attestation does	20 Data units; full system description (E5). At most 1 review per tick	1,500	2 ticks	Any company without an S8 supplier

GV-L10 is the S8 fallback that SW 11.1 calls the "Government licence route". It is deliberately slower (2 ticks) and dearer than an Approved Auditor's attestation, which is the S8 filler's reason to exist.

6.3 Grant programmes

The pool is $3,000 \times N$ VB (21,000 / 30,000 / 36,000). Grants are non-dilutive and add to cash, but they are not verified customer revenue, so they do not lift RV's revenue term (CGS 7.2).

ID	Programme	Amount (VB)	Eligibility	Use of funds	Evidence
GV-G01	Innovation Voucher	Up to 2,000	Any company	Building a new Product Card or capability (application to the GM under CGS 8.5)	Plan (E5) and interest from a customer or partner (E2)
GV-G02	Green Transition Grant	Up to 4,000, matched 1:1 by the company	Any company	An efficiency project (CGS 6.2) or new clean energy	Project record (E1) and, after, the tier change or

ID	Programme	Amount (VB)	Eligibility	Use of funds	Evidence
				capacity	delivery (E3)
GV-G03	Skills and Hiring Grant	Up to 2,500	A company with an empty required seat	Filling the seat through S10, the Talent Exchange or training	The hire (E1)
GV-G04	Partnership Grant	Up to 5,000, split between 2 companies	2 companies with a recorded partnership or joint product deal	Building the joint product (CGS 4.6)	The deal (E1) and a joint plan (E5)
GV-G05	Community Impact Grant	Up to 3,000	A company with an active Consumer contract in Health, Retail and Food, or Skills	Extending that service to more people	The contract (E1) and a feedback summary (E5)

Process. One window, default Tick 5 to the end of Tick 6, awards announced at the Tick 7 boundary; the GM may run a second, smaller round from whatever is left. Each company may win one grant, plus a share of one GV-G04. The desk drops ineligible applications, scores the rest 1–3 on impact, evidence, use of funds and partnership, and awards from the top until the pool runs out. GV-G04 is the source draft's O16 "Grant Match".

6.4 Public tenders

Tenders are Government customer contracts. They pay like customer cards and count as verified customer revenue. The GM loads up to $\lceil N \div 2 \rceil$ tenders (4 / 5 / 6) whose required licence is loaded, announces the first at Tick 3 and the rest about every 2 ticks, and gives each a 1-tick submission window. Consortium bids are welcome if the lead bidder holds the licence. The winner is the lowest-priced bid that passes every requirement; ties go to the better Reliability Record.

ID	Tender	Value (VB)	Required licence	Deliverable	Sector
GV-T01	City Skilling Programme	1,800/tick $\times$ 5 = 9,000	GV-L04	2 trained-and-placed cohort units per tick	Skills and Education
GV-T02	Municipal Green Energy	2,500/tick $\times$ 5 = 12,500	GV-L09	20 Energy units per tick	Energy and Climate

ID	Tender	Value (VB)	Required licence	Deliverable	Sector
				to city buildings	
GV-T03	Public Health Outreach	2,000/tick × 4 = 8,000	GV-L07	Telehealth plus medicine delivery, 3 units per tick	Health
GV-T04	City Freight Electrification	1,800/tick × 5 = 9,000	GV-L05	2 electric fleet capacity units per tick	Logistics and Mobility
GV-T05	Smart City Data Platform	2,200/tick × 5 = 11,000	GV-L08, or security evidence from GV-L06 or L10	Hosting, analytics and monitoring, 1 bundle unit per tick	Technology and Data
GV-T06	School Meals Programme	1,600/tick × 5 = 8,000	GV-L03	3 produce or meal units per tick, delivered	Retail and Food

GV-T02 is the "Government tender buyer" behind GreenGrid's Unlock lever; GV-T01 is the skilling tender behind SkillForge's gate. M23 Tender Watch and O07 Regulatory Window both point at this list.

6.5 Regulatory instruments

These are the parameters the GM sets when a regulatory event fires. The Dynamic Events and Crisis document schedules them; Government applies them to every company alike and explains the compliance path without solving it.

ID	Instrument	What changes	Duration	Compliance path	Fired by
GV-R01	Rule change	One product tag is suspended until a new requirement is met	Until met	Amended licence: 300 VB plus the new requirement, decided in 1 tick; or pivot	Regulatory-exposure vulnerabilities (for example a subsidy change or road rule change)
GV-R02	Sector review	Every licence holder in a sector shows	2 ticks to comply, or the licence is	Submit the item	E17 Regulatory

ID	Instrument	What changes	Duration	Compliance path	Fired by
		one extra evidence item	suspended		Review
GV-R03	Fast-track window	Licence decisions in the same tick; +2 decisions this tick	1 tick	Have a complete application ready	E18 Fast-Track Licence
GV-R04	Resource subsidy	Bank base price of one resource –25% (a CGS 6.7 price shock)	2 ticks	None needed	E29 Resource Subsidy
GV-R05	Regulatory halt	Sales of one product category stop until a halt clearance is granted	Until cleared	Halt clearance: 500 VB plus safety or security evidence, decided in 1 tick	C08 Regulatory Halt
GV-R06	Spot inspection	$[N \div 3]$ licence holders re-checked; a licence whose requirement is no longer met (for example the qualified employee left) is suspended	Until re-met	Meet the requirement again	GM, at most once per run

6.6 Desk sheet additions

Tier	Item	Rule
Always	Loaded licences with requirements and fees; grant programmes and window; announced tenders	Anyone
Earned	The licence queue length this	Right question

Tier	Item	Rule
	tick	
Earned	Which tender is announced next and its sector	Relationship: one recorded application; released Public 1 tick before announcement
Earned	Detailed grant scoring notes	Consultation fee, 150 VB
Never	Other companies' applications, scores or licence status beyond what is public; unannounced rule changes	Under no condition

7. Media / Distribution

Media sells attention through 5 outlets and 10 products, prices its featured story at 500 VB, and keeps the fact desk, broker registration and rumour rules exactly as HI sets them. A story only spreads when people in other companies choose to amplify it, so reach is earned from the city rather than bought outright, as the source draft asks. At $N = 10$ Media has its own volunteer, separate from Government.

7.1 Outlets

ID	Outlet	Audience	What it carries	Capacity per tick
MD-O1	Venture City Live	Everyone: the main screen and the public feed	Featured stories, launches, corrections, GM bulletins	1 featured slot, 2 when $N \geq 10$ (SW 12.2)
MD-O2	The City Ledger	Investors, Enterprise buyers, the Bank	Business features	2 features
MD-O3	CityPulse	Consumers	Consumer campaigns and audience access	$[N \div 2]$ campaigns; 1 audience access
MD-O4	Neighbourhood Radio and Newsletter	Community, staff, free agents	Short notices, hiring posts, rights of reply	Unlimited
MD-O5	The Trade Wire	Suppliers and procurement teams	Pinned Market Board listings, read out at each tick announcement	$[N \div 2]$ listings

7.2 Product catalogue

ID	Product	Outlet	Price (VB)	Requirement	Effect
MD-P01	Notice	O4	150	None	One line on the public feed, printed at its grade
MD-P02	Featured story	O1	500	A card to publish (HI 8.5) or a company story	Uses a featured slot; the card becomes Public and keeps its grade. One claim fact-checked free on request
MD-P03	Business feature	O2	400	At least one claim backed by E1, E2 or E3	Published, plus one platform-recorded priority meeting at the Customer or Investor desk, valid 2 ticks. Counts as M24 Media Angle evidence
MD-P04	Consumer campaign	O3	300 per tick, 1 to 3 ticks	An active Consumer contract or open Consumer bid	Each of the company's Consumer contracts buys +1 unit per tick at contract price for the campaign ticks, up to Product Card capacity
MD-P05	Audience access (S12	O3	600	None	The desk introduces one

ID	Product	Outlet	Price (VB)	Requirement	Effect
	fallback)				open Consumer card of the buyer's choice: full detail including its hidden need, and a priority first meeting
MD-P06	Launch event	O1, O2, O3	900	A delivered sale of the launched product (E1)	A featured slot, a business feature and one campaign tick together
MD-P07	Fact check	Fact desk	250, or 10 Data units; rush × 2	A claim marked verifiable by Media	Verified, Partly verified, Debunked or Unverifiable now (HI 7.2)
MD-P08	Broker registration	Fact desk	200, from Tick 1	At most $[N \div 2]$ brokers	Registered broker status (HI 9.2); fact checks at 3 for 600
MD-P09	Right of reply	O4	Free	Named in a published rumour or a correction	One notice within 1 tick
MD-P10	Trade Wire listing	O5	200	A live Market Board listing	Pinned and read out at the next 2 tick announcements

Pricing rules.

- **Brand discount.** A company holding a Brand Notable Asset pays 25% less for MD-P02, P03 and P04. It is a uniform rule by asset type, which is how the MC 4.3 note that Media coverage is cheapest for the city's consumer brand is honoured without a company-specific price.

- **Slots.** Featured slots are booked up to 1 tick ahead, first come. MD-P06 and published cards share them. The A06 Media Burst auction lot adds one extra featured window.
- **S12.** MD-P05 is the S12 Consumer audience fallback (SW 11.1). It is capped at one a tick and reveals one card, so a company that fills S12 can beat it on reach and price.

7.3 Evidence and rumours

- Media prints every claim at the grade its evidence supports. A claim with no evidence prints as "sources say" (Rumour grade). Media never upgrades a grade except through a fact check.
- Planting a rumour is MD-P02 at 500 VB: the author is recorded in the register but not printed (HI 8.5, 10.3).
- Correction rule (HI 10.3): a published rumour later Debunked triggers a Media correction one tick later naming the author's company, and the Customer desk asks that company for one extra piece of evidence for 2 ticks.
- Media declines any rumour about a real person's character, appearance or private life.

7.4 Viral mechanism

A featured story (MD-P02 or P06) or a campaign (MD-P04) goes viral when participants from at least $\lceil N \div 3 \rceil + 1$ other companies (4 / 5 / 5 at $N = 7 / 10 / 12$) amplify it before the next tick boundary.

Rule	Value
Amplify	A free platform action in Closed-net and Open-net modes, unavailable in Dark. Each participant may amplify one item per tick and never their own company's
Not eligible	Rumour-grade or Debunked items; any item about a person
Limit	One viral item per tick: the first to cross the threshold
Effect	The item's sector demand index rises by 20 for the next 2 ticks, and the subject company gets a free MD-P01 and its next MD-P04 at half price
Who benefits	Everyone selling in that sector, rivals included, because the index scales every card in the sector
E15 Media Moment	Threshold -1; MD-P02 to P04 at half price
E16 Attention Collapse	No item can go viral; MD-P04 has no effect
E23 Viral Product	GM-declared: the named sector's index rises as the event card states, outside this mechanism

Because amplification is recorded, the Founder Ledger can see who spreads what, including anyone amplifying an item that is later debunked.

7.5 Desk sheet additions

Tier	Item	Rule
Always	Outlets, price list, featured slots booked for the next tick, fact desk and broker rules	Anyone
Always	What has been published, and the author for anything other than a rumour (HI 6.1)	Anyone
Earned	Which sectors drew the most amplifications last tick	Right question
Earned	Remaining broker slots	Relationship: one recorded Media purchase
Never	A rumour's author before a correction names them; truth status of any card; other buyers' bookings	Under no condition

Automatic inbox. The platform copies to the Media desk inbox every fact-check request, rumour plant, debunk (with a draft correction), objective lodge that names Media, and the amplification counts, so the desk does not wait for these to be walked over.

8. Scaling, handoffs and open items

Every catalogue scales with N through the formulas below; prices, terms, fees and card contents never change with N.

8.1 Quantities by N

Quantity	Formula	N = 7	N = 10	N = 12
Bank stock per resource at Tick 1 / restock per tick	$40 \times N / 10 \times N$	280 / 70	400 / 100	480 / 120
Bank lending pool (VB)	$8,000 \times N$	56,000	80,000	96,000
BK-12 Credit Window facility (VB)	$2,500 \times N$	17,500	25,000	30,000
Investor fund (VB) / maximum investments	$14,000 \times N / \lceil N \times 0.7 \rceil$	98,000 / 5	140,000 / 7	168,000 / 9

Quantity	Formula	N = 7	N = 10	N = 12
Open customer cards loaded	2 per active company	14	20	24
Standard-line / alternative supplier capacity per resource	$12 \times N / 8 \times N$	84 / 56	120 / 80	144 / 96
SU-13 assembly batches per tick	$[N \div 3]$	3	4	4
Licence decisions per tick	2, or 3 when $N \geq 10$	2	3	3
Grant pool (VB)	$3,000 \times N$	21,000	30,000	36,000
Tenders loaded	$[N \div 2]$	4	5	6
GV-R06 spot inspections	$[N \div 3]$	3	4	4
Media featured slots per tick	1, or 2 when $N \geq 10$	1	2	2
Consumer campaigns per tick / registered brokers	$[N \div 2]$	4	5	6
Viral threshold (other companies amplifying)	$[N \div 3] + 1$	4	5	5

8.2 What other documents need from this one

Document	What to take from here
Company Dossiers	T0 supplier agreements sit with the standard-line supplier for the chosen resource; a Fragile-supply company's Materials agreement sits with SU-08, whose weather event is its named event. Anchor renewals use the 4.1 standard terms. Each gate maps to a GV licence or a gated customer card (CU-02, 06, 10, 14, 16, 18, 20, 22, 24); hidden-buyer and unlock levers map to CU-25 to CU-27 and GV-L09 with GV-T02.

Document	What to take from here
Dynamic Events and Crisis	Event hooks used here: E01–E05, E07–E11, E15–E18, E21–E23, E26, E28, E29, C02–C05, C08, C15. One new event is needed: a weather event that closes SU-08 for 2 ticks. GV-R01 to R06 are the regulatory instruments those events set.
GM Handbook	Capital window default Tick 8 to the cap table lock; grant window Ticks 5–6; first tender at Tick 3, then about every 2 ticks; card, licence and tender loading rules (4.2, 6.1, 6.4); choosing the lead thesis before T0.
Participant Handbook	Everything on the Always tier of each desk sheet (2.6, 3.7, 4.6, 5.4, 6.6, 7.5).
Investor Day and scoring	The lead thesis and the City Ledger record are inputs, not scores. Tender revenue counts as verified customer revenue; grants do not.

Not addressed here: CGS 10.3 asks for about 10 more opportunities for N above 9. Several cards here (CU-03's follow-on, IN-06, SU-04's closure, SU-14) are natural seeds for them, but the library itself belongs to the Dynamic Events document.

8.3 New numbers to tune first

Parameter	Value	Section	Raise it if	Lower it if
Credit grade adjustments	A –2, C +3 points	2.3	Grades do not change behaviour	Weak companies are shut out
Resource credit limit and fee	1,500 VB; 5%	2.2	Short companies still stall	It becomes routine financing
Thesis fit ceilings	2.0 / 1.5 / 1.0 × RV	3.2	Investors feel stingy	Valuations detach from evidence
Customer budgets	2,100 to 15,000 VB per card	4.3	Companies cannot cover payroll by mid-game	Customers out-earn everything else
Hidden-need stretch	+10%	4.1	Nobody asks the right question	Stretch decides most bids
Supplier split and alternative bands	12/8 × N; 15–25% below base	5.2	Alternative suppliers sit unused	Companies stop trading with each other

Parameter	Value	Section	Raise it if	Lower it if
Licence fees and decisions per tick	500–1,500 VB; 2 or 3	6.1–6.2	Queues never form	Gates block whole runs
GV-L10 cost and time	1,500 VB, 2 ticks	6.2	Nobody buys from the S8 filler	Core 7 runs stall on security
Tender values and count	8,000–12,500 VB; $\lceil N \div 2 \rceil$	6.4	Licences are not worth getting	Government outweighs customers
Featured story price	500 VB	7.2	Slots always sell out	Nobody publishes
Viral threshold and effect	$\lceil N \div 3 \rceil + 1$ companies; +20 index for 2 ticks	7.4	Nothing ever goes viral	Every tick has a viral

8.4 Defaults chosen here, open to change

- Eight sector tags (1.2), since none were listed before.
- The Supplier Market's line split into a standard-line supplier and an alternative supplier per resource, with total capacity unchanged (5).
- A run-level lead thesis that sets the valuation ceiling inside the CGS band (3.2), which also fixes when the IC-RUM-01 rumour is true.
- Two open customer cards per company, one of them gated, so card loading follows the active set automatically (4.2).
- Credit grades, resource credit, inventory-backed loans, the proof-of-funds certificate and the Bank's debt-for-equity terms (2.2–2.4).
- Government tenders count as verified customer revenue; grants do not.
- Media's brand discount and amplification-based viral rule (7.2, 7.4).
- 2026-10-05, owner decision after the complexity audit: a second Investor partner volunteer at $N = 10$, an in-app booking board that opens at Tick 7, and the valuation ceiling shown to the partner on the platform (3.1, 3.2, 3.4); separate Government and Media volunteers at $N = 10$ (6.1, 7); the Relationship tier kept, with the desk console showing cross-desk history and flagging qualified Earned items (1.1); a Media automatic inbox (7.5); term sheets drafted in the platform deal builder (3.5).

Venture City — Personal Objective System

2026-10-05 · Nero Kami

Purpose and design principles

Every participant gets one hidden Personal Objective at game start, so the floor stops behaving like 50-100 people chasing the same company score. Objectives create crossing incentives (one person wants independence, another wants to recruit them), surface behaviour the Founder Ledger wants to see, and give quieter players a concrete reason to act early.

- **Separate from the company score.** A Personal Objective never pays VB to the company and never enters Final Scoring (#14). Its only output is founder-ledger evidence, plus a small personal reward (below).
- **Generic until assigned.** Templates name no company, customer, resource or role. Blanks such as {customer} or {skill} are filled from the participant's company dossier when the card is printed or pushed to their phone.
- **Same rules for every company.** Any template can land in any company at any company count (7, 10 or 12). Where a template needs something a company lacks, the fill-in procedure (section 4) swaps the blank, never the rule.
- **Evidence, not points.** Completing an objective is one ledger entry, graded A/B/C and significance 1/2/3 like any other observation in the [Founder Identification System](#). It is not a bonus on top of the band; the band still comes from the best three independent entries.
- **How you did it matters more than whether.** A completed objective reached by copying a teammate's work grades lower than an honest failed attempt that showed initiative. Observers grade the behaviour, not the tick box.
- **Personal reward.** Completion pays 500 VB to the participant's personal wallet (the 1,000 VB wallet from Starting World). This is enough to matter for side deals, not enough to buy a company outcome.

How objectives work

Each participant is dealt one objective at T0, can earn up to two more by completing, can swap once before the end of Tick 7, and carries the objective with them if they change company. Completion is verified like a mission and becomes a Founder Ledger entry at grade B, which an observer can upgrade.

2.1 Who gets one

Every registered participant, including late arrivals (dealt at join). CEO volunteers, institution volunteers, observers and the GM never hold objectives. A Founder or Free Agent keeps theirs.

2.2 Assignment: the deal

Objectives are dealt by the platform at registration close, not drawn blind, so the floor gets a spread. The deal follows four rules in this order.

1. **No repeats inside a company.** No two people in the same company hold the same template at T0.
2. **Family spread.** Every company with 5 or more staff holds at least one template from each of the five families (Drive, Value creation, Market sense, Exchange, Pressure). The family is that of the template's primary signal.
3. **Half with the grain, half against it.** Each template carries a natural domain (section 3). About half of a company's staff get a template matching their own domain; the rest get one that pulls them outside their seat. This is what stops employees sitting inside their function.
4. **Crossing pairs.** Wherever possible the deal places the pairs in 2.3 so their holders will meet. Ties are broken at random.

Each template is held by at most $\lceil P \div 20 \rceil + 1$ people city-wide at T0, where P is the participant count (4 at 50 participants, 6 at 100). The deal is run once at T-1 day after N is fixed, re-run for no-shows at registration close, and printed into each participant's T0 envelope as well as pushed to the app.

2.3 Crossing pairs

Some templates are built to pull against or toward each other, so personal goals create real negotiations.

Pair	Tension	Deal rule
PO-13 Go Independent ↔ PO-04 Keep Your People	One wants to leave; one is rewarded for stopping departures	Each company that holds a PO-13 also holds a PO-04 where headcount allows
PO-03 Recruit the Missing Skill ↔ PO-04 Keep Your People	A recruiter in one company, a retainer in another	Place the recruiter's {domain} in a company whose PO-04 holder shares that domain
PO-12 Secure the Bottleneck ↔ PO-12 in another company	Two buyers chasing the same scarce resource	Resolve {resource} to the same resource for at least one pair
PO-20 Make Someone Else Win ↔ anyone	Only completable by finding another holder willing to say what theirs is	No pairing needed; at most one per company
PO-07 Expose a Rumour ↔ holders of false information cards	The rumour-holder does not know their card is false	Deal only when at least one false or partly true card is live

2.4 Secrecy and reveal

An objective is a Personal-class information record (Starting World 10.2): only the holder, the GM and the observer team can see it. The platform never shows it to a company, CEO or institution.

- **The holder may tell anyone, any time.** Sharing never voids anything. Each card carries a disclosure hint so people think about it: *Open* (telling people helps), *Discreet* (telling the wrong person costs you leverage) or *Your call*.
- **Nobody can transfer an objective.** A participant may help someone complete theirs (PO-20 rewards exactly that), but the completion is credited to the holder.
- **Signal codes never appear on the card.** Participants are not told what is observed (Founder Identification, section 1). The mapping in section 3 is observer-only.
- **Observers see objectives as context, not as a checklist.** An objective tells an observer where something may happen; it never tells them what to grade.
- **After the event** each participant's personal summary lists their objectives and outcomes. At the Founder Ledger reveal the Ledger Lead may tell an objective story anonymously. The ceremony may show one city-wide number ("61 of 84 participants completed an objective") and never names or rates individuals by completion.

2.5 Changes during the game

Change	When	Rule
Follow-on objective	Next tick boundary after a verification	The holder is dealt a new template not previously held. Maximum 3 completions per participant per run.
Voluntary swap	Any time up to the end of Tick 7	Once per participant, free. The new template is dealt by the same rules, excluding the one returned.
Re-resolve on a move	Tick boundary when the holder changes company, resigns or founds	Blanks naming the old company re-resolve to the new one. Progress toward a company-scoped condition resets; a completion already verified stands.
Auto-reissue	When the platform or GM finds the objective can no longer be completed	Free, does not use the swap. Causes: target company or institution gone, resource or domain no longer scarce, condition cannot occur in the ticks left.
Late-day cut-off	From Tick 9	No new or swapped objectives are dealt. Active ones can still be completed until freeze.

2.6 Completion and verification

Objectives use the Core Game Systems evidence classes E1 to E5 and the mission verification flow (Core Game Systems 1.3 and 2.5).

- **E1 conditions verify automatically** when the registry shows them. The holder is notified.
- **Everything else is claimed** in the app (or on paper at the Help Desk during an outage) with evidence attached, and verified within 10 minutes by the desk the template names, or escalated to the GM.
- **Independence, freshness and single use apply.** Counterparties must be outside the holder's company; evidence must be created after the objective was dealt; one piece of evidence completes one objective. A deal reversed within the next tick voids the completion.
- **Reward.** First completion pays 500 VB to the holder's personal wallet, follow-ons pay 250 VB, all from the City Reserve outside the mission budget. Nothing is paid to the company.

2.7 How a completion enters the Founder Ledger

This is the one place where a platform record writes a draft ledger entry, rather than only flagging an observer.

5. On verification the platform writes a **draft entry**: situation = the resolved objective text; action = the holder's claim; outcome and proof = the verifying record IDs; primary signal = the template's primary code; grade **B** (outcome confirmed, not seen first-hand); significance = the template's default.
6. The draft is sent to the nearest observer as a system-flagged moment. The observer confirms within the tick: they may **upgrade to A** if they witnessed the work or a second witness confirms it, change the significance against Founder Identification 3.2, and swap or add codes if the outcome shows a different signal better. The template mapping is a default, not a ruling.
7. **Prompted field.** Objective entries record *Prompted?* = *objective*. Because IN requires self-initiated action, IN may be coded on an objective entry only for the three templates marked ♦ (PO-13, PO-18, PO-19), which name a goal but leave the target entirely to the holder.
8. The entry then counts like any other: one independent moment, read in the signal's best three. A completion cannot by itself lift a signal above Clear, because Exceptional already needs three entries from two observers.
9. **Failed attempts are evidence too.** An observer who sees a holder fail well (refused, changed approach, tried again) writes an ordinary entry, typically RX or AD. Completing badly is also recorded: an objective pursued by abandoning the team in a crisis gets an OW- counter-entry, and the reward still stands if the rules were met.

Template library

The pool holds 20 templates. Every one of the 15 founder signals is the primary code of at least one template, and every template asks for something new rather than something the company already had at T0. Text in braces is filled at assignment (section 4); nothing else changes between companies.

3.1 The pool at a glance

ID	Template	Family (primary)	Primary	Secondary	Natural domain	Default significance	Disclosure hint
PO-01	First New Customer	Value creation	SE	BU	Growth/Sales	2	Open
PO-02	Turn a No into a Yes	Drive	RX	SE or DM	Generalist/Founder	2	Your call
PO-03	Recruit the Missing Skill	Exchange	TM	DM	Generalist/Founder	2	Open
PO-04	Keep Your People	Exchange	TM	OW	Brand/Community	2	Discreet
PO-05	Find the	Market	SP	CB	Research/Intelligence	2	Discreet

	Hidden Opportunity	sense					
PO-06	Information Edge	Market sense	SP	CA	Research/Intelligence	1	Discreet
PO-07	Expose a Rumour	Market sense	CT	SP	Brand/Community	2	Your call
PO-08	Ship Something New	Value creation	BU	OP	Product/Build	2	Open
PO-09	Run the Big Job	Value creation	OP	BU	Operations	2	Open
PO-10	A Deal Both Sides Want	Exchange	DM	CB	Growth/Sales	2	Your call
PO-11	Broker a Deal You're Not In	Exchange	CB	SP	Brand/Community	1	Open
PO-12	Secure the Bottleneck	Exchange	RH	DM	Operations	2	Discreet
PO-13 ♦	Go Independent	Drive	IN	TM	Generalist/Founder	2	Discreet
PO-14	Cut the Burn	Market sense	CA	RH	Finance/Capital	1	Your call
PO-15	Raise Smart Money	Market sense	CA	SE	Finance/Capital	2	Your call
PO-16	Lead Through the Storm	Pressure	CL	OP	Operations	2	Open
PO-17	Change the Plan	Pressure	AD	CT	Generalist/Founder	2	Your call
PO-18 ♦	Fix What Nobody Owns	Drive	OW	OP	Product/Build	1	Your call
PO-19 ♦	Make the First Move	Drive	IN	DM	Growth/Sales	1	Discreet
PO-20	Make Someone Else Win	Exchange	CB	TM	Brand/Community	1	Open

♦ = the holder chooses the target, so IN may be coded (section 2.7). Significance is the default on the draft entry; the observer sets the final value.

3.2 Templates in full

Each entry gives the card text exactly as the participant reads it, what completes it, the evidence, assignment notes, and the signal mapping.

PO-01 First New Customer

- **Card:** "Bring {company} a paying customer it did not have when the city opened. One paid delivery before freeze is enough."
- **Complete when:** a sales contract with a counterparty that is not on {company}'s T0 customer list, anchor contract or leads settles at least one paid delivery, with the holder recorded as negotiator.
- **Evidence:** E1. Government tender revenue counts; grants do not (Institution content).
- **Assignment:** any company. Never dealt to both Authorised Signatories of one company.
- **Signals:** SE primary; BU secondary if the holder also organised the delivery. Significance 3 if the customer becomes the company's largest by revenue.

PO-02 Turn a No into a Yes

- **Card:** "Somebody will say no to {company} today: a customer, a desk, another company. Go back with a better offer and get a yes."

- **Complete when:** a deal, loan, licence or application with the same counterparty is recorded as rejected and then accepted at least 1 tick later, with the holder on the accepted one.
- **Evidence:** E1 for the two records; E3 where a desk refusal was verbal and the desk confirms it.
- **Assignment:** any company. Holders are told on the card that the first no can be anyone's, not only their own.
- **Signals:** RX primary; SE if the yes is a sale, DM if it is a negotiated deal.

PO-03 Recruit the Missing Skill

- **Card:** "{company} is short of {domain} people. Get one in who wasn't there at the start: hire, poach or contract them."
- **Complete when:** a hire, outside specialist or freelance contract fills {domain} for {company} and the person is still there 1 tick later. The holder is the recorded recruiter.
- **Evidence:** E1 (hire or contract) plus E2 from the recruit that the holder approached them.
- **Assignment:** {domain} = the company's deficit domain at assignment, or its largest unfilled required domain if that has changed. Paired with a PO-04 holder elsewhere (2.3).
- **Signals:** TM primary; DM secondary if the deal included equity, a bonus or a counteroffer fight.

PO-04 Keep Your People

- **Card:** "When someone in {company} gets an outside offer, keep them, on terms both sides accept."
- **Complete when:** a staff member of {company} receives a recorded outside offer and stays through the counteroffer window, with the holder recorded as proposer of the counteroffer, retention bonus or equity grant, or confirmed by the person as the reason they stayed.
- **Evidence:** E1 (offer and counteroffer records) plus E2 from the person retained, who must be someone other than the holder.
- **Assignment:** dealt to companies that also hold a PO-13 (where headcount allows). If {company} has received no outside offer by the end of Tick 5, the holder may auto-reissue without using their swap.
- **Signals:** TM primary; OW secondary if the holder did it without being a signatory.

PO-05 Find the Hidden Opportunity

- **Card:** "Somewhere in the city an opportunity is waiting that nobody has claimed. Find one and see it claimed, by your company or by anyone you hand it to."
- **Complete when:** the Opportunity Register lists the holder as a discoverer of an opportunity and that opportunity reaches Claimed by any party.
- **Evidence:** E1 (Register).
- **Assignment:** any company. Unchanged if the holder moves, since it names no company.
- **Signals:** SP primary; CB secondary if it was claimed by a company other than the holder's.

PO-06 Information Edge

- **Card:** "Find out something true about {target} that it hasn't made public, and use it in a decision before the end of Tick {t}."
- **Complete when:** the holder lodges the fact, where it came from and the decision it changed at the Media desk; the GM confirms the fact is true; the decision is on record (a deal, bid, refusal or claim) after the lodge time.
- **Evidence:** E5 (lodged note) + E4 (GM truth check) + E1 (the decision).
- **Assignment:** {target} = a company or institution that is not the holder's own, chosen from the role slots the holder's company depends on. {t} = 4 ticks after assignment, capped at Tick 9.
- **Signals:** SP primary; CA secondary if the decision was a money trade-off.

PO-07 Expose a Rumour

- **Card:** "At least one thing people in this city believe is false. Prove it, and stop someone acting on it."

- **Complete when:** the holder lodges the claim and evidence with the Media desk; the GM confirms the information is false or partly true; and a participant from another company confirms they changed a decision because of the holder.
- **Evidence:** E5 + E4 (GM truth check) + E2 (the person who changed course).
- **Assignment:** only while at least one false or partly true information card is live (Starting World 10.5).
- **Signals:** CT primary; SP secondary.

PO-08 Ship Something New

- **Card:** "Get {company} something it can sell that it couldn't make when the city opened: a new product, or an order delivered with a new supply product."
- **Complete when:** the GM issues {company} a new Product Card (Core Game Systems 8.5), or the registry shows a first delivery made with a supply product or recipe {company} did not hold at T0. The holder is named in the application or production record.
- **Evidence:** E3/E4 (Product Card issue) or E1 (production and delivery).
- **Assignment:** any company. Natural fit for Product/Build; deliberately dealt against the grain too.
- **Signals:** BU primary; OP secondary if several people were organised to get it out. Significance 3 if it opens a new customer segment.

PO-09 Run the Big Job

- **Card:** "Lead a Tier {tier} mission or a cross-company mission to completion. You don't have to do it all yourself, but you have to run it."
- **Complete when:** a mission of the stated tier, or any cross-company mission, is Verified with the holder as claimant, and at least two other people contributed.
- **Evidence:** E1 (mission record) + E4 (observer or GM saw the holder coordinating), because teammates cannot confirm each other.
- **Assignment:** {tier} = 3 at T0; 2 if dealt after Tick 6.
- **Signals:** OP primary; BU secondary.

PO-10 A Deal Both Sides Want

- **Card:** "Set up an agreement between {company} and another company where each side gets something it couldn't get alone. A straight sale doesn't count."
- **Complete when:** a Deal Sheet that is a partnership, barter, joint bid, shared-capacity or cross-company mission split is accepted, and both sides deliver at least once.
- **Evidence:** E1, plus E2 from the other company's negotiator that it was worth doing.
- **Assignment:** any company.
- **Signals:** DM primary; CB secondary if the other side gained more than {company} did.

PO-11 Broker a Deal You're Not In

- **Card:** "Introduce two parties from outside {company} who then do a deal with each other."
- **Complete when:** the holder registers the introduction (both parties scan the introduction code) and a deal between those two parties is recorded within 2 ticks. Neither party may be the holder's own company.
- **Evidence:** E2 (both scans) + E1 (the deal).
- **Assignment:** any company. Unchanged on a move.
- **Signals:** CB primary; SP secondary. Significance 2 if the deal solved a shortage or crisis for either side.

PO-12 Secure the Bottleneck

- **Card:** "{company} will run short of {resource}. Get it at least {q} units from anywhere except buying from the Bank at list price."
- **Complete when:** transfers of {resource} into {company} totalling {q} or more come from the Supplier Market, another company, a barter, an auction, or a Bank resource credit or inventory loan, with the holder as negotiator.

- **Evidence:** E1.
- **Assignment:** {resource} = the company's critical-dependency resource, or the resource with the fewest ticks of cover. {q} = 2 ticks of the company's consumption of it. Paired with another company's PO-12 on the same resource where possible (2.3).
- **Signals:** RH primary; DM secondary.

PO-13 ♦ Go Independent

- **Card:** "By freeze, be working for yourself: a founder of a new venture or spin-out, or a free agent who has delivered a paid freelance contract."
- **Complete when:** a charter is confirmed with the holder as a founder, or the holder, as a free agent, has a freelance contract settled.
- **Evidence:** E1.
- **Assignment:** at most one per company, and only in companies with 6 or more staff. Not affected by the $[N \div 3]$ new-venture cap, since the freelance route is always open.
- **Signals:** IN primary (the holder chooses what to found or sell); TM secondary if they recruited co-founders. Leaving a team mid-crisis without a handover earns an OW- counter-entry.

PO-14 Cut the Burn

- **Card:** "Save {company} at least {x} VB over the rest of the day, by replacing a cost with a cheaper source or ending one it doesn't need."
- **Complete when:** a new supply contract, barter or renegotiation replaces a Bank purchase or an existing contract, or a recurring contract is ended by agreement, and the projected saving over the remaining ticks is {x} or more.
- **Evidence:** E1 (old and new terms) + E5 (a one-line comparison checked by the Bank desk).
- **Assignment:** {x} = one tick of the company's baseline consumption at Bank prices (about 1,000 VB for a typical profile).
- **Signals:** CA primary; RH secondary if the cheaper source was unconventional. Significance 2 if the saving is $2 \times \{x\}$ or more.

PO-15 Raise Smart Money

- **Card:** "Get {company} new money, from a loan, investment, grant or customer prepayment, on terms you can explain: what it costs and why it beats the alternative."
- **Complete when:** the funding is recorded with the holder as negotiator, and the holder's claim includes a three-line note (cost, alternative considered, why this one), which the desk that provided the money confirms is accurate.
- **Evidence:** E1 + E5 + E3.
- **Assignment:** any company. Funding must stay inside the Bank debt cap and the 40% dilution cap (Core Game Systems 7.3, 7.4).
- **Signals:** CA primary; SE secondary if the holder pitched the Investor or a customer.

PO-16 Lead Through the Storm

- **Card:** "When a crisis hits {company} or a company it depends on, organise the response so the damage is smaller than it would have been."
- **Complete when:** a crisis-response mission for that crisis is Verified with the holder as claimant, or the platform records that {company} avoided or reduced the crisis effect through an action the holder is named on.
- **Evidence:** E1 + E4 (an observer or the GM saw the holder lead the response).
- **Assignment:** any company. If no crisis has hit {company} by the end of Tick 8, the telegraphed Tick 9 major crisis becomes the target and the objective cannot be auto-reissued.
- **Signals:** CL primary; OP secondary.

PO-17 Change the Plan

- **Card:** "When the facts change, persuade {company} to reverse a decision it had already made, and show the change paid off before freeze."
- **Complete when:** the holder lodges a note in the app at the moment of the change (what changed, the old decision, the new one); the new decision is on record; and at claim the GM confirms a result that the old decision would not have produced.
- **Evidence:** E5 (time-stamped note) + E1 + E4 (GM).
- **Assignment:** any company. Natural pairing with the Tick 4 Market Event and Tick 7 company evolution.
- **Signals:** AD primary; CT secondary if the holder argued against the group to get there.

PO-18 ♦ Fix What Nobody Owns

- **Card:** "Find a problem in {company} that isn't anyone's job. Fix it so it stays fixed."
- **Complete when:** the holder logs the problem in the app before fixing it, then claims; an observer or the GM confirms the fix held for at least 1 tick.
- **Evidence:** E5 (time-stamped log) + E4.
- **Assignment:** any company. Deliberately dealt to people outside Operations as often as inside.
- **Signals:** OW primary; OP secondary. This is the template most likely to surface quiet operators for The Invisible Force.

PO-19 ♦ Make the First Move

- **Card:** "Before the market opens, set up a deal for {company} that settles in Tick 1."
- **Complete when:** a deal is recorded as Proposed before Market Open with the holder as negotiator and settles in Tick 1.
- **Evidence:** E1.
- **Assignment:** T0 only. If not complete by the end of Tick 1 it auto-reissues without using the swap.
- **Signals:** IN primary (the holder chooses what deal and with whom); DM secondary.

PO-20 Make Someone Else Win

- **Card:** "Help someone from another company complete their personal objective. You'll have to find out what it is."
- **Complete when:** another company's participant has their objective Verified and names the holder as the person who made it possible, and the holder appears in the counterparts of that completion.
- **Evidence:** E2 (the other holder's confirmation) + E1 (their verified objective).
- **Assignment:** at most one per company. A participant can credit a PO-20 holder only once, and two people cannot credit each other.
- **Signals:** CB primary; TM secondary.

3.3 Adding or retiring templates

A new template must give the card text, a completion condition the platform or a desk can check, an evidence class, any assignment limits, and one primary signal. Keep the pool between 18 and 24 so the deal can avoid repeats inside a company of 14. Retire any template that playtesting shows is completed by fewer than 10% or more than 80% of holders.

Fill-in procedure

The platform fills every blank from the holder's company dossier and the live city state at the moment of assignment, the same way company-intel information cards are resolved against role slots (Starting World 10.5). Nobody writes objective text by hand for a company, so a company swapped into or out of the active set breaks nothing.

4.1 Tokens

Token	Used in	Resolved from	Fallback
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{company}	Most templates	The holder's current company	Free agent: "any venture you work for or with"
{domain}	PO-03	The company's deficit domain (dossier), or its largest unfilled required domain if that has changed	The domain with the highest talent index
{resource}	PO-12	The company's critical-dependency resource (dossier), or the resource with the fewest ticks of cover	The resource with the highest price index
{q}	PO-12	2 × the company's per-tick consumption of {resource}, minimum 10 units	10 units
{target}	PO-06	A company or institution filling a role slot the holder's company depends on (Starting World 11), never the holder's own company	A random institution
{t}	PO-06	Assignment tick + 4, capped at Tick 9	Tick 9
{tier}	PO-09	3 at T0; 2 if dealt after Tick 6	2
{x}	PO-14	One tick of the company's baseline consumption at Bank prices	1,000 VB

4.2 Steps

10. **T-1 day (after N is fixed at T-7):** the platform runs the deal in 2.2 against the registration list and produces a template ID per participant. The GM reviews the crossing pairs and the per-company family spread.
11. **Registration close:** no-shows are removed and the deal is re-run for the gaps only. Tokens are resolved against T0 state.
12. **Print and push.** Each T0 envelope holds a printed objective card: title, resolved card text, disclosure hint, and how to claim. The same record is pushed to the app with Personal visibility. Signal codes and significance never appear on the card; the observer copy carries them.
13. **Impossibility check.** Before printing, the platform flags any card whose resolved condition cannot occur (for example PO-07 with no false card live). Flagged cards are re-dealt.
14. **In play:** follow-on objectives, swaps and moves resolve tokens against live state at the tick boundary when they happen (2.5).

4.3 Worked example

The same PO-03 card resolves differently in two companies without any change to its rule:

- Dealt in SwiftCart (deficit domain Finance/Capital): "SwiftCart is short of Finance/Capital people. Get one in who wasn't there at the start: hire, poach or contract them."
- Dealt in Ledgerly (deficit domain Growth/Sales): "Ledgerly is short of Growth/Sales people. Get one in who wasn't there at the start: hire, poach or contract them."

If the SwiftCart holder moves to Ledgerly at Tick 5, their card re-resolves at that tick boundary to Ledgerly's largest unfilled domain at that moment, and any progress toward SwiftCart's hire is dropped.

Signal coverage

All 15 founder signals are the primary code of at least one template, and every individual award in Founder Identification 6.3 has at least one template feeding its shortlist signals. No award is given for completing objectives.

Signal	Family	Primary in	Secondary in	Award shortlist it feeds
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IN Initiator	Drive	PO-13 ♦, PO-19 ♦	none	Most Promising Founder
OW Owner	Drive	PO-18 ♦	PO-04	Most Promising Founder
RX Relentless executor	Drive	PO-02	none	Most Promising Founder
BU Builder	Value creation	PO-08	PO-01, PO-09	The Invisible Force
SE Seller	Value creation	PO-01	PO-02, PO-15	Best Commercial Operator
OP Operator	Value creation	PO-09	PO-08, PO-16, PO-18	The Invisible Force
SP Opportunity spotter	Market sense	PO-05, PO-06	PO-07, PO-11	Best Opportunity Spotter
CT Contrarian	Market sense	PO-07	PO-17	Best Opportunity Spotter
CA Capital thinker	Market sense	PO-14, PO-15	PO-06	Best Commercial Operator
DM Deal maker	Exchange	PO-10	PO-02, PO-03, PO-12, PO-19	Best Negotiator
RH Resource hacker	Exchange	PO-12	PO-14	Resource Hacker
TM Talent magnet	Exchange	PO-03, PO-04	PO-13, PO-20	Best Talent Builder
CB Collaborator	Exchange	PO-11, PO-20	PO-05, PO-10	The Invisible Force
CL Crisis leader	Pressure	PO-16	none	Best Crisis Leader
AD Adaptor	Pressure	PO-17	none	Best Pivot

The Pressure family has only two templates on purpose: crises are dealt to companies by the Dynamic Events system, so pressure behaviour is mostly found by observers, not prompted by cards. RX and AD in particular show up most often in failed or redirected attempts at other objectives (2.7, point 5).

Edge cases, anti-gaming and GM operations

The evidence rules in 2.6 stop most gaming; the cases below cover what they don't.

6.1 Edge cases

Situation	Ruling
Two friends in different companies stage deals to complete each other's objectives	Independence and single use still hold. A deal reversed within the next tick voids both completions. Observers grade the moment on what it changed, so a staged deal is at best significance 1.
An objective works against the holder's company (PO-13 leaving, PO-11 helping outsiders)	Allowed; that tension is the point. The reward stands if the rules are met. Observers record harm to the team as a counter-entry, never as a lowered grade.
The holder's company fails or is acquired	Company-scoped tokens re-resolve to the acquirer, or to "any venture you work for" if they become a free agent. Auto-reissue if still impossible.
The holder founds a new venture	Tokens re-resolve to the new venture. PO-13 completes at once if they hold it.
Two holders complete the same condition with one deal (e.g. two PO-01 holders on one sale)	Credit goes to the participant recorded as negotiator. If both are named, both complete, but the observer writes one moment with two participants.
A holder claims someone else did the work	The counterparty or observer check catches it. A rejected claim returns once, like a mission (Core Game Systems 2.5); a second rejection closes the objective for 1 tick.
A volunteer CEO wants to know staff objectives	They can ask; staff can decline. The platform never shows a CEO anyone's objective.
Network failure	Paper cards are in every envelope; claims go to the Help Desk on paper and are entered at the next tick boundary, as Founder Ledger paper cards are.

6.2 What the GM watches

- **Completion rate.** Target: 40–60% of participants complete at least one objective by freeze. The GM dashboard shows verified completions per template per tick.
- **Levers if the rate runs low by Tick 5:** extend the swap window to Tick 8, or announce publicly that personal objectives exist and pay out (without naming any). If it runs high, stop follow-on objectives.
- **Dead templates.** Any template with no progress city-wide by Tick 6 is noted for playtest retirement (3.3), not fixed mid-event.
- **Money.** Rewards come from the City Reserve outside the mission budget. At 100 participants and the target rate, expect roughly 20,000–35,000 VB into personal wallets across the day, which matters mostly for new-venture charters (10,000 VB) and information purchases.

6.3 Who does what

Who	Does
Platform	Deals, resolves tokens, verifies E1, writes draft ledger entries, flags the nearest observer
Help Desk	Takes paper claims and swap requests during outages
Named desks (Media, Bank, Investor, Government, Customer)	Verify E3 and E5 evidence within 10 minutes
GM	Reviews the deal at T–1, runs truth checks (PO-06, PO-07) and E4 outcome checks, rules on impossibility
Observers	Confirm or upgrade draft entries within the tick; record attempts and counter-entries

6.4 Defaults chosen, open to change

These are my design calls, not inherited decisions: one objective at T0 with up to 3 completions; 500 VB first reward and 250 VB follow-ons; one free swap until the end of Tick 7; no new objectives from Tick 9; the dealt (not blind) assignment with half-against-the-grain matching; and verified completions writing a grade-B draft ledger entry, which is a small amendment to Founder Identification 2.4 ("a flag does not create an entry") and should be noted there.

See also: [Starting World Master Design](#) · [Core Game Systems](#) · [Founder Identification System](#)

Starting Companies — Master Catalogue

Document 2 of the build sequence · As of 5 October 2026 · Owner: Nero Kami

1. Purpose

This catalogue fixes who the 12 companies are and how they connect, so the 12 Company Dossiers can be written in parallel without contradicting each other. It sits between the [Starting World Master Design](#) (the structure and formulas) and the dossiers (the full numbers and secrets).

What it fixes for each company: the business, its place in the slot web, and one default pick for every shared-catalogue choice a dossier must make (persona, deficit domain, gate, liability, Notable Asset, hidden lever and vulnerability). The picks are spread so no type is overused across the pool and the Core 7 never repeats a CEO persona.

What it leaves to the dossiers: every VB amount, the Strategic Adjustment and SPV check, Product Card prices, leads, private facts and lever parameters, all inside the Starting World bands.

One reading rule. A dossier never names another company (Starting World 2.4). Company names in this catalogue tell writers who fills each slot when both are active, so the stories match; the dossier text itself says "a fleet-capacity provider", not "Volvway".

2. The pool at a glance

Twelve companies, each selling one thing the others need: every company fills at least one role slot and needs three to five. Archetypes, clusters, slots and workforce mixes below are carried over from Starting World sections 4.1, 5.3 and 11.2 unchanged.

Company	Sells, in one line	Cluster	Fills slot	Critical dependency	Workforce mix	Sets
SwiftCart	30-minute grocery delivery; last-mile and fleet capacity for others	Physical	S1, S2	S1 Fleet capacity	Ops-led	Core, Supply, City, Full
Ledgerly	Payments, merchant working capital, transaction data	Digital, Regulated	S7, S11	S8 Security	Tech-led	Core, Supply, City, Full
Mango & Co.	Mango-based food and lifestyle brand; access to its consumer community	Physical	S12	S5 Manufacturing	Market-led	Core, City, Full
SkillForge	Bootcamps and placement of trained hires	Digital	S10	S12 Consumer audience	Market-led	Core, Supply, City, Full
PulseAI	Forecasting and analytics models for businesses	Digital	S9	S3 Compute hosting	Tech-led	Core, Supply, City, Full
GreenGrid	Solar-plus-battery energy supply and efficiency retrofits	Physical, Regulated	S4	S5 Manufacturing	Ops-led	Core, City, Full
MediLink	Telehealth and pharmacy marketplace; anonymised health data	Digital, Regulated	S11	S8 Security	Tech-led	Core, City, Full
HarvestLoop	Fresh produce and bio-materials from a grower network	Physical	S6	S1 Fleet capacity	Ops-led	Supply, Full
StackHouse	Compute hosting from its own data centre	Digital	S3	S4 Energy	Tech-led	City, Full

Company	Sells, in one line	Cluster	Fills slot	Critical dependency	Workforce mix	Sets
Voltway	Electric vans and drivers by the tick; consumer rides	Physical	S1	S4 Energy	Ops-led	Supply, City, Full
Forgeline	Contract manufacturing runs for physical products	Physical	S5	S6 Raw materials	Ops-led	Supply, Full
TrustLayer	Security audits, monitoring and compliance attestations	Digital, Regulated	S8	S3 Compute hosting	Tech-led	City, Full

Selection sets (Starting World 4.3): Core 7 = the first seven rows; Supply-chain 7 = SwiftCart, HarvestLoop, Forgeline, Voltway, Ledgerly, PulseAI, SkillForge; City 10 = Core 7 + StackHouse, Voltway, TrustLayer; Full 12 = all.

Checklist re-run for this catalogue. All four sets pass every item in Starting World 4.3: each resource has at least 2 heavy (High or Very High) and 2 light (Low or Medium) consumers, each set has 2+ Physical, 2+ Digital and 1+ Regulated company, and every active company has 2 or more needed slots filled by other active companies. Supply-chain 7 passes on Regulated with one company only (Ledgerly), so Government has a thin role in that set. How many critical dependencies each set actually fills is in section 8.

3. Shared baseline and default picks

Every company starts with the same rulebook, the same 100 units of each resource, L0 staff on the shared salary ladder, the same Starting Package slots and an SPV inside 25,000 to 31,000 VB. Only the picks below and the numbers inside the bands differ.

The picks are spread across the pool: each liability type and each lever type is used exactly twice, each vulnerability type two or three times, and six deficit domains twice each. The Core 7 uses all seven CEO personas once.

Company	CEO persona	Deficit domain	Notable Asset	Gate (key holder)	Liability	Hidden lever	Vulnerability
SwiftCart	Growth Maximiser	Finance / Capital	Distribution channel: 6 dark stores	Cold-chain delivery permit (Government) opens medicine and chilled delivery	Deferred supplier payment	Cost lever: an S1 deal drops Logistics from Very High to High	Concentration
Ledgerly	Dealmaker	Growth / Sales	Dataset: merchant transaction history	Payments licence (Government) opens the Merchant Advance product	Refund obligation (chargebacks)	Network effect: each partner company on its rails adds revenue per tick	Hidden liability (fraud losses)
Mango & Co.	Brand Purist	Operations	Brand	Food Safety Certificate (Government) opens the Enterprise retail-chain buyer	Refund obligation	Hidden buyer: a retail-chain card appears once it holds a manufacturing deal	Fragile supply
SkillForge	Mission Idealist	Product / Build	Customer list: learners and alumni	Course accreditation (Government) opens the skilling tender	Key-person risk (lead instructor)	Network effect: each company hiring through it adds revenue per tick	Concentration
PulseAI	Product Perfectionist	Growth / Sales	Prototype: working forecasting model	2 completed pilots (Customer desk) open Enterprise contracts	Technical debt (Compute)	Multiplier: Enterprise contracts pay a premium	Key person (lead ML engineer)
GreenGrid	Operator	Finance / Capital	Licence: grid connection	2 signed offtake contracts (Bank) open project finance for the Grid Expansion	Bank loan	Unlock: green certification opens Government tender buyer	Regulatory exposure (subsidy change)
MediLink	Risk Guardian	Brand / Community	Dataset: verified provider and outcome data	3 verified deliveries (Customer desk) open the Enterprise hospital buyer	Compliance gap	Latent asset: dataset worth 2 to 3 times book to the S9 provider	Hidden liability (data-breach fine)

Company	CEO persona	Deficit domain	Notable Asset	Gate (key holder)	Liability	Hidden lever	Vulnerability
Harvest Loop	Mission Idealist	Research / Intelligence	Distribution channel: grower collection network	Food Safety Certificate (Government) opens direct Consumer sales	Deferred supplier payment	Hidden buyer: an export-processor card appears with a fleet deal and the certificate	Fragile supply
StackHouse	Dealmaker	Operations	Equipment: server halls	3 ticks of unbroken delivery (Customer desk) open the Enterprise hosting buyer	Compliance gap	Cost lever: an S4 deal drops Energy from Very High to High	Key person (site reliability lead)
Voltway	Growth Maximiser	Research / Intelligence	Equipment: electric van fleet	Transport operating permit (Government) opens the Consumer rides product	Bank loan	Latent asset: depot land worth 2 to 3 times book to the S4 provider	Regulatory exposure (road rule change)
Forgeline	Operator	Product / Build	Equipment: factory line	First batch passes inspection (Customer desk) opens Enterprise bulk orders	Technical debt (Energy)	Multiplier: contracts with other companies pay a premium	Concentration
TrustLayer	Risk Guardian	Brand / Community	IP: threat-detection engine	Approved Auditor status (Government) lets it issue compliance attestations	Key-person risk (lead auditor)	Unlock: 2 clean audits open the regulated Enterprise buyer	Hidden liability (breach warranty)

Notes for writers.

- Mango & Co. and HarvestLoop share one licence type (Food Safety Certificate), so they queue at the same Government desk when both are active. That is intended.
- Two companies with a compliance-gap liability (MediLink, StackHouse) have gates held by the Customer desk, not Government, so no company carries two Government asks at T0.
- TrustLayer's gate is what lets it fill S8 properly: until it is an Approved Auditor, its attestations do not count as the Government licence route, and buyers must wait for it or go to Government themselves.
- Persona repeats (Growth Maximiser, Dealmaker, Operator, Mission Idealist, Risk Guardian) only occur in sets that include the five new companies.

4. Company profiles: the original seven

Each profile is the brief a dossier writer expands; it does not set any VB figure. Resource dependencies are the company's Very High tiers (short by mid-game) and its Low tiers (natural surplus to sell). Founder archetypes describe the founder stories each situation invites. They are flavour for writers and CEO volunteers only, never Founder Ledger hooks (Starting World 13.2).

4.1 SwiftCart

Field	Entry
Industry and model	Quick-commerce. Consumers pay per order; small margin on each basket plus a delivery fee. Sells spare fleet and last-mile runs to other companies.
What it sells	Product Cards: 30-minute basket delivery (Consumer); last-mile delivery run (companies, fills S2). Also spare van capacity at peak-off times (fills S1).
Customers	Consumer segment cards; D2C brands and pharmacies needing last mile (Mango & Co., MediLink).
Starting position	Busiest operation in the city with the thinnest margin. Anchor contract with a Consumer card at the high end of the band, balanced by a deferred payment owed to its grocery supplier.
Advantage	Six dark stores give it the only ready consumer distribution channel; it is the natural partner for anyone shipping to homes.
Weakness	Logistics at Very High runs out around Tick 8. It sells fleet capacity it also needs, so every sale tightens its own supply.
Resource dependency	Short: Logistics (Very High), Infrastructure (High). Long: Compute (Low).
Talent dependency	Finance / Capital (deficit): nobody models unit economics.
Revenue opportunity	Per-tick last-mile contracts with physical companies; renewing the anchor after Tick 6 on better terms.
Growth opportunity	Unlocks with the cold-chain permit: medicine and chilled delivery to MediLink and pharmacy Consumer cards.
Hidden opportunity	Cost lever: a deal with a fleet provider (S1) lowers its Logistics tier one step. Held by Operations staff.
Founder archetypes	Operator who fixes unit economics; Dealmaker who turns the fleet into a logistics-as-a-service business.
Failure mode	Grows order volume to please the anchor, runs out of Logistics and cash together near Tick 8; the anchor leaves (Concentration).
Spin-out paths	Last-mile logistics unit selling S2 to the whole city; a dark-store data product sold to S9 or S12 holders.
Acquisition paths	Acquires: HarvestLoop (secures produce) or Mango & Co. (own-brand goods). Acquired by or merges with: Voltway (one fleet, two customer bases).

4.2 Ledgerly

Field	Entry
Industry and model	Fintech for small business. Takes a fee per transaction; earns interest on short merchant advances once licensed.
What it sells	Payment rails and merchant working capital (fills S7); anonymised transaction datasets (fills S11).

Field	Entry
Customers	Every other company as a merchant; Enterprise cards in retail and services; AI and security firms buying data (PulseAI, TrustLayer).
Starting position	Touches every company's money but holds little of its own. Moderate anchor with an Enterprise merchant; owes chargeback refunds if processing fails in any tick.
Advantage	Sees transaction flows, so it learns which companies are healthy before anyone else. The S7 slot is needed by 8 of 12 companies.
Weakness	Cannot lend until licensed; trust depends on security it does not own (critical dependency S8).
Resource dependency	Short: Data (Very High); Compute, Infrastructure (High). Long: Energy, Logistics, Materials (all Low).
Talent dependency	Growth / Sales (deficit): a strong product with nobody selling it.
Revenue opportunity	Transaction fees from partner companies; data sales to S11 buyers.
Growth opportunity	Unlocks with the payments licence: Merchant Advance, short working-capital loans to other companies in competition with the Bank.
Hidden opportunity	Network effect: each partner company processing through it adds a fixed revenue per tick, capped. Held by Finance staff.
Founder archetypes	Trust-builder who earns licences before scale; Dealmaker who signs up the whole city.
Failure mode	Chases merchant numbers without security cover; the fraud trigger grows its hidden liability and partners leave.
Spin-out paths	Credit-scoring and data unit (S11 seller); a fraud tool that competes with TrustLayer.
Acquisition paths	Merges with TrustLayer (secure payments). Acquires a distressed company's customer list. Natural target for StackHouse or the Investor fund.

4.3 Mango & Co.

Field	Entry
Industry and model	Direct-to-consumer brand of mango-based foods, drinks and lifestyle goods. High gross margin, high marketing spend.
What it sells	Product Cards: branded product boxes (Consumer); co-marketing and community access for other brands (fills S12).
Customers	Consumer segment cards; companies needing an audience (SkillForge, HarvestLoop).
Starting position	Loved brand, no factory. Anchor with a Consumer card; owes refunds if a delivery misses.
Advantage	The only consumer brand and community in the city; Media coverage is cheapest for it.
Weakness	Cannot make its own product (critical dependency S5) or ship it (needs S2); Materials and Logistics both High.
Resource dependency	Short: Logistics, Materials, Data (all High). Long: Compute, Energy, Infrastructure (Medium).
Talent dependency	Operations (deficit): marketers but no supply chain people.
Revenue opportunity	Consumer box sales; selling audience access to SkillForge and HarvestLoop.
Growth opportunity	Unlocks with the Food Safety Certificate: the Enterprise retail-chain buyer.

Field	Entry
Hidden opportunity	Hidden buyer: a held-back retail-chain card appears once it signs a manufacturing deal (\$5). Held by Brand / Community staff.
Founder archetypes	Brand builder who protects the brand under pressure; Partnership founder who builds a supply chain from strangers.
Failure mode	Refuses to discount or partner (Brand Purist bias), misses deliveries, pays refunds; the produce supply fails on a weather event.
Spin-out paths	Community and media unit selling \$12 on its own; a private-label food line.
Acquisition paths	Acquires or merges with HarvestLoop (farm to brand) or Forgeline (owns its factory). Attractive target for SwiftCart (own-brand goods).

4.4 SkillForge

Field	Entry
Industry and model	Edtech and talent marketplace. Learners pay for courses; companies pay a placement fee per hire.
What it sells	Product Cards: placement of a trained hire into a named domain (fills \$10); certified course seats (Consumer, Government).
Customers	Every company with a deficit domain, especially Ledgerly, PulseAI and TrustLayer; Consumer learners; Government skilling programmes.
Starting position	Two-sided marketplace with too few employers. Anchor with an Enterprise card for a corporate training cohort; its lead instructor may leave at a stated tick.
Advantage	Every company starts understaffed in one domain, so every company is a potential customer.
Weakness	Liquidity: needs both learners (\$12 audience) and employers; competes with the Talent Exchange, which is always open.
Resource dependency	Short: Compute, Data (High). Long: Energy, Logistics, Materials (Low).
Talent dependency	Product / Build (deficit): the course platform is half-built.
Revenue opportunity	Placement fees from companies' deficit domains; renewal of the corporate cohort.
Growth opportunity	Unlocks with accreditation: the Government skilling tender.
Hidden opportunity	Network effect: each company that hires through it adds a fixed revenue per tick, capped. Held by Growth / Sales staff.
Founder archetypes	Mission-driven builder; Marketplace operator who solves the chicken-and-egg problem.
Failure mode	Depends on one corporate buyer that leaves (Concentration) while it chases impact over unit economics.
Spin-out paths	Corporate training unit for one sector; an assessment and credentialing service.
Acquisition paths	Merges with PulseAI (AI-led training) or TrustLayer (security training). Acquires a distressed company's staff as an instant learner cohort.

4.5 PulseAI

Field	Entry
Industry and model	B2B AI software. Companies pay a per-tick subscription for forecasting and analytics; Enterprise contracts pay more.
What it sells	Product Cards: demand-forecast or route-optimisation model run (fills S9); Enterprise analytics subscription.
Customers	Seven companies need S9 (SwiftCart, Ledgerly, GreenGrid, MediLink, HarvestLoop, Voltway, SkillForge); Enterprise cards.
Starting position	Best technology in the city, almost no paying customers. Small anchor with an Enterprise pilot; technical debt burns extra Compute every tick.
Advantage	The most demanded slot in the pool: S9 is needed by 7 of 12 companies, so every conversation is a sales lead.
Weakness	Hungriest consumer in the city: Compute and Data both Very High, Energy and Infrastructure High. Enterprise sales are gated by evidence.
Resource dependency	Short: Compute, Data (Very High); Energy, Infrastructure (High). Long: Logistics, Materials (Low).
Talent dependency	Growth / Sales (deficit): engineers who cannot sell.
Revenue opportunity	Small S9 contracts with many companies; datasets bought from S11 make each run better.
Growth opportunity	Unlocks with 2 completed pilots: Enterprise contracts at full budget.
Hidden opportunity	Multiplier: Enterprise contracts pay a stated premium. Held by Research / Intelligence staff.
Founder archetypes	Technical founder learning to sell; Product founder who narrows to one vertical.
Failure mode	Keeps perfecting the model (Product Perfectionist bias) while Compute runs out near Tick 8; the lead ML engineer leaves (Key person).
Spin-out paths	A vertical AI unit (health, logistics or energy forecasting) built around one paying customer.
Acquisition paths	Merges with StackHouse (owns its compute). Acquires a small team for talent (as the drafts' headline example). Target for MediLink or Ledgerly wanting in-house AI.

4.6 GreenGrid

Field	Entry
Industry and model	Climate and energy. Sells energy under per-tick supply contracts and one-off efficiency retrofits; needs capital to build capacity first.
What it sells	Product Cards: energy supply block per tick (fills S4); efficiency retrofit that cuts a buyer's Energy use.
Customers	Energy-heavy companies (StackHouse, Voltway, PulseAI, Forgeline); Government and Enterprise cards.
Starting position	Asset-rich, cash-poor. Strong anchor with an Enterprise energy buyer; the largest Bank loan in the pool, due mid-game.
Advantage	Sole filler of S4, which four companies need and two of them (StackHouse, Voltway) name as their critical dependency.
Weakness	Three Very High resources (Energy, Materials, Infrastructure): the heaviest consumer in the city. Needs panels and batteries made (S5).
Resource dependency	Short: Energy, Materials, Infrastructure (Very High); Logistics (High). Long: Compute, Data (Medium).

Field	Entry
Talent dependency	Finance / Capital (deficit): big projects, nobody to raise for them.
Revenue opportunity	Long energy contracts with S4 buyers; retrofits sold to any company.
Growth opportunity	Grid Expansion: unlocks Bank project finance once it holds 2 signed offtake contracts.
Hidden opportunity	Unlock: green certification opens the Government tender buyer. Held by Operations staff.
Founder archetypes	Capital raiser who pre-sells capacity; Infrastructure builder who sequences risk.
Failure mode	Builds before it sells, misses the loan repayment; a subsidy rule change (Regulatory exposure) cuts its margin.
Spin-out paths	EV charging unit (natural partner for Voltway); an efficiency consulting unit.
Acquisition paths	Merges with Voltway (energy plus fleet) or StackHouse (green data centre). Acquires Forgeline to own its supply.

4.7 MediLink

Field	Entry
Industry and model	Health marketplace. Takes a fee per consultation and pharmacy order; sells anonymised outcome data once compliant.
What it sells	Product Cards: telehealth consultation and pharmacy order (Consumer); verified health dataset (fills S11).
Customers	Consumer segment cards; hospitals (Enterprise, after its gate); AI and security firms buying data (PulseAI, TrustLayer).
Starting position	Trusted by patients, distrusted by regulators. Moderate anchor with a Consumer health card; a compliance gap stops it selling data to regulated buyers.
Advantage	The cleanest dataset in the city: worth far more to an AI provider than its book value.
Weakness	Data at Very High; cannot sell data or reach hospitals until it fixes security (critical dependency S8) and its compliance gap.
Resource dependency	Short: Data (Very High); Compute, Infrastructure (High). Long: Energy, Logistics, Materials (Medium).
Talent dependency	Brand / Community (deficit): no one to earn patient and hospital trust.
Revenue opportunity	Consultation and pharmacy fees; data sales to S11 buyers once compliant.
Growth opportunity	Unlocks with 3 verified deliveries: the Enterprise hospital buyer.
Hidden opportunity	Latent asset: its dataset is worth 2 to 3 times book to the S9 provider (PulseAI). Held by Research / Intelligence staff.
Founder archetypes	Regulated-market navigator; Trust builder who turns compliance into a selling point.
Failure mode	Sells data before it is secure; the breach-fine trigger grows its hidden liability.
Spin-out paths	A diagnostics AI unit built on the dataset; a pharmacy delivery unit (with SwiftCart).
Acquisition paths	Merges with PulseAI (health AI) or TrustLayer (compliant data). Its dataset makes it the most valuable acquisition target for an AI company.

5. Company profiles: the five supply-side companies

The five new companies each sell what the original seven lack, so their profiles lean on the buyers they serve. They are sealed in reserve whenever they are not active (Starting World 4.4), so every profile also notes how it plays when drawn as a new venture.

5.1 HarvestLoop

Field	Entry
Industry and model	AgriTech supply. Buys from a grower network, sells produce and bio-materials to businesses by the batch; earns on volume and freshness.
What it sells	Product Cards: fresh produce batch (companies, fills S6); bio-material batch for manufacturing (fills S6).
Customers	Forgeline (bio-materials), Mango & Co. (ingredients), SwiftCart (grocery stock); Consumer cards after its gate.
Starting position	Plenty of stock, little time to sell it. Anchor with an Enterprise food buyer; a deferred payment to its seed and fertiliser supplier falls due early.
Advantage	Sole filler of S6; three companies need it, and Forgeline cannot run without it.
Weakness	Perishable in story: its Product Card has a high units-per-tick cap and a low floor price, so capacity it does not sell in a tick is simply lost (no special rule). Materials at Very High; needs fleet (critical S1).
Resource dependency	Short: Materials (Very High); Logistics (High). Long: Compute (Low).
Talent dependency	Research / Intelligence (deficit): no demand forecasting, so it over-harvests.
Revenue opportunity	Standing per-tick supply deals with S6 buyers.
Growth opportunity	Unlocks with the Food Safety Certificate: direct Consumer sales.
Hidden opportunity	Hidden buyer: an export-processor card appears once it has a fleet deal and the certificate. Held by Operations staff.
Founder archetypes	Supply-chain operator; Impact founder balancing growers' livelihoods with margin.
Failure mode	Holds out for price while stock spoils; a weather event breaks its supply (Fragile supply) before the deferred payment is cleared.
Spin-out paths	Cold-chain logistics unit; a farm-yield data product for S9 or S11 buyers.
Acquisition paths	Acquired by Mango & Co. or SwiftCart (vertical integration). Merges with Forgeline (materials to factory).
As a new venture	Works well: the founders hold a grower list and must find the first buyer within 2 ticks.

5.2 StackHouse

Field	Entry
Industry and model	Cloud and data-centre hosting. Sells compute capacity per tick; profit depends on how much of its halls are rented.
What it sells	Product Cards: hosted compute block per tick (fills S3); dedicated server for regulated buyers (after its compliance gap clears).

Field	Entry
Customers	PulseAI, Ledgerly, SkillForge, TrustLayer; Enterprise hosting cards.
Starting position	Halls built, half empty. Small anchor with an Enterprise tenant; a compliance gap blocks regulated tenants until Government licenses it.
Advantage	Sole filler of S3, needed by four companies; PulseAI and TrustLayer name it as critical.
Weakness	Energy and Infrastructure both Very High and Compute High: it pays to keep empty halls running. Depends on energy (critical S4).
Resource dependency	Short: Energy, Infrastructure (Very High); Compute (High). Long: Logistics, Materials (Low).
Talent dependency	Operations (deficit): too few people to run the halls.
Revenue opportunity	Filling halls with S3 tenants on per-tick contracts.
Growth opportunity	Unlocks with 3 ticks of unbroken delivery: the Enterprise hosting buyer.
Hidden opportunity	Cost lever: an energy deal (S4) lowers its Energy tier one step. Held by Finance / Capital staff.
Founder archetypes	Infrastructure seller who trades price for volume; Dealmaker bundling hosting with security.
Failure mode	Discounts to fill halls below its own energy cost; the site reliability lead leaves (Key person) and delivery breaks.
Spin-out paths	Managed-security unit (bundled with TrustLayer); an edge-hosting unit for physical companies.
Acquisition paths	Merges with PulseAI (AI cloud) or GreenGrid (green data centre). Acquires Ledgerly for a captive tenant.
As a new venture	Harder: a 25-unit start leaves little capacity to sell, so the founders must pre-sell before they can deliver.

5.3 Voltway

Field	Entry
Industry and model	Electric fleet and mobility. Rents vans with drivers by the tick to businesses; runs consumer rides once permitted.
What it sells	Product Cards: fleet capacity block per tick (fills S1); consumer ride (after its gate).
Customers	SwiftCart (peak capacity), HarvestLoop (perishable runs), Forgeline (factory freight); Consumer cards after its gate.
Starting position	Large fleet, idle half the day. Anchor with an Enterprise freight buyer; a vehicle loan from the Bank due mid-game.
Advantage	Main filler of S1, the critical dependency of SwiftCart and HarvestLoop. Its depot land is worth far more to an energy company than its book value.
Weakness	Energy at Very High: the fleet runs on GreenGrid's power (critical S4). Competes with SwiftCart for S1 buyers.
Resource dependency	Short: Energy (Very High); Logistics (High). Long: Compute, Materials, Data, Infrastructure (Medium).
Talent dependency	Research / Intelligence (deficit): no route or demand intelligence, so vans sit idle.
Revenue opportunity	Per-tick fleet contracts with S1 buyers.
Growth opportunity	Unlocks with the transport operating permit: the Consumer rides product.

Field	Entry
Hidden opportunity	Latent asset: its depot land is worth 2 to 3 times book to the S4 provider (GreenGrid), as a charging site. Held by Operations staff.
Founder archetypes	Asset-sweating operator; Growth founder who adds routes faster than demand.
Failure mode	Expands the fleet ahead of contracts and misses the loan; a road rule change (Regulatory exposure) suspends consumer rides.
Spin-out paths	Charging network unit (with GreenGrid); a fleet-management software unit.
Acquisition paths	Merges with GreenGrid (energy plus fleet) or SwiftCart (one fleet). Acquires a distressed physical company's routes.
As a new venture	Works: the founders start with a small fleet and must sell its first capacity block.

5.4 Forgeline

Field	Entry
Industry and model	Contract manufacturing. Makes other companies' physical products by the run; needs minimum volumes to cover its fixed line.
What it sells	Product Cards: manufacturing run (fills S5); spare line time sold by the tick.
Customers	Mango & Co. (product boxes), GreenGrid (panels and batteries); Enterprise bulk orders after its gate.
Starting position	Idle factory, one customer. Anchor with an Enterprise buyer for one product line; old machines burn extra Energy every tick (technical debt).
Advantage	Sole filler of S5; both its buyers (Mango & Co., GreenGrid) name manufacturing as their critical dependency.
Weakness	Materials at Very High; needs raw materials (critical S6) and freight (S1, S4). One customer leaving halves its order book.
Resource dependency	Short: Materials (Very High); Energy (High). Long: Compute, Data (Low).
Talent dependency	Product / Build (deficit): no engineers to adapt the line to new products.
Revenue opportunity	Manufacturing runs for S5 buyers; selling spare line time.
Growth opportunity	Unlocks when its first batch passes inspection: Enterprise bulk orders.
Hidden opportunity	Multiplier: contracts with other companies pay a stated premium. Held by Growth / Sales staff.
Founder archetypes	Operations founder who protects quality; B2B seller who fills the order book.
Failure mode	Waits for orders instead of selling; the anchor leaves (Concentration) and the line stands idle with fixed costs.
Spin-out paths	A prototyping studio for new ventures; an own-brand product line.
Acquisition paths	Acquired by Mango & Co. or GreenGrid (own the factory). Merges with HarvestLoop (materials to finished goods).
As a new venture	Harder: a factory with no orders; the founders must sign a run before the 2-tick deadline.

5.5 TrustLayer

Field	Entry
Industry and model	Cybersecurity and compliance software. Sells monitoring by the tick and one-off audits; its pitch is preventing a loss that has not happened yet.
What it sells	Product Cards: security monitoring per tick and compliance audit (fills S8); compliance attestation once an Approved Auditor.
Customers	Ledgerly, MediLink, PulseAI, StackHouse; regulated Enterprise cards.
Starting position	Credible product, hard to sell before an incident. Anchor with an Enterprise monitoring buyer; its lead auditor may leave at a stated tick.
Advantage	Sole filler of S8, the critical dependency of both Ledgerly and MediLink; every regulated company needs it.
Weakness	Data at Very High; depends on hosting (critical S3). Selling prevention is slow, and a client breach lands on its warranty.
Resource dependency	Short: Data (Very High); Compute (High). Long: Energy, Logistics, Materials (Low).
Talent dependency	Brand / Community (deficit): no one to make the case for prevention.
Revenue opportunity	Monitoring contracts with S8 buyers; audits sold before regulated deals close.
Growth opportunity	Unlocks with Approved Auditor status: issuing attestations that clear other companies' compliance gaps.
Hidden opportunity	Unlock: 2 clean audits open the regulated Enterprise buyer. Held by Research / Intelligence staff.
Founder archetypes	Trust builder; Fear-free seller who sells outcomes, not threats.
Failure mode	Over-promises protection to win deals; a client breach triggers its warranty (Hidden liability).
Spin-out paths	Security training unit (with SkillForge); a fraud-detection unit sold to Ledgerly.
Acquisition paths	Merges with Ledgerly (secure payments) or StackHouse (secure hosting). Acquires MediLink's compliance team if MediLink fails.
As a new venture	Works: low resource needs suit a 25-unit start; the founders must land one audit within 2 ticks.

6. Inter-company dependency map

With all 12 active there are 48 supplier-to-buyer relationships covering 12 critical dependencies, and every company is both a buyer and a supplier. The map is derived entirely from Starting World 11.2; both dossiers in a pair must describe the same relationship from opposite sides.

6.1 Who buys from whom

Read across a row for what a company sells and to whom; read down a column for what a company needs. An asterisk marks the buyer's critical dependency.

Supplier ↓ / Buyer →	SWC	LED	MAN	SKF	PAI	GRG	MED	HVL	STH	VLT	FRG	TRL
SwiftCart (SWC)	—		S2				S2	S1*			S1	
Ledgerly (LED)	S7	—	S7	S7	S11	S7	S7	S7	S7	S7		S11
Mango & Co. (MAN)			—	S12*				S12				
SkillForge (SKF)		S10		—	S10							S10
PulseAI (PAI)	S9	S9		S9	—	S9	S9	S9		S9		
GreenGrid (GRG)					S4	—			S4*	S4*	S4	
MediLink (MED)					S11		—					S11
HarvestLoop (HVL)	S6		S6					—			S6*	
StackHouse (STH)		S3		S3	S3*				—			S3*
Voltway (VLT)	S1*							S1*		—	S1	
Forgeline (FRG)			S5*			S5*					—	
TrustLayer (TRL)		S8*			S8		S8*		S8			—

SkillForge (S10) can also sell into any company's deficit domain, beyond the three that name it; those sales are open play, not map relationships.

6.2 What flows on each slot

Slot	Supplier when active	Buyers	What the buyer gets	Fallback (standard terms)
S1 Fleet capacity	Voltway first, SwiftCart second	SwiftCart (from Voltway only), HarvestLoop, Forgeline	Vans and drivers for a number of delivery units per tick; lowers the buyer's Logistics draw	Logistics Provider
S2 Last mile	SwiftCart	Mango & Co., MediLink	Home delivery of product units within the tick	Logistics Provider
S3 Compute hosting	StackHouse	PulseAI, TrustLayer (critical); Ledgerly, SkillForge	Compute units per tick on contract, below Bank	Supplier Market (Compute)

Slot	Supplier when active	Buyers	What the buyer gets	Fallback (standard terms)
			price	
S4 Energy	GreenGrid	StackHouse, Voltway (critical); PulseAI, Forgeline	Energy units per tick on contract, or a retrofit that cuts use	Bank or Supplier Market (Energy)
S5 Manufacturing	Forgeline	Mango & Co., GreenGrid (both critical)	A manufacturing run turning Materials into deliverable product units	Supplier Market (Materials), finished goods at a premium
S6 Raw materials and produce	HarvestLoop	Forgeline (critical); Mango & Co., SwiftCart	Produce or bio-material batches per tick	Supplier Market (Materials)
S7 Payments and finance	Ledgerly	8 companies (all but PulseAI, Forgeline, TrustLayer)	Payment processing, then Merchant Advances once licensed	Bank
S8 Security and compliance	TrustLayer	Ledgerly, MediLink (critical); PulseAI, StackHouse	Monitoring, audits, then attestations that count toward a licence	Government licence route
S9 AI and analytics	PulseAI	SwiftCart, Ledgerly, GreenGrid, MediLink, HarvestLoop, Voltway, SkillForge	A model run that improves one decision (routes, demand, credit, care)	Talent Exchange specialist
S10 Trained talent	SkillForge	Ledgerly, PulseAI, TrustLayer	A placed hire in a named domain	Talent Exchange
S11 Verified datasets	MediLink, Ledgerly	PulseAI, TrustLayer	Data units of verified quality	Supplier Market (Data)
S12 Consumer audience	Mango & Co.	SkillForge (critical), HarvestLoop	Featured access to Mango's community: Consumer leads	Media

Tie-break for two-supplier slots. S1: Voltway is the primary filler and SwiftCart the secondary, so SwiftCart never holds a memorandum with itself. S11: MediLink and Ledgerly compete as equals; no buyer names S11 as critical, so no memorandum depends on it.

6.3 Memoranda of understanding at T0

Every company starts with exactly one non-binding memorandum (Starting World 7.4, as amended here). It goes to the filler of the company's critical slot when that filler is active. If it is not, the memorandum goes to the filler of the first other needed slot, in the order listed in Starting World 11.2, that an active company fills. Both dossiers must carry the matching half. The table below is the Full 12 case; section 8 gives the smaller sets.

Buyer	Needs (critical slot)	Memorandum with, when active
SwiftCart	S1 Fleet capacity	Voltway
Ledgerly	S8 Security	TrustLayer
Mango & Co.	S5 Manufacturing	Forgeline
SkillForge	S12 Consumer audience	Mango & Co.

Buyer	Needs (critical slot)	Memorandum with, when active
PulseAI	S3 Compute hosting	StackHouse
GreenGrid	S5 Manufacturing	Forgeline
MediLink	S8 Security	TrustLayer
HarvestLoop	S1 Fleet capacity	Voltway, else SwiftCart
StackHouse	S4 Energy	GreenGrid
Voltway	S4 Energy	GreenGrid
Forgeline	S6 Raw materials	HarvestLoop
TrustLayer	S3 Compute hosting	StackHouse

Five suppliers are each the critical dependency of two companies: GreenGrid, TrustLayer, StackHouse, Voltway and Forgeline. Forgeline is the most exposed, since its only two buyers both depend on it critically. Losing any of the five mid-game is the city's biggest single shock.

6.4 Resource trade: who is short and who is long

Resource units also move between companies outside the slots. Heavy users run short by mid-game; Low-tier users hold surplus to sell above the Bank's 60% buy-back.

Resource	Very High (short first)	High	Low (natural sellers)
Compute	PulseAI	Ledgerly, SkillForge, MediLink, StackHouse, TrustLayer	SwiftCart, HarvestLoop, Forgeline
Energy	GreenGrid, StackHouse, Voltway	PulseAI, Forgeline	Ledgerly, SkillForge, TrustLayer
Logistics	SwiftCart	Mango & Co., GreenGrid, HarvestLoop, Voltway	Ledgerly, SkillForge, PulseAI, StackHouse, TrustLayer
Materials	GreenGrid, HarvestLoop, Forgeline	Mango & Co.	Ledgerly, SkillForge, PulseAI, StackHouse, TrustLayer
Data	Ledgerly, PulseAI, MediLink, TrustLayer	Mango & Co., SkillForge	Forgeline
Infrastructure	GreenGrid, StackHouse	SwiftCart, Ledgerly, PulseAI, MediLink	none (Medium: Mango & Co., SkillForge, HarvestLoop, Voltway, Forgeline, TrustLayer)

Two pressure points stand out. Data has four Very High users and one Low seller (Forgeline), so S11 sellers and the Supplier Market's Data line are the tightest market in a Full 12 run. Infrastructure has no Low-tier seller at all, so it is bought from the Bank or from Medium-tier companies willing to run down their stock.

7. Competition, partnership and merger map

Every company has at least one rival, one natural partner and one plausible merger. All of it runs on the shared M&A, spin-out and deal rules; the pairs below only tell writers which stories to seed so the city's deals feel inevitable rather than random. Where a profile and this section differ, this section wins.

7.1 Rivals

Rivals	What they fight over	When it bites
SwiftCart vs Voltway	The same S1 fleet buyers (HarvestLoop, Forgeline)	Whenever both are active; SwiftCart is also Voltway's buyer, so they are rivals and partners at once
Ledgerly vs MediLink	S11 data buyers (PulseAI, TrustLayer)	City 10 and Full 12
SwiftCart, Mango & Co., MediLink, SkillForge, HarvestLoop, Voltway	Consumer customer cards on the Customer desk	Every run; HarvestLoop and Voltway join after their gates
PulseAI, StackHouse, TrustLayer, Forgeline, SkillForge	Enterprise customer cards	Every run; most join after their gates
GreenGrid vs SkillForge	Government tender budget	After each one's unlock
Mango & Co. vs HarvestLoop	The same Food Safety Certificate queue at Government	When both are active
GreenGrid, StackHouse, Voltway	Scarce Energy units (all three Very High)	From about Tick 6 in any set with two of them
Ledgerly, PulseAI, MediLink, TrustLayer	Scarce Data units (all four Very High)	From about Tick 6 in City 10 and Full 12

Every slot filler also competes with its own institution fallback (section 6.2): Ledgerly with the Bank, SkillForge with the Talent Exchange, StackHouse with the Supplier Market. The company must beat the fallback on price, speed or capacity to win the deal.

7.2 Natural partnerships

Partners	The deal	What it unlocks
SwiftCart + MediLink	Chilled medicine delivery on the S2 slot	SwiftCart's cold-chain Growth Opportunity; MediLink's verified deliveries toward its hospital gate
GreenGrid + Voltway	Energy for the fleet; charging on Voltway's depot	Voltway's cost base; Voltway's latent asset; a joint charging spin-out
StackHouse + TrustLayer	Hosting plus security sold as one bundle	Regulated tenants for StackHouse; recurring monitoring for TrustLayer
PulseAI + MediLink	Dataset for model runs	MediLink's latent asset; better PulseAI pilots toward its Enterprise gate
Mango & Co. + SkillForge	Community access for learner sign-ups	SkillForge's critical dependency; S12 revenue for Mango
Forgeline + Mango & Co.	Manufacturing runs for product boxes	Mango's hidden buyer; Forgeline's company-contract premium
HarvestLoop + Voltway	Fleet for perishable runs	HarvestLoop's critical dependency and half of its hidden-buyer condition
Ledgerly + HarvestLoop	Merchant Advance against standing produce contracts	HarvestLoop's working capital; Ledgerly's first licensed loan

7.3 Mergers and acquisitions

Pair	Kind	Logic
SwiftCart + Voltway	Horizontal	One fleet, two customer bases; ends the S1 rivalry
SwiftCart acquires HarvestLoop	Vertical	Owens its grocery supply
SwiftCart acquires Mango & Co.	Vertical	Own-brand goods for its baskets
Ledgerly + TrustLayer	Vertical	Secure payments; clears Ledgerly's critical dependency for good
StackHouse acquires Ledgerly	Vertical	A captive tenant with heavy Compute and Infrastructure needs
Mango & Co. + HarvestLoop	Vertical	Farm to brand
Mango & Co. or GreenGrid acquires Forgeline	Vertical	Owens the factory both depend on
HarvestLoop + Forgeline	Vertical	Materials to finished goods
PulseAI + StackHouse	Vertical	AI company that owns its compute
PulseAI + MediLink	Vertical	Health AI built on the dataset
PulseAI + SkillForge	Adjacent	AI-led training and placement
GreenGrid + Voltway	Vertical	Energy plus fleet
GreenGrid + StackHouse	Vertical	Green data centre
MediLink + TrustLayer	Vertical	Compliant health data
SkillForge + TrustLayer	Adjacent	Security training

Distressed companies are also acquisition targets for anyone under the standard rules; these pairs are the ones the stories should make tempting. Every company appears in at least two pairs.

8. How the map degrades in smaller sets

The default Core 7 fills only 1 of its 7 critical dependencies with another active company; the other six meet that need at an institution, and their memoranda move to their next needed slot so every company still starts with one. Every set still passes the Starting World checklist, but company-to-company dependency rises sharply as the five new companies are added.

Set	Critical dependencies filled by a company	Memoranda moved to the next needed slot	Slots with no active filler
Core 7	1 of 7: SkillForge ← Mango & Co.	SwiftCart ← Ledgerly (S7), Ledgerly ← PulseAI (S9), Mango & Co. ← SwiftCart (S2), PulseAI ← GreenGrid (S4), GreenGrid ← Ledgerly (S7), MediLink ← SwiftCart (S2)	S3, S5, S6, S8

Set	Critical dependencies filled by a company	Memoranda moved to the next needed slot	Slots with no active filler
Supply-chain 7	3 of 7: SwiftCart ← Voltway, HarvestLoop ← Voltway, ForgeLine ← HarvestLoop	Voltway ← Ledgerly (S7), Ledgerly ← PulseAI (S9), PulseAI ← SkillForge (S10), SkillForge ← Ledgerly (S7)	S3, S4, S8, S12
City 10	8 of 10: adds Ledgerly and MediLink ← TrustLayer, PulseAI and TrustLayer ← StackHouse, StackHouse and Voltway ← GreenGrid	Mango & Co. ← SwiftCart (S2), GreenGrid ← Ledgerly (S7)	S5, S6
Full 12	12 of 12 (section 6.3)	None	None

What this means on the day. In Core 7 the city still works: every company has 2 or more non-critical slots filled by other companies, so they must still trade with each other. But six companies meet their most urgent need at a desk, which shifts early traffic to the Supplier Market, Logistics Provider and Government. Those desks need full staffing in a Core 7 run.

Unfilled slots are new-venture openings. In Core 7, a new venture that draws StackHouse, ForgeLine, HarvestLoop or TrustLayer from the reserve lands in an unfilled slot with buyers waiting. The draw stays random (Starting World 4.5), so this is luck, not design; the GM Handbook can note it.

9. Consistency rules for the 12 dossiers

A dossier is consistent with this catalogue when every relationship in section 6 reads the same from both sides and every condition still works when the other company is in reserve.

1. **Slots, not names.** Dependencies, leads and memoranda are written against slots ("a compute host"). Company names appear only in the GM-only notes of a dossier.
1. **Both sides of every edge.** For each filled cell in 6.1, the supplier's Product Card lists "company (Sx)" as an eligible buyer type, and the buyer's dossier lists Sx among its needed slots.
1. **Matching memoranda.** Each pair in 6.3 carries the same one-line need in both dossiers, phrased from each side.
1. **Beat the fallback.** A Product Card that fills a slot must beat that slot's fallback on at least one of price, speed or capacity, or no one will buy it.
1. **Conditions survive reserve.** Any lever, gate or Growth Opportunity condition that names a slot is met by a deal with whoever fills it, company or institution fallback, so it still works in Core 7. The company version should be the better deal, not the only one.
1. **Facts point the right way.** Private fact 2 (the market behind a dependency slot) must agree with the filler's own dossier, for example PulseAI's fact that the city's compute host has idle capacity matches StackHouse's half-empty halls. Rumours (fact 3) may be false.
1. **Latent assets need a reason to buy.** MediLink's dataset (worth more to S9) and Voltway's depot (worth more to S4) are matched by one clue in the PulseAI and GreenGrid dossiers that hints at the value without naming the seller.
1. **Starting numbers stay in bands.** No dossier changes a price, rate, tier, threshold or template slot. Rich anchors are balanced by heavier liabilities through the Strategic Adjustment, and the SPV check lands each company at 25,000 to 31,000 VB.

1. **Write suppliers first.** Writing the five supply-side dossiers and Ledgerly, PulseAI and SkillForge (the widest suppliers) before the others means buyers can quote their suppliers' Product Cards.
1. **Final cross-check.** Before the dossiers are released, re-tick every cell of 6.1 and every row of 6.3 against the finished dossiers.

10. Open points for the GM

One decision amends a Starting World rule; the rest are defaults this catalogue picked and can be changed without touching anything else.

Decided: memoranda when the critical supplier is inactive. If a company's critical slot has no active filler, its memorandum goes to the filler of its first other needed slot that is active (section 6.3). Every company in every set now starts with one memorandum. This amends Starting World 7.4, which gave a memorandum only for the critical slot; Starting World itself has not been edited.

Defaults chosen here, open to change.

- Mango & Co. is a mango-based food, drink and lifestyle brand, which makes HarvestLoop its natural supplier.
- Mango & Co. and HarvestLoop share one Food Safety Certificate queue.
- All default picks in section 3 (persona, deficit domain, asset, gate, liability, lever, vulnerability).
- Voltway is the primary S1 filler and SwiftCart the secondary.
- Supply-chain 7 has only one Regulated company (Ledgerly). It passes the checklist, but Government will be quiet; adding TrustLayer as an eighth company (61 to 75 participants) adds a second Regulated company and fills Ledgerly's critical dependency. Swapping TrustLayer in for SkillForge does not work: TrustLayer would have only one needed slot filled and fail the checklist.

Venture City: Starting World Master Design

Oct 5, 2026 · @Nero Kami

1. Purpose and scope

This document fixes the state of Venture City at T0, the moment the city opens (the "10:00 state"), for any run with 7 to 12 active companies drawn from a pool of 12. It decides the structure every company is built from, the formulas that set starting numbers, and who can see what. It does not write the companies themselves: that is the job of the Starting Companies Master Catalogue and the 12 Company Dossiers, which must be written by reference to this document.

What this document inherits and does not redesign. The philosophy ("the rules are fixed, the world is not"), the four-layer world model, the six resources, Venture Bucks as money rather than score, the 30-minute economic tick, the institution roster and their behaviour, the Human Internet, the Founder Ledger's evidence-only observation, the core player loop and the Investor Day format all come from the existing drafts unchanged.

What this document adds.

- The 12-company pool, how the Game Master picks an active set, and how reserve dossiers are used mid-game.
- One starting-package template that every company fills in the same way.
- Formulas that derive starting cash and capacity from headcount and turnout, so nothing assumes 7 companies.
- A visibility policy for every starting object, written as data fields the platform can enforce.
- The cross-company dependency map, written as role slots so it works whichever companies are active.

Numbers. Every VB amount, price, rate and count below is an illustrative starting parameter for playtesting, consistent with the drafts' existing placeholders. The structure is meant to be fixed; the numbers are meant to be tuned.

How later documents use this one.

Document	Takes from this document
Starting Companies Master Catalogue	Pool roster, archetypes, resource profiles, dependency slots, selection rules
Company Dossiers (12)	Starting-package template, bands each number must sit inside, visibility tags
Company Passport Packs and Role Cards	Role domains, signatory rules, what each participant knows at T0
Core Game Systems	Starting contracts, liabilities and opportunities

Document	Takes from this document
	that the live mechanics act on
Institution Operating Content	Each institution's T0 posture, inventory and capacity formulas
GM Handbook	Active-set selection checklist, scaling table, reserve-dossier procedure

2. Design principles

The governing principle is **one rulebook, many starting positions**: every company plays by identical rules, and only its story, its starting numbers and its flavour differ.

2.1 One rulebook (the uniformity rule)

The following are identical for every company, in every run, and no dossier may override them:

- Resource types, Bank base prices, dynamic-pricing rules and purchase limits.
- The salary ladder, level progression and the 30-minute tick sequence.
- Institution products, eligibility rules, loan bands and terms.
- Deal, contract, auction, mission and opportunity mechanics, including evidence and verification.
- Failure, distress, recovery, acquisition, merger and spin-out rules.
- Information classes and visibility rules.
- Scoring dimensions and Founder Ledger signals.

A dossier may vary only these five things:

What varies	How it varies	Limit
Story and flavour	Name, sector, history, CEO persona, language	Free, within the city's tone
Starting numbers	Cash, headcount mix, contract sizes, liability sizes	Must sit inside the bands in section 6 and 7
Consumption profile	One tier (Low, Medium, High, Very High) per resource	Tiers and their per-tick rates are shared
Capabilities	Which products or services the company can sell	Written on the shared Product Card schema
Hidden mechanics	Parameters of mechanic types from the shared catalogue	Exactly one lever and one vulnerability per company

The test for any new rule: if it only makes sense for one company, it is not a rule. It becomes a parameter of a shared rule, or it is cut. This keeps volunteers, the platform and participants working from one set of rules, and lets any dossier be swapped in or out of a run without rewriting anything else.

2.2 Different problems, comparable strength

Companies should start with different strategic problems, not different odds. Two shared yardsticks enforce this: every company's zero-revenue runway sits in the same band (section 6.2), and every company's Starting Position Value sits within $\pm 10\%$ of the run's benchmark (section 6.6). A rich company carries heavier obligations; a poor one carries a better lever.

2.3 Nothing assumes 7

Starting cash, institution inventories, fund sizes, logistics capacity and the number of live opportunities are all derived from headcount and the number of active companies (section 12). No document after this one may hardcode a company count.

2.4 Dependencies point at roles, not names

A dossier never says "SwiftCart depends on Voltway". It says "SwiftCart depends on a fleet-capacity provider", and the active set decides who fills that slot. If no active company fills it, a named institution does, at standard terms (section 11). This is what makes any subset of the 12 playable.

2.5 Every object carries a visibility tag

Every starting object (a fact, a contract, an objective, a mechanic) is stored with an explicit visibility class and holder, following the Technology doc's rule that privacy is never left to someone's memory (section 10).

2.6 People content is company-agnostic

Participant identities, personal objectives, personal information cards and Founder Ledger observation are generic and drawn from shared pools. None of it depends on which company a participant lands in, so a participant who moves company, or a company that is swapped out, breaks nothing.

2.7 Inherited principles that shape the start

- The dossier starts the game; it does not solve it. The information needed to win lives in the city.
- Every company starts with at least one problem it cannot solve alone.
- Participants should have something to do, someone to talk to, or a decision to make from minute one.

3. The city at T0

At T0 every participant is employed by a company, every company is solvent and operating, every institution is visible but not yet trading, and the first economic tick has not run. The city is a working economy paused one breath before the market opens.

3.1 The four layers at T0

Layer	State at T0
Companies	7 to 12 active companies, each with cash, staff, 100 units of each resource, one anchor contract, one supplier agreement, one liability and its

Layer	State at T0
	dossier
City (institutions)	Bank, Investor, Customers, Talent Exchange, Suppliers, Logistics, Government and Media staffed and posted, with T0 postures and inventories (section 9); the Investor fund is closed
Market	Bank base prices in force, all sector demand indices at 100, no auctions open, the first missions and opportunities seeded but mostly undiscovered
World	No events active; the run's event schedule, crisis library and hidden opportunities are loaded and held by the GM

Underneath all four, the Founder Ledger is open and empty.

3.2 The opening sequence

The start runs in three steps, matching the Event Foundation timeline.

1. **City opens (T0).** Orientation at company stations: welcome, company reveal, meeting the team, reading the Founder Dossier on the platform, envelopes and personal items, signatory election. 35 minutes, 09:30–10:05.
2. **Human Internet I.** No internet. Phones may stay out, but the GM's toggle preset locks the platform to read-only: each participant sees only their own Founder Dossier, role card and objective. Only personal cards are printed, for trading on paper Trade Slips. Participants find information, people and leads by talking. 30 minutes, 10:05–10:35.
3. **Market opens (Tick 1 starts).** Institutions begin trading, company cash and resources can move, and the tick clock starts.

3.3 What can and cannot happen before the market opens

The pre-market window exists for discovery, so money and resources stay still while information moves.

Action	Before Market Open	From Tick 1
Talk, trade information, make introductions	Yes	Yes
Spend personal wallet VB (for example, buying a fact)	Yes	Yes
Agree a company deal	Yes, recorded as Proposed	Yes
Settle company cash or resources	No	Yes

Action	Before Market Open	From Tick 1
Institution transactions	No (enquiries only)	Yes
Salary payments and resource consumption	No	Yes, at each tick
Level progression	No	Yes, from Tick 1

Levels start counting at Tick 1 rather than at registration, so a participant who arrives late in registration is not behind before play begins.

3.4 Core loop (canonical wording)

The drafts carry two near-identical phrasings. This document fixes the participant loop as: **Understand → Find a person → Find an opportunity → Negotiate → Act → Record → Consequence → Discover the next opportunity**. The company loop stays: **Capital + People + Resources + Information → Capability → Customer → Revenue → Reinvestment → Growth or survival**.

4. The company pool

Venture City keeps a standing pool of 12 company dossiers; for each run the Game Master activates a subset (7 by default, up to 12 for large turnout), and the rest stay in reserve as the source of mid-game new ventures. Participants never choose: they are randomly assigned within the active set, and new-venture teams are randomly assigned a reserve dossier.

4.1 The 12 companies

The first seven come from the existing drafts. The five new ones fill the gaps those seven leave: a food and materials supplier, a compute host, a fleet operator, a manufacturer and a trust provider. Each is something the original seven need to buy.

Company	Archetype	Core challenge	Cluster	Origin
SwiftCart	Quick-commerce and logistics	Operations and unit economics	Physical	Existing
Ledgerly	Fintech, SMB payments	Trust and distribution	Digital, Regulated	Existing
Mango & Co.	D2C consumer brand	Demand generation	Physical	Existing
SkillForge	Edtech and talent marketplace	Marketplace liquidity	Digital	Existing
PulseAI	B2B AI SaaS	Enterprise sales	Digital	Existing
GreenGrid	Climate and energy	Capital-intensive growth	Physical, Regulated	Existing

Company	Archetype	Core challenge	Cluster	Origin
MediLink	Health marketplace	Trust and regulation	Digital, Regulated	Existing
HarvestLoop	Agri-tech, farm-to-business supply	Perishable stock and working capital	Physical	New
StackHouse	Cloud and data-centre hosting	Utilisation and energy cost	Digital	New
Voltway	EV fleet and mobility	Asset-heavy, idle capacity	Physical	New
Forgeline	Contract manufacturing	Minimum volumes and order flow	Physical	New
TrustLayer	Cybersecurity and compliance SaaS	Selling prevention before an incident	Digital, Regulated	New

4.2 Resource consumption profiles

All companies hold the same 100 units of each resource at T0 (inherited). They differ only in the tier at which each resource is consumed. The first seven rows are carried over from the drafts unchanged.

Company	Compute	Energy	Logistics	Materials	Data	Infrastructure
SwiftCart	Low	Medium	Very High	Medium	Medium	High
Ledgerly	High	Low	Low	Low	Very High	High
Mango & Co.	Medium	Medium	High	High	High	Medium
SkillForge	High	Low	Low	Low	High	Medium
PulseAI	Very High	High	Low	Low	Very High	High
GreenGrid	Medium	Very High	High	Very High	Medium	Very High
MediLink	High	Medium	Medium	Medium	Very High	High
HarvestLoop	Low	Medium	High	Very High	Medium	Medium
StackHouse	High	Very High	Low	Low	Medium	Very High
Voltway	Medium	Very High	High	Medium	Medium	Medium

Company	Compute	Energy	Logistics	Materials	Data	Infrastructure
Forgeline	Low	High	Medium	Very High	Low	Medium
TrustLayer	High	Low	Low	Low	Very High	Medium

The per-tick rate behind each tier is shared and set in section 6.4.

4.3 Choosing the active set

The GM picks the number of companies from turnout (section 12), then picks which ones. Any combination is allowed if it passes this checklist, which keeps every resource contested and every company needed by someone.

- ☐ Every resource has at least 2 companies consuming it at High or Very High (buyers competing).
- ☐ Every resource has at least 2 companies consuming it at Low or Medium (natural sellers of surplus).
- ☐ At least 2 Physical and 2 Digital companies are active.
- ☐ At least 1 Regulated company is active, so Government matters.
- ☐ Every active company has at least 2 of its dependency slots filled by other active companies (section 11).
- ☐ One volunteer CEO is available per active company.

Four ready-made sets that pass the checklist (checked on paper, not yet playtested):

Set	Companies	Use when
Core 7	SwiftCart, Ledgerly, Mango & Co., SkillForge, PulseAI, GreenGrid, MediLink	Default; matches all existing drafts
Supply-chain 7	SwiftCart, HarvestLoop, Forgeline, Voltway, Ledgerly, PulseAI, SkillForge	A run focused on operations and physical markets
City 10	Core 7 plus StackHouse, Voltway, TrustLayer	85 to 100 participants
Full 12	All 12	100+ participants, or a deliberately crowded market

4.4 Reserve dossiers

Inactive dossiers stay sealed for the whole run. Their names and stories are not shown to participants, so a reserve company has no history in the city when it appears. Reserve dossiers serve two purposes only.

1. **Overflow at registration.** If turnout exceeds the planned active set, the GM activates the next company on a pre-agreed reserve order before T0, never after.
2. **New ventures mid-game.** When participants found a new company, they are assigned a reserve dossier at random (section 4.5).

A failed company's dossier is never returned to the reserve: its assets, customers and staff are already in play.

4.5 Starting a new venture from a reserve dossier

Once the Founder Window is open, a team that wants to found a new company follows the inherited charter, with the reserve dossier supplying the business model and capability.

1. The team meets the charter: 3 or more participants, 10,000 VB in committed personal capital or resources, a named founder agreement, and one resource agreement.
2. The GM confirms the charter first, then draws a reserve dossier at random. The draw comes after commitment so teams cannot fish for a favourite.
3. The new company starts in **founder mode**: the dossier's story, business model, capabilities, consumption profile, private objective, hidden lever and hidden vulnerability apply in full.
4. Its starting package is reduced: cash is the founders' committed capital only, resources are 25 units of each type released from Bank inventory, there is no anchor contract, and the dossier's first lead becomes its starting lead.
5. It must record one customer or letter of intent within 2 ticks, or it enters Distressed under the standard rules.
6. A participant founder runs it; no volunteer CEO is assigned.

If the reserve is empty, the team uses the blank Starting Package template from section 7 under the same rules. A team that wants to take an existing product line out of its current employer uses the spin-out route instead, which transfers parent assets and does not draw a dossier.

5. Starting participants and company roles

Every participant starts as an employee at Level 0 in a randomly assigned company, with an identical personal starting kit; nobody starts as a founder, a free agent or a CEO.

5.1 The participant at T0

Field	T0 value	Same for everyone?
Participant ID and badge	Issued at registration	Yes
Company	Randomly assigned within the active set	Rule yes, outcome random
Role domain	Assigned to fill the company's workforce mix	Rule yes
Level	L0 (counting starts at Tick 1)	Yes

Field	T0 value	Same for everyone?
Salary	L0 rate, 100 VB per tick	Yes
Personal wallet	1,000 VB	Yes
Capability tags	2 to 3, self-declared from the inherited list: Sell, Research, Build, Design, Analyse, Negotiate, Operate, Create content, Recruit, Organise	Yes
Personal objective	1, drawn from the shared pool	Yes
Personal information card	1, drawn from the shared pool	Yes
Employment status	Active	Yes

The 1,000 VB personal wallet is a deliberate addition: without it, nobody could pay for information during Human Internet I, which runs before the first salary.

5.2 Assignment to companies

Companies stay within one person of each other in headcount at all times during registration.

1. Each new registrant is assigned to the active company with the fewest staff; ties are broken at random.
2. Their domain is the company's least-filled required domain (section 5.3). A stated preference is used only to break a tie between equally open domains.
3. Participants who arrive after Market Open join the smallest company at the current state, with no catch-up grants (inherited late-arrival rule).

Balanced random assignment matters more than pure random assignment: with 50 to 100 people, pure random can produce a 4-person and a 12-person company, which no dossier can balance.

5.3 Role domains and workforce mixes

The seven inherited domains are Product/Build, Growth/Sales, Operations, Research/Intelligence, Finance/Capital, Brand/Community and Generalist/Founder. To avoid tuning 12 different mixes, each dossier picks one of three shared workforce mixes.

Domain	Tech-led	Ops-led	Market-led
Product / Build	30%	10%	15%
Growth / Sales	20%	20%	25%
Operations	10%	30%	10%
Research / Intelligence	15%	10%	10%
Finance / Capital	10%	10%	10%

Domain	Tech-led	Ops-led	Market-led
Brand / Community	5%	10%	20%
Generalist / Founder	10%	10%	10%
Default companies	Ledgerly, PulseAI, MediLink, StackHouse, TrustLayer	SwiftCart, GreenGrid, HarvestLoop, Voltway, Forgeline	Mango & Co., SkillForge

Built-in deficit. Every dossier names one deficit domain. Its requirement is set above what assignment fills, by 15% of headcount (minimum 1 person). Every company therefore opens with exactly one understaffed function and a reason to recruit, and the size of the gap scales with the company.

5.4 Roles inside a company

Role	Who	Authority at T0
CEO	One volunteer per active company	Strategy, hiring decisions, company relationships; plays the dossier's persona
Authorised Signatories	2 participants, chosen by the staff during orientation	Approve company spending; any single payment over 5,000 VB needs the CEO or both signatories
Employees	Everyone else	Act, negotiate and propose deals on the company's behalf; deals settle once a signatory approves

The signatory election is the first leadership decision of the day and the Founder Ledger's first observation point. If the CEO volunteer leaves the city (an inherited mechanic), the two signatories run the company jointly.

5.5 CEO personas

Each dossier assigns its CEO one persona from a shared list rather than a bespoke character. A persona card carries one belief, one red line and one bias, never a script.

Persona	Belief	Red line	Bias
Growth Maximiser	Customers first, profit later	Won't cut acquisition spend	Overspends on growth
Risk Guardian	Evidence before money	No credit without proof	Misses fast opportunities
Brand Purist	The brand is the asset	Won't discount	Undervalues

Persona	Belief	Red line	Bias
			partnerships
Product Perfectionist	Build it right, then sell	Won't sell vapourware	Ships late
Operator	Systems beat heroics	Won't take orders it can't fulfil	Avoids bold bets
Dealmaker	Every problem is a deal	Won't walk away from a table	Overcommits
Mission Idealist	Impact is the point	Won't take "dirty" money	Ignores unit economics

The persona belongs to the company, not to the volunteer. If a volunteer is swapped on the day, the replacement picks up the same card and nothing else changes.

6. Starting capital, employees, resources and assets

Starting cash is computed at registration close from each company's actual headcount, so a 7-person company and a 12-person company face the same runway; dossiers set only a bounded adjustment on top.

6.1 Salary ladder (inherited, all companies)

Level	L0	L1	L2	L3	L4	L5+
Salary per tick (VB)	100	150	225	325	450	600

Levels rise every tick in the same domain from Tick 1. Salary stops rising at L5; levels above L5 still count for Workforce Credit and the record.

6.2 Starting cash

Every company's T0 cash is set by one formula:

$$\text{Cash}_{T0} = (\text{Headcount} \times 2,450) + 10,000 + \text{Strategic Adjustment}$$

- **Payroll reserve (headcount × 2,450 VB)** is one person's salary for the first 7 ticks (100 + 150 + 225 + 325 + 450 + 600 + 600).
- **City base (10,000 VB)** is the same for every company.
- **Strategic Adjustment** is set by the dossier, between -5,000 and +10,000 VB, and is the balancing term for section 6.6.

At 8 to 10 staff this lands between about 25,000 and 45,000 VB, inside the drafts' 30,000 to 50,000 band once adjustments are applied.

Runway target. With its anchor contract and liability payments running and no new revenue, every company must be able to pay staff for 7 to 9 ticks. A run has roughly 12 ticks between Market Open and

the freeze, so every company has to find new revenue, finance or a deal by mid-game. Dossier writers check this with the standard runway calculation; the platform recomputes it at registration close.

6.3 Starting employees

Headcount comes from balanced assignment (section 5.2), so it is within one person across companies. All staff start at L0 in their assigned domain, with one deficit domain per company.

6.4 Starting resources and consumption

Every company holds 100 units of each of the six resources at T0 (inherited). Baseline consumption is charged at each tick by tier; products also consume resources when delivered, at the rate on their Product Card.

Tier	Units per tick	100 units last	First runs out (no purchases)
Very High	14	about 7 ticks	Around Tick 8, mid-game
High	10	10 ticks	Around Tick 11, late game
Medium	7	about 14 ticks	Only if deliveries add load
Low	4	25 ticks	Effectively never: a tradable surplus

This is the engine of the inter-company market: every company is short on its Very High and High resources and long on its Low and Medium ones.

Thresholds (same for every company and resource).

Stock	Effect
30 units	Warning on the company dashboard
15 units	Product deliveries needing this resource cost 25% more of it
0 units	Deliveries needing it stop; baseline shortfall is logged
0 for 2 ticks (High or Very High resource)	Company enters Distressed

6.5 Starting assets

Every company starts with the same set of asset slots, filled with different content.

- **Capabilities: 1 or 2 Product Cards.** Each card uses the shared schema: what the buyer gets, delivery unit, resource cost per unit, units deliverable per tick, list price and floor price, eligible buyer types, and any licence required.
- **One Notable Asset,** from the shared asset types: brand, prototype, customer list, licence, equipment, IP, distribution channel or dataset. It has a book value of 3,000 to 8,000 VB. The Bank lends against it on its standard asset-backed terms.
- **The 100-unit resource stock** described above, worth 12,500 VB at Bank base prices.

6.6 Starting Position Value

Starting Position Value (SPV) is the fairness check that lets dossiers differ without one company starting ahead.

$$\text{SPV} = \text{Cash} - \text{Payroll reserve} + \text{Resources at base price} + \text{Asset book value} + \text{Anchor contract value} - \text{Liability outstanding}$$

The payroll reserve is removed so headcount does not distort the comparison. **Every dossier must land its SPV between 25,000 and 31,000 VB** (a 28,000 VB benchmark $\pm 10\%$), using the Strategic Adjustment to balance a rich contract against a heavy liability, or a weak asset against extra cash.

Worked example (illustrative, not a real dossier). A 9-person company with a +2,000 adjustment starts with 34,050 VB cash. Its SPV is 10,000 + 2,000 + 12,500 resources + 5,000 asset + 6,000 anchor contract – 7,000 loan = 28,500 VB, inside the band.

7. Starting customers, suppliers, contracts and constraints

Every company starts with the same commercial skeleton: one anchor customer that expires at midday, three leads, one supplier deal that expires early, one liability and one critical dependency. Only the contents differ.

7.1 The Starting Package template

Each dossier fills in this template exactly; no slot may be left empty and none may be added.

Slot	Count	Shared rule	Band the dossier picks inside
Anchor contract	1	With an institution customer; pays per tick for Ticks 1 to 6, then comes up for renewal on the Customer desk's standard terms; needs product deliveries each tick	4,000 to 8,000 VB total value; 1 to 3 delivery units per tick
Leads	3	Lead 1 is named in the dossier; Leads 2 and 3 are signals only (a sector and a need, no	Leads point at institution customers or at dependency slots

Slot	Count	Shared rule	Band the dossier picks inside
		name)	
Supplier agreement	1	With the Supplier Market or Logistics Provider, on one of the company's High or Very High resources; capacity-capped; expires at Tick 4 unless renewed with a volume commitment	10% to 20% below Bank base price; 10 to 20 units per tick cap
Liability	1	Drawn from the shared liability types (7.3)	4,000 to 10,000 VB, or the equivalent burden
Critical dependency	1	Written as a role slot with an institution fallback (section 11)	Which slot; which resource or capability it supplies
Deficit domain	1	15% of headcount understaffed (section 5.3)	Which domain
Gate	1	One product, buyer type or opportunity is locked behind a licence, certification or evidence threshold held by an institution	Which product; which institution holds the key

The two early expiries are deliberate. The supplier deal lapsing at Tick 4 and the anchor contract lapsing after Tick 6 put every company under commercial pressure at the same point in the day, whatever its story.

7.2 Starting customers

Customers at T0 are institution-held customer cards, not other companies.

- **Anchor customers.** One card per active company, held by the Customer desk and already contracted.
- **Open customer cards.** The Customer desk starts with 2 open cards per active company, split between Enterprise and Consumer segment cards, each tagged with a sector, budget, must-have and deadline (the inherited customer request card). They are visible only to someone who visits the desk or holds a lead.

- **Held-back cards.** A further set is loaded but hidden, for release by event, mission or opportunity.

Companies become each other's customers through play, starting from the dependency map.

7.3 Shared liability types

Type	How it bites	Cleared by
Bank loan	Fixed repayment due at a stated tick (Tick 4 to 8)	Paying it; refinancing on standard Bank terms
Deferred supplier payment	Lump sum owed to a supplier at Tick 3 to 5; supplier agreement suspends if missed	Paying it; renegotiating
Refund obligation	Anchor customer is owed a refund if delivery misses in any tick	Delivering on time
Technical debt	One resource consumed +3 units per tick	Completing a fix mission or buying a fix from another company
Compliance gap	One product cannot be sold to regulated buyers	Obtaining the relevant licence from Government
Key-person risk	One named role domain loses a person at a stated tick unless retained	A retention deal (salary or role)

7.4 Starting contracts between companies

No binding contracts exist between companies at T0, because the active set changes from run to run. Instead each dossier names one **conditional relationship**: if the company filling its primary dependency slot is active, both start with a recorded, non-binding memorandum of understanding naming the need. It creates no obligation; it gives two teams a reason to find each other in the first hour.

7.5 Starting constraints

Every company starts with the same five constraints, filled differently: its consumption profile, its deficit domain, its critical dependency, its gate and its liability. Together they make sure every company has at least one problem it cannot solve alone, which the drafts require.

8. Starting opportunities and initial market conditions

The market opens calm and symmetric: base prices, demand at 100 everywhere, no shortages and no events, so that every later change is visibly caused by play or by the Game Master.

8.1 Opportunities at T0

Kind	Count at T0	Visible to	Source
Growth Opportunity	1 per company	Company, with its unlock condition	The dossier's Growth Opportunity slot; locked until a stated condition is met (a contract won, a licence held, a tick reached)
City opportunities	Scaled to the active set (section 12)	Mostly nobody yet; found through people, desks or missions	Drawn from the shared library (O01 to O20)
Held-back opportunities	The rest of the run's selection	GM only	Released by trigger or schedule
Hidden-lever triggers	1 per company	GM, plus the company role named in the dossier	The company's hidden mechanic (section 10.4)

8.2 Missions at T0

Missions stay generic. A dossier never contains its own missions; instead each mission in the shared library carries sector and constraint tags, and at T0 the GM activates:

- a public board of $N + 1$ missions open to anyone (8 at $N = 7$), and
- one **first mission** per company, picked from the library by matching the company's gate or critical dependency tags.

This keeps the library usable whichever companies are active, and stops a reserve company's missions sitting unused.

8.3 Initial market conditions

Variable	T0 value	Who sees it
Bank sell prices (VB per unit)	Compute 20, Energy 15, Logistics 20, Materials 15, Data 25, Infrastructure 30	Public
Bank buy-back price	60% of base, cash on settlement	Public
Resource price index	100 for all six resources	Public
Sector demand index	100 for every sector; scales customer card budgets	Public
Talent market value	100 for every domain	Public

Variable	T0 value	Who sees it
Credit posture	Standard: working-capital loans need revenue, a contract or a qualifying asset	Public summary; detailed criteria held by the Bank
Logistics capacity	Standard and priority capacity at full, scaled to the active set (section 12)	Public headline; exact remaining capacity held by Logistics
Active events and shortages	None	Public

The Bank buy-back is a new proposal. It puts a floor under surplus resources so Low-tier stock is worth something, while keeping private trades more attractive than the Bank in both directions, as the drafts require.

8.4 Information conditions

At T0 the information environment is deliberately thin and uneven. Public knowledge is the city map, institution names, base prices and the participant ruleset. Everything else (customer needs, supplier capacity, other companies' problems, upcoming changes) sits with a company, a person, an institution or the GM, and moves only through Human Internet I and later play.

9. Initial institutional state

All institutions are staffed and visible at T0 but only take enquiries until Market Open; the Investor fund and the grant pool stay closed until their later windows. Every inventory and pool is a formula of N, the number of active companies, so the city's scarcity holds at 7, 10 or 12.

Institution	Opens	T0 posture	T0 inventory or capacity
Bank	Market Open	Standard credit policy; inherited loan bands (5,000 / 10,000 / 20,000 VB, emergency)	Resource stock $40 \times N$ units of each type, restocked by $10 \times N$ per tick; lending pool $8,000 \times N$ VB
Investor / Venture Fund	Capital window (GM-scheduled)	Closed; criteria published only when it opens	Fund $14,000 \times N$ VB (98,000 at $N = 7$, matching the drafts' 100,000); at most $\lceil N \times 0.7 \rceil$ investments (5 at $N = 7$)
Customer desk (Enterprise and Consumer)	Market Open	Standard procurement: proposal, evidence, price	N anchor cards (contracted), $2 \times N$ open cards, plus held-

Institution	Opens	T0 posture	T0 inventory or capacity
			back cards
Talent Exchange	Market Open	Job board empty; no shortages declared	N specialist contracts (outside talent for hire by the tick), spread across scarce domains
Supplier Market	Market Open	Volume discounts on minimum orders of 20 units	One supplier per resource, each $20 \times N$ units per tick at 10% below Bank base, less what starting agreements reserve
Logistics Provider	Market Open	Standard pricing; surge pricing off	Standard $15 \times N$ units per tick, priority $7 \times N$ per tick (about 100 and 50 at $N = 7$, as drafted)
Government / Regulator	Market Open	Licences on application; tenders not yet announced	One licence type per gate present in the active set; grant pool $3,000 \times N$ VB, closed until its window
Media	Market Open	Standard price list; no viral events	Featured-story slots: 1 per tick
Game Master / City Control	T0	Holds all hidden state	Event schedule, crisis library, held-back cards and opportunities, hidden-mechanic triggers, rumour register

What institutions know at T0. Each institution holds its own rules and inventory, the identities of the companies it already has contracts with, and nothing about any company's hidden mechanic, private objective or cash position unless that company tells it. An institution volunteer must not be briefed on company secrets, which keeps the drafts' rule that volunteers never leak private information easy to follow.

Staffing. One volunteer CEO per active company, plus institution desks staffed on the Event Operations model (about 20 roles in total at $N = 7$). Several desks may share one volunteer; their rules stay separate.

10. Information model: what is public, what is hidden, who knows what

Every piece of starting information is a data record with an explicit visibility class and holder, and at T0 no single person, company or institution can see the whole picture; the GM alone holds everything.

10.1 The information record

Every fact, rumour, clue, objective and mechanic is stored with the same fields, so the platform can enforce visibility and the GM can trace provenance.

Field	Meaning
ID	Unique reference
Statement	What the holder reads
Kind	Fact, clue, rumour, objective or mechanic
Truth status	True, partly true or false (GM-only field)
Visibility class	One of the classes in 10.2
Holders	Who can see it now (participant, company, role, institution)
Provenance	Where it came from
Tradable	Whether the holder may sell or share it
Release trigger	Time or condition that changes its visibility
Expiry	When it stops being true or useful
Links	Companies, contracts, cards or events it refers to

10.2 Visibility classes

These merge the drafts' Game Engine matrix and Technology visibility engine into one list.

Class	Who can see it
Public	Everyone
Company	All staff of one company
Company leadership	That company's CEO and signatories
Company role	Staff of one company in one named domain
Personal	One participant
Institution	One institution's volunteers

Class	Who can see it
Hidden (GM)	GM only, until released
Time-released	Becomes Public at a trigger
Observer	Founder Ledger observers and evaluation team only

10.3 Who knows what at T0

Starting object	Class at T0	Held by
Company public profile (name, sector, products, headline story)	Public	Everyone
Starting state (cash, resources, contracts, staff)	Company	That company
Public objective	Company	That company
Private objective	Company leadership	CEO only at T0; CEO may share with signatories
Hidden lever	Company role	Staff in the domain the dossier names (not the CEO), plus GM
Hidden vulnerability	Hidden (GM)	GM; the company holds one clue to it
Critical dependency	Company	That company
Gate	Company and Institution	That company and the institution holding the key
Liability	Company and Institution	That company and the creditor institution
Anchor contract	Company and Institution	That company and the Customer desk
Leads	Company	That company
Personal objective	Personal	One participant
Personal information card	Personal	One participant
Open customer cards	Institution	Customer desk
Institution rules and inventory	Institution (headline Public)	That institution
Event schedule, crises, held-	Hidden (GM)	GM

Starting object	Class at T0	Held by
back cards		
Founder Ledger	Observer	Observers and evaluation team

Putting the hidden lever with one domain rather than the CEO is deliberate: the company only learns its best move if its people talk to each other.

10.4 Hidden mechanics catalogue

Hidden mechanics are where the drafts allowed company-specific rules, and where over-personalisation is most likely to break balance. So every company takes exactly one lever and one vulnerability, each a parameterised instance of a shared type.

Lever type	Effect
Cost lever	A deal with a named dependency slot lowers one resource's tier by one step
Unlock	A licence or evidence threshold opens a higher-budget buyer type
Multiplier	Contracts with one buyer type pay a stated premium
Latent asset	The Notable Asset is worth 2 to 3 times book value to one dependency slot
Hidden buyer	A held-back customer card appears when a condition is met
Network effect	Each additional partner company adds a fixed revenue per tick, capped

Vulnerability type	Effect
Concentration	The anchor customer leaves at a stated tick unless a condition is met
Fragile supply	The supplier agreement fails if a named event fires
Hidden liability	The liability grows by a stated amount on a trigger
Key person	One domain loses a person at a stated tick unless retained

Vulnerability type	Effect
Regulatory exposure	A product is suspended if a named rule change fires

A lever's best-case value is capped at 15,000 VB equivalent and a vulnerability's worst case at 10,000 VB equivalent, so no secret decides the day on its own.

10.5 Starting information distribution

In each dossier: the company brief (public and private parts), 3 private facts (one about its own business, one about the market behind a dependency slot, one rumour that may be false), and 1 clue to its vulnerability.

Personal information cards: each participant gets 1 card from a shared pool of four kinds: market intel, company intel, institution intel and rumour. Company-intel cards are written as templates against role slots and resolved by the platform at T0 to whichever active company fills the slot.

Distribution rules.

- A card about a company never goes to that company's own staff.
- Every active company is the subject of cards held by at least 3 outsiders, spread across at least 2 other companies.
- Across the pool, about 60% of cards are true, 25% partly true and 15% false. Truth status is never shown to the holder.

These rules make Human Internet I worth doing: most of what a company needs to know about itself is in other companies' pockets.

11. Relationships, dependencies, bottlenecks and asymmetries

Companies are tied together through 12 role slots: each company needs some slots filled and can fill others, and every slot has an institution fallback, so any active set produces a web of needs without any dossier naming another company.

11.1 Role slots

Slot	Filled by (when active)	Institution fallback	Typically needed by
S1 Fleet and delivery capacity	Voltway, SwiftCart	Logistics Provider	SwiftCart, HarvestLoop, Forgeline
S2 Consumer fulfilment and last mile	SwiftCart	Logistics Provider	Mango & Co., MediLink
S3 Compute hosting	StackHouse	Supplier Market (Compute)	PulseAI, Ledgerly, SkillForge, TrustLayer
S4 Energy supply and efficiency	GreenGrid	Bank or Supplier Market (Energy)	PulseAI, StackHouse, Voltway, Forgeline

Slot	Filled by (when active)	Institution fallback	Typically needed by
S5 Manufacturing	Forgeline	Supplier Market (Materials)	Mango & Co., GreenGrid
S6 Raw materials and produce	HarvestLoop	Supplier Market (Materials)	Forgeline, Mango & Co., SwiftCart
S7 Payments and merchant finance	Ledgerly	Bank	SwiftCart, Mango & Co., SkillForge, GreenGrid, MediLink, HarvestLoop, Voltway, StackHouse
S8 Security and compliance	TrustLayer	Government (licence route)	Ledgerly, MediLink, PulseAI, StackHouse
S9 AI and analytics	PulseAI	Talent Exchange specialist	SwiftCart, Ledgerly, GreenGrid, MediLink, HarvestLoop, Voltway, SkillForge
S10 Trained talent and hiring	SkillForge	Talent Exchange	Every company's deficit domain; named by Ledgerly, PulseAI, TrustLayer
S11 Verified datasets	MediLink, Ledgerly	Supplier Market (Data)	PulseAI, TrustLayer
S12 Consumer audience and community	Mango & Co.	Media	SkillForge, HarvestLoop

A fallback always works, but at standard institution terms: slower, capacity-capped or more expensive than a well-negotiated deal with a company. That gap is the reason to go and find the company.

11.2 Each company's slots

Company	Critical dependency	Other slots it needs	Slots it fills
SwiftCart	S1 Fleet capacity	S6, S7, S9	S1, S2
Ledgerly	S8 Security and compliance	S3, S9, S10	S7, S11
Mango & Co.	S5 Manufacturing	S2, S6, S7	S12
SkillForge	S12 Consumer audience	S3, S7, S9	S10

Company	Critical dependency	Other slots it needs	Slots it fills
PulseAI	S3 Compute hosting	S4, S8, S10, S11	S9
GreenGrid	S5 Manufacturing	S7, S9	S4
MediLink	S8 Security and compliance	S2, S7, S9	S11
HarvestLoop	S1 Fleet capacity	S7, S9, S12	S6
StackHouse	S4 Energy	S7, S8	S3
Voltway	S4 Energy	S7, S9	S1
Forgeline	S6 Raw materials	S1, S4	S5
TrustLayer	S3 Compute hosting	S10, S11	S8

Every company fills at least one slot, so every company is someone's supplier. In the Core 7, each company has 2 or more of its slots filled by other active companies; its unfilled slots (S3, S5, S8 and others) fall back to institutions and become natural spots for a new venture to fill.

11.3 City-wide bottlenecks at T0

Bottleneck	Why it binds	Scales with
Very High resources	Run out around Tick 8 for whoever consumes them	Bank stock $40 \times N$
Logistics capacity	Physical companies and fallback deliveries share one provider	$15 \times N$ standard per tick
Specialist talent	Every company has a deficit domain; outside specialists number N	N specialist contracts
Investor capital	At most $\lceil N \times 0.7 \rceil$ investments	$14,000 \times N$ VB fund
Licences	Every gate needs an institution decision	Government processing per tick
Desk time	50 to 100 people, about 9 desks	Staffing model

11.4 Built-in asymmetries

Asymmetry	How T0 creates it	What keeps it fair
Information	Facts about each company sit with outsiders	Every company gets the same number of cards about it
Resources	Low-tier companies hold surplus	Identical 100-unit stock and

Asymmetry	How T0 creates it	What keeps it fair
	that High-tier ones need	shared tier rates
Capital	Strategic Adjustment varies cash	SPV band of 25,000 to 31,000 VB
Access	Gates and regulated status differ	Every company has exactly one gate
Talent	Deficit domains differ	Every gap is 15% of headcount
Timing	None: expiries are identical on purpose	Same Tick 4 and Tick 6 pressure points for all

12. Scaling for 7, 10 or 12 active companies

The GM sets N, the number of active companies, from turnout so that each company has 7 to 10 staff; every city-level quantity is then read off the formulas below.

12.1 Choosing N from turnout

Expected participants	Active companies (N)	Staff per company
50 to 60	7	7 to 9
61 to 75	7 or 8	8 to 10
76 to 90	8 to 10	8 to 10
91 to 110	10 to 12	8 to 10

Hard limits: never fewer than 6 or more than 12 staff per company at T0. Below 6 a company cannot cover its workforce mix; above 12 people stand idle at the station.

12.2 City quantities by N

Quantity	Formula	N = 7	N = 10	N = 12
Bank stock per resource at Tick 1	$40 \times N$	280	400	480
Bank restock per resource per tick	$10 \times N$	70	100	120
Bank lending pool (VB)	$8,000 \times N$	56,000	80,000	96,000
Investor fund (VB)	$14,000 \times N$	98,000	140,000	168,000
Maximum	$\lceil N \times 0.7 \rceil$	5	7	9

Quantity	Formula	N = 7	N = 10	N = 12
investments				
Open customer cards at T0	$2 \times N$	14	20	24
Talent Exchange specialist contracts	N	7	10	12
Supplier capacity per resource per tick	$20 \times N$	140	200	240
Logistics standard capacity per tick	$15 \times N$	105	150	180
Logistics priority capacity per tick	$7 \times N$	49	70	84
Grant pool (VB)	$3,000 \times N$	21,000	30,000	36,000
City opportunities live at T0	$\lceil N \div 2 \rceil + 1$	5	6	7
Public missions at T0	$N + 1$	8	11	13
Media featured slots per tick	1, or 2 when $N \geq 10$	1	2	2

Founder Ledger observers scale with people rather than companies: one per 25 participants, which gives the drafts' 2 to 4 at 50 to 100.

12.3 What does not scale

Prices, salary ladder, tier rates, thresholds, loan bands, charter requirements, the Starting Package template and the SPV band are identical at every N. Scaling changes how much of the city there is, never how it works.

13. Handoff to the dossiers

A dossier writer should be able to fill every field below from this document without deciding anything structural; whatever remains open is listed at the end as a playtest lever or a question for the event owner.

13.1 What every dossier must contain

- ☐ Public profile: name, archetype, sector, cluster, headline story
- ☐ Private brief: history, business model, current problems

- ☐ Consumption profile (section 4.2) and workforce mix (5.3), plus the named deficit domain
- ☐ CEO persona from the shared list (5.5)
- ☐ Strategic Adjustment, with the SPV calculation showing 25,000 to 31,000 VB (6.6) and the runway check showing 7 to 9 ticks (6.2)
- ☐ 1 or 2 Product Cards and 1 Notable Asset (6.5)
- ☐ Starting Package: anchor contract, 3 leads, supplier agreement, liability, critical dependency, gate (7.1)
- ☐ Conditional relationship with its primary dependency slot (7.4)
- ☐ Public objective, private objective and Growth Opportunity with its unlock condition
- ☐ One hidden lever and one hidden vulnerability from the catalogue, with parameters inside the caps, and the domain that holds the lever (10.4)
- ☐ 3 private facts and 1 vulnerability clue (10.5)
- ☐ Founder-mode variant: what changes if this dossier is drawn as a new venture (4.5)
- ☐ A visibility class on every item

13.2 What stays generic, and why

On the question of whether founder observation can be generic: yes, and it should be. The Founder Ledger already records behaviour against signals (initiative, ownership, commercial instinct and the rest) that mean the same thing in any company. Adding company-specific observation hooks would reward participants for fitting their company's script rather than for founder behaviour, and would bias results toward whichever companies had richer hooks. Companies will still surface different behaviours; that is fine as long as observers record what happened, not how well it suited the company.

The same reasoning applies across the design:

Content	Generic (shared)	Personalised (per company)
Founder observation and awards	Signals, evidence rules, award list	Nothing
Personal objectives	Shared pool by objective type	Nothing
Personal information cards	Templates resolved against role slots	Nothing
Missions	Shared library with sector and constraint tags	Which first mission matches the company's tags
Events and crises	Shared library; per-company hits drawn by tag	Which tags a company carries
Final objectives	Shared objective types at equal difficulty	Which type a company receives
CEO personas	Shared list	Which persona
Hidden mechanics	Shared lever and vulnerability types	Parameters inside caps

Content	Generic (shared)	Personalised (per company)
Investor Day	One submission format for all	The story told
Story, numbers, flavour	Template and bands	Everything inside the bands

Where too much personalisation causes problems.

- **Volunteer swaps.** A bespoke CEO character or company rule lives in one volunteer's head and is lost when they are replaced.
- **Unused content.** Company-specific missions and crises are wasted whenever that company sits in reserve, which with 12 dossiers and 7 active is 5 companies in every run.
- **Untestable balance.** Twelve bespoke rule sets across hundreds of possible active sets cannot be playtested; twelve parameter sets on one rulebook can be checked with one formula.
- **Perceived unfairness.** Participants who discover another company plays by different rules will blame the rules, not their decisions.
- **Mobility friction.** A participant who changes company should not have to learn a new rulebook.
- **Platform cost.** Every bespoke rule is code and a visibility policy; every parameter is a field.
- **Leaks.** The more secrets a company has, the more ways volunteers can give one away.

13.3 Conflicts in the drafts, and how this document resolves them

Conflict	Resolution here
Early draft: participants pick companies through a labour market with Free Agent Cards	Superseded by random assignment (later drafts); the capability list survives as self-declared tags
Exactly 7 companies by name	A pool of 12 with an active set of 7 to 12, at the event owner's request
10 volunteers versus the 20+ role Event Operations model	Event Operations model, with one CEO per active company
Observer count of 5 to 6 versus 2 to 4	One per 25 participants, giving 2 to 4
Technology doc: company-specific rules as configurable flags	Narrowed to parameters of the shared mechanic catalogue
Two phrasings of the core loop	Fixed in section 3.4
26-phase doc: no resigning into unemployment, no firing; Game Engine: a free-agent state exists	Not a T0 question, since everyone starts employed; left for the Core Game Systems document to settle

13.4 Playtest levers

These numbers are new in this document and should be the first ones tuned: tier consumption rates (4, 7, 10, 14), the 7 to 9 tick runway band, the 28,000 VB SPV benchmark, the 1,000 VB personal wallet, the 60% Bank buy-back, the 15% deficit gap, the lever and vulnerability caps, the 60/25/15 truth mix on information cards, and every coefficient in section 12.2.

13.5 Defaults chosen, open to change

- The five new companies (HarvestLoop, StackHouse, Voltway, Forgeline, TrustLayer) and their archetypes.
- Levels and salaries start at Tick 1, not at registration.
- The hidden lever is held by one domain, not the CEO.
- New-venture teams commit their charter before the dossier draw, with no redraw.

2026-10-05 (owner decision after the complexity audit). City Opens runs 35 minutes (09:30–10:05) and Human Internet I 30 minutes (10:05–10:35); Market Open stays 10:35. Human Internet I is no longer device-free: the platform is locked to read-only own Founder Dossier, role card and objective, and only personal cards are printed.

Venture City - Technology Platform Specification v2

Oct 5, 2026 · @Nero Kami

1. Summary

Oct 10 runs on the web platform. Build it in three tiers (section 5) with a Friday-noon go/no-go per module, so anything not ready drops to its already-printed paper route instead of putting the day at risk. Sections 6 to 9 are the developer spec; section 10 covers hardening after the event.

- **Biggest finding:** the finished documents assume far more software than the original Technology section did. They name "the platform" about 180 times, for jobs from auto-verifying evidence to resolving crisis targets and generating Frozen Snapshots. Section 4 lists the 34 mechanics this adds.
- **Drift (section 2):** the Technology section knew nothing of the 12-company pool and City 10, N-scaling, the 12-step settlement order, RV and cap-table maths, evidence classes E1 to E5, the institution catalogues, the exposure-based crisis targeting, the graded information economy, the objective deal, the Founder Ledger rules or the Investor Day scoring.
- **Overbuilt (section 3):** self-serve M&A forms, a recruiting site, a 10-stage sales funnel, a VC pipeline, a notification service, three analytics dashboards, a content editor and WebSockets. Cutting them is what makes five days possible.
- **Oct 10 plan (section 5):** Tier A (ledger, settlement, desks, deals, dashboards, portal home, GM Console with feature toggles and GM lanes, snapshots) Monday to Wednesday; Tier B (investor with booking board, deal templates, whisper sender, missions, objectives, auctions, dashboard digest, info cards, crisis ranking) as time allows; observer view now Tier C; volunteers train on the real platform Thursday; code freeze Friday 12:00.
- **Developer spec (sections 6 to 9):** data model, journal rules, settlement pseudo-code and formulas, interface feature lists and the visibility matrix.
- **Decided (section 11):** physical VB notes and tokens are dropped, the platform runs on a local server at the venue, and the developer on call staffs a participant helpdesk.
- **Added 5 Oct after the complexity audit (D3, D6 to D11):** GM Console feature toggles with Dark, Closed-net and Open-net presets enforced on the server (Tier A, because the Human Internet I read-only rule depends on them); five GM accounts with lanes and a shared ruling log (Tier A); a company dashboard with runway, resource lines and deadlines (Tier A) plus value against start, objective layers and a last-tick digest (Tier B); an investor booking board and ceiling display, desk cross-desk history and a Media inbox, a deal builder, and a whisper and signal sender. Section 5 says what moved to Tier B and C to pay for them.

2. Drift: what the finished documents changed

The original Technology section was written against a generic game (7 fixed companies, 30 events, "crisis C1 to C4", a CRM-style sales funnel). The 14 finished documents replaced almost every one of those assumptions with exact rules, and the biggest drift is the reverse of what you would expect: **the finished documents assume far more platform than the Technology section did.** They name "the platform" about 180 times (auto-verify E1 evidence, reserve bid cash, resolve crisis targets, deal

objectives, generate snapshots). Each of those needs either code or a named human with a spreadsheet on Oct 10.

2.1 World structure

Area	Technology section assumed	Now locked in	Source
Companies	7 starting companies, "seven company dossiers"	Pool of 12; GM picks an active set (Core 7, Supply-chain 7, City 10, Full 12); City 10 for Oct 10 ; HarvestLoop and Forgeline held as reserve dossiers for new ventures	Starting World 4.3, Catalogue, GMH 2
Scaling	Fixed quantities	Nearly every quantity is a formula of N: Bank stock 40N, restock 10N, lending pool 8,000N, fund 14,000N, missions N+1, opportunities $\lceil N/2 \rceil + 1$, tenders $\lceil N/2 \rceil$, auction lots $\lceil N/3 \rceil + 1$	GMH 5.1
Starting cash	Loaded value	Computed at registration close: headcount $\times$ 2,450 + 10,000 + Strategic Adjustment	GMH 5.2
Assignment	Not specified	Random, sizes within ± 1 , 6 to 12 per company, domain = the company's shortest domain; safety net drops Voltway, StackHouse, TrustLayer if under 60 people	Event Ops 7.3, GMH 2
Roles	"Company lead" role	CEO volunteer + 2 elected Authorised Signatories + 7 domains; authority thresholds at 5,000 VB	CGS 1.2, Passports 4

Area	Technology section assumed	Now locked in	Source
Dependencies	Not modelled	12 role slots S1 to S12, each filled by a company or an institution fallback; slot variables resolve card text	Starting World 11, Catalogue

2.2 Economy and settlement

Area	Technology section assumed	Now locked in	Source
Tick	"Tick start / tick end" actions	A fixed 12-step settlement order with a 2-minute freeze and queued actions; arrears recorded when a step can't be paid	CGS 1.1
Money supply	VB ledger only	City Reserve as a GM ledger account paying missions (600N VB and 15N units per tick budget, carried forward) and receiving fees	CGS 1.4, 2.5
Valuation	"Health" field	Reference Valuation $RV = \max(NAV, 0) + 6 \times \text{avg verified customer revenue over the last 2 ticks, recomputed every tick and public}$	CGS 7.2
Equity	"Cap table" record	1,000 shares (800 Founding Holder, 200 option pool), price-per-share formula, 40% dilution cap, cap-table lock one tick before freeze	CGS 7.1 to 7.5
Reputation	Not modelled	Reliability Record (fulfilled, breached,	CGS 1.5, IOC Bank

Area	Technology section assumed	Now locked in	Source
		missed) is the only reputation stat; Bank credit grade A to D derives from it every tick	
Workforce	Employment record	Levels L0 to L5, ladder 100 to 600 VB, +1 level per tick, required seats, 225 VB deficit charge, Workforce Credit formula, talent index 80 to 200	CGS 5
Resources	Available, committed, consumed	Tier consumption 4/7/10/14 per tick, thresholds 30/15/0, storage cap 200 with 10% decay, Bank dynamic price +20%/+50% by remaining stock, production recipes, price index	CGS 6
Evidence	"Evidence" free text	Five classes E1 to E5 with independence, freshness and single-use rules	CGS 1.3
Lifecycle	Operating, Growth, Distressed, Failed	Adds High Growth (rule-based), Spun out, Dissolved; exact Distressed triggers; 2-tick recovery; liquidation waterfall	CGS 8.1, 8.6

2.3 Content and institutions

Area	Technology section assumed	Now locked in	Source
Events and crises	E01 to E30, C01 to C20	26 events and 20 crises with gaps and additions	Dynamic Events, event-

Area	Technology section assumed	Now locked in	Source
		(E31, E32, C21 to C23), 19-field card schema, Minor/Major event severity, deck sealed before the run	crisis-library.csv
Crisis targeting	"Affected entities" chosen by GM	Platform-computed exposure score per C1 card, eligibility filter, fairness caps (1 C1 per company, 3 crisis effects max), recorded random tie-break, logged GM veto only	DE 4.2
Signals	Not modelled	Every card has a one-tick-ahead signal to 2 or 3 holders chosen from the lowest-exposure companies	DE 7.2, GMH 4.3
Caps	Not modelled	Consequence caps C1 6,000, C2 8,000, C3 10,000, C4 12,000 VB; hooks add up to 10,000	DE 6
Institutions	Generic "Bank / Investor / Customer"	Full catalogues with stable IDs: BK-01 to 13, IN-01 to 06, CU-01 to 42, SU-01 to 15, GV-L/G/T/R, MD-O/P	IOC
Investor	Meeting-to-funding pipeline	Run-level lead thesis (drawn at 08:30 on the day), fit tests, valuation ceilings $2.0/1.5/1.0 \times RV$, window Tick 8 to lock	IOC 3, GMH 2
Information	"Human Internet mode ACTIVE/INACTIVE"	Three modes DARK / CLOSED / OPEN; graded information cards with hidden truth, provenance,	Human Internet 2 to 12

Area	Technology section assumed	Now locked in	Source
		corroboration by root, stamps per copy, exclusivity and warranties; Rumour Register; Data Drop; Internet Unlock	
Personal objectives	"Store privately"	20 templates PO-01 to PO-20 with tokens, a constrained deal algorithm, one free swap, follow-ons, 500/250 VB rewards, and a grade-B draft Founder Ledger entry on completion	Personal Objectives
Founder Ledger	Generic evidence record	15 signals in 5 families, grades and significance, bands from best three independent entries, profile reads, ten awards, strict separation from company scoring	Founder ID
Investor Day	"Data package"	Frozen Snapshot (12 blocks), Pitch Sheet, decision card per company per room, E (Founder-Held Value multiple), O (5 objective layers), Best Venture frontier	Investor Day 1.4 to 2.7

2.4 Clock and run

The Technology section never had a clock. The run is now fixed: 10 ticks, Market Open 10:35, lunch pause 12:35 to 13:05 with boundary 4/5 split (steps 1 to 10 at 12:35, step 11 at 13:05), Internet Unlock at Tick 8, freeze 16:05, final settlement and lock by 16:10, snapshots printed by 16:15, Tech Lead results sheet by 16:55 (GMH 3, 11, 12).

2.5 Participant-facing promises already in print

The Participant Handbook tells people to **bring a charged phone** and says wallets, cards, deals and missions live on the platform from Market Open to Tick 7. The Personal Objective System says objectives are pushed to the app, PO-11 uses a scanned introduction code, and PO-17 and PO-18 need "app notes". These are now build requirements for the participant portal (section 8.5); if a Tier B module slips, the Help Desk paper route in those documents applies.

3. Overbuilt or unnecessary work in the original Technology section

About a third of the original 81 sections describe software the game does not need, either because a human already does that job in the finished design or because the draft's own rules (paper fallback, "Core Design Test" in section 79, modular monolith in section 51) argue against it. Cutting them is what makes a five-day build possible.

Original section	What it asked for	Why it is overbuilt	Do instead
15 Deal Builder (acquisition, merger, spin-out forms)	Self-serve participant forms for all 10 deal types	M&A, mergers and spin-outs happen 0 to 3 times a run, always with a GM validation step (CGS 8.2 to 8.4)	Keep one Deal Sheet record with a deal builder on top: templates for resource swap, supply contract, loan, hire and info sale with pre-filled defaults (D9, 5 Oct); M&A is a GM Console wizard that posts ordinary ledger entries
22 Talent Market (job board, candidate profiles, applications)	A mini recruiting site	Recruiting is face to face; CGS 5.4 only needs the offer, the counteroffer window and the move at the boundary	One Employment record with Offer, Pending move, Active; no board, no profiles
23 Customer & Sales System (10-stage funnel)	Lead, Discovery, Proposal, Negotiation stages	Only the contract states in CGS 4.3 carry rules; earlier stages are conversation	Track contracts from Proposed onward; drop the funnel
20 Investment System (meeting, diligence stages)	A seven-stage VC pipeline	The fund is open only from Tick 8 to the cap-table lock and makes at most 7 deals at N = 10	Term sheet record, tranche condition, cap-table update; no meeting or diligence states

Original section	What it asked for	Why it is overbuilt	Do instead
36 Notifications (six audiences, event-driven routing)	A notification service	The venue has a PA, a big screen and runners, and 30-minute ticks need no push	Public feed on the city screen plus a per-person and per-company inbox that phones poll (deal signatures, whispers and signals, GM rulings); no push service
41 to 43 Analytics, Live Ops Dashboard, GM comparative view (three dashboards)	Transactions per minute, network graphs, a separate Event Lead dashboard	The GM Handbook's two-minute boundary watch list (GMH 7.2) is the only live analytics anyone reads	One GM board built around the watch list; everything else is a post-event query on the export
49 Content Management UI	Edit missions, events and crises in an admin UI	Content already lives in spreadsheets (event-crisis-library.csv, O21 to O28 CSV) and changes between runs, not during them	Load content from CSV/Sheets at setup; no editor UI
17 to 18 Opportunity Engine "hide existence until trigger"	Software-controlled discovery	Every discovery path in CGS 3.3 is a person, a desk or a printed card; the software only needs the register	Opportunity Register with discoverers and claimant; discovery stays physical
46 "optional local cached operator forms"	Offline-capable web forms	Paper is the offline mode, and it is already mandated and printed	Pre-printed numbered forms; no offline sync engine
52 WebSocket real-time layer	Live push to every screen	30-minute ticks; nothing a participant does needs sub-minute updates	15 to 30 second polling on the city board and GM board
5 Participant accounts with per-field role filtering	Login for 60 to 120 participants	Field-by-field rules are easy to get wrong under time pressure	QR badge login, and filter by visibility class on the server (section 9), not per field
74 to 76 Change control, versioning,	Formal process	Sensible, but heavy for a team of two or three	One line in the run card: rules version,

Original section	What it asked for	Why it is overbuilt	Do instead
governance boards			content version, app version

Not overbuilt, and worth keeping from the original: the append-only ledger with compensating entries (section 9), the explicit state machines (section 7), server-authoritative time (section 45), the freeze flag (section 66), the snapshot per tick (section 47) and the Core Design Test (section 79). The finished documents lean on every one of them.

4. Missing mechanics: what needs a software representation

Thirty-four mechanics in the finished documents have no home in the original Technology section. The table lists each with the source, what the software must hold or compute, and the fallback if that module is a no-go on Friday or the platform fails on the day ("tab" means a minimal spreadsheet stand-in). "Ledger sheet" means the City Ledger workbook; "GM pack" means printed sealed material.

4.1 Setup and identity

#	Mechanic	Source	Software must	Fallback
1	Active-set selection (Core 7, Supply-chain 7, City 10, Full 12) with checklist and safety-net drop order	SW 4.3, Catalogue 2, GMH 2	Store the 12-company pool, flag active, compute every N-formula, validate the set checklist	Hard-code City 10 in the ledger's Config tab; N = 10
2	Balanced random assignment to the smallest company, domain = least-filled required domain	SW 5, Event Ops 7.3	Assignment algorithm at check-in; rebalance report at 09:25	Shuffled assignment-card deck (Event Ops paper method) + roster tab
3	Starting cash recompute at registration close (headcount × 2,450 + 10,000 + adj.) and runway	SW 6, GMH 5.2	Formula per company from the roster	Formula column on the Companies tab; figure shows on the company dashboard; GM writes it on the failsafe Founder Dossier copy only if the platform is down

#	Mechanic	Source	Software must	Fallback
4	Required seats per domain and deficit domain (15% of headcount, min 1)	SW 5.3, CGS 5.3	Seat table per company fixed at registration close	Seats tab, filled at 09:25
5	Signatory election and authority thresholds (5,000 VB)	CGS 1.2	Signatory flag; approval check on every commitment	Desk checks the signature on the paper form; Signatories tab
6	Personal Objective deal (PO-01 to PO-20, constraints, token resolution, city-wide cap [P/20]+1)	PO 2.2	Constrained dealing algorithm, then re-deal for no-shows	Small script run Friday (section 5.4) and at 09:25 for gaps; print into envelopes
7	Personal information card distribution (60/25/15 truth mix; never about own company; ≥ 3 outsiders per company across ≥ 2 companies)	SW 10.5, HI 12	Distribution algorithm with slot-variable resolution	Pre-printed by company for City 10; GM hands out by envelope

4.2 Tick engine and economy

#	Mechanic	Source	Software must	Fallback
8	12-step tick settlement with queued actions and arrears	CGS 1.1	Deterministic settlement job that posts journal entries per step	Apps Script "Settle tick" button (section 7) run by the Tech Lead; Boundary GM runs paper if down
9	Salary ladder, level progression, domain change halves level, Free	CGS 5.2	Per-participant level and salary floor, recomputed	Participants tab; settlement script raises levels

#	Mechanic	Source	Software must	Fallback
	Agent freeze		each tick	
10	Deficit charge 225 VB per empty seat; Workforce Credit; talent index 80 to 200	CGS 5.3, 5.6	Seat fill count, WC formula, index update rules	Settlement script
11	Baseline consumption by tier, thresholds 30/15/0, ticks-at-zero counter	CGS 6.1, SW 6.4	Per company per resource tier; counters	Settlement script; warnings column on the city board
12	Bank dynamic pricing by remaining stock; restock 10N; per-company limit 30/tick	CGS 6.3	Price table derived from Bank stock	Bank tab formula; Bank desk reads the live price cell
13	Production recipes and capacity upgrades	CGS 6.2	Standing production orders run at step 3	Production tab; settlement script
14	Storage cap 200 with 10% decay	CGS 6.6	Decay at settlement	Settlement script
15	Price index per resource	CGS 6.5	Formula from last tick's trades and Bank price	Optional on Oct 10; compute if time allows
16	Recurring contracts, penalties, deemed acceptance, Reliability Record	CGS 4.3 to 4.6, 1.5	Contract schedule; breach detection; Reliability counters	Contracts tab with per-tick lines; script posts payments and breaches
17	Bank credit grade A to D per tick and posture stacking	IOC Bank	Grade rule from Reliability and debt	Formula column on Companies tab
18	Loan instalments, late fee, default	CGS 7.3	Loan schedule rows	Loans tab; script debits at step 6

#	Mechanic	Source	Software must	Fallback
	on second miss			
19	City Reserve account and mission budget 600N VB + 15N units per tick	CGS 1.4, 2.5	A ledger account with a per-tick budget counter	Account "RESERVE" in the journal
20	Reference Valuation, NAV, Baseline RV at Market Open	CGS 7.2, ID 2.2	RV each tick; store Baseline RV	Formula row per company; Baseline RV copied as values at 10:35
21	Cap tables, share issue formula, dilution cap, option grants, lock at boundary 9/10	CGS 7.1 to 7.5	Holdings table and share-price calc	CapTable tab; Investor desk worksheet calculates terms
22	Hidden levers credited at settlement (Ledgerly +150/tick, SkillForge +120, PulseAI +40%) and tier flips	GMH 6.1	Lever condition checks and credits	GM ticks the condition on the watch list; Tech Lead posts the credit as a journal line

4.3 Content, crises and information

#	Mechanic	Source	Software must	Fallback
23	Crisis exposure ranking per C1 card, eligibility, fairness caps, recorded random tie-break	DE 4.2	Per-card exposure formulas over ledger data	Exposure tab with one formula block per C1 card in the City 10 deck (C12, C07, C22, C23; C06/C13 only as C23's fallback); Tech Lead prints at the boundary before firing

#	Mechanic	Source	Software must	Fallback
24	Signals to lowest-exposure holders	DE 7.2	Same ranking, ascending; the whisper and signal sender (8.1) picks holders by the GM's holder rule and delivers to their phones	Same Exposure tab
25	Consequence caps per company and per crisis count	DE 6	Running total per company	Crisis log tab with a cap check column
26	Information cards with grade, truth, provenance, stamps, exclusivity, warranty	HI 4 to 8	Card and Holding records; corroboration by root	Paper cards and Media desk register (section 5.3); Rumour Register tab GM-only
27	Info mode DARK / CLOSED / OPEN and per-feature toggles (D3)	HI 2	Per-feature toggles set live in the GM Console and checked on the server; DARK, CLOSED and OPEN are presets of them (8.1)	GM announces the phase on the city board; desks refuse what the phase forbids
28	Opportunity Register, mission register, auction register	CGS 2, 3, 9	Registers with state, claimant, discoverers	Three tabs; desks and GM Control update them
29	Auction covered-bid reservation and one win per session	CGS 9.3	Cash reservation while leading; sealed bids entered in the app reserve the bid amount automatically until the lot settles	Auctioneer checks Available Cash on the city board before accepting a bid; winners posted as journal lines

4.4 Evaluation and close

#	Mechanic	Source	Software must	Fallback
30	Founder Ledger: entries, grades, significance, bands from best three independent entries, profile reads, collaboration map, system-flagged moments, grade-B drafts from PO completions	FID 2 to 6	Append-only entry store keyed to participant ID; banding and read logic	Paper Observation Cards (already the design's fallback), keyed into a separate FounderLedger sheet by freeze + 15; banding by a formula tab the Ledger Lead owns
31	Personal Objective claims, auto-verification for E1, swap, follow-ons, rewards 500/250	PO 2.5 to 2.7	Claim workflow and reward posting	Paper claim at the Help Desk; desk verifies; Tech Lead posts the reward line
32	Frozen Snapshot (12 blocks), crisis timeline, thesis fit test	ID 1.5	Snapshot generator from frozen state	Apps Script or mail-merge into a one-page template, printed at 16:15
33	E (Founder-Held Value multiple), O (5 layers), Best Venture frontier, results board	ID 2.3 to 2.7	Scoring computations	Scoring tab; results board is that tab on the big screen
34	Decision cards and Pitch Sheet	ID 1.4, 1.5	Print templates; capture m per company	Printed; Investor enters k checks into the Scoring tab in the gap

5. Oct 10 build plan: the full platform in five days

The whole event runs on the web platform (owner's decision, 5 Oct). Build it in three tiers with a go/no-go per module on Friday at noon: a module that is not green drops to its paper route for

Saturday, so one late feature never takes the day down. Paper forms are still printed, because the Event Ops failure procedure (13.3) needs them whatever happens.

5.1 Stack: optimise for speed of build and safety of money

Layer	Recommendation	Why
Database	Postgres, self-hosted on the local event server	Transactions for atomic settlement; row-level security can enforce the visibility classes in section 9
Backend	One application server (modular monolith) with server-side validation for every write	Technology 51; no client is trusted with money
Frontend	Responsive web app, phone-first for participants, tablet for desks; whatever framework the developer is fastest in	No native app needed
Auth	Participants: QR on the badge opens a session (no passwords). Staff: named accounts, stronger login for GM and Tech Lead	Event Ops 7.2 already hands out "a portal login or QR code"
Realtime	15 to 30 second polling	30-minute ticks; sockets add risk without value
Hosting	Local server at the venue on its own router, so play never depends on the internet. One environment frozen on Friday, a separate staging copy for testing, and a database backup to a second machine at every tick boundary	Technology 73 to 74
Content	CSV seed scripts from the existing files (event-crisis-library.csv, O21 to O28, catalogues)	No content editor UI

5.2 Tiers

Tier	Must work	Modules
A	At 09:00 Saturday, or the event	Run config (City 10, N-

Tier	Must work	Modules
	cannot run digitally	formulas), roster and random assignment, participant QR login, five named GM accounts with lane permissions and the shared ruling log broadcast to City Board and phones (D11), accounts and append-only journal with validation (section 7), Bank, Supplier/Logistics, Customer, Talent and Government desk consoles with the asker's cross-desk history and manual volunteer notes (D8), Deal Sheet propose, floor-price and 5,000 VB signatory checks, send for signatures with inbox notices to signatories and counterparty (D9), tick settlement engine, Company Station dashboard with runway in ticks, resource bars with 30/15/0 lines and deadline countdown (D6), Participant home (wallet, company view by class, objective text, cards held), City Board, GM Console (clock, settle, pause, watch list, GM entry, freeze), per-feature toggles enforced on the server with Dark, Closed-net and Open-net presets (D3), Founder Dossier document view per company (published at City Opens, readable in Dark) and the scheduled company inbox with GM manual send (both added 5 Oct, reusing InboxMessage), per-tick snapshot, Frozen Snapshot and scoring
B	By Thursday's training if possible; otherwise paper on	In build order: Investor term sheets and cap tables (needed

Tier	Must work	Modules
	the day	from Tick 8) with the appointment booking board (opens Tick 7) and valuation ceiling display (D7); deal templates per deal type with pre-filled defaults (D9); C1 exposure ranking with the whisper and signal sender (D10); missions and opportunities (board, claims, verification, rewards); Personal Objective deal, claims, swap and rewards; auctions (live lot board, covered bids, sealed bids in the app with automatic cash reservation); Company dashboard value against start, objective layers met and the 3-line last-tick digest (D6); desk Earned-item auto flags and the Media auto-copy inbox (D8); information cards (share, sale, transfer, grades, Media verification, corroboration by root)
C	Only if A and B are green by Wednesday night	Moved down from Tier B on 5 Oct to make room for D3 and D6 to D11: observer view with flagged moments and grade-B drafts (paper Observation Cards are its designed fallback), info-card exclusivity and warranty tracking (written on the card), Media products P01 to P10 screens (Media desk paper form), Rumour Register in the app (GM sheet). Already Tier C: City Net search, People Directory, messaging (Open-net), price index, viral amplify counting, M&A and spin-out wizard (GM can post the journal

Tier	Must work	Modules
		lines by hand), new-venture creation, live analytics

Tier B items that slip have a known paper route (section 4's last column); Tier C items that slip are simply not offered. Tick 8 is the first time Investor and Open-net features are used, so they can be finished later than the Tick 1 features if needed, but never deployed during play. The 5 Oct additions cost about a day. Tier A gains only what Saturday cannot run without (toggles and presets, GM lanes and ruling log, deal validation, dashboard basics), and these reuse the gating, role and inbox code already planned; everything else added went to Tier B, and four Tier B items dropped to Tier C to pay for it. Every D3 feature has a toggle even when its feature is Tier C, so an unbuilt feature simply stays off.

5.3 The five-day plan

Day	Build	Exit check
Mon 5 Oct	Schema (section 6), seed data for City 10 from the dossiers and IOC, auth, journal and validation, settlement engine steps 2 to 10 with unit tests	Settlement reproduces a hand-computed SwiftCart boundary to the VB; every T0 number in GMH 5.2 matches the seed
Tue 6 Oct	Desk consoles (Tier A desks) with cross-desk history and volunteer notes, Deal Sheet flow with floor-price and signatory checks, send for signatures and inbox notices, Station dashboard (runway, resource bars, deadlines), City Board, GM Console core with five GM accounts, lane permissions, ruling log broadcast and per-feature toggles	One loan, one resource sale, one hire, one contract (Event Ops T-70 test) pass end to end; a switched-off feature refuses a direct API call, not just a hidden button
Wed 7 Oct (rules freeze)	Participant portal, Dark, Closed-net and Open-net presets on the toggles, Frozen Snapshot and scoring, then Tier B in this order: Investor and cap table with booking board and ceiling display, deal templates, exposure ranking with whisper and signal sender, missions and opportunities, objectives,	Scripted 3-tick simulation with 100 bot participants completes with no balance errors

Day	Build	Exit check
	auctions with sealed bids, dashboard value against start, layers and digest, desk Earned flags and Media inbox, info cards	
Thu 8 Oct (training)	Volunteers train on the real platform: two live ticks at the tabletop. Load test at 150 concurrent sessions on the actual local server and router. The five GMs rehearse their lanes, the Human Internet I Dark preset and live toggle changes. Fix list	Desk routine actions under 2 minutes; settlement under 2 minutes; role-access tests pass (section 9)
Fri 9 Oct	Code freeze at 12:00. Full 10- tick simulated run; restore drill from a snapshot; go/no-go per module; print the paper fallback for every no-go module; deal and print objectives; tag the version	Restore drill passes; go/no-go list signed by GM and Tech Lead

5.4 Day-of staffing and change control

Keep the Event Ops Tech Lead and tech support (N = 10), and add **one developer on call all day, staffing a participant helpdesk announced at the opening briefing**. Ideally this is the person who wrote the settlement engine, with a runner who can reach GM Control in under a minute. No deployments during play except a fix the GM and Tech Lead both approve, with no state impact (Technology 74). The platform runs on a local server on the venue network, which must carry about 100 phones plus 30 staff devices; set it up and test it on site on Thursday or Friday.

5.5 Failure mode

At every boundary the platform exports the journal and each company's balances to a file the Boundary GM can print, so a paper tick can start from the last good numbers. If the platform fails mid-tick, desks switch to the numbered paper forms with time and tick, the Boundary GM runs the boundary on paper, and the Tech Lead keys the backlog in time order when the platform returns (Event Ops 13.3). Participants are told this in the Market Open briefing so a switch to paper does not feel like the game breaking.

6. Data model

One relational model serves both builds: on Oct 10 each entity is a sheet tab with these columns; for the future platform each is a table (Postgres recommended). Balances and stocks are never stored as editable fields; they are sums over the Journal (section 7). Field types: id text key, int whole VB or units, tick integer 0 to 10, enum closed list. Every table also has created_at (server time) and created_by.

6.1 World and configuration

Entity	Key fields
Run	run_id, date, rules_version, content_version, app_version, active_set enum(CORE7, SUPPLY7, CITY10, FULL12), N int, P int, lead_thesis enum(OPERATING, PLATFORM, IMPACT) GM-only until Tick 8, rumour_E20_true bool, info_mode enum(DARK, CLOSED, OPEN) = the last preset applied, current_tick, clock_state enum(PRE, RUNNING, FROZEN_FOR_SETTLEMENT, PAUSED, FINAL_FROZEN), cap_table_locked bool
Param	key, value, formula_of_N, source_ref (e.g. bank_stock_per_resource = 40N, CGS 6.3). Holds every tunable in CGS 10.2
Tick	tick_no, starts_at, settled_at, settled_by, snapshot_ref, notes
Resource	code enum(COMPUTE, ENERGY, LOGISTICS, MATERIALS, DATA, INFRA), bank_base_price, bank_stock_t1
Slot	code S1 to S12, name, institution_fallback
SectorTag	8 values (Retail and Food ... Manufacturing)
FeatureToggle / Preset	feature enum(FOUNDER_DOSSIER_READ, ROLE_CARD_READ, DEALS, WALLET, CARDS, MISSIONS, AUCTIONS, INVESTOR_BOOKING, MESSAGING, SEARCH, AMPLIFY), visible bool, usable bool, set_by, set_at / preset enum(DARK, CLOSED, OPEN) with its toggle values. Checked by the API on every read and write (D3)

6.2 Companies and people

Entity	Key fields
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Entity	Key fields
Company	company_id (SWC, LED, MAN, SKF, PAI, GRG, MED, HVL, STH, VLT, FRG, TRL; new ventures NV1..), name, archetype, cluster set(Physical, Digital, Regulated), workforce_mix enum, origin, active bool, reserve_order, lifecycle enum(OPERATING, HIGH_GROWTH, DISTRESSED, ACQUIRED, MERGED, SPUN_OUT, FAILED, DISSOLVED), distressed_since_tick, strategic_adjustment, ceo_persona, deficit_domain, critical_slot, fills_slots, needs_slots, gate_ref, baseline_rv, founded_tick, parent_company_id
CompanyTier	company_id, resource, tier enum(L=4, M=7, H=10, VH=14), effective_from_tick, reason (base, lever flip, efficiency project, event)
RequiredSeat	company_id, domain, required int, fixed_at_tick, reason
ProductCard	product_id, company_id, name, delivery_unit, resource_cost json, units_per_tick, list_price, floor_price, eligible_buyers, licence_required, is_supply_product, recipe json, capacity, upgrades int
NotableAsset	asset_id, company_id, type enum(brand, prototype, customer_list, licence, equipment, IP, channel, dataset), book_value, pledged_to_loan_id
Participant	participant_id, name, badge_no, arrival_time, company_id nullable, status enum(EMPLOYEE, FREE_AGENT, FOUNDER, LEFT), domain enum(7 domains), level 0..5, salary int, is_signatory, capability_tags, move_cooldown_until_tick, retention_lock_until_tick, needs_flag (Safety only)
Volunteer	volunteer_id, name, role enum(GM, TECH_LEAD, CLERK, CEO, DESK, OBSERVER, LEDGER_LEAD, MC, RUNNER), desk_or_company, gm_lane enum(LEAD, BOUNDARY, CRISIS, MARKET, FLOOR) for the five GM accounts (D11; BOUNDARY is the former Deputy GM)

Entity	Key fields
Employment	employment_id, participant_id, company_id, role, domain, salary, equity_grant_shares, retention_bonus, state enum(OFFERED, PENDING_MOVE, ACTIVE, ENDED), offer_expires_tick, start_tick, end_tick, counteroffer_of
TalentIndex	domain, tick, index 80..200

6.3 Money, resources and obligations

Entity	Key fields
Account	account_id, owner_type enum(COMPANY, PARTICIPANT, INSTITUTION, RESERVE, ESCROW), owner_id. Institutions: BANK, INVESTOR, CUSTOMER, SUPPLIER, LOGISTICS, GOVERNMENT, MEDIA, TALENT
JournalEntry	entry_id, tx_id, tick, posted_at, account_id, asset enum(VB, COMPUTE, ENERGY, LOGISTICS, MATERIALS, DATA, INFRA), amount signed int, kind enum (see 7.1), ref_type, ref_id, paper_form_no, entered_by, reverses_entry_id
Transaction	tx_id, type, status enum(DRAFT, PROPOSED, ACCEPTED, SETTLED, REFUSED, VOID), proposed_tick, accepted_at, negotiator_ids, signer_ids, desk, paper_form_no, flags set(NOMINAL, SELF_DEALING, OUT_OF_BAND)
Contract	contract_id, type enum(CASH_SALE, RESOURCE_TRADE, SUPPLY, CUSTOMER, REVENUE_SHARE, LICENCE, PARTNERSHIP, INFO_SALE, FREELANCE, LOAN_P2P), seller_id, buyer_id, customer_card_id nullable, units_per_tick, price_per_unit, start_tick, end_tick, settlement enum(SPOT, RECURRING, MILESTONE, DEFERRED, ESCROW), penalty_pct, late_payment_pct, exclusivity_until, force_majeure_codes, state enum(PROPOSED, ACCEPTED, ACTIVE, DELIVERED, COMPLETED, DISPUTED, FAILED, TERMINATED), consecutive_breaches

Entity	Key fields
ContractLine	contract_id, tick, units_due, units_delivered, payment_due, payment_made, outcome enum(OK, LATE_DELIVERY, MISSED_DELIVERY, MISSED_PAYMENT)
Loan	loan_id, product enum(BK-03..BK-13, P2P), lender_account, borrower_company, principal, flat_rate, term_ticks, schedule enum(EQUAL, BULLET), first_due_tick, security_ref, state enum(REQUESTED, APPROVED, DISBURSED, REPAYING, REPAYED, DEFAULTED), missed_count
ReliabilityEvent	company_id, tick, kind enum(FULFILLED, BREACHED, PAYMENT_MISSED), ref
ShareHolding	company_id, holder_type, holder_id, shares, class enum(FOUNDING, POOL_UNALLOCATED, OPTION_UNVESTED, OPTION_VESTED, INVESTOR, STRATEGIC, ANGEL, BANK), rights set(BOARD_OBSERVER, INFO, PRO_RATA, LIQ_PREF_1X, SALE_VETO, USE_OF_FUNDS)
TermSheet	ts_id, company_id, product enum(IN-01..IN-05), sponsor_partner, amount, rv_at_signing, pre_money, multiple, price_per_share, new_shares, tranche2_amount, tranche2_milestone, tranche2_deadline_tick, state, expires_tick
ProductionOrder	company_id, product_id, standing_qty, effective_from_tick
CompanyTick (derived, stored at settlement)	company_id, tick, cash, debt, receivables, resources_value, nav, verified_revenue, rv, wc, credit_grade, runway, ticks_at_zero per resource, distressed_triggers, arrears
DealTemplate	template_id, deal_type enum(RESOURCE_SWAP, SUPPLY, LOAN, HIRE, INFO_SALE), default fields (standard late penalty, proof = platform record), signer rule; a Transaction drafted from it stores template_id (D9)
SignatureRequest	tx_id, signer_id or counterparty_id, notified_at, signed_at, refused_at (D9)

6.4 Catalogues and content (loaded from CSV, read-only during play)

Entity	Key fields
CustomerCard	card_id CU-01..42, customer, segment, sector, budget_per_tick, ticks, units_per_tick, decide_by_tick, contract_ticks, must_have, opening_offer, ceiling, hidden_need (Earned), best_fit (GM), claim_method enum(COMPETITIVE, FIRST_COMMITMENT), gate, penalty_pct, load_rule enum(OPEN, HELD_BACK, EVENT, ANCHOR), state enum(HIDDEN, OPEN, AWARDED, CLOSED, RESCUE)
SupplierLine	supplier_id SU-01..15, resource, list_price, band_low, band_high, capacity_formula, min_order, payment_terms, hidden_constraint (GM), state
BankProduct, InvestorProduct, Licence, Grant, Tender, RegInstrument, MediaProduct	IDs BK, IN, GV-L, GV-G, GV-T, GV-R, MD-P with the IOC fields; plus LicenceHolding(company_id, licence_id, granted_tick, state enum(APPLIED, GRANTED, SUSPENDED))
MissionCard / MissionInstance	M01..M50 + CR-xx: category, tier, objective, evidence_classes, completion_mode enum(EXCLUSIVE, RACE_K, OPEN), k, eligibility, tags, window, deadline, reward, recipient, hi_flag, visibility / instance: state enum(LOCKED, AVAILABLE, CLAIMED, SUBMITTED, VERIFIED, COMPLETED, RETURNED, FAILED, EXPIRED, ABANDONED), claimant_id, company_id, claimed_tick, verified_by
OpportunityCard / OpportunityInstance	O01..O28: type, signal, detail, discovery_paths, claim_method, trade_off, value_cap, window, decay_rule, institutions / instance: state enum(HIDDEN, AVAILABLE, DISCOVERED, CLAIMED, ACTIVE, RESOLVED, EXPIRED), discoverers[] (participant, tick), claimant
EventCrisisCard	the 21 CSV columns of event-crisis-library.csv; plus DeckEntry(card_id, planned_tick, state enum(SEALED, SIGNALLED, FIRED, RESOLVED, ENDED, RETURNED)), Signal(card_id, holder_id, tick, holder_rule, sent_by, delivered_at),

Entity	Key fields
	CrisisHit(card_id, company_id, tick, consequence_vb, cap, veto_reason)
AuctionLot / Bid	lot_id A01..A10 or ad hoc, session 1..4, format enum(OPEN, TIMED, SEALED, LIMITED, MYSTERY, DUTCH, MULTI_UNIT), opening_price, reserve (GM), eligibility / bid_id, lot_id, bidder_company, amount, at, mandate_id, sealed bool, reserved_amount (ESCROW_HOLD while leading or sealed), status
InfoCard / Holding / Verification	HI 12.1 schema (card_id, statement, kind, truth_status GM, grade, provenance, root_id, claim_id, assertion, key, expiry...) / holding_id, card_id, copy_no, holder, grade, stamp_tick, exclusive_until, warranty_until / route, outcome, fee
ObjectiveTemplate / ObjectiveAssignment	PO-01..PO-20 with tokens, family, signals, significance / participant_id, template_id, resolved_text, dealt_tick, state enum(ACTIVE, CLAIMED, VERIFIED, RETURNED, SWAPPED, REISSUED), completion_no 1..3, reward_tx_id
InvestorSlot	slot_id, partner enum(P1, P2), tick, start_time, length 10 min, company_id nullable, booked_by, booked_at; booking open from Tick 7, meetings from Tick 8 (D7)

6.5 Evaluation, operations and audit

Entity	Key fields
FounderEntry	entry_id (initials + number), time, tick, participant_id, company_and_role_at_time, situation, action, prompted enum, outcome, proof_ref, signal_primary, signal_secondary, counter bool, grade enum(A, B, C), significance 1..3, counterparts[], observer_id, written_at, supersedes_entry_id
TipSlip, CoverageSheet	per FID 2.9 fields
Ruling, Incident	time, gm_id, lane, parties, ruling, precedent bool, public bool (broadcast to City Board and phones), supersedes_ruling_id / area, severity, action,

Entity	Key fields
	owner
AuditLog	at, actor, role, action, object, before, after, reason (required for overrides)
Snapshot	tick, file_ref or JSON blob of all derived tables
DecisionCard	company_id, room, fit_result, ceiling, check1, check2, check3, k, m, decision enum(BACK, PASS)
DeskNote	note_id, desk, asker participant_id, company_id, tick, summary, earned_flags_shown; one manual line per conversation (D8)
MediaInboxItem	item_id, source enum(FACT_CHECK, RUMOUR_PLANT, DEBUNK, OBJECTIVE_LODGE, AMPLIFY_COUNT), ref, draft_correction, received_at, handled_by (D8)
InboxMessage	message_id, to participant or company, kind enum(SIGNATURE_REQUEST, DEAL_NOTICE, WHISPER, SIGNAL, RULING, COMPANY_INBOX), ref, sender_label, text, release_tick (scheduled company inbox only; null = send now), sent_at, read_at. Company inbox messages load from each company's Inbox release schedule (Company Dossiers N.16) and are released by settlement at the tick boundary; a GM can also send one by hand
CompanyDocument	doc_id, company_id, kind enum(FOUNDER_DOSSIER), title, body (loaded from the Founder Dossier files), published bool, published_at, published_by. Visible only to that company's staff once published at City Opens; readable in the Dark preset (added 5 Oct, Tier A)
CompanyDigest (derived at settlement)	company_id, tick, line_1, line_2, line_3, value_vs_start (E), layers_met, layers_public (D6)

7. Ledger, transactions and the tick engine

Every change to money or units is a balanced set of journal lines; nothing is ever edited, and a mistake is fixed by a reversing transaction that points at the original (Technology section 9, GMH 8.6). This one rule is what makes the paper fallback, the restore drill and the audit possible, so it is the first thing to build and the last to compromise.

7.1 Journal rules

- A transaction is 2 or more JournalEntry lines sharing a tx_id. For each asset (VB and each resource) the lines sum to zero: what one account loses another gains. Resource purchases from the Bank are two balanced pairs (VB company→BANK, units BANK→company).
- Sources and sinks are explicit accounts, not "created" money: RESERVE (missions, objective rewards, lever credits, auction proceeds, fees), BANK (resources, loans, interest), INVESTOR (fund), GOVERNMENT (grants, fees, fines), CUSTOMER (institution customer payments), SUPPLIER, LOGISTICS, MEDIA, TALENT, and CONSUMED (baseline and delivery consumption, decay; units leave the economy here).
- kind values: OPENING, PURCHASE, BUYBACK, SALE, CONTRACT_PAYMENT, DELIVERY, SALARY, CONSUMPTION, DECAY, DEFICIT_CHARGE, LOAN_DISBURSE, LOAN_INSTALLMENT, LATE_FEE, PENALTY, INVESTMENT, SHARE_ISSUE, GRANT, TENDER_PAYMENT, MISSION_REWARD, OBJECTIVE_REWARD, LEVER_CREDIT, AUCTION_SETTLE, FEE, FINE, ESCROW_HOLD, ESCROW_RELEASE, PRODUCTION_IN, PRODUCTION_OUT, REVERSAL, CORRECTION.
- **Balance = sum of lines for (account, asset).** Available cash = balance – reserved (escrow holds, leading auction bids).
- Validation before commit: spender's available balance covers the leg, or the transaction is REFUSED (CGS 4.4: never half-settled); Bank per-company limit 30 per resource per tick; storage after purchase; signer authority ($\leq 5,000$ one signatory, above that CEO or both); floor price; flag NOMINAL when consideration $< 25\%$ of Bank value; flag SELF_DEALING when a party is a company's own staff.
- The API refuses an invalid transaction with a plain-language reason, and every console shows Available cash before submit. Submissions carry a client-generated idempotency key so a double tap never posts twice.

7.2 Write paths

Every write goes through one server function per action type that expands it into balanced journal lines in a single database transaction. Each records tick (from Run), desk or channel, operator, and a paper form number when it was keyed from paper. The eight staff-side action types are below; participant actions (propose a deal, accept an offer, claim, sell a card) create Proposed transactions that a signatory or desk then accepts.

Form	Used by	Creates
Bank: buy / sell back resources	Bank desk	PURCHASE or BUYBACK pair
Bank: loan event	Bank desk	Loan row + LOAN_DISBURSE, or an early repayment
Supplier / Logistics order	Supplier and Logistics desk	PURCHASE pair, or a SUPPLY contract row for standing orders
Customer contract	Customer desk	CUSTOMER contract row (payments posted by settlement)

Form	Used by	Creates
Government / Media / Talent fee or award	those desks	FEE, GRANT, TENDER contract, licence holding, specialist contract
Deal Sheet (company to company, or person)	Ledger clerk at GM Control	Contract row and any spot legs
Hire / move / release	Talent desk or clerk	Employment row (PENDING_MOVE until the boundary)
GM entry (rewards, auction results, lever credits, crisis consequences, corrections)	Tech Lead only	The matching kind; reason required

7.3 Tick settlement (CGS 1.1) as code

Run at each boundary under a lock. Each step writes journal lines tagged with the tick and step number, so a boundary can be re-run from the last snapshot after a failure. Step 1 and steps 11 to 12 are people (GM announces; desks reopen).

```

settle(tick k):
  lock(); snapshot(k, "pre")
  1 freeze: clock_state = FROZEN_FOR_SETTLEMENT (queued forms are accepted but tagged k+1)
  2 for contract in ACTIVE recurring contracts with a line due at k:
    deliver units if seller stock allows, else MISSED_DELIVERY + penalty_pct × tick value
    pay if buyer cash allows, else MISSED_PAYMENT (overdue grows by late_payment_pct)
    update consecutive_breaches; ReliabilityEvent; auto-terminate after 2
    apply lever multipliers on qualifying contracts (PulseAI +40%, Forgeline +25%)
  3 for order in ProductionOrder: if inputs in stock, consume inputs, add output ≤ capacity
  4 for employee: SALARY company → participant = max(agreed, ladder[level]); shortfall → salary arrears
  5 for company, resource: CONSUMPTION = tier rate (+ tech debt); stock floored at 0; ticks_at_zero += (stock == 0)
  6 for loan with instalment due: LOAN_INSTALMENT; if unpaid, LATE_FEE 10% + PAYMENT_MISSED; 2nd miss → DEFAULTED
  7 levels: +1 for employees in same domain since last tick (+1 bonus if Tier 2/3 domain mission, max once per 2 ticks), cap 5
    DEFICIT_CHARGE 225 × empty required seats; recompute WC; apply pending moves (Employment PENDING_MOVE → ACTIVE)
  8 lifecycle: Distressed if cash < 0, loan default, staff < 3, VH/H resource at 0 for 2 ticks, or new-venture deadline missed;
    start or clear the 2-tick recovery clock; flag "last recovery tick" for GM
  9 expire missions and opportunities past window (GM releases aftermath cards by hand on Oct 10)
  10 market: Bank restock 10N per resource; reset per-tick capacities; talent index; price index; storage decay 10% above 200; recompute NAV, RV, credit grade, runway, High Growth; write

```

CompanyTick rows

```
snapshot(k, "post"); log duration; unlock()
```

The lunch boundary (4/5) runs steps 1 to 10 at 12:35 and holds step 11 to 13:05 (GMH 3.4). The freeze runs steps 1 to 10 for Tick 10, then sets FINAL_FROZEN and locks every write path except GM corrections (GMH 11).

7.4 Formulas the engine must implement

$$\mathrm{NAV} = \text{cash} + \sum_r \text{stock}_r \times \text{BankPrice}_r + \text{asset book} + \text{receivables} - \text{debt} - \text{liabilities due}$$
$$\mathrm{RV} = \max(\mathrm{NAV}, 0) + 6 \times \overline{\text{verified customer revenue}}_{\text{last 2 ticks}}$$
$$\mathrm{WC} = \sum_{\text{employees}} \left(1 + \frac{\text{level}}{2}\right) \times \frac{\text{talent index}_{\text{domain}}}{100} + 2.5 \times \text{specialists}$$
$$\text{price per share} = \frac{\text{pre-money}}{\text{shares outstanding}}, \quad \text{new shares} = \frac{\text{investment}}{\text{price per share}}$$
$$E = \frac{\text{Founding Holder shares}}{\text{shares outstanding}} \times \text{Final RV} \{0.8 \times \text{Baseline RV}\}, \quad m = 0.5 + (\text{ceiling} - 0.5) \times \frac{k}{3}$$

Other rules coded as lookups: Bank price = base, +20% when stock is 25 to 50% of Tick 1 stock, +50% under 25%, unavailable at 0; credit grade A (≥ 2 completed contracts, no misses) / B / C (miss or breach in last 3 ticks, or Bank debt > 20,000) / D (default or Distressed); verified customer revenue counts customer contracts, product sales and tender payments only, never loans, investment, grants, mission rewards or asset sales; runway = cash $\div$ average net outflow over the last 2 ticks.

7.5 Crisis exposure ranking (the four C1 cards in the City 10 deck, plus C23's fallback)

Eligibility first: Operating, not hit by a C1 this run, not hit by any crisis in the last 2 ticks, not a new venture in its first 2 ticks. Then rank by the card's measure, highest first; ties by fewest crisis hits, then a random draw whose seed is logged. The same list ascending gives the signal holders.

Card	Tick	Exposure measure
C12 Platform Outage	3	Critical dependency still on institution fallback; largest share of verified revenue from one Product Card over last 2 ticks
C07 Talent Walkout	4	Most employees in one domain with no retention bonus, no option grant and salary at

Card	Tick	Exposure measure
		ladder floor
C22 Merchant Fraud	6	Precondition: sold S7 to ≥ 2 others in last 2 ticks. Count of companies processed, doubled per tick without S8 cover
C06 Procurement Audit (or C13 Cash Burn), only if C23 is ineligible	6	Highest share of verified revenue from one institution contract (C13: shortest runway under 4 ticks)
C23 Data Breach	6 (signal at Tick 5; moved from Tick 8 on 5 Oct)	Precondition: sold or shared Data. Data units sold or shared in last 2 ticks, doubled per tick without S8 cover

8. Interfaces

Six interfaces share one API and one visibility policy. Items marked **[Oct 10]** are Tier A (section 5.2); unmarked items are Tier B or C.

8.1 GM Console (five GMs by lane, Tech Lead)

- **Clock and settlement** [Oct 10]: current tick, time left, info mode, Settle tick button with step-by-step log and duration, pause/resume (extends crisis windows by the pause), freeze and final lock.
- **Feature toggles and info-mode presets** [Oct 10] (D3): one switch per feature for visibility and use: Founder Dossier read, role card and objective read, deals, wallet, cards and trading, missions, auctions and bids, investor booking, messaging and chat, search of city records, amplify. GMs set them per phase and can change any of them live. Presets set them all at once: Dark = only the participant's own company Founder Dossier, own role card and objective, read-only (Human Internet I, per D2); Closed-net = no search and no messaging (HI 2); Open-net = everything built. The server checks the toggle on every read and write and refuses with a plain reason; a hidden button is not enough. Every change goes to the audit log and the current preset shows on the City Board.
- **GM accounts and lanes** [Oct 10] (D11): five named GM accounts, each with a lane that sets which console actions it can take. Lead GM: everything, including stage, announcements, final rulings and the Investor Day room A panel. Boundary GM (formerly the Deputy GM): Settle with the Tech Lead, watch list, company clocks, Distressed recovery. Crisis GM: deck, exposure ranking, whisper and signal sender, aftermath releases. Market GM: missions, opportunities, held-back customer cards, auctions, Founder Window. Floor GM: desk queues, disputes, objective and mission escalations, volunteer cover. Any GM can apply a preset or toggle; every action is logged with the GM and lane.

- **Ruling log** [Oct 10] (D11): all five GMs write to one shared log (time, GM, lane, parties, ruling, precedent flag). A ruling marked public is broadcast to the City Board and to participants' phone inboxes. The Lead GM has the final word: an overrule posts a superseding entry, never an edit.
- **Boundary watch list** [Oct 10]: one screen implementing GMH 7.2: runway under 4, cash heading negative, resources at 30/15/0 and ticks at zero, Distressed flags with recovery clocks, liabilities due (SwiftCart T4, Voltway T6, GreenGrid T7), key-person departures (T5, T6), lever conditions met, concentration checks (SkillForge T4, SwiftCart T5), NOMINAL and SELF_DEALING flags, Reliability breaches this tick, conditional crisis eligibility.
- **Deck** [Oct 10]: City 10 deck by tick with state (sealed, signalled, fired, resolved, ended), exposure ranking and signal-holder list for the next card (printable), cap tracker per company, veto log.
- **Whisper and signal sender** (Tier B, D10): the Crisis GM picks the card and a holder rule (for example "2 outsiders lowest on exposure"); the platform selects the holders from the exposure ranking, shows the list for a confirm, delivers the text to those phones and writes a Signal row per holder. No hand-routing; if the module is a no-go, the printed signal list and runners are the paper route.
- **Releases**: missions to the board, opportunities (top up to 6, never above 12), aftermath cards, held-back customer cards CU-25/27/28, tenders in order (GV-T06 T3, T05 T4, T01 T5, T03 T7).
- **Registers** [Oct 10]: missions, opportunities, auctions, Rumour Register (GM file), ruling log, incident log.
- **GM entry** [Oct 10]: rewards, auction settlements, lever credits, crisis consequences, compensating corrections; reason mandatory; never edit.
- **Hidden state**: levers, vulnerabilities, truth status, thesis, reserve prices. GM accounts only, within each lane (below).
- **Close-out** [Oct 10]: Baseline RV capture at 10:35, snapshot generator, Scoring tab (E, O, frontier, bottom-half list released to the Ledger Lead only after winners are fixed), results board.

8.2 Institution Consoles (one per desk)

Every desk sees: its catalogue with live state, the asker company's public profile plus exactly the fields its rules need, a transaction form, its per-tick capacity remaining, and an "escalate to Floor GM" note. Never another company's dealings with the desk.

Desk	Sees	Does [Oct 10 = form]
Bank	Live price per resource from stock steps, stock left, pool left, asker's cash, Bank debt vs 30,000 cap, credit grade, posture, Reliability Record	Sell/buy back resources ($\leq 30 / \leq 20$ per resource per tick), disburse loans BK-03 to 13, record early repayment, BK-11 lock
Investor	Fund left vs 70,000 Tick 8 cap and 140,000 total, deals left of 7, RV, fit test result per thesis (from Tick 8), valuation ceiling per company (RV $\times$ thesis fit multiple 2.0/1.5/1.0, IOC 3.2	Term sheet calculator (price per share, new shares, post-money %, dilution check $\leq 40\%$, concentration $\leq 30\%$), fund tranches

Desk	Sees	Does [Oct 10 = form]
	and 3.4), cap table, appointment board (D7, Tier B: two partner calendars, 10-minute slots, booking opens Tick 7, meetings from Tick 8)	
Customer	Open cards CU-01..24 (20 loaded), proposals by decide-by tick, anchor states and renewal ceilings	Record proposals, award competitive cards (lowest compliant price, then Reliability, then earlier), accept pilots (E3), accept deliveries, anchor renewals at Tick 6
Supplier and Logistics	Capacity per line left this tick (12N standard, 8N alternative; logistics 15N/7N), min orders, surge state (+25% past 80% booked), T0 agreements and their Tick 4 lapse	Orders, standing orders up to 3 ticks, agreement renewals
Government	Licence queue in arrival order, 3 decisions per tick cap, grant pool 30,000 and window, tenders	Applications, grant awards at boundary 6/7, tender awards, suspensions (E31, E32)
Media	Slots per outlet per tick, fact-check queue, published items, broker register (≤ 5)	P01 to P10 sales, fact-check results with stamp, corrections, viral amplify count, auto-copy inbox (below)
Talent Exchange	$N = 10$ specialist contracts, fee = $400 \times \text{index} \div 100$, talent index by domain, pending moves	Specialist contracts, record offers and moves, releases

Cross-desk history and Earned flags (D8). [Oct 10] Every desk console also shows the asker's history across all desks (their requests, deals and outcomes at every desk), so desks can see each other's records for that asker; volunteers log each conversation by hand in a one-line note. Tier B: the console flags which Earned-tier items the asker already qualifies for; the desk relationship tier itself is kept as written in IOC. Still never another company's dealings.

Media auto-copy inbox (D8, Tier B). The Media desk gets an automatic copy of every fact-check request, rumour plant, debunk (with a draft correction pre-filled), objective lodge that names Media, and amplification count. If it slips, the Media volunteer works from the desk queue and the paper register.

8.3 Company Station view (CEO volunteer tablet; signatories later)

[Oct 10] Read-only: cash and available cash, debt and next instalments, resource stocks with tier and ticks until 30/15/0, people (domain, level, salary, seats filled vs required, deficit charge), active contracts and next deliveries due, licences held, Reliability Record, RV, credit grade, lifecycle flag. The CEO's sealed private objective shows on the CEO's login only (D6); the sealed envelope stays as the paper copy.

Company dashboard (D6), the same view on the Company Station and in the participant portal's company view. [Oct 10] Runway in ticks, resource bars with lines at 30, 15 and 0, and a countdown to the company's own deadlines (liabilities, contract deliveries, licence and tender dates, new-venture deadlines). Tier B: live value against your start (the E multiple from Investor Day Playbook 2.3, from current RV and cap table); objective layers met out of the company's public layers, with the private objective layer shown to the CEO only; and a 3-line "what changed last tick" digest written by settlement after each boundary. If Tier B slips, the dashboard shows the Tier A fields only.

8.4 City Board (public big screen)

[Oct 10] Clock and tick, info mode preset, Bank prices and stock band per resource, desk Open/Limited/Closed, active parameter changes with end tick (DE pacing rule), public notices and GM rulings marked public, mission board, auction lots and current bid, per-company public line (lifecycle flag, Reliability Record, RV). Refresh every 30 seconds via a published sheet.

8.5 Participant Portal (Tier A home, Tier B and C features)

[Oct 10] Home answers "what do I know, what can I do, what changed" (Technology 11.2): wallet and recent lines; company snapshot by visibility class; my objective with claim, swap and note buttons (PO-17, PO-18); my information cards with grade, copy and provenance, plus sell/share/transfer flows with exclusivity and warranty; mission board and my claims; offers and counteroffers; propose a Deal Sheet that routes to my signatories for approval; introduction code (PO-11) as a QR both parties scan; auction bid with mandate; from Tick 8 City Net search over Public records and the People Directory; messaging only in OPEN mode. Deal builder (D9): pick a template (resource swap, supply contract, loan, hire, info sale) with defaults pre-filled (standard late penalties, platform record as proof); the floor-price and 5,000 VB signatory-limit checks run before it can go; then "send for signatures" notifies the signatories and the counterparty (checks and sending Tier A, templates Tier B). Inbox: signature requests, whispers and signals delivered by the platform (D10), GM rulings marked public (D11), and the company inbox: scheduled messages (sender label and text) released at each tick boundary from the company's N.16 schedule, plus any a GM sends by hand [Oct 10]. Founder Dossier [Oct 10]: a per-company document view, visible only to that company's staff, published by the GM at City Opens and readable in the Dark preset; it replaces the passport as the one start-of-day read. From Tick 7 a company books an investor appointment on the board (D7, Tier B). Auction bids include sealed bids, which reserve the amount from available cash automatically. Feature gating (D3): every feature here sits behind a GM Console toggle that the server checks. In the Dark preset (Human Internet I) the portal shows only the participant's own company Founder Dossier, own role card and objective, read-only: no deals, chat, card trading or wallet actions. Closed-net: no search and no messaging. Open-net: everything built.

8.6 Observer view (Tier C since 5 Oct; paper Observation Cards are the route)

Observation Card form with exactly the paper fields (FID 2.5), the zone's participant list with last-seen time and Look-for flags, system-flagged moments pushed to the observer covering the zone (major sale, crisis action, M&A, spin-out, rescue, scarce hire, hard mission, PO completion draft at grade B), tip slip entry, and the Ledger Lead's banding and award shortlist screens. Observer-class only; never visible to the GM Console's company screens.

9. Visibility policy matrix

Every object carries one of the Starting World visibility classes, and the server filters by class before anything leaves it (Technology sections 30 and 64). Write it once as a policy table in code and run every role against it before Thursday's training. Columns are viewers; R = read, W = write via a form or action, — = never.

Object (class)	Participant	Own company staff	Company leadership	Named-domain staff	Desk volunteer	GMs (all lanes)	Tech Lead	Observer / Ledger Lead
Public profile, RV, Reliability Record, Distressed flag, prices, board (Public)	R	R	R	R	R	R	R	R
Company cash, stocks, contracts, debt, cap table (Company)	—	R	R	R	R only fields its desk needs, for the asker	R	R	—
Private objective (Company leadership)	—	—	R	—	—	R	—	—

Object (class)	Participant	Own company staff	Company leadership	Named-domain staff	Desk volunteer	GMs (all lanes)	Tech Lead	Observer / Ledger Lead
p)								
Hidden lever (Company role)	—	—	—	R	—	R	R (to credit it)	—
Vulnerability, levers' triggers, deck, targets (Hidden GM)	—	—	—	—	sealed card only once fired	R/W	R exposure ranking only	—
Personal wallet, personal objective, personal cards (Personal)	own only	—	—	—	wallet balance at point of sale	R	R	objective only
Info card truth status, Rumour Register (Hidden GM)	—	—	—	—	Media sees outcome for the card shown	R/W	—	—
Institution Earned-tier items, whispers (Institution)	when rule met	—	—	—	R	R	R	—

Object (class)	Participant	Own company staff	Company leadership	Named-domain staff	Desk volunteer	GMs (all lanes)	Tech Lead	Observer / Ledger Lead
on)								
Customer card hidden need, best fit (Institution / GM)	earned / —	—	—	—	R / —	R	R	—
Investor lead thesis (Hidden GM until Tick 8, then Public)	from T8	from T8	from T8	from T8	Investor from T8	R	from T8	from T8
Credit grade (Company + Bank)	—	R	R	R	Bank only	R	R	—
Founder Ledger entries, bands, reads (Observer)	—	—	—	—	tip slips W only	R (forwards flags, panel)	—	R/W
Company scores E, O, frontier	after results	after results	after results	after results	—	R	R/W	bottom-half list only, after winners fixed
Audit log, snapshot	—	—	—	—	—	R	R	—

Object (class)	Participant	Own company staff	Company leadership	Named-domain staff	Desk volunteer	GMs (all lanes)	Tech Lead	Observer / Ledger Lead
s								
Feature toggles and current preset (Public)	R	R	R	R	R	R/W (any GM lane)	R	R
Company dashboard: runway, resource lines, deadlines, value against start, layers met, digest (Company; private objective layer: CEO only)	—	R	R	R	—	R	R	—
Investor appointment board (Company, own slot)	—	R own slot	R/W book from T7	R own slot	Investor R/W	R/W	R	—
Valuation ceiling,	—	—	—	—	Investor R	R	R	—

Object (class)	Participant	Own company staff	Company leadership	Named-domain staff	Desk volunteer	GMs (all lanes)	Tech Lead	Observer / Ledger Lead
RV × thesis fit multiple (Institution)								
Asker's cross-desk history and desk notes (Institution)	—	—	—	—	R for the asker, any desk; W own notes	R	R	—
Media auto-copy inbox (Institution)	—	—	—	—	Media R/W	R	R	—
Founder Dossier and company inbox (Company)	—	R	R	R	—	R/W	R/W	R
Whisper and signal deliveries (Personal)	own only	—	—	—	—	R/W (Crisis GM, Lead GM)	R	—
Ruling log (Hidden GM;	public rulings	public rulings	public rulings	public rulings	public rulings	R/W	R	public rulings

Object (class)	Participant	Own company staff	Company leadership	Named-domain staff	Desk volunteer	GMs (all lanes)	Tech Lead	Observer / Ledger Lead
Public once marked public)								

Four rules the developer must test by trying to break them: a station view never shows another company's rows; nothing tagged Hidden GM is in any non-GM file or API payload; the Founder Ledger and company scoring share only participant and company IDs; a feature switched off in the GM Console refuses the API call and returns no payload, even when called directly (D3).

10. After Oct 10: debrief and hardening

The first live run is the requirements test for everything after it. Spend the two weeks after the event on what it reveals, not on new features.

Step	Work	Done when
Debrief (Oct 11 to 24)	Post-event report Part 4 with platform data: settlement durations, refused transactions by reason, desk queue times, every GM correction, every module that fell back to paper and why	A ranked list of the 10 most painful steps
Replay	Load Oct 10's journal into a clean database and re-run every boundary	Every CompanyTick row reproduces exactly
Finish Tier C	City Net, People Directory, messaging, price index, M&A and new-venture flows, analytics	Each is used in a tabletop before the next run
Hardening	Load test at 150 participants, security review of role access, automated restore drill, compact 7-tick parameter set (Event Ops compact day)	Passes before the next event's rules freeze

11. Open questions for the owner and developer

Each has a default already written into this spec. The first two should be settled today because they change what gets printed or booked.

- ☒ **Physical money and tokens. Decided: dropped.** The platform journal is the only record of cash and units. Event Ops 8.4 and every doc that mentions serialised VB notes, resource tokens or physical counts is being updated to match.
- ☒ **Venue network. Decided: local server.** The platform is hosted on a local server at the venue, so the internet connection is not a dependency. The local network must still carry about 130 devices; test it on site by Friday.
- ☒ **Developer on call. Decided:** the on-call developer is announced at the event and staffs a participant helpdesk all day.
- ☒ **Complexity audit additions. Decided 2026-10-05 (owner decision after the complexity audit):** GM Console per-feature toggles with Dark, Closed-net and Open-net presets enforced on the server (D3, Tier A); five GM accounts with lanes and a shared ruling log (D11, Tier A); company dashboard runway, resource lines and deadlines (D6, Tier A) with value against start, layers met and digest (Tier B); investor booking board and ceiling display (D7), desk cross-desk history, Earned flags and Media inbox (D8), deal builder templates (D9, validation and sending Tier A), whisper and signal sender (D10), sealed auction bids with cash reservation (all Tier B). Observer view, info-card exclusivity and warranty, Media product screens and the in-app Rumour Register move to Tier C. C23 Data Breach moves to Tick 6 (D4), so the exposure ranking covers four C1 cards. Added 2026-10-05 (owner decision in the Company Dossiers thread): the Founder Dossier document view and the scheduled company inbox with GM manual send, both Tier A because they reuse InboxMessage and the Dark preset.
- ☐ **Tier B order.** Default order if time runs short (updated 5 Oct): Investor and cap table with booking board and ceiling (needed at Tick 7 and 8), deal templates, exposure ranking with whisper and signal sender, missions and opportunities, objectives, auctions with sealed bids, dashboard value against start and digest, desk Earned flags and Media inbox, information cards. Observer view is now Tier C.
- ☐ **Information-card copies.** Default: digital copies with provenance, as Human Internet 8 specifies. If the info-card module is a no-go, sales transfer the printed original only.
- ☐ **Dark phase.** Human Internet I (10:05 to 10:35 since 5 Oct) runs under the Dark preset: phones may stay out but can only read their own Founder Dossier, role card and objective. Trade Slips from 10:05 to 10:35 stay on paper and are keyed by desks at Market Open. Default: a "bulk entry" screen for the Help Desk.
- ☐ **Participant data.** Names and badge IDs live in the platform database. Default: staff-only access to the roster, deletion after the 14-day reports, matching Founder ID's retention note.

Sources: the original Technology section of the [source draft](/mnt/project-files/Draft - Build a Venture Event Structure - PVL.docx), and the finished documents as linked in project memory: Starting World, Master Catalogue, Company Dossiers, Passport Packs, Personal Objectives, Core Game Systems, Dynamic Events (plus event-crisis-library.csv), Human Internet, Institution Operating Content, GM Handbook, Event Operations Manual, Participant Handbook, Founder Identification System, and the [Investor Day Playbook](#).

Venture City — Participant Handbook, Quick Start & FAQ

Oct 5, 2026 · @Nero Kami

The day at a glance

Venture City runs on **Saturday 10 October 2026, 9:00 to 18:00**, in the 9th and 11th floor Seminar Halls, BE Block, RR Campus. Entry is free, lunch and snacks are provided, and you must bring your ID card.

Time	What happens
09:00	Doors open. Check in with your ID card, collect your badge and company pack
09:30 to 10:05	City Opens: welcome, company reveal, meet your team, read your Founder Dossier on the platform, elect your signatories
10:05 to 10:35	Human Internet I: the city's first big information session
10:35	Market opens. Tick 1 starts
12:35 to 13:05	Lunch. The city clock is paused, nothing moves while you eat
13:05	Market resumes
16:05	Market freeze. No more deals, trades or filings
16:25	Investor Day: every company pitches to an investor panel, in two rooms at once
about 17:30 to 17:50	Results and awards
18:00	Close

The main market is in the larger hall. The second Investor Day room is in the smaller hall on the other floor. Lunch is served on the 13th floor. Volunteers will point you the right way.

Bring: ID card, a fully charged phone (you play the game on it), a charger or power bank, a pen.

Registration closes 9 October 2026. **Questions:** analyst@pesuventurelabs.com.

The game runs on the Venture City platform. It is a web app you open in your phone's browser over the venue Wi-Fi. Your wallet, your company's cash and resources, your information cards, deals, missions and objectives all live there. All VB is digital: there are no paper notes or tokens. A Help Desk with a developer on call runs all day if anything goes wrong.

Part 1: Quick Start Guide

You have a company. You have people. You have limited money. Go create value.

Venture City is a live, one-day startup economy. You work inside a real-feeling company, alongside real people, in a city full of customers, banks, suppliers, investors and rivals. Nobody will tell you the best move. You find it by talking to people, making deals and acting. You do not need any business background to do well.

What you get at check-in

- **A company.** You are assigned to one at random. You do not choose it, and that is on purpose.
- **A Founder Dossier.** About four pages on your company: who you are, your money and resources, your obligations, customers and leads, who you depend on and your known deadlines. Everyone on your team has the same one, on the platform from City Opens.
- **A Role Card.** Your area of work, such as Growth / Sales or Operations. It says what your team looks to you for. It never stops you doing anything else.
- **Your own pocket.** A personal wallet of 1,000 VB, one personal information card and one secret personal objective. These belong to you, not your company. You see and use all of this, and everything your company owns, on the Venture City platform on your phone. There is no paper money.

Your first hour

1. **Read your Founder Dossier, fast.** Open it on the platform and find three things: how many ticks of money your company has left, which resource runs out first, and the problem you cannot solve alone. Your company dashboard shows the first two at a glance.
2. **Elect two Authorised Signatories.** Your team picks two people who approve spending alongside your CEO. This is your first leadership decision of the day.
3. **Human Internet I (10:05).** Your phone can stay out, but the platform only lets you read your own Founder Dossier, Role Card and objective. No deals, trades or chat on it until the market opens, and personal buys go on paper Trade Slips. The only way to learn anything is to talk to people. Write things down, because you cannot look anything up.
4. **Find who you need.** Your company depends on someone else in the city. Work out who, and start talking.
5. **Agree your first deal.** Deals made before the market opens are recorded as Proposed and go live at Tick 1.

How time works

The city runs in **ticks**. Each tick is 30 minutes and there are 10 of them, from 10:35 to the freeze at 16:05. At the end of every tick the city settles: salaries are paid, resources are used up, contracts pay out and new events land. Watch the Venture City Live screen for what changed.

Five ways to create value

Do this	Who you go to
---------	---------------

Do this	Who you go to
Sell something to a customer	Customer desk, or another company that needs what you make
Trade resources, information or help with other companies	Other participants
Complete a mission	The mission board
Spot an opportunity before others do	The Human Internet, desks, announcements
Borrow, raise investment or win a grant	Bank, Investor, Government

Six rules you cannot break

1. **If it is not recorded, it did not happen.** Every deal, sale and hire goes on the platform (or a paper Trade Slip when the platform is locked).
2. **Company money and your personal money are separate.** Spending company money needs a signatory or the CEO.
3. **You may bluff in conversation.** You may never forge a card or record, impersonate a volunteer or the Game Master, or write false terms into a deal.
4. **No outside internet or AI tools until the Internet Unlock at Tick 8 (14:35).** Before then, people are the internet.
5. **Rumours are about companies and markets, never about a real person.**
6. **The Game Master's ruling is final.** Ask any volunteer if you are unsure what is allowed.

Remember

- **VB is money, not your score.** A company with less cash and real customers can beat a company that hoarded VB.
- **Failure is not game over.** If your company fails, its people, assets and customers go back into the city, and you get a new game: join another company, go freelance or start your own.
- **Stuck?** Go to the Help Desk, ask your CEO, or just go talk to someone. Doing something beats planning everything.

Part 2: Participant Handbook

This is the full player rulebook. You do not need to memorise it. Read the Quick Start, start playing, and come back here when you need a detail. Numbers are the starting settings for this run; the Game Master (GM) announces any change on the Venture City Live screen.

1. What Venture City is

Venture City is a working economy that pauses one breath before the market opens, then runs for a day. There are companies, customers, banks, investors, suppliers, a government office, a media desk and rivals. Some of them are other participants; some are volunteers running city desks.

Your job is to make your company more valuable, or build something of your own, before the city closes. Every company plays by the same rules. Only the story, the starting numbers and the problems differ. **The rules are fixed. The world is not.** Prices move, shortages hit, crises land, and opportunities appear that nobody announced.

The basic loop is simple: understand your situation, find a person, find an opportunity, negotiate, act, record it, see what changes, then spot the next opportunity. Someone who acts and learns will beat someone who plans all day.

2. Your company

You are assigned at random. Teams are kept within one person of each other in size, and your role area is the one your company is shortest of. You do not pick, and that is deliberate: real founders rarely choose their starting conditions either.

Your Founder Dossier is your company's short briefing, the one thing your team reads at the start. It covers who you are, your money and resources, your obligations, customers and leads, who you depend on and your known deadlines. Every company starts with at least one problem it cannot solve alone, and the dossier tells you where to start, not how to win. The information you need to win lives in the city.

Your company dashboard is your company's live view on the platform, also shown on your Company Station. It shows your runway in ticks, each resource level against the 30, 15 and 0 lines, a countdown to your company's own deadlines, your value against where you started, how many of your objectives you have met, and a three-line note of what changed last tick after each settlement. Check it at the start of every tick. During the day, new messages for your company reach your company inbox on the platform.

Who runs the company:

- **The CEO** is a volunteer, not a participant. They set strategy, make hiring decisions and play a persona with one belief, one red line and one bias. They can approve any spending. They cannot be hired away and they do not make rules rulings.
- **Two Authorised Signatories** are participants your team elects at orientation. Either one can approve spending up to 5,000 VB. Anything above 5,000 VB needs the CEO or both signatories together. If a signatory leaves, the team elects a replacement at the next tick. If the CEO leaves, the two signatories run the company together.
- **Everyone else** can find opportunities, negotiate, propose deals and claim missions. Deals you negotiate are credited to you by name, even if someone else signs them.

Role areas. Each participant has a Role Card in one of seven areas: Product / Build, Growth / Sales, Operations, Finance / Capital, Brand / Community, Research / Intelligence, or Generalist / Founder. The card says what your team looks to you for. It never stops you acting outside it.

Something only some of you know. Your Founder Dossier ends with private facts, and a few people in your company may get a sealed insert that the rest do not. Your company's best move is often hidden inside your own team, so talk to each other early.

3. Money: Venture Bucks (VB)

VB is money, not your score. It pays for things. A company is not judged on how much VB it hoards but on what it built: customers, revenue, a strong team, a record of keeping its promises.

There are two kinds of money, and they never mix:

	Company cash	Your personal wallet
Starts with	Roughly 25,000 to 45,000 VB, shown in your Founder Dossier	1,000 VB
Pays for	Salaries, resources, loans, penalties	Information, freelance fees, angel investing (from 250 VB), funding a new venture
Gets paid by	Customers, missions, loans, investors, asset sales	Your salary, personal objective rewards, personal missions
Who controls it	Signatories and CEO	You
If you leave or the company fails	Stays with the company	Comes with you

Salary. You start at Level 0 on 100 VB per tick, paid from company cash into your wallet. Every tick you stay in the same role area, your level goes up by one, up to Level 5. The ladder is 100, 150, 225, 325, 450, then 600 VB per tick. Switching role area halves your level. You can ask for a raise any time and formally at the salary review in Tick 4, and again in Tick 8 if your company chooses to hold a second review; a pay cut needs your agreement.

Runway. Most companies have money for 7 to 9 ticks with no new income, and the day has 10. Every company has to find revenue, finance or a deal by mid-game.

4. Ticks: how the clock works

A tick is 30 minutes. There are 10 ticks, from 10:35 to the freeze at 16:05, with the clock paused for lunch. At the end of each tick the platform pauses for about 2 minutes and settles everything in this order: contract payments and deliveries come in first, then production, salaries, resource use, loan payments and staffing charges, then status checks, then new missions, prices and events. Because income lands before costs, a sale made this tick can pay this tick's bills. Anything you submit during the pause is queued, not lost.

Tick	Starts	What to watch for
1	10:35	Market opens, deals go live, salaries and resource use begin
2	11:05	
3	11:35	First auction session
4	12:05	Starting supplier agreements expire unless renewed. Salary

Tick	Starts	What to watch for
		review
Lunch	12:35	Clock paused until 13:05
5	13:05	Auction session
6	13:35	Anchor contracts finish and come up for renewal
7	14:05	Human Internet II: new information released. Auction session
8	14:35	Internet Unlock. Investor window opens. Optional second salary review (each company decides)
9	15:05	Last auction session
10	15:35	Ownership locks. Last chance for deals
Freeze	16:05	Nothing more can be recorded

5. Resources

Every company runs on six resources: **Compute, Energy, Logistics, Materials, Data and Infrastructure**. You start with 100 units of each. Every tick your company uses some of each, whether or not you sell anything: 4, 7, 10 or 14 units depending on how heavily your business relies on it. Your Founder Dossier shows your rates. You will be short of some resources and have spare of others. That imbalance is what makes trading worth it.

Watch your stock. At 30 units you get a warning. At 15, deliveries that need that resource cost 25% more of it. At 0, those deliveries stop. A heavily used resource at 0 for 2 ticks makes your company Distressed. Nothing is bought for you automatically.

Where to get more:

Source	Price	Limits
Bank	Base price: Compute 20, Energy 15, Logistics 20, Materials 15, Data 25, Infrastructure 30 VB per unit. Rises 20% to 50% when Bank stock runs low	Up to 30 units per resource per tick
Supplier Market	10% below base, 15% below for	Minimum order 20, paid up

Source	Price	Limits
	50+ units	front
Other companies	Whatever you agree	Anything goes, as long as it is recorded
Missions	Free, as a reward	Earned

The Bank buys spare resources back at 60% of base. Another company will usually pay more. Post what you need or want to sell on the **Market Board**. You can store up to 200 units of each resource; anything above that loses 10% per tick. Some products turn resources into other resources, and some missions or investments permanently lower how much you use.

6. People: hiring, moving and jobs

Talent is a market like any other. People move, and good people get poached.

- **Anyone can make you an offer, and you can accept any offer.** An offer states role, area, salary, any shares or bonus, and a start tick, and lasts at most one tick. When you accept, your current company is told at once and may counteroffer. You choose freely. The move happens at the next tick.
- **After a move you stay put for 2 ticks.** This cooldown does not apply if your company failed, was bought, or could not pay you.
- **Nobody can be fired.** A company and a person can agree a release, recorded like any deal. You can resign at any time and become a **Free Agent**.
- **Free Agents** earn no salary but keep their wallet and level. They can freelance for up to 2 companies at once, take on personal missions, join any company or start one.
- **Freelance jobs** last at most 2 ticks. The client's fee is held by the platform and released to you when they confirm, or one tick after you deliver if they stay silent. Companies post open roles on the **Talent Exchange** job board, and it also rents out outside specialists.
- **Empty seats cost money.** Each company needs a set number of people in each role area. Every required seat left empty costs the company 225 VB per tick. Companies start one seat short, so recruiting matters from minute one.
- **Fewer than 3 participants** makes a company Distressed. Poaching a company below 3 is legal.
- **Retention bonuses** can lock you in for up to 2 ticks. Leave early and you repay it from your wallet. **Share options** granted to you pay out at the end if you are still there, or straight away if your company is bought.

When you leave a company you lose access to its internal information at once. Your wallet, your personal cards, your objective, your level and your history come with you.

7. Deals

A deal is anything two parties agree: a sale, a resource swap, a supply contract, a loan, an investment, a licence, a revenue share, a hire, an information sale, a merger.

Negotiate in person. Record on the platform. A deal only counts when both sides' signers accept it on the platform (or a paper Trade Slip while the platform is locked). What was said out loud does not bind

anyone; only the recorded terms do. Each Deal Sheet lists who, what, the price, the timing, any conditions and penalties, how delivery will be proven, and who negotiated it. The platform refuses a sheet with a gap.

Draft it in the app. Anyone can draft a deal from a template: a resource swap, a supply contract, a loan, a hire, an information sale and more. Standard terms, such as late penalties and the platform record as proof, come filled in, so you only change what you agreed. The app checks the floor price and the 5,000 VB signatory limit, then you send it for signatures. Your signatories and the other side get a notification.

How a deal moves: Proposed (lapses if not accepted within 1 tick) → Accepted → Active → Delivered (the buyer has 1 tick to accept or dispute) → Completed. Every completed deal counts on both sides'

Reliability Record. Every breach and missed payment counts too, and banks, investors and customers all read that record.

Default terms if your sheet says nothing: a late delivery costs 10% of that tick's value per missed tick; a late payment grows 10% per tick, up to 30%; either side may end the deal after 2 breaches in a row.

Price rules. Between participants, any price is fine. City desks only trade at their published prices. You can never sell a product below the floor price on its Product Card.

Proof. Missions, objectives and some deals need evidence. In order of strength: the platform record itself, confirmation from the other party, a desk's approval, a GM or staff witness, or a document you submit. Your own teammates cannot confirm things for you, and evidence must be created after the claim.

Disagreements. The two sides get 10 minutes to sort it out and record a fix. If they cannot, the relevant desk or the Deal Desk decides, and the GM handles anything bigger. Rulings follow the recorded terms.

8. Missions

Missions are defined tasks with a reward, posted on the **mission board**. The board always shows a few more missions than there are companies and refills every tick. Rewards come from the city, not from another company.

Tier	Typical reward	Time to finish once claimed
Tier 1	250 to 500 VB, or 5 to 10 resource units	1 tick
Tier 2	750 to 1,500 VB, 15 to 25 units, or an introduction or discount	2 ticks
Tier 3	2,000 to 3,000 VB, 25 to 50 units, or a strategic unlock such as credit or tender access	2 ticks
Crisis	Tier 2 reward, plus your company escapes the crisis effect	Until the crisis deadline

Some missions are first-come, some are a race where the first 2 verified finishers win, and some are open to all. You can hold 2 claims at a time and your company 3. Failing a mission costs nothing, except crisis missions. Abandon one twice and you are blocked from claiming for a tick. Some missions are hidden and only appear when you find the right card, desk or person. Doing a Tier 2 or 3 mission in your own role area also earns an extra level.

9. Opportunities and auctions

An opportunity is not a mission. It is an open situation with no set method: a customer with an unmet need, a supplier with spare capacity, a company that needs rescuing. Everyone may see the signal; only the person who digs finds the detail (who, how much, when, on what terms). Discovery is personal: you decide whether to bring it to your company, sell the detail, or act on it yourself.

You find opportunities through information cards, by asking desks the right question (they never volunteer the detail), as mission rewards, by doing business with someone and learning what they need next, and from other players. Most expire 2 ticks after they appear. The first recorded commitment usually wins. Every company also has one exclusive Growth Opportunity that unlocks when it meets a condition. Finding it is part of the game.

Auctions run at Ticks 3, 5, 7 and 9, announced at least a tick ahead. Lots include extra Compute, priority delivery slots, specialist talent, warehouse space, introductions to big customers, media bursts, licences and the assets of failed companies. Only signatories, or someone holding a written bid mandate from them, can bid for a company. Bids must be covered by cash. Each company can win at most one lot per session, and a strategic lot not used within 2 ticks goes back with no refund. Bidding against yourself through a friend is cheating.

10. The city's institutions

The institutions are desks run by volunteers. Before the market opens they answer questions only. From Tick 1 they trade. They give everyone the public answers; detail, capacity and inside tips are earned by doing business with them, asking the right question, or paying a consultation fee. They never reveal another company's business.

Desk	Go here for
Bank	Buying and selling resources; loans of 5,000, 10,000 or 20,000 VB if you can show revenue or contracts; loans against assets; one emergency loan for companies in trouble. Total Bank debt is capped at 30,000 VB. Two missed repayments in a row is a default
Investor	Investment of 5,000 to 25,000 VB in exchange for shares, only once the investor window opens (planned for Tick 8). Book a meeting in the app from Tick 7; meetings start at Tick 8. A round can give away at most 40% of the company

Desk	Go here for
Customer desk	Customer requests with a budget, a must-have and a deadline. You win them with a proposal, evidence and a price
Talent Exchange	The job board and outside specialists for hire
Supplier Market	Resources in bulk, cheaper than the Bank
Logistics Provider	Delivery capacity: standard (next tick) or priority (immediate, 1.5 times the price)
Government	Licences, grants (in a set window) and tenders
Media	Fact checks, featured stories and publishing
Help Desk	Rules questions, paper backups, problems with the platform

You can also lend to, borrow from and invest in other participants and companies. Angel investing starts at 250 VB from your wallet.

11. When things go wrong

Distressed is a public warning flag. A company becomes Distressed if, after a tick settles, its cash is below zero, it has defaulted on a loan, it has fewer than 3 participants, or a key resource has been at zero for 2 ticks. It then has 2 ticks to fix every problem: sell assets, raise money, take the emergency loan, or agree a rescue.

Failure is not game over. It is a new game. If a company cannot recover, it fails. Its assets are auctioned, unpaid salaries are paid before most other debts, and its customers go back to the Customer desk for others to win. Its people become Free Agents immediately, keep their wallets and can move at once with no cooldown. Many of the best stories of the day come from people whose company failed and who then joined a rival, rescued a customer, bought the assets cheaply, or started something new.

12. Starting something new, buying and merging

Once the GM opens the **Founder Window**, you can start a company.

- **New venture:** 3 or more people, 10,000 VB committed from your wallets or resources, a founder agreement and a resource agreement. You then draw a sealed company at random and run it yourselves, with no volunteer CEO.
- **Spin-out:** 3 or more people, at least 2 from the parent company, 10,000 VB, a product, one customer or letter of intent, and the parent's shareholders' approval. The parent usually keeps 20%.
- Either way, you must record a sale or customer contract within 2 ticks or the new company becomes Distressed. Each person can found only once, and only a limited number of new companies can start in one day, first come first served.

Shares. Every company has 1,000 shares: 800 held by the founding holder, voted by the CEO and the two signatories, and 200 for staff options. Selling the company, merging, spinning out or issuing more than 10% new shares needs a shareholder majority.

Buying and merging. A company can buy another company (with its shareholders' agreement), buy its assets, or hire its team. There are no hostile takeovers. Nobody is moved against their will; anyone who declines becomes a Free Agent with no cooldown. A buyer takes on everything the company has, good and bad. All ownership locks at the start of Tick 10.

13. The Human Internet and information

The internet is down. The people around you are now the internet. Until Tick 8, nobody can look anything up online. What you know, you learned from someone.

Period	Devices	What works
Human Internet I (10:05 to 10:35)	Out, but the platform is read-only: your own Founder Dossier, Role Card and objective	Talking, paper notes, printed cards, paper Trade Slips
Orientation, and Ticks 1 to 7	The Venture City platform only, plus a calculator or notes app	Your wallet, cards, deals and missions on the platform. No chat, no search, no web, no AI
Tick 8 to the end (from 14:35)	Everything	Web, AI tools, platform messaging, search of all public city records

Personal emergencies always come first: step outside and take the call.

Information comes as cards. Every useful fact you can trade is an information card, and every card shows a grade:

Grade	Means	Typical price
Rumour	No traceable source	0 to 150 VB
Reported	A named source, not checked yet	100 to 300 VB
Corroborated	Two independent sources agree. Usually right, not guaranteed	150 to 400 VB
Verified	A desk or the Media fact desk stands behind it, as of a stated tick	200 to 600 VB
Debunked	Checked and found false	Kept as evidence

Some cards are wrong. Some are false, some only partly true, some out of date, and you cannot tell from the card's face. Nobody, including the GM and volunteers, will tell you if a card is true. They will tell you who can check it.

How to check a card: show it to the desk it is about, which can confirm or deny it for free (they say "no comment" if it touches another company's private business); match it with a second card from a different source, which is free; or pay the Media desk 250 VB for a fact check.

Words are free, cards are proof. Anyone can repeat what they heard, but only a card you hold can be verified, used as mission evidence, redeemed at a desk or resold. You can share a card free, sell a copy, sell it exclusively for some ticks, or hand over the original. Personal cards earn money for your wallet; company cards need a signatory and the money goes to the company. Some cards are **Key** cards that unlock a real offer at a desk. A key works once, for whoever gets there first, so buy the original and use it fast.

Your company's own secrets are in other people's pockets. Nobody holds a card about their own company. To learn about yourself, ask outsiders.

At **Human Internet II** (Tick 7), volunteers hand new cards to random people around the floor, so ask around again. At the **Internet Unlock** (Tick 8), a lot of desk information becomes public, so information you have been sitting on may lose its value. Sell or use it first.

14. Your personal objective

Everyone gets one secret personal objective at check-in, such as "Turn a No into a Yes", "Recruit the Missing Skill" or "Make Someone Else Win". It is yours, not your company's, and it comes with you if you move.

- Finishing your first objective pays **500 VB** into your wallet. Each follow-on pays **250 VB**. You get a new one at the next tick, up to 3 completions in total.
- You may swap your objective once, free, until the end of Tick 7. Nothing new is dealt from Tick 9, but you can finish what you hold until the freeze.
- Some complete automatically from the platform record. Otherwise claim in the app with evidence, and a desk checks it within 10 minutes. The other party must be outside your company.
- You may tell anyone what your objective is, or keep it quiet. Your call.
- Objectives do not count toward your company's result and no award is given just for completing them.

15. Investor Day and the end of the day

At **16:05 the market freezes**. Nothing more can be recorded. Ownership already locked at the start of Tick 10.

At **16:25 Investor Day** begins, in two rooms at once. Each company gets about 9 minutes: 5 minutes to pitch, 3 minutes of investor questions, 1 minute to change over. Your team decides who presents.

Prepare between 16:05 and 16:25. At the freeze each company receives a Frozen Snapshot of its final numbers. Your team writes a one-page **Pitch Sheet**: the seven beats of your story, up to three claims

you will defend with evidence from the snapshot, and your ask (amount, use of funds, and the milestone it buys). Hand it in at your room's door by 16:25.

The seven beats of your pitch:

1. What we started with
2. What changed
3. What we built
4. What customers valued
5. How we survived
6. Where the opportunity is now
7. Why this team should continue

The panel trusts evidence, not confidence. Investors check your claims against public city records, your recorded deals and your Verified cards. A claim backed only by rumour carries no weight. A smaller company with real customers and a clean Reliability Record can beat a bigger one with a great speech.

Results and awards follow at about 17:30. There is one company award, **Best Venture**. It goes to a company that no other company beats on both value created and objectives met. If several companies qualify, the fund's Investor Day decision chooses among them. There are also ten individual awards (see section 16). Company results and founder awards are decided separately; neither affects the other, so you can win an individual award even if your company failed.

16. Who is watching, and why

Venture City is run by PESU Venture Labs, and part of its purpose is to find people with the instincts to build things. Some staff on the floor keep the city's records of what people actually did and what changed as a result.

This is not an exam, and there is no right answer to perform. Here is what that means for you:

- **What counts is what you did, not how you sounded.** A good pitch or a loud voice earns nothing by itself.
- **Quiet work counts as much as loud work.** The person who fixed the supply problem or made the introduction is noticed as much as the person who closed the deal.
- **Your record is yours, not your company's.** Your company's cash or rank never enters it. Saving a company that later fails still counts, and you can change company or found one without losing anything.
- **Staff do not help, hint or react.** If you ask them a game question, they will point you to the right desk.

Individual awards: Founder of the Day, Most Promising Founder, Best Commercial Operator, Best Negotiator, Resource Hacker, Best Talent Builder, Best Opportunity Spotter, Best Crisis Leader, Best Pivot, and The Invisible Force, for the person whose quiet work made others' success possible. Each person can win at most one. An award can go ungiven if nobody earned it.

After the event, within 7 days, every participant gets a short summary of their strengths and two or three moments from their day. Some participants will be invited to future Venture Labs programmes. Records are kept by Venture Labs only, and you can ask to see your own summary.

17. Fair play

Allowed	Not allowed
Bluffing, keeping secrets, declining to answer	Forging or changing a card, Trade Slip or platform record
Selling an unchecked card without a guarantee	Pretending to be a volunteer, a desk or the GM, or claiming a desk said something it did not
Poaching people from other companies	Writing false terms into a recorded deal
Teaming up with other companies, joint bids	Bidding against yourself through a friend at auction
Publishing a rumour about a company through the Media desk	Rumours about a real person's character, looks or private life
Using a calculator or notes app from orientation	Outside internet, AI tools or group chats before Tick 8

If a rumour you published is later debunked, the Media desk prints a correction naming your company, and customers ask your company for extra evidence for the next 2 ticks.

Anything found to break the rules is reversed by the GM. Deals made only to farm a reward and undone straight after lose the reward. Very cheap deals and deals between a company and its own staff are flagged for review. **The GM's ruling is final.**

Words you will hear

Word	Meaning
Tick	One 30-minute round, ending in settlement
VB	Venture Bucks, the city's money
Signatory	One of two elected people who approve company spending
Distressed	A public warning flag; 2 ticks to fix it
Free Agent	A participant with no company, free to freelance, join or found
Reference Valuation	Your company's public value: what it owns minus what it owes, plus credit for recent customer revenue
Reliability Record	Public tally of promises kept and broken
Market Board	Public list of resources wanted and offered

Word	Meaning
Founder Window	The period when new companies can be started
Internet Unlock	Tick 8, when outside internet and AI become allowed
Freeze	16:05, end of play

Part 3: FAQ

Volunteers: if a participant asks something covered here, give this answer. If it is not covered, send them to the Help Desk rather than guessing.

Before the day

I don't know anything about business. Will I be lost? No. Nobody needs a business background, and the rules are designed to be picked up in the first 30 minutes. Most of what wins here is ordinary: talking to people, noticing what someone needs, keeping your promises, and acting before you feel completely sure. People with no business training regularly do very well.

Do I need to register as a team? No. Everyone registers individually and is placed in a company on the day. Registration closes on 9 October 2026.

What should I bring? Your ID card (you need it to check in), a fully charged phone, a charger or power bank, and a pen. Lunch and snacks are provided. Entry is free.

Do I need my own phone? Yes. The whole game runs on the Venture City web platform, which you open in your phone's browser over the venue Wi-Fi. There is no app to install and no paper money. If your phone dies or will not connect, go to the Help Desk straight away.

I'm going to be late. Can I still play? Yes. You will join the smallest company. There is no catch-up money, so come on time if you can: the first hour is where a lot of the best deals are made.

Your company and team

Can I choose my company, or be with my friends? No. Companies are assigned at random so every team is a mix of strangers, like a real job. From Tick 1 you can accept a job offer from any company, so if your friends want you, they can recruit you.

Isn't it unfair that some companies start with more money? Every company plays by exactly the same rules. A company that starts rich also carries heavier obligations; one that starts poor has a better hidden advantage to find. Companies start with different problems, not different odds.

I don't like my team, or my role. What can I do? You can act outside your role at any time; the Role Card only says what your team expects from you. If you want to leave, you can accept an offer from another company or resign and become a Free Agent. Your wallet, personal cards and objective come with you. After a move you stay put for 2 ticks.

Can I be fired? No. Nobody can be fired. A company can only agree a release with you, and you have to agree too.

Can I become the CEO? The CEO of each starting company is a volunteer. You can lead in other ways: be elected a signatory, run the deal that saves the company, or start your own company and lead that.

What does the CEO actually decide? Strategy, hiring and big spending. They play a persona with their own beliefs and biases, so you may have to persuade them. They do not make rules rulings; the Help Desk and the GM do.

Money, winning and scoring

How do I win? There is no single winner. Companies compete for the Best Venture award, which goes to a company that no other company beats on both value created and objectives met; if several qualify, the fund's Investor Day decision chooses among them. Individuals compete for ten separate awards based on what they did. You can win an individual award even if your company did badly.

Does the company with the most VB win? No. VB is money, not score. Money sitting in the bank does very little. Customers, revenue, a strong team and a record of keeping promises count for more.

Is VB real money? Can I keep it? No. VB only exists inside Venture City and has no value outside the event.

Does my own VB count toward anything? No. Personal wallets are money, not score.

Is this graded? Am I being judged? It is not an exam, and there is nothing to perform. Venture Labs staff keep records of what people actually did and what changed because of it, so that standout people can be recognised and invited to future programmes. Confidence, polish and volume earn nothing on their own. Quiet, useful work counts just as much.

What do I get out of this? A day of doing, not listening: selling, negotiating, hiring, raising money, handling a crisis and recovering from setbacks, with real people and real consequences. Within 7 days you get a short summary of your strengths and a few moments from your day. Some participants will be invited to future Venture Labs programmes.

When things go wrong

What if my company fails? It is not game over. It is a new game. You become a Free Agent immediately, keep your wallet, and can join any company or start one with no waiting period. Your company's customers and assets go back into the city, so you may be the person who knows best how to win them. Saving or rescuing a failing company still counts on your personal record.

Can I quit my company and start a new one? Yes, once the GM opens the Founder Window. You need at least 3 people, 10,000 VB between you (from wallets or resources), a founder agreement and a resource agreement. You then draw a company at random and run it yourselves. You must land a first customer within 2 ticks. Each person can found only once, and only a few new companies can start in a day, so do not leave it too late.

Someone broke a deal with us. What now? If it is recorded, the terms bind them. Late deliveries and payments carry automatic penalties, and every breach shows on their public Reliability Record. If you

disagree on what happened, you have 10 minutes to sort it out, then the Deal Desk or GM rules on the recorded terms. If it was only agreed out loud, nothing can be enforced, so always record.

What if the platform goes down? Carry on with paper Trade Slips, signed by both sides, and hand them to the Help Desk. They are entered when the platform is back.

What if I have to leave early? Tell your team and the Help Desk before you go. Your company pays a charge for every empty seat, so it helps them to know.

Rules and fair play

Can I lie? In conversation, yes. Bluffing and keeping secrets are part of business. You can never forge or alter a card or record, pretend to be a volunteer or the GM, or write false terms into a recorded deal.

Can I use my phone, Google or ChatGPT? During Human Internet I (10:05 to 10:35), your phone can stay out, but the platform only lets you read your own Founder Dossier, Role Card and objective: no deals, trades or chat, and personal buys go on paper Trade Slips. Otherwise, from orientation to the end of Tick 7, only the Venture City platform and a calculator or notes app. From Tick 8 (14:35), everything is allowed. A real emergency always comes first.

Can our company team up with another company? Yes. Partnerships, joint bids, shared contracts and even mergers are allowed. Working together is strategy, not cheating.

Can I tell people my personal objective? Yes, if you want to. Some objectives are easier with help. Others go better if nobody knows.

Is that card true? Nobody will tell you, including the GM. Check it: ask the desk it is about, find a second card from a different source, or pay the Media desk for a fact check.

Who do I ask about a rule? The Help Desk, or any volunteer. If it is unclear, the GM decides and that decision is final. CEOs and observers do not make rulings.